



AUS Policies and Procedures Manual

AY 2024-2025
Version 5

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Executive Summary

Founded in 1997, AUS envisioned to be an institution of education preeminence in the Arab world. Throughout its history, AUS has been firmly grounded in principles of meritocracy and the value of academic excellence, creating graduates who are positioned to become the innovators, thinkers, contributors and leaders.

In the support of the AUS compliance with the Ministry of Education, CAA (Commission for Academic Accreditation) Manual of “Standards for Institutional Licensure and Program Accreditation”, OIRA has compiled the AUS Policies and Procedures Manual. The Policy Manual guides the university operations, strategy, and workflow. The report has followed rigorously the CAA standards and includes all policies and procedures required by the stipulation set out in the *SIL* (*Standard of Institutional Licensure*). The report also includes additional policies and procedures outlined in the *Framework for the Compliance Inspection of Higher Education Institutions*. A [table](#) mapping the Inspection Compliance policies and procedures to CAA policies and procedures is provided in the appendix.

The AUS Policy and Procedures Manual presented herein followed the list of stipulations and the sub-stipulations mandated by CAA standards. To achieve these objectives, the team has developed a standardized and unified policy template and all policies are presented in this format. The template is comprehensive and covers the policy issuance, approval and next revision dates; policy purpose, policy statement, responsibilities, applicable abbreviations, scope history and finally and contact information of the designated departments/unit.

All policies are inspired by the vision and mission of the university that promote the excellence in teaching, learning, research and creative work, and nurture the institutional values of inclusive community, intellectual inquiry, integrity and active engagement.

All requested stipulations and sub-topics specified by the SIL are documented except those which do not apply: 1.i. Multiple Campuses Coordination Policy; 1.j. Campuses of UAE institutions in other countries Policy; 1.k. Branch Campuses of Foreign Institutional of other countries policy; and 6.o. Gender Segregation.

1. Governance and Management

a. Mission Development, Approval and Review Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0100IR01	Policy Title:	Mission Development, Approval and Review
Prepared By:	Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Chancellor	Effective Date:	August 26, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Review:	August 31, 2025

Vision

American University of Sharjah (AUS) seeks to be globally recognized as the leading university in the Arab World, renowned for outstanding teaching, learning, research and scholarship while fostering innovation that positively impacts society.

Mission

American University of Sharjah (AUS) is a comprehensive, independent, non-profit, coeducational institution of higher education that promotes excellence in teaching, learning, research and creative work.

Based on an American model of higher education, integrating liberal arts and professional programs, and grounded in the context of UAE culture, AUS prepares engaged and effective members of society who display mastery in their areas of specialization, communicate clearly, think critically and solve problems creatively.

AUS fosters a community that celebrates diversity, and whose members are committed to the ideals of open intellectual inquiry, ethical behavior and civic responsibility.

Policy History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 2013	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor
2.0	September 20, 2023	General Update	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	August 20, 2024	General update on the format	Office of the Chancellor

References

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Tel: +971 6 515 2225	oir@aus.edu

b. Organization of American University of Sharjah - Version 5

Policy Number:	0100BT02	Policy Title:	Organization of American University of Sharjah
Prepared By:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Issue Date:	March 3, 2011
Responsible Office:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Next Revision Date:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy outlines the job roles, reporting lines, and organizational structure for academic and administrative leaders at the American University of Sharjah (AUS).

2. Purpose:

AUS has academic and administrative structures that facilitate the achievement of its mission and strategic objectives. This policy allocates the authorities and responsibilities to determine AUS's organizational and governance structure, communicates the university's key organizational and departmental activities, and outlines the relationships between different units and departments.

3. Introduction/ Background:

Not available

4. Policy Statement:

The senior administration has continuously grown in response to the evolving nature and expansion of programs at AUS since its establishment in 1997. At present, the senior officers reporting to the Chancellor are:

- Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
- Vice Chancellor for Student Experience
- Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
- Vice Chancellor for External Relations
- Vice Chancellor for Research
- Chief of Protocol and Security
- Executive Director for Advancement and Alumni Affairs
- Director of Board of Trustee Affairs
- Director of Institutional Research and Analysis
- Director of Strategic Communications and Marketing
- Director of Internal Audit

As AUS's Chief Executive Officer, the Chancellor, in collaboration with the Board of Trustees (BOT), is responsible for defining the qualifications, duties, scope of activities, and accountability measures for each officer and establishing evaluation and compensation methods. The Chancellor's Office manages the development, publication, periodic review, and updating of position descriptions for these roles.

The BOT, in conjunction with the Chancellor, assesses the portfolios of various senior officers. They may create, modify, consolidate, or eliminate these portfolios as needed. The Chancellor's Office keeps current and archived position descriptions for all senior officers, including the Chancellor.

When implementing the position description policy, the Chancellor's Office presents the position description of the most senior officer to the BOT before a vacancy or contract renewal. The BOT's relevant Standing Committee reviews and updates the description in collaboration with the Chancellor, focusing on portfolio and reporting structure adjustments. Any changes are incorporated, and the senior officer and relevant offices are notified. In case of a vacancy, the updated description guides the

recruitment and selection process. The Chancellor and the BOT review Position descriptions at least once every three years to ensure alignment with AUS's administrative and leadership needs.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy applies to the entire organizational structure of AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

The Chancellor

With due regard to the provisions of Article No. 10 of the Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023 Concerning the Reorganization of the AUS, the Chancellor shall be appointed by a Resolution of the President after such appointment is approved by the Board. The Chancellor shall be responsible before the President in carrying out his/ her duties. The Chancellor's salary and other financial and in-kind privileges shall be determined by the President.

The Chancellor shall:

- Be in charge of administering the University employees and be responsible before the Chair and the Board.
- Be responsible for executing Board policies to operate, develop, and promote the University's objectives.
- Perform such acts, duties, and responsibilities as shall, in his/her judgment, promote the interests of the University consistent with the provisions of the Law, these Bylaws, and Board policies.
- Preside or designate an appropriate University officer to preside at public academic occasions and represent the University before the public.
- Keep the President, Board, and Executive Committee regularly informed of the University's activities, developments, operations, and affairs.
- Be responsible for maintaining full accreditation in the UAE and the US for the institution and specific professional degree programs.
- Have other powers and duties as assigned by the Chair.

The Board of Trustees

The BOT is the ultimate governing and decision-making body within AUS. The BOT is entrusted with the power and authority to manage AUS, enabling it to achieve the objectives established in its Bylaws. The BOT plays a crucial role in guiding AUS to fulfill its mission by making decisions that shape institutional policies, academic programs, financial management, and operations.

The BOT appoints and evaluates the Chancellor and oversees the appointment of senior academic and administrative leaders. Its oversight authority and policy-level leadership include establishing institutional plans and policies, approving budgets, and securing the financial resources to provide impactful academic programs, state-of-the-art facilities, and infrastructure, and combine to create an exceptional student experience. To ensure academic programs are aligned with Sharjah's socio-economic growth and workforce development needs, the BOT also plays a key role in shaping AUS's academic and research policies, including the establishment of colleges and schools, the creation of research centers, and the approval of new programs.

While it can delegate some powers to the Chancellor and other senior academic and administrative leaders, the BOT's institutional governance responsibilities and obligations include the authority, powers, and duties to:

- Approve and update AUS's vision, mission, strategies, and objectives.
- Develop and implement major institutional strategies to fulfill AUS's mission.
- Monitor AUS's operational performance and update policies as necessary.
- Set tuition and fees and approve the annual operating and capital budgets.

- Appoint the Chancellor and senior academic and administrative leaders and approve the salary structure and terms of employment for employees.

7. Definitions/ Abbreviations/ Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** The Board of Trustees is an appointed group of individuals responsible for the management and governance of an organization.
- **Bylaws:** Bylaws generally refer to laws, rules, and decrees issued or enacted by the institution to govern itself. Bylaws specify the hierarchy, main powers, and responsibilities of principal departments and bodies of an institution. The AUS Bylaws govern the organization of the university with relation to the formation, responsibilities, and authorities of the BOT and the appointment, duties, and powers of the Chancellor.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

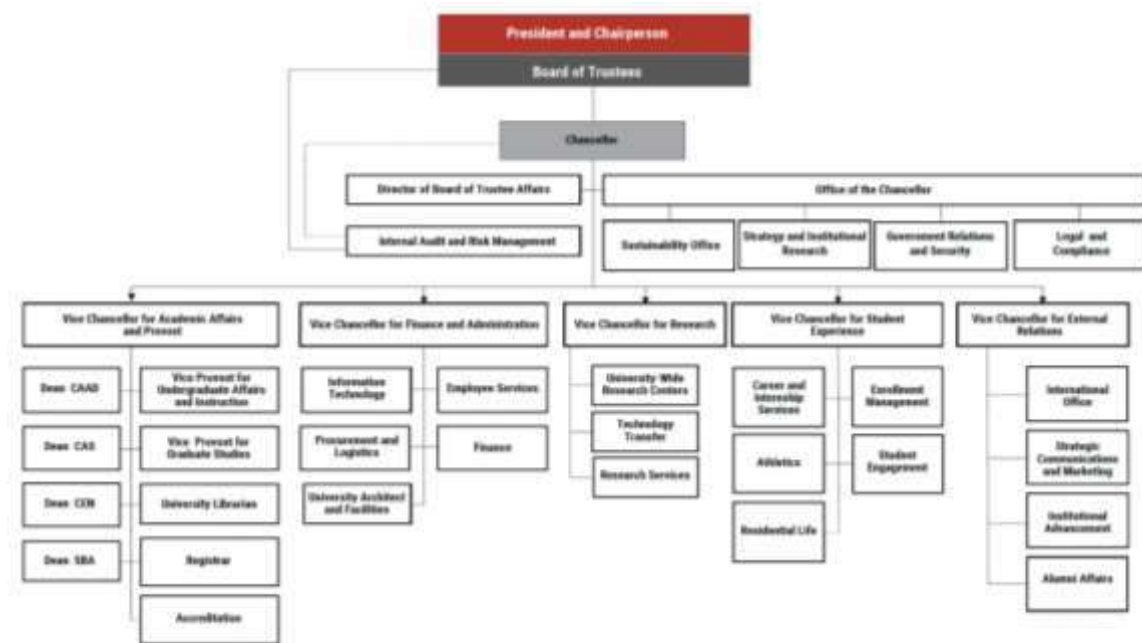
American University of Sharjah Constitution and Bylaws

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the United Arab Emirates (UAE), Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of the American University of Sharjah (AUS), has issued Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023 Concerning The Reorganization of AUS; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Consultative Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah, its executive regulations, and amendments thereof; Amiri decree (53) of 2023 Regarding the Formation of the Board of Trustees of American University of Sharjah.

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the UAE, Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of AUS, has issued Emiri Decree No. (53) of 2023 Concerning The Formation of the AUS Board of Trustees; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Decree of Law No. (3) of 2023 concerning the Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah; and requirement of the public interest.

Organizational Chart

The University's organizational Chart is designed to indicate reporting relationships between units and departments and visualize the hierarchy of authority for all leadership positions. The Organizational Chart conceptualizes the flow of information, policy decisions, and how they are developed, transmitted, and shared between different departments. The Organizational Chart is also important for auditing purposes, reporting relationships required by human resources, and budgetary decisions.



Job Descriptions

- [Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost Job Description](#)
- [Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration Job Description](#)
- [Chief of Protocol and Security Job Description](#)
- [Executive Director for Advancement and Alumni Affairs Job Description](#)
- [Executive Director of Student Experience Job Description](#)
- [Director of Board of Trustee Affairs Job Description](#)
- [Director of Institutional Research and Analysis Job Description](#)
- [Director of Strategic Communications and Marketing Job Description](#)
- [Director of Internal Audit Job Description](#)

9. Policy History:

This policy was initially introduced and issued in 1998. The AUS Bylaws established the BOT and put rules and regulations governing the appointment and election of the board members. The policy was part of the Emiri Decree No. 5 of the year 1998 on Bylaws of Law No, 3 of the Year 1998 that established the AUS.

10.Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of Changes	Requested By
1.0	March 3, 2011	Initial policy Release	OIRA
2.0	May 1, 2017	General Update	OIRA
3.0	April 30, 2019	General Update	OIRA
4.0	June 1, 2021	General Update	OIRA
5.0	June 1, 2024	Comprehensive Update: Changing of the Responsible Office; Sections 3, 5,	OIRA

		7, 8, 9; New Organizational Chart; New Job Descriptions	
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11. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

c. Terms of Reference of Standing Committees - Version 4

Policy Number:	0100BT03	Policy Title:	Terms of Reference of Standing Committees
Prepared By:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Issue Date:	March 3, 2011
Responsible Office:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy delineates the composition and responsibilities of the established Standing Committees of the American University of Sharjah (AUS) according to their respective fields or jurisdictions and in accordance with the university's ByLaws.

2. Purpose:

AUS aims to formalize the role of its Standing Committees, which are responsible for proposing decisions and recommending actions concerning the university's academic and administrative governance. This policy aims to outline each committee's roles and authorities to ensure clear and effective governance and decision-making processes within the institution.

3. Introduction/ Background:

Not available

4. Policy Statement:

The BOT has seven Standing Committees, each headed by a committee chair and composed of three or more trustee committee members. The Chairperson designates, from among the Board of Trustee (BOT) members, standing committee chairs.

The board holds three annual regular meetings, typically scheduled in October/November, January/February, and May/June to coincide with commencement. The Chairperson, in consultation with the trustees, determines the meeting date, time, and venue, providing written notice to the trustees at least 30 days in advance. Meeting materials are shared with trustees at least two weeks in advance of scheduled meetings.

Board meetings are typically held in Sharjah, allowing for in-person attendance while also accommodating virtual participation for trustees unable to be physically present. Trustees are encouraged to attend in person to foster connections with students, faculty, and staff and familiarize themselves with the campus. Occasionally the board may invite representatives from the AUS community, including faculty, staff, students, and alumni, to participate as non-voting guests in committee or board meetings.

Standing committee meetings are conducted online two weeks prior to the three annual regular meetings of the full BOT. Committee Chairs have the authority to call additional meetings when necessary. Chairs set the meeting date, time, and venue, providing written notice to committee members at least 30 days in advance. Meeting materials are distributed to committee members at least two weeks in advance of meetings.

Special meetings may be convened by the Chairperson, or by written request of at least three trustees, to address urgent, unanticipated, or time-sensitive matters. When possible, special meetings will be scheduled with 48 hours' written notice, and meeting materials will be shared at least 24 hours in advance, or as soon as possible.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy applies to the Standing Committees and their scope of work of AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

The Standing Committees and their broad responsibilities are as follows:

- Academic Affairs and Research Committee
 - Approving teaching, research, and service policies, overseeing academic programming, and facilitating the establishment of colleges, centers, and institutes.
 - Overseeing the hiring and promotion of senior academic and administrative leaders.
- Student Life Committee
 - Recommending student life policies to create a safe, diverse, and intellectual community for students including financial aid, housing, campus safety, student wellbeing, student organizations, and other community policies.
 - Overseeing the development and execution of AUS's institutional advancement and alumni relations policies and strategies.
 - Reviewing, approving, and monitoring student enrollment and success strategies.
- Financial Affairs Committee
 - Setting tuition and fees and approving the annual operating and capital budgets.
 - Assessing and ensuring financial sustainability by developing revenue generation opportunities, devising financial aid policies, and managing financial risks.
 - Reviewing and approving campus and physical plant maintenance and expansion plans.
- Investment Committee
 - Developing and updating investment and endowment policies.
 - Monitoring endowment strategies, performance, and allocation.
 - Evaluating investment managers and advisors.
- Resource Development Committee
 - Approving the Constitution and Bylaws of AUS's Alumni Association and overseeing alumni relations strategies and policies.
 - Identifying donors and cultivating relationships that can result in significant financial support.
 - Supporting engagement with alumni and philanthropic, corporate, and community partners.
- Audit and Compliance Committee
 - Reviewing and auditing AUS's financial health and acting on auditor recommendations.
 - Monitoring compliance with financial, spending, and control policies and procedures.
 - Appointing and dismissing external and internal auditors.
- Trusteeship Committee
 - Recommending policies and processes for board operations.
 - Evaluating board-wide and individual trustee performance.
 - Assessing new trustee nominations and term renewals for incumbent trustees.
 - Ensuring trustees understand conflict of interest policies and submit disclosures.

This list is not intended to be comprehensive, and the failure to include an authority, power, or duty does not affect the existence or exercise of that authority, power, or duty.

The Standing Committee Chairs' broad responsibilities are as follows:

- Presiding over committee meetings, setting agendas, assigning action items, monitoring progress, and preparing and distributing meeting materials and minutes.
- Ensuring that the committee adopts an annual work plan and objectives.

- Providing committee reports to the board on activities, recommendations, and progress.
- Overseeing priority projects and initiatives assigned by the board.
- Facilitating communication with other standing committees and AUS staff.

7. Definitions/ Abbreviations/ Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** The Board of Trustees is an appointed group of individuals that has overall responsibility for the management and governance of an organization.
- **Standing Committee:** The Standing Committee is a permanent body that was formed to accomplish general tasks in an organization. The committee's role is to recommend actions and propose policies in the functional areas under their jurisdiction.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Board of Trustees Handbook (June 2024)

9. Policy History:

This policy was initially introduced and issued in 1998. The AUS Bylaws established the BOT and put rules and regulations governing the appointment and election of the board members. The policy was part of the Emiri Decree No. 5 of the year 1998 on Bylaws of Law No, 3 of the Year 1998 that established the AUS.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested by
1.0	March 3, 2011	Initial policy Release	OIRA
2.0	May 1, 2017	General Update	OIRA
3.0	May 1, 2021	General Update	OIRA
4.0	June 1, 2024	General Update (Policy Statement)	OIRA

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

d. Bylaws of the Governing Body - Version 3

Policy Number:	0100BT04	Policy Title:	Bylaws of the Governing Body
Prepared By:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Issue Date:	March 03, 2011
Responsible Office:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy establishes the regulations, laws, governing rules, and operational framework for the American University of Sharjah (AUS). It defines the hierarchy of authority across different levels of leadership and outlines the responsibilities of senior positions.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of the AUS Bylaws policy is to function as the operational manual for all university departments, offering guidance on organizational functioning and effective operational strategies.

3. Introduction/ Background:

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the United Arab Emirates (UAE), Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of the AUS, has issued Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023 Concerning The Reorganization of AUS; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Consultative Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah, its executive regulations, and amendments thereof; Amiri decree (53) of 2023 Regarding the Formation of the Board of Trustees (BOT) of American University of Sharjah.

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the UAE, Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of AUS, has issued Emiri Decree No. (53) of 2023 Concerning The Formation of the AUS BOT; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Decree of Law No. (3) of 2023 concerning the Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah; and requirement of the public interest.

4. Policy Statement:

Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023

We, Sultan bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Ruler of the Emirate of Sharjah, having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof;

Law Number (3) of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah, its executive regulations, and amendments thereof;

Amiri decree (53) of 2023 Regarding the Formation of the Board of Trustees of American University of Sharjah;

based on the proposal of the President of the American University of Sharjah and the approval of the Executive Council; and Upon public interest, have decreed the following Law:

The Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah

- **Article 1: Definitions**

- **State:** The United Arab Emirates.
- **Emirate:** The Emirate of Sharjah.
- **Ruler:** The Ruler of the Emirate.
- **University:** The American University in the emirate of Sharjah.
- **Board:** University's Board of Trustees.
- **President:** The President of the University, and the chairperson of the Board.
- **Chancellor:** The Chancellor of the University.
- **Law:** Law No. 3 of the year 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah.
- **Bylaws:** The Bylaws of the Law No. 3 of the year 1998

- **Article 2: Legal Personality**

- The University is a non-profit, academic, and scientific institution conferred the legal personality and legal capacity to fulfill its objectives and carry out its competences, shall be financially and administratively independent and shall be fully owned by the Emirate's Government.

- **Article 3: The Campus**

- The University's main campus shall be located in the city of Sharjah and may, by a resolution of the President, establish branches inside or outside the Emirate.

- **Article 4: Values**

- The University is based on the principles and values of equality, justice, fellowship, tolerance, happiness, and sustainable development, all being part of the values of the State and the society, and the University shall promote such values in all its programs, bylaws, policies, and activities in accordance with the State law.

- **Article 5: Objectives**

- The University aims to achieve the following objectives:
 - Balanced development of the University students' personality, knowledge and abilities, and to prepare human competencies trained in theory and practice to meet the requirements of the State's comprehensive development plans.
 - Sponsor and encourage scientific researches to achieve scientific development and to service the community and to grow and develop it for the better.
 - Launch and develop higher education programs according to the University's policies and plans that are based on the needs of the community, to achieve scientific excellence.
 - Strengthen cultural and scientific ties with other universities, institutes of higher education, and Arab and foreign academic organizations.
 - Provide the necessary care and create a suitable environment for the University students, faculty members and administrative staff of different nationalities and to encourage them to excel, create and innovate.
 - Contribute to the community service and to respond to and interact with its needs by forming partnerships with government and private agencies.

- **Article 6: University Presidency**

- The presidency of the University shall be assumed by a President, appointed by an Emiri Decree, who shall be the chairperson of the Board and may delegate all or some of his/her powers in the Board to other Board members.

- **Article 7: Management of the University**
 - The University shall be managed by, each in his/her field of competence and in accordance with the provisions of this Decree of Law and its executive regulations:
 - The President
 - The Board
 - The Chancellor
 - The Board of Deans
 - The executive regulations of this Decree of Law shall prescribe the duties and competencies of the titles specified in clause (1) of this Article.
- **Article 8: Authorities of the President**
 - The President shall, in particular, assume the following duties and authorities:
 - Chairmanship of the Board.
 - Nominating the Chancellor and submitting the same to the Board for approval.
 - Approving the appointment of vice chancellors and deans.
 - Issuing bylaws to organize the operation of the University and its academic, administrative and financial activities.
 - Issuing organizational decisions.
- **Article 9: Formation of the Board**
 - The Board shall be formed by a resolution of the President and shall be constituted of not less than (9) members, and for the purpose of reorganization under this Decree of Law, the new Board of the University shall be formed by an Emiri Decree of the Ruler.
- **Article 10: Chancellor**
 - The Chancellor shall be appointed by a resolution of the President after such appointment is approved by the Board. The Chancellor shall be responsible before the President in carrying out his/her duties. The Chancellor's salary and other financial and in-kind privileges shall be determined by the President.
 - If the position of the Chancellor becomes vacant, the President shall have the authority to appoint an acting Chancellor for a term that shall not exceed one year.
- **Article 11: Chancellor's Authority**
 - The Chancellor shall, in particular, assume the following duties and authorities:
 - Heading all the administrative and academic staff of the University.
 - Implement the policies of the Board to ensure the advancement of the University and the appropriate conduct of its business and development of its activities.
 - Undertake all tasks and activities that are required for the performance of his/her duties and responsibilities to achieve the continuous development of the University, however, taking into consideration the laws and regulations in force, and the resolutions and directives issued by the President and the Board.
 - Preside over the public academic events and represent the University before all external parties and may delegate whomever he/she deems fit for this latter purpose.
 - Report to the President and the Board on the activities, events and operation of the University.
 - Delegate part of his/her duties and authorities to vice chancellors, assistant chancellors, directors of departments and competent employees of the University.
 - Any other duties or authorities assigned to him/her by the President.

- **Article 12: Colleges, Institutes, Centers, and Scientific Institutions of the University**
 - The University includes colleges, institutes, and research, learning and training centers, and scientific institutions determined by resolutions issued by the President pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board.
 - All the affairs of the University, its colleges, institutes, and its academic, administrative, financial and community centers and departments, shall be subject to the laws and regulations in force in the State.
- **Article 13: Degrees**
 - The University grants certificates of scientific, academic, professional and honorary degrees to those who are eligible according to the provisions of this Decree of Law and the regulations issued pursuant thereto.
- **Article 14: Language of the University Teachings**
 - Teaching at the University shall be in both Arabic and English, depending on the nature of the approved study programs.
 - The Board may approve other languages for teaching or training at the University if so required by the nature of the approved curriculums.
- **Article 15: Financial Resources**
 - The University's financial resources shall consist of the following:
 - Government allocations.
 - The revenues generated through the University's activity, for example:
 - Tuition fees and the fees charged for services provided by the University.
 - Proceeds of the investment of the University's immovable and movable assets.
 - Proceeds of the sale or licensing of patents, copyrights, designs, trademarks and inventions owned by the University or which the University has the right to dispose of.
 - Gifts, bequests, donations, and endowment resources that are consistent with the University's activity and approved by the Board.
 - Any other resources approved by the Board.
- **Article 16: Budget and Fiscal Year**
 - The University shall have a budget independent from the budget of the Government of the Emirate, which shall be approved by the President pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board.
 - The University's fiscal year shall begin on the first of September of each year and shall end on the thirty-first of August of the following year.
 - The Board shall determine the financial rules and accounting systems of the University and all its financial affairs in accordance with the internationally recognized accounting principles and standards.
- **Article 17: Exemptions**
 - The University's assets are public assets and, except the consumer fees, are exempted from all forms and types of local government taxes and fees. The University shall be exempted from customs duties on all its imports.
- **Article 18: Acquisition of Real Estate and Assets**
 - The University shall have the right, by a resolution of the President following an

approval of the Board, to acquire real estate and movable assets of all kinds, to invest in all areas permitted under the laws and regulations in force, to establish commercial companies, hold shares, or manage businesses as well as the right to exercise all required legal actions.

- **Article 19: Executive Orders**

- The President shall, in implementation of this Decree of Law, pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board, issue the following resolutions:
 - Executive Regulations of this Decree of Law.
 - Academic Regulation Bylaws.
 - Faculty Members Affairs Bylaws.
 - Non-Academic Employees Affairs Bylaws.
 - Granting Bachelor's Degree Bylaws.
 - Scientific Research Bylaws.
 - Higher Studies Bylaws.
 - Students' Disciplinary Bylaws.
 - Scholarship Bylaws.
 - Financial Bylaws.
 - Procurement Bylaws.
 - Any other bylaws or regulation orders.

- **Article 20: Accreditation and Auditing Executive Orders**

- The University shall be subject to the requirements and standards of institution licensing and program accreditation of the Ministry of Education and may expand its set of accreditations from other authorities.
- The Board shall appoint an external auditor, and the President may seek the assistance of local government authorities to carry out auditing tasks.

- **Article 21: Transitional Provisions**

- This Decree of Law supersedes, the afore-mentioned, Law No. (3) of 1998, provided that all executive regulations, bylaws and orders issued pursuant thereto shall, until they are amended or repealed, continue in effect to the extent they do not conflict with the provisions of this Decree of Law.

- **Article 22: Notifying the Consultative Council**

- The Consultative Council of the Emirate shall, immediately when convenes, be notified of this Decree of Law.

- **Article 23: Effective Date and Promulgation**

- This Decree of Law shall come into effect on the date of its issuance, shall be enforced by the concerned authorities, each in their jurisdiction, and shall be published in the Official Gazette.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy applies to all members and entities governed by the Bylaws of AUS, defining the rules and procedures for institutional governance and operation.

6. Responsibilities:

As the ultimate governing and decision-making body within AUS, the BOT is entrusted with the power and authority to manage the university, enabling it to achieve the objectives established in its Bylaws.

7. Definitions/ Abbreviations/ Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **Bylaws:** Bylaws generally refer to laws, rules, and decrees issued or enacted by the

institution to govern itself. Bylaws specify the hierarchy, main powers, and responsibilities of principal departments and bodies of an institution. The AUS Bylaws govern the organization of the university with relation to the formation, responsibilities, and authorities of the BOT and the appointment, duties, and powers of the Chancellor.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

American University of Sharjah Constitution and Bylaws

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the United Arab Emirates (UAE), Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of the AUS, has issued Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023 Concerning The Reorganization of AUS; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Consultative Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Law Number (3) of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah, its executive regulations, and amendments thereof; Amiri decree (53) of 2023 Regarding the Formation of the Board of Trustees of American University of Sharjah.

His Highness Sheikh Dr. Sultan Bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Member of the Supreme Council of the UAE, Ruler of Sharjah, and Founder of AUS, has issued Emiri Decree No. (53) of 2023 Concerning The Formation of the AUS Board of Trustees; having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof; Decree of Law No. (3) of 2023 concerning the Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah; and requirement of the public interest.

9. Policy History:

This policy was initially introduced and issued in 1998. The AUS Bylaws established the BOT and put rules and regulations governing the appointment and election of the board members. The policy was part of the Emiri Decree No. 5 of the year 1998 on Bylaws of Law No, 3 of the Year 1998 that established the AUS.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested by
1.0	March 3, 2011	Initial policy Release	OIRA
2.0	June 1, 2021	General Update	OIRA
3.0	June 1, 2024	Comprehensive Update (Policy Statement)	OIRA

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

e. Board Appointments, Term of Office, and Replacement - Version 3

Policy Number:	0100BT05	Policy Title:	Board Appointments, Term of Office, and Replacement
Prepared By:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Issue Date:	March 3, 2011
Responsible Office:	Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy includes provisions for filling vacancies that arise on the American University of Sharjah (AUS) Board of Trustees (BOT). It regulates the process of electing a new trustee and clarifies the instances when the Chair of the BOT can appoint a successor for a vacant seat on the BOT.

2. Purpose:

AUS regulates the appointment and selection process for BOT members, aiming to ensure the most suitable candidates comprise the Board.

3. Introduction/ Background:

The policy regulates the appointment and selection process of members of the BOT. The process is transparent and formal, with the Trusteeship Committee of the Board responsible for appointing new members. New Trustees must also be recommended by at least two-thirds of all current Board members for approval by the Chair. This policy applies when there is a vacancy in Board membership as well.

4. Policy Statement:

The BOT is the ultimate governing and decision-making body within AUS. The board is entrusted with the power and authority to manage AUS, enabling it to achieve the objectives established in its Bylaws. The board plays a crucial role in guiding AUS to fulfill its mission by making decisions that shape institutional policies, academic programs, financial management, and operations.

Procedure for Implementing Policy

- The AUS Bylaws stipulates the establishment of a BOT consisting of a minimum of nine members. Board members are appointed to an initial three-year term with the possibility of renewal for an additional term. The President, Chairperson of the Board, and the Chancellor are ex-officio board members.
- Board members can submit nominations for new trustees to the Trusteeship Committee. Upon nomination, the Trusteeship Committee will evaluate the nominees, considering their professional experience, contribution to diversity and inclusion, and personal integrity. The Trusteeship Committee will then present a curated list of nominees for a vote at the next board meeting. Nominees require a two-thirds vote to become board members.
- The board selects trustees to serve an initial three-year term with the potential to be reappointed for a second consecutive term of three years.
- After each trustee's three-year term, they shall be asked by the Trusteeship Committee to perform a self-evaluation. This self-evaluation forms the basis for determining priorities, setting goals, and developing a professional development plan.

- Further, the Chairperson carefully reviews this self-evaluation when undertaking decisions to extend terms of service as part of a comprehensive assessment process. This process includes reviewing the trustee's performance, meeting attendance, contributions, and the recommendation of the Trusteeship Committee.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

The policy applies to the process of appointing, electing, and terminating membership for all members of the BOT.

6. Responsibilities:

While some of the authority, powers, and duties of the BOT apply to the governing body as a whole, there are responsibilities and obligations that are specific to trustees at an individual level. A trustee has the individual responsibilities and obligations to:

- Have a deep, abiding commitment to AUS's institutional values, traditions, and mission of providing a world-class education.
- Serve as an AUS ambassador by engaging with philanthropic, corporate, government, academic, and other stakeholders to acquire institutional support and build partnerships.
- Make informed, thoughtful, and transparent decisions that strike a balance between the current resource needs of the institution and its future requirements.
- Prepare for board meetings by reviewing materials in advance.
- Communicate recommended board agenda items to the Chairperson or Committee Chairs in advance.
- Participate in at least 50% of board meetings during any consecutive twelve-month period.
- Serve on at least one standing committee and ad-hoc working groups formed by the Chairperson as needed.
- Maintain confidentiality on all board matters.

Upon joining the BOT, members must complete a Statement of Board Member Commitment and Responsibilities.

7. Definitions/ Abbreviations/ Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** The Board of Trustees is an appointed group of individuals that has overall responsibility for the management and governance of an organization.
- **Bylaws:** Bylaws generally refer to laws, rules, and decrees issued or enacted by the institution to govern itself. Bylaws specify the hierarchy, main powers, and responsibilities of principal departments and bodies of an institution. The AUS Bylaws govern the organization of the university with relation to the formation, responsibilities, and authorities of the BOT and the appointment, duties, and powers of the Chancellor.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Board of Trustees Handbook (June 2024)

9. Policy History:

This policy was initially introduced and issued in 1998. The AUS Bylaws established the BOT and put rules and regulations governing the appointment and election of the board members. The policy was part of the Emiri Decree No. 5 of the year 1998 on Bylaws of Law No, 3 of the Year 1998 that

established the AUS.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested by
1.0	March 3, 2011	Initial policy Release	OIRA
2.0	June 1, 2021	General Update	OIRA
3.0	June 1, 2024	Comprehensive Update	OIRA

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

f. Policies Development, Document Control, Review and Dissemination - Version 3

Policy Number:	0100IR06	Policy Title:	Policies Development, Document Control, Review and Dissemination
Prepared By:	Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Issue Date:	April, 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OIRA / Office of the Chancellor	Effective Date:	August 26, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Review:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

All policies at the American University of Sharjah are to be developed in accordance with this policy and are to be set out in the approved template provided in Appendix II.

2. Purpose:

The main purpose of developing and reviewing policies/procedures is to ensure compliance with applicable legislation and the goals and objectives of the university's strategies and mission. In addition, the following are additional reasons to maintain systematic and consistent review policy/procedure:

- To have a consistent regular review process for all policies/procedures.
- To periodically take an in-depth review of existing institutional policies and associated documents (such as procedures, FAQs and appendices) and ensure they are consistent with the main purpose of the policy.
- To address any policy/procedure issues that may arise during implementation or as a result of feedback from policy stakeholders.
- A policy/procedure could be superseded by a newer policy/procedure or legislation, which entails that the older policy/procedure should be retired.
- Emergencies requiring the development of a new policy/procedure.
- To determine whether a policy/procedure is still needed, and whether the purpose/objective of the policy/procedure is attained and whether the policy is still effective.
- To highlight the areas of the policy/procedure that need to be improved due to effectiveness or clarity related issues.

Another purpose is to ensure that the policy/procedure goals and objectives are understood by the target audience and the team responsible for implementation. Occasionally, this might necessitate functional training to the implementation team. Policy development must give due consideration to the cost and resource implications of implementing and ensuring compliance with the policy.

3. Introduction/background:

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As a part of the UAE Higher Education System, the AUS has a range of legislative, regulatory and contractual requirements with which it must comply. These requirements may change over time, making it important to have processes to cope with the changes and regularly review and update policies/procedure and practices to maintain compliance. This policy/procedure guides those processes and assists in demonstrating compliance when required.

The University (through the Office of Institutional Research and Analytics - OIRA) first developed a policy on Writing New Policy/Procedure or Updating Existing Policy/Procedure in April 2013. The policy was later reviewed in February 2017.

While the development and review of policies have long been part of the university's governance process, it was recognized that the time had come to standardize this process for more effective outcomes and greater consistency in policies. This rationale led to the implementation of a standardized policy development and review process.

4. Policy Statement:

The policy/procedure review policy provides the set of standards and procedures needed to develop or review policies on both ad-hoc and periodical review basis. These standards ensure the consistency of all institutional policies and procedures at the AUS and their alignment with the strategic plan, mission and values of the institution. Every five years, the University produces a Strategic Plan which outlines the next five years' mission, vision, and strategic goals. These overarching goals provide guidance for the University as it invests in growth and continuous improvement.

All institutional policies and procedures identified in the Handbook of Policies and Operating Procedures (HPOP) must comply with applicable legislation and be compatible with the strategic goals of the university. These core policies should be reviewed at least every five years and preferably every two or three years, unless stated otherwise. The Chancellor or the Area Chief may at any time initiate a review outside the normal schedule.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy statement applies to all institutional policies and associated procedures introduced by any university unit.

6. Responsibilities:

As stated in the Bylaws, the Board of Trustees has overall oversight of policy creation. The Board determines which policies must be approved by the Board and which policies in relation to the management of its affairs are delegated to the Chancellor. Nothing in this policy is intended to interfere with the responsibilities of the Board of Trustees as set out in the Bylaws.

The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost is the owner of AUS's academic policies, while the Vice Chancellor for Research is the owner of AUS's research policies. Each Vice Chancellor is responsible for overseeing the approval process and related procedures, with input from relevant committees

Approval of policies related to the management of the university's affairs is delegated to the Chancellor, who will approve these policies following the necessary endorsements.

The Secretary of the Board of Trustees maintains a schedule of all policies, and policies are posted for the information of the university community on the AUS intranet.

The policy owner is responsible for carrying out the policy development and review process and for obtaining approval when required in accordance with the Bylaws. The policy owner has responsibility for consulting with appropriate stakeholders during development and review, prior to seeking policy approval.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- a. Board of Trustees (BOT): The Board of Trustees is an appointed group of individuals that has overall responsibility for the management and governance of an organization.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

This policy statement is related to the policies governing the responsibilities of the Board of Trustees and the organizational hierarchy of the university; these are:

1. Law No. 3 of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah.
2. Decree of Law No. 3 of 2023 Concerning the Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah.
3. The Organization Policy: This policy specifies job titles and lines of authority/reporting structure for the principal administrative and academic officers.
4. The Planning Policy: This covers short-term operational and long-term strategic planning and the review and revision of the institution's strategic plan.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 2013	New Policy	OIRA
2.0	September 20, 2023	General Update	OIRA
3.0	August 20, 2024	General update	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Tel: +971 6 5154721	research@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Tel: +971 6 515 2344	occoo@aus.edu
Director of the Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	Tel: + 971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu
Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Tel: +971 6 515 2225	oira@aus.edu

g. Institutional Planning, and Specific Plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability – Version 3

Policy Number:	0100IR07	Policy Title:	Institutional Planning and specific plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability.
Prepared By:	Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Issue Date:	July, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Chancellor	Effective Date:	August 26, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

Institutional Planning, and specific plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability.

In fulfilling its mission, AUS commits itself to serving its broader community through mutually productive relationships with partners and stakeholders within the external community. The University acknowledges its responsibility as a corporate citizen to contribute to the common good within the emirate of Sharjah, the UAE, and the region as a whole.

2. Purpose:

This policy ensures that the university through its institutional planning and assessment efforts is adhering to its mission and its strategic plan to benefit our community and to enhance AUS presence as a force for good in our broader environment. The three areas of emphasis include community engagement, research and scholarly activity, and sustainability.

- Under the standards for accreditation, the CAA under section 1- Governance and management, an institution of higher education as part of its institutional planning and assessment efforts must include goals, plans, and mechanisms to report on growth and investment in resources to cover community engagement, research and scholarly activity, and sustainability. These initiatives are clearly tied to the mission of the university.
- In case of any conflicts among departments on external outreach and community engagement will be resolved through annual reporting requirements as part of the university's annual institutional planning process.
- This Policy aims at ensuring the university's mission of external outreach and community engagement remains at the core of academic and professional activities through planning and assessment.

3. Introduction/background:

In order to comply with CAA Standard 1, this policy is a revision combining other policies that have to do with institutional planning, community engagement, scholarly and professional activities, and sustainability. The scope of the various policies was evaluated to create a revised policy that would ensure ongoing institutional planning to meet the university's mission of external outreach and community engagement.

4. Policy Statement:

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Community outreach has always been an essential element of the AUS mission and its institutional plan. Through myriad volunteer projects, through training programs and workshops, through student leadership development and athletic programs, through the cultivation of partnerships with friends and donors, sustainability and environmental practices, research and scholarly activity, AUS is actively engaged in seeking ways to benefit our community and to enhance our presence as a force for good in our broader environment.

AUS also acknowledges the manifold benefits of outreach activities for the sustained vitality of the University itself. For the external community, outreach activities provide access for AUS's many stakeholders to the human and material resources of the University. For the AUS community, outreach activities provide experiential, educational, professional, sustainability and environmental practices, and research and scholarly benefits through productive relationships within the external community and through material support for the operation of the University in the form of scholarships, sponsorships, gifts and endowments.

The highest indication of scholarly activities is the development, presentation and documented acceptance of original work in the professional community. Excellence in scholarly activities typically reveals itself as continuing scholarly work documented primarily in publications appearing in relevant journals, in the form of books published by companies respected in the professional community, or curated and reviewed exhibitions of creative works.

The university recognizes its responsibility to the environment and aims to continuously reduce the impact of its activities. By implementing proper practices, AUS aspires to attain sustainable use of natural resources, and to prevent any wasteful or polluting exercises. A mandatory environmental policy imposes implications on the behavior between the university and staff, and its relationship with the local community. AUS educates, trains and motivates employees to carry out tasks in an environmentally responsible manner.

Strategic Planning is a key process at the American University of Sharjah (AUS) which acts to guide and nurture institutional growth. The process incorporates both planning—the development of strategic goals—and assessment—the appraisal of how well the University meets those goals. Every five years, the University produces a Strategic Plan, which outlines the next five years' mission, vision, and strategic goals. These overarching goals provide guidance for the University as it invests in growth and continuous improvement. Individual University senior administrators will decide on which goals will be addressed in the next year's Implementation Plan, which will drive budget allocations for all areas of the University. Finally, annual progress reports from every department that will document the success of every departmental goal and allow for annual assessment of the Strategic Plan will be sent to OIRA. Those Goals and Action Plans are reviewed annually and may be modified to meet the University's current needs.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy highlights the role each unit of the University, both academic and administrative, plays to identify external partners and outreach opportunities that are consistent with and supportive of that unit's purpose within the institution.

6. Responsibilities:

It is the policy of AUS that each unit of the University, both academic and administrative, is encouraged to identify external partners and outreach opportunities that are consistent with and supportive of that unit's purpose within the institution and strategies to meet the mission of the university.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

CAA - Commission for Academic Accreditation

OIRA - Office of Institutional Research and Analytics

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards - Standard 1 Governance & Management
- Community Engagement Policy
- Faculty/staff evaluation policy
- Research Administration Policy
- Strategic Plan: <https://www.aus.edu/about/aus-strategic-plan-2020-2025>
- AUS Sustainability: <https://www.aus.edu/sustainability>

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	July, 2021	New Policy	OIRA
2.0	September 20, 2023	General Update	OIRA
3.0	August 20, 2024	General update on the format	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Tel: +971 6 515 2225	oira@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Tel: +9716 5152203	research@aus.edu

h. Risk Management

This policy covers both Policy and procedure as follows:

1. Risk Management Policy – Version 2
2. Risk Management Procedure – Version 2

1. Risk Management Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0100AR08	Policy Title:	Risk management policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Chancellor	Issue Date:	June 2011
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Chancellor	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	January 2025

1. Risk Management Policy Statement

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is committed to the management of risk in order to achieve its vision, principal tasks and key objectives and to protect its core values.

The Board of Trustees of AUS (hereafter referred to as BOT) and its Audit and Compliance Committee (hereafter referred to as ACC) has committed the University to a process of risk management that is aligned to Leading Risk Management Practices. It is expected that all faculties, departments, processes, and projects will be subject to the Risk Management Policy. AUS Management will be formally assessed on their contribution to, and implementation of the University's Risk Management Policy.

Effective risk management is imperative to the University with reference to its risk profile. The realization of AUS's strategy depends on the University being able to take calculated risks in a manner that does not jeopardize the direct interests of stakeholders. Sound management of risks will enable management to anticipate and respond to changes in the education environment, and to make informed decisions under conditions of uncertainty.

A University-wide approach to risk management has been adopted by the University, which means that every identified key risk in each part of the University will be included in a structured and systematic process of risk management. All identified key risks will be managed within a unitary framework that is aligned to the University's corporate governance responsibilities.

It is expected that risk management processes will become embedded in all the University's systems and processes to ensure that its responses to risk remain current and dynamic. All key risks associated with major changes and significant actions by the University will also fall within the processes of risk management. The nature of its risk profile demands that the University adopt a prudent approach to corporate risk, and its decisions regarding risk tolerance as well as risk mitigation to reflect this. Nonetheless it is not the intention to slow down the University's growth with inappropriate bureaucracy. Controls and risk interventions will be chosen to assist the University in fulfilling its commitments to stakeholders.

2. Policy History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 2014	New Policy	Not Applicable
2.0	September 9, 2024	Updated template formatting	OIRA

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3. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director, Internal Audit, Office of the Chancellor.	Tel +971 6 515 4023	kfairbotham@aus.edu .

2. Risk Management Procedures – Version 2

Policy Number:	0100AR09	Policy Title:	Risk management procedures
Prepared By:	Office of the Chancellor	Issue Date:	June 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Chancellor	Effective Date:	September 9, 2024
Approved By:	Audit and Compliance Committee	Date of Next Revision:	January 2025

1. Introduction & Background

The American University of Sharjah (hereafter referred to as “AUS” or “the University”) under the directive of the Audit and Compliance Committee (hereafter referred to as “ACC”) of the Board of Trustees (hereafter referred to as “BOT”), has undertaken initiatives to establish a Risk Management Framework designed to identify potential events that may affect the University, manage risk and provide reasonable assurance regarding the achievement of the University objectives of teaching, learning, research and community engagement.

As part of this initiative, the following activities have been undertaken:

- Establish effective Risk Management operations within the University through regular oversight and monitoring by Senior Staff to facilitate the Risk Management activities within the University. The Senior Staff comprise the Chancellor, Provost, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration, Vice Chancellor for Student Affairs, Vice Chancellor for Enrollment Management, Vice Chancellor for Development and Alumni Affairs, Director of Internal Audit, Director of Institutional Effectiveness and Planning and the Director of Strategic Communications and Media;
- Develop Risk Management Framework governed by this policy document; and
- Conduct Risk Assessment to identify the Key Risks faced by the University.

This Policy will highlight the Target Operating Model for Risk Management as well as the key Roles and Responsibilities of the Committees / Personnel within the University.

The Audit and Compliance Committee will approve this Policy to enhance the Governance arrangements pertaining to the Risk Management practices within the University.

2. Purpose and Objectives

This Policy document is a formal acknowledgement of the commitment of the Board of Trustees to Risk Management within the University. The purpose and objective of this document is to:

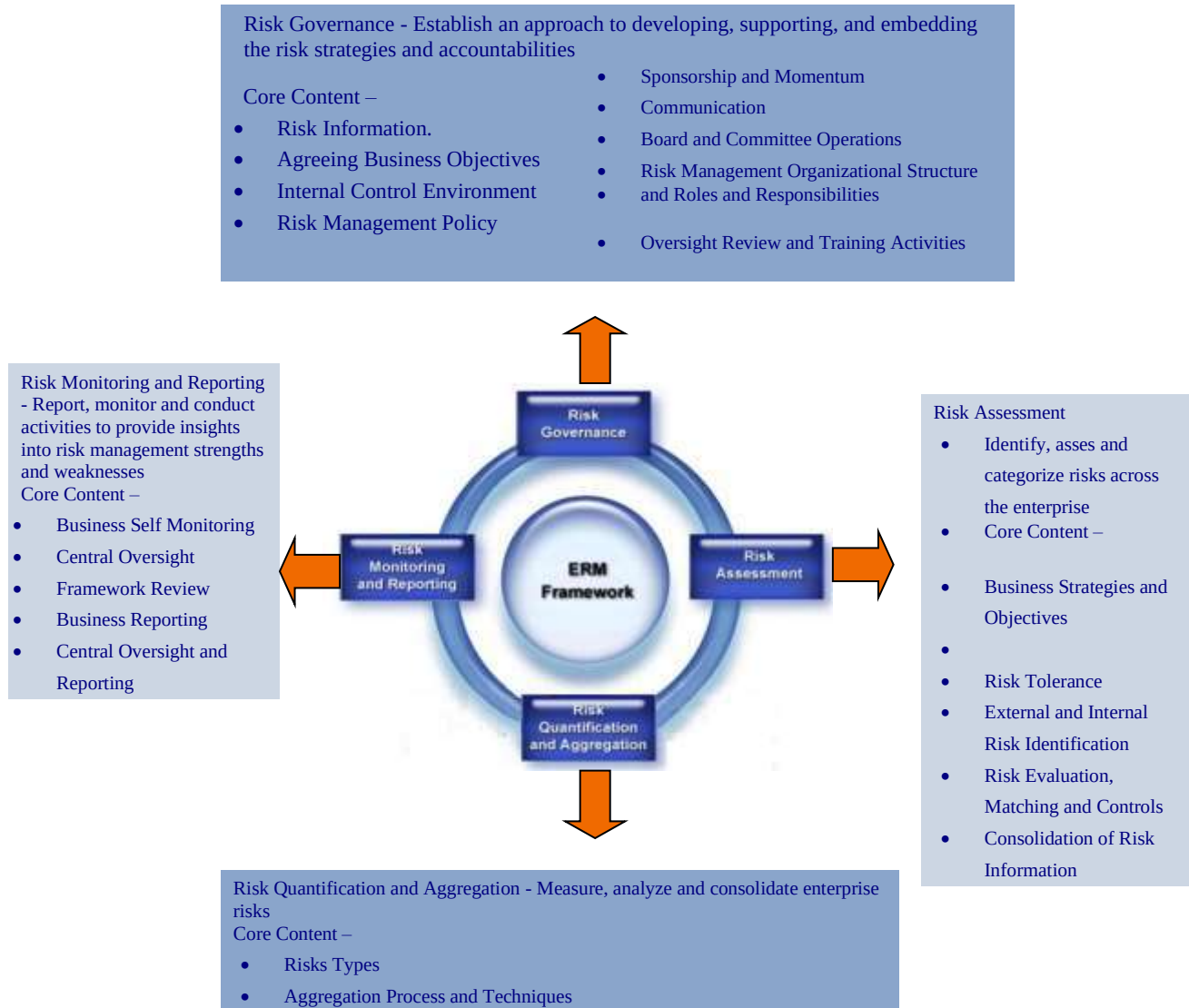
- Communicate **objectives and key principles** of risk management in the University.
- Develop a **common understanding** across the University of what are, and are not, acceptable risks, so that decisions across management levels are taken in accordance with the University’s Strategy.
- Formalize and communicate consistent **Process and Tools** for Identifying, Measuring, Mitigating, Monitoring and Reporting risks at all levels within the University.

- Assign **accountability to all staff** for the management of key risks pertaining to their areas and define their interaction.
- This policy **applies to all employees** and relevant stakeholders of American University of Sharjah.

This policy is intended to assist in implementation of an effective risk management framework within AUS that will aid in identifying, monitoring, managing and reporting key risks to the ACC.

3. Risk Management Framework

Detailed below are the four key elements essential for establishing a Risk Management Framework within AUS:

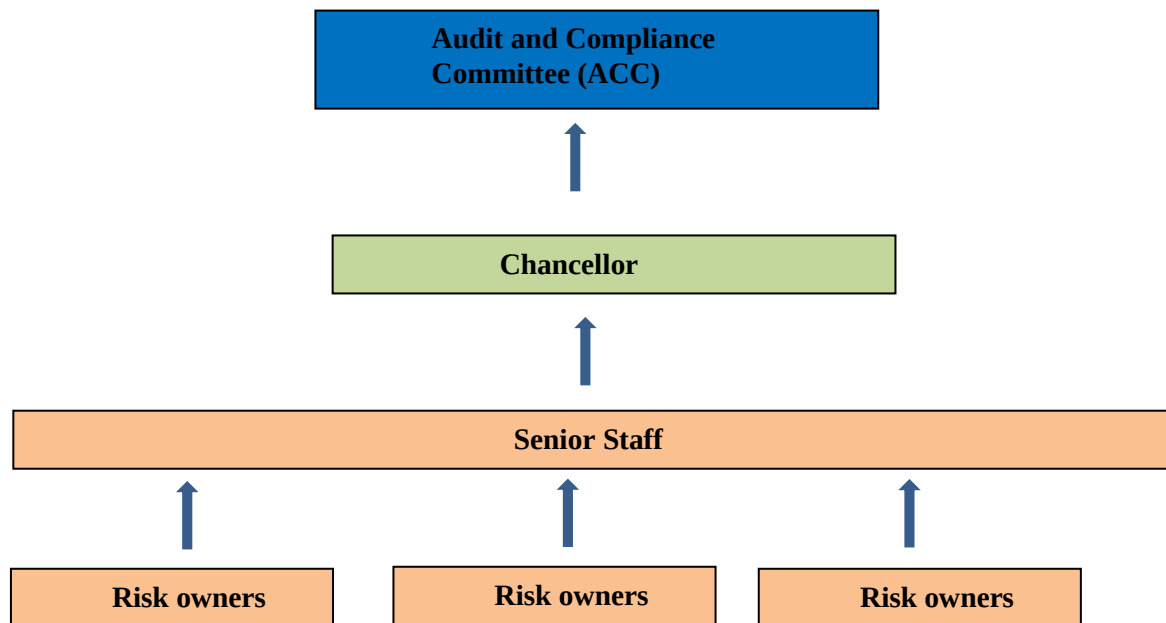


4. Target Operating Model

Based on inputs received from the Audit & Compliance Committee (ACC), the Chancellor, based upon feedback from Senior Staff, will incorporate a direct, autonomous reporting line to the ACC.

Depicted below the Target Operating Model for Risk Management:

Target Operating Model:



Overview of Elements of Risk Management Framework

	DESCRIPTION
A) RISK GOVERNANCE	In order to ensure that the Risk Management procedures within AUS meet the University's objectives, it is vital that an appropriate Risk Governance structure and an approach to risk management robust enough to manage the university's risk profile are established. Accordingly the following initiatives / documents needs to be undertaken / developed: ▪ Risk Governance structure; ▪ Senior staff oversight and monitoring procedures; ▪ Risk Management Framework; ▪ Risk Management Policies and Procedures; and ▪ Reporting and Communication Protocol.
B) Risk Assessment	AUS will ensure that the Senior Staff on a regular basis identify, assess and categorize internal and external risks across the University on a regular basis. The risk assessment process will allow AUS to consider the extent to which potential events have an impact on achievement of objectives. AUS will develop an enterprise-wide approach, assign resources and implement processes, tools and systems for identifying, assessing and evaluating top 10 risks and controls to construct the University's risk portfolio.
C) Risk Quantification and Aggregation	AUS's Senior Staff will aim to aggregate and quantify the risks identified in the Risk Assessment Process. The development and analysis of risk information will ensure more accurate attribution of risk, and, in advance cases the ability to apply risk measures to activities within the University to understand which activities are adding or destroying value.
D) Risk Monitoring and Reporting	Subsequent to the risk assessment and quantification and aggregation process the Senior Staff will obtain the buy in from the process owners for the timelines of the implementation of the risk mitigation plan. On a periodic basis the Senior Staff will monitor and report the risks in the Risk Register to ensure that the risk mitigation plans are implemented.

5. Element (A) – Risk Governance – Accountability & Responsibility

5.1 Board of Trustees

The Board of Trustees (BOT) will have ultimate responsibility for the oversight of risk management within the University. Part of their responsibility includes the following:

- Delegate power to the Audit and Compliance Committee for undertaking oversight role on risk management;
- Determining the level of risk, which is acceptable to the University; and
- Approve Risk Management Policy for the University.

5.2 Audit and Compliance Committee

The Responsibility of the Audit and Compliance Committee includes the following:

- Review and approve risk profile of the University;
- Review and approve the AUS Risk Register;
- Update Board of Trustees with Key risks and trends;
- Monitor emerging issues and share best Risk Management practices with Management;
- Guide integration of enterprise wide risk management with other business planning and management activities;
- Establish, review and monitor the implementation of appropriate risk management processes and tools in accordance with this Policy;
- Provide periodic updates to the Board of Trustees on the current risk management procedures and status of the key risks;

5.3 AUS Senior Staff

The AUS Senior Staff are responsible for implementation of the Risk Management Framework and Risk Policy. Senior Staff will ensure that risks within AUS are managed to acceptable levels by establishing, implementing and adhering to appropriate risk management processes and tools in accordance with the Risk Management Policy. The key responsibilities will include the following:

- Establish and maintain a common understanding of the risk universe, which needs to be managed in order to meet AUSs mission, vision and objectives;
- Periodic facilitation and review of risk assessments to determine the material risks to which the University may be exposed;
- Ensure that the identified risks are mitigated in line with agreed action plans
- Evaluate on an on-going basis the significant commercial and the financial risks prevalent and / or applicable to the University

- Provide quarterly updates to the ACC on the risk management work undertaken and the extent of any actions taken through coordination between ACC and the Board of Trustees to address areas identified for improvement.
- Monitor the effectiveness of the University's Risk Management procedures and mitigating action plans;
- Development and implementation of appropriate Policies and Procedures and Systems pertaining to risk management in all the functions;
- Periodically update ACC of the key University level risks, their potential impact and mitigation measures to manage the same;
- Collate risks identified and communicate updates / changes to the ACC;
- Update Risk Register on a regular basis
- Coordinate with Internal Audit Department to identify external risks like new regulations etc.

5.4 Risk Owners

Risk owners will be identified within the various departments / functions within the University. The responsibilities of the Risk owners include the following:

- Identify, assess and report key risks (including Strategic, Operational, Financial and External including market risks) within their respective areas, in line with the instruction received from Senior Staff;
- Review and monitor the risks pertaining to their function and related mitigating action plans on an ongoing basis;;
- Discuss and finalize the risk mitigation plans during the with the Senior Staff meetings; and
- Monitor implementation of the risk mitigation plan for the identified risks and report the same in predefined template.

5.5 Internal Audit Department

The Internal Audit Department will play an important role in identifying, monitoring and sharing operational risks with Risk Management Function. The key responsibility for the Internal Audit Department includes the following:

- Examine the techniques used to identify risks;
- Monitor the effectiveness of the University's Risk Management operations;
- Assist the Senior Staff by auditing the adherence to control systems, and their effectiveness;
- Flag off any new risks that may emerge during the internal audit reviews; and
- Audit the effectiveness of the Risk Management procedures.

6. Elements (B &C) – Risk Assessment, Quantification and Aggregation

The University's Risk Objectives will be achieved by following key risk management policies pertaining to Risk Treatment, Risk Assessment, Risk Quantification and Risk Aggregation as depicted below:

A) Risk Treatment:

Universities by their nature involve significant operational risks. However the University will adopt the following Strategy for treating risks:

- 1) **Tolerate Risk:** The University will develop automated trigger that will initiate action when risk trend is nearing the University's set risk appetite.
- 2) **Transfer Risk:** The University will develop and implement Insurance Strategy to transfer the internal risk to third parties.
- 3) **Treat Control Risk:** The University will identify and assess the existing control to manage risk.
- 4) **Terminate Risk:** The University will terminate the risk in instances when the risk cannot be mitigated and develop and implement exit strategy and update business/ strategic plan.

B) Risk Assessment:

- 1) **Decentralized Risk Management:** The Senior Staff will serve as the "owner" of all tools, methodologies and processes used for Risk Management and will provide these to the various Risk Owners within AUS. The Risk Owners will focus on implementing these policies and methodologies to identify, measure, mitigate, monitor and report key risks in predefined template.
- 2) **Continuous assessment:** The Senior Staff will continually assess the risks for changes in the market circumstances and update the Risk Register, if required..
- 3) **Risk Categorization:** The Risk Categorization into different groups help to prioritize risks. It assists management in ensuring that they have captured all categories of risks listed below:
 - Operational Risks (Including People and Process Risks)
 - Strategic Risks. (Including Market Risks)
 - Financial Risks.
 - Regulatory/Legal Risks
 - Information Technology Risks.

(Please refer to **Appendix 1** for guidelines and definition on the Risk Categorization.)

C) Risk Quantification:

1) **Explicit risk evaluation:** Risk evaluation will be an integral part of any decision affecting the University. To ensure high quality decisions, risks will be investigated in sufficient depth, quantified as far as possible, and communicated using probabilistic estimates for clarity. Major risks will be mitigated to the extent possible, or will be highlighted as being uncontrollable. All types of risks – strategic, market, operational (People, Process, Systems), legal, regulatory - will be evaluated.

D) Risk Aggregation:

Integrated approach: The University will adopt an integrated approach to risk management in which risks across all activities will be compared in a consistent manner, and can be aggregated to form the overall picture for the University, i.e. the risks will be aggregated at various departmental and then consolidated at University level to form an overall University risk profile.

7. Element (D) – Risk Monitoring and Reporting

The monitoring and reporting of the key risk information will assist in ensuring that the risk mitigation plan has been implemented for the identified risks. The Chancellor will provide periodic updates to the ACC on:

- Key University level risks.
- Potential impact of these risks, with comparison from the past.
- Progress on initiatives taken up to mitigate these risks.

The risk monitoring and reporting process will consist of the following

- The Senior Staff will identify the relevant Risk Owners within AUS.
- The Senior Staff will periodically obtain, review and monitor the status of risks status from the identified Risk Owners.
- The Senior Staff will suggest the risk mitigation plan to the risk owners based on the risks reported in the Risk Register.

The Risk Owners will monitor the implementation of the Risk Mitigation Action Plans and will report the status to Senior Staff during regular meetings.

8. Appendix 1 – Risk Categorization

Depicted below are the factors to be considered for risk categorization:

S.NO	Risk Type	Definition	Questionnaire/Guidelines
1	Operational Risk	Operational risk is defined as the risk of loss resulting from inadequate or failed internal processes, people and systems, or from external events. Operational risks arise from execution of the business function.	1) What are the risks inherent in the processes that have been chosen to implement the strategies? 2) How does the organization identify, quantify, and manage these risks given its appetite for risk? How does it adapt its activities as strategies and processes change?
2	Strategic Risk	Strategic risk is defined as the risk that will have an adverse impact and will hinder the organization from achieving its strategic objectives and goals. It will require certain Strategic decisions to manage the same.	1) Are the critical strategies appropriate to enable the organization to meet its business objectives? 2) What are the risks inherent in those strategies, and how might the organization identify, quantify, and manage these risks? 3) How much risk is the organization willing to take? 4) What risk result from e-business developments?
3	Financial Risk	Financial risk is defined as the risk associated with any form of financing decision that will have an impact on the profit and functionality of the University.	1) Have operating processes put financial resources at undue risk? 2) Has the organization incurred unreasonable liabilities to support operating processes? 3) Has the organization succeeded in meeting business objectives?

S.NO	Risk Type	Definition	Questionnaire/Guidelines
4	Regulatory / Legal Risk	Regulatory risk is defined as the risk arising from non compliance with relevant laws and regulations.	What risks are related to compliance with applicable regulations or contractual arrangements —not just those that are financially based?
5	Information Technology Risk	Information Technology risk is defined as the risk arising from the lack of controls into the design and implementation of an Information Technology system	1) Is our data/information/knowledge reliable, relevant, and timely? 2) Are our information systems reliable? 3) Do our security systems reflect our e-business strategy?
6	Health and Safety Risks	Health and safety risk is defined as the risk arising from the inability to preserve the highest quality health and safety practices across the University-wide spectrum of activities.	1) What risks are related to compliance with Health and Safety Regulations and leading practices?

1. Policy History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 2014	New Policy	Not Applicable
2.0	September 9, 2024	Updated template formatting	OIRA

2. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director, Internal Audit, Office of the Chancellor.	Tel +971 6 515 4023	kfairbotham@aus.edu .

i. Multiple Campus Coordination

N.A.

j. Campuses of UAE Institutions in Other Countries
N.A.

k. Branch Campuses of Foreign Institutions
N.A.

I. Board of Trustees Annual Self-Evaluation Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0100BT10	Policy Title:	Board of Trustees Annual Self-Evaluation Policy
Prepared By:	Office of BOT Affairs	Issue Date:	December 31, 2023
Responsible Office:	Office of BOT Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

The Board of Trustees (BOT) Annual Self-Evaluation Policy outlines the procedures for the annual self-evaluation of the BOT.

2. Purpose:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is dedicated to promoting excellence and continuous improvement within its Board of Trustees (BOT). This policy aims to outline procedures for BOT members to conduct effective self-evaluations, improve governance practices, enhance accountability, and facilitate the BOT's ongoing development.

3. Introduction/ Background:

Not available

4. Policy Statement:

This policy lays out the steps and guidelines for conducting the annual self-evaluation of the Board of Trustees. It establishes a structured framework for board members to assess their individual and collective performance, as well as the board's overall effectiveness in fulfilling its responsibilities.

Accessibility, storage, and retention:

BOT self-evaluations shall be securely retained in an electronic format to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements and organizational policies, thereby preventing unauthorized access or disclosure.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy shall apply to all BOT members at AUS. This policy extends to AUS employees and administrators involved in the governance and oversight processes.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of BOT Affairs:

- Manage and facilitate the BOT self-evaluation process.
- Ensure the confidentiality and integrity of self-evaluation data and reports, implementing appropriate measures to safeguard sensitive information.
- Compile and analyze self-evaluation results to identify strengths, weaknesses, and areas for improvement within the BOT.
- Collaborate with University leadership to develop action plans and initiatives based on self-evaluation findings to enhance governance effectiveness.
- Maintain electronic records of self-evaluation activities and outcomes for future reference and reporting purposes.

BOT Members:

- Actively participate in the self-evaluation process by providing honest feedback, insights, and perspectives on the performance and functioning of the BOT.

- Review and reflect on self-evaluation results and recommendations provided by the Office of BOT Affairs.
- Engage in discussions and initiatives to address identified areas for improvement and enhance the BOT's overall effectiveness.
- Communicate concerns, challenges, or suggestions related to the self-evaluation process to the Office of BOT Affairs.
- Commit to ongoing professional development and training opportunities to strengthen governance knowledge and skills supporting the BOT's objectives.

University Departments:

- Provide necessary support and resources to facilitate the self-evaluation process.
- Implement any action plans or recommendations from the self-evaluation process pertaining to their respective departments or functions.
- Maintain confidentiality and integrity regarding self-evaluation data or outcomes that may impact their department or the University.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** Board of Trustees
- **BOT Self-Evaluation:** The process whereby BOT members evaluate their performance, effectiveness, and adherence to governance practices through a structured assessment to enhance accountability and facilitate the ongoing development of the BOT.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Policies and Procedures Manual

9. Policy History:

This policy shall undergo a biennial review to verify its effectiveness and relevance, considering shifts in legal requirements, organizational priorities, stakeholder input, and emerging governance standards. Any proposed revisions shall be presented to the BOT for assessment and approval, and all approved revisions, along with their justification, shall be documented and shared with relevant stakeholders. Regular audits shall be conducted to evaluate compliance with this policy, and any identified issues shall be promptly rectified. All modifications shall be recorded in the official board records, with oversight of implementation assigned to the Director of the Office of BOT Affairs.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 31, 2023	New Policy	OIRA
2.0	June 1, 2024	General Updates	OIRA

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director of the Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+ 971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

m. Board of Trustees Statutory Records - Version 1

Policy Number:	0100BT11	Policy Title:	Board of Trustees Statutory Records
Prepared By:	Office of BOT Affairs	Issue Date:	January 1, 2024
Responsible Office:	Office of BOT Affairs	Effective Date:	January 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

The Board of Trustees (BOT) Statutory Records Policy outlines the efficient management and oversight of the BOT Statutory Records.

2. Purpose:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is dedicated to efficiently managing and overseeing Statutory Records concerning the academic qualifications, professional work experiences, and contact addresses of its Board of Trustees (BOT) members. This policy ensures the accuracy, transparency, and compliance of these critical records, providing a structured framework for documenting the qualifications of the University's governing body.

3. Introduction/ Background:

Not available

4. Policy Statement:

The aim of this policy is to establish clear guidelines for the management of BOT Statutory Records. The policy aims to promote transparency, accountability, and integrity in the organization's governance processes.

Accessibility, Storage, and Retention:

Statutory Records shall be securely retained in an electronic format to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements and organizational policies, thereby preventing unauthorized access or disclosure.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy shall apply to the Office of BOT Affairs at AUS, which is responsible for efficiently managing and overseeing such Statutory Records. This policy extends to AUS employees and administrators handling or accessing such Statutory Records as part of their responsibilities.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of BOT Affairs:

- Manage and maintain the Statutory Records of BOT members in accordance with the established policy.
- Provide assistance and guidance to BOT members regarding compliance with record-keeping requirements.
- Ensure the confidentiality and security of Statutory Records and implement appropriate measures to safeguard sensitive information.
- Coordinate with other University departments as needed to support the effective management of Statutory Records.

BOT Members:

- Ensure the accuracy and completeness of their academic qualifications, professional work experiences, and contact information provided to the University.
- Promptly communicate updates to Statutory Records with the Office of BOT Affairs.

7. Definitions/ Abbreviations/ Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** Board of Trustees
- **Statutory Records:** All official documentation related to the BOT members, containing details such as academic qualifications, professional work experiences, and contact addresses.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Policies and Procedures Manual

9. Policy History:

This policy shall undergo a biennial review to verify its effectiveness and relevance, considering shifts in legal requirements, organizational priorities, stakeholder input, and emerging governance standards. Any proposed revisions shall be presented to the BOT for assessment and approval, and all approved revisions, along with their justification, shall be documented and shared with relevant stakeholders. Regular audits shall be conducted to evaluate compliance with this policy, and any identified issues shall be promptly rectified. All modifications shall be recorded in the official board records, with oversight of implementation assigned to the Director of the Office of BOT Affairs.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 1, 2024	New Policy	OIRA

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director of the Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+ 971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

n. Maintenance, Storage, and Access to Board of Trustees Materials - Version 2

Policy Number:	0100BT12	Policy Title:	Maintenance, Storage, and Access to Board of Trustees Materials
Prepared By:	Office of BOT Affairs	Issue Date:	December 31, 2023
Responsible Office:	Office of BOT Affairs	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2025

1. Policy:

The Maintenance, Storage, and Access to Board of Trustees (BOT) Materials Policy outlines the procedures for the maintenance, storage, and access of BOT Materials and Information at AUS.

2. Purpose:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is dedicated to the efficient maintenance, storage, and access to materials and information relating to its Board of Trustees (BOT). This policy sets forth the procedures governing BOT Materials and Information maintenance, storage, and access at AUS. It promotes transparent and effective governance by delineating guidelines for record preservation, confidentiality measures, and accessibility enhancement.

3. Introduction/ Background:

Not available

4. Policy Statement:

The aim of this policy is to establish clear guidelines regarding the maintenance, storage, and access of BOT materials and information within AUS. This policy is put in place to ensure the proper handling and protection of sensitive data and materials related to the Board of Trustees. By defining the processes for maintenance, storage, and access, this policy aims to promote accountability, security, and efficiency in the management of BOT-related resources within the institution.

Confidentiality:

Board Materials and Information are confidential and proprietary documents intended solely for the use of authorized individuals involved in BOT-related activities, including BOT members, designated employees, and advisors, in carrying out their fiduciary responsibilities. All individuals granted access to BOT Materials and Information must exercise discretion and maintain confidentiality, refraining from disclosing or distributing them to unauthorized parties.

Accessibility, Storage, and Retention:

BOT Materials and Information shall be securely stored in electronic and physical formats to ensure compliance with legal and regulatory requirements and organizational policies, thereby preventing unauthorized access or disclosure.

Electronic BOT Materials and Information shall be kept in storage systems hosted on secure servers with robust security measures, such as password protection and encryption, to safeguard sensitive information and ensure authorized access.

Physical BOT Materials and Information shall be kept in secure, access-controlled environments, including locked cabinets and other secure facilities, to prevent potential loss, theft, or unauthorized access.

5. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy shall apply to all AUS employees, administrators, Trustees, and individuals handling or accessing BOT Materials and Information.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of BOT Affairs:

- Develop and enforce policies and procedures governing BOT Materials and Information handling, access, and dissemination.
- Establish and maintain secure systems for the electronic storage and retrieval of BOT Materials and Information.
- Manage all BOT Materials and Information on Diligent, a highly secure platform that employs robust encryption protocols, access controls, and advanced security features to safeguard the confidentiality and integrity of sensitive information.
- Ensure regular backups of electronic materials are conducted to prevent data loss.
- Oversee the receipt, organization, and storage of all BOT Materials and Information submitted by university departments.
- Revoke access for individuals no longer associated with the BOT from the Diligent.
- Provide guidance and training to university departments on proper BOT Materials and Information management procedures.
- Conduct regular audits or reviews of departmental practices to ensure compliance with BOT Materials and Information maintenance practices.
- Investigate any incidents of unauthorized access, loss, or disclosure of BOT Materials and Information and take appropriate corrective actions.
- Serve as the central point of contact for inquiries, requests, or issues related to the maintenance of BOT Materials and Information.

BOT Members:

- Exercise discretion and maintain confidentiality of BOT Materials and Information.
- Refrain from disclosing or distributing BOT Materials and Information to unauthorized individuals.
- Follow established procedures for accessing and using BOT Materials and Information.
- Adhere to all guidelines provided by the Office of BOT Affairs regarding the handling and disseminating of BOT Materials and Information.
- Safely return or dispose of any physical BOT Materials and Information upon the conclusion of their respective Board term.
- Report any incidents of unauthorized access, loss, or disclosure of BOT Materials and Information to the Office of BOT Affairs immediately for investigation and resolution.

University Departments:

- Promptly submit BOT Materials and Information to the Office of BOT Affairs.
- Ensure only authorized personnel can access BOT Materials and Information within the department.
- Follow established procedures for accessing and using BOT Materials and Information.
- Adhere to all guidelines provided by the Office of BOT Affairs regarding the handling and disseminating of BOT Materials and Information.
- Securely handle and store physical copies of BOT Materials and Information to prevent unauthorized access or disclosure.
- Maintain electronic copies of BOT Materials and Information for archival purposes only.
- Cooperate with the Office of BOT Affairs in conducting audits or reviews of BOT Materials and Information maintenance practices within the department.

- Participate in training sessions or workshops on properly handling and maintaining BOT Materials and Information.
- Report any incidents of unauthorized access, loss, or disclosure of BOT Materials and Information to the Office of BOT Affairs immediately for investigation and resolution.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah
- **BOT:** Board of Trustees
- **BOT Materials and Information:** All confidential or sensitive documents, reports, approved, signed, and dated meeting minutes, proposals, and other records associated with the actions and determinations of the BOT, including deliberations on financial reports, strategic plans, and personnel matters during BOT meetings.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Policies and Procedures Manual

9. Policy History:

This policy shall undergo a biennial review to verify its effectiveness and relevance, considering shifts in legal requirements, organizational priorities, stakeholder input, and emerging governance standards. Any proposed revisions shall be presented to the BOT for assessment and approval, and all approved revisions, along with their justification, shall be documented and shared with relevant stakeholders. Regular audits shall be conducted to evaluate compliance with this policy, and any identified issues shall be promptly rectified. All modifications shall be recorded in the official board records, with oversight of implementation assigned to the Director of the Office of BOT Affairs.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 13, 2023	New Policy	OIRA
2.0	June 1, 2024	General Update	OIRA

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director of the Office of Board of Trustee Affairs	+ 971 6 515 2706	msalaam@aus.edu

2. Quality Assurance

a. Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0200IR01	Policy Title:	Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA)	Issue Date:	September 30, 2015
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA) Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost (OVCAAP)	Effective Date:	August 20, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

The Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy at AUS ensures continuous evaluation and improvement of academic programs and administrative units. It establishes a systematic framework for developing annual QA/IE plans that align with the university's strategic goals and accreditation standards. The policy facilitates evidence-based decision-making, strategic planning, and accountability, with oversight provided by the Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (for administrative QA/IE processes) and the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost (for academic QA/IE processes). The policy applies to all university units and supports continuous quality enhancement across AUS.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of the Quality Assurance and Institutional Effectiveness (QA/IE) Policy is to ensure that AUS continuously assesses and improves the quality of its academic and administrative services. The policy aims to support informed decision-making, strategic planning, and accountability through systematic evaluation and improvement of institutional performance.

3. Introduction/background:

At AUS, Quality Assurance (QA) and Institutional Effectiveness (IE) are integral to achieving the institution's mission and strategic goals. The QA/IE system operates at three levels: the university-wide strategic plan, QA/IE plans at academic and administrative unit levels, and program-level and course-level assessments. The QA system ensures compliance with accreditation standards and fosters continuous quality improvement across all areas of the university. The Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA) and the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost (OVCAAP) oversee these processes.

4. Policy Statement:

- AUS will maintain a comprehensive QA/IE system for both academic and administrative units, ensuring continuous monitoring and improvement of outcomes. Details on QA/IE processes are outlined in the university's Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Manual.
- AUS will foster a culture of continuous improvement by systematically using assessment results to enhance academic programs, administrative services, and overall institutional effectiveness.

3. AUS will actively involve internal and external stakeholders, including students, faculty, staff, alumni, and employers, in the quality assurance process to ensure that diverse perspectives contribute to institutional improvement.
4. All quality assurance processes at AUS will be aligned with national and relevant international accreditation standards to ensure compliance with regulatory requirements.
5. AUS will ensure that the results of quality assurance activities, including evaluations and assessments, are reported to relevant stakeholders and used to inform decision-making at all levels of the institution.
6. Each academic and administrative unit will develop and implement an annual QA/IE plan, aligned with AUS's strategic goals and accreditation standards. This QA/IE plan will include an annual operational plan at the beginning of the academic year and a self-assessment plan at the end of the year.
7. OIRA and the OVCAAP will coordinate efforts and support administrative units and academic departments in their QA/IE processes, providing necessary data, information, and guidance.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all academic and administrative units at AUS. It governs the development, implementation, and evaluation of QA/IE plans and activities, including assessments at the university, department/program, and course levels.

6. Quality Assurance and Institutional Strategic/Operational Planning:

The QA/IE system plays a central role in AUS's strategic planning process. Data collected from both academic and administrative units, along with the results of program and course evaluations, are used to inform strategic decision-making and resource allocation. This evidence-based approach ensures that institutional goals are aligned with operational outcomes, fostering continuous improvement and institutional effectiveness.

OIRA is a key contributor to the strategic planning process and contributes to this process in various ways: conducting environmental scanning, systematically collecting and analyzing data to assess the university's current state, producing insights on issues of strategic importance to the university, conducting benchmark studies, providing data-driven recommendations, supporting the development of key performance indicators (KPIs), monitoring institution performance against strategic objectives and targets, etc.

Data, information, and insights from all QA/IE stakeholders (both administrative and academic) are integrated into the strategic planning process to inform the institutional mission, vision, and strategic goals. The strategic plan, in turn, provides the guiding framework for developing strategic goals, priorities, and initiatives at unit and departmental levels. Departmental goals, objectives, and priorities must align closely with the institution's overall strategic goals.

Operational planning is an integral part of both the QA/IE and strategic planning processes. At the start of each academic year, each major academic and administrative unit will develop an operational plan, with OIRA coordinating this process in close collaboration with the offices of the Vice Chancellors. At the end of the year, units will also submit a performance assessment report to evaluate their progress and outcomes.

7. Assessment/Evaluation of the Quality Assurance System:

The effectiveness of the QA/IE system will be assessed through annual evaluations conducted by OIRA and the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Academic and administrative units will provide feedback on the QA process, which will be compiled into institutional reports—one for administrative quality assurance and another for academic quality assurance. The effectiveness of the QA system may be evaluated through various methods, such as:

- Surveys of and/or interviews with stakeholders in QA/IE processes
- Analysis of performance indicators/outcomes across academic and administrative units
- Periodic self-evaluation of academic and administrative units
- Internal audits
- 360° evaluation

8. Responsibilities:

- Chancellor and Senior Leadership: Review and approve QA/IE plans (including operational plans and self-evaluation reports) and use findings from performance evaluations to inform institutional planning and resource allocation.
- Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost: Oversee academic QA/IE processes to ensure consistency across academic program and compliance with regulatory requirements.
- OIRA: Oversee administrative QA/IE processes and provides data, information, and insights to support both academic and administrative QA/IE efforts.
- Academic and administrative units: Develop and implement QA/IE plans (including operational plans and performance assessment) and use assessment results for continuous improvement.
- Heads of academic departments and program coordinators: Ensure that program and course learning outcomes are assessed regularly and consistently; organize and conduct accreditation self-studies; and use program data to inform changes and improvements.

9. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- *Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness at American University of Sharjah*

10. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 13, 2015	New Policy	OIRA
2.0	February 20, 2017	Edited Policy	OIRA
3.0	September 20, 2023	General Update	OIRA
4.0	August 20, 2024	General Update	OIRA

11. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Institutional Research and Analytics	Tel: +971 6 515 2225	oira@aus.edu
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

3. The Educational Program

a. Program Planning and Development – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300AP01	Policy Title:	Program Planning and Development
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Program Planning and Development

2. Purpose:

This policy relates to the planning and development of new undergraduate and graduate degree programs.

3. Introduction / background:

N.A.

4. Policy Statement:

Proposals for new programs require the preparation of a document providing an evidence-based case for offering the new degree. The proposal is prepared by the college/school with input from faculty with relevant expertise to the proposed program. The proposal needs to be endorsed by the college/school curriculum committee, dean, university curriculum committee (either UUCC or GPC). The proposal must be approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost is required prior to the preparation of the initial accreditation self-study for submission to the CAA.

The proposal for new degree program should include the following:

- Rationale:** Explain how the proposed academic program will contribute to fulfill the university's mission and to meeting the critical needs of students and stakeholders. Provide the program goals, program outcomes and an assessment plan.
- Faculty Requirements:** Describe the qualifications for faculty contributing to the proposed degree program. The proposal must demonstrate the existence of faculty resources with the needed expertise and capacity to teach and supervise dissertation in the program. A tentative schedule of faculty workload endorsed by the relevant department head(s) and dean(s) must be included.
- Curriculum:** Provide a detailed description of the semester-by-semester curriculum and course descriptions of all new/existing courses (clearly indicating which courses are new). Explain the impact on other departments (e.g. the increased demand for courses to be taught within other schools/colleges). Provide a credit hour and curriculum comparison between the proposed program and others that have been established.
- Contribution:** Describe the anticipated economic, social, cultural, and political contribution of

the degree to the UAE, the GCC, and globally. Explain how this degree may complement existing programs, enhance existing research agendas, and/or provide opportunities for interdisciplinary collaboration.

- e) **Impact:** List competing programs in the MENA region and describe what impact this may have on both the proposed program and competing institutions. Describe the costs that the degree represents in terms of other AUS degree programs that may receive reduced funding.
- f) **Cost-Benefit Analysis:** Provide evidence that there is student and market demand to justify the new degree program. Describe the human, financial, physical, and ancillary resources that will be needed to establish the program and sustain it over time. Provide an estimate of the cost of graduate assistants needed to support the program and the source of funding. Explain any additional facilities that would be necessary to support the program. Provide an analysis of the incremental revenue streams associated with the degree and assess the point at which the degree will break even.
- g) **Timeline:** Provide a complete timeline for implementation of the degree program, including milestones (e.g. semester-by semester enrollment targets, accreditation deadlines, graduation rate targets, etc.) and plans for discontinuing the program if milestones are not met (including a teach-out provision and a plan for dealing with faculty affected by program closure as per AUS teach out policy).
- h) **External Validation:** Provide evidence from external parties in academia and in the broader community that the proposed degree program would be desirable. Explain any challenges that may be encountered during the UAE CAA accreditation process. Provide an overview of professional accrediting agencies that would consider accrediting the proposed degree program.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the offering of new undergraduate and graduate degree programs.

6. Responsibilities:

The dean must ensure compliance with this policy when planning to offer new degree programs. The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction or the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies manage the review of the proposals for submission to the Provost for approval.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

UUCC – University Undergraduate Curriculum Committee

GPC – Graduate Programs Committee

CAA – Commission on Academic Accreditation

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Policy on Creating New Majors at AUS CAA Standards 2019
- Undergraduate Curriculum Development and Review Guide Graduate Curriculum Development and Review Guide

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	November 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for

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			Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	General Update – Approval Levels	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpua@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

b. Program Specification Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	03UIPG02	Policy Title:	Program Specifications Policy
Prepared By:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Program Specifications Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy ensures that each program at the institution maintains an up to date definitive statement of information on a program's aims, learning outcomes, structure, admission requirements, approaches to teaching and learning, assessment and quality assurance.

3. Introduction / background: Not Available

4. Policy Statement:

Every program at AUS must provide a comprehensive specification document that:

- is a primary source of information for students and prospective students seeking an understanding of a program; what students need to have achieved in order to enter the program, what will be expected of them during the program, and what they will have achieved having taken the program
- assists those involved in program curriculum development to appreciate the structure of the program and its learning outcomes
- allows internal and external reviewers to understand the program's learning outcomes, structure and approach
- is a source of information for employers, particularly about the skills, knowledge and aspects of competencies that they can expect from graduates of the program
- assists AUS in communicating essential program information to external stakeholders, such as professional bodies
- is a guide for receiving feedback from students on the extent to which they perceived that the opportunities for learning were met
- Each program specification should include:
 - program title and program code/number
 - authoring team
 - date document prepared
 - dates of initial accreditation of the program and, where appropriate, subsequent renewal of accreditation of the program;
 - dates of international accreditation and subsequent renewal of accreditation, if applicable
 - academic unit(s) delivering the program
 - in cases of interdisciplinary or jointly offered programs, the academic unit primarily responsible for the program;
 - delivery support partner (as applicable)

- p. delivery mode(s)
- q. educational aims of the program
- r. program learning outcomes
- s. completion requirements
- t. program structure
- u. support for students and their learning
- v. criteria for admission
- w. facilities, including laboratories, studios or other specialist resources supporting the program
- x. methods for evaluating and improving the quality and standards of teaching and learning
- y. assessment plan for program learning outcomes
- z. indicators of quality and standards
- aa. program matrices or schematic showing:
 - ☐ the schedule of delivery
 - ☐ program learning outcomes mapped to course learning outcomes
 - ☐ program learning outcomes mapped to descriptors of the QFEmirates for the appropriate program level
 - ☐ teaching and learning methods
 - ☐ assessment methods

5. Scope/applicability:

All bachelor's, master's, and doctoral programs at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Department heads and program coordinators are responsible for maintaining an up to date program specifications document for the programs that they are responsible for.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: Not applicable

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: Not Applicable

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised but no changes made	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpua@aus.edu

Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu
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c. Undergraduate Completion Requirements Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0300RG03	Policy Title:	Undergraduate Completion Requirements Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction ● Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Undergraduate Completion Requirements Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy provides a detailed description of the completion requirements for a general undergraduate degree at AUS including the core and non-core components of the general education program, the structure of the discipline specific general education requirements, and the innovation and entrepreneurship requirement. It also includes a definition of major requirements, major electives, free electives, and internships.

3. Introduction / background:

The policy is reviewed annually and revised accordingly.

4. Policy Statement:

Graduation Requirements Catalog

The graduation requirements for any individual student are determined by the catalog that was effective when the student matriculated in the major, referred to as the student's catalog of record. A student may choose to follow the catalog effective for any semester/term in which they were a registered student in their current program of study. To change catalogs, a student must file a Change of Academic Catalog Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) with the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of Add/Drop period of the student's graduation semester/term.

A student who changes majors may petition to revert to the catalog in effect at the time of matriculation into the university. The Petition Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) must be approved by the student's associate dean and submitted to the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of the add/drop period of the student's graduation semester/term.

Every individual student is personally responsible for meeting all graduation requirements as detailed in his/her catalog of record.

If a required course within a program changes its number of credit hours, then the number of credit hours required by the program for graduation may, at the discretion of the college/school, change by the same amount provided the minimum total number of credit hours for graduation is 120 and the CGPA is at least 2.00.

In case of substantial changes in course offerings, equivalent graduation requirements are determined by the dean of the student's college/school.

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Course information, content and prerequisites may be subject to change as a result of the university's commitment to a process of continual improvement in academic programs. Students must comply with the most up-to-date course requirements.

Courses: Courses are considered primary components of the curriculum and should not be split into individual credit hours to be counted in different areas of the degree audit.

Preparatory Courses

Preparatory courses are intended for students with a deficiency in a specific subject matter. Credit hours generated by preparatory courses do not count in the earned hours and grades earned in preparatory courses do not count in the SGPA and the CGPA.

Preparatory courses do not count towards meeting degree program graduation requirements.

Passing Grade Requirement

The minimum passing grade requirement for a course to meet any area of the graduation requirements and to satisfy any course prerequisites and/or co-requisites is C-.

General Education Program Mission Statement

Liberal studies form the core component of an AUS education. The General Education Program encourages intellectual discovery and critical reflection, promotes an appreciation of the various modes of human inquiry, and develops the knowledge and skills to succeed in and contribute to the Arab Gulf region and the world at large. The program fosters personal development by providing the foundation for lifelong engagement with the questions that shape individuals and societies. General education at AUS complements professional programs by offering opportunities for students to reflect on a diverse and increasingly interdependent world and their place within it.

Program Goals and Outcomes

The General Education Program provides students with opportunities to: Goal A. Gain an understanding of the history and culture of the Arab World

Outcomes

- Explain the literary, artistic or scientific traditions of the Arab world
- Analyze the interdependencies between the Arab Gulf region, the Middle East and the world at large

Goal B. Examine the values and ideas that have shaped the Western intellectual and cultural traditions

Outcomes

- Describe intellectual and cultural traditions of the Western world
- Analyze and explain how Western traditions have influenced the present

Goal C. Explore how modes of human inquiry or expression enhances our understanding of culture

Outcomes

- Analyze cultural ideals and values in order to enhance self-understanding and empathy for others
- Explain how societies are defined in relation to culture, nationality, race, ethnicity or gender
- Analyze and explain implied and expressed cultural values and attitudes in works of literature (literary perspectives)
- Analyze and explain the development of human institutions, ideas and social structures (historical perspectives)
- Analyze and explain philosophical works that present perspectives on social and cultural issues or problems (philosophical perspectives)

Goal D. Appreciate the roles of creative endeavors in enriching the human condition

Outcomes

- Identify, interpret and explain themes in works of literature or art (study of arts/literature)
- Explain how artistic and literary traditions have influenced individuals, cultures or societies (study of arts/literature)

- Demonstrate an understanding of creative processes through the production of works of art or literature (engagement in arts/literature)
- Reflect upon and explain the decisions made during the creative process (engagement in arts/literature)

Goal E. Reflect on the consequences of individual and collective human action

Outcomes

- Explain the ways in which individuals, groups, institutions or societies behave and influence one another
- Analyze and describe how social, cultural, political or economic conditions affect individuals
- Analyze and explain human behavior in a variety of contexts
- Assess the ethical dimensions of actions and explain the relationships between individual moral choices and professional responsibility

Goal F. Recognize the value of the natural sciences

Outcomes

- Explain how scientific hypotheses are conceived and tested
- Explain how basic scientific concepts are related to contemporary issues

Goal G. Employ quantitative reasoning as a conceptual tool for analysis and description

Outcomes

- Analyze data to identify quantitative and qualitative relationships
- Apply basic mathematical concepts
- Demonstrate proficiency in deductive reasoning and problem solving

Goal H. Develop the skills and abilities to thoughtfully seek information, critically analyze sources and clearly formulate complex ideas

Outcomes

- Communicate effectively in written English
- Communicate effectively in spoken English
- Evaluate written communication, identify key ideas and establish hierarchies of information
- Structure clear and persuasive arguments based on an analysis and presentation of evidence
- Analyze and explain how culture affects communication
- Identify and access information resources efficiently and effectively based upon the Association of College and Research Libraries standards

Goal I. Investigate how digital technology can facilitate inquiry and the advancement of knowledge

Outcomes

- Demonstrate how digital technology can contribute to understanding
- Demonstrate the ability to use digital technology to enhance analysis, description and presentation

General Education Requirements

All students must successfully complete a minimum of 36 credit hours in core and non-core general education requirements (GER) with a minimum grade of C- in order to graduate. In addition, students must successfully complete one course from each area of the major- designated requirements. Information on specific courses meeting each of the general education areas is available at <https://www.aus.edu/general-education-program>.

Students who transfer to AUS may satisfy general education requirements if the course(s) being transferred meet the outcomes of a general education area as defined by the general education program.

Core Requirements (minimum of 15 credit hours)

Students must successfully complete a minimum of 15 credit hours in courses meeting the following

core general education areas. Credit hours earned in these areas cannot be counted towards other general education requirements or other degree program requirements. Credit hours counted towards a specific core general education area cannot be counted towards another core general education area.

- history and culture of the Arab world: three to six credit hours
- culture in a critical perspective: three to six credit hours
- arts and literature: three to six credit hours
- human interaction and behavior: three to six credit hours

Non-Core Requirements (minimum of 21 credit hours)

Students must successfully complete a minimum of 21 credit hours in courses meeting the following non-core general education areas. Courses in these areas may also meet major requirements and program core requirements. In cases where a course is considered both a non-core general education requirement and a major or program core requirement, credit hours for the course are counted only once towards the overall credit hours earned and, in the degree program literature, are included in the total credit hours of the major requirements area or the program core requirements area the course satisfies.

- natural sciences: a minimum of six credit hours
- mathematics: a minimum of three credit hours
- statistics: a minimum of three credit hours (for College of Engineering, please see degree program details)
- communication: a minimum of 9 credit hours in 100-level or above writing (WRI) courses and/or 200-level or above English (ENG) courses in this area. WRI 101 Academic Writing I and WRI 102 Academic Writing II should be completed in the first year or before completion of 30 credit hours and cannot be repeated once the student has earned 75 credit hours. Either ENG 203 or ENG 204 can be used to meet the communication requirement.

Major-Designated Requirements

Students must successfully complete one course from each of the following areas:

- ethical understanding
- discipline-specific writing intensive course
- oral proficiency
- information literacy
- computer literacy

Innovation and Entrepreneurship Requirement

All students must successfully complete three credit hours towards the innovation and entrepreneurship requirement. IEN 301 - Innovation and Entrepreneurship Mindset - meets this requirement.

The credit hours earned from IEN 301 cannot be counted towards other degree program graduation requirements.

Students who transfer to AUS may satisfy the innovation and entrepreneurship requirement if the course being transferred meets the outcomes of IEN 301.

Requirements of a Major

Each student in a degree program must successfully complete at least 36 credit hours in courses that are specific to the major and distinctive to the major subject area. The specific requirements for a major are listed as major requirements, program core requirements, concentration requirements and electives, and major electives, under the corresponding degree program section in this catalog.

Some major requirements and program core requirements may count toward fulfilling non-core or major-designated general education requirements; credit hours of such courses will not double count.

Requirements for a Double Major

To graduate with a second major, students must satisfy all of the graduation requirements of the degree programs of the two majors requested. Some courses may be counted toward the fulfillment of both degree programs' graduation requirements.

The catalog in effect for the student's primary major will be followed for the degree audit of both degree programs.

Double-major students will be awarded the degree of the primary major degree program, with a notation on the diploma indicating completion of a second major.

Requirements for a Double Concentration

Certain degree programs offer students the choice of a double concentration. In cases where the two concentrations have common courses, courses used to fulfill the requirements of the first concentration can double count toward the second concentration.

Because the second concentration is not a degree program requirement, it is considered a free choice of the student. As such, courses used toward the second concentration can double count as free electives.

Internships

Internships that contribute to meeting graduation requirements must be a minimum of five consecutive weeks. Some degree programs require the internship to be completed over a minimum of 10 consecutive weeks. Internship offerings and requirements are listed under the various degree program graduation requirements.

For information on internship registration, please see Registration and Course Information/Internship Registration earlier in this section of the catalog.

Free Electives Requirement

To satisfy the free electives requirement, students must successfully complete at least two courses with a minimum of six credit hours. Some degree programs might require more than the minimum of six credit hours. In addition, a college/school may exclude certain courses from being counted as free electives. For more information, please refer to the degree requirements of the corresponding degree program section later in this catalog.

Courses taken to satisfy a double concentration requirement can count towards meeting the free electives requirement.

Requirements of a Minor

Minor programs consist of a minimum of 12 credit hours. At least 50 percent of the credit hours required for a minor must be in courses at or above the 300 level. At least six credit hours of the courses at or above the 300 level must be successfully completed in residence at AUS. Fifty percent of all credit hours required for the minor must be successfully completed in residence at AUS.

Students must meet the prerequisite requirements for courses required for the minor.

The minimum cumulative GPA for minor courses is 2.00. The specific course requirements constituting a minor are listed in the corresponding college/school section in this catalog (refer to the index of this catalog).

Coursework completed in the context of a summer/winter term outside AUS does not meet the residence requirements.

Courses used to satisfy a degree program's graduation requirements can be used towards meeting the minor requirements as follows:

1. At least 12 credit hours of courses used to satisfy the requirements of a minor do not double count towards meeting the core requirements, major requirements, major electives, concentration requirements, concentration electives or general education requirements of the student's degree program graduation requirements.

2. Free elective courses can double count towards meeting a minor's required and elective courses.

Students pursuing 2 minors must meet the requirements of both minors. Courses used to satisfy the requirements of one minor may double count towards satisfying the requirements of the second minor provided that at a minimum, 12 credit hours are not double counting.

All courses used to satisfy a degree program's graduation requirements may also be used towards meeting the requirements of a minor. To complete an additional minor, students must satisfy all the requirements of the two minors.

The catalog in effect for the student's major will normally be followed for the audit of the minor. If the minor is not listed in the student's catalog of record, then the first catalog in which the minor is listed will be applied.

Graduation requirements of the minor(s) must be completed prior to the award of the degree.

Academic Standing Requirement

A student must be in good academic standing to be eligible for graduation.

Graduation Residence Requirements

Candidates for the bachelor's degree are expected to complete their last semester/term in residence at the university unless registered at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement.

A minimum of 36 credit hours of 300- and/or 400-level course work must be successfully completed in residence at AUS to obtain a bachelor's degree. Coursework at the 300- and/or 400- level completed at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement will meet the AUS upper-level requirement if the courses have been pre-approved by the relevant college/school.

Note that coursework completed in the context of a summer/winter term outside AUS does not meet graduation residence requirements.

Transfer students must successfully complete at least 50 percent of the required credit hours for a degree program in residence at AUS.

Time Limit on Duration of Study

Regardless of the catalog by which the student's graduation requirements are governed, all degree requirements must be completed within eight years of admission to AUS as an undergraduate student or matriculation from the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program, inclusive of any leave.

Graduation Procedures and Diploma Information Participation in the Commencement Ceremony

The university holds two commencement exercises: a fall commencement ceremony at the end of the fall semester and a spring commencement ceremony at the end of the spring semester.

Prospective candidates for graduation in a fall or spring semester are eligible to participate in the corresponding semester commencement ceremony. Prospective candidates for graduation in a summer term are eligible to participate in the following fall semester commencement ceremony.

Students registered at the 11th week of a semester for courses/project/internship necessary to complete their degree program requirements may participate in commencement at the end of that semester.

Students who do not wish to participate in the commencement exercises of their semester/term of graduation must complete the Absentia Form available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms or www.aus.edu/commencement. Absentia graduates are not eligible to participate in another commencement ceremony.

Application for Graduation

Candidates for degrees file an Application for Graduation form in the Office of the Registrar in their last expected semester/term of study. The Application for Graduation form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms or www.aus.edu/commencement. The deadlines for application submission are published in the academic calendar at the front section of this catalog, as well as at

www.aus.edu/commencement. Only after an Application for Graduation form has been filed can the Office of the Registrar begin processing the necessary information for final certification for graduation.

Students who fail to complete all degree requirements by the end of the semester/term for which they apply to graduate need not reapply for graduation. Their previous application will be automatically moved to the following semester/term.

Conferral of Degrees

Only students who have successfully completed degree requirements by the end of the semester/term for which they have applied to graduate are certified for conferral of a degree.

Conferral of the degree is noted on the academic transcript of the graduate with the date of graduation.

Conferral of the degree is based solely on achievement of degree requirements. There is no board of examiners or conferral committee involved in the process of conferral.

Names on Diplomas

The names of AUS students will be spelled in English exactly as they appear on their passports or identity cards when printed on diplomas. If a name on a passport or an identity card does not appear in English, then the spelling of the name will be printed according to the personal preference of the student.

Degree Information on Diplomas

The diploma will list the full name of the degree program awarded, as well as the applicable concentration(s).

The diploma of students graduating with a double major will also list the second major. Completed minors appear on the student's academic transcript but not on the diploma.

Graduation Honors

The university grants Latin honors at graduation. To be eligible for graduation honors, students must have achieved the requisite CGPA. These are:

Summa cum laude: 3.90–4.00 CGPA

Magna cum laude: 3.70–3.89 CGPA

Cum laude: 3.50–3.69 CGPA

Latin honors are noted on the student's diploma and transcript.

Attestation of Diplomas and Transcripts

The Office of the Registrar provides information relevant to the attestation of diplomas and transcripts with the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division. For more information, please visit www.aus.edu/commencement.

5. Scope/applicability:

All undergraduate bachelor degree programs at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

It is the responsibility of academic departments to ensure that their programs are designed and maintained in line with this policy. The Office of the Registrar and the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs are responsible for ensuring that any curricular revisions to the programs are in line with this policy.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

GPA: Grade Point Average

CGPA: Cumulative Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

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Graduate completion requirements policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	November, 2021	General Update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May, 2023	Revised – Credit hour number – Minor condition.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April, 2024	General Update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

d. Graduate Completion Requirements Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0300RG04	Policy Title:	Graduate Completion Requirements Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Graduate Degree Programs Graduation Requirements

2. Purpose:

In addition to the specific graduation requirements of individual graduate degree programs, graduate level degree programs share a set of graduation requirements that graduate students must meet in order to be awarded their degree. This general set of requirements ensures that the degree programs graduation requirements are in compliance with the CAA related standards and with recognized practice at the North American institutions of higher education.

A clear statement of the general graduation requirements that graduate students and graduate degree programs must comply with provides the students, the degree programs, as well as all individuals concerned with enforcement of these requirements, with a clear set of guidelines to follow.

Graduate students registered as degree seeking students must comply with these requirements, as applies to their choice of degree program, to be awarded their degree.

3. Introduction / background:

Not Applicable

4. Policy Statement: Catalog:

The graduation requirements for any individual student are determined by the catalog that was effective when the student admitted in the major, referred to as the catalog of record.

A student may choose to follow the catalog effective for any semester/term in which they were a registered student in their current program of study. To change catalogs, a student must file a Change of Academic Catalog Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) with the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of Add/Drop period of the student's graduation semester/term.

A student who changes his/her degree program may petition to revert to the catalog in effect at the time of matriculation into the university. The Petition Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) must be approved by the student's graduate program coordinator/head of department or associate dean and submitted to the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of the add/drop period of the student's graduation semester/term.

Every individual student is personally responsible for meeting all graduation requirements as detailed in his/her catalog of record.

If a required course within a degree program changes its number of credit hours, then the number of credit hours required by the degree program for graduation may, at the discretion of the college/school,

change by the same amount provided the minimum total number of credit hours for graduation is 30 for a master's degree program and 54 for a PhD degree program, and the CGPA is at least 3.00. In case of substantial changes in course offerings, equivalent graduation requirements are determined by the dean of the student's college/school.

Disclaimer: Course information, content and prerequisites may be subject to change as a result of the university's commitment to a process of continual improvement in academic programs. Students must comply with the most up-to-date course requirements.

Courses

Courses are considered primary components of the curriculum and should not be split into individual credit hours to be counted in different areas of the degree audit.

Requirements of a Graduate Degree Program

Each student in a graduate degree program must successfully complete a minimum number of credit hours in courses that are specific to the degree program and distinctive to the major subject area of the degree program. The specific requirements are listed as major requirements (that could comprise college core requirements and program core requirements), concentration requirements and electives, and major electives. The minimum number of credit hours of a master's degree is 30 credit hours; the minimum number of credit hours of a PhD degree is 54 credit hours.

Details of the graduation requirements of a degree program are provided under the corresponding degree program section in the Graduate Academic Catalogue.

Conferral of the degree is based solely on achievement of degree requirements. There is no board of examiners or conferral committee involved in the process of conferral.

Requirements for a Double Major

To complete a double major, students must satisfy the degree program requirements of the two majors requested. Some courses may be counted toward the fulfillment of both degrees' requirements. The catalog in effect for the student's primary major will be followed for the degree audit of the second major.

Double-major students will be awarded the degree of the primary major degree program, with a notation on the diploma indicating completion of a second major.

Graduate Courses Completed While at the Undergraduate Level

With the approval of their associate dean and the relevant graduate program coordinator/head of department, AUS senior undergraduate students with a minimum CGPA of 3.00 can register for up to two master's level courses while enrolled at the undergraduate level. Once the student is admitted to an AUS master's degree program, these courses may be counted toward completion of the master's degree program requirements, provided they were completed no more than five years prior to the start date of the first semester of study of the current master's degree program. Where AUS graduate courses taken while at the undergraduate level count towards the student's master's degree program graduation requirements, courses could be used to satisfy registration requirements, as applicable.

Grades earned in such courses will also count in the master's-level cumulative grade point average (CGPA).

Undergraduate students accepted to the Accelerated Master's Program (AMP) of an AUS master's-level degree program are eligible to register for a maximum of six credit hours in master's-level courses while completing their undergraduate degree program graduation requirements. These courses may be used towards meeting the undergraduate degree program graduation requirements and may be evaluated for transfer of credit hours towards meeting the master's-level degree program graduation requirements post admission to the program.

For full details on the AMP, including eligibility, application process, course registration and tuition fees, refer to the Accelerated Master's Program section of the AUS Undergraduate Catalog or consult www.aus.edu/amp.

Graduation Residence Requirements

Candidates for graduation are expected to complete their last semester in residence at the university, unless registered at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement.

In order to obtain a master's degree from AUS, students must complete a minimum of two regular semesters in residence at AUS. Accelerated Master's Program (AMP) students who are admitted to the corresponding master's degree program and who choose the thesis option of this program must complete a minimum of three regular semesters in residence at AUS as students of that master's degree program.

To earn a PhD degree from AUS, doctoral students must complete a minimum of four semesters in residence at AUS. Coursework completed at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement will meet the graduation residence requirement provided the courses have been pre-approved by the relevant graduate program coordinator/head of department and the associate dean for graduate studies.

Note that coursework completed in the context of a summer term outside AUS does not meet graduation residence requirements.

Master's degree students may transfer up to six credit hours in master's-level courses. PhD degree students may transfer up to nine credit hours in doctoral-level courses. For details, please refer to the Transfer Credit hours Policy under the Admission to Graduate Studies section earlier in this catalog.

Time Limit on Duration of Study

Regardless of the catalog by which the student's graduation requirements are governed, all degree requirements must be completed within five years of admission to AUS as a master's degree student and within 10 years of admission to AUS as a PhD degree student, inclusive of any leave.

Academic Standing Requirement

A student must be in good academic standing to be eligible for graduation.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy governs the degree awarding of every graduate level student registered in a graduate degree program.

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of the Registrar is responsible for enforcing this policy by ensuring that graduate students who do not meet the policy requirements detailed in this policy are not awarded graduate degrees.

Exceptions to any of this policy requirements are requested by the student and evaluated by the student's graduate program coordinator. Exceptions recommended for approval are forwarded to the associate dean for graduate studies of the student's college. If approved, these exceptions are forwarded to the Office of the Registrar. The Office of Registrar is responsible for evaluating the recommended exceptions. Exceptions that are not approved by the Office of the Registrar are forwarded with all supporting documents to the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies for final decision making.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AMP: Accelerated Master's Program
- CGPA: cumulative grade point average

- GPA: grade point average
- CAA: Commission for Academic Accreditation

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019
- AACRAO guide for best practice
- Master's Thesis Professional Project and Dissertation
- Each degree program graduation requirements as detailed in the degree program section of the graduate academic catalog.

9. Policy history:

This policy is reviewed every academic year by the Office of the Registrar and by the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies. Recommendations for modifications are discussed by the Graduate Programs Committee within the course of the academic year and prior to the compilation of the Graduate Academic Catalog.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	September, 2022	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May, 2023	Editorial Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April 25, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Registrar	Tel:9716-5152003	registrar@aus.edu

e. Course Substitution Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300RG05	Policy Title:	Course Substitution Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction ● Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Course Substitution Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy governs the conditions under which AUS deems it reasonable to offer a course substitution for a student's degree requirements.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Courses required by a degree program or by a minor are regularly offered at a frequency that will ensure students' timely access to these courses to facilitate meeting graduation requirements. Elective courses are offered at the discretion of the department offering the course. Electives listed in the course descriptions section of this catalog are expected to be offered on a regular basis, at a frequency that provides students fair access to courses of interest and as permitted by the department faculty load.

In the unlikely event where a department was short of offering a required course, resulting in a possible delay in a student's graduation, and where the student's CGPA does not meet the minimum CGPA requirement for taking the course independently (refer to Independent Study Course Registration under Registration and Course Information earlier in this section of the catalog), a course substitution could be considered, provided the following conditions are met:

- It has been identified that the required course was not offered as frequently as expected, resulting in the student not having a reasonable opportunity to register for the course;
- It has been established that the course to substitute for the required course meets, to a reasonable extent, degree program outcomes the required course satisfies;
- It has been established that not offering a course substitute alternative will delay the student's graduation.

An upper-level course can only be substituted by an upper-level course.

5. Scope/applicability:

All undergraduate degree programs and minors at AUS. All graduate programs at AUS

6. Responsibilities:

To request a course substitution, a student must file a petition and submit it to his/her head of department by the first day of the semester/term for which the exception is requested.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

VPUAI: Vice Provost of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction

CGPA: Cumulative Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Student Petition Form at www.aus.edu/registration/forms

Course Waiver policy (graduate catalog)

Transfer of Credit Hours policy (undergraduate and graduate catalogs)

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Updated student responsibility for application process	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs & Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

f. Joint Degree Programs Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0300PG06	Policy Title:	Joint Degree Programs Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	December 1, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	● Vice Provost for Graduate Studies ● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Joint Degree Programs Policy

2. Purpose:

To provide guidelines on the establishment and management of joint degree programs with other institutions as per CAA Standards

3. Introduction / background:

As per CAA Standards “In a joint degree program students study at two or more institutions, and upon completion of the program receive a single degree certificate issued by all the participating institutions. A joint degree program is a program that is designed and delivered in conjunction with one or more partner institutions. The partner(s) may or may not be based in the UAE. Typically, a joint degree program will be established to access the partner institution’s specialized knowledge and experience.”

4. Policy Statement:

Academic programs may establish joint degrees with reputable universities in order to enhance the knowledge and learning experience of students and to strengthen the AUS portfolio. Proposals for establishing joint degree programs must be endorsed by the college/school curriculum committee, dean, university curriculum committee (either UUC or GPC). The proposal must be approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Once approved, the program must prepare a self-study as per the CAA requirements for initial program accreditation.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all degree programs that are jointly offered with other institutions.

6. Responsibilities:

Heads of departments and deans to oversee the pre-planning and proposal development of joint degree programs. The relevant Vice Provost (undergraduate or graduate) to oversee the proposal review process by the university curriculum committee and make a recommendation to the Provost. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost to approve the proposal.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not Applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Creating New Majors at AUS Policy
CAA Standards (Joint Degree Programs)

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 1, 2021	Initial creation of policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	General update – Approval levels	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs & Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

g. E-Learning Policy

This policy covers a number of policies as follows:

1. Design of E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy - Version 4
2. Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy - Version 3
3. Online Assessment Policy – Version 3

1. Design of E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0300AP07	Policy Title:	Design of E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	December 11, 2020
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May, 2026

1. Policy:

Design of E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy.

2. Purpose:

To provide guidelines for designing E-learning programs and courses to ensure that the pedagogy facilitates interaction among students and between students, and faculty.

3. Introduction/background:

Not Applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

The University is committed to designing E-Learning programs and courses that are highly engaging and provide opportunities for interaction between students as well as between faculty and students.

1.1. Development of Online Programs and Courses

The overall procedures and processes relating to the development of the Blended Learning courses will entail the following phases;

A. Analysis Phase

Faculty members in liaison with the program coordinators and department heads will identify the potential courses to be delivered in a blended learning mode. The criteria for identification of the potential blended learning courses include the nature of the courses, course level, profile of the learners, preparation of the instructors, and the desired outcomes such as enhancement of the teaching and learning experience, open and flexible delivery, support of different learning styles, etc. The course instructors will be responsible for compiling the course content and will provide a breakdown of the

learning content delivered in the traditional mode and in blended learning mode in preparedness for the design phase. The course instructors consult with the Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL) staff in preparation for the design phase of the online component of the course. Approval of offering a course in a blended learning format will be through the regular curriculum review process involving department/program, college/school, university level curriculum committees, department head and dean.

B. Design phase

The course instructors in consultation with the TSLC department representative, CITL, and IT services will identify the learning components with potential for delivery in blended learning mode to match different learning styles and course objectives.

The design phase of the blended learning courses will identify the learning units of instruction that will be covered online. This includes the establishment of e-learning components such as online exercises, content, lesson planning, media selection, etc. IT requirements and educational technology support are also considered at the design phase.

C. Development and testing phase

The required e-learning components will be developed (e.g., video, animation, assessment, online lectures, etc.) by the instructional designer in liaison with the course instructor. The course instructor in collaboration with the instructional designer will continuously test, review and revise the instructional units.

D. Implementation phase

Training for the use of the Learning Management System (LMS) will be provided by the Education Technology and Support team to the course instructor and the students with clear instructions and guidance notes to assist with their engagement in the course. Where there are synchronous modes of delivery (real-time), technical support will be provided before and during the sessions. Similarly, instructions and technical support will be provided for asynchronous modes of delivery to ensure compatibility of the learning environment and smooth delivery of the course.

E. Evaluation phase

The evaluation phase includes gathering feedback from students and course instructors about the teaching and learning pedagogy, instructional design services, IT infrastructure services, IT infrastructure support, and other related services. Feedback is often obtained as part of the regular end of semester course evaluation process including student surveys and course assessment reports by the faculty. However, feedback may also be obtained through peer observation, self-reflection, and formal and informal discussion with colleagues. The feedback will be used by the concerned party (instructor, program, IT, CITL) to inform decisions about future changes and support to continuously enhance the e-learning course delivery experience. The evaluation of the faculty teaching online/blended courses will take into consideration their efforts in the preparation of the course material, use of appropriate assessment methods, demonstration of promoting engagement with and among students, and efforts in ensuring an excellent learning experience for online students.

1.2. Student Assessment

Mid-term and final exams will be conducted on campus (in-house), following the traditional controlled measures according to the university policy. Other assessment methods such as quizzes, presentations, essays, etc., or assessments for fully online classes, can be assessed online with appropriate academic integrity measures such as Respondus LockDown browser and Monitor.

Regardless of the apps or software used, all data used in the course delivery/assessment are kept by the course instructor to be included in the course file prepared at the end of each course delivery as per the Course File Policy.

Assessment of submitted student papers/class projects should involve class presentations and discussions and that will help in ensuring authenticating the student work. Furthermore, student work is checked using plagiarism detection software.

1.3. Student Interaction

Instructors delivering online classes must use appropriate technology (e.g. Blackboard Collaborate) to allow for students' interaction within the virtual learning environment through shared presentations, real-time voice interaction, instructor/user(s) management controls, and group interactions using virtual classrooms, mimicking the traditional arrangements for group work. Students will also be able to request to meet the instructor in person or schedule an on-line meeting.

The main source of communications, including assignment and feedback, in online courses is the LMS and the AUS official email. When apps or software outside the LMS are used, then the data is stored for quality assurance purposes by the course instructor.

4.4 Student Support

Students registered in courses offered using a blended mode of delivery, where students are required to have regular presence at the University campus, will have opportunities for both face-to-face and online student-faculty interaction. Furthermore, students registered in fully online courses/programs will have adequate remote access to all program and university services including scheduling meetings with instructors, advisors, program coordinator, and department head. Students at AUS will be encouraged to freely engage with their peers in online group discussions and virtual spaces via the online portal, as well as having direct access to supervisory support, questions and answers. Furthermore, AUS is already well equipped and currently provides online services in areas such as recruitment, enrolment management, student accounts, advising and counselling, registration, career services, technical help and library resources.

4.5 AUS does not sell student or faculty information or use sites or software that use student or faculty information for commercial purposes.

4.6 The use and access of online courses data and course sessions and materials is limited to students who are registered in the online course and for the sole purpose of meeting the course requirements.

4.7 Student proctoring videos are stored in a secure environment with access limited to those that need access only. After a defined period of time, the videos are automatically purged from the system.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to programs and courses offered fully online or using blended learning delivery mode.

6. Responsibilities:

Implementation is by instructors and departments with support from the CITL and ICT and IT Security Department. The office of the dean and the Office of the Provost oversee the implementation of e-learning courses and programs.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- CITL - Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning
- LMS - Learning Management System
- TSLC - Technology Supported Learning Committee
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8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Appendix IV. E-Learning Manual
- IT Online Learning Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 10, 2020	Creation of the new policy.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	February 22, 2023	Revised to address the requirements of the CAA Procedural Manual for Online and Blended Learning. Approved by the Council of Deans and Provost and CAO	Vice Provost for Research and Graduate Studies
3.0	May, 2023	Reviewed – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

2. Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0300AP08	Policy Title:	Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	December 11, 2020
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May, 2026

1. Policy:

Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy

The University is committed to create a working environment for its faculty that supports them in teaching their courses seamlessly whether online or in person.

2. Purpose:

This Policy ensures that faculty are equipped with all the areas of support needed in order to deliver online or hybrid courses in accordance with the quality standards of AUS.

3. Introduction/Background: N.A.

4. Policy Statement:

This policy outlines the institution's responsibilities in terms of offering support to faculty members teaching online or hybrid courses.

Faculty members teaching online or hybrid courses are entitled to the following support. It is the responsibility of the faculty member to seek engagement in the support being offered in these areas.

Section 1: IT support

The information technology department supports course instructors through:

- Providing regular training sessions on the tools used in the e-learning environment
- Considering faculty feedback on suggested enhancements to the e-learning environment
- Responding to service requests in a timely manner
- Providing and maintaining the necessary hardware required to support the e-learning environment.

Section 2: Pedagogical Support

The Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL) supports course instructors through:

- Regular group training/information sessions on topics related to e-learning pedagogy
- Individual instructional design support by suitably qualified personnel
- Training and advice on how to assess students in an online environment

Section 3: Library services

The AUS Library supports course instructors by providing:

- E-books to support learning objectives
- A scanning service (within copyright) to deliver print material electronically
- A print book delivery service to faculty residences on-campus, or via courier for off- campus faculty
- Resources for embedding information literacy skills into the e-learning environment
- Personalized support from professional librarians for faculty and students for learning and research help.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to faculty that deliver programs and courses offered fully online or using blended learning delivery mode as well as the departments that provide the support needed to ensure the delivery of these programs and courses.

6. Responsibilities:

Implementation is by instructors and departments with support from the Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL) and ICT and IT Security Department and Library Services.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N/A

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Appendix IV. E-Learning Manual
- IT Online Learning Policy
- Designing E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 11, 2020	Creation of the new policy. Changes will be tracked going forward.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May, 2023	Full Revised	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: (971) 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

3. Online Assessment Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0300AP09	Policy Title:	Online Assessment Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	December 23, 2020
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May, 2026

1. Policy:

Online Assessment Policy

2. Purpose:

The university is committed to administering effective online examinations while maintaining its standards for academic integrity.

3. Introduction / background:

This policy was introduced due to the onset of the COVID 19 pandemic and as a result of the safety restrictions imposed.

4. Policy Statement:

This policy outlines the responsibilities of the University with regards to maintaining academic integrity during online examinations. The University will:

- Maintain guidelines for administering effective online exams
- Ensure that the guidelines will be available to all instructors of online courses
- Provide online assessment support to course instructors through groups workshops and one-to-one consultations
- Maintain the capacity to provide an online proctoring software tool to course instructors of online courses and provide training in the tool to course students and instructors
- Provide training to students on how to take an online exam that is proctored by online proctoring software
- Maintain a rigorous and transparent academic integrity code and ensure that this is available to all members of the AUS community
- Provide guidelines on how the code can be applied to alleged violations during an online exam

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all courses and programs requiring exams to be scheduled and administered using and online method.

6. Responsibilities:

Course instructors are responsible for ensuring the integrity of online assessment and providing

students with clear guidelines about online assessment policies and procedures used in their courses. Students are required to abide by all guidelines related to online assessment.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N/A

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Student Academic Integrity Code
- Appendix IV. E-Learning Manual

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 23, 2020	Creation of the new policy. Changes will be tracked going forward.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May, 2023	Full Revision	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: (971) 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

h. Additional Degree from the Same Institution Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300RG10	Policy Title:	Additional Degree from the Same Institution Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Additional Degree from the Same Institution Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy governs the conditions under students may apply for a second degree at the undergraduate and graduate levels at AUS.

3. Introduction / background: No Applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Applicants for a Second Undergraduate Degree

Applicants who have completed an undergraduate degree at AUS are not eligible to apply for a second undergraduate degree at AUS.

Applicants with an undergraduate degree earned at another independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS may apply for a second undergraduate degree at AUS. Courses completed within the context of the first undergraduate degree program will not be evaluated for transfer of credit hours or course waivers towards the AUS degree program graduation requirements.

Applicants for a second undergraduate degree must complete the New Applicant online application by the dates specified in the Application Deadlines section hereafter. The official transcript of the previously earned undergraduate degree must be submitted. After completing their application, applicants should contact infodesk.aus.edu to request admission as applicants for a second degree.

To be considered for admission, applicants must meet the minimum established university admission requirements, as well as any additional requirements specific to the degree program they are applying for. For details, refer to Program Admission Requirements under First-Year Admission in the Admission to Undergraduate Studies section of the undergraduate catalog.

Applicants for a Second Master's Degree

Holders of a master's degree awarded by AUS or another independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS may apply for admission to an AUS master's degree program.

Applicants for a second master's degree must complete the New Applicant online application by the dates specified in the Application Deadlines section. The official transcript of the previously earned master's degree must be submitted. After completing their application, applicants should contact

graduateadmissions@aus.edu to request admission as applicants for a second degree.

To be considered for admission, applicants must satisfy the General University Requirements for Graduate Admission (refer to Full Admission and Conditional Admission section in the Graduate Catalogue), as well as any specific requirements set by the master's degree program they are applying to. For details on program-specific admission requirements, please refer to the relevant degree program section of the graduate catalog. Holders of a master's degree awarded by AUS are considered to have met the AUS General University Requirements for Graduate Admission.

Graduate courses applied towards a previously earned master's degree may be considered for transfer of credit hours. Whether the first master's degree was awarded by AUS or by another university, the grades earned for courses completed to fulfill the requirements of the first master's degree program will not count in the calculation of the cumulative GPA for the second master's degree program. Approved courses that meet the graduation requirements of the second master's degree program will be recorded as transferred courses. For more information on transfer of credit hours, see Transfer of Credit Hours in the Admission to Graduate Studies section of the graduate catalog.

Policies and regulations governing registration, grades and graduation requirements apply.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate degree programs at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

VPUAI and Office of the Registrar

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

GPA: Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Transfer of Credit Hours (graduate catalog)
- Waiver of Credit Hours (graduate catalog)
- Course Substitution Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Editorial updates	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

i. Thesis/Dissertation Supervision and Examination Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300RG11	Policy Title:	Thesis and Dissertation Supervision and Examinations
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Thesis and Dissertation Supervision and Examinations

2. Purpose:

Master's theses and PhD dissertations document research are conducted by graduate students under the guidance and supervision of faculty members. They are the culmination of the students' programs of study and are expected to reflect appropriate scholarly depth and rigor. This policy aims at ensuring that the expected scholarly depth and rigor is attained by every master's thesis and PhD dissertation compiled by every graduated student.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Master's thesis supervision

The master's thesis committee is normally constituted of up to three members — the master's thesis advisor and two additional members as examiners. The committee is formed by the program coordinator/head of department in consultation with the master's thesis advisor and is approved by the student's associate dean. Each committee member must hold a terminal degree in their discipline and must have a demonstrated record of scholarly activities related to the thesis/project research topic. The master's thesis advisor must be research-active and must have prior supervisory experience at the graduate level.

For details on the master's thesis committee formation and related deadlines, please refer to the *Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies -Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures.

Master's thesis examination

Master's thesis students must prepare and orally present the proposal of their master's thesis to the satisfaction of a master's thesis committee by the end of the first semester/term of registration in their master's thesis. Students who do not demonstrate adequate thesis work progress by the end of the 10th week of the semester will be withdrawn from the master's thesis by their advisors.

The master's thesis normally requires longer than one semester/term to be completed. A master's thesis grade will be assigned after defense of the master's thesis and submission of the approved master's thesis. The master's thesis defense has two parts: an open public session followed by a

closed session with the master's thesis committee. The associate dean for graduate studies will inform the Office of Graduate Studies and the Office of the Registrar of the master's thesis final grade.

PhD Dissertation supervision

Prior to registering for dissertation credit hours, PhD degree candidates must officially request the appointment of their Dissertation Advisory Committee (DAC) or, otherwise, the DAC chair. The DAC is constituted of the DAC Chair and two other members, at a minimum. In addition to the DAC chair, at least two of the DAC members must hold a full-time faculty position at AUS. All DAC members must hold doctoral degrees and must have a demonstrated record of scholarly activities related to the dissertation topic. In addition, the DAC chair must have prior supervisory experience at the graduate level.

The DAC chair is the principal dissertation advisor of the PhD degree candidate, guiding the candidate develop the dissertation research proposal and completing the dissertation.

For details on the DAC formation, please refer to the *Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies - Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures.

PhD Dissertation Defense

Qualifying Examination

To advance to candidacy for a PhD degree and become eligible to register for the PhD dissertation, a doctoral student must pass a qualifying examination. The qualifying examination may have a written and/or oral part to test the student's breadth of knowledge, understanding of fundamentals, and ability to perform independent research work in a specific area.

Registration for the qualifying examination is conditional upon meeting the following minimum requirements:

- the student must be in good academic standing
- the student must have successfully completed a minimum of 12 credit hours of doctoral-level course work.

Further eligibility requirements may be imposed by the individual PhD degree programs. For details, consult the degree program information in the Graduate Catalog.

Students need to seek guidance from their program coordinator/head of department regarding the qualifying examination requirements and deadlines.

A doctoral student who fails the qualifying examination is academically dismissed from the university. A student who was academically dismissed as a result of failing the qualifying examination may petition for reinstatement and a repeat of the failed qualifying examination to the program coordinator/head of department, one month ahead of the registration of the semester immediately following academic dismissal.

Decisions regarding reinstatement and repeat of the qualifying examination will be made by the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies. A student who failed the qualifying examination may be allowed to repeat the qualifying examination only once.

Further details on the qualifying examination are provided in the *Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies - Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures.

Dissertation Proposal

Students are expected to successfully complete the dissertation proposal within three semesters of dissertation first registration. A PhD candidate is eligible to defend the dissertation research proposal only after all coursework is successfully completed. The research proposal defense includes a comprehensive examination of all coursework completed.

Failure to complete the dissertation proposal within the specified time frame or failure to demonstrate progress after the proposal defense may result in assigning an NP grade, resulting in withdrawal of candidacy from the PhD degree program.

The dissertation proposal report must be submitted and orally presented to the dissertation review panel. The dissertation review panel is composed of the DAC in addition to two more members who hold a doctorate degree and are active in the research field of the proposal. The proposal must be approved in writing by the review panel. Details on the dissertation proposal review process are provided in the *Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies -Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures.

Dissertation Defense and Grading

The dissertation must be defended to the satisfaction of the Final Oral Defense Committee (FODC). The FODC consists of the DAC members and at least two additional members. The FODC membership is formed by the program coordinator/head of department in consultation with the DAC chair; it is approved by the associate dean for graduate studies and appointed by the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies. One of the extra members must be a full- time faculty member from the student's academic program and the other member must be a doctorate holder from outside AUS. The curriculum vita for the committee member external to AUS must be provided by the DAC Chair to the Office of Graduate Studies with the request for forming the FODC.

The dissertation defense has two parts: an open public session followed by a closed session with the FODC. The outcome of the defense will be either Pass or Fail. If the candidate is required to make minor or major changes, then the final grade will not be assigned under the final dissertation is accepted. If the work is not completed within the semester of the defense then and IP grade will be assigned and the student will be required to continue registration in dissertation credit in the following semester/term until the work is completed.

Candidates with an NP grade may petition to the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies, within one month of receiving the grade, for permission for a second final oral examination. If approved, the student must register for three credit hours of dissertation. The examination must be held with the same FODC, no sooner than four months from the first final oral examination.

Failing the second final oral examination will result in an automatic withdrawal of candidacy from the PhD degree program.

For further details, consult the *Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies - Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to every graduate level student registered in master's thesis or a PhD dissertation.

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies in collaboration with the Graduate Programs Committee establishes and oversees the regulations and requirements for master's theses, professional

projects and PhD dissertations at AUS. Degree candidates are responsible for adhering to these requirements as published in the *Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies -Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures. In addition, degree candidates are responsible for familiarizing themselves with and adhering to the standards and regulations of the latest edition of the *AUS Guide to Writing and Formatting Dissertation-Thesis-Final Project Reports* available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community- Graduate Studies - Writing and Formatting Guidelines.

It is AUS policy to maintain master's theses and PhD dissertations in the AUS Archives and to make them available to other students and scholars. The AUS Library is responsible for the archiving of the master's theses and PhD dissertations. Detailed procedures and requirements for submitting master's theses and PhD dissertations to the AUS Library and Archives are outlined in the *Graduate Studies*.

Policies and Procedures document

AUS also has a stringent policy regarding research involving humans as subjects. Detailed information on such research activities may be found on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community-Research Services–Institutional Review Board (IRB).

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- FODC: Final Oral Defense Committee
- DAC: Dissertation Advisory Committee
- IRB: Institutional Review Board
- NO: No Pass
- IP: In Progress
- P: Pass

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019
- Each degree program graduation requirements as detailed in the degree program section of the graduate academic catalog.
- <https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalog>
- Master's thesis and PhD dissertation registration and grading processes as detailed in the graduate academic catalog

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Pass/Fail details updated	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Further details can be sought from the student's graduate program coordinator. For contact details, consult the University Directory.

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: (971) 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

j. Academic Progress Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300RG12	Policy Title:	Academic Progress Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Academic Progress Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy governs the conditions under which a student at undergraduate or graduate level can be placed on academic probation or be academically dismissed.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Undergraduate Students Academic Standing

An undergraduate student's academic standing is determined by his/her CGPA.

Matriculated Achievement Academy students start their first undergraduate semester in good standing, regardless of their most recent Bridge Program academic standing.

Good Academic Standing

In order to be considered in good standing, an undergraduate student must maintain a CGPA of at least 2.00 out of 4.00. A student must be in good standing to be eligible for graduation.

Placement on Academic Probation

All undergraduate students are placed on academic probation at the end of a semester in which the CGPA falls below 2.00. A full-time undergraduate student on probation for the first time is allowed to carry a load of five courses with a maximum of 16 credits. A full-time undergraduate student who is on a second consecutive probation may only register for four courses with a maximum of 13 credits. Thereafter, an undergraduate student must be in good academic standing (minimum CGPA of 2.00) to continue at AUS.

An undergraduate student who registers for a summer term while on academic probation and who fails to remove his/her academic probation by the end of that summer term will maintain his/her academic probationary status.

Undergraduate students placed on academic probation must sign a contract with the Academic Support Center. Probation students are expected to fulfill the obligations of their probation contract and meet on a regular basis with their Academic Support Center advisor. In addition, undergraduate students who have earned less than 30 credit hours and who are placed on academic probation for the first time are required to successfully complete the university study skills course UPA 200 offered by the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program. Students who have enrolled in the Achievement

Academy/Bridge Program prior to admission to the undergraduate level and have completed the university study skills course UPA 100 while in the Academy are exempted from this requirement. For more details, see the section on the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program in this catalog.

Removal of Academic Probation

Undergraduate academic probation will be removed at the end of any semester or summer term in which the student attains a CGPA of 2.00.

Academic Dismissal

An undergraduate student who fails to remove his/her probation by the end of the second consecutive semester on academic probation, with the academic probation status maintained at the end of the interim summer term, is academically dismissed and will not be allowed to continue as a student at AUS.

Students seeking reinstatement following academic dismissal must file a Reinstatement Petition form with the Academic Support Center (ASC) prior to the official deadline. The Reinstatement Petition, eligibility criteria for application and submission deadlines are available from the ASC. Reinstatement petitions may be submitted only for the regular semester immediately following the academic dismissal semester. Reinstatement following academic dismissal is granted only in exceptional circumstances.

Graduate Students

Academic Standing

A student's academic standing is determined by his/her CGPA.

Good Academic Standing

In order to be considered in good academic standing, graduate students must maintain a CGPA of at least 3.00 out of 4.00.

A student must be in good academic standing to be eligible for graduation.

Academic Probation

If a graduate student's cumulative GPA falls below 3.00 at the end of any given semester, the student is placed on academic probation. A graduate student placed on academic probation, who fails to remove his/her academic probation by the end of the immediately following summer term, will maintain his/her academic probationary status.

During probationary status, the following conditions apply:

- A graduate student on academic probation may not register for more than six credit hours in a semester. The program director/coordinator may restrict the summer course load of a graduate student on academic probation to three credit hours.
- A graduate student on academic probation may not register for thesis, final project or dissertation.

An academic probation is removed at the end of any semester/term in which the student attains a CGPA of 3.00.

Academic Dismissal

A graduate student on academic probation who does not achieve good academic standing by the end of the regular semester following the semester in which the cumulative GPA fell below 3.00, with the academic probationary status maintained at the end of the interim summer term, is academically dismissed from the university.

Graduate students who receive an F grade in a graduate course are academically dismissed from the university.

PhD degree seeking students who fail the qualifying examination are academically dismissed from the university.

Students who have been academically dismissed may petition for reinstatement to the student's program director/coordinator, one month ahead of registration of the semester immediately following academic dismissal. The Student Petition Form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms. Petitions will be reviewed by the graduate program director/coordinator who will make a written recommendation to the appropriate dean (or appointed designee). The dean (or appointed designee) will then provide a recommendation to the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies. Decisions regarding continuation in the program will be made by the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies in consultation with the appropriate dean (or appointed designee). Reinstatement following academic dismissal is granted only in exceptional circumstances.

Academically dismissed students who have been away longer than two consecutive semesters may not apply for readmission.

Withdrawal of PhD Candidacy

Doctoral students who do not successfully defend their dissertation proposal or their final dissertation are asked to withdraw their PhD candidacy. Doctoral students who are asked to withdraw their PhD candidacy are not eligible to continue at AUS, do not qualify for reinstatement and may not apply for readmission. For details, refer to *Office of Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures* document available on iLearn and accessible using the following path: iLearn-Community-Office of Graduate Studies (OGS)-Office of Graduate Studies Policies & Procedures.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

The academic support center is responsible for monitoring the progress of undergraduate students on academic probation. The Office of the Registrar is responsible for maintaining records of academic progress.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- GPA: Grade Point Average
- CGPA: Cumulative Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Appeal of a Grade
- Independent Study Course Registration (undergraduate catalog)
- Internship Registration (undergraduate catalog)
- Interrupted Studies and Reactivation of Student Record
- Graduation/Academic Standing Requirement (undergraduate catalog)
- Student Course Load
- Master's Thesis/Professional Project/Dissertation/Registration

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for

			Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes made	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

k. Grading and Assessment Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0300RG13	Policy Title:	Grading and Assessment Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Grading and Assessment Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy provides a description of the AUS grading scale at the undergraduate and graduate level at AUS. The policy governs the contribution of the standard letter grades towards the CGPA and provides conditions for which non-standard letter grades can be applied.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

UNDERGRADUATE STUDENTS

Grading System

Excellent	
A	equals 4.00 grade points
A-	equals 3.70 grade points
Good	
B+	equals 3.30 grade points
B	equals 3.00 grade points
B-	equals 2.70 grade points
Satisfactory	
C+	equals 2.30 grade points
C	equals 2.00 grade points
C-	equals 1.70 grade points
Poor	
D	equals 1.00 grade points
Fail	
F	equals 0.00 grade points
Academic Integrity Violation Fail	
XF	equals 0.00 grade points

The grade point average (GPA) is based on a four-point scale. The minimum passing grade for any course taken at AUS is C-. The following grading system is used at AUS:
Grades not calculated in the grade point average are:

AUD	Audit
AW	Administrative Withdrawal
I	Incomplete
IP	In Progress
N	No Grade
P	Pass; credits counted
TR	Transfer; credits counted
W	Withdrawal
WV	Waive; no credit

The grade appeal process is outlined in the Student Petitions and Appeals section herein.

Incomplete Grades

The work for a course must be completed by the end of the final examination period of the corresponding registration semester/term. In the case of unexcused incomplete work, an F grade is given for the missing work and the course grade is computed accordingly. Only in exceptional cases, such as a compelling medical or other emergency certified in writing by a medical or other professional, is a student assigned an incomplete grade (I) in a given course (also see Examinations earlier in this section). The instructor of the course will then process an Incomplete Grade Form (available from the office of the associate dean) through the college/school housing the course and submit it to the Office of the Registrar for final approval and implementation. The Incomplete Grade Form must be submitted within the final examinations period.

An I grade pending beyond the end of the second full week of classes of the next regular semester will revert into either an F grade or the alternative grade indicated by the instructor of the course on the Incomplete Grade Form. It is the responsibility of the student to find out from his/her professor the specific dates by which requirements must be fulfilled.

Prospective candidates for graduation with incomplete grades will be awarded their degrees in the semester/term where their courses are completed.

In Progress Grades

Project and internship courses could take longer than one semester to complete. In this case, the college/school associate dean will request that the Registrar enter an In Progress (IP) grade. The request for an In Progress grade must be submitted within the final examination period.

The in-progress work must be completed before the deadline agreed upon with the Registrar, not exceeding the end of the following semester/term. An IP grade pending beyond this time limit will revert into an F grade. It is the responsibility of the student to find out from his/her professor the specific dates by which requirements must be fulfilled.

No Grade Entries

An No Grade (N) is assigned to a course when an academic integrity violation has been reported and the adjudication process cannot be concluded before the course grade is due for the semester/term. In such cases, the N grade is temporary and the final grade for the course will be entered once the adjudication process is concluded.

If a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code or the Student Code of Conduct results in suspension or dismissal effective for the semester/term in which the offense occurred then an N grade will be entered for all courses except for those that were subject to an XF grade penalty. If suspension or dismissal occurs at the end of a regular semester or summer term and a letter grade has been assigned in a course, the letter grade will revert to an N grade. The Semester GPA and the Cumulative GPA will be recalculated accordingly and a Suspended or Dismissed academic standing will be assigned for the semester/term. For details on transcript notations, refer to Notation of an Academic Integrity Code Violation Penalty under Academic Integrity earlier in this section of the catalog.

Repeating Courses

A student may repeat any course, pending seat availability, up to two times. In cases of limited seat availability, AUS may give priority to students who have not had the opportunity to take a course for the first time.

During the early registration period, the university reserves the right to drop students who are repeating courses that were previously completed with a grade of C- or above. For violations related to registration, refer to the Student Code of Conduct in the *Student Handbook*, also accessible at www.aus.edu/student-handbook.

Students are allowed to repeat a preparatory course up to Sophomore I standing (less than 45 credits). Students are allowed to repeat WRI 101 or WRI 102 up to Junior I standing (less than 75 credits).

Only the last entry of the repeated course is counted in the calculation of the cumulative GPA.

Students may not repeat AUS courses at another institution with the aim of transferring credit hours.

Students may not repeat courses in an independent course format.

Class Standing

The class standing of a student in a specific semester is determined by the number of credit hours the student has completed up until and excluding that semester. The following table summarizes the earned credit hours to class standing equivalencies:

Hours	Standing
0–29 credits	First-Year
30–59 credits	Sophomore
60–89 credits	Junior
90 and above credits	Senior

During the period of early registration, the credit hours of the courses in progress are considered when determining the class standing of a student who wishes to enroll in a course with a class standing restriction.

Grade Point Average

AUS uses two grade point averages: the semester grade point average (SGPA) and the cumulative grade point average (CGPA).

Quality Points

The quality points earned in a course are calculated by multiplying the grade point value of the letter grade by the number of credits the course is worth.

The grades obtained in non-credit courses and in preparatory courses are not included in the computation of a grade point average.

Only the last entry of the repeated course is counted in the calculation of the CGPA.

Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA)

The SGPA is the grade point average of grades earned in a particular semester/term. It is calculated by dividing the sum of the quality points of courses taken in a particular semester/term by the total number of credits of the courses taken in that same semester/term.

SGPA = $\frac{\text{sum (quality points of courses taken in semester X)}}{\text{sum (credit hours of courses taken in semester X)}}$

Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)

The CGPA is calculated by dividing the sum of the quality points of courses taken in all semesters/terms by the total number of credits of all courses taken in all semesters/terms.

CGPA = $\frac{\text{sum (quality points of courses taken in all semesters)}}{\text{sum (credit hours of courses taken in all semesters)}}$.

Only the last entry of a repeated course is considered in the CGPA calculation.

Students who enroll in the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program prior to admission to the undergraduate level will have the credit hours and the grades earned in 100-level College of Arts and Sciences courses taught within the context of the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program counted in the calculation of their undergraduate CGPA.

GRADUATE STUDENTS

Grading System

Courses are graded using letter grades. The grade point average (GPA) is based on a four-point scale. The AUS grading system is provided below:

Excellent	
A	equals 4.00 grade points
Exceeds Expectation	
A-	equals 3.70 grade points
Meets Expectation	
B+	equals 3.30 grade points
B	equals 3.00 grade points
Below Expectation	
B-	equals 2.70 grade points
C+	equals 2.30 grade points
C	equals 2.00 grade points
Fail	
F	equals 0.00 grade points
Academic Integrity Violation Fail	
XF	equals 0.00 grade points

Grades not calculated in the grade point average are:

AUD	Audit
AW	Administrative Withdrawal
I	Incomplete
IP	In Progress
N	No Grade
NP	No Pass (thesis, project and dissertation)
P	Pass; credit hours counted
TR	Transfer; credit hours counted
W	Withdrawal
WV	Waive; no credit hours

The minimum passing grade for a graduate course is C. Students who receive an F grade in a graduate course will not be allowed to continue in the university.

Incomplete Grades

The work for a course must be completed by the end of the final examination period of the

corresponding registration semester/term. In the case of unexcused incomplete work, an F grade is given for the missing work and the final course grade is computed accordingly.

Only in exceptional cases, such as a compelling medical or other emergency certified in writing by a medical or other professional, is a student assigned an incomplete grade I in a given course, provided the student has been in attendance up until the end of the withdrawal period of the semester/term (also see Examinations earlier in this section). The instructor of the course will then process an Incomplete Grade Form and submit it to the Office of the Registrar for final approval and implementation. The Incomplete Grade Form must be submitted no later than the last day of the examination period of the corresponding semester/term.

An I grade pending beyond the end of the fourth week of classes of the next regular semester will revert into the alternative grade indicated by the instructor of the course on the Incomplete Grade Form. In the event where no alternative grade was indicated on the form, the I grade will revert into an F grade. It is the responsibility of the student to find out from his/her professor the specific dates by which requirements must be fulfilled.

A student who is on academic probation and who was approved for an I grade in a specific semester/term is not eligible for early registration for an upcoming semester/term.

Prospective candidates for graduation with incomplete grades will be awarded their degrees in the semester/term where their courses are successfully completed.

In Progress Grades

A thesis/final project/dissertation normally requires longer than one semester/term to be completed. An In Progress (IP) grade is recorded until completion of the thesis/final project/dissertation. Once the thesis/final project/dissertation is completed, the program director/coordinator will inform the Office of Graduate Studies and the Office of the Registrar of the final grade.

Prospective candidates for graduation with In Progress (IP) grades will be awarded their degrees in the semester/term where the courses are successfully completed.

Graduate students who fail to maintain thesis/final project continuation in a semester without their program director/coordinator prior approval of thesis/final project registration discontinuation, will be assigned an NP grade, resulting in academic dismissal from the master's degree program. Likewise, PhD candidates who fail to maintain dissertation continuation in a semester without their program director prior approval of dissertation registration discontinuation, will be assigned an NP grade, resulting in an automatic withdrawal of candidacy from the PhD degree program.

An IP grade will be changed to an N grade in the following situations:

- the student is approved to discontinue thesis work in order to pursue a final project (or vice versa)
- the student fails to complete the degree program graduation requirements within the time limit on residency and is denied an extension of the residency time limit
- the student is asked to withdraw PhD candidacy
- the student withdraws from the university.

No Grade Entries

A No Grade (N) grade is assigned to a course when an academic integrity violation has been reported and the adjudication process cannot be concluded before the course grade is due for the semester/term. In such cases, the N grade is temporary and the final grade for the course will be entered once the adjudication process is concluded. If a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code or the Student Code of Conduct results in suspension or dismissal effective for the semester/term in which the offense occurred then an N grade will be entered for all courses except for those that were subject to an XF grade penalty. If suspension or dismissal occurs at the end of a regular semester or summer term and a letter grade has been assigned in a course, the letter grade will revert to an N grade. The Semester

GPA and the Cumulative GPA will be recalculated accordingly and a Suspended or Dismissed academic standing will be assigned for the semester/term. For details on transcript notations, refer to Notation of an Academic Integrity Code Violation Penalty under Academic Integrity earlier in this section of the catalog.

An N grade is also assigned as a replacement of an IP grade. For details, refer to the preceding In Progress Grades section.

Repeating Courses

Graduate courses may not be repeated. With the recommendation of the program director/coordinator and the approval of the appropriate dean (or appointed designee), a graduate student may be allowed to repeat up to two graduate courses in a degree program. The original grade and the new grade will appear in the transcript, but only the new grade will be calculated into the GPA. No course may be taken more than twice.

Students may not repeat courses in an independent course format.

Students may not repeat AUS courses at another institution with the aim of transferring credit hours.

Note: Graduate students who receive an F grade in a graduate course will not be allowed to continue in the university.

Grade Point Average

AUS uses two grade point averages: the semester grade point average (SGPA) and the cumulative grade point average (CGPA).

Quality Points

The quality points earned in a course are calculated by multiplying the grade point value of the letter grade by the number of credit hours the course is worth.

Semester Grade Point Average (SGPA)

The SGPA is the grade point average of grades earned in a particular semester/term. It is calculated by dividing the sum of the quality points of courses taken in a particular semester/term by the total number of credit hours of the courses taken in that same semester/term.

$$SGPA = \text{sum (quality points of courses taken in semester/term X)} / \text{sum (credit hours of courses taken in semester/term X)}$$

Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA)

The CGPA is calculated by dividing the sum of the quality points of courses taken in all semesters/terms by the total number of credit hours of all courses taken in all semesters/terms. Only the last entry of a repeated course is considered in the CGPA calculation.

$$CGPA = \text{sum (quality points of courses taken in all semesters/terms)} / \text{sum (credit hours of courses taken in all semesters/terms)}$$

Methods for moderation and proctoring of assessments

Proctoring: All online exams must be proctored by Respondus Monitor or a similar video monitoring software. Face to face exams must be proctored by live proctors with a recommended maximum ratio of 45 students to one AUS proctor. AUS faculty and teaching staff are eligible to proctor exams. In the case of undergraduate exams, Graduate Teaching Assistants may proctor if a faculty member is present.

Moderation: Exams, quizzes, and written assignments are not moderated at the time of original grading as they are graded to a rubric or a solution key.

Students have the right to appeal a grade on the basis of an incorrectly graded assessment of this type as per the grade appeal process outlines in policy 6i: *Grade Approval and Change*.

Studio courses, senior design courses, master's theses and PhD theses take input from a range of faculty / staff / external professionals to arrive at the final grade for these assignments.

Storage of Assessment Data

The department must store assessment data and materials for final exams / key assessments for a duration of 1 semester after they have been used to determine students' qualifications.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate degree courses at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

It is the responsibility of the individual course instructor to assign a letter grade for a course as an indicator of academic achievement for that course. The Office of the Registrar is responsible for approving non-standard letter grades.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- SGPA: Semester Grade Point Average
- CGPA: Cumulative Grade Point Average
- GPA: Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: N.A.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Removed W grade	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April 25, 2024	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu
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I. Examinations Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0300RG14	Policy Title:	Examinations policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Examinations Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy covers the institutional rules regarding final examinations including the rights of students with regards to makeup exams and the responsibilities of AUS faculty with regards to the administering and retention of exams.

3. Introduction / background: Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Timing of Final Examinations

Final examinations for undergraduate courses are administered as per official final examination published by the Office of the Registrar on the AUS website.

Final examinations for graduate courses are scheduled by the faculty member during week 16 of the semester.

Three or More Final Examinations on the Same Day

Students are not obligated to take more than two final examinations in one day. Students who have more than two final examinations in one day may request that additional examinations be taken on another day by submitting a request to the Associate Dean of the student's home school/college by the end of week 11 of the semester.

Four or More Final Examinations in Two Consecutive Calendar Days

Students are not obligated to take more than three final examinations in two consecutive calendar days. Students who have more than three final examinations in two consecutive calendar days may request additional examinations to be taken on another day by submitting an e-mail request to the Associate Dean of the student's home school/college by the end of week 11 of the semester.

Tardiness

If an instructor allows a student who arrives late for a final examination to take the examination as scheduled, no additional time beyond the period scheduled by the Office of the Registrar will be provided.

Illness Prior to and During Final Examinations

Students are responsible for taking final examinations during the period scheduled by the Office of the Registrar. If an incapacitating illness prohibits taking a final examination, the student must notify the Associate Dean of the student's home school/college and provide complete documentation to the University Health Center in advance of the scheduled examination.

Students who begin a final examination are expected to complete it unless a sudden and incapacitating illness requires urgent medical attention. A student whose condition is so serious that medical care is necessary must report immediately to the University Health Center.

If the University Health Center determines that the medical condition prior to or during the scheduled examination period is serious enough to render a student incapable of taking or completing the examination then, based on the recommendation of the University Health Center, the relevant Associate Dean will determine whether a make-up examination can be completed as per the make-up examination schedule or an I grade should be awarded and the make-up examination should be scheduled at the beginning of the next semester or summer term.

The opportunity to complete a make-up examination will not be provided if compelling medical evidence indicates that taking or completing the examination was an option.

Failure to Appear for a Final Examination

A student who fails to appear for the examination, will not be permitted to take the examination unless the Associate Dean of the school/college responsible for the course determines that extraordinary circumstances exist and a make-up examination is warranted.

Academic Accommodations during Final Examinations

Students with an approved academic accommodations contract will be given consideration as per the terms of the contract. It is the responsibility of the student to inform the faculty member teaching the course.

Final examinations are considered to be an integral part of instruction at AUS and are required in all undergraduate courses unless prior approval has been obtained from the department head and the dean of the school/college in which the course is taught.

Examinations, tests, and quizzes cannot be administered within the calendar week leading up to and including the last day of classes. Furthermore, assignments and projects administered earlier in the semester, that are not in lieu of a final examination, must be due before this time period. Assignment due dates need to be clearly stated on the course syllabus at the start of the semester. Presentations of work already completed, such as studio review presentations, capstone / senior design presentations, and other class presentations are exempted and can be held up to and including the last day of classes. The weighting of final exams should be greater than or equal to the percentage assigned to individual mid-term exams.

Procedures

A. Administration of Final Examinations

Faculty members are responsible for administering final examinations as per the official final examination schedule published by the Office of the Registrar on the AUS website.

B. Proctoring of Final Examinations

Faculty members are responsible for ensuring that final examinations are adequately proctored. If an academic integrity violation occurs during a final examination, a report of the incident and all supporting evidence must be submitted to the dean (or appointed designee) immediately after the examination ends.

C. Availability During Final Examinations

Faculty members must be available on campus during the final examinations for their courses unless prior approval has been obtained from the department head and the dean. If a faculty member must travel during the final examination period, then they must arrange for proctors who will be able to answer student questions and be easily reachable by e-mail or telephone in case of emergencies. Complete contact details must be provided in the request for leave.

D. Procedure for Rescheduling Final Examinations

If a student has more than two final examinations in one day, then they may request to reschedule one of the examinations for the make-up day or take the exam with another section of the course with the approval of the relevant department head and Office of the Dean. The determination of the examination to be administered on the make-up day will be made according to the following priorities:

1. If the conflict is between common and non-common final examinations, the common

examination will be administered on the make-up examination day

2. If the conflict is between two common final examinations, the examination for the course within the student's home school/college will be administered on the make-up examination day
3. If the conflict is between two common final examinations for courses outside the student's home school/college, the examination for the course with the higher course number will be administered on the make-up examination day
4. If the conflict is between two common final examinations for courses within the student's home school/college, the examination for the course with the higher course number will be administered on the make-up examination day
5. If the conflict is between two non-common final examinations, the examination for the course within the student's home school/college will be administered on the make-up examination day
6. If the conflict is between two non-common final examinations for courses outside the student's home school/college, the examination for the course with the higher course number will be administered on the make-up examination day
7. If the conflict is between two non-common final examinations for courses within the student's home school/college, the examination for the course with the higher course number will be administered on the make-up examination day

If a student has more than three final examinations in two consecutive calendar days then the following applies:

1. If one of the days has three or more exams then the above procedure is first applied to the day with three or more exams.
2. If neither of the days has three or more exams then the procedure above will apply to the two exams on the second day.

Criteria for Common Final Examinations

Common final examination time slots are allocated to courses that meet all of the following criteria:

- 1) Two or more faculty members assigned to the course;
- 2) Three or more sections of the course offered by a single faculty member;
- 3) All sections of the course must require the common final examination; and
- 4) Common final examinations must be collaboratively graded. If available common final examination time slots and space result in limitations, priority will be given to courses based on the number of sections offered.

Grading of Final Examinations and Posting of Final Grades

Faculty members must grade final examinations and enter final grades no later than 48 hours after the examination period for their class ends.

Review of Final Examinations

Students have the right to review their examinations up to two working days after the grade has been made available on banner. Faculty members need to be reachable during this period.

Retention of Final Examinations

Final exams must be retained, along with all assessment materials used to form a student grade for at least the next regular semester. Students have the right to review their examinations during the first two weeks of the next regular semester.

(Grade appeals are still subject to the deadline outlined in the Undergraduate/Graduate Catalog).

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate degree courses at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

- a. Students are responsible for taking final examinations during the period scheduled by the Office of the Registrar unless the rules of the policy allow for an exam to be rescheduled.

- b. Faculty members are responsible for administering final examinations as per the official final examination schedule published by the Office of the Registrar on the AUS website.
- c. Faculty members are responsible for ensuring that final examinations are adequately proctored.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

VPUAI: Vice Provost for Undergraduate affairs and Instruction

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Catalogues: <https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August, 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May, 2023	Revised – No changes made	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April 25, 2024	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	- Strengthen the restriction on assessments due during the final week of classes. - Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

m. Curriculum Approval and Revision Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	03UIPG15	Policy Title:	Curriculum Approval and Revision
Prepared By:	● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction ● Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Curriculum Approval and Revision

2. Purpose:

The University Undergraduate Curriculum Committee (UUC) and the Graduate Programs Committee (GPC) are standing university-level committees charged with ensuring that the curricular integrity of academic programs is maintained. The UUC and GPC operate according to a yearly schedule that guides activities to ensure work can be completed in a timely and efficient manner. Each spring the respective vice provost offices provide a schedule of deadlines and meetings for the following academic year. Although extraordinary meetings may be called, the committees are expected to follow the published schedules as closely as possible. Guidelines and deadlines for curriculum review are published undergraduate and graduate programs by the corresponding vice provost office and shared with each college/school before the start of every fall semester.

3. Introduction / background: Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Assessing program and course outcomes is a fundamental activity that assists in improving teaching and learning. Assessment must be conducted at the program and course levels by faculty members with the specialized knowledge necessary to assess discipline-specific outcomes. Assessment forms the basis for program revisions, course revisions and the development of new programs and courses. Material submitted for program and course review by university committees should clearly demonstrate how the results of assessment have informed program and/or course development.

Fall Semester Course Review Undergraduate Programs and Courses

The UUC and GPC review all new, revised, and cancelled courses, proposals for new and revised minors, and curricular revisions each fall semester. The UUC and GPC review Special Topics conversions. Each school/college is expected to develop an internal schedule.

Curriculum changes for undergraduate and graduate programs are submitted by each college/school to the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction and the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies, respectively, as per the deadlines specified in the Curriculum Review Guide. Approved documents are to be forwarded from the UUC and GPC to the Office of the Registrar for implementation in the following academic year.

Proposals for new undergraduate and graduate programs are reviewed by the UUCC and the GPC, respectively, as part of the formal approval process. Recommendations from the UUCC and the GPC are submitted to the Provost.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all undergraduate and graduate degree programs for making major curriculum changes.

6. Responsibilities:

The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies are responsible for enforcing this policy and ensuring the formal review and approval of curriculum changes by the UUCC and GPC, respectively. The Office of the Registrar is responsible for documentation and implementation of approved curriculum changes. Each college/school curriculum committee and academic administrators are responsible for adherence to this policy.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- UUCC: University Undergraduate Curriculum Committee
- GPC: Graduate Programs Committee

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019
- Undergraduate Curriculum Development and Review Guide
- Graduate Curriculum Development and Review Guide

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	September 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	March 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

n. Internship/Practicum Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300RG16	Policy Title:	Internship/Practicum Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Internship Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy covers the institutional rules regarding undergraduate internships that contribute to meeting graduation requirements.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Internships that contribute to meeting graduation requirements must be a minimum of five consecutive weeks with a minimum of 200 work hours. Internship offerings and requirements are listed under the various program requirements.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate internships that form graduation requirements for the undergraduate program. Voluntary internships are not covered by this policy.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of the Registrar, VPUAI

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not Applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Catalogue: <https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>
New Appendix: Internship Manual

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Provost and Chief

			Academic Officer
2.0	August 2021	General update	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	May 2023	Changes to Policy statement	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB. The internship manual has been added.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

o. Teaching and Learning Methodologies Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300AP19	Policy Title:	Teaching and Learning Methodologies Policy
Prepared By:	Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Teaching and Learning Methodologies Policy

2. Purpose:

The aim of the Teaching and Learning Policy is to ensure that the vision, “*American University of Sharjah (AUS) aspires to be globally recognized for outstanding and innovative teaching, learning, research and creative work that have a positive and distinctive impact on the region and beyond.*” is connected to aims and objectives in the areas of curriculum, teaching, and learning.

3. Introduction / background:

Not Applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Aims

- Curriculum:** To provide a range of engaging, challenging, and individualized programs of learning which meet international standards.
- Teaching:** To achieve excellence in teaching through demonstrated effort in, and enthusiasm for the teaching process.
- Learning:** To support all students in reaching their utmost goals inside and outside of the classroom.

Objectives

1. Curriculum

AUS provides a range of courses that not only meet the needs of our students but having a broad, balanced, and engaging curriculum which is appropriately differentiated according to the industry needs. To ensure quality is maintained in our curricula, we implement the following across all our courses:

- Regular review, by the department, instructors, and students, of course content, textbooks, and supplementary materials.
- Use of supplementary materials, which complement the curriculum, provide additional learning opportunities, and allow it to be adapted to meet the needs of individual students.
- Use of internationally recognized benchmark for the aims and objectives of each course, to enable students and instructors to assess progress and achievement in learning.
- Embedding self-study activities into all curricula to develop independent learning skills.

2. Teaching

AUS has an excellent academic team, who have a broad range of qualifications, skills, knowledge, and experience. We believe that employing highly experienced and newly qualified instructors creates a team which is knowledgeable, supportive, and creative. Our instructors have high expectations of themselves, each other, and their students; and they employ a variety of pedagogical approaches and teaching methods to deliver high quality lessons and learning experiences.

The following practices help us to ensure teaching at AUS is of the best quality:

- Having clearly identified teaching standards.
- Supporting the continual professional development of all teaching staff through Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL):
 - Learning visit (Peer observation) program
 - Workshops on skills development
 - Weekly sessions on good practices – promoting a culture of sharing skills, ideas and resources.
 - Certification program
 - One-on-one consultation
- Delivering well planned lessons that have clear objectives that are shared with students.
- Using formal and informal assessments to inform the ongoing planning and delivery of lessons.
- Involving students in the selection of course materials and in planning adaptations to the set curriculum through regular dialogue.
- Providing a secure, stimulating environment where all students are supported in responding to the challenges involved in moving towards their full potential.
- Ensuring inclusivity - all students are included, motivated, and engaged by their learning.

3. Learning

At AUS, we strive to personalize student's learning as much as possible, and work in collaboration with students to help them achieve their goals, and become independent learners, in a supportive and safe environment. To make the learning experience of our students meaningful and successful, we have identified the following as being essential to effective learning:

- Sharing the objectives for lessons and the purpose of the teaching activities.
- Promoting a positive self-image whereby students are encouraged towards a sense of responsibility for themselves and others.
- Ongoing formal, and informal, assessments and guides throughout a student's journey at AUS, to allow individual targets to be set and progress to be reviewed.
- Setting and marking assessment regularly.
- Using a centralized e-learning platform to allow students to be involved in managing and monitoring their own learning and progress.
- Provision of extra curricula activities, clubs, and workshops to give students the opportunity to practice areas they feel are important to their development.
- A collaborative approach in the classroom so students can be involved in the planning of their lessons.
- The use of feedback forms, a student council, and open communications, give students an opportunity to formally voice their opinions on their learning, and experience in the college as a whole.

Monitoring and Evaluation

To ensure we maintain high standards in the areas of *curriculum*, *teaching*, and *learning*, we employ the following monitoring and quality assurance practices:

- The Teaching and Learning Policy will be monitored by:
 - Accreditation body.
 - External reviewers.
 - Leadership team.

- Heads of department.
- Instructor's self-monitoring
- Monitoring will be done through lesson observation, sampling of students' work, sampling of lesson plans, students' evaluation, and talking to students. Heads of department will monitor course and faculty performance according to the submitted end of term course portfolio and a yearly performance review.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate curriculum delivery

6. Responsibilities:

Not Applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

CITL: Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Not Applicable.

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August, 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May, 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

p. Course Syllabus Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0300AP18	Policy Title:	Course Syllabus
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	September 1, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Course Syllabus Policy

2. Purpose:

AUS requires that each course to have a comprehensive syllabus, containing sufficient information to ensure that, as per the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation *Standards*:

- those involved in curriculum development understand any pre-requisites or co- requisites, and the learning outcomes of the course;
- students and external reviewers understand the course's contribution to the program and its connection to other courses in the curriculum;
- students who take the course understand what they need to have achieved in order to take the course, what will be expected of them during the course, and what outcomes they will have achieved having successfully completed the course;
- sufficient information on the course is available for the purposes of course and program review (program effectiveness).

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Each course syllabus should include:

- course title and course code/number;
- credit hours (or equivalent);
- pre-requisites (if any) and co-requisites (if any);
- name and contact information of instructor(s);
- brief course description (as in the Catalog);
- intended learning outcomes of the course;
- linkage and contribution of course learning outcomes to the program outcomes;
- course topics and contents on a week-by-week basis, including sessions for assessments;
- scheduling of laboratory, studio, external visits and other non-lecture sessions, including online sessions, as appropriate;
- information on out-of-class assignments with due dates for submission;
- methods and dates of examinations and other student assessments, including the relative weight of various assessment elements in determining the course grade;
- teaching methods, including any use of online instruction;
- course texts and recommended readings listed in standard bibliographic detail, and any other learning resources.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all undergraduate and graduate degree programs for preparing course syllabi for existing or new programs.

6. Responsibilities:

Instructors are required to prepare course syllabi in accordance with this policy. The head of department or program coordinator must ensure compliance and accuracy of each syllabus before every offering. The office of the dean will keep an electronic archive of all course syllabi for each degree program.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not Applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019 – Annex 13
- Undergraduate and Graduate Catalogs

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 2021	New Policy	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
2.0	May 2023	No changes made	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 515228	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

q. Course File Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	03UIPG19	Policy Title:	Course File Policy
Prepared By:	- Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction - Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Course File Policy.

2. Purpose:

This policy aims at ensuring that complete files for each course of instruction are prepared and updated according to the requirements stipulated in the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation Standards.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable

4. Policy Statement:

AUS requires complete files for each course of instruction. As per the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation Standards, each course file must contain sufficient information on each presentation of the course so that the faculty or other persons who assess program effectiveness can determine whether the course is meeting its learning outcomes, and whether changes to the course are appropriate.

Course files must include the following information:

- Course syllabus of the current and previous offerings
- Copies of all teaching materials
- Copies of all assessment instruments
- Instructor-worked answers and marking schemes for all assessment instruments
- Examples from across the range of student performance of graded responses to all assessment instruments
- A comprehensive instructor review of the presentation of the course, covering:
 - Appropriateness of the course learning outcomes
 - Extent to which the syllabus was covered
 - Extent to which learning outcomes were met (with evidence).
 - Appropriateness of textbooks and other learning resources
 - Appropriateness of assessment instruments in relation to learning outcomes
 - Appropriateness of the balance of assessment (with reasonable time frame allowed for completing the assignments and timely feedback to students)

- g. Appropriateness of prerequisites
 - i. General comments on any problems encountered with the course
7. Quantitative analysis of student performance during the course presentation (e.g., grade distributions)
8. Summary of student feedback on the evaluation of the course.
9. Summary of actions taken during this offering to improve the course.
10. Instructor's proposals for any future course improvements.

Course files for courses that are counted toward programs with professional accreditations may contain additional information that corresponds to requirements of professional accrediting agencies.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all undergraduate and graduate courses.

6. Responsibilities:

- Instructors are responsible for preparing complete files for every course of instruction. The coordinator for courses that have multiple sections with common exams can submit one course file. Course files need to be in a well-organized electronic format that has clear copies of course materials. All course files must be submitted to the department head or program coordinator within the same academic year of offering.
- Department heads/program coordinators must ensure that course files meet the requirements of this policy and maintain an archived copy of each course file in a secure folder that is regularly backed up by the IT department (e.g. shared drive, iLearn, etc.)

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019
- Course Syllabus Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Provosts
2.0	30-10-2019	Updated policy to follow the 2019 CAA Standard	Vice Provosts
3.0	17-10-2021	Included items 9 and 10 in Section 4 to be aligned with CAA requirements	Vice Provosts
4.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Provosts
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

r. Class Size Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0300UI20	Policy Title:	Class Size Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Class Size Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy provides class size ranges for all undergraduate and graduate class types and explains how class size form part of the curricular planning. This is critical for academic planning.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Class size must be considered in the design and delivery of courses at AUS and determination of maximum enrollment is primarily the responsibility of departments offering the course. Class size is determined according to course format, course content, course requirements and space availability rather than strictly by course level. The Course Approval Form (CAF) reviewed by department heads, deans, and faculty curriculum committees at departmental, school/college, and university levels requires that the course format and course enrollment be explicitly stated. Although courses delivered through e-learning may not have the same space restrictions as courses delivered through the traditional face-to-face mode, the class size limits specified below apply to maintain a similar learning experience regardless of the mode of delivery.

Class size for master level courses typically range between 6 and 25 students. PhD level courses normally range between 4 and 15 students. Under certain circumstances, a smaller class size might be accommodated with the approval of the Dean and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Undergraduate lecture and studio classes have a minimum class size of 12. Individual exceptions to this minimum can be made by the Provost.

In general, class sizes at the undergraduate level, normally adhere to the guidelines in the table below:

Course Format	Class Size Considerations
Lab	Labs require hands-on work to be carried out under the supervision of an instructor; class size will depend on nature of the work and space limitations such as the number of work stations available in the teaching space.
Lecture	Lectures will normally have at least 20 students and may be conducted for classes in excess of 300 if course content is suited to large-format lectures and

	appropriate teaching space is available. Smaller lecture courses normally have writing-intensive or other specific course requirements that necessitate smaller class size
Recitation	Recitation sessions may be employed to provide opportunities for discussion or problem-solving sessions to supplement large-enrolment lecture courses. Enrolment in recitation sessions is normally limited to a maximum of 35 students.
Practicum	Practica provide opportunities for students to be involved in faculty-supervised research; class size typically ranges between 12 and 20 students and maximum capacity should be based on the particular topic and scope of work.
Project	Project courses provide opportunities for students to be involved in independent faculty-supervised projects; class size is normally limited to 5 students and should be based on the particular topic and scope of work.
Applied Lessons	Applied lessons provide an opportunity for individualized or small-group instruction for voice or musical instruments. Normally private instruction courses are limited to a maximum of 6 students.
Seminar	Seminars provide opportunities for greater interaction between students and class size should typically range between 16 and 20 students.
Studio	Studio courses normally range between 12 and 18 students, depending on course level, nature of the topics explored and complexity of studio projects.
Studio/Lecture	The studio/lecture is a hybrid course that allows for both lecture/demonstration and hands-on work in a studio setting. Enrolment is normally limited to 20 students.
Theatre Rehearsal	Theatre rehearsal size will depend upon the number of students involved in the production as determined by script and technical production requirements.

Class sizes mentioned in this policy are applicable to both online and face-to-face delivery of classes.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate classes of all types.

6. Responsibilities:

VPUAI is responsible for overseeing the policy and insuring its implementation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

CAF: Course Approval Form

VPUAI: Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history:

The Policy was revised in 2018 following the introduction of the PhD programs to include class size requirements as mandated by the CAA.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and

			Provost
2.0	Fall 2018	Class size policy for PhD programs	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Added connection to online classes – Section 4	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

s. Intensive Modes of Course Delivery Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	03UIPG21	Policy Title:	Intensive Modes of Course Delivery
Prepared By:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Intensive Modes of Course Delivery Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy ensures that credit-bearing courses that are offered over a shorter duration than the generally accepted period of a standard semester adhere to the same requirements and quality standards as courses offered over a regular semester.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Courses offered in an intensive mode such as during the on-campus summer term and as part of a study abroad experience must meet the minimum requirement for 15 hours of contact time for one semester credit (i.e. earning three credits requires a minimum of 45 contact hours). Courses offered during condensed periods have comparable expectations for out-of-class study time. In order to maintain comparable expectations for study time, AUS policy restricts students to two courses (up to six credits) during the six-week summer term. For courses of a shorter duration, AUS policy normally allows no more than one credit per week of instruction (e.g. no more than three credit hours for a three-week study abroad course). Limiting the number of credit hours during condensed periods ensures that students are able to meet the minimum contact hour requirements while maintaining comparable expectations for out-of- class study time.

The full content of the approved syllabi must be taught during condensed periods and the course schedule that is required for all AUS syllabi is developed to ensure that course learning outcomes can be met during the shortened duration. The same assessment methods are used in courses offered in intensive mode or over a regular semester.

AUS ensures that student services are maintained during the six-week on-campus summer term. Students have access to the AUS Library and to the range of University services that are available during a regular semester, including IT support, food and beverage outlets in the AUS Student Center, the University Health Center, and recreational facilities.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all undergraduate and graduate degree courses offered in an intensive mode such as a summer term on campus. It is also applicable to regular courses or topical courses offered in a study abroad format during the summer. All study abroad courses require a detailed syllabus as per the UAE CAA Standards and an approved Course Approval Form. AUS has clear policies and approval processes for study abroad courses that are available via the website: (<https://www.aus.edu/academics/international-study-and-exchange/go-abroad/fall-and-or-spring>).

6. Responsibilities:

The head of department or program coordinator must ensure compliance with this policy during course scheduling and evaluation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

CAA: Commission for Academic Accreditation

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019 – Annex 14
- Undergraduate and Graduate Catalogs

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	September 2021	General update. All detailed changes will be captured going forward.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	• Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB. • The link to the study abroad courses policies has been updated	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

t. Academic Misconduct Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	03SEUI22	Policy Title:	Academic Misconduct Policy
Prepared By:	- Vice Chancellor for Student Experience - Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	- Office of the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience - Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Academic Misconduct Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy covers (i) Faculty and Professional Staff disciplinary policy, (ii) Student misconduct policy and (iii) Student Academic Integrity Policy.

The policy currently only covers (iii) from above. For part (i) the disciplinary policy is covered in the Faculty Handbook. For part (ii) the student misconduct policy is covered in the Student handbook. We may need to copy paste those policies into this policy.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Student Academic Integrity Code

Academic integrity lies at the heart of intellectual life. As an institution committed to the advancement of knowledge in a manner consistent with the highest ethical standards, AUS affirms the importance of respecting the integrity of academic work. The AUS Student Academic Integrity Code (referred to herein as Code) describes standards for academic conduct, students' rights and responsibilities as members of an academic community, and procedures for handling allegations of academic dishonesty.

In order to establish within the AUS student body a sense of ethical responsibility, honor and mutual respect, prior to registration, every student must sign the following Academic Integrity Pledge:

- I [student's name] pledge my commitment to the following values:*
- I will hold myself accountable for all that I say and write;*
- I will hold myself responsible for the academic integrity of my work;*
- I will not misrepresent my work nor give or receive unauthorized aid;*

- *I will behave in a manner that demonstrates concern for the personal dignity, rights and freedoms of all members of the community;*
- *I will respect university property and the property of others; and*
- *I will not tolerate a lack of respect for these values.*

Students are responsible for becoming familiar with their rights and responsibilities as defined by the Code and for ensuring that they understand the requirements for their particular courses (e.g., regarding issues such as collaborative work, use of study aids or take-home examinations, etc.).

Attempts to violate or to assist others in violating the Code, including unsuccessful attempts, are prohibited, and will be treated as actual violations.

Definition of Academic Violations

Members of the AUS academic community are expected to conduct themselves with integrity in their work and actions. Violations of the Code include, but are not limited to, the following categories.

Plagiarism

To plagiarize is to use the work, ideas, concepts, images or words of someone else without fully acknowledging the source in all academic work, including assignments, quizzes, examinations, papers and projects. Plagiarism may involve using someone else's wording—a distinctive name, a phrase, a sentence or an entire passage or essay—without using quotation marks and appropriately citing the source. Plagiarism may also involve misrepresenting the sources that were used or expressing the ideas of someone else in your own words without the appropriate citation.

Inappropriate Collaboration

Collaboration on academic work may be encouraged, but it is important to ensure that contributions are acknowledged. Inappropriate collaboration includes working with someone else in developing, organizing or revising a project (such as a paper, an oral presentation, a research or design project or a take-home examination) without acknowledging that person's help. The use of unauthorized assistance must be avoided in the production of all academic work.

Specific requirements related to collaborative work, peer review, the use of an external entity in the production of work, the use of tutors and editing may vary among courses and students must ensure that faculty members explicitly provide approval in advance of the collaboration.

Impersonation

Students must attend their own classes, be present and sit for all tests and examinations, and personally attend other events associated with a course. The individual impersonated and the impersonator may be subject to sanctions.

Dishonesty in Examinations and Submitted Work

All academic work and materials submitted for assessment must be the sole original work of the student, unless otherwise directed by the instructor. Students are prohibited from submitting any material prepared by or purchased from another person or company.

Communication is not allowed between or among students, nor are students allowed to consult books, papers, study aids or notes without explicit permission. Dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, communication with another student or an external party using electronic devices during an examination or in-class assignment, copying from another's paper, giving unauthorized assistance, obtaining unauthorized advance knowledge of examination questions, and the use of mechanical or marking devices or procedures for the purpose of achieving false scores on machine-graded examinations.

Specific policies regarding examinations may vary among individual professors.

Work Completed for One Course and Submitted to Another

Students may not present the same work for more than one course. Under exceptional circumstances, faculty members may permit a significant piece of research to satisfy requirements in two courses. However, both professors must agree in advance to this arrangement. If past research is incorporated into current projects, previous work must be appropriately referenced.

Deliberate Falsification of Data

Students may not deliberately falsify data or distort supporting documentation for course work or other academic activity.

Interference with Other Students' Work

Students may not intentionally interfere with the work of others, such as sabotaging laboratory experiments, creative work, research or digital files, or by giving misleading information or disrupting class work.

Copyright Violations

Copyright laws must be observed. These laws govern practices such as making use of printed materials, duplicating computer software, duplicating images, photoduplicating copyrighted materials and reproducing audio/visual works. The Code prohibits theft and the unauthorized use of documents and requires adherence to the laws of Sharjah and the federal laws of the UAE.

Complicity in Academic Dishonesty

Complicity in academic dishonesty consists of helping or attempting to help another person commit an act of academic dishonesty or willfully assisting another student in the violation of the Code. Complicity in academic dishonesty is pre-meditated and intentional. This can include, but is not limited to, the following:

- doing work for another student
- designing or producing a project for another student
- willfully providing answers during an exam, test or quiz
- communicating with another student or external party on a computer, mobile phone or other device while an exam is in progress
- providing a student with an advance copy of a test
- posting of notes or other materials from a class (whether the student is enrolled in the class or not) on the Internet, whether or not for a fee, without express permission from the faculty member
- leaving inappropriate materials behind at the site of an exam or test

Adjudication of Academic Offenses

Jurisdiction

Academic cases resulting from alleged violations of the Code are within the jurisdiction of the dean (or appointed designee) of the college/school in which the alleged Code violation occurred.

Faculty members who have knowledge of an alleged violation should report the incident to the dean (or appointed designee) of the college/school in which the alleged Code violation occurred.

A faculty member may exercise discretion in those cases involving a student's judgmental error rather than willful violation of the Code.

Students who wish to bring charges against other students must do so through the faculty member in whose course or academic activity the alleged Code violation occurred. The student who brings the charges must identify himself/herself to the faculty member.

Violations of the Code that involve admission and/or placement testing fall within the jurisdiction of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction and may result in the revocation of admission or dismissal from the university.

The Adjudication Process

An allegation of dishonesty must be reported to the dean (or appointed designee) and the head of the department or unit in which the offense occurred within five working days of the date of discovery of the alleged offense. The report must be supported by appropriate documentation.

Once the alleged violation has been reported, faculty members must not submit grades for the work in question or for the course until the case has been adjudicated. If the semester grades are due before the adjudication process is complete, a temporary grade of N will be assigned and a "Pending Conduct Investigation" statement will be recorded on the student's academic transcript.

The student must remain enrolled in the course in which an infraction has been reported until the adjudication process is complete.

Legal counsel or involvement of any parties other than the student and relevant university personnel is not permitted at any point during the adjudication process.

After receiving complete information, the dean (or appointed designee) will follow the adjudication process outlined below:

- a) The dean (or appointed designee) will promptly notify the student of the charge and inform the student of the date and time of a formal meeting to discuss the charge. The dean (or appointed designee) will also notify the head of the department or unit in which the offense occurred and will consult with the student's dean (or appointed designee) to inform them of the allegation if the student is pursuing a major in another college/school.
- b) The dean (or appointed designee) will meet with the student to explain the adjudication process and present the allegation and the evidence. If the student fails to attend the meeting, the dean (or appointed designee) will proceed with the process.
- c) The student will be given the opportunity to respond to the allegation in writing within two working days.
- d) After the deadline for the student to respond to the allegation has passed, the dean (or appointed designee) will consider all evidence and, depending on whether a preponderance of evidence supports the allegation of academic misconduct, take one of the following actions:
 - i. dismiss the case
 - ii. request that the student resubmit the work in question or retake an examination
 - iii. assign a penalty.
- e) If a student resubmits the work in question or retakes an examination, the results will be considered in determining whether a preponderance of evidence exists to support the allegation of academic misconduct and the assignment of a penalty.

Penalties

Violations of the Code will be treated seriously, with increasingly severe penalties considered for repeat offenders. A second violation may result in suspension or dismissal.

In assigning a penalty, the dean (or appointed designee) will take into account both the seriousness of the offense and any particular circumstances involved.

Penalties for an academic offense may include one or more of the following:

- a) a warning letter to be kept in the academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.
- b) a lowered grade or loss of credit for the work found to be in violation of the Code (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)
- c) a lowered overall grade for the course in which the offense occurred (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)
- d) a failing grade of XF for the course in which the offense occurred (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)
- e) suspension for the semester/term in which the offense occurred with a possible addition of one or more academic semester(s)/term(s)
- f) dismissal from the university

Penalties (b)–(f) will result in non-academic sanctions that may include prohibition from extracurricular activities and the loss of athletic scholarships. See the *AUS Student Handbook* for details.

For penalties (e) and (f), the student is assigned a grade of N for all semester/term registered courses, with a provision for a grade penalty for the course where the academic offense was reported. No refund or cancellation of tuition fees will be permitted in such cases.

Students are solely responsible for any financial implications resulting from an academic integrity violation.

Students found guilty of an academic integrity violation will not be allowed to complete a course evaluation for the course in which the offense occurred.

Students with a record of sanctions resulting from violations of the Code (or Student Code of Conduct) will not be eligible for the Dean's List.

Suspension and Dismissal

The decision as to whether suspension or dismissal is appropriate in a given instance will necessarily depend on the circumstances of each case.

Suspension

(temporary separation from the university)

Suspension is effective for not less than the semester/term in which the penalty is levied or for not more than one calendar year. The length of a suspension must be specified in writing when the student is notified of the outcome of the adjudication process.

A student who is suspended is entitled to resume studies in the same college/school at the conclusion of the period of suspension if all academic requirements are met. The student must submit a Reactivation Request Form to the Office of the Registrar. The form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms.

Courses completed outside AUS while on suspension do not transfer.

Dismissal

(permanent separation from the university)

Dismissal is invoked in cases of serious infractions of rules and regulations and when circumstances indicate that a student's association with the university should be terminated in the interest of maintaining the standards of behavior and conduct normally expected in a university community. In instances where the dean (or appointed designee) hearing the case has recommended dismissal, the Academic Appeals Review Committee will review the case and make a recommendation to the Provost.

Notification of Penalty

The dean (or appointed designee) hearing the case will notify the student in writing of the outcome of the adjudication process and, if applicable, the assigned penalty.

In addition to the faculty member bringing the charge, the following university officials have a legitimate need to know and will be informed of the outcome of the adjudication process at the time that the student is notified:

- The head of the department in which the offense occurred
- The dean of the college/school and the head of the department responsible for the major in which the student is enrolled (if applicable)
- The Dean of Students
- The Office of the Registrar
- The Academic Support Center
- The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction OR the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies (as appropriate)

For record keeping of documents pertaining to the infringement of the Code, please refer to the appropriate section under Student Records herein.

Appeal of Penalty

In cases concerning notation to the student's record [penalties (d)–(f)], students will be notified in writing of their right of appeal. Appeals must be submitted in writing to the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction within five working days of the date of notification of the outcome of the adjudication process by the dean (or appointed designee).

Appeals are limited to grounds of excessive sanction, improper procedure and unavailability of relevant evidence at the time of the meeting with the dean (or appointed designee) to discuss the charge with the student.

The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction may affirm, modify, or remand the case to the dean (or appointed designee) with instructions for further action. The decision of the Vice Provost is final.

For penalty (f), the Academic Appeals Review Committee will review the case and make a recommendation to the Provost. The Provost may affirm, modify, or remand the case to the dean with instructions for further action. The decision of the Provost is final.

Notation of an Academic Integrity Code Violation Penalty

A student's standing that impacts his or her eligibility to continuously enroll at AUS affects academic

progress and, for this reason, is deemed transcript-appropriate. The general type of infraction (academic or disciplinary) is noted on the student's transcript, as well as the office responsible for issuing the student's separation from the institution.

Penalties (d)–(f) will become a permanent part of the student's file maintained by the Office of the Registrar, with appropriate notation on the student's academic transcript indicating that there has been a violation of the Code.

For penalties (f) and (f), the student is assigned a grade of N for all semester/term registered courses, with a provision for a grade penalty for the course where the academic offense was reported.

The student may petition to replace an XF grade resulting from a category (d) penalty with an F grade at the time of graduation or following complete withdrawal from the university. For details, please refer to the Appeal of an XF Grade section under Student Petitions and Appeals.

For tracking purposes, all academic integrity violations will be recorded in the university's academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

5. Scope/applicability:

Faculty, professional staff, and all students at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Vice Chancellor for Student Experience is responsible for the policy and its implementation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

XF Grade: Academic Integrity Violation Fail.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Student Catalog
- Student Handbook

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
2.0	October 2021	Creation of new policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
3.0	May 2023	Revised appeals categories	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu

u. Conferral of Posthumous Degree – Version 3

Policy Number:	0300AP23	Policy Title:	Conferral of Posthumous Degree
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	February 21, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

AUS is committed to maintaining a supportive and empathetic environment for students and parents, especially in time of tragedy.

2. Purpose:

In cases where a student passes away before receiving their degree.

3. Policy Statement:

In cases where a student passes away before receiving their degree, the relevant Dean of the college/school, or a senior leader in the Office of the Student Affairs, can petition the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost to have the student's degree conferred posthumously. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, in consultation with the Registrar, will consider the following conditions for the conferral of a posthumous degree.

- The student was enrolled at the American University of Sharjah at the time of death.
- The student had fulfilled normal graduation requirements and completed at least 75 percent of the degree credits required to earn their degree.

If the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost decides to recommend to the Chancellor and the Chancellor agrees that the student will be awarded a degree posthumously, the Office of the Provost will notify the following departments of the decision of the conferral of the posthumous degree:

- The Dean of the College/School requesting the degree
- The Office of Student Affairs
- The Registrar's Office

Upon the Chancellor's approval to award a degree posthumously, the following actions will be undertaken:

- The Chancellor, or designee, will notify the deceased student's family that the degree will be awarded posthumously.
- If the family of the deceased student agrees to receive the degree, the Office of the Registrar will include the student's name in the convocation program, and issue a diploma indicating that the degree has been conferred posthumously.

Sample letter from the Chancellor (to be adjusted on a case to case basis):

Dear (Family member of students)

American University of Sharjah (AUS) would like to again extend our deepest condolences to you and your family for the loss of your (son/daughter, student's first and last name).

(Student's name) was highly respected by students, faculty, and staff throughout the university and was widely regarded as exemplary. (Student's first name) was in good academic standing and was also extremely active in campus life through the (add engagement information if applicable).

Therefore, given (Student's first name) academic record and his contributions to the AUS community, it has been agreed by the AUS Registrar and Provost that (Student's first name) will be awarded his degree (Add degree program) posthumously.

We invite you or another family member to join us for our spring commencement graduation on (date of commencement), at University City Hall to accept (Student's first name) degree. If you or another family are unable to attend, we can send (Student's first name) degree to your home address.

(Name of Staff member), Vice Chancellor of the Student Experience at AUS, will be in touch via telephone to discuss how you would best like to receive (Student's name) degree.

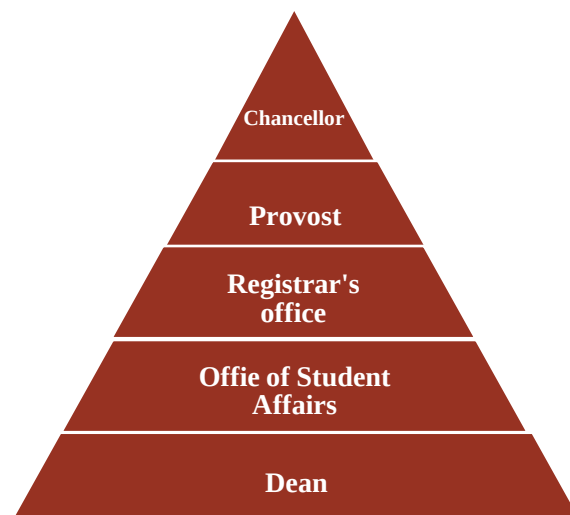
We hope that the awarding of (Student's first name) degree posthumously provides you with an indication of how highly regarded Student's first name) was by the AUS community.

Thank you for allowing AUS to provide this honor to (Student's first name) in recognition of his hard work and character.

Sincerely,

(add Chancellor's name)
Chancellor

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst administrators involved in this policy.



4. Scope/applicability:

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To ensure that the University is able to recognize students after they are deceased.

5. Responsibilities:

The responsibility for nominations falls on the Dean of the related College/School and the Office of Student Affairs. The responsibility for the review of the nomination and the recommendation to the Chancellor falls on the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and the Office of the Registrar. The responsibility of internal communication of the decision falls on the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and the responsibility for communication with the family and the possible arrangement of a private award ceremony is with the Office of Student Affairs.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Policies and Procedures Manual.

8. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Policies and Procedures Manual. Any changes or updates to this policy are approved by the Council of Deans, and the Provost.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	February 21, 2023	Initial draft	Office of Student Affairs
2.0	May 2023	Reviewed – No changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Phone Number: 06-5152020	Email: provost@aus.edu

v. Creating New Majors – Version 4

Policy Number:	03UIPG24	Policy Title:	Creating New Majors
Prepared By:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	Pre-2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Creating New Majors

2. Purpose:

This policy is for the establishment of new majors at AUS.

3. Introduction / background:

The strategic development of new majors is essential for keeping the curriculum of AUS vibrant and for expanding our appeal to new cohorts of potential students. Over the course of time, the educational needs in the external environment evolve, and as they do, our responsiveness to that environment must be both timely and relevant. The development of new majors provides an opportunity to rejuvenate the curriculum and to adjust our position in the marketplace of higher education in our nation, region, and the world. It also allows us to expand our catchment area, geographically and topically, and to appeal to new groups of students who have not historically viewed AUS as a venue for study. Accordingly, planning a new major must be done with care and objectivity. A new major represents a considerable commitment of the University's resources, both human and material. Entering into a new major entails the postponement or rejection outright of alternative opportunities for the commitment of our valuable resources. In that spirit, these policies and procedures have been developed to provide a set of guideposts in marshaling a strong but realistic argument for establishing a new major.

1. Policy Statement:

In establishing a major at AUS, the following stages need to be followed under the general guidance of the Dean – Pre-Planning, Proposal Development, and Proposal Review and approval by the relevant Curriculum Review Committees, the Provost, the Chancellor, and the Board of Trustees.

Pre-Planning Stage

The Heads of Departments and faculty who are interested in creating a new major will meet with the appropriate Dean or Deans to discuss the rationale for its creation. If the Dean deems there to be sufficient cause for investigating the establishment of the major, the Head will convene a Planning Committee consisting of interested faculty members to begin work on the pre-planning of the major. The Planning Committee's first task should be to write a Pre-Plan of no more than two pages describing the following aspects of the major:

- Purpose: What is the rationale of the major in the context of the Department's current offerings?
How does the major complement or compete with existing programs, both in the Department and

School/College as well as outside? How does it fit the mission of the School/College and the University?

- **Attractiveness:** What factors make the major appealing, either as unique within the region or in comparison with similar majors offered elsewhere in the UAE, the GCC, or beyond?
- **Market:** What will graduates likely do with the degree once they enter the work force? What “soft skills” as well as technical skills does the proposed major impart?
- **Size:** How many faculty—existing and new—would be involved and in what capacity? How many students would be likely to choose this major, current and future? How was the number of students determined?
- **Financial Feasibility:** What, preliminarily, are the revenue and resource implications of the new major, both in the short run (3 years) and long run (7—10 years)?

Development of the Pre-Plan should be an iterative process involving, as appropriate, the Dean(s), the relevant Curriculum Review Committees, the Provost, the Council of Deans, and possibly interested Trustees. The purpose of these conversations is to test the appropriateness and feasibility of establishing the major before undertaking the comprehensive process of collecting data and surveying the environment. The Planning Committee will require approval from the Chancellor and Provost for the Pre-Plan before proceeding with the development of a formal Proposal, which will ultimately be taken to the Board of Trustees for final approval. If the Chancellor or Provost do not approve of the Pre-Plan, the major may be further developed as a concentration or a minor.

Proposal Development

With the approval of the Chancellor and Provost, the Planning Committee should next prepare a Proposal based on the Pre-Plan using the template shown below. The Proposal should demonstrate clearly that the major is not solely a project of a few interested faculty and that it will be viable over the long term. Nor should it be solely a response to a student, parent, or alumni pressure to implement the major. The Proposal must be an objective, fact- and data-driven plan that recognizes the opportunities as well as the challenges and risks that the major represents. During the development of the Proposal, the working group should collaborate closely with either the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction or the Vice Provost for Research and Graduate Programs and meet with the Dean and Provost as often as is useful and necessary.

The following template should help in preparing the Proposal.

Template for Proposing New Majors

4.1 Cover Sheet (form in this document)

4.2 Checklist (form in this document)

4.3 Executive Summary (two pages maximum)

The Executive Summary should be written after all other parts of the Proposal are completed. It should provide a brief overview of the proposed major summarizing the information found in the body of the Proposal and address the following points:

- a. The core case for the major, its appropriateness within the University and the demand and competition within the external environment (SWOC);
- b. A summary description of the proposed major and its key curricular elements and themes;
- c. Highlights of the business plan, including seven-year pro forma revenue and cost projection scenarios showing realistic projections of operating margins for the major;
- d. A summary of space, capital, and library requirements of the major;
- e. Plans for eventually sunsetting the major and potential exit strategies.

4.4 Case Statement for the Major and Environmental Scan

The Proposal should describe the relationship of the proposed major to the University's broad strategic mission of delivering high quality education and generating new knowledge for the UAE and the region. The Proposal will be strengthened by demonstrating how the major will advance one of the identified strategic initiatives of the University. Given the many needs and opportunities confronting the University, what compelling evidence is there that this particular major deserves our attention and resources at this particular juncture?

The Planning Committee should perform a clear and objective assessment, including a SWOC analysis, of the competitive environment within which the new major must thrive. This effort should include the compilation of relevant data drawn from the University's financial and personnel records to develop appropriate revenue and cost projections for a seven-to-ten-year period. A thorough examination of potential sources of students and potential employers in the marketplace are critical elements of the SWOC analysis.

The SWOC analysis should address the following points:

- a. **Strengths:** What are the specific assets at AUS—human expertise, material, and capital—that can be used to establish and support the major? What competitive advantages does AUS enjoy in launching the major at this time? Please list all faculty and their particular contribution to the major.
- b. **Weaknesses:** How will the University find the additional resources needed to establish the major? What will be the impact on current programs at AUS if we divert existing institutional resources to offer the major?
- c. **Opportunities:** Offer evidence to demonstrate the likelihood that sufficient interest exists among students who do not currently enroll at AUS to justify introduction of the major. Through surveys, demonstrate that employers are expressly interested in the skill set and mix of qualifications that students with this major will possess as a result of meeting program outcomes and engaging in the broad variety of general education offerings at the University. Alternatively, are there requirements for admission to advanced study that this major fulfills? Demonstrate that there is a compelling public good that the major will help the University fulfill, thereby enhancing AUS's reputation and attractiveness for faculty and students in the future. What collaborative opportunities exist to support the major within and outside AUS?
- d. **Challenges:** Is there strong competition in this field that will need to be overcome to make the major successful? Who exactly are our likely competitors and how do they compare in terms of resources, quality, and reputation? Please produce any available statistical data.

4.5 Curricular Detail

The Proposal should describe the curriculum, provide clear and measurable program outcomes that state what a student should be able to do upon completion of the program, and list both the required courses as well as a variety of elective offerings that will be necessary to achieve the degree in the major. The list of courses should contain a brief description of the course, together with prerequisites, as well as information about how each course contributes cumulatively to the competencies and body of knowledge that is expected of a graduate who chose this major. Please list all required courses for the degree, including a capstone or thesis course. Please also provide sample courses of study that include all courses that the student might take within the discipline and as part of the General Education Program to receive an integrated, well-balanced, yet in-depth education in the field of the major.

This section of the proposal should list those courses currently being taught as well as those that will need to be developed in order to mount the major. If courses need to be adjusted or created, please demonstrate that sufficient expertise exists within the Department or elsewhere in the University in order to offer those courses in a timely fashion. The Plan should lay out how over time necessary new courses will be developed in time for their timely implementation. Please describe any new faculty lines that will need to be added in order to continue the major.

4.6 Business Plan

The business plan should be developed using information from the environmental scan and with input from faculty and administrators regarding likely revenue streams and expenditures. The business plan

should be expressed both in text and in readily understood spreadsheets showing the various elements of revenue and expense, cash flow over time, break-even points, marginal profit and loss, and, if possible, the rate of return and the net present value of the University's initial investment. The business plan should be flexible enough to allow the modeling of different scenarios with regard to initial conditions, variable rates of growth in the various revenue and expense categories, and alternative assumptions about the external environment. The plan should be realistic, highlighting the risks as well as the payoffs that are inherent in different sets of predictive factors about the major and its prospects.

4.7 Space, Equipment, Library Needs

The Plan should provide a realistic catalog of space requirements, capital needs, and library resources. The Planning Committee should consult with the University Facilities Department concerning likely facility implications, if any. Similarly, the equipment and technological needs of the major should be thoroughly vetted within the Planning Committee, and a baseline for necessary equipment established. Library staff should be consulted concerning other resources, such as databases, electronic subscription services, and books. These items should be priced out and included in the Plan, along with a projection for how much these items will cost over the life of the plan.

4.8 Sunsetting and Exit Strategy

Although the Plan should be written with every intention of success, the Planning Committee should nevertheless consider the possibility of failure and construct an exit strategy for dismantling the major, should events and circumstances so dictate. This element of the Plan should anticipate the possible necessity of reassigning personnel and liquidating resources in such a way as to minimize the disruption in the lives of those involved and in the on-going stability of the University. By the same token, the Plan should include processes for evaluating the success of the major over time, including the identification of concrete goals to be achieved within a specific timeframe. The Plan should identify the criteria by which the relative success of the major should be evaluated in the future, with the possibility of merging, closing, or reducing the major to a minor or a concentration, based upon the evolving needs and purposes of the University.

Proposal Submission & Final Approval

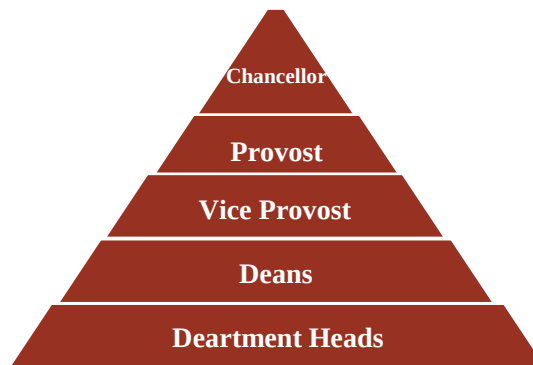
The Proposal needs to be reviewed, modified as necessary, and endorsed by the Head(s), Dean(s) of the Units/Colleges concerned prior to final submission to the appropriate Vice Provost's office. The Vice Provost will consult with the relevant university-level curriculum committee and forward a recommendation to the Provost. The Provost, Chancellor, and Vice Provost may ask for some modification to the Proposal prior to authorizing it for submission to the Board of Trustees (BOT) for its final approval. Once approved, the major can be moved forward for review by the CAA and ultimate implementation.

4. Scope/applicability:

Applicable to all new majors.

5. Responsibilities:

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty role selection and ranks.



6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

AUS: American University of Sharjah

GCC: Gulf Countries Council

SWOC: Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities, and Challenges

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Appendix III: Proposal for a New Major Form

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	December 2018	Revised	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	September 6, 2023	Revised – No changes were made but updated with new format	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

w. Generative AI (GAI) Tools in Teaching and Learning Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0300UI25	Policy Title:	Generative AI (GAI) Tools in Teaching and Learning Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	November 21, 2023
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Generative AI (GAI) Tools in Teaching and Learning Policy

2. Purpose:

To communicate institution wide regulations and guidelines pertaining to the use of GAI tools in teaching and learning at AUS.

3. Introduction / background:

GAI tools, such as ChatGPT, DALL-E, and others, constitute an important challenge for educators and institutions. Judicious deployment of such tools in the learning environment can be beneficial to the learning process, and supervised exposure in an educational environment can help students be better prepared for future endeavors after graduation.

Nevertheless, it is widely accepted that GAI tools have the potential for a negative impact on both the learning process and the academic integrity of student work. Higher education institutions must then ensure a balance between the associated cognitive benefits and the associated ethical concerns.

This policy on the usage of GAI tools in teaching and learning at the American University of Sharjah (AUS) aims to provide general regulations and guidelines to course instructors, students, and administrators (the institution) on the usage of GAI tools for promoting excellence in cognitive engagement and instruction (maximizing learning) while maintaining academic integrity, privacy, security, and equity.

4. Policy Statement:

Authorization of usage of GAI tools

Students are forbidden from using GAI tools to produce any work for assessment unless that use is explicitly permitted by the course instructor. More generally, incorporating GAI tools in a course in other ways is also at the discretion of the instructor. In courses with multiple sections and multiple instructors, the coordinator will establish permitted uses in consultation with instructors of individual sections.

Course Instructor and Student Responsibilities

If GAI tools are used in the classroom the following points must be adhered to.

Course instructors must:

1. Include the following details in the course syllabus:

- i. Name(s) of the generative AI tool(s) that can be used. If there is an update to the list of AI tools then the instructor must post the updated list on the course iLearn page.
 - ii. Brief rationale for using the tool(s) in the course.
 - iii. Instructions on which assignments and class activities the tool(s) can be used for.
 - iv. The following statement on academic integrity: *"It is considered an academic integrity violation to represent output of a generative artificial intelligence tool as your own work"* together with any other course specific academic integrity rules related to usage of the tool(s).
2. Ensure that students are provided with a comprehensive introduction to the cognitive and ethical dimensions of the usage of the generative AI tool(s).
 3. Ensure that all students in the class have access to the tool(s) and can use them in compliance with the tools' regulations.

Students must:

1. Ensure they do not represent output of the tool(s) as their own creative work.
2. Acknowledge, in line with course policy, any usage of the tool(s) in all material submitted for course credit including the name and version number of the tool(s).
3. Take full responsibility for the accuracy of AI generated output in any work they produce.
4. Ensure that any use of the tool(s) is compliant with the course syllabus, any updates posted on the course ilearn page, the most recent versions of the AUS academic integrity policy, and the AUS IT acceptable use policy.

Course Instructor and Student Guidelines

If GAI tools are used in the classroom the following guidelines should be followed.

Course instructors should:

1. Follow and remain up to date on the emerging/best international practice on the use of GAI tools in the classroom for the level and type of course they are teaching.
2. Structure assessments so that students can use the tools in a transparent manner.
3. Continually assess usage of such tools in the course and document this assessment in the Course Assessment Report (CAR) / Course Evaluation (CE) at the end of the semester.
4. Make use of institutional learning resources on GAI tools such as workshops offered through the CITL, and the colleges/school.

Students should:

1. Carefully read the course syllabus and the most recent institutional policies on academic integrity and IT acceptable use and raise any questions they have to the course instructor as they arise.
2. Make use of institutional learning resources on GAI tools such as workshops offered through the Library, Academic Support Center, and the colleges/school.

Institutional Responsibilities

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The institution will:

1. Provide regular seminars and workshops to students and faculty on the opportunities and threats associated with GAI tools.
2. Maintain alignment with emerging / international best practice on the use of GAI tools in higher education and modify policies and procedures accordingly.

GAI detection software

The institution does not prohibit the use of GAI detection software at any stage of the academic integrity adjudication process but does recognize that the output of such tools cannot provide a definitive judgement on whether an academic integrity violation has taken place.

5. Scope/applicability:

All undergraduate and graduate teaching and learning environments at AUS.

The use of GAI tools in faculty research is not covered under this policy.

6. Responsibilities:

Course instructors, AUS students, AUS administration.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

GAI – Generative Artificial Intelligence.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

[AUS Academic Integrity Policy](#), [AUS IT Acceptable Use Policy](#).

9. Policy History:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	November 21, 2023	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

x. LMS Usage Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0300UI26	Policy Title:	Learning Management System (LMS) Usage Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	April 17, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

LMS Usage Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide institution wide requirements for the use of the Learning Management System (LMS) by course instructors, in order to ensure effective utilization of the LMS for the benefit of students.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Usage of the AUS Learning Management System is mandatory for all courses at AUS. Course instructors are required to make use of the LMS as follows:

- I. Prior to the first day of classes the course section on the LMS must be activated and the course syllabus must be uploaded.
- II. All handouts and course materials are to be uploaded to the LMS throughout the semester in a timely manner.
- III. Official email communications for the course must be sent through the LMS or the official AUS email. Other platforms of communication such as WhatsApp, Telegram, and Facebook, are not considered to be substitutes for the official communication through the LMS.
- IV. All grades for any assessment appearing in the syllabus are to be uploaded to the grade center component of the LMS throughout the semester in a timely manner.
- V. Online classes are to be provided through the LMS. Other official AUS approved platforms may be used with approval from the Head of Department.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate courses

6. Responsibilities:

Policy to be implemented by the department heads and associate deans where appropriate.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

LMS: Learning Management System

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 17, 2024	New policy – Initial version	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

y. Testing Center Security Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	03UIEM27	Policy Title:	Testing Center Security Policy
Prepared By:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Office of Enrolment Management	Issue Date:	April 25, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Office of Enrolment Management	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Testing Center Security Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the security measures that are in place to ensure the physical security of the centralized examination center.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

AUS takes the following security measures with regards to the AUS testing center:

- Security Guards at the Gates:** Dedicated security officers are appointed to oversee exam takers and staff safety and security throughout the Testing Center examination period.
- Security guard duties include preventing exam takers from leaving the testing area during exam breaks and preventing interaction with external individuals, such as parents, friends, or guardians. The security guards are required to report any breach to the test proctors on duty for further action.
- Security guards are required during tests offered on the weekends, from one hour before the exam until the end, and once all the test takers leave the testing center.
- CCTV Surveillance.** Tactically installed security cameras throughout the testing halls, computer labs, lobby, and corridors are used to effectively monitor and record the activities of testing center visitors and test takers.
- Locking Mechanisms:** Various locking systems are implemented throughout the testing center, including offices, cabinets, test materials, and lockers.
- Approximately 250 lockers are available to test takers to securely store test personal items such as wallets and mobile phones. The Testing Center staff checks the items deposited in the lockers.
- Test provider partners are given the option to handle the deposits of test takers' personal items.
- The Testing Center staff are not to receive or handle paper-based exams requiring storage.

9. The test materials of the paper-based exams are to be managed directly by the test provider partners.
10. The test materials for exams offered by AUS Colleges are handled by AUS faculty and the college's administrative staff.
11. **Access Control.** Three days before the exam date, the AUS security office receives the list of test registrants to email gate passes for accessing the AUS campus and the Testing Center building. The security office issues a gate pass for each exam, which is limited by data and time.
12. **Entrance/ Exit Controls.** Each test has a scheduled start and end time. Throughout the testing period, whether for scheduled breaks, unscheduled breaks, or during the test, the testing proctor diligently monitors the entrance and exit of the testing room, ensuring the integrity of the examination process.
13. After each break, the testing proctor must physically check each candidate for notes on papers, devices, accessories, eyeglasses, hoods, ties, arms, etc., before returning them to their designated test station—devices into the testing room.
14. **Scanning process (Metal detector).** At the onset of the test, the testing proctor conducts a thorough scanning process using a metal detector to ensure the safety and integrity of the testing environment.
15. Test takers cannot carry mobile phones, watches, jewelry, calculators, cameras, notes, etc.
16. The scanning's purpose is to support test security and facilitate monitoring of the testing room by helping to detect unseen prohibited items before they enter.
17. **Fire Protection/ Fire Drills.** The testing center has a fire protection system, and the safety team regularly conducts fire drills.
18. **Signboards.** There are different signboards and instructions distributed across the Testing Center premise, such as:
 - Fire Extinguisher Location
 - First Aid Kit Location
 - Emergency Contact Information
 - Hazardous materials restriction: explosives materials, fireworks, flammable gas or liquids, ammonia, chlorine and lighters,
 - Emergency Assembly Point
 - No Smoking Area

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students

6. Responsibilities:

Office of Enrolment Management

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

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Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 25, 2024	New policy - to ensure compliance with the MOE standards.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

4. Research and Scholarly Activities

a. Research Administration and Support Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0400RS01	Policy Title:	Research Administration and Support Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Research	Issue Date:	November 10, 2017
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Research Administration and Support Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the requirements and provides guidance for faculty and staff, project leaders, department heads and program coordinators, and deans in both the submission and administration of sponsored research and other funded scholarly projects.

3. Introduction / background:

The contribution and dissemination of innovative research and scholarly activities are integral to the American University of Sharjah's (AUS) vision as an educational institution. Faculty are encouraged and expected to contribute to the body of knowledge within their field, and to seek support for their research from any source, provided that the terms and conditions for using such funds comply with AUS policies and procedures as well as any applicable laws. Any issues related to Intellectual Property as an outcome of scholarly or creative active is handled through Policy 10.c Intellectual Property Policy.

4. Policy Statement:

All requests for funding (e.g., research grants, research service agreements, consortiums, consultancies, non-disclosures, cooperative agreement, etc.), seeking internal or external support for research or research partnership must be submitted to the Office of Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR) for review and approval prior to submission to sponsors.

Occasionally this policy may be augmented by directives issued through other AUS policy memoranda or bulletins as they may relate to research activities at AUS. The OVCR may also produce other guidelines or memoranda that expound, develop upon, or complement the principles in this policy.

The OVCR is responsible for the submission, processing, and acceptance, of external sponsored research proposals and contracts. The Office of Advancement & Alumni Affairs (OAAA) handles non-research related agreements. Where potential conflicts or ambiguities arise regarding the nature of the contract or award, the OAAA and OVCR will work together to prevent multiple or competing solicitations from the same external sources.

All external payments to AUS that have contractual requirements, whether grant or contract are established as external or "223" funds (the required prefix of all funds from external sources in the AUS accounting system).

The following is a partial list of the types of proposals handled by the two offices:

- a. Office of Vice Chancellor for Research
 - Research agreements: Grants, cooperative agreements, contracts, sub-awards, colloquiums, Research Services Agreements
 - Other transactional agreements: Consultancy contracts, contracted services, interagency agreements, data sharing, equipment and facility loan or use contracts,
 - Industry Agreements: NDAs, material transfer agreements (MTA), industry sponsored research agreements, license agreements, IP/Proprietary agreements,
- b. Office of Advancement & Alumni Affairs
 - Endowment funds
 - Undergraduate scholarships and student aid
 - Endowed chairs
 - General support funds for departments, schools, etc.
 - Facilities not covered by a sponsored research award
 - Equipment not covered by a sponsored research award

Elaboration of Policy

I. Principal Investigator eligibility

To be a Principal Investigator/Program Director (PI/PD) one must be designated as a rolling-track faculty or staff as per the Faculty Handbook, Chapter A “Faculty Roles, Ranks and Titles”. Instructional faculty or temporary positions do not have PI/PD Eligibility status. The following are guidelines applicable to all identified faculty or staff with PI/PD status:

- a) All PI/PD status will be the responsible stewards for any applications or awards on which they are affiliated.
- b) On the occasion that sponsor guidelines require a student (graduate or undergraduate) or post-doctoral fellow to be listed as the PI/PD on a proposal or grant application, the faculty mentor/advisor for the student will become the PI/PD of record for all internal AUS forms and records, thereby making them responsible for the conduct and oversight of the project and the participant researchers.
- c) In those rare circumstances where an individual is not a faculty member or employee at the time of the application, the designation of PI/PD can be given by the Vice Chancellor for Research on a case-by-case basis.
- d) Violation of applicable laws, AUS or sponsor policies or procedures may result in the suspension or termination of PI/PD status.

II. Proposal preparation & acceptance of awards

All internal or external proposals submitted, and awarded grants or research related contracts to be performed by any faculty, students, and/or staff at AUS require the review and approval by the OVCR. Deans, faculty members/principal investigators, or their designees, are not authorized to sign or submit any form of a request for external funding that does not also include the Vice Chancellor for Research’s authorized approval.

To ensure proposals are submitted to sponsors by the sponsor’s deadline, all administrative documents (Proposal, budget, budget justification, biosketches, and other documents) must be received by OVCR in final form (ready to submit) at least five (5) business days before the sponsor’s deadline. Any required changes, particularly to the budget on or near the deadline day should not significantly impact the administrative documents already under review.

The contractual acceptance of awards from external sponsors can only be done by the OVCR. Signature authority for all research agreements rests with the Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Research, or his/her designee, depending upon the category or size of the award. Principal investigators are prohibited from signing research agreements.

It is AUS policy to not generally waive or reduce the Facilities and Administration (F&A) rate, also known as indirect cost rate, applicable to research agreements. F&A costs help to reimburse AUS for both infrastructure and service support costs associated with research. Any request for waiver or reduction of F&A should only be due to extraordinary hardship to the project. Requests for waivers or reduction must be submitted to the OVCR by using the Non-Standard IDC Request Form. This form must be approved by the appropriate department head(s), dean(s) prior to sending to the OVCR. AUS reserves the right to negotiate with the college, department or PI to cost-share any F&A that is waived or reduced.

Cost sharing, if any, included in budgets shall follow AUS's cost sharing policy and procedures and should be detailed on AUS's Cost Sharing Form. A copy of the approved form must be submitted to OVCR with any proposal.

III. Negotiations and grant/contract management

In the event a proposal is funded, it is only the OVCR, not the PI, who assumes the responsibility for negotiating and then formally accepting agreements on behalf of AUS. This ensures that all obligatory legal requirements for AUS in the application and acceptance of the funding are carefully reviewed and suitably addressed and that AUS policies and procedures are consistently and rationally adhered to. Occasionally there are agreements issued unilaterally and will not allow for negotiations, nor signatures from AUS.

Except on very rare occasion, agreements with sponsors are executed solely between AUS (not the principal investigator) and the sponsor. In accepting these legally binding agreements, AUS becomes the grantee or the contractor. The PI becomes responsible for the technical work, fiscal oversight, and the overall management of the sponsored project, and (s)he is obligated, together with AUS, to comply with all terms of the agreement.

IV. Research involving human subjects

All research involving human subjects conducted by AUS faculty, staff, post docs or students or conducted in AUS facilities or on AUS property, shall be conducted only after the Institutional Review Board (IRB) has reviewed and approved the protocol. The IRB approval confirms that the research is in accordance with AUS policy and is designed in a manner which protects the rights and welfare of the subjects involved.

V. Research involving animals

All research involving animals conducted by AUS faculty, research staff, post docs and students, or conducted in AUS facilities or on AUS property, shall be undertaken only after review and approval by the AUS Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC).

VI. Export controls

All exports of materials and data, including research results, must be in compliance with any applicable laws and regulations (e.g., [UAE Federal Law No. \(18\) for the year 1981 on the regulation of commercial agencies](#)). Exports include actual shipments or transmissions of materials or data outside of the country including to research sponsors. Exports also include disclosures of data or other technology (e.g., laptops, data storage devices) to a foreign person, including faculty, staff and student research team members. Generally, research at AUS qualifies as fundamental research and is not subject to export control restrictions on disclosures to foreign persons in the country. In specific circumstances, the nature of the research may not qualify as fundamental research and may be controlled.

VII. Transfer of materials

Any materials used as part of research and that are required to be transferred to or from AUS by faculty, research staff, postdocs or students must be transferred as per a Material Transfer Agreement, which shall be negotiated and executed by the OVCR. All transfers shall comply with national requirements and shall be verified by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management as not violating any national export control regulations.

VIII. Expenditures of grant/contract funds

All research agreements must have a designated start and end date. The funding period of a project begins on the effective date of the award agreement and runs for the identified end date. All expenditures incurred prior to the effective date of the agreement may not be charged against the project unless specifically pre-authorized in either the award document, approval has been received by the sponsor, or the appropriate designated authority within AUS. The process for obtaining such internal approval requires the submission of the Pre- award/Advance Spending Request form. No expenditures may be processed or reimbursed after the end date of the agreement unless approved by the sponsor.

All accounting functions shall be under the direction of the Office of Finance. The PI/PD has the preliminary responsibility to ensure that all charges and budgetary decisions are made in accordance with the terms and conditions of the award, including the approved budget, and in accordance with the relevant policies of AUS.

Grant/contract closeout

It is the responsibility of the PI/PD to ensure that all interim and final scientific/technical reports are transmitted through the OVCR in accordance with the terms, conditions and deadlines of the award. AUS requires a copy of any report submitted by the PI/PD directly to the sponsor. Failure to submit reports on a timely basis may result in action by AUS against the principal investigator, including ineligibility to submit future proposals until all delinquent reports have been submitted and accepted by a sponsor.

AUS, through OVCR and the Office of Finance, is responsible for submitting all invention, equipment/property and fiscal reports. The PI/PD shall work with, and provide all necessary information to these offices to ensure the timely and accurate submission of all reports. OVCR will submit the patent report(s) directly to the sponsor after final review from the PI.

IX. Innovation, patent & commercialization

AUS fosters an environment of innovation and creative work. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research owns and implements the Intellectual Property (IP) policy and procedures applicable to staff, faculty and students' protectable outputs.

5. Scope/Applicability:

This policy applies for all internally and externally funded research projects.

6. Responsibilities:

The design, conduct, report, and/or support of research activities at AUS is a collaborative effort from a number of individuals and units. Some individuals may undertake multiple roles within the institution.

A. Principal Investigators/Project Directors

Principal Investigators, are responsible for the scientific or technical direction as well as

preliminary budgetary and financial oversight of the project. While departmental administrators, central accounting and OVCR personnel provide PI/PDs support in this area, it is the investigator who must make the financial decisions related to expenditures. PIs and other responsible persons involved on sponsored projects are obligated to read their grant and contract documents carefully and adhere to any and all terms, and conditions and requirements stated within fully-executed documents. Additionally, PI/PDs have the primary responsibility to ensure that faculty, students, research staff, postdocs and visiting scholars receive the appropriate training, instruction and mentorship necessary to work safely in the laboratories where the research project is conducted. In addition, the PI in conjunction with the college/school designated Lab Safety Managers must ensure that equipment and supplies are placed so that research can be conducted safely and comply with AUS policies as well as with any applicable laws.

Additionally, PI/PD responsibility includes:

- i. Following institutional and sponsor instructions as well as terms and conditions;
- ii. Ensuring the proper recording and storage of data;
- iii. Timely reporting of intellectual property;
- iv. Proper handling of hazardous materials;
- v. Directing the use of and care for equipment;
- vi. Handling issues regarding conflicts of interest; research ethics; and scientific misconduct.
- vii. For research involving human subjects or the use of animals in research, or potential export control issues, principal investigators shall also ensure that students, postdocs and research staff receive information and complete the necessary training prior to conducting any research in these areas in accordance with AUS policies and procedures.
- viii. Principal investigators shall also inform their research staff, postdocs and students of those AUS policies and procedures that may impact their research projects such as those regarding purchasing, travel, and intellectual property.
- ix. Principal investigators should inform members of their research teams, including students and postdocs, of the source of support of the research and of their salary or stipend and principal investigators must have first-hand knowledge of the effort and amount and type of contribution each person makes to a research project.
- x. In the mentorship of students, principal investigators shall avoid the acceptance of external sponsorship of research activities which would compromise a student's ability to publish or discuss his/her work openly or jeopardize a student's ability to satisfy a graduation requirement in a timely manner due to a sponsor's imposed time constraint.
- xi. Publish their findings and conclusions in keeping with the academic and ethical principles of AUS
- xii. PI/PDs should appropriately acknowledge internal and external support of research findings in publications, announcements, news programs, and other media.
- xiii. comply with all AUS policies, governmental laws and regulations, and terms of sponsor agreements
- xiv. PI/PDs should not pursue research without scholarly merit such as “work for hire” services, “fee for service” work, or services ordinarily performed by a commercial entity. Notwithstanding the foregoing, AUS recognizes that there may be occasions where it is appropriate for faculty to undertake such work because of the opportunities it may provide for students or others to collaborate with a sponsor or the unique instrumentation available at AUS or expertise of a principal investigator. Under these circumstances, the prior written approval of the Vice Chancellor for Research is required.
- xv. PI/PD will ensure that all involved in sponsored projects will adhere to the Policy related to sustainability, thereby recognizing the university’s responsibility to the environment and its aim to continuously reduce the impact of its activities. (see policy 1.g Institutional Planning and specific plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability).

B. Deans and Head of Department (HOD)

In supporting sponsored research activities by their faculty, postdocs, and research staff, colleges

and departments assume certain responsibilities. Approvals of deans (or their designee) and department heads (or their designee) of a proposal, award or expenditures for a grant certifies to the following:

- i. Scholarly merit of the project;
- ii. The competence of the principal investigator in the area of research;
- iii. The recognition of applicable safety standards and regulations and the existence of plans for appropriate action to comply with them;
- iv. The ability of the principal investigator to successfully manage the proposed research project;
- v. Compliance with existing AUS and departmental policies;
- vi. Acknowledgment that, to the extent possible, the research project relates to the academic objectives of the department and provides opportunities for graduate and/or undergraduate education or research training;
- vii. the availability of AUS and department space, facilities, and equipment including information technology resources to fulfill project needs;
- viii. the adequacy of the budget and the determination of the department to prevent cost overruns;
- ix. the capability of the department to provide necessary administrative support (personnel and supplies); and
- x. assurance that the project will be conducted with appropriate management and oversight.

C. Staff (Lab Technicians and Lab Instructors)

- i. Staff are responsible for successfully completing required training and adhering to safe practices while working or doing research in laboratories. They must follow the required work practices and use personal protective equipment and engineering controls. Additionally, they are responsible for properly using AUS- supplied materials and equipment and for exercising good judgment in safely carrying out their work by following established procedures.
- ii. Staff are responsible for promptly notifying and reporting potentially unsafe conditions and environmental health hazards, as well as injuries and illnesses in the laboratory, to the PI, to the PI's designated laboratory representative or to the Operations department of AUS.

D. Office of Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR)

Under the leadership of the Vice Chancellor for Research, the OVCR reviews, approves, and provides institutional endorsement for proposals, awards, and contracts as these documents relate to internal or externally sponsored research and projects. In addition, the OVCR is responsible for monitoring compliance with national regulations and AUS and sponsoring agency policies and procedures, regarding the management of non- financial aspects of sponsored research and projects, as well as coordinating financial management with the Office of Finance. The OVCR functions as the liaison between sponsors and the Principal Investigator in matters of policy, procedures, and regulations and provides communication, guidance, education, and training on proposals, awards, and contracts to the AUS research community.

Vice Chancellor for Research

The Vice Chancellor for Research is AUS's chief official responsible for directing and guiding AUS's research mission including the identification and development of sponsorship opportunities. In this capacity, s/he provides direction, resources, and oversight to help ensure that allegations of research misconduct are managed in accordance with national, AUS, and sponsoring agency policies and procedures. Through the formulation of compliance entities, policies, procedures, systems, and educational programs that support research and related activities, the Vice Chancellor for Research supports the development and implementation of high quality research initiatives and establishes and maintains a culture of compliance among faculty, students, and staff involved in research and related activities.

E. Office of Finance

The Office of Finance ensures that AUS is in compliance with any applicable laws and regulations related to financial responsibilities for the management of sponsored research and other sponsored programs. The office also provide support on all post-award requests.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- A. Award: The provision of funds by a sponsor to AUS or the individual Principle Investigator to accomplish an activity or project with identified deliverables based on a prior approved application and budget.
- B. Award Document: A legally binding document containing or referencing all terms and conditions applicable to the award, and documenting the obligation of funds. The award document may be in letter format, contract, grant agreement, and/or may be issued electronically such as email. Awards to AUS are formally accepted by the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research on behalf of AUS, never to an individual.
- C. Budget: An estimate of all allowable, reasonable, and allocable proposal/award related costs, for a specific budget period. These costs must be consistent with national and AUS policy; including materials and supplies, direct and indirect costs.
- D. Budget Period: The interval of time (typically 12 months) into which the grant project period is divided for funding and reporting purposes.
- E. Consortium/Collaborative Agreement: A cooperative research arrangement in which some portion of the activity is carried out through a formalized contract between AUS and one or more other organizations that are separate legal entities from the grantee (AUS).
- F. Private Consultancy: A short-term contractual employment of a professional nature, undertaken within the PIs field of expertise, for a client outside of AUS for which financial compensation is provided. The PI's scope of work cannot exceed the dedication of more than 8 hours per week over a 9-month appointment; the work does not make use of any AUS facilities or services.
- G. Contract: Any formal agreement used when the principal purpose of the operation is to procure a specific service or end product for the direct benefit of, or use by the sponsoring party. Contracts are legally binding documents, which may only be executed by authorized officials at AUS.
- H. Contract (applicable to a grant): Any written agreement between a grantee and a third party to procure routine goods or services.
- I. Cooperative Agreement: A formal agreement, articulating an assistance relationship between AUS and a recipient, during which the performance of the activity will have significant sponsor involvement.
- J. Direct Costs: Costs that can be specifically identified with, and allocated to, a particular sponsored activity or project.
- K. Facilities and Administrative (F&A) Costs: Costs which are incurred for common or joint objectives and cannot be identified with a particular project or program. Facilities and Administrative (F&A) costs are those costs associated with the physical and administrative infrastructures which support the research enterprise and cannot easily be allocated to a specific project. F&A is commonly referred to as Indirect Costs (IDC).
- L. Grant: Any financial contract which provides money, goods, or both to AUS to carry out an approved sponsored project. Responsibility for execution rests primarily with AUS, and there is little or no involvement or participation in the performance of activities by the Sponsor.
- M. Grantee: The organization or person awarded a grant or cooperative agreement by a sponsor in which the awardee assumes all legal, financial, and scientific responsibility and accountability for both awarded funds and the performance and reporting of the supported activity. External grants are to be issued to AUS and not to an individual.
- N. Indirect Costs: See Facilities and Administrative (F&A) Costs.
- O. Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC): A committee set up by AUS to review the institution's operations for humane care and use of animals. The IACUC Board

reviews research protocols involving any animal use at the institution, including both live animals and animal carcasses; The committee also evaluates the animal facilities, and personnel training of investigators and will provide recommendations to the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research.

- P. Institutional Review Board (IRB): A board set up by a research institution to ensure the protection of the rights and welfare of human research subjects participating in research conducted under its auspices. The IRB makes an independent determination to approve, require modifications to, or disapprove research protocols based on whether human subjects are adequately protected, as required by both national regulations and institutional policy.
- Q. Principal Investigator/Program Director (PI/PD): The individual responsible for conducting the scientific, budgetary and reporting obligations of a sponsored project/program. The PI should certify that there are sufficient resources, such as investigator time, equipment, and space, and adequately trained lab personnel to carry out the research safely. All PIs must have an active academic appointment at the institution and be research eligible (see Faculty Handbook Ch. A).
- R. Proposal: Any request for financial or asset assistance for a project/activity submitted to a sponsor, be they governmental, internal, or corporate.
- S. Research Services Agreement: A contract completed and submitted to the OVCR when engaging individuals or companies to perform services using AUS resources. It is a contract between AUS and the contractor for sponsored research funds.
- T. Sponsored Research Project (or Sponsored Program or Project): Any internally or externally-funded activity in which a formal written agreement (i.e., a grant, contract, sub-award, research service agreement, or cooperative agreement) is entered into by AUS and the sponsor. Broadly, a “Sponsored Project” is any contract in which a specified statement of work receives reciprocal value in money or goods.
- U. Stipend: A payment made to a graduate student in accordance with AUS policy that provide for living expenses during the period of training. Stipends are not compensation for the services expected of an employee.
- V. Terms and Conditions of Award: All legally binding obligations and expectations imposed by fully-executing a grant or contract. These obligations may be based on law, regulation, policy, other referenced documents, or from within the award document itself. The notice of award, be it contract, grant or other type of agreement, may include both standard and/or special provisions that are considered necessary to attain the project objectives, facilitate administration of the award, conserve grant funds, or otherwise protect the interests of parties involved.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook, Chapter A

10.2 Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct Policy

10.3 Policy on Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities

Policy 1.g Institutional Planning and specific plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability.

Policy 10.c Intellectual Property Policy

Related documents (posted on iLearn at *iLearn-Community-Research Services*):

1. All IRB related forms and guides
2. External Sponsored Projects – Internal Clearance Package (ICP)
3. Research Routing Forms and Templates
 - a. Contract/Award Authorization Form
 - b. Conflict of Interest (COI) declaration
 - c. Contract templates
 - Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA)
 - Consultant Contract

- Research Service Agreement (RSA)
- 4. Grant Management Forms:
 - d. AUS Pre-Award Spending Authorization Form
 - e. Budget Change Request (BCR) Form
 - f. Grant Modification Request Form
 - g. No-Cost Extension (NCE) Request Form

9. Policy history:

Prior to the creation of an independent Research Office in September of 2017, there was not an existing independent policy on research administration. The initial policy distinguished and provided guidance to AUS employees, faculty and students on the rules regarding the execution of research related agreements and compliance. After CRO review and consultation with the Executive Cabinet in May of 2019, version 2.0 of the Policy of Research Administration was approved using the latest format, as well as better aligning the definitions used in other relevant policies; The relation to other related policies was also included. Version 3 again updates to the latest policy format, including the policy history and form references.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	November 10, 2017	Initial independent policy on research administration created	Chancellor
2.0	05.24.2019	Format change, simplification of terms and references to related policies included	Chief Research Officer
3.0	30.8.2021	Editorial changes and format changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	May 2023	Revised – No Change	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	To comply with the MOE standards - Addition of AUS sustainability and IP Policy numbers. Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR)/Research Services	Tel: +971 6 5154721	research@aus.edu

b. Ethical Research Policy

This policy covers a number of policies as follows:

1. Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct – Version 4
2. Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities – Version 6

1. Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct – Version 4

Policy Number:	0400RS02	Policy Title:	Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct
Prepared By:	Office of Research Services	Issue Date:	March 29, 2019
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy reaffirms AUS's commitment to the highest principles of integrity in all its research and scholarly activities, identifies general types of research misconduct, and establishes procedures for dealing with alleged research misconduct and for complying with the policies of sponsoring agencies.

3. Introduction / background:

The maintenance of high ethical standards is central to effective research undertaken in the pursuit of knowledge. Research integrity demands the valid collection and accurate reporting of data. In order to uphold this integrity, AUS respects the ideas and rights of others and rejects the unauthorized use of others' data or scholarship and the abuse of animal and human subjects.

Research misconduct means fabrication, falsification or plagiarism in proposing, performing, or reviewing research, or in reporting research results. Fabrication is making up data or results and recording or reporting them. Falsification is manipulating research materials, equipment, or processes, or changing or omitting data or results such that the research is not accurately represented in the research record. Plagiarism is the appropriation of another person's ideas, processes, results, or words without giving appropriate credit.

A finding of research misconduct requires that there be a significant departure from accepted practices of the relevant research community. Research misconduct may also include a failure to comply with applicable requirements for protecting researchers, human and animal subjects and the public. Any action in connection with proposing, conducting, reviewing, or reporting research taken with the intent to defraud is also a form of research misconduct. Research misconduct does not include honest error or differences in opinion.

4. Policy Statement:

As an institution of higher learning, American University of Sharjah (AUS) expects all of its members

to maintain the highest standards of conduct in pursuing research and scholarly activities. Any form of research fraud or misconduct is contrary to AUS's principles and adversely affects the reputation of all individuals in the AUS community. Moreover, since AUS receives external funding to support research, it has certain regulatory responsibilities to inform those participating in sponsored research activities of the funding agencies' research misconduct policies.

5. Scope:

While designed to comply with international best standards, the principles and procedures in this policy apply to all scholarly and professional activities within the AUS community and to all cases of research misconduct at AUS, whether or not they involve sponsors.

6. Responsibilities:

To ensure maintenance of high ethical standards, the University expects all its faculty, staff, and students to embrace the principles of intellectual integrity, whether or not the research or scholarly activity is funded by external sources. All faculty, students, and staff involved in research activities are required to adhere to this policy.

Research misconduct procedures - criteria, reports, and time limitations:

The primary responsibility for maintaining high standards of conduct lies with the individual researcher. Nevertheless, because research misconduct is a very serious offense, AUS must also take appropriate steps to prevent its occurrence. Compliment to this policy please see the "Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation" document for procedures to be followed for inquiries and investigations.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- a. Research: a systematic investigation, including research development, testing and evaluation, designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge. A project requires IRB review if it includes both research and human subjects.
- b. Research misconduct: fabrication, falsification or plagiarism in proposing, performing, or reviewing research, or in reporting research results.
- c. Fabrication: making up data or results and recording or reporting them.
- d. Falsification: manipulating research materials, equipment, or processes, or changing or omitting data or results such that the research is not accurately represented in the research record.
- e. Plagiarism: appropriation of another person's ideas, processes, results, or words without giving appropriate credit.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- 10.1 Research Administration
- 10.3 Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities AUS Faculty Handbook
- Appendix V. Ethical Research
- Related documents:
- Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation

9. Policy history:

The policy history started with the document prepared by the Chief Research Officer (CRO) in 2019 after review and approval by the Executive Cabinet. The Latest Version was to reformat the policy and include new references.

Revision History:

AUS POLICIES AND PROCEDURES MANUAL | AY24-25 | VERSION 5

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Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	March 29, 2019	Initial Misconduct Policy	Chief Research Officer
2.0	August 30, 2021	Policy template updated; Appointment of Research Integrity Officer by Provost since the CRO position is no longer exist	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Changes to Scope language	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	+9716 5152203	research@aus.edu

2. Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities – Version 6

Policy Number:	0400RS03	Policy Title:	Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities
Prepared By:	Office of Research Services	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May, 2026

1. Policy: Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities

American University of Sharjah is committed to the safe and ethical practice of research in all regards. AUS holds faculty, staff and students to the highest international standards of research compliance without obstructing the process of research.

2. Purpose

a. Legal of Regulatory Reasons

American University of Sharjah has an ethical and legal responsibility to review all proposed research projects and activities involving humans as subjects to ensure compliance with internationally recognized principles and regulations governing the protection of humans participating in research.

b. Description of conflict or problem to be solved.

The purpose of IRB review is to assure, both in advance and by periodic review, that appropriate steps are taken to protect the rights and welfare of humans participating as subjects in the research. In the absence of effective review, the university, researchers, and subjects will be open to liability from the potential harm inflicted on community members.

c. Overall benefits:

Protection for human and animal subjects, transparency, and unconditional health and safety standards are paramount to AUS research success and the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research supports and upholds these standards.

3. Introduction/Background

Principal guides for the University's human subjects review system are:

- a. The Belmont Report: Ethical Principles and Guidelines for the Protection of Human Subjects of Research [The National Commission for the Protection of Human Subjects of Biomedical and Behavioral Research, April 18, 1979].
- b. Protection of Human Subjects [Code of Federal Regulations - 45 CFR 46, revised November 13, 2001, effective December 13, 2001].

All research involving human subjects, conducted at the University or under its sponsorship at another location, must be reviewed and approved by the Institutional Review Board for Protection of Human Subjects (IRB) or its designated reviewer(s) under the policies outlined below.

When reviewing research proposals, the IRB is primarily interested in safeguarding the rights and well-being of the human subject and in assessing the ethical implications of the proposed procedures. The ethical principles and their translation into action:

1. Respect for Persons - Informed Consent,
2. Beneficence - Assessment of Risks and Benefits, and
3. Justice - Equitable Selection of Subjects,

set forth in the Belmont Report serve as the guide for the IRB/DRB's review of all research activities.

Research procedures and design may affect the use and experience of human subjects in research activities. In this context, the IRB has the responsibility to require modification or change in the design of the research, to assure that the use of human subjects is valid and the risks to the subjects are minimized. However, it is not the intention of the IRB to provide full scientific review.

In analyzing the risk/benefit ratio of a research activity, both the stated goals and the scientific merit of the research will be considered. Therefore, the research must be described to the IRB in a manner that allows adequate review of all these aspects of the research.

As required by AUS Policy 10.1 Research Administration, no research or educational activities involving human subjects may be undertaken at American University of Sharjah (AUS) unless the Institutional Review Board (IRB) for the Protection of Human Subjects at Risk has reviewed and approved the activity. Moreover, appropriate certification of such review and prior approval must have been provided to the sponsor.

4. Policy Statement

The AUS community maintains its rights to privacy, within the limits of the law. Therefore, research involving AUS students, faculty, alumni, and staff by external parties will be denied except in cases where a member of the university community is a research collaborator.

If an AUS community member thinks that an external research request is valuable, they may request to take part in the study themselves, or can request to participate as a collaborator. If the external party is in collaboration with a member of the AUS community, then the study will be considered of internal origin.

The only procedure of an invasive nature that may normally be undertaken for research or instructional purposes is the collection of blood samples by venipuncture. Volunteer subjects must be at least 18 years of age who certify that they are in good health and not pregnant. Blood samples may be drawn no more than twice a week with an upper limit in volume of 450 milliliters over an eight-week period. Signed and witnessed consent forms, available in the Office of Research Services iLearn page, are required in all cases. These procedures may be performed only by medical personnel, i.e. physicians, licensed nurses, or certified medical laboratory technicians/ phlebotomists.

Non-invasive procedures to be used with human subjects, for example, in memory testing, must be justified by the Principal Investigator (PI) in writing and are subject to review and approval by the IRB. Consent forms are required in these cases also.

Additional details and guidance can be found in the IRB Procedures Manual.

5. Scope/applicability

All research protocols involving the participation of humans must be submitted to and approved by the AUS Institutional Review Board (IRB) before any study is undertaken. This includes research conducted by AUS faculty, staff and students, whether externally or internally funded, or self-funded, conducted either on- or off-campus. Further, any research conducted on AUS campus by AUS or non-AUS affiliates requires IRB approval. Reliance on an external IRB when medical in nature or when in collaboration with another institution is possible via Reliance Agreement. Reliance Agreements must be executed via the AUS IRB office and can only be executed by the Vice Chancellor for Research.

6. Responsibilities

It is the responsibility of the investigator to ensure they have fully executed all required IRB protocol procedures and obtained documented approval prior to the commencement of any research wherein human subjects are engaged.

Investigators at the University are entrusted with the primary responsibility for protecting the human subjects involved in their research in accordance with University policies, all applicable regulations, and the code of ethics of their professions. Specific responsibilities of investigators are to:

- a. Submit an adequately prepared form to the IRB via Research Services for each research project involving human subjects.
- b. Request a continuing review if the research extends beyond the initial review period.
- c. Notify the IRB and their Head of Department of any injury - physical, psychological, or social
- d. - suffered by a subject because of his or her participation in a research activity.
- e. Retain adequate records, documents, and informed consent forms for at least three (3) years following the completion of the approved project or activity, or for a longer period as judged necessary.
- f. Maintain any current certifications in Human Subjects Education as required by the institution.
- g. Assure that all research assistants participating in the protocol receive complete any required training.
- h. The composition of the IRB Board follows as much as possible, the U.S. Department of Health and Human Services (HHS) regulations for the protection of human subjects in
- i. research at 45CFR 46 include five subparts. Subpart A, also known as the Common Rule, provides a robust set of protections for research subjects; subparts B, C, and D provide additional protections for certain populations in research; and subpart E provides requirements for IRB registration. When policy conflicts with local laws, or customs the board will determine the best adapted policy for the institution that both adheres to the local law and establishes protections for the participants.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- a. Institutional Review Board (IRB): A board set up by a research institution to ensure the protection of the rights and welfare of human research subjects participating in research conducted under its auspices. The IRB makes an independent determination to approve, require modifications to, or disapprove research protocols based on whether human subjects are adequately protected, as required by both national regulations and institutional policy.
- b. Investigators are defined as all persons who contribute significantly to the design and implementation of a study protocol. Also often called principal investigator or program director.
- c. Research Assistants are all persons who contribute to the implementation of the study, including interaction with subjects and/or access to data, but do not participate in the design and development of the study protocol.
- d. Research is defined as a systematic investigation, including research development, testing and evaluation, designed to develop or contribute to generalizable knowledge. A project requires IRB review if it includes both research and human subjects.
- e. Principal Investigator/Program Director (PI/PD): The individual responsible for conducting the scientific, budgetary and reporting obligations of a sponsored project/program. Also called the investigator, the PI should certify that there are sufficient resources, such as investigator time, equipment, and space, and adequately trained lab personnel to carry out the research safely.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms

Related policies:

10.1 Research Administration

10.2 Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct

Related documents (posted on iLearn at *iLearn-Community-Research Services-IRB*):

1. IRB Protocol (Application) Form
2. IRB Consent Form Template
3. Elements of Informed Consent Guide
4. IRB Request for Waiver of Documentation of Informed Consent
5. IRB Continuation Form
6. IRB Modification Request Form
7. IRB Adverse & Incidental Reporting Form
8. IRB Authorization Agreement Request Form
9. PowerPoint Presentation on IRB
10. Recording of the live webinar including Q&A
11. IRB Guide

9. Policy history

Prior to the creation of an independent research office in September 2017, there was not an independent policy on IRB. After the creation of an independent research office a new IRB policy was created – followed shortly by the creation of the IRB Guide. The IRB Guide allowed the initial IRB policy to be simplified, and the final iteration was to accommodate the latest policy formatting requirements.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	Faculty Handbook guidance	Provost & Chief Academic Officer
2.0	December 25, 2018	Initial independent IRB policy	Chief Research Officer
3.0	August 20, 2020	Inclusion of new forms, Simplification of policy and increased emphasis on IRB Guide	Chief Research Officer
4.0	June 28, 2021	New policy template format	Provost
5.0	May 2023	Revised	Provost & Chief Academic Officer
6.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References

For more help with regard of IRB process please contact:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Research Services	+9716 5152203	irb@aus.edu

c. Student Involvement in Research Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0400PG04	Policy Title:	Student Involvement in Research
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	December 1, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Graduate Studies • Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Office of Research Services	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Involvement in Research

2. Purpose

To demonstrate the University's commitment for strengthening student research skills and provide guidelines to faculty and students about the roles and responsibilities of students engaged in research work.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Statement

AUS students, at undergraduate and graduate levels, are encouraged to participate in research and scholarly activities under the supervision of AUS faculty who provide advice and mentorship on conducting research work. The University provides support to students by providing them with access to Library resources, laboratories and computing facilities, talks by invited speakers, and opportunities to work with faculty members in funded research projects. The AUS Library provides instruction, resources and services that strengthen student research skills, promote critical reflection and foster academic excellence.

Graduate students are required to have significant engagement in research activities as part of their degree requirement in the form of course projects, theses and dissertations. Graduate students are expected to disseminate their research work through presentations and publications in high quality conference and journal publications.

While it is the responsibility of the students to take initial steps or indicate interest in research while at AUS, it is also the obligation of the faculty to encourage and educate students on the various avenues of such participation.

The following guidelines are to be observed when students are involved in research and scholarly activities:

- Students cannot use their affiliation with AUS in any published article without having the approval of a faculty member from AUS to ensure that the work has been properly reviewed.
- Students involved in research, including capstone project, thesis or dissertation work, are encouraged to discuss in advance with their AUS faculty supervisor their role and co-authorship pertaining to any possible publications from the work.

- Student must adhere to the ethical conduct of research when conducting research involving human subjects, and must avoid fabrications, falsifications, plagiarism and other practices that deviate from accepted scholarly practice.
- Students must adhere to the applicable University policies.
- Intellectual property produced by students shall be governed by the AUS Intellectual Property Policy

5. Scope/applicability

This policy is primarily targeted at AUS students to provide confirmation and encouragement in their participation in research production. It also serves as a guide for faculty and staff in promoting student participation in research.

6. Responsibilities:

Students and faculty must ensure compliance with this policy when involved in research and scholarly activities at AUS.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not Applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

It is required that students participating in research adhere to the same ethical and misconduct guidelines as their faculty peers. The following policies should be read and adhered to by both faculty and students engaging in research:

- Policy 10.1 Research Administration
- Policy 10.2 Research & Scholarly Work Misconduct
- Policy 10.3 Protection of Human Subject Participating in Research or Educational Activities

9. Policy History:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 1, 2021	Initial creation of policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpua@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

d. Commercialization of Research Output Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0400RS05	Policy Title:	Commercialization of Research Output Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Research Services	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Research Services	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Next Revision:	June 2027

1. Policy:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is committed to fostering innovation and maximizing the societal impact of its research endeavors. This Commercialization of Research Output Policy outlines the principles and procedures for facilitating the translation of research findings and intellectual property into commercially viable products, services, and solutions.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Promote the commercialization of research outputs generated by faculty, students, and staff.
- Facilitate the transfer of technology and knowledge from academia to industry for economic development and societal benefit. Ensure the responsible management and protection of intellectual property arising from research activities.
- Support entrepreneurship and innovation among the AUS community.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

The Commercialization of Research Output Policy reflects AUS's commitment to advancing knowledge and driving innovation in alignment with its mission as a leading institution of higher education in the region. By promoting the commercialization of research outputs, AUS seeks to contribute to economic growth, create entrepreneurial opportunities, and address societal challenges through the application of research-driven solutions. The successful translation of research discoveries into marketable products and services is essential for maximizing the impact of academic research. Recognizing this imperative, AUS has developed this policy to provide a framework for guiding and supporting the commercialization process while upholding the principles of academic integrity and ethical conduct.

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

- **Research Output Disclosure:** Researchers must disclose all potentially patentable inventions or commercially valuable research outputs to the Technology Transfer Officer (TTO) using the Invention Patent Disclosure Form (IPDF). This form should include detailed descriptions of the invention or research output, its potential applications, and any relevant supporting documentation.
- **Evaluation and Protection:** Upon receiving the IPDF, the TTO will evaluate the invention or research output to assess its novelty, commercial potential, and intellectual property protection requirements. The TTO may engage external experts or patent attorneys to assist in this evaluation process.
- **Intellectual Property Protection:** If the research output is deemed to have commercial potential

and meets the criteria for patentability or other forms of intellectual property protection, the TTO with the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Research (VCR) will initiate the necessary steps to protect the intellectual property rights associated with the invention. This may include filing patent applications, copyright registrations, or other forms of intellectual property protection. Details about intellectual property ownership are described in the Intellectual Property policy and procedures.

- **Commercialization Strategy:** The TTO, in discussion with the inventor team, will develop a commercialization strategy for the research output, considering market dynamics, industry trends, and potential licensing or commercialization partners. This strategy may include licensing the intellectual property rights to third-party entities, forming strategic partnerships with industry stakeholders, or establishing startup ventures to commercialize the research output.
- **Licensing and Technology Transfer:** The TTO will negotiate licensing agreements with potential licensees or commercialization partners to facilitate the transfer of technology and intellectual property rights from AUS to the commercial sector. These agreements will define the terms and conditions of the licensing arrangement, including royalty rates, revenue sharing mechanisms, and intellectual property ownership rights.
- **Entrepreneurship Support:** For researchers interested in pursuing entrepreneurial opportunities based on their research outputs, the TTO provide support and guidance through the process of forming startup ventures, securing funding, and navigating the commercialization landscape. This may include access to entrepreneurship training programs, mentorship networks, and incubation facilities such as Sharjah Research Technology & Innovation Park or Sheraa.
- **Monitoring and Compliance:** The TTO will monitor the progress of commercialization efforts and ensure compliance with all applicable policies, procedures, and legal requirements. Regular updates on the status of ongoing commercialization projects will be provided to the university administration and relevant stakeholders.
- **Sovereignty and Cooperation.** AUS shall have the sole discretion regarding the Commercialization of IP fully owned by AUS. Notwithstanding, AUS will ensure that reasonable efforts are made to keep the inventors informed and, where appropriate, involved in the Commercialization of the IP to which they contributed. The Commercialization of AUS IP will be planned, executed, and monitored by TTO.
- **Review and Revision:** This Commercialization of Research Output Policy will be reviewed periodically to ensure its effectiveness and alignment with evolving best practices in research commercialization. Amendments or revisions to the policy may be made as necessary to address changing circumstances or regulatory requirements.

By adhering to these detailed procedures, AUS aims to streamline the commercialization process, maximize the impact of its research outputs, and contribute to the economic and social development of the region.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all faculty, students, researchers, and staff engaged in research activities at AUS, as well as any intellectual property or research outputs generated through their work. It encompasses inventions, discoveries, software, copyrightable materials, and any other forms of intellectual property that have the potential for commercialization.

6. Responsibilities:

- **Researchers:** Researchers are responsible for disclosing any potentially patentable inventions or commercially valuable research outputs to the TTO in accordance with established procedures.
- **Technology Transfer Officer (TTO):** TTO is responsible for evaluating, protecting, and managing intellectual property arising from research activities, as well as facilitating technology transfer and commercialization efforts.
- **Research Services:** The office of research services will bring any research projects with

commercial potential to the attention of the TTO, based on proposals and interim reports received.

- Industry Partners and Entrepreneurs: Industry partners and entrepreneurs interested in collaborating with AUS or licensing its intellectual property are responsible for adhering to the terms and conditions of licensing agreements and supporting the responsible commercialization of research outputs.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Intellectual Property (IP): Creations of the mind, such as inventions, literary and artistic works, designs, symbols, names, and images, used in commerce.
- Technology Transfer: The process of transferring scientific findings from research institutions to the commercial sector for further development and commercialization.
- Commercialization: The process of bringing research outputs to market as commercially viable products, services, or technologies.
- Entrepreneurship: The activity of setting up a business or businesses, taking on financial risks in the hope of profit.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- AUS IP Policy
- IPDF Document
- Non-disclosure Agreement

9. Policy history:

Revision Table:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Research
2.0	June 24, 2024	• Revised • Policy details have been added. • Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

For more help with regard of appealing contact:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Technology Transfer Officer	+971 6 515 2216	tto@aus.edu

e. Creating New Research Centers at AUS – Version 6

Policy Number:	0400RE06	Policy Title:	Creating New Research Centers at AUS
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Issue Date:	December 26, 2018
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	August 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Revision:	July 2026

1. Policy:

Creating New Research Centers at AUS

2. Purpose:

This policy establishes the requirements for the creation, operation, modification, review, and dissolution of Research Centers to facilitate the effective administration of Research Center activities. Additionally, this procedure addresses Research Centers that are jointly established and administered with other institutions and external agencies, both public and private.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

Research Centers at AUS can play an important role in promoting excellence in education, research, and service by bringing together disciplinary and cross-disciplinary expertise, financial resources, and physical assets in innovative ways to fulfill the University's mission.

4. Policy Statement:

The establishment and dissolution of Research Centers must follow the following process:

- I. The formation of a Research Center shall be discussed with the Vice Chancellor for Research and approved in concept prior to the full-scale development of a proposal. A full proposal for the creation of a Research Center must be submitted by the Associate Vice Chancellor for Research (AVCR) to the University Research Council (URC) for further consideration and recommendations. Final approval for the establishment of a Research Center is made by the Chancellor. The proposal will state the following:
 - A. The rationale for creating the center, including its relation to the central mission of the University and the University's Strategic Plan;
 - B. Its instructional and/or research agenda, with specific reference to the resources, human and material, that will be committed to supporting that agenda;
 - C. A financial model, including the current and projected sources of financial support and potential funding sources, as well as operating and capital expenses. The model should forecast space requirements as well as equipment and computing expenses. The model should include a fully-funded scenario as well as scenarios with moderate and conservative funding assumptions, over the course of five years;
 - D. A list of faculty members, with qualifications, who will engage in the planning and operation of the Research Center;
 - E. A list of external partners who will collaborate with AUS in the activities of the Research Center;
 - F. Plans of future or existing collaborations with internationally renowned centers/scholars in core areas of the Research Center;

- G. The impact of the Research Center on the education and training of AUS students;
 - H. The impact of the Research Center on the economic, social, and cultural vitality of Sharjah and the UAE;
 - I. The governance and advisory structure;
 - J. A detailed implementation plan, including personnel and space, and likely financial scenarios for the duration of the Research Center. Specify the existing laboratory and office facilities that will be used by the Research Center. Assignment of this space to the Research Center must be approved by the responsible Head of Department, Dean and the URC; and
 - K. The mechanisms for periodic review including Key Performance Indicators and possible sunset of the Research Center.
 - L. Major changes or modification from the approved proposal in name, function, focus, or funding sources will require prior approval by the Vice Chancellor for Research subject to the recommendation of the URC.
- II. All Research Centers shall be reviewed at least every three years for continuation in accordance with guidelines to be developed by the Office of The Vice Chancellor for Research.
- III. The dissolution of a Research Center will require the recommendation of the AVCR, URC and approval of the Vice Chancellor for Research. Requests to dissolve a Research Center should be approved by the Chancellor.

5. Scope:

This policy applies to all Research Centers funded solely by the University or jointly with an external party.

6. Responsibilities:

- I. All faculty proposing to establish a Research Center must adhere to this policy.
- II. Accountability for the effective management of each Research Center is vested in its Director or other responsible administrative official as designated by the Vice Chancellor for Research. The Director is responsible for the annual assessment of the Research Center's performance and report the achievement of the KPIs.
- III. Responsibilities for the periodic review and evaluation of the Research Center rests with the AVCR.
- IV. The Vice Chancellor for Research serves as the responsible administrative official with oversight and monitoring responsibilities for the University-wide administration of Research Centers. The Vice Chancellor for Research establishes general guidelines for monitoring Research Centers in the effective review and evaluation of their activities.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

The mission and activities of a Research Center should not duplicate those accomplished by an existing organized research unit or academic unit, and proposed new Research Centers should be reviewed in the context of other activities that are ongoing within the University to ensure that the University's overall effort in a given field of inquiry is strengthened. A Research Center is administered by a director and typically focuses on research and external engagement activities broader than those interests of an academic unit.

For the purposes of this policy, the following are not considered Research Centers:

- Single-discipline administrative, educational or research entities, usually residing within an academic Department or College;

- Interdisciplinary programs that are capable of being administered within a single existing Department or an already established Organized Research Unit;
- Administrative units within the University (such as professional development programs, Writing Center, outreach programs, laboratories, buildings, computing centers, Faculty Development Center, etc.).

Although faculty participate in Research Centers, regular faculty appointments can only be made within an academic Department or Program. Research Centers do not host majors, nor can they on their own authority offer courses of instruction. For courses offered for degree credit in conjunction with a Research Center, the course credit shall be assigned to one of the Colleges or Schools of the University.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

New appendix: Administration of AUS Research Centers

9. Policy history:

The policy was initiated in 2018 as part of the Research Agenda to establish centers and institutes but with the major shift in the Research Agenda in 2019, the policy was not put into effect. In order to support the realization of the research strategy, as per of the University's Strategic Plan, the policy has been revised to guide the establishment of centers.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	26-12-2018	Initial Policy developed	Chief Research Officer
2.0	21-11-2022	Policy amended and approved to guide the establishment of centers and removing institutes	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	May 2023	Reviewed – No Changes	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
4.0	January 18, 2024	Policy guidelines established	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
6.0	August 12, 2024	Policy updated to reflect the newly established administration of research centers under the Vice Chancellor for Research	Vice Chancellor for Research

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	06 515 2214	research@aus.edu

f. Organized Research Units – Version 1

Policy Number:	0400RE07	Policy Title:	Organized Research Units
Prepared By:	Vice Chancellor for Research	Issue Date:	August 14, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Research	Effective Date:	September 1, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2027

1. Policy:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is committed to the promotion of interdisciplinary research. It encourages faculty, students and research staff to engage in interdisciplinary, collaborative research that promotes research excellence and opportunities for collaboration.

2. Purpose:

This policy provides the framework for establishment and management of organized research units (ORUs) at AUS, including research groups, research centers, and, if applicable in the future, university designated institutes. This policy gives effect to that commitment.

3. Policy Statement:

- Organized Research Units (ORUs) at AUS consist of Research Centers and Research Groups.
- ORUs are the foundation for collaborative research and are the vehicles for advancing the university's strategic research agenda. All faculty, students, and staff involved in an ORU must adhere to AUS's research policies and procedures.
- All ORUs must support AUS in fulfilling its mission as follows:
 - Broadening and deepening knowledge leading to new discoveries and technical innovation;
 - Establishing visibility in key research areas, and building industrial connections to attract and sustain external funding support;
 - Educating and training students to create a knowledge intensive workforce for Sharjah, the UAE, the region and the world;
 - Strategically involving companies and government stakeholders that engage in exchanges of technical skills and know-how to advance research and development in areas of joint interest.
- Any form of ORU is only eligible to be formed if the following are provided:
 - Evidence that new activities or an increased magnitude of research and/or educational activity could not be undertaken at the university in the absence of the proposed unit;
 - Explanation of what the proposed research unit will do that existing centers or research groups cannot do; and
 - Description of how the research unit will contribute in a new way to both the educational

and research objectives of the university.

- Research Centers can be formed as a result of a structured funding call or based on a university strategic need linked to Sharjah and UAE research priorities.

4. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the establishment of any type of organized research unit.

5. Responsibilities:

- The policy is governed by the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research.
- Exceptions to this policy require approval by the Vice Chancellor for Research.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Director: The appointed leader of a Research Center.
- Research Center: A large-scale research unit that is managed by a Director that reports to the Associate Vice Chancellor for Research. Centers are established to support the evolution of the university's research capabilities and priorities in a defined application domain and to engage in research that addresses the needs of industry and/or government partners.
- Research Group: A collection of faculty, staff and/or students with common research interests who wish to collaborate under a unified banner but are not allocated a specific annual allotment of internal research funds. Research groups are often formed and managed within Colleges and academic Departments.
- Sponsored Research Center: A mission-focused research center that addresses the needs of industry and/or government partners interested in financially supporting large-scale and focused research activities at AUS for a defined period of time.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Research Governance Policy
- Creating New Research Centers at AUS

8. Policy history:

The policy history started with the document prepared by the Vice Chancellor for Research on August 5, 2024.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	August 5, 2024	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Research

9. References

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	06 515 2214	research@aus.edu

g. Research and Scholarly Work Governance - Version 1

Policy Number:	0400RE08	Policy Title:	Research and Scholarly Work Governance
Prepared By:	Vice Chancellor for Research	Issue Date:	August 14, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Research	Effective Date:	September 1, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2027

1. Policy:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) furthers its mission to become an internationally recognized research-intensive institution with policies, procedures, and administrative capacity that support and enable research. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR) is charged with administrative oversight over all types of internally and externally funded research and scholarly work that is conducted by AUS researchers, including faculty, students and research staff.

2. Purpose:

This policy defines the role and responsibilities of the OVCR and University Research Council (URC) in furthering research and scholarly activities at AUS. It governs the relationship between researchers and the OVCR. The document specifically outlines the overarching AUS research administration framework, defines clear and concise guidelines that will be followed when executing research at AUS and serves as a primary reference for the academic community for both internally and externally sponsored research projects.

3. Policy Statement:

- The Vice Chancellor for Research, senior research management, deans, faculty and other academic and research staff have the collective responsibility of ensuring the high standards of research and compliance with all applicable university policies and procedures.
- Collective governance of research at the American University of Sharjah (AUS) will be implemented through the University Research Council. The OVCR oversees research units and implements programs that provide the infrastructure and support mechanisms for conducting world-class research while enhancing the scholarly outcomes of the university and promoting and enabling partnerships with external stakeholders in pursuance of Sharjah and UAE needs.
- The functions of the OVCR in support of research excellence are to:
 - Develop, maintain, and implement a policy and operational framework for research activity that is supportive of AUS's mission to raise the research profile and activity of the university;
 - Establish centers that are aligned with the needs of Sharjah and the UAE and position the university as a world leader in its chosen research focus domains;
 - Ensure compliance by all research projects with the AUS mission, with relevant AUS policies and procedures, and with the requirements of sponsors or funding agencies;
 - Ensure administrative compliance of AUS research activities regarding conflict of interest, responsible conduct of research, research integrity, export control and research involving human and animal subjects;

- Provide administrative support to faculty members interested in obtaining or bidding for a grant or contract from an external agency, to ensure implementation of awards contractually, to monitor submission of required reports, and to handle part of the administrative communication with the granting agencies;
- Support the Finance Department in the financial management of research awards, including creating projects budgets, issuing awards, and tracking project spending performance;
- Ensure that research laboratory equipment and infrastructure is available, safe, and maintained for use by faculty, students and research staff in their research activities;
- Ensure that research computing resources are available and maintained for use by faculty, students and research staff in their research activities;
- Establish and maintain ties with sponsors and funding agencies; and on a periodic basis, to inform faculty members of funding and consulting opportunities and deadlines;
- Set forth the university's intellectual property policy and inform faculty members and students on intellectual property rights while ensuring the protection of scholarly outcomes and registration of inventions, scientific, or creative works whenever warranted, and commercializing faculty and student intellectual property;
- Provide periodic summary reports to the government, decision makers, and the academic community on the portfolio of research projects conducted, and the scholarly activities and outcomes of the AUS faculty and students; and
- Maintain and update all policies related to research and notify faculty of policies changes.

4. Scope/applicability: This policy and its provisions applies to all research and scholarly activities conducted at AUS.

5. Responsibilities:

- The OVCR is the custodian of this policy. All inquiries and matters relating to the policy will be addressed to the Vice Chancellor for Research.
- All policies and procedures contained in this policy operate in accordance with AUS's Delegation of Authority.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR): The office that oversees AUS centralized research units and activities.
- University Research Council (URC): The most senior research governance body at AUS. It oversees the strategic directions and implementation of research at the university.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- University Research Council Charter

8. Policy history:

The policy history started with the document prepared by the Vice Chancellor for Research on July 16, 2024.

Revision History:

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Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	July 16, 2024	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Research

9. References

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	06 515 2214	research@aus.edu

h. Care and Treatment of Animals Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0400RE09	Policy Title:	Care and Treatment of Animals
Prepared By:	Office of the Research Services	Issue Date:	March 28, 2024
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Care and Treatment of Animals

2. Purpose:

This policy is designed to ensure that tests, experiments, and procedures conducted by researchers on whole living organisms, such as animals, are being carried out in a humane way and according to international best practices. Proof of this will have to be provided through IACUC approval from the institution where the experiments are being conducted. This proof needs to be submitted prior to initiating a contract for the services of the in-vivo lab.

3. Introduction/Background:

It is the policy of American University of Sharjah (AUS) that animals used in research, testing, education, and training deserve a compassionate caring environment.

4. Policy Statement:

American University of Sharjah (AUS) recognizes both a scientific and an ethical responsibility for the humane care of animals. All faculty conducting research involving vertebrate animals must assume responsibility for general animal welfare.

In the absence of animal facilities on site at AUS, such experiments are currently being carried out at academic institutions with animal care facilities. It is the responsibility of the AUS Principal Investigator carrying out the experiments that they obtain the written approval from the Institutional Animal Care and Use Committee (IACUC) at the academic facility where the experiments are being carried out.

Once received, the written IACUC approval will have to be submitted to the Institutional Review Board (IRB) at American University of Sharjah (AUS), who will register the request and its approval. The IRB, at its own discretion, may request that the animal hosting facility provides proof of appropriate animal care and use policies.

If at any given time AUS will have a growing number of experiments with animals and / or a vivarium, the university will institute its own IACUC.

5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to

conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, staff, students, as appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

This policy is shared between faculty and Office of Research Services.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS University Policy No. 10.1 Research Administration

AUS University Policy No. 10.2 Research and Scholarly Misconduct

9. Policy history:

This policy was established in March 2024 to ensure compliance with the MOE standards.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	March 28, 2024	New - Policy is established to ensure compliance with the MOE standards	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Tel: 971 6 5152203	research@aus.edu

5. Faculty and Professional Staff

a. Faculty Role Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0500AP01	Policy Title:	Faculty Role Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre - 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Faculty Roles Policy

2. Introduction / background:

The University is committed to hiring exceptional International Faculty by defining their roles and permissible ranks. This would allow faculty to have more precise expectations for a role and what success looks like in it.

3. Purpose:

The Purpose of this policy is to allow the University to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community. Therefore, the American University of Sharjah employs faculty members in the following roles:

- i. *Rolling-Track Faculty*: Professor, Associate Professor, Assistant Professor, Senior Lecturer, Lecturer, Senior Instructor and Instructor
- ii. *Non-Rolling Track Faculty*: Visiting faculty, Research Fellow, Appointee in Residence, Professor of Practice, Adjunct faculty and Special Contract Faculty
- iii. *Faculty Administrators*: Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Chancellor for Research, Vice-Provost for Graduate Studies, Vice-Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction, Deans, Associate Deans and Department Heads.
- iv. The University also holds the Honor of bestowing current or past faculty members with *Honorary Titles*.

Those appointed to the faculty are expected to observe the professional standards and procedures set forth in the *Faculty Handbook*. Included within these standards is the expectation that all those appointed to the faculty will provide the University with full and accurate information about their credentials, including official transcripts. It is expected that faculty satisfactorily perform their teaching and other duties, including scholarly activities, and service.

4. Policy Statement:

Rolling-Track Faculty Ranks: An essential requirement for appointment as a rolling-track faculty is a commitment to both the advancement of knowledge and the dissemination of scholarly work.

Permissible ranks among the rolling-track faculty are Professor, Associate Professor, Assistant Professor, Senior Lecturer, Lecturer, Senior Instructor and Instructor. The proportion of Lecturers and Senior Lecturers should not exceed 15% of the current faculty in the college/school. The initial appointment at rank should align with the following criteria for each rank:

A.2.a Professor

The rank of Professor is normally attained by promotion from Associate Professor or the equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Professor normally will have had at least five years of full-time academic experience at the rank of Associate Professor or the equivalent. The candidate also will have achieved a record of significant and substantial contributions to the scholarly activities of the field, and will have demonstrated superior teaching ability and strong record of service, based on the terms of the contract.

A.2.b Associate Professor

The rank of Associate Professor is normally attained by promotion from Assistant Professor or the equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Associate Professor normally will have had at least five years of full-time academic experience at the rank of Assistant Professor or equivalent. The candidate also will have demonstrated the capability for scholarly achievement and professional growth, will have demonstrated superior teaching ability and a strong record of service, based on the terms of the contract.

A.2.c Assistant Professor

An appointee to the rank of Assistant Professor normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Assistant Professor normally will have demonstrated potential as an effective teacher as well as dedication to service, or have shown promise of future professional growth in his/her field.

A.2.d Senior Lecturer

The rank of Senior Lecturer is normally attained by promotion from Lecturer or by reappointment from the rank of Associate Professor. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Senior Lecturer normally will have had at least five years of full-time teaching experience in a college or university at the rank of Lecturer, hold the rank of Associate Professor, or have equivalent experience, pursue professional development actively, and show dedication to service.

A.2.e Lecturer

An appointee to the rank of Lecturer normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. A candidate for the rank of Lecturer would normally qualify for the rank of Assistant Professor, having a superior teaching record and dedication to service, pursuing professional development actively, but not meeting the scholarly requirements of the professorial ranks.

A.2.f Senior Instructor

The rank of Senior Instructor is normally attained by promotion from Instructor or equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. The candidate for the rank of Senior Instructor normally will hold a master's degree in a field appropriate to the instructional responsibilities and have completed at least five years of full-time teaching experience in a college or university at the rank of Instructor, or have equivalent experience. The candidate also will have demonstrated effective teaching, professional development, and dedication to service.

A.2.g Instructor

An appointee to the rank of Instructor normally will hold a master's degree in a field appropriate to the instructional responsibilities. Requisite equivalent professional experience may be considered. The candidate also will have demonstrated potential for effective teaching, professional development, and dedication to service.

Duties of a faculty member shall consist of those responsibilities assigned by the Chancellor and/or an appropriate administrator, such as the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Dean, Program Director or Department Head. Teaching assignments, schedules and other instructional responsibilities shall be performed under the direction of the supervising administrator. Normally, duties and responsibilities shall be related to the expertise and competence of the faculty member. Teaching, scholarly activities, and service shall be subject to evaluation by appropriate administrators and shall be considered in performance-based decisions relating to compensation, retention, promotion, termination, and renewal/extension.

a. Teaching

Responsibility as a Teacher

The faculty member accepts the obligation to exercise critical self-discipline and judgment in using, extending, and transmitting knowledge and to practice intellectual honesty. Faculty are entitled to freedom in the classroom in discussing their subject, but they should be careful not to introduce into their teaching inappropriate matter or matter which has no relation to the subject. As teachers, faculty members are responsible for the following:

- i. to be engaged in the education of undergraduate, graduate and professional students, as appropriate to the mission of each college/school and/or department
- ii. to conduct each course they have been assigned to teach in general conformity with the content, format, and official description of such course as established by the faculty of the academic unit and approved by the Dean and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
- iii. to meet and conduct classes and final exams as well as final projects evaluation at all regularly scheduled times and places. The pertinent administrators or a duly appointed representative may authorize a member of the faculty to be absent from classes or to reschedule the work for reasons of health or when in the best interests of the University
- iv. to develop in students the free pursuit of learning
- v. to strive to obtain and transfer the best scholarly standards of the discipline
- vi. to demonstrate respect for students as individuals and their privacy in academic matters
- vii. to adhere to the proper role of intellectual guide and advisor
- viii. to make every reasonable effort to foster honest academic conduct and assure that the evaluation of students reflects their true merit
- ix. to notify as promptly as possible the Head/Director of the unit whenever emergencies such as illness or accident prevent meeting a scheduled class
- x. to commit to discharging duties and responsibilities primarily on the campus of the University and, when necessary, at other sites as appropriate to the mission of each college/school and/or academic unit

Presence

New faculty members are required to be available on campus two weeks prior to the start of Fall semester classes to take part in a formal new faculty orientation program. Faculty members may take a leave of absence for professional development or in an emergency with written authorization from the Department Head and Dean.

Faculty members are expected to be available a minimum of nine hours per week, as stipulated in faculty contracts, for advising and student conferences throughout the semester. Formally scheduled final examinations are to be given only during the time periods officially announced. Except for official leaves of absence, release-time provided by research or administrative appointments, special ad-hoc arrangements that permit teaching to be concentrated in one term during a particular academic year, or other official exemptions, faculty are expected to participate fully in the teaching program during each regular term of the academic year.

Teaching Load

Please refer to the Teaching Load Policy.

Undergraduate Academic Activities outside Scheduled Timings

Faculty members are to abide by the published schedule for class meeting times. Any additional required meetings (including lectures, exams, laboratories, studios, presentations, etc.) during day-time hours (8:00 a.m. to 6:00 p.m.) of regular class days are prohibited, and those scheduled for evenings and weekends are discouraged.

If evening or weekend scheduling is unavoidable, advanced approval of the Dean is required. Required academic activities are not allowed to be scheduled on Fridays and University holidays.

It is recognized that occasionally faculty will be absent from regular class meeting time due to conference attendance or personal emergencies. Faculty should attempt to seek assistance from colleagues to conduct classes in their absence. Field trips and site visits are recognized as extended learning experiences held off campus. These activities should be pre-announced and dates included in the syllabus of the course. Students who are unable to meet on Saturdays and/or evenings must inform the faculty member by the end of the add/drop period to consider alternative venues.

Graduate courses are exempt from these guidelines.

Eligibility for Teaching of Graduate Courses

Faculty members are assigned to teach in graduate programs by the Dean or designee of the respective college/school. To be eligible to teach in a graduate program, a faculty member should hold a terminal degree in a field appropriate to the instructional responsibilities. Faculty not holding the terminal degree must meet both the alternative standards established by the appropriate United States-based accreditation organization for professional qualification and the provisions of the latest CAA *Standards for Licensure and Accreditation*. Further, the faculty member must demonstrate evidence of a strong record of, or potential for, research and scholarly activity or have significant professional experience in applied fields as a practitioner and meet any additional specific eligibility requirements established by each college/school.

b. Scholarly Activities

Faculty members at the professorial rank of Assistant Professor and above are expected to conduct scholarly activities and to disseminate the results of such activities in appropriate peer-reviewed venues. They are expected to base their scholarly activities on an honest search for knowledge with due respect to evidence, impartial reasoning and honesty in reporting.

Because of the professional diversity across the four colleges and school of AUS, the University believes the term “scholarly activities,” in this context, must be considered broadly. Therefore, the University defines the term scholarly activity as: scholarship directed toward new discovery, investigations resulting in creative and artistic expressions, the evolution of novel and more effective teaching methodologies and materials, and the integration and application of new methodologies in the profession.

Faculty members must ensure, where possible, that their affiliation with AUS appears on all publications and scholarly work produced while employed by AUS. This requirement also applies to faculty members on sabbatical leave or leave without pay. Scholarly work that is disseminated during the term of employment at AUS without listing the institutional affiliation with AUS may not be considered in contract renewal and/or promotion processes and/or may result in the revocation of research funding if the University sponsored the work.

Intellectual Property: Copyrights and Patents

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The University encourages faculty to protect both the University's and their own interests in intellectual property.

c. Service

All rolling-track faculty members, regardless of rank, are expected to contribute to the administrative work of their respective academic unit and college/school through committee participation. Furthermore, faculty members have the opportunity to serve on the Faculty Senate and its committees as well as on University-wide committees. Faculty members can also serve their profession and the community at large by engaging in activities that facilitate the work of these professional and community organizations. Other service opportunities include institutional development, involvement with students in the total life of the University, and activities that further the University's mission in the public sphere.

Professional Conduct, Ethics, and Conflicts of Interest

Professional Conduct

To ensure a professional and collegial work environment, the principles of this Section on Professional Conduct, Ethics, and Conflicts of Interest apply to all faculty members. Faculty must subscribe to high standards of conduct, which include honesty, integrity, and ethical behavior. Membership in the academic community imposes on students, faculty members, and administrators an obligation to respect the dignity of others, to acknowledge their right to express differing opinions, and to foster and defend intellectual honesty, freedom of inquiry and instruction, and free expression.

Professional Ethics

AUS recognizes and supports the principle that faculty members who speak or write as private citizens should be free from institutional censorship or discipline. However, a faculty member's special position in the community imposes particular obligations and serious responsibilities regarding conduct and behavior and requires faculty members to act in the best interests of the profession and the institution.

Academic Ethics and Responsibility

For faculty members the notion of academic freedom is linked to the equally demanding concept of academic ethics and responsibility. As a faculty member, a person assumes certain ethical obligations and responsibilities to students, to fellow faculty members, to the institution, to the profession, and to society at large. Some of these responsibilities are listed below.

Faculty members have ethical obligations and responsibilities to the students of AUS

- i. Faculty members shall foster scholarly values in students, including academic honesty, the free pursuit of learning, and the exercise of academic freedom.
- ii. Faculty members shall act professionally in their academic relationships with students.
- iii. Faculty members shall exercise critical self-discipline and judgment in using, extending, and transmitting knowledge.
- iv. Faculty members are entitled to freedom in the classroom in discussing their subject, but they should be careful not to introduce into teaching inappropriate matters that have no relation to their subject.
- v. Faculty members must maintain respect for students as individuals, within their role as intellectual guides and counselors.
- vi. Faculty members must assure that evaluations of students reflect true merit. Faculty members must avoid taking any action that would compromise the honesty and equity of the evaluations.

- vii. Faculty members shall be available at reasonable intervals to students for consultation on course work through posted office hours.
- viii. Faculty members shall duly acknowledge the contribution of students to their scholarship and research.
- ix. Faculty members shall not engage in any exploitation, harassment, or discriminatory treatment of students.
- x. Counseling of students on non-academic issues should be professional, confidential and within the capabilities of the professor. Students who have serious and sensitive matters, especially if they are related to a specific culture, religion or custom, should be referred to professional counselors available in Student Services.

Faculty members have ethical obligations and responsibilities to other members of the University community

- i. Faculty members shall not engage in any exploitation, harassment, or discriminatory treatment of any members of the University community.
- ii. Faculty members shall acknowledge the academic contributions of others, and strive to be objective in their professional judgment of colleagues. Clearances must be obtained from the relevant persons or individuals when appropriate to the norms of the discipline, and digital and archival material must be used in accordance with the rules of the source.
- iii. Faculty members who are in a supervisory position shall abide by the rules and policies of the current AUS HR (Human Resources) Policy Manual.

Faculty members have ethical obligations and responsibilities to AUS as an Institution

- i. In determining the amount (if any) and character of work done outside of the institution, faculty members shall recognize that their primary responsibilities are to the institution. Such outside work shall be consistent with University regulations. Faculty members may follow subsidiary interests, but these must be revealed to the institution and must never compromise their freedom and willingness to draw intellectually honest conclusions.
- ii. When considering the interruption or termination of their service, faculty members shall take into account the effect of their decision upon the institution and give notice of their intentions as per their contract.
- iii. Faculty members shall accept their share of faculty responsibilities for contributing to the governance of the institution.

Faculty members have ethical obligations and responsibilities to their profession

- i. The fundamental responsibilities of a faculty member as a teacher and scholar include:
 - a. maintenance of competence in one's field of specialization, including appearances in the public arena such as discussions, lectures, consulting, publications and/or participation in professional organizations and meetings,
 - b. exhibition of such professional competence in the classroom, studio, library or laboratory, and
 - c. fostering honest academic conduct as specified in the University regulations.
- ii. The demonstration of professional integrity by a faculty member includes recognition that society at large will judge the profession as well as the institution by his/her statements and behavior. Therefore, the faculty member should strive to be accurate, to exercise appropriate restraint, and to be willing to listen to and show respect to members of the society at large expressing different opinions. Faculty members should make every effort to indicate that they are not speaking or acting for the college/school or the University when speaking or acting as a private person.
- iii. Scholarly conduct must avoid fabrications, falsifications, plagiarism and other practices that deviate from accepted scholarly practice.
- iv. Faculty members must apply scholarly rigor and integrity in obtaining, recording and analyzing data as well as in reporting and publishing results.

- v. Faculty members undertaking scholarly activities should do so in a manner consistent with professional honesty and within the public interest. Scholarly activities should be designed to
- vi. enhance knowledge in a particular field of scholarship and should demonstrate sound methodology, accuracy and maintain the factual integrity of the data.
- vii. Faculty members must use funds designated for scholarly activities in the prescribed manner.
- viii. Faculty members must comply with relevant statutes or regulations for the protection and welfare of researchers, human subjects, the public, laboratory animals and the environment.
- ix. It is the duty of faculty members doing scholarly activities, teaching, laboratory/ studio exercises or other activities to protect the privacy of others, to avoid causing mental or physical harm and to promote safe and healthy working practices and environments.

Conflicts of Interest

Each rolling-track faculty member owes primary professional responsibility to the University and must avoid outside obligations, financial interests, or employment that can affect the objectivity of decisions as a member of the University community.

- i. Conflict of interest includes any outside obligations, financial interests, and/or employment that can affect the objectivity of decisions.
- ii. Full-time faculty members owe primary professional responsibility to the University and must avoid conflicts of interest.
- iii. Any potential conflict of interest, financial or otherwise, that might influence a faculty member's decisions when the individual is asked to review manuscripts or applications, test products, conduct scholarly activities, or be permitted to undertake work assisted, supported, or sponsored by outside sources must be revealed to a faculty member's immediate supervisor, sponsors, journals, and funding agencies.
- iv. Full-time faculty members should reveal conflict of interest involving family members, including the hiring or evaluating of a family member as an employee or consultant for any project supported by funds administered through the University.
- v. Full-time faculty members should reveal any conflict of interest involving University purchasing of equipment, supplies, or services from a source in which they or their families have a substantial interest.
- vi. Faculty and their immediate family members may not accept money or in-kind compensations from students for any services provided.

Violations of Rules Pertaining to Professional Conduct, Ethics, and Conflicts of Interest

Serious violations of the rules governing professional conduct, ethics, and conflicts of interest must be reported or referred to the relevant Department Head (HOD) and will trigger an investigation as outlined in this section. If the Department Head is directly involved in the case or there is a demonstrated conflict of interest then the matter is referred to the Dean. Allegations of acts of misconduct that were intentionally and knowingly committed must be proven by a preponderance of evidence.

The investigation of alleged violations amounting to professional misconduct, serious ethical violations, and serious unreported conflicts of interest must be carried in a manner that minimizes the risk to the reputation of the accused faculty member, and must be carried out according to strict standards of confidentiality.

In cases of serious violations of the rules governing professional conduct, ethics, and conflicts of interest, sanctions may include one or more of the following disciplinary actions:

- i. Formal written reprimand to be included in the faculty personnel file.
- ii. Reporting offender to external funding organization or to the client to whom consulting and/or outreach activities were provided.
- iii. Cancellation of internal grant proposal and ban from submission to any type of internal

- grants and sabbatical for two years.
- iv. Reimbursement of full amount granted if proposal is already approved and funds disbursed.
- v. Suspension of merit increase for a period of one to three years.
- vi. Forfeiture of salary, benefits and indemnity payment for faculty members in their terminal year of employment.
- vii. Non-renewal of term contract or suspension of rolling contract with a grace period of two years with the possibility to reapply at the beginning of second year.
- viii. Dismissal from the institution for adequate cause with effect at the end of the academic semester or year.
- ix. Immediate dismissal from the institution for adequate cause. If the accused faculty member can demonstrate the occurrence of procedural or factual errors in the case, then he/she may seek a remedy in accordance with the Grievance Code outlined in Chapter I. of the Faculty Handbook.

Formation of the Review Panel

The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost establishes the three-person Review Panel in consultation with the Senate Executive Committee (SEC) from the eligible pool of faculty members. The eligible pool of faculty members shall consist of all faculty members who have at least two years of service at the American University of Sharjah. Administrators, including the Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Provosts, Deans, Associate Deans, Directors and Department Heads, may not serve on the Review Panel.

The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and SEC must exercise due diligence that appointees are free of reasonable perceived bias or conflict of interest. The Review Panel will include one member from the school/college of the faculty member accused of the violation and two members from outside the accused faculty member's school/college.

Mandate of the Review Panel

The Review Panel shall investigate the allegations, shall interview the accuser and the accused, and may interview others. Following its investigations, it shall submit a comprehensive written report clearly stating whether it finds the allegations substantiated by a preponderance of evidence or unsubstantiated to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Dean, Department Head, and the accused faculty member. The report must describe:

- i. the allegations investigated;
- ii. how the investigation was conducted;
- iii. how and from whom information was obtained; and
- iv. the findings and their basis.

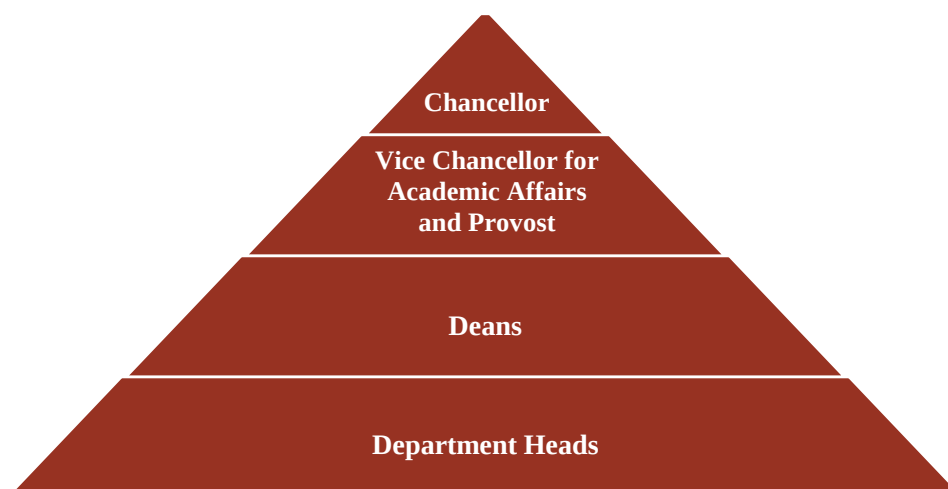
The report must also include texts or summaries of the interviews and hearings, if any conducted by the Review Panel. If the Review Panel determines that the allegations are proven by a preponderance of evidence, it must include in its report a recommendation about the appropriate sanction. If the Review Panel concludes that the allegations are unsupported and maliciously motivated, it may recommend appropriate disciplinary against those responsible for the accusation.

If the Review Panel cannot reach consensus regarding whether the allegations are substantiated by a preponderance of evidence or unsubstantiated, its report must include detailed explanation of the arguments of the majority and minority opinions. In that case, the report must not identify the names of the majority or minority members, and the members of the Review Panel should not disclose that information to anyone.

Unless the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, for good cause, extends the deadline for completion of the Review Panel's report, the latter must be submitted within four calendar weeks after the Review Panel's first organizational meeting.

5. Responsibilities:

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty role selection and ranks.



6. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, staff, students, as appropriate).

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- CAA: Commission for Academic Accreditation of the Ministry of Education of the UAE
- SEC: Senate Executive Committee
- HOD: Head of Department
- HR: Human Resources

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook: The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL: <https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	Changes were implemented after the approved review process	Provost's Office
2.0	November 23, 2020	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Changes as per the January 29, 2023 Faculty Handbook	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and

			Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

b. Faculty Employment and Appointment Policy – Version 6

Policy Number:	0500AP02	Policy Title:	Faculty Employment and Appointment Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

The University is fully committed to equal opportunity at all levels without discrimination on the basis of race, gender, religion, age, family status, or national origin.

In addition, discrimination is prohibited on any other basis prohibited by law that applies to the faculty member's employment at the University. As a university formed on American models, AUS will give priority to candidates who have substantial experience in American models of higher education.

2. Purpose:

This Policy aims at ensuring that a fair and equal opportunity faculty employment process is implemented and that candidates are selected and employed as per the standards identified by the University.

3. Introduction/ Background:

This policy is imbedded in the Faculty Handbook.

4. Policy Statement:

A.3 *Search and Appointment of Rolling-Track Faculty*

The University is fully committed to equal opportunity at all levels without discrimination on the basis of race, gender, religion, age, family status, or national origin. In addition, discrimination is prohibited on any other basis prohibited by law that applies to the faculty member's employment at the University. As a university formed on American models, AUS will give priority to candidates who have substantial experience in American models of higher education.

A.3.a *Initiation of Search*

Based on demonstrated need of a unit's academic program, the Dean, after receiving approval from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, initiates the search for a new faculty member.

A.3.b *Search Committee*

A thorough search and careful selection precedes any recommendation of appointment from any academic unit (describes department/program). The length and complexity of this process depends upon the nature of the appointment.

A.3.c *Appointment*

All appointments to faculty ranks are made by the Chancellor on the recommendation of a college, school, department or other appropriate academic or administrative unit with the concurrence of

the appropriate Dean and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. The University does not normally promote faculty at the time of initial appointment. Notification of appointment is made by letter from the Chancellor.

This letter of appointment specifies:

- i. academic unit
- ii. rank
- iii. salary and related financial conditions
- iv. benefits
- v. length and type of contract

Previous correspondence between the Department Head or the Dean and the prospective faculty member concerning these matters is unofficial and not binding on the University.

A.3.d Acceptance of Appointment

The signed contract constitutes the terms of employment. All employment is subject to satisfying the conditions for a UAE residency and work visa.

A.3.e Joint Appointments

A faculty member holds a joint academic appointment if he/she holds instructional, research, and/or service responsibilities in two or more units (describes college/school). Faculty members with and without a joint appointment should be treated equally. Unless otherwise specified, the current AUS policies, principles, practices, and guidelines apply to all faculty with joint appointments.

The principles stated primarily address joint academic appointments that cross two or more different schools, colleges, institutes, and centers. However, the principles are also applicable to other situations such as, when a joint appointment crosses two (or more) departments within a single school or college.

For a faculty position that is jointly appointed in two or more units, one unit will be designated as the primary unit and the other(s) will be referred to as the secondary unit(s). The primary unit with which the faculty member will be affiliated, will handle and process all matters of promotion, salary raises, and rolling contracts, as needed. The primary unit is responsible for the faculty member's total compensation.

The primary unit is responsible for managing administrative issues and processes (e.g., leaves, benefits) for individuals with joint appointments, unless otherwise specified in the agreement at the time of appointment. Rolling is not held in the secondary unit. The secondary unit cannot be converted to primary. If there is non-reappointment in the primary unit, the secondary appointment terminates at the same time.

A.4 Types of Contracts for Rolling-Track Faculty

The academic performance of each faculty member is evaluated annually.

A.4.a Initial Contract

Initial rolling-track faculty appointments are for three years.

A.4.b Second Contract

During the terminal year of the faculty member's initial contract, a careful review is conducted by the Head of Department and the Dean. A recommendation regarding a second three-year contract, based on the outcome of that review, will be communicated to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and to the Chancellor, who will make the final decision. A faculty member who is not recommended for a second three-year contract will be given a terminal year effective the following Fall.

A.4.c Three-Year Rolling Contract

For faculty who are approved for a second three-year contract, an in-depth review in the sixth year determines either the conferral of a three-year rolling contract or a notice of termination of the faculty member contract, effective one year from the following Fall.

Unless otherwise specified in the letter of appointment, a faculty member is entitled to apply for a three-year rolling contract in the sixth year of full-time employment at AUS. An applicant with extensive professional experience in his/her field may be granted up to two years of credit toward eligibility for a three-year rolling contract, which must be specified in the letter of appointment. If a faculty member has an extraordinary academic record, they may be considered for the early award of a three-year rolling contract at any time after the conclusion of the first three-year contract. A candidate who has previously earned tenure at a comparable institution may be considered for a three-year rolling contract at the time of hire.

The three-year rolling contract is mutually acknowledged expectation of continuing employment. A three-year rolling contract is renewable each year based on an annual assessment of the faculty member's performance. If the Dean in consultation with the Department Head (HOD) recommends an in-depth evaluation and the outcome is not positive, the faculty member will complete, at a minimum, the remaining one year of his/her contract prior to the termination.

The three-year rolling contract expires at the date of voluntary retirement or earlier if the faculty member's employment at the University has been terminated for other reasons. If a faculty member on a rolling contract resigns from and later seeks a faculty reappointment at AUS, then the application must be considered per the process in Section A.3. The status of the three-year rolling contract for returning faculty members should be set forth in clear, unequivocal language in the letter of appointment. A returning faculty member away from AUS for five years or more shall be offered a three-year contract.

A.4.d Rolling Contract for Joint Appointments

For individuals with joint appointments, their rolling contract decision should be conducted by their primary unit in collaboration with and/or participation of the secondary units.

The primary unit is responsible for actively coordinating the process and seeking input from the secondary unit(s) and submitting it with the final reports. The agreement at the time of appointment must specify the method that will be used to collaborate and to solicit input from the secondary unit(s). For all evaluations, the weighting of performance criteria should be consistent with the specific expectations articulated in the agreement.

A.5 Non-Rolling Track Faculty Ranks

Permissible ranks among the non-rolling track faculty are: Visiting faculty, Research Fellow, Appointee in Residence, Professor of Practice, Adjunct faculty and Special Contract Faculty.

A.5.a Visiting Faculty

A person who is on leave as a faculty from an accredited college/university or a comparable educational, research, corporate and/or policy institution may be appointed on an annual basis as a Visiting Professor, Visiting Associate Professor, Visiting Assistant Professor, Visiting Senior Lecturer, Visiting Lecturer, Visiting Senior Instructor, or Visiting Instructor. Visiting faculty positions normally are one or two semesters in length. Those faculty members new to the profession may also be appointed to one-year terms as visiting faculty.

Recommendations for reappointment of visiting faculty shall be made annually by the appropriate unit through the Dean to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. A visiting appointment normally is not extended beyond a second year.

Faculty on visiting appointments may apply for rolling-track positions as per the policy and procedure described in Chapter A- Section A.3 (Policy) and Section A.1 (Procedure) related to

the search for a new faculty.

A.5.b Research Fellow

Appointment as Research Fellow requires the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Appointees will have a strong research record of accomplishments in their area of expertise and an ability to contribute to the university's research agenda.

Research Fellow is appointed for one semester or more, not to exceed three years. The appointment may be renewed.

A.5.c Appointee in Residence

An Appointee in Residence will be titled or identified with an appropriate designation, such as Executive, Scholar, Artist, Diplomat, or other descriptive term. An appointee to this rank may or may not hold the terminal degree in the discipline; however, they must possess a record of significant accomplishment in their area of expertise and demonstrate the ability to contribute to advancing the university's mission. Teaching assignments for Appointees in Residence are determined based on qualifications and are made in accordance with discipline-specific terminal degree requirements.

Appointee in Residence contracts are renewable and may either be short term for a portion of a semester, or range from one semester to a maximum of three years. The Appointee in Residence is not eligible for a rolling contract.

A.5.d Professor of Practice

An appointee to Professor of Practice holds the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The appointee will have a strong teaching ability to engage in instruction of professional students with emphasis on the development of practical skills.

Contracts for Professor of Practice are renewable and may range from one semester to three years. A Professor of Practice is not eligible for a rolling contract.

A.5.e Adjunct Faculty

The University makes important use of the service of adjunct faculty in many academic units. Adjunct faculty are identified, employed, reviewed, counseled, encouraged, retained, or terminated as part of a coherent academic plan.

Adjunct faculty members are employed on a part-time basis. A part-time faculty appointment allows an individual to contribute to the instructional program of a college/school on a part-time basis. Persons may serve as adjunct faculty without limit of time through successive appointments on an as-needed basis. These appointments offer none of the employee benefits of a full-time (rolling-track, research, or visiting) faculty appointment. Whereas the conditions of employment and perquisites of employment are not the same as for full-time faculty, all other rules, policies and procedures that relate to teaching responsibilities and professional conduct at AUS apply.

The duties, expectations, and rights of adjunct faculty can be obtained from the appropriate Dean's office. It is the Department Head's responsibility to inform adjunct faculty about the mission and objectives of the department in its relation to the institution, as well as about the conditions (curriculum, general rules, and policies) under which students are taking the course or under which the scholarly activities fulfill the institution's objectives. Toward this end, it is important, wherever possible, for adjunct faculty to receive appropriate unit, college/school and University communications, and to be invited to unit meetings, as well as appropriate public events, seminars, and symposia.

Adjunct faculty within a degree program cannot exceed 25% of the program's faculty team. This includes adjunct faculty remotely teaching online and blended learning courses.

A.5.f Special Contract Faculty

A special contract faculty appointment allows an individual possessing special skills or knowledge needed to complete a particular curriculum to contribute to the instructional program of a college/school on a part-time basis. Special contract appointments are made at the rank of Professor, Associate Professor, Assistant Professor, Senior Lecturer, Lecturer, Senior Instructor, and Instructor. The terms, conditions and limitations of such appointments are at the discretion of the appropriate Dean(s) and Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Such an appointment may be renewed annually.

A.6 Search and Appointment for Non-Rolling Track Faculty

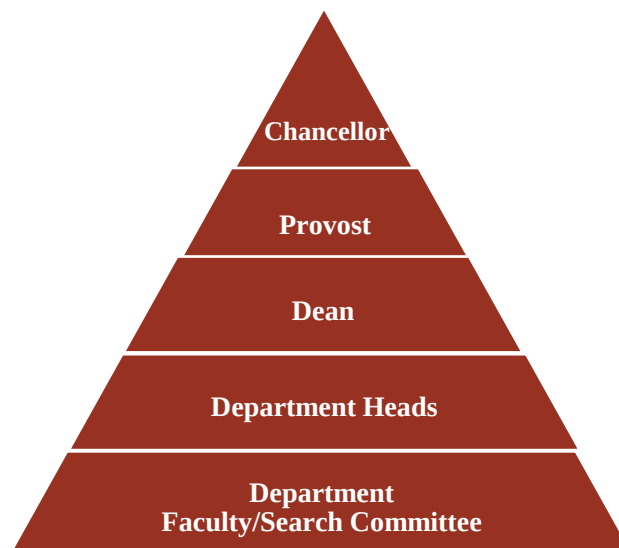
A.6.a Visiting and Other Hiring

Appointments to these kinds of positions are made through recommendations to the Dean from the Department Head. Visiting faculty are normally hired for up to one year.

A.6.b Emergency Hiring

When a vacancy occurs outside the normal recruiting/hiring time-frame, the Dean may petition the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost to conduct an emergency hire.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty selection and Appointment.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, staff, students, as appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

The Head of the academic unit shall consult with the faculty of the academic unit about the needs of the program, providing faculty full opportunity to help define the qualifications and to formulate the description of the position. The Dean, in consultation with the academic unit faculty shall appoint a search committee appropriate to the position to be filled. The Head of the academic unit shall be a member of the search committee.

The search committee will submit to the Dean a shortlist of a minimum of three candidates, if possible, including a rationale for the recommendations. The Dean, in consultation with the search committee, will submit a recommendation for appointment to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

HOD: Head of Department

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources

Faculty Handbook: The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL: <https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	October 26, 2019	Edited Policy - General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	October 27, 2022	Edited Policy - no updates	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	May 2023	Edited Policy - changes are based on the Faculty Handbook of January 29, 2023	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	April 25, 2024	Edited Policy - changes are based on the Faculty Handbook of June 2023, adjunct faculty percentage per department has been added to ensure compliance with the MOE standards	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
6.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
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Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu
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c. Compensation and Benefits Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0500ES03	Policy Title:	Compensation and Benefits
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre - 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Compensation and Benefits

2. Purpose:

The AUS Compensation and Benefit Program is designed to provide AUS employees and their dependents a comprehensive total compensation package to attract and retain quality faculty and staff.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement:

Recruiting and retaining top academic and staff talent is crucial to AUS' growth and success against competitors in the Gulf region. This is accomplished by providing, among other means, competitive salaries and meaningful benefits as outlined in this policy.

Compensation

AUS participates in annual salary surveys with other institutions and organizations in the Gulf region. The results of these surveys and other salary indicators are used to provide competitive salaries to employees. Additionally, as budget resources allow, annual increments are provided to help reduce the impact of inflation on wages and to reward performance.

Benefits

AUS offers a comprehensive benefit program in support of our faculty, staff, and their dependents. The following is the core benefit program of AUS.

Self-Directed Benefits

Faculty and staff may select one of two options listed below under the Self-Directed Benefit Program. The cash portion of the allowance is applied to the health and life insurance premiums and/or the cost of flight tickets at the request of the employee. Each October, any remaining funds in this allowance are encased and paid to the employee.

Option A

All full-time faculty and eligible staff (grade 10+) are eligible for this option which includes 25% of annual basic pay plus undergraduate tuition remission for two (2) dependent children attending AUS.

Option B

The full-time faculty and eligible staff (grade 10+) would receive a fixed allocation of \$14,935 plus school tuition fees for up to two children of AED 30,900 for primary school (KG2 - grade 8), AED 41,200 for secondary school (grade 9 - grade 12) and up to 50% of the net tuition fee after any discount for additional children in school up to a maximum of AED 20K per child. In addition, the employee would be eligible for undergraduate tuition remission for one dependent child attending AUS

Health Insurance

AUS has contracted with a local insurance company to provide all AUS employees and their dependents with quality and affordable medical insurance coverage.

Group Life and Accidental Death Insurance

AUS has group life coverage which is optional to all full-time faculty and mandatory for all full-time staff. The insured amount is two times the employee's annual base salary for natural death and four times the annual base salary for accidental death. Permanent and temporary disability is also covered.

Housing & Housing Allowance

Faculty are offered housing on campus based on family size. Employees who are not eligible for campus housing and who are otherwise entitled will receive a housing allowance. The annual housing allowance amount is 45 percent of an employee's annual base salary for grades 1–6, 40 percent of an employee's annual base salary for grades 7–9 and 35 percent of an employee's annual base salary for grades 10 and above. The annual housing allowance is normally paid in 12 monthly installments.

All employees who are receiving a housing allowance and who can produce supporting documents may apply to receive an interest-free advance to pay their accommodation lease, subject to the maximum of AED 75,000. The advance amount will be determined by the following: the lesser of the installment amount mentioned in the tenancy contract or the housing allowance for the period, which the installment amount covers.

Indemnity Payment Non-U.A. E Nationals

In lieu of an end of service gratuity, AUS makes an indemnity payment to the employee as outlined by the two options below.

Option 1

Payment will be made via the monthly payroll in the month of the employee's anniversary date. The amount of the indemnity payment will be equal to 10 percent of the employee's annual base salary.

Option 2

Payment will be made at the end of the employee's tenure. The amount paid out will be equivalent to 10 per cent of the employees monthly basic salary valid for each of the years covered by employment from the last date the indemnity was paid (if applicable) until the last date of employment at AUS.

U.A.E. Nationals

For U.A.E nationals, in lieu of the annual indemnity, AUS will make monthly payments into the U.A.E Pension Plan on your behalf. Monthly employee contributions will be made via payroll deductions. AUS's monthly payment will be presented to the Pension Authority each month and will be inclusive of both your contributions (5%) and AUS's contributions (15%).

5. Scope/applicability:

All AUS employees and their dependents. The actual level of participation in some of the benefits is dependent upon salary grade or marital status and plan provisions. The employee declaration form, which must be completed by all AUS employees, will also assist HR in aligning benefits to match the needs of our employees and maximize their utilization.

6. Responsibilities:

Human Resources is responsible for recommending to leadership and the Board of Trustees the benefit design and salary ranges for staff. The Office of the VCAA and Provost is responsible for establishing faculty pay rates.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Staff Handbook: Policy 30.11 AUS Self Directed Employee Benefits Plan Staff Handbook: Policy 40.0 Compensation
Staff Handbook: Policy 50.0 Employee Benefits

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	May, 2023	Merit Increase for Faculty	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

d. Faculty Leaves of Absence Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0500AP04	Policy Title:	Faculty Leaves of Absence Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

This policy includes the following Faculty Leaves of Absence:

1. Leave without Pay
2. Parental Leave (Maternity Leave and Paternity Leave)
3. Sabbatical Leave
4. Extended Medical Leave

2. Purpose:

This policy describes the policy applicable to all faculty who would like to apply for Leave.

3. Introduction/ Background:

The term “leave” is used to denote a period of time during which the faculty member does not have obligations to the university in terms of teaching or service; an expectation of scholarly activity may continue, depending upon the type of leave. For some leaves, the University continues to provide salary and benefits. For other leaves, the University does not provide salary continuation or benefits; the latter are referred to as Leaves without Pay (LWOP). If a faculty member has external insurance of any kind, he/she should consult his/her medical insurance contract to determine coverage during a leave without pay.

There are three named leaves that provide some level of continuation of salary and benefits:

- i. Sabbatical Leave
- ii. Parental Leave (Maternity and Paternity Leaves)
- iii. Extended Medical Leave

An additional leave program, Leave without Pay, does not provide continuation of salary and benefits, but does provide for return to the position held by the faculty member upon completion of the approved leave.

4. Policy Statement:

Sabbatical Leave:

Through sabbatical leaves, the University provides faculty members with opportunities to enhance their teaching, scholarly activity, and service. The release from normally assigned duties is granted with the expectation that faculty members will utilize their leave for scholarly endeavors of an academic, artistic, or professional nature. These activities should enhance their careers and their ability to contribute to the work of the University.

Eligibility and Duration

Sabbatical leave should be regarded not as a right, but as a privilege competitively awarded on the basis of the merit of proposals. Only faculty members on rolling contracts are eligible to apply for sabbatical leave. Sabbatical leave may be granted as follows:

- i. one semester at full pay;
or
- ii. two semesters at 50% of the annual pay

Applications for sabbatical leave may be made only for the academic year subsequent to the academic year in which the application is submitted.

Faculty members may submit applications either:

- i. during or after the sixth year of credited service from the date of appointment;
or
- ii. during or after the sixth year of credited service following a previous sabbatical leave

Budget and Number of Sabbatical Leaves

To the extent possible, the University shall announce early in each academic year the allocated sabbatical leave budget for the subsequent academic year.

The University Sabbatical Leave Committee

The Chancellor shall, in consultation with the President of the Faculty Senate, designate a University Sabbatical Leave Committee to review the applications for sabbatical leave and submit recommendations for awards.

Remuneration and Benefits

Faculty members granted sabbatical leave remain eligible for benefits to which they are entitled when in regular employment status. However, faculty members approved for sabbatical leave must, as a condition of the leave, inform the University of any remuneration and other payments to be received during the sabbatical leave period. The University reserves the right to offset remuneration and other payments received from non-University sources against corresponding payments from the University to the extent that the corresponding non-University and University payments would otherwise exceed the normal remuneration and other payments the faculty member would have received from the University.

The period of any leave without pay shall not be counted as years of credited services for purposes of sabbatical leave applications.

Return from Sabbatical Leave

Faculty members, upon applying for sabbatical leave, must acknowledge in writing their obligation to return to the University following the leave period and to serve the University for a period not less than one academic year. The University reserves the right to withhold any payments or benefits to which a faculty member would otherwise be entitled should he or she leave the University within one year of return from sabbatical leave.

Leave Without Pay

Leave without pay may be granted to rolling-track faculty members for a maximum of one academic year. A leave request must include details for the reasons for requesting a leave and assurances that the faculty member intends to return to the University following the leave. The policy is expressly intended to provide faculty members an opportunity to take care of personal and family circumstances or to take advantage of professional opportunities for development away from the University. Under extraordinary circumstances, a leave without pay may be extended when there is a clear and compelling reason to do so.

Applications for leave without pay must be submitted in writing to the Dean through the Department Head. If the Department Head and Dean approve the request, it is submitted to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost for final action.

The faculty member is withdrawn from the benefits plan offered by the University while on leave without pay. If a faculty member has external insurance of any kind, he/she should consult his/her medical insurance contract to determine coverage during a leave without pay.

The University's contractual terms of employment with a faculty with regard to a rolling contract or promotion may be placed in abeyance for the period of the leave without pay. A request to the University to "stop the clock" should be filed in writing at the time when the leave without pay is requested and needs to be confirmed upon approval. Years on leave without pay do not count towards eligibility for sabbatical.

Faculty members on leave without pay will retain their housing unit subject to availability as determined by the Director of the Operations Department in consultation with the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Faculty who wish to retain their housing unit while on leave must indicate this request in writing when applying for leave.

Parental Leave

The University recognizes the importance of supporting faculty as they balance career and family life and acknowledges the benefits that accrue to the University in recognition of this support. This policy provides income continuation for faculty members during time off to care for a newborn child. There is a maximum of one parental leave, per faculty, per year. Retention of position, salary, and benefits for faculty will continue during the maternity/paternity leave period. Health insurance premiums must continue to be paid by the faculty member to avoid lapse of coverage. In some circumstances, and if feasible, a part-time workload may be arranged.

Faculty members must use (in order): parental leave, then vacation (for those who accrue vacation days). Additional leave will be leave without pay.

To be eligible for parental leave an individual must have completed at least one year as a full-time faculty member prior to beginning parental leave. Paid leave is applicable only to the parent(s) of a newborn child. The maternity/paternity leave policy for faculty provides for one semester leave with pay for the birth mother, and a total of two calendar weeks paid leave for the father.¹ The leave period for the mother is to be taken during the semester in which delivery is expected to take place. If that time is between Fall and Spring semesters, the faculty member has the choice of which semester she will be on leave.

The faculty member should notify his/her Departmental Head as far in advance as possible of any paternity or maternity leave. The faculty member should request the parental leave in writing, specifying the semester of leave. There will be no teaching expectations of the birth mother during maternity leave. The birth mother may participate in department, college/school, and University governance during maternity leave, but such participation is not required. Expectations for scholarly activity during maternity leave are suspended.

The University will bear the cost of providing replacement faculty for the semester that the faculty member is on maternity leave.

Extensions of further unpaid leave under this policy must be granted by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. If a faculty member has external insurance of any kind, he/she should consult his/her medical insurance contract to determine coverage during a leave without pay.

The University's contractual terms of employment with a faculty member with regard to a rolling contract or promotion may be placed in abeyance for the period of maternity leave and/or subsequent leave without pay. A request to the University to "stop the clock" should be filed in writing at the time when the parental leave is requested and needs to be confirmed on the approval.

A decision to stop the clock will not otherwise affect the evaluation standards of contract or promotion determinations by the evaluating parties.

Final decisions regarding eligibility, administration and any questions regarding the policy rest with the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Extended Medical Leave

The University recognizes that medical leave beyond the University's regular sick leave (for those who accrue sick leave) may be necessary in extenuating circumstances. This policy provides benefits while the faculty member is recovering from illness or injury. The University recognizes that retention of faculty is mutually beneficial, and that implementation of this policy serves both parties.

EML provides income continuation due to non-work related illness or injury of the Faculty. It is in addition to any sabbatical leave to which a faculty member may be entitled. Occupational-related illness or injury is covered by the University Occupational Illness/Injury Leave Policy²

A faculty member's position, pay, and benefits will continue during the EML benefit period. Pay under the policy is at full pay for a maximum of six months. Applicable health insurance premiums must continue to be paid by the faculty member to avoid lapse of insurance coverage.

The Dean and the Department Head will work with faculty to determine how best to cover the responsibilities of a faculty member on EML.

To be eligible for EML, the faculty member must have been a full-time faculty member at AUS for one year or more. A physician's certificate is required supporting the faculty member's inability to perform job duties. In some cases, a second opinion may be required (by the faculty member or by AUS).

Maximum leave under the EML policy is six months per occurrence. EML leave may be combined with other leave, e.g. annual leave (for those who accrue annual leave) to extend beyond six months. In the event EML leave extends beyond six months, the faculty member may apply to take LWOP. LWOP may be granted only on the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. If a faculty member has external insurance of any kind, he/she should consult his/her medical insurance contract to determine coverage during LWOP.

The University's contractual terms of employment with a faculty member with regard to a rolling contract or promotion may be placed in abeyance for a period of one year for a faculty member on EML. A request to the University to "stop the clock" should be filed with the Department Head as soon as possible after the faculty member determines to take a EML, but under no circumstances later than the end of semester during which extended medical leave is to be taken.

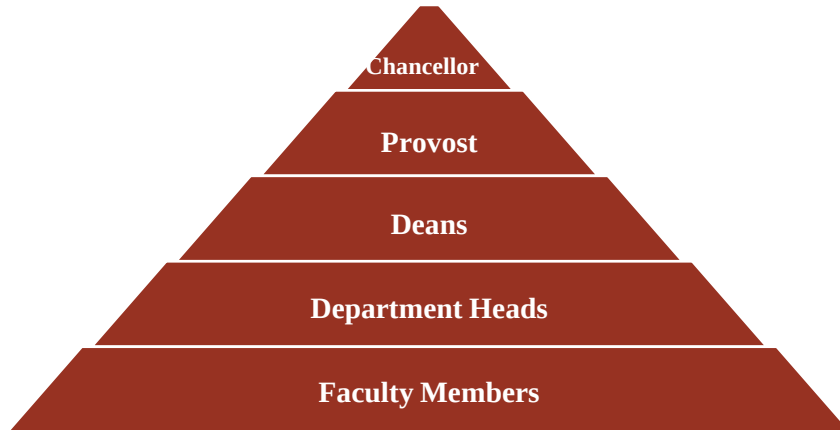
A decision to defer will not otherwise affect the evaluation standards of contract or promotion determinations by the evaluating parties.

The faculty member must submit the proper application requesting EML, if physically possible. The faculty member may apply to take LWOP if he/she is unable to return to work at end of the EML period. Otherwise, the faculty member may request long-term disability benefits if he/she is unable to

return to work at end of the EML period.

Final decisions regarding eligibility, administration and any questions regarding the policy rest with the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty selection and Appointment.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its responsibility towards its faculty members. This policy affects all rolling-track faculty.

6. Responsibilities:

The faculty is responsible to know the policy and follow the procedures associated with each leave policy. The Department Heads and Deans are responsibility for the well-being of the faculty member in regards to the leave applications as well as the well-being of the department and College/School. The final decision for all leaves rest with the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost except for the Sabbatical leave, which needs the final approval of the Chancellor.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

HOD: Department Head

LWOP: Leave Without Pay

EML: Extended Medical Leave

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources

Faculty Handbook: The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL: <https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
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1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised, no updates	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

e. Faculty/Staff Personnel Records Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES05	Policy Title:	Faculty and Staff Personnel Records
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Faculty and Staff Personnel Records

2. Purpose:

Emphasize to all AUS administrators the importance of confidentiality in handling employee information and guidelines for handling such information.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

In collecting, maintaining, and disclosing employee information, AUS strives to protect employees' privacy rights and interests and prevent inappropriate or unnecessary disclosures of information from any person's file or record.

4. Policy Statement:

All administrative employees are expected to treat personal information about employees as confidential and respect the need for protecting each employee's privacy by enforcing secure information handling procedures on the part of all employees whose job duties involve gathering, retaining, using, or releasing personal information about the organization's employees. AUS Human Resources collects and retains only such personal information, as it needs to effectively conduct business and administer its employment and benefit programs. Human Resources takes reasonable steps to make sure that all personal and job-related information about employees is accurate, complete, and relevant for its intended purpose. Wherever possible, Human Resources notifies affected employees if it needs additional personal information and gives these employees an opportunity to supply the requested data.

All paper-based documents relating to AUS' employee record system are kept in securely locked files within Human Resources. These files are accessible only to authorized Human Resources staff and executives, managers, and supervisors who have a valid, demonstrable need to obtain specific information from an employee's employee file. When a request for information from an employee's file, made by a manager, supervisor or other authorized employee of AUS, is received by Human Resources and viewed as possibly intruding on the employee's privacy, access maybe denied.

All employees can review the information contained in their own file, although AUS reserves the right to remove certain sensitive documents, including letters of reference and management planning documents such as succession or promotion plans. To prevent abuses of this access privilege, AUS also reserves the right to limit the number of times an employee can access his/her file during a twelve-month period. Employees who are interested in reviewing the contents of their employee file should contact the Human Resources and provide at least two days' notice of their desire to schedule a mutually convenient time for an appointment. Files cannot leave the Human Resources Department and must be reviewed in the presence of a Human Resources representative.

On occasion, AUS must provide information and data from its employee records and files to local

government in accordance with record keeping and reporting requirements imposed by such agencies.

All medical information relating to an employee is kept in the separate Medical Records System files maintained by the University Health Services. Access to these medical files is tightly controlled.

Faculty and staff can request correction or deletion of information in their personnel records as appropriate by submitting a written request to the Executive Director of Employee Services. The Executive Director of Employee Services ordinarily checks with the head of the department where the record originated. Within fourteen (14) calendar days of receipt of a written request to amend a record, the Executive Director of Employee Services notifies the employee in writing that the amendment will be made as requested, or that the amendment request has been denied. A copy of the request and response(s) shall be placed in the personnel file.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the personal and medical files of all faculty and staff employed by AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Human Resources is the designated steward of faculty and staff personnel files which document the faculty and staff member's terms and conditions of employment.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2021	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10. References:

Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu
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f. Professional Development for Staff and Faculty Policy

This policy covers the professional development of both Staff and Faculty:

1. Professional Development for Faculty – Version 4
2. Professional Development for Staff – Version 2

1. Professional Development for Faculty – Version 4

Policy Number:	0500AP06	Policy Title:	Professional Development for Faculty
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Faculty members at AUS should be kept informed of developments and innovative teaching methods in their fields. The University provides in-service training and travel funds to assist faculty in attending important professional and industrial conferences and encourages faculty to take advantage of these professional development opportunities. Provisions for faculty development are contingent upon the financial conditions and constraints of the University.

2. Purpose:

AUS requires its faculty to always develop and innovate through its policies and initiatives and provides an environment that encourages the pursuit of professional development.

3. Introduction/Background:

Not applicable

4. Policy Statement:

Faculty Conference Grant Program

Dissemination of scholarly work of faculty through appropriate peer-reviewed channels is essential to recognizing quality of work. Contingent upon availability of funds, other resources, and subject to competition the University will provide funds for travel to professional meetings, conferences, and seminars where faculty members are presenting results of their scholarly activities. The grants cover expenses associated with faculty travel and conference registration fees up to a specified maximum. A faculty member may normally receive only one such grant in any given academic year. However, a faculty member may seek reimbursement for costs of attending one or more additional conferences if conference grant funds remain available at the end of the fiscal year; the same reimbursement limitations apply.

Written requests for conference grants are reviewed and awarded at the academic unit and college/school levels. The program is competitive and each grant request must include information

regarding relevance of the conference to the faculty member's professional development as specified by the Office of the Dean.

Faculty Scholarly Activities Grant Program

The University's motivation for allocating grant funds includes recognition of the following: (a) the institution must support professional development and continuing growth in a systematic way; (b) the institutional reputation and quality of teaching and scholarly activities requires a strong and forward-looking faculty; (c) the institution, to remain competitive, must continue to support efforts to refine and improve scholarly activities and teaching in order to provide students with the best possible education; (d) in as much as research productivity is one of the areas of evaluation for contract renewal/extension and promotion, the institution offers financial support to help its faculty remain productive.

Types of Grants

AUS offers two programs to support faculty scholarly activities: the Seed Grant and the Faculty Research Grant.

The Seed Grant

The purpose of the Seed Grant is to support faculty endeavors in developing pilot projects and/or preliminary data necessary to position themselves for garnering competitive internal and/or external funding.

Eligibility

Full-time faculty at the rank of assistant, associate and full professors are eligible for a Seed Grant (faculty who were hired on temporary, visiting contracts shall be eligible in their first year of rolling-track employment).

Seed grants are only awarded during the first two regular semesters of full-time employment.

The Faculty Research Grant

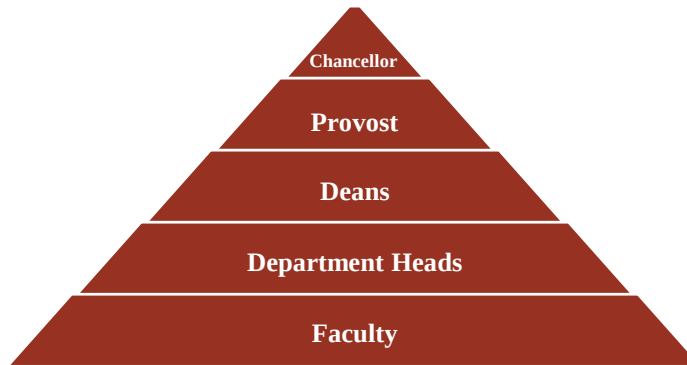
The purpose of the Faculty Research Grant is:

- a. to support development of the scholarly activity program at AUS;
- b. to stimulate external research support, including support in developing pilot projects and preliminary data necessary to prepare competitive proposals;
- c. to assist faculty conducting exemplary scholarly activity in fields where external funding is currently limited; and
- d. to complement scholarly activity programs elsewhere in the University.

Eligibility

All regular faculty members are eligible for a Faculty Research Grant including faculty members who have previously received Seed Grants and Faculty Research Grants.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty grants.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, staff, students, as appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

Faculty development responsibility is shared between faculty and administrators as applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook: The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL: <https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	October 26, 2019	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Editorial Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: 971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

2. Professional Development for Staff Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES07	Policy Title:	Professional Development for Staff Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date Of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Professional Development for Staff Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy is part of the policy on **90.0 Workplace Health Safety and Security**. This policy is available in: [HR Policy Manual](#)

3. Introduction / Background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement:

90.2 SAFETY AND HEALTH TRAINING

Safety and Health Orientation

Workplace safety and health orientation begins on the first day of initial employment or job transfer. Each employee must have access to a copy of the Safety and Enforcement Office manuals through his/her supervisor and be given a personal copy of the safety and health rules, policies and procedures pertaining to his or her job. Copies of the Safety and Enforcement Office manuals are available at [Public Affairs/Safety](#)

Supervisors ask questions of employees and answer employees' questions to ensure knowledge and understanding of safety and health rules, policies and job-specific procedures described in the Safety and Enforcement Office manuals.

90.3 JOB SPECIFIC TRAINING

Supervisors are responsible for:

- Training employees initially on how to perform assigned job tasks safely
- Reviewing carefully with each employee the specific safety and health rules, policies, and procedures that are applicable to their jobs
- Giving employees verbal instruction and specific directions on how to do their work safely
- Observing employees performing the work, and if necessary, providing a demonstration on using safe work practices or ensuring employees receive remedial instruction to correct training deficiencies before they are permitted to perform unsupervised work

- Ensuring all employees receive safe operating instructions on seldom- used or new equipment before using the equipment
- Reviewing safe work practices with employees before permitting the performance of new, no routine, or specialized procedures.

5. Scope/applicability:NA

6. Responsibilities: NA

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: NA

8. Revision History:

Revision of Policy and Procedures Retraining of Employees.

All employees are retrained periodically on safety and health rules, policies, and procedures, and when changes are made to the workplace safety and health manual.

Individual employees are retrained after the occurrence of a work-related injury caused by an unsafe act or work practice, and when a supervisor observes employees engaging in unsafe acts, practices, or behaviors.

This policy includes two additional documents (both added in the appendix):

1. Soft Skills Training Records.
2. Technical Training.

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2013	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Editing and formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

g. Faculty Workload Policy – Version 6

Policy Number:	0500AP08	Policy Title:	Faculty Workload Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Faculty Workload Policy

2. Purpose:

Consistent with the Faculty Handbook (FHB), the policy is to clarify the teaching load for faculty members and faculty administrators at AUS and ensure compliance with the CAA Standards.

3. Introduction/Background:

This Instructional Workload Policy establishes the maximum teaching load for faculty members per academic year (AY) along with a framework to reduce the total teaching load by recognizing i) Research and creative activities; ii) Supervision of student work: PhD dissertations, master's theses, undergraduate students outside regular scheduled courses (such as independent study, Senior Research Projects and Senior Design Projects). Moreover, the policy specifies the teaching workload of faculty administrators whose titles are outlined in the faculty handbook.

4. Policy Statement:

Faculty members:

The maximum teaching load for faculty members whose research and/or creative activity contributions are determined by the Head of Department and Dean to be “*As Expected*” (or better) according to Departmental and College/School criteria, is set at six (6) regularly scheduled course sections per AY (18 SCH per AY). Faculty members demonstrating excellent research or creative activities may be awarded a reduction in their teaching load by no more than 3 SCH (one section) per AY. The maximum teaching load for faculty members *who do not* engage in research or creative activities is set at eight (8) regularly scheduled sections per academic year (AY), which is equivalent to 24 Semester Credit Hours (SCH) per AY. Faculty in professorial ranks cannot teach more than 24 credit hours in an AY including the summer term. If due to extenuating circumstances, a faculty member is assigned to teach more sections than stipulated in the above policy then the faculty member will receive additional monetary compensation as determined by the Council of Deans and approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Supervision of student work such as PhD dissertations, master's theses, undergraduate students outside regular scheduled courses (e.g. independent study, Senior Research Projects and Senior Design Projects) counts towards the teaching load of the faculty member. The credit of the supervision is calculated as specified in the Faculty Workload Procedures

document.

The minimum teaching load per AY is four (4) regularly scheduled course sections. Exceptions to this minimum load maybe allowed with the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

- Faculty administrators:

Faculty administrators receive varying amounts of release time to fulfill their administrative duties during their appointment. The teaching load for Department Heads is specified in the faculty handbook. Teaching loads for Associate Deans and other academic administrators are recommended by the Dean and approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Other administrators, including Deans, are granted full release time from teaching responsibilities.

5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, and relevant administrators).

6. Responsibilities:

Faculty Workload policy is shared between faculty members and faculty administrators.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

SCH: Semester Credit Hour

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL:
<https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

Appendix: Faculty Workload Procedures

9. Policy history:

This policy was developed in 2020 as a requirement from the CAA and in alignment with the Faculty Handbook.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	January 13, 2020	Edited policy - Including PhD supervision and design project in the supervision.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Edited policy - Formatting as per template.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

4.0	December 12, 2023	Edited policy - Included master's thesis supervision in the workload as per CAA requirement. Revised the SCH award.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	April 25, 2024	Edited policy – Added the faculty administrator's workload and teaching overloads - to ensure compliance with the MOE standards.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
6.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: 971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

h. Professional Requirements for Teaching Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0500AP09	Policy Title:	Professional Requirements for Teaching Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Professional Requirements for Teaching Policy.

2. Purpose:

Consistent with the Faculty Handbook (FHB), the policy is to clarify the professional requirements for teaching for faculty members at AUS.

3. Introduction/Background:

This policy is embedded in the Faculty Handbook.

4. Policy Statement:

Rolling-Track Faculty Ranks

An essential requirement for appointment as a rolling-track faculty is a commitment to both the advancement of knowledge and the dissemination of scholarly work. Permissible ranks among the rolling-track faculty are Professor, Associate Professor, Assistant Professor, Senior Lecturer, Lecturer, Senior Instructor and Instructor.

The initial appointment at rank should align with the following criteria for each rank:

Professor

The rank of Professor is normally attained by promotion from Associate Professor or the equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Professor normally will have had at least five years of full-time academic experience at the rank of Associate Professor or the equivalent. The candidate also will have achieved a record of significant and substantial contributions to the scholarly activities of the field, and will have demonstrated superior teaching ability and strong record of service, based on the terms of the contract.

Associate Professor

The rank of Associate Professor is normally attained by promotion from Assistant Professor or the equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Associate Professor normally will have had at least five years of full-time academic experience at the rank of Assistant Professor or

equivalent. The candidate also will have demonstrated the capability for scholarly achievement and professional growth, will have demonstrated superior teaching ability and a strong record of service, based on the terms of the contract.

Assistant Professor

An appointee to the rank of Assistant Professor normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Assistant Professor normally will have demonstrated potential as an effective teacher as well as dedication to service, or have shown promise of future professional growth in his/her field.

Senior Lecturer

The rank of Senior Lecturer is normally attained by promotion from Lecturer or by reappointment from the rank of Associate Professor. An appointee to this rank normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The candidate for the rank of Senior Lecturer normally will have had at least five years of full-time teaching experience in a college or university at the rank of Lecturer, hold the rank of Associate Professor, or have equivalent experience, pursue professional development actively, and show dedication to service.

Lecturer

An appointee to the rank of Lecturer normally will hold the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. A candidate for the rank of Lecturer would normally qualify for the rank of Assistant Professor, having a superior teaching record and dedication to service, pursuing professional development actively, but not meeting the scholarly requirements of the professorial ranks.

Senior Instructor

The rank of Senior Instructor is normally attained by promotion from Instructor or equivalent after a positive evaluation of performance. The candidate for the rank of Senior Instructor normally will hold a master's degree in a field appropriate to the instructional responsibilities and have completed at least five years of full-time teaching experience in a college or university at the rank of Instructor or have equivalent experience. The candidate also will have demonstrated effective teaching, professional development, and dedication to service.

Instructor

An appointee to the rank of Instructor normally will hold a master's degree in a field appropriate to the instructional responsibilities. Requisite equivalent professional experience may be considered. The candidate also will have demonstrated potential for effective teaching, professional development, and dedication to service.

Non-Rolling Track Faculty Ranks

Permissible ranks among the non-rolling track faculty are: Visiting faculty, Research Fellow, Appointee in Residence, Professor of Practice, Adjunct faculty and Special Contract Faculty.

Visiting Faculty

A person who is on leave as a faculty from an accredited college/university or a comparable educational, research, corporate and/or policy institution may be appointed on an annual basis as a Visiting Professor, Visiting Associate Professor, Visiting Assistant Professor, Visiting Senior Lecturer, Visiting Lecturer, Visiting Senior Instructor, or Visiting Instructor.

Research Fellow

Appointment as Research Fellow requires the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Appointees will have a strong research record of accomplishments in their area of expertise and an ability to contribute to the university's research agenda.

Appointee in Residence

An Appointee in Residence will be titled or identified with an appropriate designation, such as Executive, Scholar, Artist, Diplomat, or other descriptive term. An appointee to this rank may or may not hold the terminal degree in the discipline; however, they must possess a record of significant accomplishment in their area of expertise and demonstrate the ability to contribute to advancing the university's mission.

Professor of Practice

An appointee to Professor of Practice holds the recognized terminal degree in the discipline. Requisite professional experience equivalent to a terminal degree may be considered. The appointee will have a strong teaching ability to engage in instruction of professional students with emphasis on the development of practical skills.

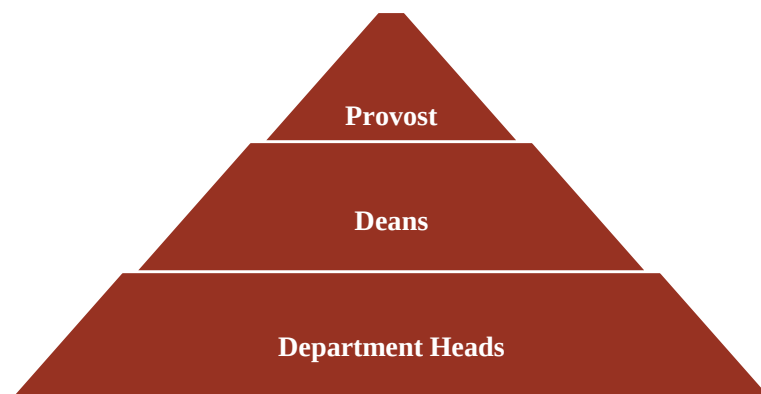
Adjunct Faculty

The University makes important use of the service of adjunct faculty in many academic units for their academic and professional credentials and experience.

Special Contract Faculty

A special contract faculty appointment allows an individual possessing special skills or knowledge needed to complete a particular curriculum to contribute to the instructional program of a college/school on a part-time basis.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty grants.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, and administrators appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

Professional Requirements for Teaching policy is shared between faculty and administrators as applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS POLICIES AND PROCEDURES MANUAL | AY24-25 | VERSION 5

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Faculty Handbook

The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL:
<https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised. No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: 971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

i. Faculty/Staff Evaluation Policy

This policy covers two policies:

1. Faculty Evaluation Policy - Version 4
2. Staff Evaluation Policy Version

1. Faculty Evaluation Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0500AP10	Policy Title:	Faculty Evaluation Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Faculty Evaluation Policy

2. Purpose:

Consistent with the Faculty Handbook (FHB), the policy is to clarify the evaluation policy for faculty members at AUS.

Faculty performance evaluations will be conducted periodically for the following purposes: to support and encourage excellence by recognizing and rewarding performance that advances the mission of the University; to assess faculty in the areas of teaching, scholarly activities (research and creative activities) and service; to provide guidance to faculty members regarding professional improvement and development; and to obtain information relevant to contract renewal/extension, promotion, termination, or merit pay decisions.

3. Introduction/Background:

This policy is embedded in the Faculty Handbook.

Faculty members' performance evaluations will be conducted based upon criteria in this section in the areas of teaching, scholarly activities, and service.

The specific performance criteria used in the evaluations can vary among the departments and across colleges/school. The performance criteria for each department will be developed by the college/school leadership team and shall require final approval by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Copies of the current performance criteria must be available to the faculty. These performance criteria will be used for end-of-year, rolling contract, promotion, and in-depth evaluations.

4. Policy Statement:

Teaching Activities

Teaching includes educational activities that directly involve students. Activities in this area may include the following: classroom instruction; advising; developing and testing new educational methods, new evaluation methods; teaching new courses; serving as a course coordinator; and/or revising and improving existing courses. Also included in teaching are supervision of students'

theses, dissertations, and final projects. Teaching should be evaluated using multiple measures such as:

- i. Course portfolios
- ii. Curriculum development
- iii. Flexibility to teach different courses
- iv. Peer Evaluations
- v. Evaluations by Department Head/Director
- vi. Textbooks and supplementary teaching material
- vii. Course revision/improvement
- viii. Teaching evaluations by students
- ix. Teaching technology tools
- x. Advising undergraduate projects

Scholarly Activities

The highest indication of scholarly activities is the development, presentation and documented acceptance of original work in the professional community. Excellence in scholarly activities typically reveals itself as continuing scholarly work documented primarily in publications appearing in relevant journals, in the form of books published by companies respected in the professional community, or curated and reviewed exhibitions of creative works. Citations of a candidate's work in the professional literature and/or journal impact factor are other indicators of scholarly activities.

As part of scholarly activities, creative work may include, but is not limited to, literary publications, drawings, paintings, models, exhibitions, installations, digital creations and built work as well as other work authored by the candidate. Assessment of creative work will be through examination of the normal products of such activity.

The publication of a textbook is considered as a scholarly activity and its evaluation weight depends on the nature of the textbook and the contributions it makes to the field.

The following are examples of scholarly activities fulfilling performance evaluation criteria:

- i. Refereed journal publications
- ii. Books and book chapters
- iii. Refereed conference proceedings
- iv. Citation index/Impact factor
- v. Refereed conference presentations
- vi. Internal/external research grants
- vii. Supervising graduate theses/projects
- viii. Patents obtained
- ix. Presentations at international conferences
- x. Creative endeavors such as art pieces, films, etc. presented to juried exhibitions

Service

Service is non-remunerated work other than teaching or scholarly activity on behalf of the University or external to the University. Service is one of the three performance areas required from a faculty member for annual evaluation, contract renewal, rolling contract, in-depth and promotion review. The University commends faculty for undertaking a variety of volunteer work external to the

University, but to be included in the evaluation, it must be related to the faculty member's professional expertise.

The following are examples of service performance evaluation criteria:

- i. Service to Department
- ii. Service to College/School
- iii. Service to University/Senate
- iv. Service as reviewer in the profession
- v. Member on Editorial Board
- vi. Service in organizing a conference
- vii. Outreach activities (e.g., workshops, consultation, training, etc.)
- viii. Mentoring and advising students

Information and Materials Required for Faculty Performance Evaluations

Evaluations will be based on the professional responsibilities of the faculty member in the areas of teaching, scholarly activities, and internal and external service. It is recognized, however, that within the broad definitions of these areas, the activities in which the faculty engage in fulfilling their professional assignments can vary from one department to another.

Relative Weights of the Main Performance Areas

For end-of-year annual evaluation purposes, the Colleges/School should establish clear guidelines for a faculty member to meet expectations in the three areas of performance. Relative weights approved by the Head of Department may be established to typically reflect the percent of time that the faculty member spends in the three areas of performance and should be reported in the Faculty Annual Report (FAR).

Faculty Performance Evaluation

At the beginning of each academic year the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will establish deadlines for the completion of the performance evaluation processes. In all contract-related evaluations (Sections D.5.a to D.5.c), the Dean will provide a summary of the unit's evaluations to the faculty member. The faculty member has the right to review the Dean's performance evaluations and recommendations. The faculty member has the option of attaching a written response to the file. If shortcomings are identified, appropriate plans for professional development and improvement should be worked out between the faculty member, the Department Head/Director, and the Dean of the college/school. The plan will be part of the dossier for future reference.

For individuals with joint appointments, their related (when applicable) annual evaluation, salary raises, promotion, rolling contract, in-depth decision and disciplinary actions should be conducted by their primary unit in collaboration with and/or participation of the secondary unit(s). The primary unit is responsible for actively coordinating the process and seeking input from the secondary unit(s) and submitting it with the final reports. The agreement at the time of appointment must specify the method that will be used to collaborate and to solicit input from the secondary unit(s). For all evaluations, the weighting of performance criteria should be consistent with the specific expectations articulated in the agreement.

Evaluation for Annual Faculty Performance

Assessments are conducted at the end of the Spring semester each year. Evaluation of faculty performance is designed to provide a planning mechanism for faculty development, to recognize excellence in role performance, to improve teaching, to enhance professional competencies, and to delineate areas for improvement. The first purpose of this evaluation is to provide a basis for professional growth and development. Professional growth plans serve as the framework for the evaluation and recognition of past endeavors and for focusing on future goals and objectives. A second purpose of faculty performance evaluation is to recognize past professional performance and, as approved by the Administration and the Board of Trustees, to reward those endeavors with appropriate merit increases in salaries, while also providing feedback to faculty demonstrating a need for improvement. A third purpose of the faculty performance review is to provide a structure for systematically measuring progress and to substantiate consideration toward a rolling contract and promotion.

Evaluation for Contract Decisions

Awarding of the Second Contract:

Assessment for the purpose of awarding a second contract is to be completed before the outset of the last academic year of the existing contract. Based on the annual evaluation described in Section D.5.a, the Dean of the unit recommends to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost either awarding the faculty member a second three-year contract or offering a terminal one-year contract effective the following Fall.

Awarding of the Three-Year Rolling Contract:

Faculty members applying for a three-year rolling contract must provide a cumulative dossier that covers teaching, scholarly activity, and service during the period of employment at AUS. The in-depth evaluation process is detailed in Section D.6.

The outcome of the evaluation is one of the following for full-time faculty members:

- i. A three-year rolling contract beginning the Fall semester of the following academic year; or
- ii. A one-year, terminal contract effective the following Fall for full-time faculty.

Guidelines Regarding External Peer Review

- i. Scholarly activities must be evaluated by external reviewers in the field who are in a position to give an objective evaluation. These reviewers will not be from schools where standards of performance and expectations are substantially higher or lower than those of AUS. At least one of the reviewers will be chosen from the candidate's list. None of the reviewers should be current or former members of the AUS faculty, former teachers, co-workers, co-authors, or students of the candidate. Reviewers should be acquainted with the candidate through his/her published work or other professional accomplishments. All external reviewers should have attained the rank pursued or higher.
- ii. Since standards of acceptable scholarly activities may properly vary from one department to another within an institution, and from one institution to another, it is important that the standards applicable to a given application be clearly explained to each external evaluator.

- iii. Each reviewer must be requested to justify any conclusions regarding the quality of the scholarly activities of the applicant and do so at a level of detail that permits an understanding of the achievement of the applicant relative to standards of excellence in his/her field. The degree to which the external assessments will be considered is based on the cogency of the argument made.
- iv. The acceptable level of the quality of the scholarly work and its impact on a promotion recommendation or decision is a matter of judgment at the various steps of the evaluation process.

Extension of Existing Rolling Contract:

Assessment for the purpose of extending an existing rolling contract is conducted every year and is based on assessment of the faculty member's academic performance as reflected in performance evaluations and annual recommendations as described in Section D.5.a and based on criteria described in Section D.2. The Dean of the college/school, in consultation with the Department Head, recommends to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost either extension of the faculty member's rolling contract for another year, or an in-depth evaluation of the faculty member's academic performance.

The outcome of this in-depth evaluation is one of the following:

- i. extension of the rolling contract; or
- ii. non-extension of the rolling contract, with a terminal year during the academic year immediately following the decision.

Evaluation for Promotion Decisions

At certain points during their employment history, faculty members may elect to apply for promotion. It is the responsibility of the Department Heads/Directors to inform faculty early on of the expectations for the granting of a promotion within a given department and the University as a whole.

- i. To be considered for promotion, a candidate must meet minimum eligibility requirements, which include time-in-rank as set forth in the *Minimum Criteria by Rank* Section below;
- ii. To be granted promotion, a candidate must meet clear and distinct criteria established by the administration and faculty members as set forth in Section D.2.

Eligibility

A faculty member is considered for promotion to a higher rank based on demonstrated quality in teaching, scholarly activities, and service, and becomes eligible to apply for promotion after a period of five years in the preceding rank with a minimum of one year under full-time faculty contract at AUS. Faculty who wish to apply for promotion early must meet the minimum criteria that apply to the five-year promotion requirement and must have a record of achievement in teaching, scholarly activity, and service that is at least equal to the record expected of a faculty member coming up after five years at rank. In such a case, the Department Head/Director and the Dean of the college/school must add to the candidate's dossier a written supporting report justifying the basis for early promotion. An unsuccessful candidate for early promotion can reapply only after serving five years at rank.

When a new faculty member has approved post terminal degree professional experience, whether academic or industrial that relates to the intended area of teaching and research, the Dean of the hiring college/school, with approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, may award a maximum of two (2) years of credit toward promotion eligibility at AUS. Additionally, at least three (3) year

s of full-time teaching experience must be evidenced to be eligible to apply for promotion.

Promotion Procedure

Though the promotion application procedure may vary across the University's colleges/school, the evaluation procedures should achieve a fair and objective evaluation of the applicant's total record in terms of teaching, scholarly activities, and service.

Preparation and Submission of Applications for Promotion Consideration

An evaluation file for promotion consideration is prepared by the faculty member. Many elements of the evaluation file should already be present in the faculty member's dossier on file in the Dean's Office.

Guidelines Regarding External Peer Review

Scholarly activities must be evaluated by external reviewers in the field who are in a position to give an objective evaluation. These reviewers will not be from schools where standards of performance and expectations are substantially higher or lower than those of AUS. At least one of the reviewers will be chosen from the candidate's list. None of the reviewers should be current or former members of the AUS faculty, former teachers, co-workers, co-authors, or students of the candidate. Reviewers should be acquainted with the candidate through his/her published work or other professional accomplishments. All external reviewers should have attained the rank pursued or higher.

Since standards of acceptable scholarly activities may properly vary from one department to another within an institution, and from one institution to another, it is important that the standards applicable to a given application be clearly explained to each external evaluator.

Each reviewer must be requested to justify any conclusions regarding the quality of the scholarly activities of the applicant and do so at a level of detail that permits an understanding of the achievement of the applicant relative to standards of excellence in his/her field. The degree to which the external assessments will be considered is based on the cogency of the argument made.

The acceptable level of the quality of the scholarly work and its impact on a promotion recommendation or decision is a matter of judgment at the various steps of the evaluation process.

Minimum Criteria by Rank

The University has established the following minimum criteria for promotion to the academic rank cited. All faculty members are expected to demonstrate the highest levels of character and professional ethics when representing the University, and to be a role model.

Senior Instructor

Promotion to Senior Instructor requires five years of full-time teaching as an Instructor, or equivalent professional experience, including at least one year of full-time service as an Instructor at AUS. A candidate for Senior Instructor will demonstrate a superior record of effectiveness in teaching and constructive participation in service, according to the promotion guidelines developed in the college/school.

Senior Lecturer

Promotion to Senior Lecturer requires at least five years in the rank of Lecturer, including at least one year of full-time service at that rank at AUS. A Senior Lecturer will possess a doctorate or appropriate professional degree in the field. The candidate will have demonstrated a superior record of teaching effectiveness and substantial service to the University and the community at large. A Senior Lecturer will display consistently mature performance in course and curriculum planning, guiding and counseling students, mentoring, and participating in University and community service.

Associate Professor

Promotion to Associate Professor requires at least five years in the rank of Assistant Professor, including at least one year of full-time service in the rank of Assistant Professor at AUS. An Associate Professor will possess a doctorate or appropriate terminal professional degree and have substantial experience in teaching and scholarly activity or applicable professional experience. The

candidate will demonstrate teaching effectiveness and have the interest and capacity for continuing growth as a teacher, scholar, and member of his/her profession. An Associate Professor will display consistently mature performance in course and curriculum planning, guiding and counseling students, mentoring junior faculty, and participating in University and community service.

Professor

Promotion to Professor requires at least five years in the rank of Associate Professor, including at least one year of full-time service in the rank of Associate Professor at AUS. The rank of Professor recognizes the attainment of authoritative knowledge and the achievement of effective teaching skills. The Professor will have attained an excellent reputation in his/her field of expertise, as evidenced by scholarly activities, teaching excellence, leadership within his/her department and within his/her professional or learned organizations, and effective participation in University and community service.

The In-Depth Evaluation Process

The faculty evaluation process is established for the evaluation of all full-time faculty members for the purposes of the awarding of a rolling contract and renewal of an existing rolling contract. In such a case, a candidate will be evaluated separately and independently by his/her Department Head/Director and Faculty Personnel Committee (FPC). Subsequently, the Dean reviews these separate recommendations and write his/her own recommendation. In cases of diverging recommendations from the Department Head/Director, FPC and the Dean, the case is referred to the Faculty Evaluation Review Committee (FERC). After receiving all preceding performance evaluations, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will conduct his/her own assessment and make a recommendation to the Chancellor. For applicants who are considered for the award of a three-year rolling contract at the time of hire, the evaluation process will be carried out according to a timeline established by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Structure of Evaluation Committees

Faculty Personnel Committee (FPC)

Purpose. The purpose of the FPC is to write recommendations concerning decisions related to renewal of contracts, rolling contracts, renewal of existing rolling contracts, and promotions.

i. Composition of the FPC:

- a) The FPC consists of four “permanent” members, two from inside and two from outside the college/school, and three “temporary” members from the candidate’s department.
- b) Non-administrator professors of a college/school who are not on leave, who already have rolling contracts, and who are not subject during their service term to an in-depth review will be eligible to serve as “permanent” members on the FPC. Associate professors will be considered where the number of full professors in the college is inadequate.
- c) Non-administrator assistant professors, non-administrator associate professors, and non-administrator professors of a department who are not on leave, who have served at least three years teaching in the department or program at AUS, and who are not subject in that year to an in-depth review will be eligible to serve as “temporary” members of the FPC.
- d) Selection of the members of the FPCs will take place before the end of the week 3 of classes in Fall Semester of each year. In no case will an FPC selection process occur before the selection of the membership of that year’s Faculty Evaluation Review Committee (FERC).

Terms of members:

- (a) The “temporary” members of the FPC will have a term of one year;
- (b) The “temporary” members of the FPC may serve a maximum of two consecutive terms;

- (c) The “permanent” members of the FPC will have a term of two years;
- (d) One of the internal “permanent” members and one of the external “permanent” members will retire when the FPC concludes its duties for an academic year.

ii. Work:

- (a) The FPC establishes its own *modus operandi* including reporting on any conflict of interest, so long as the Performance Enhancement and Achievement Review and the general standards set forth in 6.F are adhered to;
- (b) All members of the FPC participate in the review of all in-depth review cases. In rolling contract and renewal of existing rolling contract cases, all FPC members vote/recommend; in promotion cases only members at the rank sought or above are eligible to vote;
- (c) Should any member of the FPC have a conflict of interest regarding any case, as decided upon by the FPC, then he/she should be recused for all discussions and voting on that case.

Faculty Evaluation Review Committee (FERC)

Purpose. The purpose of the FERC is to evaluate applications when the recommendations of the Department Head/Director, the college/school FPC, and the Dean differ. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost also has the discretion to refer cases to the FERC when he or she deems it appropriate to do so. The committee will write recommendations to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost concerning decisions related to renewal of contracts, rolling contracts, renewal of existing rolling contracts, and promotions and will advise the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost in matters relating to the policy and processes involved with in-depth, promotion, and rolling contract reviews.

i. Composition of the FERC:

- Non-administrator Full Professors of a college/school who are not on leave, who already have rolling contracts, who are not subject during their service term to an in-depth review, and who are not members of the FPC will be eligible to serve on the FERC.
- (d) The FERC consists of four eligible faculty members, representing respectively the four colleges/school elected by the faculty, plus an at-large eligible faculty member appointed by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

i. Terms:

- (a) FERC members will have a term of two years, staggered terms;
- (b) First year exception: before the election in the first year, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost in coordination with the Faculty Senate President will determine which two colleges/school members of the FERC will serve for one year and which will serve for two years;
- (c) The at-large FERC member will have a term of one year;
- (d) FERC members may serve a maximum of two consecutive terms.

iii. Work:

- (a) The FERC will review the performance evaluations and recommendations of a faculty member being evaluated for renewal of contract, rolling contract and/or for promotion when the recommendations of the Department Head/Director, the college/school FPC, and the

Dean differ, and will make recommendations concerning renewal of contract, rolling contract, and/or promotion for each candidate;

Should any member of the FERC have a potential conflict of interest regarding any case, as decided upon by the FERC, then he/she should recuse him/herself for all discussions and voting on that case.

Confidentiality

Absolute confidentiality is required in the review process, and all participants are expected to maintain the strictest secrecy concerning all deliberations, votes, decisions, and recommendations.

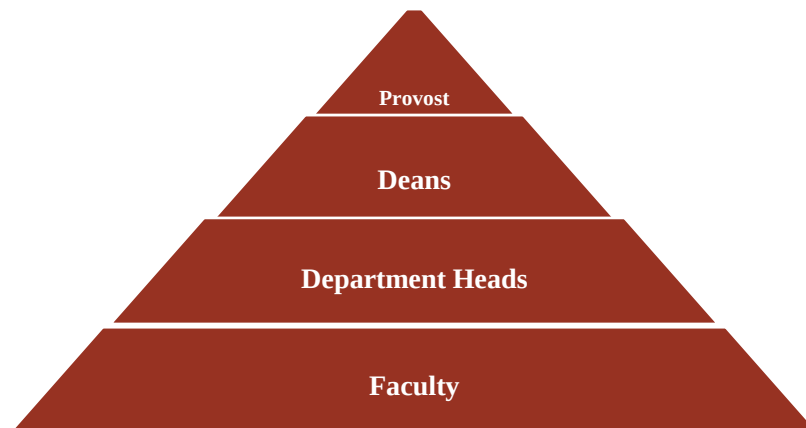
Committees and individuals involved in faculty evaluations are expected to act in a professional manner to protect the integrity of the review process.

The nature of the evaluations mandates that the work of review committees be conducted confidentially and only within committee meetings so that participants can feel free to voice opinions without fear of reprisals or concerns about confidentiality being compromised.

Participants in the evaluation process must not reveal or share any material or discussions that take place during the deliberations, either while the deliberations are in process or forever afterward.

Failure to adhere to strict standards of confidentiality are to be reported to the relevant Dean or to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and after consultation with the Faculty Senate President, may result in serious sanctions being imposed on violators.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty grants.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, and administrators appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

Faculty Evaluation policy is shared between faculty and administrators as applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Faculty Personnel Committee (FPC)
Faculty Evaluation Review Committee (FERC)
Faculty Annual Report (FAR)

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook

The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL:
<https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised. No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	January 2024	Revised to follow the latest faculty handbook	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: 971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

2. Staff Evaluation Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES11	Policy Title:	Staff Evaluation Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Staff Evaluation Policy

2. Purpose:

The Annual Performance Review is a mechanism for setting goals, developing plans and receiving feedback for improvement. AUS strives to provide a work environment where employees have the opportunity to excel in their field of endeavor. The annual Performance review is key process for assisting employees in realizing their career goals.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement:

Performance management is a major responsibility of all supervisors. Supervisors who fail to comply with this policy may have their own performance rating negatively affected.

Planning

At the beginning of the appraisal cycle, which occurs annually, the supervisor and the employee must meet to determine the employee's work plan and performance expectations. Each employee, including trainee and probationary employees, must have a work plan established within 30 days of starting in the position or when job duties change significantly.

A work plan is a specific course of action outlining the significant responsibilities and duties consistent with the employee's job description. Performance expectations are the objective measures or criteria used to measure job performance. The work plan must be reviewed or updated at least annually.

Managing

Managing involves coaching and reinforcing employee progress toward achieving performance expectations. Supervisors should provide employees with ongoing feedback about their job performance. Supervisors also may conduct an informal interim performance review within six months of an annual review or within six months of establishing an initial work plan. Supervisors do not need to complete a performance evaluation form for an interim review, but they should document:

- Any performance expectations set out in the work plan that are not being met
- Steps the employee must take to correct performance deficiencies
- The date that the review took place.

Appraising

In preparation for the evaluation, the supervisor can invite the employee to prepare a self-evaluation. After reviewing any employee self-evaluation, the supervisor must schedule an evaluation meeting. At the evaluation meeting, the supervisor must:

- Identify and discuss good performance
- Identify and discuss performance that needs improvement
- Review the employee's ratings on job performance factors
- Review the extent to which the employee was successful or unsuccessful in meeting goals and accountabilities set out in the employee's work plan

Rating Scale

AUS uses the following five-level rating scale:

- **Excellent:** The employee's performance is far above the defined expectations. The employee consistently does outstanding work, regularly going far beyond what is expected of employee in this job. Performance that exceeds expectations is due to the employee's own knowledge, skill, or effort. Any performance not consistently exceeding expectations is minor or due to events not under the control of the employee.
- **Exceed Expectations** The employee's performance meets the defined job expectations and, in many instances, exceeds job expectations. The employee generally is doing a very good job. Performance that exceeds expectations is due to the employee's own knowledge, skill, or effort. The employee's performance meets the defined job expectations. The employee's performance is at the level expected for employees doing this job. The performance is due to the employee's own knowledge, skill, or effort.
- **Meets Expectations** The employee's performance meets almost all of the job expectations and in some cases exceeds them. The employee is doing a good job at the performance standard set for the job. Lapses in performance are due to the employee's lack of knowledge.
- **Needs Improvement** The employee's performance meets some of the job expectations, but does not fully meet the remainder. Improvement is needed to fully meet expectations. The employee generally is doing the job at a minimal level or is performing less than a good job. Lapses in performance are due to the employee's own lack of knowledge, skill, or effort.
- **Unsatisfactory** The employee's performance generally fails to meet the expectations as defined. The employee frequently requires close supervision; the employee's work frequently must be redone; or the employee is not doing the job at the level expected for employees in this position. Unsuccessful job performance is due to the employee's own lack of knowledge, skill, or effort.

Record keeping

Supervisors considering an employee for transfer or promotion are permitted access to the current or past performance evaluation documents of that employee.

Steps to Follow:

- HR sends out the performance evaluation forms to all Deans & Directors
- HR to provide coaching to deans and directors on the method of carrying out the evaluation

- Employees and supervisors' complete evaluation form
- Supervisors conduct employees' annual reviews

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to full time nonacademic staff.

6. Responsibilities:

Supervisor's Responsibilities

The policy asks those managers and supervisors:

- Develop a work plan for each employee with the active participation of that employee.
- Coach, counsel and monitor the employee's job performance.
- Conduct a fair, unbiased, and equitable performance appraisal annually for each eligible employee.
- Ensure that the employee is given continuous constructive feedback to enable him/her to improve their work performance throughout the year.

Training for supervisory and managerial staff in the principles and techniques of the PMP is provided by Human Resources.

Human Resource Services Responsibilities

The Executive Director of Employee Services is responsible for facilitating, monitoring and evaluating the PMP to ensure it operates in full compliance with this policy. The Executive Director Employee Services assigns Employee Services staff to:

- Monitor the program
- Train supervisory personnel
- Administer and interpret the policy
- Develop program enhancements

Employees with at least six months of serve are eligible to be considered in that year's performance review, which is normally conducted in May. Salary increases approved in this review become effective in September.

Employees' Responsibilities

Employees are responsible for actively participating in the performance evaluation process and working with their supervisors to develop work plans and self-development plans.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Promotion and Transfer Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
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1.0	Pre 2021	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

j. Nepotism/Employment of Relative Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES12	Policy Title:	Nepotism/Employment of Relative Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Nepotism/Employment of Relative Policy

2. Purpose:

Provided for the employment of relatives of AUS employees such that it does not adversely affect the conditions of employment or working environment of non-relative employees.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah bases all appointments and promotions on qualifications and work performance. The employment of relatives is permitted so long as it does not create an environment that is discriminatory or harassing to other employees. At no time may one family member supervise another or have influence over the other's employment, transfer, promotion, salary administration, or other related management or personnel matters.

Members of an employee's immediate family or relatives that live with an employee may be offered employment at the university. This policy also applies to nonrelatives who live in the same household or so closely identified as to suggest the potential for bias in the employment relationship.

If members of the same family or household are required to work for the same supervisor, written approval of this arrangement from the Executive Director of Employee Services with approval from the VCAA & Provost and or the Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration required in advance.

5. Scope/applicability:

All faculty and nonacademic staff.

6. Responsibilities:

- Employees or applicants shall disclose any family or household members currently working at the university to the hiring manager or department head.
- The department head shall notify Human Resources of the family or household relationship and to receive further guidance.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Nondiscrimination Policy Employment Policy Conflict of Interest Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2021	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

k. Faculty/Staff Discipline Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES13	Policy Title:	Faculty/Staff Discipline Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Faculty/Staff Discipline Policy

The guiding policy relating to conditions of work and personal conduct is that the quality of work and the atmosphere in which it is done be consistent with the reputation of AUS as a leading educational institution. An employee's conduct while working for or representing the university, or when on university premises, should meet acceptable standards of the community and show respect for the law and the rights of others.

2. Purpose:

To provide a safe and productive work environment while adhering to professional standards of behavior that foster and promote order, respect and dignity of co-workers and visitors.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement:

Absenteeism or Tardiness

Employees are expected to be at work on time and to work their full schedule. If an employee is absent from work for any reason, the employee must call his/her supervisor at least one hour before the employee start time of that day. Repeated absenteeism or tardiness will be cause for disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Breach of Confidence or Security

Because of the nature of work, no breaches of security measures or of confidential business relationships will be tolerated.

Conflict of Interest

Employees are prohibited from transacting any business that competes with the university. You must communicate any such conflict to your supervisor. For more information, please refer to the Conflict of Interest and Code of Confidentiality Policy in the HR Policy manual.

Damage to Property

Deliberate reckless or careless damage to the university's property will not be tolerated. The university, at its discretion, may report such damage of its property to law enforcement agencies.

Discourtesy or Disrespect

All employees must be courteous, polite and friendly to students, visitors, and to fellow employees. No one should use profanity or show disrespect or engage in any activity that could harm the reputation of the university.

Fighting, Threats, or Weapons

Fighting, threatening words or conduct, loud or abusive language, or any other actions that could injure a student, fellow employee, or member of the public, regardless of where such words or actions occur

are not allowed. The possession of weapons of any kind on AUS' premises is prohibited.

Fraud, Dishonesty or False Statements

No employee or applicant may falsify or make any misrepresentations on or about any application, document establishing identity or work status, medical history record, insurance form, invoice, paperwork, time sheet, time card, or any other document. If such a violation is observed this must be reported to the supervisor immediately.

Gambling

Employees may not engage in any form of gambling on AUS premises.

Gifts or Gratuities

Employees may not accept any gift or gratuity of any kind from a customer or supplier unless approved by the respective Senior Administrator.

Harassment

The policy against harassment and discrimination, strictly prohibits harassment or discrimination based on race, color, sex, national origin, age, disability, or any other category prohibited by law.

Injuries and Accidents

Every injury at the workplace, no matter how slight, must be immediately reported to a supervisor for first aid treatment or medical care. A doctor designated by the university must see a job related injury/accident employee. Employees may be required to present a doctor's release before returning to work.

Insubordination

Employees may not refuse to follow the directions of a supervisor or administrative official, unless there is disagreement and discussion of the application of a policy or practice.

Misuse of Property

Employees may not misuse or use without authorization any equipment, vehicle or other property of AUS.

Poor Performance

All employees must make every effort to learn their job and to perform at a satisfactory level. Employees who fail to maintain a satisfactory level of performance are subject to disciplinary action.

Misuse of E-mail and Computer Systems

The IT policy contains a code of conduct for use of email and computer systems. Employees who breach this policy may be subject to disciplinary action up to and including termination.

Shortages

Employees who handle cash as part of their job duties will be held accountable and may be required to pay for all shortages. Employees who handle cash as a part of their job duties may also be disciplined for such shortages, up to and including termination.

Sleeping or Inattention

To protect the safety of all employees and to properly serve our students, everyone needs to be fully alert while on the job. Sleeping or inattention on the job will not be tolerated.

Substance Abuse

Employees who test positive for the presence of drugs or alcohol may be subject to termination.

Theft

Stealing or attempting to steal the university's property or property belonging to others is strictly prohibited. To protect employees, and the university, AUS reserves the right to inspect all purses,

briefcases, packages, lockers, tool boxes, desks, cabinets, vehicles, and any other containers or items on university property. If employees wish to remove any of the university's property from the premises, they must obtain written permission in advance from their supervisor or department head.

Unlawful Activity

Employees should not engage in any unlawful or unethical activity, including, but not limited to activity either on AUS' property or off the job, since such activity can adversely affect the university's reputation.

Unsafe Work Practices

A safety program has been implemented to ensure that everyone understands the importance of safety and to prevent employees and visitors from getting injured. Everyone is expected to follow the rules outlined in the safety policy.

Violation of these or similar rules may lead to discipline, up to and including termination. Obviously, this list is not all-inclusive and there may be other circumstances for which employees may be disciplined or terminated.

TAKING CORRECTIVE ACTION

The progressive discipline policy referenced in this policy applies to staff positions. Faculty matters are governed by the Faculty Handbook-*Professional Conduct, Ethics, and Conflict of Interest*. The university administers a progressive discipline policy for staff designed to help employees correct work performance or conduct that has become unsatisfactory. The emphasis is on working out problems and restoring harmony and productivity to the work environment. This policy applies to full time staff employees who have completed the probationary period.

Taking corrective action is required when employees fail to correct behavior or performance problems after one or several discussion(s) with their manager/supervisor, depending on the severity of the infraction. Typically, each action taken, at each level of the progressive process, is more severe in consequence if the behavior/performance is not corrected. Remember, certain work rule violations or behaviors may warrant immediate termination, depending on their seriousness.

Corrective action should be taken as soon as possible after the occurrence of an offense. The employee's immediate supervisor and Human Resource Officer, if requested, are responsible for promptly and thoroughly investigating offenses and obtaining and considering relevant facts, including any mitigating circumstances.

HR will keep all the documentation related to the facts of each case including investigations, statements and any other relevant documents. The Executive Director of HR shall recommend appropriate corrective action to the appropriate Senior Administrator.

The university may impose only one penalty on an employee for the same offence. External offenses may also be subject to civil or criminal procedures by the relevant authorities.

Counseling or Oral Reprimand

This step is required when the supervisor has held informal discussions with an employee regarding a work habit or work performance problem and he/she fails to correct the problem. A private discussion should be held with the employee describing the behavior or performance issue that needs correcting. The responsibility for a plan of corrective action should rest primarily with the employee although it is appropriate to ask the employee if he/she needs any help from his/her supervisor.

The employee should know that this is a formal corrective action and will be documented and put in his or her personnel file. Throughout this discussion the leader should listen and respond with empathy, to the employee, being careful not to remove the responsibility from the employee for correcting the problem. A supervisor may counsel an employee several times before going to the next step.

First Written Warning

This step should be used after a formal oral warning/counseling has been used and the work habit or behavior has still not been corrected. Usually, it is not corrected as a result of unwillingness, rather than inability. It is considered the second step in the progressive process although a supervisor/manager may go directly to this step if the violation/infraction is more serious and warrants such action. A formal letter (Refer to Warning letter) is issued stating what rule was violated or describing the unsatisfactory job performance; the area needing improvement; the desired improvement needed; what the plan of corrective action will be; the date of completion; and, the consequences of not correcting the problem. Again, a discussion should be held in private with the employee to review the contents of the letter. The same format as outlined in the oral warning/counseling process described above should be used. A copy of the letter is given to the employee and another copy is placed in the personnel file, with appropriate notations. The letter is active for a period not greater than twelve months.

Second Written Warning

This step is the third step in the progressive disciplinary process. The guidelines in 2.b.1 apply.

Suspension

Suspensions are primarily implemented in cases where the employee must be removed from the work environment to assist the investigation process or occasionally as a sanction. A meeting is held in private with the employee where he/she is given a written letter (Refer to letter at the end of the section) specifying the reason(s) for the suspension. In addition, it should specify the date and time that the suspension becomes effective. Again, the accompanying letter should be given to the employee with a copy given to him/her and a copy placed in his or her personnel file with appropriate notation.

Termination

The department head should review the matter with a Human Resource Officer and the appropriate Senior Administrator prior to making a decision to terminate an employee. If a decision to terminate is determined, the Executive Director of HR and the appropriate Senior Administrator must approve it. The Chancellor should be notified and a meeting with the employee is scheduled.

The meeting should be carefully planned in advance and held in a private office. The department head should have another member of management in the meeting with him or her. The department head may request that a Human Resource Officer be present at the meeting. A chronology of the events leading up to the termination should be reviewed with the employee. The department head should collaborate with the Human Resource Officer to ensure that all keys or other university items are collected, that all final pay and benefits are determined and that there is a plan in place in the event that there is a violent reaction from the employee.

5. Scope/applicability:

All employees and visitors of American University of Sharjah.

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of the VCAA and Provost is responsible for Faculty Handbook. Human Resources is responsible for the Staff Handbook

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Senior Administrators are defined as the Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs & Provost, Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration, Vice Chancellor for Research)

8. elated Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook section B.3.d Professional Conduct, Ethics, and Conflict of Interest.

Staff Handbook: Policy 10.0 Nondiscrimination and Anti-Harassment Policy Staff Handbook: Policy 60.7 Occupational Illness/Injury Leave
Staff Handbook: Policy 70.0 University Work Rules and Personal Conduct Staff Handbook: Policy 90.0 Workplace Health Safety and Security
Staff Handbook: Policy 100.0 Workplace Violence
Staff Handbook: Policy 110.0 Code of Business Ethics Staff Handbook: Policy 120.0 Confidentiality
Staff Handbook: Policy 130.0 Substance Abuse Staff Handbook: Policy 140.0 Termination Staff Handbook: Policy 150.0 Employee Information and Privacy

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2013	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

I. Faculty and Professional Staff Appeals Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES14	Policy Title:	Faculty and Professional Staff Appeals Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Faculty and Professional Staff Appeals Policy

2. Purpose:

Maintain a productive work environment through the prompt resolution of disputes in the workplace while ensuring the fair treatment of all employees.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

In collecting, maintaining, and disclosing employee information, AUS strives to protect employees' privacy rights and interests and prevent inappropriate or unnecessary disclosures of information from any person's file or record.

4. Policy Statement:

This policy section relates to FACULTY Appeals

Informal Attempts at Conflict Resolution

Before a formal grievance is filed, a potential grievant should attempt to resolve the grievance informally.

Notice of Grievance

If informal resolution fails, a faculty member who believes that he or she has a grievance must file a Notice of Grievance with the highest-ranking member of the Senate Executive Committee who is not a party to the complaint or from the same unit as parties to the grievance.

The Notice of Grievance shall contain a concise statement of the reasons that led the faculty member to feel aggrieved and shall specify the remedy requested. The grievant must file the notice within thirty (30) days of an officially documented action.

The Notice of Grievance includes basic information regarding the person submitting it, including the name, office addresses and phone number(s), the unit, the individuals against whom the grievance is being filed, the date that the aggrieved action occurred, and the date of submission.

The Notice of Grievance should be thorough, but as clear and concise as possible, and contain the following information:

- The (administrative or collegial) acts to be reviewed
- The names and phone numbers of all parties involved, as well as those of any witnesses who may be called to testify, along with a brief summary of their testimony
- How these acts adversely affected the grievant

- The applicable sections or subsections of the grievance code
- The section(s) and specific provision(s) of the applicable university rules, regulations or contracts alleged to have been violated, if any, and how these provisions were violated
- The remedy being requested

Appropriate documentation should be included to substantiate any claims.

Formation of the Senate Executive Subcommittee (SES)

As soon as a Notice of Grievance is filed, the Senate Executive Committee shall form a subcommittee (hereinafter SES) of itself. If the grievance notice is filed after the end of week 10 of the Spring semester, the SES may defer, for practical reasons, some or all of its duties until the first day of the following regular semester. The SES will consist of all members of the Senate Executive Committee who are not from the same unit as parties to the grievance. The Chair of the SES shall be the highest-ranking member of the SES.

The SES fulfills the following duties:

- Determines within ten (10) days whether or not the complaint is a grievable matter and sends its report in this regard to the Chancellor and to the grievant.
- The chair of the SES may request additional information from the grievant only to assist the SES in determining whether the complaint is grievable.
- If the SES determines that the complaint is a grievable matter, informs the person against whom the grievance is filed and includes a copy of the Notice of Grievance.
- Selects the members of the Grievance Committee.
- Determines what evidence provided by the grievant is admissible.
- Provides guidance and direction for the Grievance Committee.
- Reviews the findings and recommendations of the Grievance Committee and identifies any flaws in the grievance procedure.
- Ensures the integrity of the grievance process.

Formation of the Grievance Committee

The SES shall by majority vote select a Grievance Committee of five (5) members from the eligible pool of faculty members. The eligible pool of faculty members shall consist of all faculty members who have at least two years of service at the American University of Sharjah and are neither part of the current Faculty Senate Executive Committee nor are members of any unit that is involved in the grievance.

Individuals in the following positions may not serve on a Grievance Committee under this code: all administrators, including the Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Provosts, Deans, Associate Deans, Directors and Department Heads. The committee will elect its own chair. The SES must exercise due diligence that appointees are free of reasonable perceived bias, conflict of interest, or such previous association with the issues

that are raised by the grievance and/or close association with the parties to the grievance as would recommend that the appointee not serve.

No person must be involved in the pending grievance process who has rendered a previous judgment on any of the parties to the grievance in the case at hand.

The Grievance Committee shall receive a copy of the Notice of Grievance and any supporting documents filed by the parties to the grievance. The Grievance Committee shall also receive the report of the SES stating which matters are grievable. Non-grievable matters as determined by the SES should not be investigated.

Procedures for the Grievance Committee

Once the SES has determined that a Notice of Grievance has been appropriately filed and all necessary information has been included, it shall convene the organizational meeting of the Grievance Committee within ten (10) days and shall instruct the Grievance Committee to:

- Elect a Chair
- Establish procedures necessary for a fair and orderly hearing
- Forward a copy of the Notice of Grievance to all parties against whom the grievance is filed
- Solicit documents or other hard copies or electronic evidence from parties to the grievance

The committee may not meet if more than one member is absent. Decisions must be reached by a majority vote of members present, and votes shall be tabulated and recorded without designating how any individual voted.

The Notice of Grievance and the solicitation of documents shall be delivered to the campus office address of the parties to the grievance.

Parties to the grievance must complete their submissions no later than ten (10) days after receiving the solicitation from the Grievance Committee. The first day of the ten is the first day after an adversarial party has received the request from the Grievance Committee.

Not more than five (5) days after the deadline for submissions of documents and evidence from parties to the grievance, the Chair shall convene the first meeting to consider the written documents and evidence submitted by the parties. Beginning with the grievant, all parties will be invited to make oral presentations and to submit supplementary written evidence.

Strict rules of evidence and procedures shall not apply, but parties must be permitted to be present when the committee receives oral statements and all parties must receive all documents submitted in evidence by any party.

Parties to the grievance may choose to be assisted by an advisor throughout the hearings. The committee may also have an advisor. All advisors must be employees of the University.

At any time before or during its deliberations, the Grievance Committee may, by majority vote, determine that it is necessary to obtain further information and may call witnesses for

oral testimony, or seek any additional documents or information from any source, including by way of addressing hard copy or electronic questions to any party. Witnesses are called to give testimony and are not to attend other portions of the proceedings. The same individual cannot serve as both witness and advisor.

The manner in which oral proceedings are conducted shall be determined by the Chair of the Grievance Committee, in consultation with the members of that committee. The Chair shall make all reasonable efforts to give all relevant parties a reasonable amount of advance notice as to the procedures that will be followed during the oral proceedings. At the discretion of the committee, parties and their advisors may be allowed to question witnesses.

Records of the committee meetings must be kept. The committee must prepare a report of its deliberations and its recommendations, specifying the rationale(s) for its recommendation, to assist the Chancellor in his/her final decision in the case.

Once the committee has completed its receipt of oral and written evidence, it shall meet in executive sessions to consider its conclusions and recommendations. In executive session, only members of the committee shall be present, provided, however, that, at the committee's discretion, a personnel officer or legal advisor of the University may be present as an advisor to the committee.

Unless the SES, for good cause, extends the deadline for completion of the committee's report, the committee's recommendation must be submitted to the SES within thirty (30) days after the organizational meeting. Copies of the committee's recommendations and report shall also be forwarded to the parties to the grievance. Parties to the grievance may respond to the report by filing in writing to the SES. The SES shall review the report of the committee as well as any comments from any of the parties involved in the grievance process; add its own comments, concerns and suggestions to the file; and forward the file to the Chancellor for final action. Copies of comments from the SES shall be made available to the parties of the grievance. Unless the Chancellor, for good cause, extends the deadline, he/she will inform the parties to the grievance and the SES of his/her decision within twenty (20) days of receiving the file. The Chancellor will notify the parties to the grievance and the SES of any deadline extension.

This policy section relates to Professional STAFF appeals.

- AUS will endeavor to ensure fair and honest treatment of all employees. Supervisors, managers, and employees are all expected to treat each other with mutual respect.
- Each employee has the right to express his/her views concerning policies or practices to management in a business-like manner, without (fear of) retaliation. Employees are encouraged to offer positive and constructive criticism.
- Each employee is expected to follow established rules of conduct, policies, and practices. Should an employee disagree with the application of a policy or practice, the employee can express his or her disagreement through this policy.
- No employee shall be penalized, formally or informally, for voicing a disagreement with AUS in a reasonable, business-like manner, or for using the problem solving procedure.
- It is recognized that occasions or events may occur when an employee believes that a condition of employment or a decision affecting him/her is unjust or inequitable. In these situations, the employee is encouraged to make use of the following procedural steps. The employee may terminate the procedure at any step.

STEP 1

The employee presents the problem to his or her immediate supervisor within a reasonable period (30 working days or less) of the incident. If his or her supervisor, manager or department head is personally involved, he/ may begin with Step 3.

The immediate supervisor must respond during the initial discussion or within seven working days of notification of the incident. The supervisor consults with appropriate management, when necessary. He/she will immediately notify Human Resources if the problem is discrimination or harassment. The supervisor will document the discussion for the record.

STEP 2

If the problem is not resolved to the employee's satisfaction within ten working days by the supervisor, he or she may present the problem to the department head.

The department head responds during discussion or within seven working days. The department head consults with appropriate management, if necessary. He/she will immediately notify HRSE, if the problem is discrimination or harassment. The department head will document the discussion for the record.

STEP 3

If the problem is still not resolved to the employee's satisfaction, he/she may present the problem to Human Resources. Human Resources will investigate the matter including speaking with the supervisor, manager, other employees or anyone familiar with the incident. Human Resources will attempt to mediate the matter and bring a resolution.

STEP 4

As a final step, if the matter is still not resolved to the employee's satisfaction, he/she can request a review and decision by the appropriate Senior Administrator or Provost. Human Resources will frame the issue to be reviewed and provide the results of the mediation/investigation before the appropriate Senior Administrator schedules an audience with the employee and renders a final and binding decision.

5. Scope/applicability:

All employees

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of the VCAA and Provost is responsible for implementing the provisions of the Faculty Handbook. Human Resources is responsible for implementing the provisions of the Staff Handbook.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Professional Staff at AUS re categorized into 2:

1. Academic Staff
2. Non-Academic Staff

Please see below their definitions as approved by the Council of Deans and the VCAA & Provost.

Academic staff: those in non-professoriate ranks with primary responsibilities in delivering or supporting instruction and/or conducting or supporting research.

Non-academic staff: those who support the administrative and technical needs of the University but are not directly engaged in instruction and/or research.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Faculty Handbook: Section I.1 Grievance Procedure Staff Handbook: Policy 80.0 Problem Resolution

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2013	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

m. Faculty and Professional Staff Grievances Policy

This policy covers a number of policies as follows:

1. Faculty Grievances Policy – Version 3
2. Staff Grievance Policy – Version 2

1. Faculty Grievances Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0500AP15	Policy Title:	Faculty Grievances Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre 2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Faculty Grievances Policy

2. Purpose:

Consistent with the Faculty Handbook (FHB), the policy is to clarify the grievances policy for faculty members at AUS.

The policy of the Grievance Code, under which a faculty member who has a complaint against an administrative action or individual(s) at the level of the academic unit, the unit or the central administration is able to seek a remedy within the University.

3. Introduction/Background:

This policy is embedded in the Faculty Handbook.

Individuals in the following positions may not grieve under this code: all administrators, including the Chancellor, Vice Chancellors, Vice Provosts, Deans, Associate Deans, Directors and Department Heads. A faculty member serving as Associate Dean, Department Head or Director may invoke the code if, in his/her capacity as an individual faculty member (and not because of any action or omission in his/her capacity as Head of an academic unit), he or she is subjected to any of the actions listed in I.3 of this chapter. The Senate Executive Subcommittee, (hereinafter SES) will resolve questions concerning which capacity, as faculty member or administrator, gave rise to the complaint. (Procedures for grievances by administrators or faculty in administrative capacities may be found in the *HR Policy Manual*).

4. Policy Statement:

Definition of a Grievance

A grievance is a formal complaint by a member of the faculty that his/her terms or conditions of employment at the American University of Sharjah (hereinafter “the University”), or ability to act in his/her professional or academic capacity at the University has been significantly impaired due to serious violations as a result of one or more of the four items listed below. A grievance is not an opportunity for a faculty member to express disagreement over the judgment rendered by an administrator or committee; rather, it provides the opportunity to redress one of the following:

- i. violation of academic freedom as defined in Chapter B (Policy) - Section B.2.b
- ii. discrimination on the basis of age, disability, ethnic or national origin, gender, race or religion
 - o Note that University policy, in keeping with UAE labor law, does not allow extension of contracts after an individual has reached age 70
- iii. violation or misapplication of an applicable University contractual provision, practice, procedure, regulation or rule
- iv. violation of accepted standards of behavior in the workplace of the University as stated in the *Faculty Handbook*

The grieving faculty member must demonstrate the occurrence of procedural or factual errors in the case.

Notice and Suspension of Proposed Administrative Actions

The following actions – dismissal, suspension without pay, reduction in academic rank, reduction in salary, denial of promotion or reappointment – shall take effect only if the administrative officer of the University who intends to take action gives to the faculty member affected by the proposed action written notice of at least thirty (30) days in advance of its effective date, unless provisions to the contrary are explicitly stated in the *AUS Faculty Handbook*. Such notice shall be confidential, unless the faculty member affected by the proposed action waives confidentiality in writing.

However, the above-mentioned actions shall not take effect if the faculty member affected by the proposed action invokes the procedures of this code. In all cases of dismissal or non-renewal, efforts shall be made to bring the grievance procedure to conclusion by the end of Spring semester classes.

Nothing in this section nullifies the conditions of employment contained in the letter of appointment.

Mandate of the Grievance Committee

The responsibility of the Grievance Committee is two-fold:

- to reach a decision regarding the validity of the grievance, and, if the grievance is upheld,
- to recommend an action to provide relief to the grievant.

In reaching its recommendation for relief, the committee should consider the relief requested by the grievant(s), but the committee has wide discretion and may recommend appropriate relief within University guidelines and regulations.

The type and extent of relief may, at the committee's discretion, be influenced by the committee's views about factors such as:

- whether a violation was intentional or unintentional
- whether a violation involved negligence or was a reasonable misinterpretation of responsibilities
- the likelihood of the harm and its possible magnitude for situations in which possible future harm is involved

Confidentiality Requirement

Unless confidentiality is waived in writing by all parties, participants are required to maintain the confidentiality of the proceedings. Documented failure to comply that has been presented in writing to the Chair of the SES and confirmed as such by the SES will be added to the grievance file.

Once concluded, none of the involved parties to the grievance is to discuss any aspect of a case. The final documentation will be filed in the Chancellor's office. To the extent allowed by law, notices are privileged and cannot be compelled in any other proceeding.

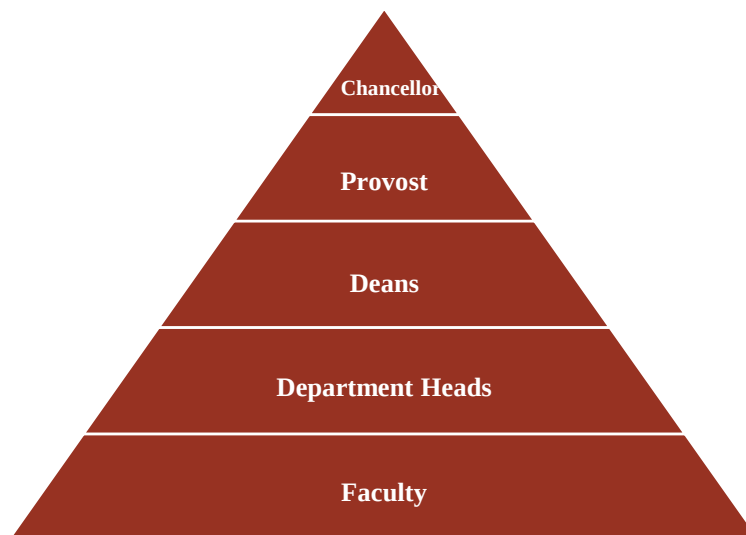
Information concerning a grievance may be provided to appropriate officials of the University on a need-to-know basis. Any person so informed shall be bound by confidentiality requirements.

Role of the Chancellor

The Chancellor of the University is the final decision maker under the terms of this code and is responsible to the Board of Trustees for actions as the chief executive officer of the University. The Chancellor is not subject to the grievance provisions of this code for decisions made or actions taken as Chancellor, whether based upon the advice of others or upon independent judgment of the needs and interests of the University.

In all matters, the Board of Trustees expects the Chancellor to adhere to the rules and regulations of the University and personally to maintain high professional and ethical standards. Any faculty member having complained that the Chancellor has violated the rules and regulations of the University or has failed to abide by appropriate professional and ethical standards may address his/her concerns in writing to the Chair of the Academic Affairs Committee of the Board of Trustees. Correspondence should be addressed to: “Chair, Academic Affairs and Research Committee, AUS Board of Trustees, c/o Office of the Chancellor,” with a copy of the complaint and any supporting documentation sent to the Chancellor. The Chair will inform the complainant and the Chancellor of the process to be followed and, when completed, the result of the review.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in faculty grants.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, and administrators appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

Faculty Evaluation policy is shared between faculty and administrators as applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

SES: Senate Executive Subcommittee

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

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Faculty Handbook

The official version of the handbook resides on the AUS website at the following URL:
<https://www.aus.edu/faculty-handbook/>

9. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Faculty Handbook. Any changes or updates to the Faculty Handbook are approved by the Council of Deans, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Faculty Senate and the Chancellor. The final approval for recommended changes/updates is by the Board of Trustees of the University.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised. No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: 971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

2. Staff Grievance Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0500ES16	Policy Title:	Staff Grievance Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Staff Grievance Policy

2. Purpose:

Maintain a productive work environment through the prompt resolution of disputes in the workplace while ensuring the fair treatment of all employees.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement:

AUS is committed to providing the best possible working conditions for its employees. This commitment is illustrated by the points below.

- AUS encourages an open and frank atmosphere in which any work- r e l a t e d problem, complaint, suggestion, or question is answered quickly and accurately by supervisors or management.
- AUS will endeavor to ensure fair and honest treatment of all employees. Supervisors, managers, and employees are all expected to treat each other with mutual respect.
- Each employee has the right to express his/her views concerning policies or practices to management in a business-like manner, without (fear of) retaliation. Employees are encouraged to offer positive and constructive criticism.
- Each employee is expected to follow established rules of conduct, policies, and practices. Should an employee disagree with the application of a policy or practice, the employee can express his or her disagreement through AUS' problem-solving procedure.
- No employee shall be penalized, formally or informally, for voicing a disagreement with AUS in a reasonable, business-like manner, or for using the problem-solving procedure.
- It is recognized that occasions or events may occur when an employee believes that a condition of employment or a decision affecting him/her is unjust or inequitable. In these situations, the employee is encouraged to make use of the following procedural steps. The employee may terminate the procedure at any step.

STEP 1

The employee presents the problem to his or her immediate supervisor within a reasonable period (30 working days or less) of the incident. If his or her supervisor, manager or department head is personally involved, he/ may begin with Step 3. The immediate supervisor must respond during the initial discussion or within seven working days of notification of the incident. The supervisor consults with appropriate management, when necessary. He/she will immediately notify Human Resources if the problem is discrimination or harassment. The supervisor will document the discussion for the record.

STEP 2

If the problem is not resolved to the employee's satisfaction within ten working days, by the supervisor he or she may presents the problem to the department head. The department head responds during discussion or within seven working days. The department head consults with appropriate management,

if necessary. He/she will immediately notify Human Resources if the problem is discrimination or harassment. The department head will document the discussion for the record.

STEP 3

If the problem is still not resolved to the employee's satisfaction, he/she may present the problem to Human Resources. Human Resources will investigate the matter including speaking with the supervisor, manager, other employees or anyone familiar with the incident. Human Resources attempts to mediate the matter and bring a resolution.

STEP 4

As a final step, if the matter is still not resolved to the employee's satisfaction, he/she can request a review and decision by the appropriate Senior Administrator or Provost. Human Resources will frame the issue to be reviewed and provide the results of the mediation/investigation before the appropriate Senior Administrator schedules an audience with the employee and renders a final and binding decision.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to academic staff and nonacademic staff.

6. Responsibilities: NA

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: NA

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2021	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

n. Graduate Assistantships Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0500AP17	Policy Title:	Graduate Assistantships Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Graduate Assistant Policy

2. Purpose:

To provide guidelines and eligibility criteria for awarding graduate assistantships to master's and doctoral students.

3. Introduction / background:

The purpose of offering Graduate Assistantships (GAs) at AUS is to attract highly qualified students who bring benefit to the academic community. There are two categories of Graduate Assistantships.

Graduate Teaching Assistantships (GTAs)

GTAs are intended to provide graduate students with opportunities to gain teaching-related experience by working in positions such as lab assistants.

Graduate Research Assistantships (GRAs)

GRAs are intended to provide graduate students with opportunities to develop research experience by working with a faculty member on research-related activities.

4. Policy Statement:

A graduate assistantship covers tuition waivers and/or stipends but do not cover other fees such as activities fees, dormitory fees, health insurance, etc. GAs may be funded through the OGS or through internal or external Faculty Research Grants (FRG). Section 4.1 provides information about OGS funded GAs, while Section 4.2 discusses FRG funded GAs. Finally, graduate student employment is discussed in Section 4.3.

Graduate Assistantships Funded by OGS

GTAs are funded through the OGS, while GRAs are mainly funded through faculty research grants with some limited funding available from OGS. The OGS informs the Associate Dean of the college/school of the GA budget allocated to the college/school for the following academic year.

GAs are competitively awarded by OGS during regular semesters (Fall or Spring) on a semester-by-semester basis; GRA & GTA funded through OGS follow the same application process.

Eligibility Requirements

- Graduate Assistantships are available to graduate students who have been admitted to the

university in good standing, meeting or exceeding all university and program-level requirements for full admission. Students on conditional or probationary status are not eligible for graduate assistantships.

- Graduate assistants must have achieved and must maintain a satisfactory academic record with a Cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) of 3.25 or greater in graduate level courses. Some graduate programs may establish additional and/or higher standards.
- Students on a graduate assistantship must register for at least six credits during the semester when they receive the award. Exceptions to this policy are allowed if the student is left with a smaller number of credits to complete the degree requirements.
- Graduate assistants are expected to make satisfactory progress toward completing their degree. Students may not delay completion of their degree in order to prolong an assistantship appointment
- AUS employees or their spouses who receive tuition remission for graduate courses are not eligible for a GA award by OGS.

Types of Assistantships Available at AUS and Corresponding Workload

For each of the two categories of graduate assistantship (GRA and GTA), AUS offers two types of assistantships:

Full-time assistantship

This type of graduate assistantship is highly competitive and is only offered to full-time graduate students at AUS.

Students on full-time assistantships are expected to be available at AUS during regular working hours (8:00 – 5:00 pm) and, hence, they are not allowed to work at other organizations while holding the assistantship.

A master's student who has been awarded a full graduate assistantship for at least two semesters is required to register for the thesis option, if offered in the program of study. However, a college/school may waive this requirement with the approval of the Department Head/Program Coordinator and the Associate Dean based on program goals and needs. Students are advised to check with their college/school regarding requirements for thesis registration prior to accepting the assistantship offer. Students must register for at least the number of waived credits per semester (6 to 9 credits). They may take no more than 12 credit hours per semester with the approval of the Department Head/Program Coordinator and by paying for the extra credits not covered by the GA.

Part-time assistantship

This type of graduate assistantship is available to both full- and part-time graduate students at AUS. The working hours vary according to the assigned duties but students are required to adhere to the timing specified by the Department Head/Program Coordinator.

Students must register for at least 6 credits per semester. They may take no more than 12 credit hours per semester with the approval of the Department Head/Program Coordinator. Students must pay for the extra credits not covered by the GA.

Graduate Assistantships Distribution for Master's Students

GAs for master's degree students are normally distributed by the Department Head/Program Coordinator as shown below. Program coordinators may adjust the allocation as per the available budget and needed workload for the program. A GA may work for up to 20 hours per week during a regular semester.

Graduate Teaching Assistantships (Funded by OGS)

Type of GTA	GTA Units	Stipend/Semester (in AED)	Credit hours waiver/semester	Expected hours of work/week
Full-time	Full	20,000	9.0	20.0
Full-time	Two-Thirds	13,333	6.0	16.0
Part-time	Half GTA	10,000	4.5	12.0
Part-time	One-Third	6,666	3.0	8.0

Graduate Research Assistantships (Funded by OGS)

Type of GRA	GRA Units	Stipend /Semester (in AED)	Credit hours waiver/semester	Expected hours of work per week
Full-time	Full	10,000	9.0	16.0
Full-time	Two-Thirds	6,666	6.0	12.0
Part-time	Half GTA	5,000	4.5	10.0
Part-time	One-Third	3,333	3.0	8.0

Graduate Assistantships Distribution for PhD Students

AUS offers a limited number of Graduate Assistantships (GAs) on a competitive basis to PhD students. PhD GAs cover tuition fee waiver for the whole program and monthly stipends that is determined through a formal contract signed between AUS and the student. PhD students work for 20 hours per week during regular semesters (fall and spring) and 40 hours per week during other times.

Appointments, Duration, and Responsibilities

Appointments, Duration Master's Students

Graduate assistants are appointed on a semester-by-semester basis. The GA is renewed every semester pending budget availability and as long as the student meets the eligibility criteria and performs assigned task with acceptable performance. GAs for master's students can be held for a maximum of two years (4 regular semesters).

Appointments, Duration PhD students

Graduate assistants are appointed on a yearly basis and the student must sign and adhere to the terms of the contract. The student's academic and GA work related performance will be subject to review every semester to decide on the continuation of the appointment. GAs for doctoral students can be held for a maximum of four years.

Responsibilities

The coordinator of the relevant graduate program or faculty supervisor is required to provide a detailed statement of duties and assignments for the graduate assistant at the beginning of every semester. Graduate assistants are responsible for adhering to weekly workload expectations.

Both full- and part-time assistants may serve as lab assistants, teaching assistants and/or research assistants.

Applying for Assistantships

New Students Applying for a Graduate Assistantship

New students applying for graduate assistantships must mention this on their application for graduate admission and submit any required document during the time of their application for admission. For PhD students, a special form for GA is required and can be downloaded from <https://www.aus.edu/graduate-assistantships-0>. For submission deadlines, please refer to the Graduate Academic Calendar posted on the AUS web page.

Continuing Students Applying for a Graduate Assistantship for the First Time

Students who did not receive a graduate assistantship when they initially joined an AUS graduate program may elect to apply for the assistantship at any time during their studies as long as they meet the eligibility criteria and deadline for application. Each college/school establishes an internal deadline when applications for an assistantship should be submitted by the student to the graduate Department Head/Program Coordinator so students are encouraged to contact their Department Head/Program Coordinator for details. To apply, continuing students must submit an Application for Graduate Assistantship form to the relevant Department Head/Program Coordinator by the deadline. The form is available at the Graduate Studies iLearn page. The Department Head/Program Coordinator may ask the students to submit two recommendation letters if they have not provided two letters during the application process.

Submission of GA Data Sheet to the OGS

Each college/school must submit the GA Database Sheet for graduate assistantship assignments to the OGS three weeks prior to the beginning of the semester.

Review Process

Complete application packages of students who meet the minimum requirements are reviewed by the relevant graduate programs. The Department Head/Program Coordinator will forward the GA recommendations to the dean or his/her designee of the relevant college/school. The dean or his/her designee will review the application packages and make recommendations to the VPRGS for decision. The awards of the GA are finally approved by the Provost.

Appointment

OGS will issue contracts for GAs at the beginning of each semester of award. Once the student accepts and signs the contract, OGS will inform the Finance Office about the tuition waivers granted to the GAs.

GA Payment Schedule

For master's students, stipends are paid on three installments during a regular semester. For doctoral students awarded an annual GA contract, stipends are paid on a monthly basis (no time sheets are needed). GAs will be paid through a direct deposit to their bank account provided to the Finance Department.

Graduate Assistantships Funded by Faculty Research Grants

This section provides guidelines to appoint a Graduate Research Assistant (GRA) using Faculty Research Grant (FRG) funds. The implementation of this process involves the Principle Investigator (PI), college/school associate dean, the Office of Finance, and the Graduate Studies. This procedure must be followed before the commencement of the GRA work with the PI. Students are encouraged

to contact program faculty for GRA opportunities.

Eligibility

GRAs funded using AUS FRG funds may be appointed provided that the student is enrolled in a graduate program, in good academic standing, and normally registered in credit bearing hours for a minimum of six (6) credit hours in the semester of award (fall or spring). For a summer term, there is no minimum requirement applicable for the number of credit hours for a GRA. AUS employees who join a graduate program may work as a GRA funded by faculty research grants (not by OGS) but prior approval from their work supervisor is needed demonstrating that their GRA assignment does not influence their employment duties at AUS. The workload for such cases will be limited to a maximum of 10 hours per week.

Workload

The workload for GRAs cannot exceed 20 hours per week during any semester when they are registered in credit bearing hours. A GRA may work up to 40 hours per week during breaks (Winter, Spring, or Summer) or a Summer semester when they are not registered in credit bearing hours; however, the GRA must be enrolled as a fulltime student in the regular semesters before and after the break or summer semester.

Compensation

A GRA is normally paid a maximum stipend of AED 20,000, and/or a maximum of Tuition Remission the equivalent to 9 credit hours during any Fall or Spring semester; a maximum stipend of AED 10,000, and/or a maximum of Tuition Remission the equivalent to 6 credit hours during Summer semester. The PI may adjust the tuition or stipend amount as per available budget or needed amount of work.

Appointment

OGS will issue contracts for GRAs at the beginning of each semester of award. Students may contact the associate dean for the application procedure. During breaks, no contracts are issued and the regular graduate student employment appointment and payment procedures are followed.

GRA Payment Schedule

Stipends will be paid over three installments in regular semesters and two installments during summer semester (no time sheets are needed). GRAs will be paid through a direct deposit to their bank account provided to the Finance Department

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all master's or doctoral students applying for or receiving a graduate assistantships.

6. Responsibilities:

- Graduate program coordinators evaluate, with relevant program committee, applications for GA and make recommendation to the dean or designee (associate dean)
- Dean or designee review program recommendation and submit approved applications to OGS
- OGS evaluate applications and prepare GA contracts for Provost Approval.
- Students must sign the graduate assistant contract and adhere to the terms and conditions of their appointment.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

OGS: Office of Graduate Studies

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GA: Graduate Assistantship
GTA: Graduate Teaching Assistantships
GRA: Graduate Research Assistantships
FRG: Faculty Research Grants
CGPA: Cumulative Grade Point Average

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Graduate Studies Policies and Procedures (available on Graduate Studies page on ilearn.aus.edu)

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	November 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

o. New Faculty Orientation Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0500AP18	Policy Title:	New Faculty Orientation Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	April 9, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

New Faculty Orientation Policy

2. Purpose:

The New Faculty Orientation (NFO) program is a way to learn about the university and make the transition to campus as smooth as possible.

The NFO program will:

- Provide an introduction to the campus and community, including resources and services.
- Incorporate cultural sensitivity training to ensure faculty awareness, appreciation and understanding of the diverse cultural, and social background within the university and the broader community.
- Describe the expectations and responsibilities of faculty.
- Outline policies and procedures that guide faculty life.
- Orient faculty to their roles in teaching, research, and service, and
- Familiarize faculty with mentoring and professional development opportunities.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

- It is mandatory for all the newly appointed faculty members (full-time, visiting, and adjunct) to attend the orientation sessions organized by the Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL) at the beginning of each academic semester.
- The orientation sessions shall take place during the non-teaching week prior to the start of the academic semester.
- Deans and Head of Departments are required to permit newly appointed faculty members to be excused from their regular duties to attend these orientation sessions.
- Departments are also expected to provide a new faculty member with a more specific orientation about the department and the specifics of each job assignment.
- During orientation, each new faculty member will receive information and training regarding the University policies, teaching, research, services, and other general information about the University.

5. Scope/applicability:

All new faculty whether full time or part time.

6. Responsibilities:

Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning. Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

None

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 9, 2024	New policy - to ensure compliance with the MOE standards.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

p. Employee Information and Privacy – Version 1

Policy Number:	0500ES19	Policy Title:	Employee Information and Privacy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	Pre 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 2, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Employee Information and Privacy

2. Purpose:

Emphasize to all AUS administrators the importance of confidentiality in handling employee information and guidelines for handling such information.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

In collecting, maintaining, and disclosing employee information, AUS strives to protect employees' privacy rights and interests and prevent inappropriate or unnecessary disclosures of information from any worker's file or online record. While complying with its governmental reporting and record keeping requirements, AUS strives to ensure that it handles all personal and job-related information about employees in a secure, confidential, and appropriate fashion in accordance with the principles and procedures outlined below.

4. Policy Statement:

Treatment of Confidential Information

All administrative employees are expected to treat personal information about employees as confidential and respect the need for protecting each employee's privacy by enforcing secure information handling procedures on the part of all employees whose job duties involve gathering, retaining, using, or releasing personal information about the organization's employees. AUS Human Resources collects and retains only such personal information, as it needs to effectively conduct business and administer its employment and benefit programs. HR takes reasonable steps to make sure that all personal and job-related information about employees is accurate, complete, and relevant for its intended purpose. Wherever possible, HR notifies affected employees if it needs additional personal information and gives these employees an opportunity to supply the requested data.

Security and storage of Employee records and medical information

All paper-based documents relating to AUS' employee record system are kept in securely locked files within HR. Electronic information is securely contained in the university's online systems.

Collectively, these files are accessible only to authorized HR staff and executives, managers, and supervisors who have a valid, demonstrable need to obtain specific information from an employee's employee file. Employees also are granted access to their employee files and records in accordance with the access procedures outlined below. All employee files and records must remain in the HR at all times.

If an individual with an authorized need to know requires to review information in an employee's employee file or online personnel records, HR will provide access upon written request. If the request is viewed as possibly intruding on the employee's privacy, access maybe denied.

All medical information relating to an employee is kept in the separate Medical Records System files maintained by the University Health Center. Access to these medical files is tightly controlled.

Ordinarily, medical information about an employee is supplied only to the worker's designated physician in accordance with the worker's written specific request.

Disclosure or release of employee information to government agencies

On occasion, AUS must provide information and data from its employee records and files to local government in accordance with record keeping and reporting requirements imposed by such agencies. In instances where a government agency requests information beyond that which it normally requires, AUS ordinarily advises the affected employees of the agency's information request.

If, however, an agency's information request occurs in the course of an agency investigation or if an agency asks AUS to keep such a request confidential, AUS, in its discretion, can comply with the agency's request. AUS ordinarily honors subpoenas demanding production of information with respect to any employee, but usually advises an employee of the subpoena and nature of the information requested, unless otherwise prohibited by law.

Disclosure or release of employee information to nongovernmental entities

In response to an information request from an outside organization, individual, or other nongovernmental entity, AUS normally verifies only the employment status and dates of employment for former or present employees. Salary may additionally be provided on letters for financial institutions. AUS does not provide any other information unless and until it has received from the employee or former employee a written request that it disclose or confirm additional specific information or it is required to do so by legal process.

Employees' access rights to Employee file information

All employees can review the information contained in their own file and online records, although AUS reserves the right to remove certain sensitive documents, including letters of reference and management planning documents such as succession or promotion plans. To prevent abuses of this access privilege, AUS also reserves the right to limit the number of times an employee can access his/her file during a twelve month period. Employees who are interested in reviewing the contents of their employee file should contact the HR and provide at least two days' notice of their desire to schedule a mutually convenient time for an appointment. Files cannot leave the HR Department and must be reviewed in the presence of an HRO.

Accuracy of basic employee information

To ensure that AUS' Employee files are updated with accurate and complete information, employees are asked to complete the Employee Declaration Form and to notify HR of any changes that need to be made in the following data:

- Name change due to marriage etc
- Contact information
- Physical residence
- Telephone numbers
- Changes of marital status
- Number of qualified dependents residing or out of UAE
- Beneficiary designations
- Scholastic achievements
- Training and development
- Individual to notify in case of an emergency

Correction or deletion of file information

Employees can request correction or deletion of information in their Employee records as appropriate by submitting a written request to the Executive Director of Employee Services. The Executive Director of Employee Services ordinarily checks with the head of the department where the record originated.

Within fourteen calendar days of receipt of a written request to amend a record, the Executive Director of Employee Services notifies the employee in writing that the amendment will be made as requested, or that the amendment request has been denied. In cases where a requested amendment is denied, the Executive Director of Employee Services must explain the reasons for refusing to make the change. A copy of the response must be placed in the individual's record if the request is denied.

If the Executive Director of Employee Services refuses to amend or delete the record, the individual has the right to enter into the record a statement setting forth the reasons for the individual's disagreement.

5. Scope/applicability:

All AUS administrative employees that handle employee information.

6. Responsibilities: N.A.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: N.A.

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre 2021	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	September 2, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10.. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

6. Students

a. Undergraduate Admissions Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0600EM01	Policy Title:	Undergraduate Admissions Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Enrollment Management	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Enrollment Management	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2027

1. Policy:

The American University of Sharjah is committed to equal treatment and opportunity for all of its applicants based on merit to ensure that the most qualified candidates are selected to fill the available places.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to comply with the American University of Sharjah (AUS) Board of Trustee's mandates/ directives, which advocate for equal merit-based educational opportunities for all applicants.

This policy is intended to clarify the requirements expected of all undergraduate applicants; and to identify means to manage all applications equitably and with transparency. No overlapping of responsibilities or conflict of interests among university units.

This Policy aims at ensuring the continuous enhancement and improvement of the undergraduate admissions process in support of the American University of Sharjah's mission by recruiting and registering undergraduate applicants who meet the university's minimum admission requirements.

3. Introduction / background:

Since the inception of the institution in 1997, the American University of Sharjah Board of Trustees mandated the establishment of an admission policy to manage the process of applying to the university following established minimum requirements and procedural guidelines.

4. Policy Statement:

American University of Sharjah places special emphasis on quality education. Applicants are considered based on their qualifications regardless of race, color, gender, religion, disabilities, age or national origin. The most qualified candidates are selected to fill the available places.

The medium of instruction is English and a good command of the language, both oral and written, is essential for students to be successful at AUS.

The university requires regular attendance at all classes. Students are not permitted to pursue AUS degrees through correspondence or by merely passing university examinations. AUS does not offer any degrees by distance education.

For admission consideration, secondary school grades and university grade point averages (if applicable) must meet the minimum established standards as set by the university. Furthermore, applicants with previous college/university experiences applying to AUS as first- year students will be

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considered only if they were in good standing in their previous college/university, provided seats are available.

Application Process

Admission to all AUS undergraduate programs is processed through the Office of Enrollment Management/Undergraduate Admissions. Applicants should address their inquiries and subsequent correspondence to:

American University of Sharjah
Office of Enrollment Management - Undergraduate Admissions PO Box 26666 - Sharjah, United
Arab Emirates
<https://infodesk.aus.edu>

To apply to undergraduate studies at AUS, applicants must:

- Complete the online application for applicants to an undergraduate degree program (HYPERLINK "<http://www.aus.edu/apply>")
- Upload clear scans of the required supplemental documents (details available at HYPERLINK "<http://www.aus.edu/admissions/bachelors-degrees/application-requirements>")
- Transfer applicants must also submit an official university transcript along with course descriptions.
- Submit SAT Math/EmSAT Math scores, as applicable to their secondary school certificate (see Secondary School Certificates section hereafter)
- Pay the application fee.

The Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions will notify the applicant of the university's final decision.

Minimum Admission Requirements

The American University of Sharjah's (AUS) minimum admission requirements, as stated on the AUS website will depend on the applicant's type of secondary education program and certificate. For non-vocational certificates, only subjects classified as academic will be accepted for admission consideration and the calculation of averages. Admission to the university is competitive, and the actual required minimum average for admission consideration and to guarantee a seat will depend on the variables below:

- Secondary education certificate or school average
- SAT or EmSAT Achieve Math scores
- English Language Proficiency Requirements: TOEFL (iBT), IELTS (Academic version), or EmSat Achieve
- Number of qualified applicants
- Number of available seats

The minimum required average for accepting an application for admission consideration must be the equivalent of 80 percent or more in the final year depending on the education system of secondary education, or 80 percent or more in the best two out of the last three years. Higher averages will be applicable for certain colleges and or majors. Other program-specific requirements or restrictions will also be applied.

English Proficiency Requirements

In order to be admitted to an AUS college/school, applicants must obtain a minimum score of: 80 on the Internet-Based TOEFL (iBT), or

550 on the AUS Institutional Paper-based TOEFL (ITP), or
6.5 on the academic IELTS, or

1550 on EmSAT (Achieve English)

Applicants who score below the minimum required TOEFL or IELTS score, but who otherwise meet AUS admission standards, will be admitted to the Achievement Academy Bridge Program at AUS if they meet the minimum English proficiency requirements of TOEFL (iBT) score 45 and above, or IELTS (Academic) score 5.0 and above, or EmSAT Achieve score of 1100 or above. For information on matriculation into the chosen field of study after studying in the Bridge Program, please refer to the 'Exit from the Bridge Program' section under the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program section:

<https://www.aus.edu/achievement-academy/bridge-program/courses>

Recognized Secondary School Certificates

AUS will recognize Secondary school certificates awarded by ministries of education, private schools and institutions. However, some countries award two levels of secondary school certificates. In this case, the university recognizes the higher certificate. The university accepts certificates awarded by private secondary schools that are recognized by their host country.

The university will accept certificates awarded by recognized qualification authorities, international boards and national boards.

Examples of Secondary School Certificates

Following is a list of some common certificates and the corresponding minimum levels of performance required for accepting an application at AUS. These certificates and levels of achievement serve only as guidelines for admission to AUS and may change depending on the education system or school. Moreover, they *may* differ from other institutions or the standards that are generally accepted in an applicant's native country.

The university may consider other types of secondary school certificates.

- National General Secondary School Certificates (Thanawiyah Amma): minimum cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) equivalent to 80%. (90% CGPA for General Track applicants from UAE schools applying to Engineering, Architecture and Interior Design).
- American-style High School Diploma: minimum cumulative Grade Point Average (CGPA) equivalent to 80% (90% CGPA for General Track applicants from UAE schools applying to Engineering, Architecture and Interior Design). SAT math scores or EmSAT math scores are also required as applicable.
- Canadian High School Diploma: minimum required average is the equivalent of 80 percent or more in the final year or in the best two years.
- French Baccalaureate or equivalent: obtaining the baccalaureate with an average equivalent to 80 percent.
- German Abitur: Minimum overall average in the German Abitur of 3.0.
- IGCSE, GCSE, GCE: at least five IGCSE/GCSE (O-level) subjects and two GCE (AS-level) subjects or One (A-level) subject, and obtain a minimum overall weighted average of B, as calculated by AUS of all the subjects and levels combined (Arabic Language and pEducation are not counted as part of the above number of subjects). BETCs are accepted under certain requirements and conditions. Applicants must complete Year 13 of schooling (equivalent to American Grade 12) and submit a sequencing certificate (certificate of school registration history) that confirms Year 13 as the last year of schooling.
- Subjects must be from at least four different groups (such as art, humanities, languages, math, sciences, and social studies).

- Only subjects classified as academic by AUS (including arts and creativity subject group) will be accepted for admission consideration.
- Indian Board(s) Certificates: complete 12th Standard and typically obtain a minimum of 60% or more in the Senior Secondary Certificate (12 Standard), or 60% or more in the best two years.
- International Baccalaureate Diploma (IB): Full IB diploma with six subjects (excluding Islamic Education) with at least three at the higher level and a minimum score of 24 points. Applicants with only the IB certificate can apply and will be assessed based on their credentials.
- Lebanese Baccalaureate: obtaining the baccalaureate with an average equivalent to 80 percent.
- Pakistani Boards Certificates: Senior Secondary School Certificate (12th Standard) required with an average equivalent to 80 percent or above, or a minimum average equivalent to 80 percent in the best two years, as calculated by the Office of Enrollment Management/Undergraduate Admissions.

Program Admission Requirements

Certain types of secondary school certificates will be accepted only for specific programs at AUS. Literary Certificates: Holders will be admitted to:

- The College of Arts and Sciences (excluding the biology, chemistry, environmental sciences, physics, and mathematics majors), the College of Architecture, Art and Design (excluding the architecture and interior design majors) and any major offered by the School of Business Administration.

Scientific Certificates: Holders will be admitted to any major in any of the colleges/schools.

Technical and Vocational Secondary School Certificates: Highly motivated and academically qualified students will be admitted to a major that corresponds to the nature of the technical or vocational secondary school program. For example, the holder of a technical secondary certificate in electricity may apply to electrical engineering.

Admission Procedures

Applicants may apply to the university on [apply.aus.edu](https://www.aus.edu) Early First Year Admission

Students in their final year of secondary school may apply for early provisional admission by submitting official transcripts from at least the two years previous to the final year of secondary school, SAT or EmSAT scores as required (refer to Secondary School Certificates earlier in this section).

Early First-Year admission will be offered only to highly qualified applicants and will not be considered final until students submit a recognized and official secondary school certificate, or equivalent, showing the successful completion of a secondary education and all items as requested in the applicant's letter of admission. Students are restricted from registering for courses until the admissions process has been completed.

Advanced Standing Credit Transfer

Applicants who achieve a minimum grade equivalent to B in the IB Higher Levels, GCE A- Levels, the Lebanese Baccalaureate, the French Baccalaureate, the German Abitur or the American Advanced Placement tests may be awarded course credit hours for first-year-level courses. For more information, refer to [HYPERLINK https://www.aus.edu/academics/registrars-services](https://www.aus.edu/academics/registrars-services) ". The complete transfer policy is available from the Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions. Refer to the table below for details.

Admitted applicants must submit a copy of their original secondary school certificate attested by the UAE Ministry of Education, or the appropriate authority, along with the subjects' descriptions to the Office of Enrollment Management/Undergraduate Admissions no later than the early registration of their second semester of study at AUS. Admitted applicants who submit their documents before their first semester of study will have their documents evaluated toward credit hours transfer as well

as exemption from appropriate placement tests. More information on placement tests is provided in the following section.

No transfer of advanced standing credit hours will be awarded after completion of the first semester of study at AUS.

Admitted applicants will be notified of their transferred credit hours by the Office of the Registrar.

The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the advanced standing students' records.

	Minimum Grade Required for Awarding Credit	Minimum Grade Required for Waiving Placement Test
British A-Level	B	C
International Baccalaureate (IB) Higher Level (6 and 7)	6	English 5 Math and Physics 5
French Baccalaureate (or equivalent)	13	Math 10 English 12
Lebanese Baccalaureate (or equivalent)	13 (out of 20) 65 (out of 100)	10–12 (out of 20) 50–64 (out of 100)
American Advanced Placement (AP)	4	3
German Abitur	7	10

All documents must be attested for submission to the Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions, to complete their admission process to be eligible to register for course before the start of the semester of admission.

Document attestation

Certification or attestation must be done in one of the following ways:

Applicants who complete their secondary education in the UAE must follow the attestation process below:

- Certificates and grade reports must be certified or attested by the UAE Ministry of Education.
- British system qualifications must be certified or attested by the British Council and the UAE Ministry of Education. The British Council requires the certificates to be attested by the school. The required attested certificates are the final IGCSE/GCSE/GCE grade reports. Originals will be returned to the enrolled applicants.
- Applicants who completed their secondary education outside the UAE must follow the applicable attestation process below:
 - Certification from country of origin:
 - Documents must be certified or attested by the authorized educational authority, the country's Ministry of Foreign Affairs and the UAE Embassy.
 - For countries not having a UAE Embassy, documents attested by the authorized educational authority must be certified in the UAE by the country's embassy and the UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

Pre-entry Requirements for First Year Students

Admission/Placement Tests

All first-year applicants who attain the minimum score of 80 or higher on TOEFL iBT, or 550 or higher on the AUS Institutional Paper-Based TOEFL (ITP) or 6.5 or higher on IELTS (Academic), or EmSat score of 1550 or above are required to sit for placement tests appropriate for their intended majors as shown in the following chart. For more information, visit <https://www.aus.edu/testing->

center/aus- placement-tests.

Required Placement Tests					
Majors	Placement Test				
	Engineering Math	Business Math	Architecture Math	Physics	English
Architecture/Interior Design	No	No	Yes	No	Yes
Biology/Chemistry/Environmental Sciences, Physics	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
Business Administration (all majors)/Economics (BA)	No	Yes	No	No	Yes
Computer Science	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
Design Management	No	Yes	No	No	Yes
Engineering majors	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
English Language and Literature	No	No	No	No	Yes
International Studies	No	No	No	No	Yes
Psychology	No	No	No	No	Yes
Mass Communication	No	No	No	No	Yes
Mathematics	Yes	No	No	Yes	Yes
Multimedia Design/Visual Communications	No	No	No	No	Yes
Undeclared Major	**	**	**	**	**

* Students with a declared concentration in international economics must take either the business math placement test or the engineering math placement text.

** Students with undeclared major must take all the placement tests of their intended major.

Notes:

- The appropriate placement test(s) must be taken before a student can enroll in the corresponding first-year course.
- Admitted Achievement Academy students may take the math and/or physics placement tests for their intended major.

Applicants will be exempted from taking certain placements tests in one of the following two ways:

- Applicants who have completed TOEFL (ITP or iBT), IELTS or EmSAT or SAT Subject Test will be exempted from taking the corresponding Admission/Placement test as follows:

Examination	Minimum Score	Exempted from
TOEFL (ITP)	610	English Placement Test
TOEFL (iBT)	102	English Placement Test
IELTS	7.5	English Placement Test
EmSAT Achieve English	1800-1900	English Placement Test

EmSAT Mathematics o For Science and Engineering Students o For Business and Architecture Students	1500 or above 1300 or above	Math Placement Tests
EmSAT Physics	1100 or above	Physics Placement Test
SAT Subject Test		
SAT Subjects - Math Level 1	600	Math Placement Test
SAT Subjects - Math Level 2	600	Math Placement Test
SAT Subjects - Physics Level 1	600	Physics Placement Test
SAT Subjects - Physics Level 2	600	Physics Placement Test

2. Transfer applicants awarded credit for Math, Physics and English by the Office of the Registrar may be exempted depending on subjects/courses completed and grades earned.
3. Applicants who achieve the stated grades in the previous Advanced Standing table, will be exempted from the corresponding admission/placement tests.

Applicants who meet any of the exemption criterion must submit a request along with copies of the relevant reports to the AUS testing Center for evaluation and the issuance of a written confirmation of the exemption if applicable.

Preparatory Courses

Students who score low on a particular placement test must enroll in an appropriate preparatory course (i.e., MTH 00X, PHY 00X, WRI 00X). The course's credits do not count toward graduation requirements. A failing grade in a preparatory course must not be changed in the student record by passing the placement test later. Students are allowed to repeat a preparatory course up to Sophomore I (less than 45 credits).

The Offer of Admission

The offer of admission, regardless of type, is valid only for the semester for which the candidate has applied. Applicants will be able to defer their admission for one semester. A written request should be submitted to the Office of Enrollment Management Undergraduate Admissions. Applicants who wish to defer the application for one academic year or longer must submit a new application form; an application fee will apply.

Conditional Admission

There is no conditional admission for undergraduate students at AUS

Admission Deposit

All admitted students, regardless of type, must pay a seat reservation deposit of UAE Dirhams (AED) 5,000. Without exception, the paid seat reservation deposit is non-refundable, non-transferable to others, and can't be utilized for any other purpose than the intended. These deposits will be deducted from the student's bill once the applicant joins AUS. If a student requests to defer admission to the following semester and the request is approved, the deposit will be applied to the following semester's invoice.

Falsified Admission Documents

AUS reserves the right to take disciplinary action up to and including the revocation of admission or permanent dismissal if the university determines that information has been misrepresented in application documents or falsified documents have been submitted in support of an application for admission or matriculation to a program.

Other Admission Categories

Transfer Admissions

Refer to the Transfer Admissions Policy.

Non-degree Admission

Non-degree status is the designation used for students who are enrolled in credit courses at AUS but who are not currently pursuing a degree program. Some students begin their studies in non-degree status while others do not wish to pursue a degree program. To be considered for admission, an applicant must meet the same minimum admission criteria established for freshman or transfer admission and must submit the corresponding application with all the required documents to the Office of Enrollment Management Undergraduate Admissions by the stated admission deadlines for each academic year.

American University of Sharjah students who have not yet completed their degree programs and students who have been dismissed from the university are prohibited from registering for non-degree status.

Non-degree students may enroll in any university course for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications. Courses are registered with the assistance of the College of Arts and Sciences. In courses with enrollment limits, priority is given to AUS students.

Non-degree students may request to change status to undergraduate degree-seeking students. For details, please refer to the Change of Status section hereafter.

Exchange Student Admission

An exchange student is not formally admitted to American University of Sharjah but is allowed to take courses at the university in the context of a semester exchange program. Exchange students must check with their home institutions about the transferability of AUS credits to their programs.

To be admitted as an exchange undergraduate student, a student must be enrolled in an undergraduate program at an accredited institution and be in good academic standing in his/her current institution. In addition, students must have attained a minimum Internet-Based TOEFL score of 80 or a minimum IELTS (Academic Version) score of 6.5, or they must have successfully completed the CEFR English C1 level.

Exchange students coming from institutions located in an English-speaking country and where English is the language of instruction, or from institutions with a TOEFL/IELTS admission requirement higher than at AUS, are exempt from this requirement. Students must first apply through the study abroad office at their home institutions. In addition, they must submit to the AUS Office of International Exchange Programs (IXO) a complete online application, accessible through www.aus.edu/ixo, along with an official university transcript showing courses in progress at the time of application.

To secure seats in courses, applications should be submitted by the fourth Saturday of April for summer and fall enrollment, and the fourth Saturday of October for spring enrollment. Exchange students register through IXO. They may enroll in any university course for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications. In courses with enrollment limits, priority may be given to AUS students.

Tuition and fees are governed by exchange agreements. Details are available with AUS IXO. Normally, a student is allowed to register as an exchange student for not more than one academic year. For further information, please contact IXO at ixo@aus.edu. Undergraduate students admitted as exchange students may request to change status to undergraduate degree-seeking students. For details, please refer to the Change of Status section hereafter.

Transient Student Admission Transient student status covers:

- those who have obtained their undergraduate or graduate degrees from AUS and have returned to take extra course(s) at AUS
- those who hold degrees from universities other than AUS and who want to take course(s) at AUS but not toward a degree

Applicants seeking transient student status at AUS must submit to the Office of the Registrar the complete Transient Student Application available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms.

Undergraduate transient students may enroll in any university course for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications. They must register for courses through the Office of the Registrar. In courses with enrollment limits, priority is given to AUS students. Normally, a student can register as a transient student for no more than one academic year.

Visiting Student Admission

A visiting undergraduate student is one who is not formally admitted to American University of Sharjah but is allowed to take courses at AUS for transfer back to the student's home institution. Visiting students are not registered in the context of a semester exchange program between AUS and the student's university. Visiting students must check with their home institutions about the transferability of AUS credits to their programs.

To be admitted as a visiting undergraduate student, a student must be enrolled in an undergraduate program at an accredited institution and be in good academic standing in his/her current institution. In addition, students must have attained a minimum Internet-Based TOEFL score of 80 or a minimum IELTS (Academic Version) score of 6.5, or they must have successfully completed the CEFR English C1 level. Visiting students coming from institutions located in an English-speaking country and where English is the language of instruction, or from institutions with a TOEFL/IELTS admission requirement higher than at AUS, are exempt from this requirement.

Applicants seeking visiting student status must submit to the AUS Office of International Exchange Programs (IXO) a complete online application accessible through www.aus.edu/ixo, along with an official university transcript showing courses in progress at the time of application. To secure seats in courses, applications must be submitted by the first Saturday of March for summer and fall enrollment, and the first Saturday of October for spring enrollment.

If the application is approved, registration will be completed through IXO. Visiting students may enroll in any university course for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications. In courses with enrollment limits, priority will be given to AUS students. Standard undergraduate tuition and fees apply.

A student is restricted to register as a visiting student for not more than one academic year. For further information, please contact IXO at ixo@aus.edu. Undergraduate students admitted as visiting students may request to change status to undergraduate degree-seeking students. For details, please refer to the Change of Status section hereafter.

Change of Status

Students may request a change of status from non-degree to undergraduate degree status or from exchange/visiting to undergraduate degree status. Interested students must submit the Transfer Applicant online application form by the deadlines specified in Application Deadlines. All admissions requirements for transfer admission in place at the time of the change of status request

must be met. In addition, students wishing to transfer to degree status must have achieved a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.00 in courses completed at AUS.

Courses taken at AUS while under exchange/non- degree/visiting status can be used to satisfy registration and graduation requirements where applicable. Grades earned in such courses will count in the cumulative grade point average (CGPA).

Courses completed outside AUS prior to admission to the degree program are evaluated for transfer of credit hours at degree program admission time. The university deadlines, rules and regulations governing transfer courses and credit hours will apply. The degree program graduation requirements are determined by the catalog effective when the student is admitted to the degree program.

Returning Students

Students in good standing who leave AUS for two or more consecutive semesters, inclusive of a semester of complete course withdrawal, and wish to resume studies must complete the online Returning Applicant application. Students who have been dismissed from AUS will not be eligible for readmission consideration.

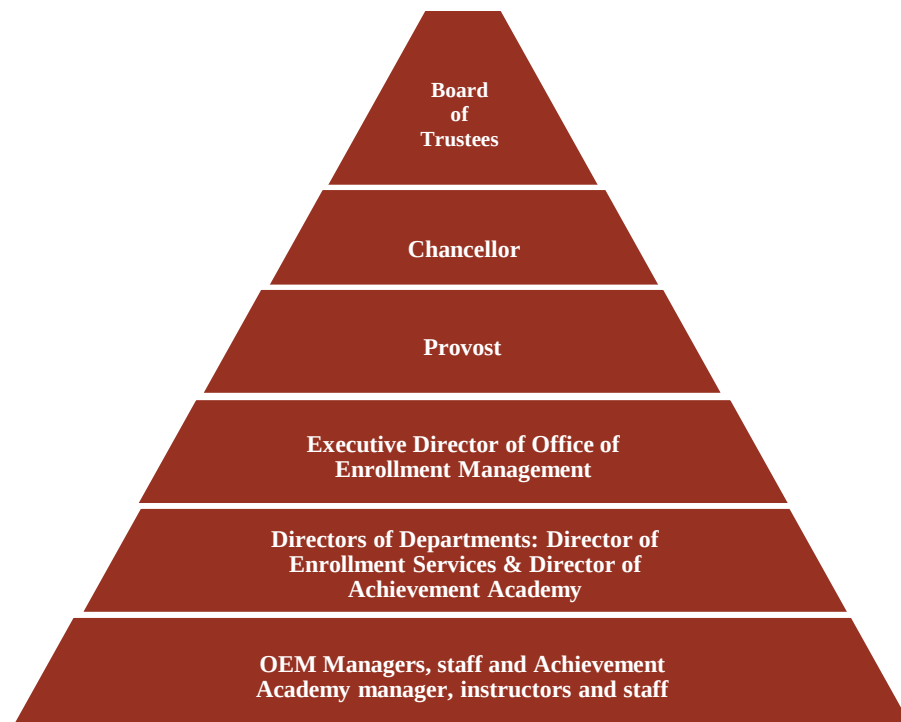
Readmission of returning students is subject to AUS academic rules and regulations on readmitting students. All admission requirements in place at the time of applying for readmission must be met.

Courses taken at another institution while on leave from AUS will not be transferred. Applicants with Mobility Issues

Depending on available facilities and the type of physical condition, the university may provide special services to applicants with mobility issues. Applicants are requested to contact the Academic Support Center at: asc@aus.edu or <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/accessibility-support-at-aus-empowering-every-student> to determine if a specific service can be provided by AUS. This information will be treated confidentially.

Implementation of the Undergraduate Admissions Policy

The below chart presents the flow of authority regarding the implementation of the Undergraduate Admissions Policy.



Compliance with the policy is ensured through a number of channels. The Office of Enrollment Management Managers and Directors generate periodic exception reports to flag any inconsistencies in applying the requirements of the policy which are shared for resolutions with the Executive Director of the Office of Enrollment Management. Moreover, biennial internal audits are conducted by the AUS Director of Internal Audit to ensure compliance with the policy.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all applicants and the Office of Enrollment Management employees.

6. Responsibilities:

Undergraduate Admissions policy: Office of Enrollment Management staff, including Directors and Managers:

- Shall not disclose Sensitive Information related to applicants to unauthorized individuals.
- Shall not modify or delete applicants' data unless authorized to do so.
- Shall maintain applicants' data in a secure manner.
- Shall complete specific confidentiality training if they have job related responsibilities that require access to Sensitive Information.

Detailed roles and responsibilities are defined within the various units in the Office of Enrollment Management: Enrollment Services, Admissions, Student Recruitment, and Achievement Academy. All employees will be held accountable for upholding the policy standards.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- CEFR: The Common European Framework of Reference for Languages: Learning, Teaching, Assessment, abbreviated in English as CEFR or CEF or CEFR, is a guideline used to describe achievements of learners of foreign languages across Europe and in other countries.
- iBT TOEFL: Test of English as a Foreign Language is a standardized test to measure the English language ability of non-native speakers wishing to enroll in English-speaking universities. The Internet Based Test (iBT) is one test from a suite that are available.
- IELTS: The International English Language Testing System is an international standardized test of English language proficiency for non-native English language speakers. It is jointly managed by the British Council, IDP: IELTS Australia and Cambridge Assessment English.

Sensitive information: Includes student academic records and personal data.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Admissions help: infodesk@aus.edu
- Minimum Admissions Requirements: <https://www.aus.edu/application-requirements>
- Applying to AUS: Applicants may apply to the university on apply.aus.edu Submitting application supplemental items: apply.aus.edu
- How to attest documents: www.aus.edu/attestations
- Submitting attested documents: <https://infodesk.aus.edu>
- Admissions deadlines: www.aus.edu/deadlines
- Advanced Standing Credit Transfer: www.aus.edu/transfer-of-credits Information about placement tests: <https://www.aus.edu/testing-center/aus-placement-tests>
- Booking for Placement Tests: banner.aus.edu
- Testing Center help: testingcenter@aus.edu
- Deferring admission: apply.aus.edu
- Transient Student Application form <https://www.aus.edu/academics/registrars-services#forms>
- AUS Undergraduate Admissions Prospectus: www.aus.edu/admissions/forms-and-publications
- Undergraduate catalog: www.aus.edu/catalog
- Exit from the Bridge Program: under the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program section: <https://www.aus.edu/achievement-academy/bridge-program/courses>

- Frequently asked questions, such as those listed below, are addressed on the AUS website:
<https://www.aus.edu/prospective-students>
 - *I'm looking for a university. Why choose AUS?*
 - *I've chosen AUS. How do I apply?*
 - *I've been accepted. What's next?*

9. Policy history:

The policy history started with the document prepared by the Office of Enrollment Management at the American University in Sharjah in 1997 on Undergraduate Admissions, which was revised June 2017 and updated in November 2019.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 2017 and November 2019	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	A number of changes to highlight changes in admission policies and practices	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	April 25, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 3, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Executive Director of the Office of Enrollment Management	Tel: +971 6 5151001	ashuhaimy@aus.edu

b. Graduate Admissions Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0600EM02	Policy Title:	Graduate Admissions Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Enrollment Management	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Enrollment Management	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

The American University of Sharjah is committed to equal treatment and opportunity for all its applicants based on merit, ensuring that the most qualified candidates are selected to fill the available positions.

AUS considers all applications based on qualifications, regardless of race, color, gender, disability, religion, age, or national origin.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to conform to the American University of Sharjah (AUS) Board of Trustee's mandates/ directives, which advocate for equal merit-based graduate educational opportunities for all applicants.

The policy complies with the 2019 Standards and subsequent decrees of the Commission for Academic Accreditation (CAA) of the Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division in the United Arab Emirates. The policy is also to ensure compliance with AUS' accrediting agency, the Middle States Commission on Higher Education (MSCHE) recognized by the US Secretary of Education and the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).

The Admission policy is intended to clarify the requirements expected of all graduate applicants and identify means to manage all applications equitably and transparently. The Admissions policy demonstrates the roles of each unit at the university, avoiding overlaps or conflicts between the units.

This Policy also aims to continuously enhance and improve the graduate admissions process, recruiting and registering graduate applicants who meet the university's minimum admission requirements in support of the American University of Sharjah's mission.

The policy is to be revised regularly based on changes in the CAA requirements, MSCHE accreditation requirements, and the graduate programs' requirements once approved by the CAA.

3. Introduction/background:

As a part of the UAE Higher Education System, and since its inception in 1997, the American University of Sharjah has a range of CAA stipulations, accreditors' requirements, and board of trustees' directives, which it must comply with. These requirements also change over time, so it is important that we have processes to keep coping with these changes and regularly review, check, and update policies and practices to maintain compliance. This policy guides those processes and assists us in demonstrating compliance when required.

Following is a summary of some of the general and specific requirements for this current update:

- Text of the sections and subsections of the policy were revised and detailed.
- The GRE exam was removed from being an admission requirement to the doctoral programs, PhD-MSE, PhD-BSBE and PhD ESM.
- Reference Letters were added as an Admission requirement to all master's programs applications.

4. Policy Statement:

This policy aims to outline the graduate admissions standards and the graduate program-specific admission criteria for entering the University.

The application form and the required documents listed below must be submitted to the Office of Enrollment Management/ Graduate Admissions at apply.aus.edu. The Office of Enrollment Management/ Graduate Admissions must review all the complete applications submitted by the application deadline. The pertinent degree program's graduate admission committee recommends admission to a specific graduate degree program. The Office of Enrollment Management/ Graduate Admissions will notify the applicant of the university's final decision.

4.1 General University Requirements for Graduate Admission

For full admission to a graduate program at AUS, an applicant must meet the general university admission requirements detailed in the sections below. Some degree programs may require additional specific admissions requirements. For details, please refer to the Program Specific Admissions Requirements section below.

4.2 Requirements to apply to a PhD degree program

- 4.2.1 Hold a master's degree from an independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS. Applicants with a master's degree obtained outside the UAE must submit an equivalency certificate or qualification recognition report (QRR) of their degree from the UAE Ministry of Education.
- 4.2.2 Have achieved a minimum master's degree cumulative grade point average (CGPA) of 3.00 (on a scale of 4.00) or its equivalent. Some programs may require a higher CGPA.
- 4.2.3 Have attained a minimum iBT score of 80 or a minimum IELTS score of 6.5 (Academic Version), or a minimum EmSAT (Achieve - English) score of 1550
- 4.2.4 Submit three reference letters to the Office of Enrollment Management–Graduate Admissions along with the application using the AUS online template (apply.aus.edu). At least two of the letters are to be from an academic advisor/faculty member familiar with the applicant's background.
- 4.2.5 Submit a Statement of Purpose (about 1,500 words) describing experiences, research interests, and reasons for applying for admission to the doctorate program
- 4.2.6 Submit a current curriculum vitae/resume

Only applicants meeting the full admission requirements will be considered for PhD degree program admission.

4.3 PhD Degree Programs Specific Admissions Requirements

Applicants are also required to meet the following program-specific requirements:

4.3.1 Applicants to the PhD in Business Administration (PhD-BA) degree program must meet the following program admission requirements for full admission:

- Applicants must have completed a master of science relevant to the concentration applied for, or a Master of Business Administration degree
- Applicants must submit official Graduate Management Admission Test (GMAT) scores (required for PhD BA program only; if GMAT is not available, General Graduate Record Examination (GRE) test scores are acceptable).
- Applicants to the PhD-BA with a Concentration in Finance must have completed a graduate-level course in applied econometrics.

4.3.2 Applicants to the PhD in Engineering - Engineering Systems Management (PhD-ESM) degree program must meet the following program admission requirements for full admission:

- Applicants must hold a master's degree in engineering from an independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS. Applicants with non-engineering master's degrees may be considered on a case-by-case basis.

4.3.3 Applicants to the PhD in Materials Science and Engineering (PhD-MSE) degree program must meet the following program admission requirements for full admission:

- Applicants must have a Master's degree in any of the following fields: materials science, materials engineering, physics, chemistry, mechanical engineering, electrical engineering, chemical engineering, or civil engineering.
- Students with a relevant master's degree but not in Materials Science or Materials Engineering will be required to complete bridging courses. The bridging courses are assigned by the program and must be completed to resume studies at AUS.

4.3.4 Applicants to the PhD in Biosciences and Bioengineering (PhD-BSBE) degree program must meet the following program admission requirements for full admission:

- The PhD-BSBE degree program accepts applicants from a wide variety of natural sciences backgrounds, including biology, chemistry, physics and biotechnology, and from engineering backgrounds, including biomedical, chemical, computer, electrical, industrial and mechanical engineering. In addition to meeting the university's general requirements for admission to PhD degree programs, applicants to the PhD-BSBE degree program must have successfully completed university-level courses in calculus, physics, statistics, biology/cellular biology, and human anatomy and physiology, as demonstrated through their undergraduate or graduate-level degree courses.
- Where a background requirement is not met, applicants will be required to demonstrate knowledge acquisition by successfully passing relevant placement test(s), as mandated by the program. Applicants who do not successfully pass a required placement test but otherwise meet all admission requirements must successfully complete undergraduate or master's-level courses specified by the program coordinator prior to admission to the PhD-BSBE degree program.

4.3.5 Applicants to the PhD in Mathematics (PhD-MTH) degree program must meet the following program admission requirements for full admission:

- Applicants must have a Master of Science degree in Mathematics or Applied Mathematics.

4.4 Requirements to apply for a master's degree program

- Hold a four-year bachelor's degree from an independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education and by AUS. Applicants with a bachelor's degree obtained outside the UAE must submit an equivalency certificate or qualification recognition report (QRR) of their degree from the UAE Ministry of Education.
- Have attained a minimum undergraduate cumulative grade point average (CGPA) of 3.00 (on a scale of 4.00) or its equivalent
- Have attained a minimum iBT score of 80 or a minimum IELTS score of 6.5 (Academic Version) or a minimum EmSAT (Achieve - English) score of 1550
- Submit at least one reference letter to the Office of Enrollment Management–Graduate Admissions with the application using the AUS online template (apply.aus.edu). Specific programs require at least two reference letters, as indicated in the program-specific requirements below.
- Submit a current curriculum vitae/resume.

4.5 Master's Degree Programs Specific Admissions Requirements

Applicants are also required to meet the following program-specific requirements:

- Masters of Business Administration (MBA) applicants must submit a GMAT score report or the AUS MBA test.
- Applicants to the Engineering graduate programs offered by AUS are required to submit two reference letters to the Office of Enrollment Management-Graduate Admissions with their graduate application using the required online template available at apply.aus.edu.

4.6 Applicants must present attested documents based on the criteria below:

- Requirements for graduates of UAE public universities: Official university transcripts should be submitted in sealed envelopes. Original certificates should be presented to the Office of Enrollment Management for verification. Electronic transcripts and graduation certificates can be accepted if received by email directly from the university or if they can be verified online.
- Requirements for graduates of AUS: Official attested graduation diploma and university transcripts. The attestations have to be completed by the UAE Ministry of Education. Unattested transcripts can be accepted if submitted in a sealed envelope or received by email from the Registrar's Office.
- Requirements for graduates of UAE universities accredited by the Ministry of Education: Official attested graduation diploma and university transcripts. The attestations have to be completed by the UAE Ministry of Education.
- Requirements for graduates of international Universities (Universities outside UAE): Official attested university transcripts and attested graduation Diploma. The attestations can be done in one of the following methods:
 - In the country of graduation: attest by the authorized educational authority/ministry in the country of graduation. Both documents must be certified by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of that country and the UAE Embassy in the country of graduation.
 - In the UAE (for countries not having the UAE Embassy, the following might be accepted by the Ministry of Foreign Affairs where applicable): attest by the authorized educational authority/ministry in the country of graduation, the country's embassy in the UAE and the UAE Ministry of Foreign Affairs.

4.7 Conditional Admission

4.7.1 Conditional Admission Requirements

Conditional admission to a master's graduate degree program may be granted to applicants holding a four-year bachelor's degree from an independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS and who meet any of the following requirements:

- Attainment of a minimum cumulative GPA of 2.50 (on a scale of 4.00) or equivalent. Applicants with CGPAs below 2.5 and 2.0 may be considered for conditional admission on a case-by-case basis as evaluated by the program.
- Attainment of a minimum Internet-based TOEFL (iBT) score of 71, a minimum IELTS score of 6.0 (Academic Version), or a minimum EmSat Achieve-English score of 1400. However, the MBA and TESOL programs require a minimum iBT score of 80, an IELTS score of 6.5 (Academic Version), or an EmSat Achieve-English result of 1550.
- Conditional admission applicants may also be required to meet specific requirements specified by their requested degree program. Applicants should consult the relevant degree program section of the graduate catalog www.aus.edu/catalog.
- Each graduate degree program may also assign undergraduate bridging courses and/or specially tailored courses for conditional admission students. Credits from these courses do not satisfy credit requirements for completing the graduate degree program and are not used to calculate the cumulative GPA.

4.7.2 Completing the Conditional Admission Requirements

To be accorded full admission into a graduate degree program, a conditional admission student must:

- Achieve a cumulative GPA of at least 3.00 in the first two graduate-level courses (for a minimum of six credits). Courses must be completed over a maximum period of two consecutive semesters. Applicants who do not satisfy the cumulative GPA condition after completing the six credit hours can petition the Graduate Admissions Office for a one-semester extension.
- Achieve the required English Language Proficiency score for full admission before the beginning of the second semester: an iBT TOEFL score of 80, an IELTS score of 6.5 (Academic Version), or an EmSat Achieve-English result of 1550.

If either provision or any additional specific conditions imposed by the degree program are not met, the student will not be allowed to continue their studies at AUS.

4.8 Waiver of English Language Proficiency Requirement

Applicants to AUS graduate degree programs may be exempted from the English language proficiency admission requirement provided the conditions below are met. The Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions makes decisions regarding exemptions. Applicants are required to present supporting documents.

4.8.1 Applicants to a Master's Degree Program

- Applicants who are English native speakers and who have completed their undergraduate education in an English-medium institution may be considered for exemption from the English language proficiency admission requirement.
- Holders of a bachelor's degree awarded by AUS are exempted from the English language proficiency admission requirement.

4.8.2 Applicants to a PhD Degree Program

Applicants who have earned a master's degree from an institution where English is the language of instruction and who have met the AUS English language proficiency requirement for full graduate admission at the time of their admission to that master's degree program may be considered for exemption from the English language proficiency admission requirement.

4.9 Other Admission Categories

4.9.1 Non-degree Admission

Non-degree graduate students are those who wish to take AUS courses for academic credit but do not seek a master's degree. Students are admitted to AUS with non-degree status if they meet the requirements for full or conditional graduate admission. Complete applications must be submitted to the Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions. The following additional criteria are applicable:

- AUS graduate students who have been dismissed or who interrupt their studies may not apply for admission as graduate non-degree seeking students.
- AUS graduate students enrolled in a degree program may not change their status to graduate non-degree-seeking students.
- Non-degree graduate students may register for a maximum of nine credits at the graduate level.
- Non-degree graduate students who do not meet the requirements for full admission may register for no more than six credits in their first semester of study.
- Graduate students admitted as non-degree may request to change their status to graduate degree-seeking students.

If all continuation requirements of conditionally admitted students are met (*refer to the Conditional Admission section earlier in this section*), registration in a subsequent semester/term will be allowed. Registration in courses will be subject to approval by the relevant graduate program director.

4.9.2 Second-degree Admission

Holders of a master's degree awarded by AUS or another independently accredited university recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and by AUS may apply for admission to an AUS master's degree program.

A second graduate degree applicant must apply through the Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions. A complete application with the official transcript of the previously earned graduate degree must be submitted to the Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions by the assigned deadlines.

- To be considered for admission, applicants must satisfy the General University Requirements for Graduate Admission and any specific requirements set by the graduate degree program they are applying to. Holders of a master's degree awarded by AUS are considered to have met the AUS General University Requirements for Graduate Admission.
- Graduate courses applied toward a previously earned graduate degree program may be considered for transfer credit. Whether the first graduate degree was awarded by AUS or

by another university, the grades earned for courses completed to fulfill the requirements of the first graduate degree program will not count in calculating the cumulative grade point average for the second graduate degree program. Approved courses that meet the graduation requirements of the second-degree program will be recorded as transferred courses. For details on the transfer of credits, see the Transfer Credit Policy later in this section.

Policies and regulations governing registration, grades, and graduation requirements apply.

4.9.3 Transient Student Admission

Transient student status covers those who have obtained their undergraduate or graduate degrees from AUS and have returned to take extra course(s) at AUS.

Applicants seeking transient student status at AUS must submit the complete Transient Student Application form to the Office of the Registrar (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms).

Transient students may enroll in any university course for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications. They must register for courses through the Office of the Registrar. Priority is given to AUS students in courses with enrollment limits. Normally, a student can register as a transient student for one academic year.

4.9.4 Visiting Students Admission

A visiting student is one who is not formally admitted to the American University of Sharjah but is allowed to take courses at AUS for transfer back to the student's home institution. Visiting students are not registered in the context of a semester exchange program between AUS and the student's university. Visiting students should check with their home institutions about the transferability of AUS credits to their programs.

To be admitted as a visiting graduate student, a student must be enrolled in a graduate program at an accredited institution and be in good academic standing in his/her current institution.

In addition, students must have attained a minimum Internet-Based TOEFL score of 80 or a minimum IELTS (Academic Version) score of 6.5 or successfully completed the CEFR English C1 level. Visiting students coming from institutions located in an English-speaking country and where English is the language of instruction or from institutions with a TOEFL/IELTS admission requirement higher than at AUS are exempt from this requirement.

Applicants seeking visiting student status must submit to the AUS Office of International Exchange Programs (IXO) a complete online application accessible through www.aus.edu/ixo and an official university transcript showing courses in progress at the time of application. To secure seats in courses, applications should be submitted by the first Saturday of March for summer and fall enrollment and the first Saturday of October for spring enrollment.

If the application is approved, registration is completed through IXO. Visiting students may enroll in university courses for which they have the necessary academic background and qualifications, subject to approval by the relevant graduate program director or college/school associate dean. In courses with enrollment limits, priority is given to AUS students. Standard graduate tuition and fees apply.

Students can register as visiting students for one academic year.

Graduate students admitted as visiting students may request to change status to graduate degree-seeking students.

4.10 Transfer Credit Policy

Transfer credit hours may be awarded to applicants from the following categories:

- 4.10.1 Transfer applicants from recognized graduate schools at independently accredited universities recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division who meet the General University Requirements for Graduate Admission/Full Admission
- 4.10.2 Second-degree applicants with a master's degree awarded by AUS or by recognized graduate schools at independently accredited universities recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division who meet the General University Requirements for Graduate Admission/Full Admission
- 4.10.3 Applicants to a master's degree program with a bachelor's degree awarded by AUS who have completed master's-level courses while at the undergraduate level in the context of the AUS Accelerated Master's Program (AMP), and who meet the General University Requirements for Graduate Admission/Full Admission Applicants for transfer of credit hours must submit their official transcripts, syllabi and other material required by the program to the Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions by the application deadlines specified earlier in this section.
- 4.10.4 Applicants with transcripts from two or more institutions of higher education are eligible for transfer evaluation of only the courses completed at the institutions meeting the AUS transfer admission requirements.
- 4.10.5 Transfer credit hours are evaluated at the time of admission. Transcripts of transfer students will be evaluated only once.
- 4.10.6 To be evaluated for transfer, the coursework must have been taken for graduate credit and applied toward a graduate degree at the host institution. Courses successfully completed in the context of the AMP qualify for evaluation toward transfer of credit hours. Only graduate-level courses completed with a grade of B or higher will be evaluated for transfer of credit hours.
- 4.10.7 Courses identified as equivalent in content and level to AUS courses will be transferred as the equivalent AUS course. Other appropriate graduate-level courses may be transferred as electives. Transfer of credit hours will not be accepted for research and thesis hours, travel experience, or work/life experience.
- 4.10.8 Courses completed more than five years from the start date of the first semester of study of the current graduate degree program at AUS are not transferable.
- 4.10.9 Courses related to areas taught within the School of Business Administration will be evaluated for credit hours transfer only if completed within institutions accredited by the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB International), the European Quality Improvement System (EQUIS), or from universities approved by the School of Business Administration.
- 4.10.10 Grades earned in transferred courses do not count in the student's cumulative GPA. Credit hours of transferred courses count in the cumulative earned hours and may apply towards meeting registration and graduation requirements.
- 4.10.11 Applicants to a master's degree program may be granted up to six credit hours in master's-level courses. Applicants to a PhD degree may be granted up to nine credit hours in doctoral-level courses. Students granted transfer credit hours must satisfy the university's graduation residence requirements as outlined in this catalog's Academic Policies and Regulations section.
- 4.10.12 While credit hours will be temporarily transferred, the student will not be awarded his/her graduate degree until AUS receives the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division verification of the host institution's transcript.
- 4.10.13 Students will be notified of their transferred credit hours by the Office of the Registrar.
- 4.10.14 The relevant academic divisions at AUS make decisions regarding the award of transfer credit hours with input from faculty having expertise in the subject area. The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the transfer students' records.

4.11 The Offer of Admission

The offer of admission, regardless of type, is valid only for the semester for which the candidate has applied. Applicants can defer their admission for one semester. A written deferral request should be submitted to the Office of Enrollment Management/Graduate Admissions. Applicants who wish to defer the application for one academic year or longer must submit a new application form; an application fee will apply.

4.12 Falsified Admissions Documents

AUS reserves the right to take disciplinary action, up to and including the revocation of admission or permanent dismissal, if the university determines that information has been misrepresented in application documents or that falsified documents have been submitted to support an application for admission or matriculation to a program.

4.13 Implementation of the Graduate Admissions Policy

The chart below presents the flow of authority regarding the implementation of the Graduate Admissions Policy. Compliance with the policy is ensured through several channels. The Office of Enrollment Management Managers and Directors generate periodic exception reports to flag any inconsistencies in applying the policy's requirements, which are shared for resolutions with the Executive Director of the Office of Enrollment Management. Moreover, the AUS Director of Internal Audit conducts biennial internal audits to ensure compliance with the policy.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all applicants to master's and doctoral programs.

To ensure the concerned University departments apply the standards and requirements consistently and accurately, the outlined policies and related processes are shared with the Admissions Office, Academic units and programs, the Office of the Registrar, and the Office of Graduate Studies.

The Admissions requirements and standards, related processes, and petition process are made available to all applicants and students in the Graduate Catalog.

6. Responsibilities:

- Office of Graduate Admission
The Graduate Admissions staff is responsible for processing complete applications following the established policies and requirements, ensuring the minimum admission requirements are met, and applying admissions conditions as applicable.
- Graduate Associate Deans / Program Coordinators
The Graduate Associate Deans and Program Directors are responsible for reviewing and admitting or rejecting applicants based on their academic backgrounds and seat availability, ensuring the students are fit for the programs, and imposing bridging courses and other requirements to ensure the students' success. The Graduate Associate Deans / Program Coordinators also coordinate with the Office of the Registrar to approve awarding course credit transfers for eligible courses claimed by eligible transfer applicants.
- Office of Graduate Studies
The Office of Graduate Studies constantly reviews the policies to make sure they are in line with updates by the programs and the programs' accreditors.

- Office of the Registrar
The Office of the Registrar is responsible for updating the requirements per the policies in the Graduate Catalog and applying them to students regarding petitions, credit transfers, and bridging courses.
- Office of Institutional Research and Analytics
The Office of Institutional Research and Analytics is responsible for documenting the policies and communicating the updates to the CAA.

All the units with access to applicants and student information shall not disclose sensitive information to unauthorized individuals or delete University data or documents unless authorized.

All the involved employees will be held accountable for upholding the policy standards applicable to their responsibilities.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Certificate of Equivalency (CEQ): Currently known as QRR, the certificate of equivalency confirms that the earned higher education degree is from an accredited university outside the UAE and complies with the UAE Ministry of Education's guidelines and international academic standards.
- EmSAT: EmSAT Achieve English is an English assessment test offered by UAE MOE. It is a computer-based exam with six major sections: grammar, vocabulary, sentence construction, reading, extended reading, and writing.
- GMAT: The Graduate Management Admission Test is a computer adaptive test intended to assess certain analytical, writing, quantitative, verbal, and reading skills in written English for use in admission to a graduate management program, such as an MBA program.
- GRE: Graduate Record Examinations is a standardized exam used to measure one's aptitude for abstract thinking in the areas of analytical writing, mathematics, and vocabulary. The GRE is commonly used by many graduate schools to determine an applicant's eligibility for the program.
- iBT TOEFL: Test of English as a Foreign Language is a standardized test to measure the English language ability of non-native speakers wishing to enroll in English-speaking universities.
- IELTS: The International English Language Testing System is an international standardized English language proficiency test for non-native English speakers. It is jointly managed by the British Council, IDP: IELTS Australia, and Cambridge Assessment English.
- MA TESOL: Master of Arts in Teaching English to Speakers of Other Languages
- MBA: Master of Business Administration
- MSCHE: Middle States Commission on Higher Education. The MSCHE is an institutional accrediting agency recognized by the US Secretary of Education and the Council for Higher Education Accreditation (CHEA).
- PhD-BSBE: PhD in Biosciences and Bioengineering
- PhD ESM: PhD in Engineering - Engineering Systems Management
- PhD-MSE: PhD in Materials Science and Engineering
- Qualification Recognition Report (QRR): a certificate confirming that the earned higher education degree is from an accredited university outside the UAE and complies with the UAE Ministry of Education's guidelines and international academic standards.
- Sensitive information: Includes student academic records, medical information, and personal data.
- Visiting student: A visiting student is one who is not formally admitted to the American University of Sharjah but is allowed to take courses at AUS for transfer back to the student's home institution.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Frequently asked questions on the AUS website: <https://www.aus.edu/faq>
- Information required by prospects: <https://www.aus.edu/prospective-students>
- Applying to AUS and uploading application documents: apply.aus.edu
- Admissions help: infodesk@aus.edu
- How to attest documents: www.aus.edu/attestations
- Deferring admission: www.aus.edu/admissions/bachelors-degrees/application-deferment
- Graduate catalog: www.aus.edu/catalog
- Transient Student Application form www.aus.edu/registration/forms
- AUS Graduate Admissions Prospectus: www.aus.edu/admissions/forms-and-publications
- AUS Accreditation Information: www.aus.edu/about/aus-at-a-glance/accreditation
- Doctoral Degree Admissions Requirements: www.aus.edu/admissions/doctorsal-degrees/application-requirements
- Doctoral Admissions Deadlines: www.aus.edu/deadlines-for-doctoral-admissions
- Master's Degree Admissions Requirements: www.aus.edu/admissions/masters-degrees/application-requirements
- Master's Admissions Deadlines: www.aus.edu/deadlines-for-masters-admissions

9. Policy history:

The admissions policy was initialed in 1997 and since then has been updated regularly in response to the growth in the university graduate programs and to the CAA requirements. The changes have been captured in each academic year's Graduate Catalog. In the future, major changes will be recorded and included in this section of the policy.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Changes to reflect updated admission policies and practices	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 3, 2024	Changes to reflect updated admission policies and practices	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB. PhD programs in Mathematics and BSBE have been added to the policy statement. Admission requirements for the (PhD-BSBE) program has been updated to match the statement in the catalog.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Executive Director of the Office of Enrollment	Tel: +971 6 5151001	ashuhaimy@aus.edu

Management		
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c. Transfer Admissions Policy – Version 6

Policy Number:	0600EM03	Policy Title:	Transfer Admissions Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Enrollment Management - UG Admissions	Issue Date:	Pre -2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs Instruction Office of Enrollment Management	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Transfer Admissions Policy

The American University of Sharjah is committed to equal treatment and opportunity for all of its applicants based on merit to ensure that the most qualified candidates are selected to fill the available places.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to comply with the American University of Sharjah (AUS) Board of Trustee's mandates/ directives, which advocate for equal merit-based educational opportunities for all applicants.

This policy is intended to clarify the requirements expected of all undergraduate transfer applicants; and to identify means to manage all applications equitably and with transparency. No overlapping of responsibilities or conflict of interests among university units.

This Policy aims at ensuring the continuous enhancement and improvement of the undergraduate admissions process in support of the American University of Sharjah's mission by recruiting and registering undergraduate applicants who meet the university's minimum admission requirements.

This policy provides a detailed list of the conditions governing admission consideration as well as the requirements for transfer students.

3. Introduction / background:

Not Applicable

4. Policy Statement:

Undergraduate Students Transfer Admission Requirements

Depending on available seats, candidates transferring from institutions of higher education may be considered for admission, subject to the following conditions:

- They are transferring from independently accredited institutions of higher education recognized by the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division and offering learning experiences equivalent to those offered at AUS.
- They have successfully completed one or more semesters at their institution.
- They are in good standing (i.e., not on any probation or dismissal from the institution from which they are transferring).

- They achieved at their institution a minimum cumulative grade point average (CGPA) as required by AUS for that type of institution.
- Prior to their admission to the institutions from which they are transferring, they met the AUS requirements for admission.
- They meet the English language proficiency requirements of AUS.
- They submit official transcripts of their high school and college/university records along with the syllabi for and descriptions of courses they seek to transfer.

Pre-Entry Requirements for Transfer Students

Depending on credit hours transferred, transfer students might need to sit for certain placement tests. Please check the information on Pre-entry Requirements for First-Year Students earlier in this section for details on placement tests and preparatory courses.

Exemption from Placement Tests

Transfer applicants may be exempted from taking certain placements tests depending on transferred courses.

Math and Physics Placement Tests

Transfer applicants granted transfer of credit hours for courses equivalent to AUS math or physics courses are waived from taking the corresponding AUS math or physics placement tests.

English Placement Test

Transfer applicants granted transfer of credit hours for courses equivalent to AUS WRI 101 (Academic Writing I) or WRI 102 (Academic Writing II) courses are waived from taking the English Placement Test. Transfer applicants waived from WRI 101 are also exempted from taking the English Placement Test.

Transfer of Credit Hours

Transfer applicants from two-year community colleges in North America and four-year colleges/universities with a similar mission to AUS may be awarded transfer of credit hours. The minimum required course grade(s) to be considered for credit hours transfer will depend on the institution from which the applicant is transferring.

Transfer applicants with transcripts from two or more institutions of higher education are eligible for transfer evaluation of only the courses completed at the institutions meeting the AUS transfer admission requirements.

Admitted transfer applicants must submit their official transcripts, syllabi and requested work samples to the Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions by the file completion deadlines announced on the AUS website. In addition to the official transcript and the syllabi and descriptions for courses students seek to transfer, some programs may require applicants to submit samples of their work, assignments and/or examinations. Applicants who seek transfer of credit hours for studio courses are advised to provide a portfolio of completed course work in photographic, digital or original format.

Files completed by the published deadlines will be evaluated, and admitted transfer applicants will be awarded transfer credit hours, as applicable, before the first day of registration of the student's first semester at AUS. Files not completed by the deadline may be evaluated during the first semester at AUS. No transfer of credit hours will be awarded after completion of the first semester of study at AUS. Transcripts of transfer students will be evaluated only once.

Courses identified as equivalent in content and level to AUS courses will be transferred as the

equivalent AUS course. Other appropriate university level courses may be transferred as free electives or as unassigned courses meeting specific degree requirements. Transfer of credit hours will not be accepted for graduation project courses.

Courses completed more than five years prior to matriculation as an undergraduate student at AUS are not transferable.

No engineering or computer science courses will be considered for transfer from academic programs not recognized by ABET, Inc. (www.abet.org).

Courses related to areas taught within the School of Business Administration will be evaluated for transfer of credit hours only if they were completed within institutions accredited by the Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (AACSB www.aacsb.edu), the European Quality Improvement System (EQUIS) or from universities approved by the School of Business Administration.

No more than 50 percent of the credit hours required to earn a degree from AUS may be transferred from another institution. A maximum of 30 credit hours may be transferred from an institution where the language of instruction is not English. In addition, transfer students must satisfy the university's graduation residence requirements as outlined in the Academic Policies and Regulations section of this catalog.

Grades earned on a transferred course do not transfer and will not be used to calculate the student's cumulative grade point average (CGPA). The transfer course(s) could be used to satisfy registration and graduation requirements where applicable.

Students will receive an email notification of their transferred credit hours by the Office of the Registrar. While credit hours will be temporarily transferred, the student will not be awarded his/her bachelor's degree until AUS receives verification of the host institution's transcript from the UAE Ministry of Education's Higher Education Affairs Division.

The decision regarding credit hours awarded is made by the appropriate academic division at AUS with input from faculty with expertise in the subject area. The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the transfer students' records.

The complete transfer policy is available from the Office of Enrollment Management/Undergraduate Admissions.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all transfer applicants, employees of the Office of Enrollment Management, and the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of Enrollment Management and the Office of the Registrar

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AACSB: Association to Advance Collegiate Schools of Business (www.aacsb.edu), EQUIS: European Quality Improvement System (EQUIS)
- CGPA: cumulative grade point average.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

<https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Editorial changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April 25, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 3, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
6.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB. To comply with CAA standards, the English Language Proficiency requirement is mandatory regardless of taking WRI101 or WRI102, and the statement regarding the waiver of this requirement has been removed.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Executive Director of Enrollment Management, Office of Enrollment Management	Tel + 971 6 515 1010	ashuhaimy@aus.edu
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

d. Advanced Standing Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0600EM04	Policy Title:	Advanced Standing Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Enrollment Management - UG Admissions	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	- Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction - Office of Enrollment Management	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Advanced Standing Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the requirements for the recognition and award of credits to new students for advanced work completed prior to admission.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Advanced Standing Credit Hours Transfer

Students who achieve a minimum grade equivalent to B in the IB Higher Levels, GCE A- Levels, the Lebanese Baccalaureate, the French Baccalaureate, the German Abitur or the American Advanced Placement tests may be awarded course credits for first-year-level courses. For more information, refer to <https://www.aus.edu/academics/registrars-services>. The complete transfer policy is available from the Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions.

Admitted applicants must submit a copy of their original secondary school certificate attested by the UAE Ministry of Education, or the appropriate authority, along with the subjects' descriptions to the Office of Enrollment Management/Undergraduate Admissions no later than the early registration of their second semester of study at AUS. Admitted applicants who submit their documents before their first semester of study will have their documents evaluated toward credit hours transfer as well as exemption from appropriate placement tests. More information on placement tests is provided in the following section.

No transfer of advanced standing credit hours will be awarded after completion of the first semester of study at AUS.

Admitted applicants will be notified of their transferred credit hours by the Office of the Registrar.

The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the advanced standing students' records.

New First-Time Students Seeking Transfer Credit Earned in Secondary School and/or Advanced Placement Courses.

New first-time students seeking to transfer advanced placement or university-equivalent course credits earned in secondary school to AUS are admitted with a student type “(N)” and the type is changed to “(A)” following the evaluation of advanced placement or university-equivalent courses. Credit transfer evaluation must be processed through the Office of the Registrar.

Transfer student files must be submitted to the Office of the Registrar two weeks prior to the beginning of the final exam period of the semester prior to the semester of admission. If files are not complete by the deadline, the Office of the Registrar will be unable to complete the transfer credit evaluation prior to the start of the semester; the evaluation will be completed during the student’s first semester at AUS.

Required Documents

Students seeking credit transfer for secondary school and/or advanced placement courses must submit their UAE Ministry of Education-attested certificate/s along with a copy of the AUS admission letter, and syllabi if required, to the Office of the Registrar. However, if original documents are not available at the time of application, the Office of Enrollment Management may download and sign off on grade reports from official websites in order to facilitate the timely processing of student files. A Banner hold will be placed on students that do not submit original certificate/s; students will be required to submit all original material by the end of their first semester at AUS.

Criteria for Awarding Transfer Credit or Exemptions from Placement Tests

Students who achieve the minimum grades specified in the table below may be awarded credits or granted waivers for placement tests for courses as approved by the Associate Dean of the relevant school/college.

	Minimum Grade Required for Awarding Credit	Minimum Grade Required for Waiving Placement Test
British A-Level	B	C
International Baccalaureate (IB) Higher Level (6 and 7)	6	English 5 Math and Physics 5
French Baccalaureate (or equivalent)	13	Math 10 English 12
Lebanese Baccalaureate (or equivalent)	13 (out of 20) 65 (out of 100)	10–12 (out of 20) 50–64 (out of 100)
American Advanced Placement (AP)	4	3
German Abitur	7	10

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy is applicable to all new students who seek the recognition and award of credits for advanced work completed prior to admission.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of Enrollment Management and Office of the Registrar

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

IB: International Baccalaureate

GCE: General Certificate of Education

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

<https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Changes to Minimum grade requirement numbers	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 3, 2024	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Executive Director of Enrollment Management, Office of Enrollment Management	Tel: + 971 6 515 1010	ashuhaimy@aus.edu
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

e. Recognition of Prior Learning – Version 4

Policy Number:	0600AP05	Policy Title:	Recognition of Prior Learning
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Recognition of Prior Learning

2. Purpose:

This policy relates to the award of credit for experiential or other non-classroom based learning.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

AUS does not award credit for experiential or other non-classroom-based learning. AUS only awards credit through advanced placement or credit transfer as specified in the Undergraduate Admissions Policy and Graduate Admissions Policy.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to experiential or other non-classroom-based learning.

6. Responsibilities:

The head of department or program coordinator must ensure compliance with this policy during course scheduling and evaluation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Experiential Learning: This term applies to those learning experiences which involve the application of learning typically outside of the classroom. Experiential learning encompasses such experiences as internships, practicums, field study, or clinical learning.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- CAA Standards 2019 – Annex 20
- Undergraduate and Graduate Catalogs

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	September 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6-5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6-5154721	ogs@aus.edu

f. Students Records Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	0600SE06	Policy Title:	Student Records Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	- Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction - Registrar	Effective Date:	August 27, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Records Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the types of academic records that are maintained on students as well as the privacy rights of students with regards to their personal information and records as held by the university.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Undergraduate Students

Custody of Records

All transcripts and other documents students submit from other institutions at the time of admission or later are the property of AUS, and, as such, are part of the student record that is under the custody of the Office of the Registrar. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Transcripts submitted to AUS for admission or credit hours transfer cannot be returned to the student or forwarded to other institutions.

The academic record of an individual student is maintained by the Office of the Registrar for a maximum period of five years after the student graduates or leaves AUS. Beyond this retention limit, documents in a student's record are managed in accordance with the AUS Office of the Registrar policy on file retention, which could entail permanent destruction of some of these documents.

Student Privacy Rights

The university reserves the right to disclose students' records to the parent, the immediate guardian of the student and to the private or public authority sponsoring the student, if applicable. AUS is required to comply with requests for student information originating from the UAE Government and the Sharjah Government

Students have the right to:

Inspect and review information contained in their educational records. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Under: specific circumstances, the university may allow specific documents included in a student's record to be provided. Requests for copies of documents will be reviewed after submission of a signed request from the student concerned. Request changes or updates to their personal data. Registered students are given access to update their emergency telephone/mobile contact numbers and their personal email address via the secured online

student information system. For mailing address updates, an official request signed by the student concerned has to be submitted to the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section. The form is available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms.

Request non-disclosure, within the extent of UAE federal and local laws, of personally identifiable information from education records.

For further information on students' records, please check with the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section.

Academic Transcripts

The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the academic records of all students who register at the university. The permanent record reflecting the academic achievements of each student throughout his/her entire study period at the university is referred to as academic transcript or transcript.

At the end of every semester/term, the Office of the Registrar updates the academic transcripts of the students who were registered in that semester/term. Students may access their transcripts through the secure online student information system. Students are encouraged to review their records online periodically. Online transcripts are not official and are only intended to update students on their academic achievement.

At the end of any given semester/term, the Office of the Registrar mails the students who are not in good academic standing an unofficial copy of their updated transcript. These transcripts are mailed to the address maintained in the student's record at the Office of the Registrar. For details on academic standing policy, refer to Academic Standing in this section of the catalog.

Students may obtain copies of their academic transcripts at AUS from the Office of the Registrar. Transcripts will only be released with a signed request from the student concerned (request form available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) or an online request submitted by the student via the secured student information system. A nominal fee applies. The university will issue only complete transcripts, not parts of the student record.

A brief explanation of the university's grading system is provided on the back of every official transcript. The detailed explanation is included in the Grades and Academic Standing section herein.

Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations

The retention of records on academic integrity code violations is governed by the following:

In cases where penalties (a)–(c) were assigned: All records pertaining to the infringement of the Student Academic Integrity Code are maintained by the student's college/school. If the student does not graduate from AUS, the records are retained for five years after the student's last registration. If the student graduates from AUS, these records are destroyed by the college/school upon the student's graduation.

In cases where penalties (e)–(f) were assigned: The notation indicating a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code will become a permanent part of the student's file maintained by the Office of the Registrar. For tracking purposes, all violations are recorded on the university's academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

Records on Student Academic Integrity Code violations maintained by the Office of the Registrar are subject to university regulations concerning the confidentiality of student records. Upon written request, students have the right to inspect their records related to violations of the integrity code.

Enrollment Verifications and Certifications

Students may need different types of official certificates pertaining to their academic record at AUS. These certificates must be requested from the Office of the Registrar using the request forms available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms. A nominal fee applies.

Graduate Students Custody of Records

All transcripts and other documents students submitted from other institutions at admission time or later are the property of AUS, and, as such, are part of the student record that is under the custody of the Office of the Registrar. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Transcripts submitted to AUS for admission or credit transfer cannot be returned to the student or forwarded to other institutions.

Student Privacy Rights

Students have the right to:

Inspect and review information contained in their educational records. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. The university allows, nevertheless, copy making of very specific documents included in a student's record. Copies of such documents will only be provided upon submission of a signed request from the student concerned. The request form is available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms. A nominal fee applies.

Request changes or updates to their personal data. Registered students are given access to update their emergency telephone/mobile contact numbers and their personal email address via the secured online student information system. For mailing address updates, an official request signed by the student concerned has to be submitted to the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section. The form is available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms.

Request non-disclosure, within the extent of UAE federal and local laws, of personally identifiable information from education records. The university reserves the right to disclose students' records to the immediate guardian of the student and to the private or public authority sponsoring the student. For further information on students' records, please check with the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section.

Academic Transcripts

The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the academic records of all students who register at the university. The permanent record reflecting the academic achievements of each student throughout his/her entire study period at the university is referred to as academic transcript or transcript. At the end of every semester/term, the Office of the Registrar updates the academic transcripts of the students who were registered in that semester/term. Students may access their transcripts through the secure online student information system. Students are encouraged to review their records online periodically. Online transcripts are not official and are only intended to update students on their academic achievement. Students may obtain copies of their academic transcripts at AUS from the Office of the Registrar. Transcripts will only be released with a signed request from the student concerned (request form available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) or an online request submitted by the student via the secured student information system. A nominal fee applies. The university will issue only complete transcripts, not parts of the student record. A brief explanation of the university's grading system is provided on the back of every official transcript. The detailed explanation is included in the Grades and Academic Standing section herein.

Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations

The retention of records on academic integrity code violations is governed by the following:

- In cases where penalties (a)–(c) were assigned: All records pertaining to the infringement of the code are maintained by the student's college/school. If the student does not graduate from AUS, the records are retained for five years after the student's last registration. If the student graduates from AUS, these records are destroyed by the college/school upon the student's graduation.

- In cases where penalties (e)- (f) were assigned: The notation indicating a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code will become a permanent part of the student's file maintained indefinitely by the Office of the Registrar. Upon graduation, all records pertaining to the violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code that were maintained by the college/school will be transferred to the Office of the Registrar for permanent retention. If the student does not graduate from AUS, all records pertaining to violations of the academic integrity code will be retained by the college/school for five years after the student's last registration at AUS and then transferred to the Office of the Registrar for permanent retention.

Records on Student Academic Integrity Code violations maintained by the Office of the Registrar are subject to university regulations concerning the confidentiality of student records. Upon written request, students have the right to inspect their records related to violations of the integrity code.

Enrollment Verifications and Certifications

Students may need different types of official certificates pertaining to their academic record at AUS. These certificates must be requested from the Office of the Registrar using the request forms available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms. A nominal fee applies.

Digital Backups

The university ensures that all digital student records maintained in the Student Information System (SIS), including academic transcripts, enrollment information, and personal identification details, are securely backed up to maintain data integrity and compliance with regulatory requirements. Full backups of the Student Information System (SIS) database, which houses these records, are performed daily. The full backups are maintained for 180 days on-premises and in a disaster recovery (DR) location through online replication of the backups. The ICT & IT Security Department ensures proper policies and procedures are in place to maintain and manage these backups according to the specified retention schedules and storage locations. In compliance with regulatory stipulations, the Office of the Registrar ensures that records maintained within the Student Information System (SIS) will be retained for a period of 50 years to ensure long-term accessibility and preservation.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students

6. Responsibilities:

ICT & IT Security Department to establish the university's information backup and restoration requirements to ensure the availability of information in the event of intentional or unintentional failure or disruption. This involves maintaining approved and up-to-date policies, procedures, and supporting documents that govern how backups are created, stored, and managed and how data, including student records, is restored from those backups in case of a disaster or other data loss event. The documents should outline guidelines for the frequency of backups, their storage location, retention periods, access control, and procedures for restoring data from backups.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

See Undergraduate Catalog and Graduate Catalogs for terms/definitions related to academic integrity in this policy.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate and Graduate Catalog

9. Policy history

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Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2023	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Updates on GR Academic Transcripts and on Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	August 27, 2024	To ensure compliance with MOE standards regarding the storage and backup of student digital records	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu
Executive Director, ICT & IT Security	Tel: +971 6 515 2124	execdirectorit@aus.edu

g. Information Release Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0600RG07	Policy Title:	Information Release Policy
Prepared By:	Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Information Release Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the disclosure and confidentiality rights of students with regards to their records as maintained by the university.

3. Introduction / background:

Not Applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Undergraduate Students Custody of Records

All transcripts and other documents students submit from other institutions at the time of admission or later are the property of AUS, and, as such, are part of the student record that is under the custody of the Office of the Registrar. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Transcripts submitted to AUS for admission or credit hours transfer cannot be returned to the student or forwarded to other institutions.

The academic record of an individual student is maintained by the Office of the Registrar for a maximum period of five years after the student graduates or leaves AUS. Beyond this retention limit, documents in a student's record are managed in accordance with the AUS Office of the Registrar policy on file retention, which could entail permanent destruction of some of these documents.

Student Privacy Rights

The university reserves the right to disclose students' records to the parent, the immediate guardian of the student and to the private or public authority sponsoring the student, if applicable. AUS is required to comply with requests for student information originating from the UAE Government and the Sharjah Government

Students have the right to:

- Inspect and review information contained in their educational records. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Under specific circumstances, the university may allow specific documents included in a student's record to be provided. Requests for copies of documents will be reviewed after submission of a signed request from the student concerned.
- Request changes or updates to their personal data. Registered students are given access to

update their emergency telephone/mobile contact numbers and their personal email address via the secured online student information system. For mailing address updates, an official request signed by the student concerned has to be submitted to the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section. The form is available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms

- Request non-disclosure, within the extent of UAE federal and local laws, of personally identifiable information from education records.

For further information on students' records, please check with the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section.

Academic Transcripts

The Office of the Registrar maintains and updates the academic records of all students who register at the university. The permanent record reflecting the academic achievements of each student throughout his/her entire study period at the university is referred to as academic transcript or transcript.

At the end of every semester/term, the Office of the Registrar updates the academic transcripts of the students who were registered in that semester/term. Students may access their transcripts through the secure online student information system. Students are encouraged to review their records online periodically. Online transcripts are not official and are only intended to update students on their academic achievement.

At the end of any given semester/term, students who are not in good academic standing receive an unofficial copy of their updated transcript. These transcripts are mailed to the address maintained in the student's record at the Office of the Registrar. For details on academic standing policy, refer to Academic Standing in this section of the catalog.

Students may obtain copies of their academic transcripts at AUS from the Office of the Registrar. Transcripts will only be released with a signed request from the student concerned (request form available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) or an online request submitted by the student via the secured student information system. A nominal fee applies. The university will issue only complete transcripts, not parts of the student record.

A brief explanation of the university's grading system is provided on the back of every official transcript. The detailed explanation is included in the Grades and Academic Standing section herein.

Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations

The retention of records on academic integrity code violations is governed by the following:

- In cases where penalties (a)–(c) were assigned: All records pertaining to the infringement of the Student Academic Integrity Code are maintained by the student's college/school. If the student does not graduate from AUS, the records are retained for five years after the student's last registration. If the student graduates from AUS, these records are destroyed by the college/school upon the student's graduation.
- In cases where penalties (e)–(f) were assigned: The notation indicating a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code will become a permanent part of the student's file maintained by the Office of the Registrar.
- For tracking purposes, all violations are recorded on the university's academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

Records on Student Academic Integrity Code violations maintained by the Office of the Registrar are subject to university regulations concerning the confidentiality of student records. Upon written request, students have the right to inspect their records related to violations of the integrity code.

Graduate Students Custody of Records

All transcripts and other documents students submitted from other institutions at admission time or later are the property of AUS, and, as such, are part of the student record that is under the custody of the Office of the Registrar. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. Transcripts submitted to AUS for admission or credit transfer cannot be returned to the student or forwarded to other institutions.

Student Privacy Rights

Students have the right to:

- inspect and review information contained in their educational records. The university is not required to provide (or allow the making of) copies of these documents. The university allows, nevertheless, copy making of very specific documents included in a student's record. Copies of such documents will only be provided upon submission of a signed request from the student concerned. The request form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms. A nominal fee applies.
- request changes or updates to their personal data. Registered students are given access to update their emergency telephone/mobile contact numbers and their personal email address via the secured online student information system. For mailing address updates, an official request signed by the student concerned has to be submitted to the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section. The form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms.
- request non-disclosure, within the extent of UAE federal and local laws, of personally identifiable information from education records. The university reserves the right to disclose students' records to the immediate guardian of the student and to the private or public authority sponsoring the student. For further information on students' records, please check with the Office of the Registrar/Student Records section.

Academic Transcripts

A permanent record reflecting the academic achievements of each student who registers at the university (also referred to as a "transcript") is maintained by the Office of the Registrar. At the end of every semester, the Office of the Registrar issues updated transcripts for all the students who were registered for the semester. These transcripts are mailed to every individual student. These copies are not official and are only intended to update students on their academic achievement. Students may also access their transcripts through the secure online student information system. Students are encouraged to review their records online periodically.

Students may obtain copies of their academic transcripts at AUS from the Office of the Registrar. Transcripts will only be released with a signed request from the student concerned. The request form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms. A nominal fee applies. The university will issue only complete transcripts, not parts of the student record.

An explanation of the university's grading system is included in the Grades and Academic Standing section herein. A brief explanation is also provided on the back of every official transcript.

Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations

The retention of records on academic integrity code violations is governed by the following:

- In cases where penalties (a)–(c) were assigned: All records pertaining to the infringement of the code are maintained by the student's college/school. If the student does not graduate from AUS, the records are retained for five years after the student's last registration. If the student graduates from AUS, these records are destroyed by the college/school upon the student's graduation.

- In cases where penalties (e)–(f) were assigned: The notation indicating a violation of the Student Academic Integrity Code will become a permanent part of the student’s file maintained indefinitely by the Office of the Registrar.
- Records on Student Academic Integrity Code violations maintained by the Office of the Registrar are subject to university regulations concerning the confidentiality of student records. Upon written request, students have the right to inspect their records related to violations of the integrity code.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of the Registrar to adhere to all protocols described in this policy.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

See Undergraduate Catalog and Graduate Catalogs for terms/definitions related to academic integrity in this policy.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate and Graduate Catalog.

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	CAI and Chief Academic Officer
2.0	August 2021	General update.	CAI and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	May 2023	Revision in the UG and GR Records on Academic Integrity Code Violations and in the UG Transcripts	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

h. Degree Audit Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600UI08	Policy Title:	Degree Audit
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Degree Audit.

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines all of the academic requirements that a student at AUS must meet in order to graduate.

3. Introduction / background:

Not Applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Catalog

The graduation requirements for any individual student are determined by the catalog that was effective when the student matriculated in the major, referred to as the student's catalog of record. A student may choose to follow the catalog effective for any semester/term in which they were a registered student in their current program of study. To change catalogs, a student must file a Change of Academic Catalog Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) with the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of Add/Drop period of the student's graduation semester/term.

A student who changes majors may petition to revert to the catalog in effect at the time of matriculation into the university. The Petition Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) must be approved by the student's associate dean and submitted to the Office of the Registrar no later than the end of the add/drop period of the student's graduation semester/term. Every individual student is personally responsible for meeting all graduation requirements as detailed in his/her catalog of record.

If a required course within a program changes its number of credit hours, then the number of credit hours required by the program for graduation may, at the discretion of the college/school, change by the same amount provided the minimum total number of credit hours for graduation is 120 and the CGPA is at least 2.00.

In case of substantial changes in course offerings, equivalent graduation requirements are determined by the dean of the student's college/school.

Disclaimer: *Course information, content and prerequisites may be subject to change as a result of the university's commitment to a process of continual improvement in academic programs. Students must comply with the most up-to-date course requirements.*

Courses

Courses are considered primary components of the curriculum and should not be split into individual credit hours to be counted in different areas of the degree audit.

Preparatory Courses

Preparatory courses are intended for students with a deficiency in a specific subject matter.

Credit hours generated by preparatory courses do not count in the earned hours and grades earned in preparatory courses do not count in the SGPA and the CGPA.

Preparatory courses do not count towards meeting degree program graduation requirements.

Passing Grade Requirement

The minimum passing grade requirement for a course to meet any area of the graduation requirements and to satisfy any course prerequisites and/or co-requisites is C-.

General Education Program

Mission Statement

Liberal studies form the core component of an AUS education. The General Education Program encourages intellectual discovery and critical reflection, promotes an appreciation of the various modes of human inquiry, and develops the knowledge and skills to succeed in and contribute to the Arab Gulf region and the world at large. The program fosters personal development by providing the foundation for lifelong engagement with the questions that shape individuals and societies. General education at AUS complements professional programs by offering opportunities for students to reflect on a diverse and increasingly interdependent world and their place within it.

Program Goals and Outcomes

The General Education Program provides students with opportunities to:

Goal A. Gain an understanding of the history and culture of the Arab World

Outcomes

- Explain the literary, artistic or scientific traditions of the Arab world
- Analyze the interdependencies between the Arab Gulf region, the Middle East and the world at large

Goal B. Examine the values and ideas that have shaped the Western intellectual and cultural traditions

Outcomes

- Describe intellectual and cultural traditions of the Western world
- Analyze and explain how Western traditions have influenced the present

Goal C. Explore how modes of human inquiry or expression enhances our understanding of culture

Outcomes

- Analyze cultural ideals and values in order to enhance self-understanding and empathy for others
- Explain how societies are defined in relation to culture, nationality, race, ethnicity or gender

- Analyze and explain implied and expressed cultural values and attitudes in works of literature (literary perspectives)
- Analyze and explain the development of human institutions, ideas and social structures (historical perspectives)
- Analyze and explain philosophical works that present perspectives on social and cultural issues or problems (philosophical perspectives)

Goal D. Appreciate the roles of creative endeavors in enriching the human

Outcomes

- Identify, interpret and explain themes in works of literature or art (study of arts/literature)
- Explain how artistic and literary traditions have influenced individuals, cultures or societies (study of arts/literature)
- Demonstrate an understanding of creative processes through the production of works of art or literature (engagement in arts/literature)
- Reflect upon and explain the decisions made during the creative process (engagement in arts/literature)

Goal E. Reflect on the consequences of individual and collective human action

Outcomes

- Explain the ways in which individuals, groups, institutions or societies behave and influence one another
- Analyze and describe how social, cultural, political or economic conditions affect individuals
- Analyze and explain human behavior in a variety of contexts
- Assess the ethical dimensions of actions and explain the relationships between individual moral choices and professional responsibility

Goal F. Recognize the value of the natural sciences

Outcomes

- Explain how scientific hypotheses are conceived and tested
- Explain how basic scientific concepts are related to contemporary issues
- Goal G. Employ quantitative reasoning as a conceptual tool for analysis and description
- *Outcomes*
- Analyze data to identify quantitative and qualitative relationships
- Apply basic mathematical concepts
- Demonstrate proficiency in deductive reasoning and problem solving

Goal H. Develop the skills and abilities to thoughtfully seek information, critically analyze sources and clearly formulate complex ideas

Outcomes

- Communicate effectively in written English
- Communicate effectively in spoken English
- Evaluate written communication, identify key ideas and establish hierarchies of information
- Structure clear and persuasive arguments based on an analysis and presentation of evidence
- Analyze and explain how culture affects communication
- Identify and access information resources efficiently and effectively based upon the Association of College and Research Libraries standards

Goal I. Investigate how digital technology can facilitate inquiry and the advancement of knowledge

Outcomes

- Demonstrate how digital technology can contribute to understanding
- Demonstrate the ability to use digital technology to enhance analysis, description and presentation

General Education Requirements

All students must successfully complete a minimum of 36 credit hours in core and non-core general education requirements (GER) with a minimum grade of C- in order to graduate. In addition, students must successfully complete one course from each area of the major- designated requirements.

Information on specific courses meeting each of the general education areas is available at <https://www.aus.edu/generaleducation-> program.

Students who transfer to AUS may satisfy general education requirements if the course(s) being transferred meet the outcomes of a general education area as defined by the general education program.

Core Requirements (minimum of 15 credit hours)

Students must successfully complete a minimum of 15 credit hours in courses meeting the following core general education areas. Credit hours earned in these areas cannot be counted towards other general education requirements or other degree program requirements. Credit hours counted towards a specific core general education area cannot be counted towards another core general education area.

- history and culture of the Arab world: three to six credit hours
- culture in a critical perspective: three to six credit hours
- arts and literature: three to six credit hours
- human interaction and behavior: three to six credit hours

Non-Core Requirements (minimum of 21 credit hours)

Students must successfully complete a minimum of 21 credit hours in courses meeting the following non-core general education areas. Courses in these areas may also meet major requirements and program core requirements. In cases where a course is considered both a non-core general education requirement and a major or program core requirement, credit hours for the course are counted only once towards the overall credit hours earned and, in the degree program literature, are included in the total credit hours of the major requirements area or the program core requirements area the course satisfies.

- Natural sciences: a minimum of six credit hours
- Mathematics: a minimum of three credit hours
- Statistics: a minimum of three credit hours (for College of Engineering, please see degree program details)
- Communication: a minimum of 9 credit hours in 100-level or above writing (WRI) courses and/or 200- level or above English (ENG) courses in this area. WRI 101 Academic Writing I and WRI 102 Academic
- Writing II should be completed in the first year or before completion of 30 credit hours and cannot be repeated once the student has earned 75 credit hours. Either ENG 203 or ENG 204 can be used to meet the communication requirement.

Major-Designated Requirements

Students must successfully complete one course from each of the following areas:

- Ethical understanding
- Discipline-specific writing intensive course
- Oral proficiency
- Information literacy
- Computer literacy
- Innovation and Entrepreneurship Requirement

All students must successfully complete three credit hours towards the innovation and entrepreneurship requirement. IEN 301 - Innovation and Entrepreneurship Mindset - meets this requirement.

The credit hours earned from IEN 301 cannot be counted towards other degree program graduation requirements.

Students who transfer to AUS may satisfy the innovation and entrepreneurship requirement if the course being transferred meets the outcomes of IEN 301.

Requirements of a Major

Each student in a degree program must successfully complete at least 36 credit hours in courses that are specific to the major and distinctive to the major subject area. The specific requirements for a major are listed as major requirements, program core requirements, concentration requirements and electives, and major electives, under the corresponding degree program section in this catalog.

Some major requirements and program core requirements may count toward fulfilling non-core or major-designated general education requirements; credit hours of such courses will not double count.

Requirements for a Double Major

To graduate with a second major, students must satisfy all of the graduation requirements of the degree programs of the two majors requested. Some courses may be counted toward the fulfillment of both degree programs' graduation requirements.

The catalog in effect for the student's primary major will be followed for the degree audit of both degree programs.

Double-major students will be awarded the degree of the primary major degree program, with a notation on the diploma indicating completion of a second major.

Requirements for a Double Concentration

Certain degree programs offer students the choice of a double concentration. In cases where the two concentrations have common courses, courses used to fulfill the requirements of the first concentration can double count toward the second concentration.

Because the second concentration is not a degree program requirement, it is considered a free choice of the student. As such, courses used toward the second concentration can double count as free electives.

Internships

Internships that contribute to meeting graduation requirements must be a minimum of five consecutive weeks. Some degree programs require the internship to be completed over a minimum of 10 consecutive weeks. Internship offerings and requirements are listed under the various degree program graduation requirements.

For information on internship registration, please see Registration and Course Information/Internship

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Registration earlier in this section of the catalog.

Free Electives Requirement

To satisfy the free electives requirement, students must successfully complete at least two courses with a minimum of six credit hours. Some degree programs might require more than the minimum of six credit hours. In addition, a college/school may exclude certain courses from being counted as free electives. For more information, please refer to the degree requirements of the corresponding degree program section later in this catalog.

Courses taken to satisfy a double concentration requirement can count towards meeting the free electives requirement.

Requirements of a Minor

Minor programs consist of a minimum of 12 credit hours. At least 50 percent of the credit hours required for a minor must be in courses at or above the 300 level. At least six credit hours of the courses at or above the 300 level must be successfully completed in residence at AUS. Fifty percent of all credit hours required for the minor must be successfully completed in residence at AUS.

Students must meet the prerequisite requirements for courses required for the minor.

The minimum cumulative GPA for minor courses is 2.00. The specific course requirements constituting a minor are listed in the corresponding college/school section in this catalog (refer to the index of this catalog).

Coursework completed in the context of a summer/winter term outside AUS does not meet the residence requirements.

Courses used to satisfy a degree program's graduation requirements can be used towards meeting the requirements of a minor as follows:

- at least 12 credit hours of courses used to satisfy the requirements of a minor do not double count towards meeting the core requirements, major requirements, major electives, concentration requirements, concentration electives, or general education requirements of the student's degree program graduation requirements;
- free elective courses can double count towards meeting a minor's required and elective courses.

Students pursuing two minors must meet the requirements of both minors.

Courses used to satisfy the requirements of one minor can double count towards satisfying the requirements of the second minor provided that, at a minimum, 12 credit hours are not double counting.

The catalog in effect for the student's major will normally be followed for the audit of the minor. If the minor is not listed in the student's catalog of record, then the first catalog in which the minor is listed will be applied.

Graduation requirements of the minor(s) must be completed prior to the award of the degree.

Academic Standing Requirement

A student must be in good academic standing to be eligible for graduation.

Graduation Residence Requirements

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Candidates for the bachelor's degree are expected to complete their last semester/term in residence at the university unless registered at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement.

A minimum of 36 credit hours of 300- and/or 400-level course work must be successfully completed in residence at AUS to obtain a bachelor's degree. Coursework at the 300- and/or 400- level completed at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement will meet the AUS upper level requirement if the courses have been pre-approved by the relevant college/school.

Note that coursework completed in the context of a summer/winter term outside AUS does not meet graduation residence requirements.

Transfer students must successfully complete at least 50 percent of the required credit hours for a degree program in residence at AUS.

Time Limit on Duration of Study

Regardless of the catalog by which the student's graduation requirements are governed, all degree requirements must be completed within eight years of admission to AUS as an undergraduate student or matriculation from the Achievement Academy/Bridge Program, inclusive of any leave.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students.

6. Responsibilities:

The ultimate responsibility for degree audits lies with the student. Schools/colleges use degree audits in advising. The Office of the Registrar uses degree audits for petitions, and records of graduation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

All definitions are provided in the policy.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Changes from catalogue applied	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact	Department Email ID
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	Number	
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

i. Grade Approval and Change Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	06URG09	Policy Title:	Grade Approval and Change Policy
Prepared By:	● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction ● Registrar	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	● Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction ● Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Grade Approval and Change Policy

2. Purpose:

For a description of the AUS grading system please refer to individual policy 3.k. *Grading and Assessment*. For a description of the student appeal process for student conduct issues please refer to individual policy 6.x. *Student Appeals*. This policy provides a description of the grade appeal process at the undergraduate and graduate level at AUS.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Students are entitled to fair and equitable evaluation and treatment in the course of their academic relationships with members of the faculty. These criteria are observed by the members of the AUS faculty as a part of their professional responsibilities.

A student who believes that he/she has a legitimate concern regarding a final course grade must inform the professor responsible for the course in writing and then discuss the matter with the professor. If a resolution cannot be reached, the student may contact the department head in writing to file a formal grade appeal no later than seven working days after the makeup examination day. The department head will review the case and provide a written response to the student. If the matter cannot be resolved at the department level, a grade appeal review will be conducted by a college/school committee appointed by the dean (or appointed designee). Based on the committee's formal recommendation, the dean (or appointed designee) may grant or deny the appeal and notify the student and the professor responsible for the course of the decision. If a change of grade is warranted, the dean (or appointed designee) will inform the Registrar of the grade change. The decision of the dean is final.

In cases where a failing grade of XF was assigned to a course as a result of an academic offense penalty, a student may petition during the semester/term of graduation, or at the time of complete withdrawal from AUS, to have the grade converted to an F on the academic transcript. The petition is submitted to the Office of the Registrar along with the Application for Graduation or the Complete Withdrawal Form. The final decision will be made by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

The F grade resulting from an XF grade will be reverted back into an XF grade if the student reactivates

his/her record at AUS.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students

6. Responsibilities:

Policy to be implemented by the department heads, associate deans and vice provosts where appropriate. Scope of authority for each role is detailed in the policy text.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	Revised – No Change.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	April 25, 2024	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel: +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

j. Career Services Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600AA10	Policy Title:	Career Services Policy
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	February 22, 2009
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

The Career Services division within the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs provides free-of-charge lifetime support to registered students and alumni, as they search for employment. This includes contacting employers, organizing workshops on relevant topics, and providing career counseling.

2. Purpose:

a. The purpose of this policy is to outline the commitment of the Career Services division within the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) to ensuring open and equitable access to the broadest range of opportunities, across all industries and sectors, for all undergraduate and graduate students.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The Career Services at the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) is responsible for assisting students and alumni in their effort to develop career and life planning skills, acquire practical experience, master job search strategies, and explore pre and post-graduation opportunities.

The Career Services division contacts employers in order to recruit students for jobs and internships, organize workshops on relevant topics, and provide career counseling.

All positions listed through AUS must comply with relevant UAE and local laws, as well as University regulations.

Employers working with AUS must let the University know on a timely basis when they hire AUS students or graduates, in order to ensure that the person(s) in question are not considered for other positions, as well as to allow the collection of relevant statistics.

Employers must respect the confidentiality of any student or alumni information. This must not be released to other organizations unless the person concerned has agreed to this in writing.

In addition, the Career Services division must seek to nurture and develop relationships that are mutually beneficial to both internal and external stakeholders, consistent with the mission of AUS.

5. Scope/applicability:

The Career Services at the American University of Sharjah (AUS) is committed to providing free of-charge lifetime support to registered students and alumni, as they search for employment. This includes contacting employers, organizing workshops on relevant topics, and providing career counseling. To ensure fruitful outcomes, we acknowledge that not all opportunities are of interest to all students. The Career Services division at AUS expects members of our community to make their own personal decisions about the paths they pursue. The Career Services office takes a holistic approach to help students discover and explore the opportunities they will find personally meaningful and to understand their values, interests and strengths as part of the career decision-making process.

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) and its Career Services division shall facilitate the interaction between employers and its students/alumni but are not responsible for the employer's hiring procedures, selection of candidates or employment contracts. If an employer and a job candidate using the university Career Services enter into a dispute, they both agree to release AUS and its Career Services division from liability for any type of claims/damages of any kind and nature in relation to this dispute.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

This Policy stands on its own with no other related documentation.

9. Policy history:

This policy has been introduced in February 2009. A review cycle have been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years. The next review round is scheduled in December 2024.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	February 22, 2009	New Policy	-
2.0	2017	Revised Policy	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	careerservices@aus.edu

k. Residential Life Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE11	Policy Title:	Residential Life Policy
Prepared By:	Student Residential Life Department (SRLD)	Issue Date:	June 13, 2015
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/Student Residential Life Department	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	September 12, 2025

1. Policy:

The residence halls policy outlines the rules and guidelines for living in on-campus housing. It typically includes regulations on behavior, safety, maintenance, and guest permissions to ensure a respectful, secure, and well-maintained living environment for all residents. This policy is to enhance student development and experience as an important member of a living and learning community in a comfortable, safe, and secure environment

2. Purpose:

The purpose of the residential halls policy is to foster a safe, inclusive, and orderly living environment that supports the well-being and academic success of residents. It establishes clear expectations for behavior, maintenance, and interactions to ensure a positive and respectful community within the residential halls.

3. Introduction / background:

The residential halls policy is designed to provide a structured and supportive framework for students living in on-campus housing. As part of the AUS commitment to fostering a positive and enriching living experience, the policy addresses various aspects of residential life, including behavioral expectations, safety procedures, and maintenance responsibilities. The intent is to create an enriching and secure environment where students can focus on their academic and personal development. By setting clear guidelines and standards, the policy aims to promote respect, community, and effective management within the residential halls.

4. Policy Statement

The Student Residential Life policy outlines guidelines and expectations for students living in residential halls. It covers aspects such as:

- **Behavioral Expectations:** Defines acceptable conduct within residential areas, emphasizing respect for others, quiet hours, and community standards.
- **Safety and Security:** Details about procedures for building access, emergency protocols, and responsibilities regarding personal and communal safety.
- **Residential Hall Regulations:** Includes rules on visitors, room inspections, use of common areas, and policies regarding appliances and furnishings.
- **Administrative Procedures:** Outlines processes for room assignments, maintenance requests, check-in/out procedures, and handling of policy violations.

These policies aim to create a conducive living environment that supports students' academic pursuits while fostering a sense of community and responsibility.

SRLD Mission

To support and complement the mission of the university and its academic programs by creating a comfortable and safe environment that contributes to the success of resident students' educational progress and personal growth.

Vision

To create a dynamic and inclusive living environment that enhances students' overall university experience.

Values

- **Community:** Promoting a sense of belonging and inclusivity among residents, fostering a supportive community where students from diverse backgrounds can thrive together.
- **Safety:** Ensuring a secure environment where students feel protected and can focus on their academic and personal growth without concerns about their well-being.
- **Respect:** Upholding respect for individuals' differences, cultures, and beliefs, encouraging mutual understanding and acceptance within the residential community.
- **Excellence:** Striving for excellence in all aspects of residential life, from the quality of accommodation and facilities to the level of support and services provided to students.
- **Integrity:** Acting with honesty, fairness, and accountability in all interactions and operations within the residential halls, maintaining trust and ethical standards.
- **Personal Growth:** Supporting residents' personal development and academic success through programs, resources, and opportunities that enhance their university experience.
- **Environmental Responsibility:** Promoting sustainable practices within the residential halls, encouraging residents to be mindful of their environmental impact and contribute to a greener campus.

Introduction

The AUS Student Residential Life staff support and complement the mission of the university and its academic programs by creating a comfortable and safe environment that contributes to the success of resident students' educational progress and personal growth. Student Residential Life offers a learning environment that fosters self-dependence, respect for social and communal standards, and acceptance and tolerance of cultural diversity. The residential halls provide opportunities for residents to improve their leadership, communication and social skills, which support their academic development.

The residential halls are overseen by a dedicated team of professionals, with each area managed under the supervision of the Women's and Men's Complex Managers. This management team ensures the effective operation and maintenance of the residential halls, providing students with a well-supported and organized living environment.

Around-the-clock security will always be in place in the halls, with a Residential Life Resource Officer (RLRO) present at all times in each of the halls. For further support to our resident students, there will be full-time Residential Hall Coordinators (RHC) on duty during the day, with each RHC assigned to one or two residential halls, assisted by an Assistant Residential Hall Coordinator in each hall. Additionally, Housing controllers will be on duty at night across the residential hall complex, ensuring that there is a 24/7 supervision of professional staff.

The on-call Residential Hall Coordinators (RHC) can be reached at the extension provided below after 6:00 PM:

- Women's RHC on-call: 7760.
- Men's RHC on-call: 6670.

Residential Halls Fees

Students in our residential halls enjoy convenient access to everything our campus offers. There are

separate campus residential halls for men and women. All residential halls are equipped with Internet access, computer labs, gyms, TV and entertainment rooms, vending machines and laundry rooms. Residence on campus is available for all full-time students who have paid or arranged for the payment of their room, tuition and other university fees. (Other student categories may be considered depending on the availability of rooms.)

Residential Halls Fees Academic Year 2024–2025* (All fees are in UAE Dirhams)		
Type of Room	Regular Semester	Summer Term
Private room: Single occupancy with private bath and kitchenette (men's and women's dorms)	15,000***	6,890***
Semi-private room: Single occupancy with a shared bath and kitchenette (men's and women's dorms)	11,000***	4,880***
Shared room: Double occupancy with a shared bath and kitchenette (men's and women's dorms)	7,000***	3,710***
Utilities Service Fee	290*	
Residential Halls Maintenance Deposit (One-time fee applied when students first register for residential halls–refundable after cancelation**)	1,000	

* 5% VAT charge applies

Applicants who cancel their room reservations after the deadline set by Student Residential Life will be charged AED 500, which will be deducted from the Residential Halls Maintenance Deposit. New first-time students joining from Fall 2024 as well as first time students to AUS dormitories will receive the following discounts for any room type based on the academic year of intake.

- Year 1: 25 percent
- Year 2: 20 percent
- Year 3: 15 percent
- Year 4 and beyond: 10 percent.

Students with disabilities

At the American University of Sharjah (AUS), we are committed to fostering an inclusive environment where all students have equal opportunities to thrive academically and socially. We believe in providing comprehensive support to students with disabilities, ensuring they have the necessary accommodations to excel in their academic pursuits.

AUS conducts accessibility audits, adheres to Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA) definitions and requirements for students with disabilities, and is a member of the Association on Higher Education and Disability (AHEAD).

According to the Americans with Disabilities Act (ADA), a disability is defined as a physical or mental impairment that significantly limits a major life activity including walking, seeing, hearing, speaking, working, breathing, learning, performing manual tasks, etc. Students who have a documented

disability diagnosed by a qualified professional in the field may apply for [Academic Accommodations](#) through ASC in order to have equal access for educational opportunities at AUS. The university is committed to supporting students with disabilities. For more information, please check out AUS's [Empowering Every Student](#) webpage.

Support for students with disabilities:

- ii. Long-term disabilities: AUS offers a well-established protocol to support students with long-term disabilities academically. Accommodations are available, along with clear policies and guidelines. Referral lists for academic accommodations from various organizations in the UAE are provided. Documentation such as Academic Accommodations Contracts and Faculty Letters are provided to eligible students.
- iii. Short-term disabilities: A new policy has been developed to address the needs of students experiencing short-term disabilities, including sudden illness or injury. This initiative is a collaborative effort involving multiple departments to ensure swift and effective support for students in need.
- iv. Office of Student Affairs initiatives: Efforts are underway to empower students with disabilities through involvement in extracurricular activities and leadership roles. Personalized communication, training opportunities and on-campus employment options are being provided to facilitate their engagement within the university community.

We request any applicant who has a physical disability to contact the Student Residential Life Department through res-halls@aus.edu to get further clarification prior to applying for a room in the residential halls. Some of the residential provisions made to accommodate students with physical disabilities include: room size and entrances large enough to accommodate wheelchair users on the ground floor, ramps at the entrance of each residential hall and a number of residential hall rooms have a bathroom designed specifically for students with a disability

Housing Agreement

The residential hall agreement is a contract between the student and the university residential halls whereby the student agrees to settle all finance and the other charges applicable unconditionally. The agreement is binding for the student and constitutes his/her obligation to pay the university all the applicable charges for the right of occupancy in the university residential halls. Nevertheless, all room assignments exclude fall and spring vacation periods, the period between semesters, and/or periods when the university is officially closed.

First-time applicants should pay a refundable maintenance Deposit Fee of AED 1000. Submitting the Housing Application Form along with the required fee does not guarantee that a room will be assigned, as this is subject to availability. All applications are subject to being processed on a first-come, first-served basis.

Note:

- Applicants who cancel their room reservations after the deadline set by the Student Residential Life Department will be charged AED 500, which will be deducted from the Maintenance Deposit Fee.
- The university reserves absolute rights in changing room configuration and reassignment of space as it deems necessary. Moreover, it also reserves the right to relocate students to other rooms for consolidation purposes in order to generate availability of room space.
- The resident student bound by the agreement terms is only eligible to occupy the space assigned. Under no circumstances is a resident student allowed to rent or share this space with a third party.
- Students whose financial aid application has been accepted by AUS are liable to apply only for sharing rooms in men's residential halls and sharing rooms in women's residential halls.

This agreement will be deemed effective when signed by the student, provided that he/she is enrolled as an AUS student and the Housing Application Form has been received beforehand by the Student Residential Life Department.

Housing Agreement Renewal

- All the terms and conditions mentioned above in the Housing Agreement are applicable in renewal.
- Students should submit the renewal application through Banner within the restricted period set for applying.
- A student who fails to re-apply within that period will lose his/her assigned room space and may not be admitted to the residential halls during that upcoming session/semester.
- Upon renewal, a student will be charged for the full residential hall fee set for that particular space.
- Applicants who cancel their reservations after the deadline set by the Student Residential Life Department will be charged AED 500, which will be deducted from the Maintenance Deposit Fee.
- The refund policy for withdrawal after checking in remains as noted above.

Student Housing Agreement Cancellation/Withdrawal from Residential Halls

Students who wish to cancel their room assignment should submit a written notice specifically to the Student Residential Life Department by fax, mail or in person.

Withdrawal Period		Refund
During Fall and Spring Semesters	During Summer Term	
Withdrawal during the first week from the residential halls opening date	Withdrawal during the first two days from the residential halls opening date	90% of Room Fee
Withdrawal during the second week from the residential halls opening date	Withdrawal during the first four days from the residential halls opening date	70% of Room Fee
Withdrawal during the third week from the residential halls opening date	Withdrawal during the first six days from the residential halls opening date	50% of Room Fee
Withdrawal after the third week from the residential halls opening date	Withdrawal after the first six days from the residential halls opening date	No Refund

The above refund policy would not apply in case of academic or disciplinary dismissal or suspension during the semester. Moreover, if a resident student joins an external academic program, the refund policy will be at the discretion of the AUS Finance Department.

What is provided in the room?

All residential halls bedrooms have similar standard furnishings. You will have a single bed, a study desk, a rolling chair, a wardrobe, a bedside table, roller blinds and an air-conditioning unit. A new bedding set consisting of one quilt, a mattress protector, a pillow and a bed sheet set are also provided for new resident students. For returning resident students, a set of washed linen (except pillows) will be provided. Private rooms also have a sofa and a coffee table. A small fridge and a hotplate are available in each room. The fridge is shared if a person is in a sharing room.

Private rooms also have the following additional items:

- Either single or twin seat sofas, or armchairs.
- Coffee tables.

In the rooms' kitchenette area:

- Hotplates with two hobs each.
- Sinks.
- Small fridges (for sharing).

Items that can be brought by students:

- Iron.
- Iron stand.
- Microwave.
- Water boiler.

Items that can't be brought:

- Bakhoor, incense, candles (flammable items are not permitted in the halls).
- Personal Furniture (no modifications allowed to room fixtures).
- Alcohol (it is illegal in Sharjah and at AUS).
- Permanent fixtures (wall mirrors, paint, locks/chains, wiring, antennas, wall hooks).
- Pets (no animals are permitted in the residence halls).
- Smoking devices (NO SMOKING in all room types as well as common areas. AUS is a smoke-free campus.).

Facilities **offered** inside the residential halls:

- High-speed Wi-Fi in all common areas and student rooms.
- Computer rooms with network printers.
- Laundry rooms with heavy duty washer and dryers (free to use but detergent is not provided).
- Once a week room cleaning by Cleanco staff.
- Fully equipped common kitchens.
- Fitness room.
- Table tennis and foosball table.
- Vending machines for snacks/soft drinks/coffee/tea.
- Large screen TV with satellite TV channels in the student lounge.
- Free-to-air satellite channels available inside all rooms (TV not provided).

University Health Services (UHS)

UHS is an outpatient center fully accredited by the UAE Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP) and is committed to addressing all aspects of healthcare such as physical health, mental health, wellness and health education to all students, faculty members and staff of AUS. We are here to promote and improve the health of the AUS community.

All students can use the regular medical services at UHS during work hours (8:30 a.m. to 4:30 p.m.). Emergency services are available 24 hours a day. All patients are accepted on a walk-in basis. UHC provides round the clock emergency care after working hours and on public holidays. The medical emergency team can be contacted by calling 050 6357651. For more information, please click [here](#).

University Counseling Services (UCS)

UCS Provides psychological support to students, faculty, staff and their families as they pursue their personal goals, and to enhance the quality of each community member's experience at AUS. UCS aims to support the healthy environment of the university by promoting positive mental health for the community through counseling, crisis intervention, consulting, assessment and referral that are responsive to the individual, cultural and demographic diversity of our community. The UCS is open Monday-Thursday, 8:00 a.m.-5:00 p.m.

To book an appointment: ucsappointments.youcanbook.me.

Contact: ucs@aus.edu.

Location: Language Building, LAN 018A/018B/020.

For more information, please click [here](#).

Commercial Outlets

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) offers a variety of commercial outlets to enhance campus life and provide convenience for students, faculty, and staff. These include diverse dining options, retail shops, and service providers strategically located across the campus. Whether it's grabbing a

quick meal, shopping for essentials, or accessing various services, these outlets contribute to a vibrant and well-equipped campus environment. For details list of outlets, please click [here](#).

For delivery orders, students are required to be present in their halls to receive their meals and make any necessary payments. Deliveries are not permitted directly to students' rooms.

SRLD Meal Plan

The Residential Halls Meal Plan provides students with flexible dining options tailored to fit their schedules and preferences. The plan includes a range of meal choices, offering convenience and variety to support students' dietary needs. By incorporating a comprehensive meal plan, the SRLD aims to enhance the residential experience, ensuring that students have access to nutritious and satisfying meals throughout the academic year. For more information, please click [here](#).

Occupancy of Space

Through the Right of Occupancy mentioned hereafter in this agreement, the student will have the right to inhabit the assigned space in AUS residential halls as well as the right to the shared use of common facilities existing in the building (residential hall) where the space is allocated for her/him.

Checking into Residential Halls and the Requirements for Lodging

New first-year students are allowed to check into their allocated space one week prior to the first day of classes for fall and spring semesters and two days for summer session. Returning students are allowed to check into their rooms allocated two days before classes for Fall, Spring and Summer. Those wishing to check in prior to the official check-in date should submit a written request to the Student Residential Life Department four weeks preceding that date. Such requests are subject to unconditional approval/refusal and those students approved for early arrival may be charged additional fees during their stay. Early check-in fees will be outlined upon request approval. During these early check-in periods, students should anticipate less staffing and services (e.g., housing, maintenance, etc.).

Note:

- Full payment of residential hall fees is due before the first day of classes.
- Access to rooms in the residential hall will be contingent upon submission of payment receipt from the university cashier.
- If a housing hold has been placed on a student due to a violation of the AUS Student Code of Conduct or an outstanding financial balance, the student will be unable to check into their room until the hold is resolved. Housing hold: Is a restriction placed on a student's ability to access or modify their housing arrangements, often due to unresolved issues such as unpaid fees, incomplete paperwork, or disciplinary matters. This hold prevents the students from making changes to their housing status, such as requesting room assignments or cancellations, until the underlying issue is resolved.

Termination of Contract Situations

This contract can be terminated by the AUS Student Residential Life Department unconditionally due to any of the following conditions:

A. Change in Student Status: Should a student at any time cease to be enrolled as a full-time AUS student, the agreement shall be terminated simultaneously without notice, such notice being hereby waived. In such case, the refund policy stated in Article 4 of this agreement will apply.

B. Disciplinary Action: If a student violates any of the terms and conditions of this agreement, and particularly those stated in Article 6, the student may be given written notice by the university to quit and vacate the residential hall according to Conduct Council decrees. Upon such decree, as implemented in writing by the Executive Director of Student Experience or designee, this agreement may be terminated.

C. Student Behavior: If a student exhibits behavior or a mode of living that is determined unethical by the Office of Student Affairs management, then this agreement may upon due notice be terminated unconditionally by the university. In such cases, the refund policy may not be applicable although charges may be incurred.

D. Failure to Check-In: If a student fails to claim his/her space by checking in prior to the first day of classes, this agreement will be considered null and void, unless the Office of Student Affairs has received a written notice of student's late arrival.

E. Failure to Vacate Space: If the agreement is terminated as provided above in A, B, C or D, the student must vacate the space on the effective date of termination. If the student fails to quit and vacate, the university shall be entitled to immediate possession of the space and to take all summary action to secure possession without any other or further notice of any kind to the student, applicable law or otherwise, such notice being expressly waived. The university may then, without notice to the student, enter, take possession of, and re-let the space. The university is further irrevocably authorized, on behalf of the student, to remove and to store the student's belongings without any liability on the part of the university for damage or loss. In that event, the university will make no charge for the first three weeks' storage; thereafter, storage charges shall occur at the rate AED 100 per week for the next five weeks; and at the end of an eight-week period the university is irrevocably authorized, on behalf of the student, to dispose of these belongings in any manner that it shall deem fit without any obligation to make payment of any kind to the student resulting from such disposition, damage or loss. In connection with disposition of such property by the university, it is expressly agreed by the student with the university as a condition of this agreement that the value of student's belongings is AED 200 or less.

F. Future Housing Obligations: A student who is dismissed from a university residential hall may be utterly deprived housing in residential halls subject to university decisions.

Room Inventory Forms

Room inventory forms must be signed and returned to the staff at the halls within one day of issuance. Failure to do so will result in the assumption that the room and furnishings are in excellent condition. Damage charges will be based on the above conditions. As a result, the student may be charged more than he/she would otherwise have been charged. Outstanding cleaning costs for the room, floor or door damage will be charged at the end of a student's occupancy or at the end of the academic year.

Transfer

Requests for a transfer to another room are first done through the residential coordinators and require final approval by the Complex Manager of Student Residential Life. If a resident is moving to a more expensive room, the difference in price should be paid prior to moving. Students who choose to downgrade their room status will receive no refund. Please note that transfers are only allowed once per semester and only with a valid reason approved by the Director of Student Residential Life. Students who change rooms, graduate, withdraw or take a leave of absence must completely vacate their rooms and return their access cards to hall staff.

Entering Student Rooms

AUS officials, including the residential coordinators, may enter student rooms (a) when an emergency exists, (b) when a service has been requested by a resident, (c) to check for cleanliness or (d) to check for prohibited items. AUS respects resident students' privacy and therefore, will avoid violating it to the greatest extent possible.

Check-out Procedure

Residents who intend to check out should inform the staff in advance. Residents must clean their rooms before checking out and return their rooms to the condition prior to occupancy. Students are responsible for having the room checked, locking the door, returning the access card and checking out with the staff at the hall. If a room is found unclean or student belongings unpacked, SRLD staff

reserves the right to arrange for removal and packing of items left behind. Cleaning and packing charges will be applicable depending on the number of cleaners engaged and the packaging material used for the task.

Maintenance of Space Access

The university employees and/or contract service providers shall provide at scheduled times general maintenance of assigned spaces in terms of cleaning and repairing. During the semesters and vacations, routine maintenance and cleaning will be done on schedules developed by the university. Students shall inform the residential halls staff of any special maintenance or repairs required. A maintenance or repair request acts as a permission to access assigned student space without prior notice, provided, however, that entry for the purpose of making requested repairs or alterations should be at reasonable times. AUS departments will take care of such damaged items as rapidly as can be accomplished. It is usually not possible to give a precise time when such maintenance or repairs will be carried out. Authorized university agents or employees have rightful access to assigned space without prior notice in cases of emergency, damage, personal injury, safety, health or casualty. In addition, authorized staff members of the Office of Student Affairs and/or Security may access a student's space in situations where there is probable cause to believe that a violation of law or university regulations have taken or is taking place.

The residential halls also provide comprehensive pest control service designed to maintain a clean and comfortable living environment. Regular inspections and preventative treatments are conducted to address and manage any pest-related issues effectively. The service ensures that all common areas and individual rooms are treated as needed, contributing to a healthy and hygienic atmosphere for all residents.

Damages to Property or Persons

American University of Sharjah shall not be liable for any loss or damage to property resulting from fire, casualty or personal injuries occurring within the space or for any other causes unless such damages, losses or personal injuries are caused directly by or result from the proven negligence of the university's agents or employees.

Lost or Non-Returned Access Cards

For security purposes, residents are compelled to keep their doors closed at all times. If a student loses his/her access card, a replacement fee of AED 50 will be binding. In case the lock cylinder has been damaged, the student will be charged AED 150. In the event any door lock spare part is damaged, charges will be imposed according to that spare part cost.

Liability of Damage, Theft or Missing Belongings

The university is not liable, directly or indirectly, for the loss and/or damage of personal property that results from a fire, theft or any other cause.

Space Clearance Procedure

When leaving the residential hall at the end of the year or when terminating housing during a year, the student agrees to check out officially with a member of the university residential hall staff, and to turn in the access card(s) upon check out. Charges for non-returned access cards are noted above in Article 12. The student must also leave his/her space clean and remove all his/her personal items upon check out. A student leaving the residential halls before the expiry of the assignment validity must notify the Student Residential Life Department in writing of such intent prior to leaving.

Storage

Storage rooms are available in all residential halls. Students need to check with the hall staff members regarding the space availability for storing their belongings during semester breaks. Stored items must be properly boxed and clearly labeled with the student's name and ID number. The university does not insure stored items and assumes no liability for them. During any semester, if a resident fails to join the university, the Student Residential Life Department holds the right to vacate his/her room, and place personal belongings in the storage area. If a student's

belongings remain unclaimed for more than eight weeks, the Office of Student Affairs reserves the right to donate these items to charity. The Student Residential Life Department will not be responsible for any student belongings left or stored in the residential halls during semester breaks and periods when the university is officially closed. Kindly refer to the [Student Handbook](#) for further details on leaving personal belongings in the residential hall.

Scooters

Scooters. Residents are responsible for leaving electric scooters outside the residence in the parking lot, or they can store the scooters inside their own rooms. Residents are not allowed park scooters in the corridors to prevent any blockage or obstruction of the evacuation paths. It is also prohibited to ride scooters inside the residence under any circumstances. During leaves, students who are residents of the UAE should take their scooters with them. International students can store their registered scooters in the residential halls in the space provided by SRLD, following the directives issued by the Safety and Crisis Management department. Stored scooters must not be connected to a battery or power source.

Cable/TV/Internet. Students

Cable/TV/Internet. Students are allowed to have televisions and DVD players in their rooms, but personal cable or satellite connections are not allowed to be installed by the resident. However, each hall has a lounge area with a television connected to satellite channels as well as connection to free-to-air satellite channels in each student room. Internet connections are available in all rooms free of charge.

Validity of Agreement

The terms and conditions of this agreement remain valid as long as the student continues to stay in the residential halls by renewing his/her housing contract each semester/session. The contract expires if the student cancels the room assignment, or it is terminated as per Article 5 of this agreement.

Policies Governing Resident Student Conduct

Regulations for student conduct in the residential halls are based on AUS Student Code of Conduct and are detailed below:

Curfew

During the week (Sunday, Monday, Tuesday and Wednesday), all residents are expected to be in their respective halls by 12 midnight. During weekends, (Thursday, Friday and Saturday) they must be in by 1:00 a.m. Curfew violations will be managed by Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution. Curfew hours may be adjusted to match extended library hours announced by the University Librarian during study period and exams. During official holidays and the holy month of Ramadan, curfew hours will be announced by the Director of Student Residential Life Department. A resident student may consult with the Director of Student Residential Life Department about his/her extenuating circumstances for consideration and processing of the exception to curfew timings.

Curfew Violations & Missing Students

Students are expected to be inside their residential halls by the designated curfew hours mentioned above. Any student who arrives after curfew will be deemed in violation of the curfew policy. Initially, curfew violations will be addressed by the SRLD team. When necessary, the matter will be escalated to the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) office according to the guidelines outlined below:

- First, second and third curfew violation: The Residential Life team will call the students for a meeting to Educate them on the Curfew Policy, consequences for violating curfew, and advice, compliance with curfew timings.
- On a count of 4 lateness's, SCCR will call the student for a meeting. Educate students on the Curfew Policy, consequences for violating curfew, and advice, compliance with curfew timings.

- 4+ times, Verbal warning (or Undertaking - Student signs with Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR). The flexibility allowed: No action will be taken by SCCR this Fall 2023 semester until SCCR Officials meet with the students.
- 5 times - Reprimand letter after meeting SCCR Official.
- 8 times - First Warning with a copy to parents and the halls. We restrict them from assuming leadership positions in clubs and organizations.

11 times - 2nd Warning letter stating that a housing hold will be imposed with a copy to parents.

Students are required to sign in each night with the RLRO. Failure to do so will result in the student being classified as missing, prompting the SRLD team to initiate a comprehensive effort to locate the missing students. The following protocol will be followed to address and resolve cases of missing students:

06:00 PM: Residents can begin signing in for the night.
 10:00 PM: RLRO sends a broadcast message to missing residents.
 11:00 PM: RLRO sends a broadcast message to missing residents.
 12:00 AM: RLRO sends individual messages to missing residents.
 02:00 AM: HC calls missing residents.
 05:00 AM: RO sends individual messages to missing residents.
 09:00 AM: RHC sends an email to missing residents.
 10:00 AM: RHC knocks on doors of missing residents.
 11:00 AM: RHC sends individual messages to missing residents.
 12:00 PM: RHC calls each missing resident.
 04:00 PM: RHC sends an email with the missing students list to SCCR.

Residential Halls Leave

All resident students are expected to sleep at the residential halls every night, except during official hall closing periods or if their parents/guardians verify otherwise with Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials. No leave is given during the week. Students may only apply for [leave](#) on weekends with approval of their parent(s) or guardian; this authorization will remain valid for the entire period of stay unless a notification stating the contrary (cancellation of this form) is received from parent(s) or guardian by Student Residential Life or Student Conduct or Conflict Resolution. Leave during the week is only authorized in cases of emergency or under special circumstances and must be approved by the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) official. If a resident is absent for two consecutive weeks from the Residential Halls without written notice, the Student Residential Life Department (SRLD) is authorized to cancel the room assigned. In such cases, the student's belongings will be removed from the room and stored as per the storage policy outlined in the Residential Halls Agreement.

Alcohol/Drugs

Refer to the Student Code of Conduct 2.1 Policy on Alcohol Abuse and 2.2 Policy on Controlled Substance/Drug Abuse in the [student handbook](#).

Smoking

Refer to the Student Code of Conduct 2.17 Policy on Smoking in the [student handbook](#) and the Smoke-Free Campus Policy. The presence of cigarette smoke in a student's room will imply the use of cigarettes or tobacco and will be referred to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution as a health and safety violation.

Littering

Since the residential halls become residents' second homes, all students are expected to maintain cleanliness inside the halls. Rooms are inspected periodically for cleanliness. This practice is important, as it can have serious effects on student hygiene. Students are also expected to regularly empty their rooms of garbage.

Harassment

Refer to the Student Code of Conduct 2.10 Policy on Harassment in the [student handbook](#).

Visitors

AUS non-resident students are not allowed to stay overnight in the residential halls, instead, they should spend time in the Hub only. The Hub serves as a central gathering place for all the residential students to study and connect with fellow residents. It also serves as a welcome center for parents to meet and catch up with their resident student. Additionally, The Hub is used for the events and activities organized by the residential halls team.

Responsibility for Guests

Residents will be held responsible for the behavior of their guests and any other persons visiting them in their residential hall rooms as outlined by the conduct regulations. Residents may, in lieu of the guest or visitor, be charged with violating the respective sections of these policies.

Important:

- AUS students who are nonresidents and any other guests can only visit resident students for brief periods and should only meet them in the reception, TV lounge or computer lab.
- Fathers and brothers of male residents, and mothers and sisters of female residents can visit their student's room for a brief period during the check-in/move in day and check-out.
- In addition:
- A resident shall not pressure a roommate to tolerate the presence of a guest.
- The presence of the guest should not restrict residents' comfortable use of common and private areas.
- Residents are not allowed to give access card to guests.

Quiet Hours

Whatever other functions a residential hall may serve, its essential role is to be a place where students can sleep and study. In order to assist you in your academic endeavors, our policy in all areas is that the right to quiet supersedes the right to make noise. The staff will be more lenient with noise during the day and stricter in their enforcement during the evening and nighttime hours. Quiet hours are designated daily between 12 midnight and 7 a.m. to provide more specific parameters to resident students. Noise generated outside the residential halls may be reported to AUS Security.

Exterior Displays

Room decorations must be limited to student rooms. AUS assigns the inside of residences for student use and does not grant residents permission to decorate the exterior of university buildings. This includes window displays, regardless of whether a display is positioned on the inside or the outside of a window. The outside of your door is also considered an interior space for the purpose of decoration. Students will be held accountable to the university for the materials placed on their doors. Students are not allowed to repaint the walls or furniture or damage assets for the purpose of decoration, e.g., nailing a frame to the wall.

Maintenance

Student rooms will be fully maintained and repaired for any damages. If students cause damage, they will pay for the cost of repairs. In case of damage, the Residential Hall Coordinator should be informed. Each student is responsible for any damage caused by his/her guest.

Commercial Use

Resident students are not allowed to conduct a business operation from within a residential hall. Resident students are prohibited from encouraging commercial or profit-making activities or calling in off-campus sales/beauty professionals. It is also prohibited to rent or sublet a room to another person, even if he/she is an AUS student.

Flammable Chemicals, Firearms, Fireworks, Weapons and Explosives

These articles are prohibited, and residents found in possession of such articles will be subject to disciplinary

action. Utility knives are permitted in the halls but will be confiscated if used as weapons.

Fire Safety

A fire alarm sound indicates that an emergency exists. Residents and guests should never assume that an alarm is false or a drill, as any delay in evacuating could be fatal. Setting fires, turning in false alarms, making a bomb threat, refusing to vacate during a fire alarm and tampering with firefighting equipment, fire alarm systems, fire protection sprinklers and smoke detectors are serious offenses and will result in severe disciplinary action. Staff on duty are the direct persons who are responsible for evacuation of the facility. Students and guests should fully comply with the instruction being issued by the staff. A fire drill will be conducted on regular basis at halls to enhance students' evacuation time. Students are encouraged to participate and cooperate during the fire drill.

Residential Facilities Policies

The policies below are aimed at protecting AUS and resident students' property from misuse. Students should not:

- Attach a mirror to the walls
- Paint walls, ceilings, doors, university furniture, etc.
- Remove window screens.
- Install external wiring, antennas or satellite dishes.
- Put any holes or hooks in walls, floors or ceilings.
- Intentionally or unintentionally damage university property.

Laundry

Washers and dryers are located in each residential hall. Only resident students are allowed to use this service. AUS is not liable of any loss, damage or theft of student/s clothes. Students are encouraged to be on guard while they are using the laundry.

Furniture

Students are strictly forbidden from removing any of their room furniture. The necessary furniture is provided according to AUS standards. Resident students may obtain approval from the Director of Student Residential Life to bring in special furniture prescribed for medical purposes.

In the Event of an Emergency

Students may contact the Residential Halls Coordinator on duty who will communicate with the emergency services of the university.

Fitness Rooms

By signing the check-in form, the residing student has accepted that AUS is exempted from any liability related to the use of the fitness rooms.

PROHIBITED CONDUCT CONCERNING SECURITY

The following conduct is prohibited:

- a. Entering any residential hall without showing identification card to the Residence Halls Coordinator.
- b. Not responding to the Residence Halls Coordinator instruction.

- c. Hosting a visitor in the residential hall without permission from the Residential Halls Coordinator extending authorized visiting time.
- d. Propping open emergency doors or exit ways without the permission of a Residential Halls Coordinator.
- e. Using any marked fire exit except during a fire drill or in the event of an actual fire.
- f. Blocking any fire door or fire exit.
- g. Misuse of access card.
- h. Failure to return access card upon vacating a room.
- i. Entering or exiting a residential hall through a window in a nonemergency situation
- j. Breaching the privacy of others in the halls.
- k. Stealing, using or moving student belongings without their permission.
- l. Aggressive behavior towards other students or staff.

PROHIBITED CONDUCT CONCERNING FIRE CODES

The following conduct is prohibited:

- a. Setting a fire within university buildings or areas next to the buildings.
- b. Using any broiler oven, electric coffee maker, popcorn popper, toasters, microwave oven, hotplate, open burner or electric water-heating device in non-designated areas.
- c. Cooking indoors with charcoal or any open flame device.
- d. Burning candles or incense indoors.
- e. Failure to evacuate buildings immediately and properly when a fire alarm has sounded and/or reentering any building during a fire drill or in an actual fire situation before receiving permission to do so from a Residential Hall Coordinator or security official.
- f. Tampering with fire equipment or removing fire extinguishers from their mounts or storage boxes except in the case of an actual fire.
- g. Activating a fire alarm when no fire is present or falsely reporting a fire or other emergency.
- h. Using electrical lights and appliances so that wattage in use totals more than 850 watts in a student room at a given time.
- i. Disconnecting the alarm or otherwise tampering with any smoke detector.
- j. Running electrical wires beneath any rug or carpet.
- k. Replacing any university-provided room draperies with something other than fire-retardant materials.

PROHIBITED CONDUCT CONCERNING REMOVING FURNITURE

The following conduct is prohibited:

- a. Removing furniture from any common area without the authorization of a hall coordinator.
- b. Removing any wall-mounted furniture.
- c. Marking or defacing any surface (e.g., door, wall, carpet).
- d. Marking, defacing, stealing, harboring or damaging any property belonging to the university in general, to any hall resident or to any commercial vendor (i.e., vending machines, washing machines, dryers or telephone equipment).
- e. Vandalism/Responsibility for Damage. Residential halls and their populations are held responsible for all university property assigned for their use and may be financially liable for its destruction or loss. Residents will be billed for repair or replacement if they have caused damage in their own rooms or in common areas. In the event of willful damage to the common areas in the immediate vicinity of a student's room or to the furnishings or facilities located there, if the willful perpetrators of such damage cannot be identified, all residents served by that common area may be assessed for repair or replacement costs.

OTHER PROHIBITED CONDUCT

The following conduct is prohibited:

- a. Engaging in any disorderly conduct or interfering with other residents' rights to an environment conducive to study and to sleep.
- b. Any activity that excessively disturbs residents, especially during designated quiet hours.
- c. Shouting or otherwise creating disturbances from any residential hall window

- d. Making excessive noise by any means whatsoever. This includes putting loudspeakers through room windows at any time and any noise audible outside a student's room or in public areas, especially during quiet hours.
- e. Dropping or throwing any solid object or liquid from windows
- f. keeping dangerous materials, including but not limited to firearms, air or carbon dioxide- powered weapons, fireworks and dangerous weapons.
- g. Refusing to follow a directive from a hall coordinator or security official who is acting in the performance of his/her duties.
- h. Harassing or verbally abusing any resident, guest or staff member living in the residential halls.
- i. Physically assaulting or causing harm to any person on university premises.
- j. Posting or distribution of any materials or soliciting or canvassing within the residential halls without the approval of the Residential Hall Coordinator or in violation of university posting policies.
- k. Hosting an overnight guest (resident student only) without obtaining an internal visitor's form.
- l. Participating in water fights in and around the residential halls using water guns, water balloons or buckets.
- m. Video shooting or filming documentaries in the residential halls.
- n. Keeping any pet in a student room.

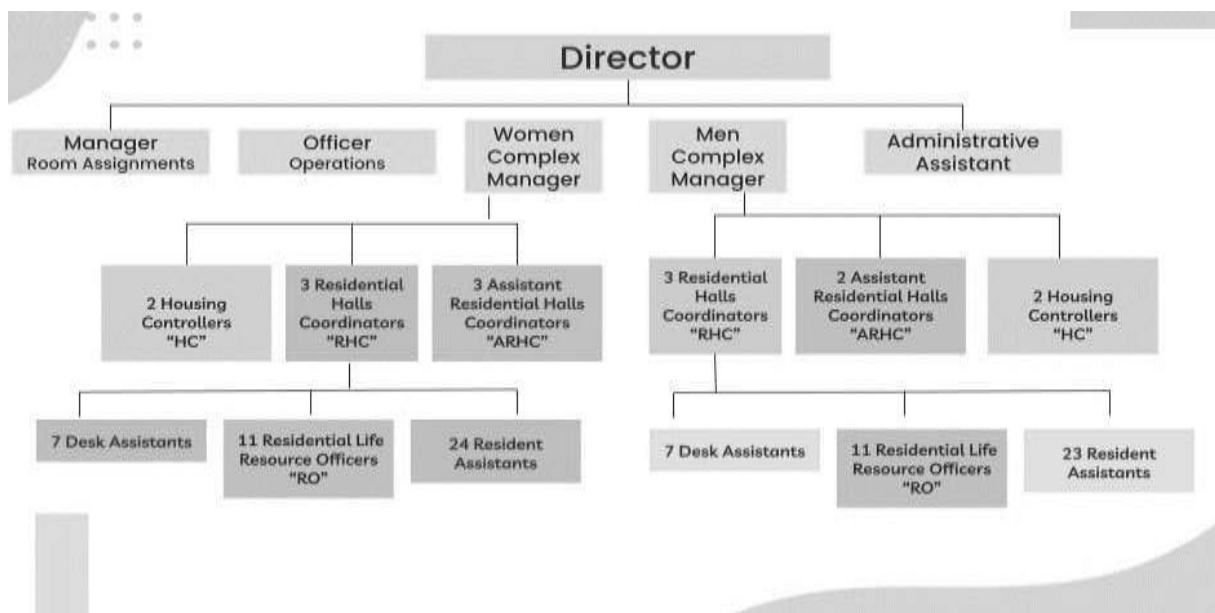
5. Scope/applicability:

The scope of the residential halls policy encompasses all aspects of life within the on-campus housing facilities at the American University of Sharjah. It applies to all residents, including students, staff, and guests, outlining expectations for behavior, safety, and maintenance. The policy is designed to ensure a respectful and orderly living environment and governs activities and procedures related to residential hall operations, including curfew enforcement, guest policies, and maintenance responsibilities.

6. Responsibilities

The responsibility of the residential halls policy lies in establishing and upholding standards that ensure a safe, respectful, and well-managed living environment for all residents. It mandates that students adhere to guidelines for behavior, safety, and maintenance, while also outlining the roles and responsibilities of residential halls staff. By clearly defining these expectations, the policy aims to promote a positive community atmosphere and address any issues that arise within the residential halls efficiently and fairly.

The list of roles and responsibilities are stated below.



7. Definitions:

- **AUS:** American University of Sharjah.
- **Resident:** Any student who lives in the residential halls.
- **Visitor:** Anyone who doesn't reside in the residential halls.
 - **Guardian:** Includes the student's mother, father, brothers, sisters, mother-in-law, father-in-law, and grandparents.
 - **Code of Conduct:** Rights, responsibilities, and reasonable standards essential to the AUS community to live, work and study together.
 - **Disciplinary Action:** Punishment of some kind meted out to a person who has committed a breach of a code of conduct.
 - **Policy:** Written regulation.
 - **VCSE:** Vice Chancellor for Student Experience.
 - **ASC:** Academic Support Center.
 - **Residential Halls:** AUS residential Buildings.
 - **OSA:** Office of Student Affairs.
 - **SCCR:** Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution.
 - **SRLD:** Student Residential Life Department.
 - **CM:** Complex Managers oversee the operation of both the Women's and Men's

residential halls. They are responsible for ensuring the smooth and efficient running of these facilities, addressing resident concerns, coordinating maintenance and support services, and fostering a positive living environment.

- **RHC:** Residential Hall Coordinators are experienced professional staff assigned to each residential hall. They play a crucial role in managing daily operations, supporting resident needs, and creating a positive and engaging living environment.

- **ARHC:** Assistant Residential Hall Coordinators provide essential support to the

operation of residential halls, working closely with both the Residential Hall Coordinators and the Complex Managers. They assist in the day-to-day operations of the halls, helping in addressing resident issues, and coordinate maintenance complaints.

- **RLRO:** The Residential Life Resource Officer is a security staff who operates

around the clock, working 12-hour shifts in a rotation. Positioned at the reception area of each residential hall. The resource officer always ensures the safety and security of the students. Their role involves monitoring entry and exit points, providing assistance to residents, and maintaining a visible presence to deter and address any security concerns that may arise.

- **HC:** Housing Controller is a Residential Hall staff member who works mostly nights.

They are expected to work with the RHC on-call to ensure the safety and well-being of our resident students during the night hours.

- **Housing hold:** Is a restriction placed on a student's ability to access or modify their housing arrangements, often due to unresolved issues such as unpaid fees, incomplete paperwork, or disciplinary matters. This hold prevents the students from making changes to their housing status, such as requesting room assignments or cancellations, until the underlying issue is resolved.

- The Hub serves as a central gathering place for all the residential students to study and connect with fellow residents. It also serves as a welcome center for parents to meet and catch up with their resident

student. Additionally, The Hub is used for the events and activities organized by the residential halls team.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

<u>Residential Halls:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls
<u>Residential Halls Forms:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls?t=forms--fees-and-rules
<u>New and Prospective Students:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls?t=apply
<u>Activities and Facilities:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls?t=activities-and-facilities
<u>Payment Guide:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/admissions/payment-guide
<u>Residential Halls Fees:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls?t=forms--fees-and-rules
<u>Rules and Regulations:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/residential-halls?t=forms--fees-and-rules
<u>Student Handbook:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/sites/default/files/osa_handbook_2024-2025.pdf
<u>Academic Calendar:</u>	https://www.aus.edu/sites/default/files/final_-_ug_-_catalogue_-_academic_calenar_2023-2024_-_undergraduate_-_april_17_2023.pdf

9. Policy History:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 13, 2015	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	1 July, 2022	Edited Policy – (Updated new structure job titles including Complex Managers, Residential Halls Coordinators, and Resident Assistants).	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	12 September 2024	Updated the Policy	Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Tod Alan Laursen	Tel: +971 6 515 2204	todlaursen@aus.edu

Chancellor		
Shaima Bin Taliah Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Issam Zaarob Student Residential Life Department	Tel: +971 6 515 2427	izaarob@aus.edu

I. Student Finance Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600FN12	Policy Title:	Student Finance Policy
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 11, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Introduction / background:

The university is committed to provide a clear guidance to the students, parents, sponsors, on the fees structure and the components of such fees, and the available methods of paying the fees, with a dedicated department for this purpose.

2. Purpose:

The policy aims to have clear, detailed and reachable guidance on the fees structure, and the available methods of payments is important for a smooth and efficient registration process.

The University also recognizes that in some cases students and/or parents might need to have payment plans in place, and hence the introduction of the possible payment plans and related conditions and requirements needed to facilitate the education to all students.

The University also recognize that there might be some rare cases where a student decide to withdraw from a semester and requests refund, where this policy also identify the refundable items and stipulates the deadlines and the refundable amounts.

3. Policy Statement:

Payment Methods

Applies for both Undergraduate and Graduate students.

For any inquiries, students can contact Student Accounts Department from 8:00 AM to 6:00 PM on +971 6 515 2039 or +971 6 515 2282 or send an email to studentaccounts@aus.edu

E- Payment	Students can login into his/her banner system with their AUS username and password and do the following steps: 1. Student services 2. Student records 3. E-payment Main Menu 4. Submit E-payment 5. Then, you can insert the amount you wish to pay as on account payment.
Debit & Credit Cards	• Payments can be made through a credit card (not debit card) by filling out the Credit Card Authorization Form • Debit cards with no online facilities are not accepted for deferred and/or online payment.

Direct Cash Deposits at Al Ansari Exchange / UAE Exchange	• Deposits can be made at any branch of Al Ansari Exchange or UAE Exchange; where available all over UAE. • Deposits are accepted in the form of cash only. • The student's name and AUS ID number must be mentioned on the deposit instructions. • Scan the deposit confirmation and email to studentaccounts@aus.edu												
Direct Bank Transfer and/or Bank Deposits	<table border="1" data-bbox="467 589 1332 891"> <tr> <td>Bank:</td><td>Sharjah Islamic Bank</td></tr> <tr> <td>Account Name:</td><td>American University of Sharjah</td></tr> <tr> <td>Account Number:</td><td>0011 200170 001</td></tr> <tr> <td>Branch:</td><td>University City - Sharjah Branch</td></tr> <tr> <td>Swift:</td><td>NBSHAEAS</td></tr> <tr> <td>IBAN:</td><td>AE02 0410 0000 1120 0170 001</td></tr> </table> • The student's name and ID number must be mentioned on the transfer instructions. • Scan the transfer confirmation and email to studentaccounts@aus.edu • Deposits can be made at any Sharjah Islamic Bank Branch or the cash deposit machines where available. • Post-dated checks should not be deposited at the bank	Bank:	Sharjah Islamic Bank	Account Name:	American University of Sharjah	Account Number:	0011 200170 001	Branch:	University City - Sharjah Branch	Swift:	NBSHAEAS	IBAN:	AE02 0410 0000 1120 0170 001
Bank:	Sharjah Islamic Bank												
Account Name:	American University of Sharjah												
Account Number:	0011 200170 001												
Branch:	University City - Sharjah Branch												
Swift:	NBSHAEAS												
IBAN:	AE02 0410 0000 1120 0170 001												

Tuition fees payment deadlines:

- For the “Undergraduate” students there should be 2 deadlines for payment of tuition fees, where: deadline (A) by the end of the 1st week of commencement for returning students and the week after for new students, while deadline (B) by the end of the 3rd week.
- If payment is not completed by the deadline, late fees of AED 500 plus 5% VAT will be charged.
- If payment is not completed by deadline B, registration will be dropped and only reinstated when the full fees and the AED 1,500 plus 5% VAT reinstatement fee and AED 500 plus 5% VAT late payment fee are fully paid. Failure to attend a course (no show) does not result in a refund for courses registered. Students must drop excess credits before the add/drop deadline in order to receive a refund.
- Payment can be made any time before registration.
- As for the “Graduate” students there is only 1 deadline, which would be the beginning of the 3rd week of commencement.
- If payment is not completed by the deadline, late fees of AED 500 plus 5% VAT will be charged.
- Failure to attend a course (no show) does not result in a refund for courses registered. Students must drop excess credits before the add/drop deadline in order to receive a refund.

- Payment can be made any time before registration.

Payment by installments:

This applies for both Undergraduate and Graduate students.

If full fees cannot be paid immediately, installments can be arranged with the Student Accounts Department as follows:

Due Dates	End of 1 st week of commencement (5 p.m.)	60% of full fees (net of scholarship amount)
	1 month following the above date	20% of full fees (net of scholarship amount)
	1 month following the above date	20% of full fees (net of scholarship amount)

- Deferment by Credit Card Authorization is subject to approval by the Student Accounts. Student has to fill the “Credit Card Authorization Form” as per the above dates and equivalent to the above dues and then sent by email to studentaccounts@aus.edu
- Deferred credit card payments rejected/not authorized on the date of withdrawal will be subject to AED 500 + 5% VAT charges per transaction.
- If student has two or more rejected credit card payments, then student can no longer apply to pay by installments.
- Failure to attend a course (no show) does not result in a refund of charges. Students not planning to attend must drop their registration during the drop/add period. Students reported as “no show” in class will be withdrawn from the class without a refund. These students shall be placed on a drop/delete hold and will not be able to register in future semesters unless the fees are paid in full in advance.
- If the credit card authorization for the first installment is returned, then the balance of credit card authorizations for the remaining installments shall be reversed and the student shall be requested to complete the full payment in cash. The student in this case will no longer have the privilege of paying in installments.

Withdrawals and refunds:

Withdrawal from the university is subject to the following refund policy:

Before 5 p.m. End of 2 nd Week of commencement	Full tuition refund less AED 500 pre-registration fee
After 5 p.m. End of 2 nd Week — 5 p.m. End of 3 rd Week of commencement	50% of the tuition
After 5 p.m. End of 3 rd Week — 5 p.m. End 4 th Week of Commencement	25% of the tuition
After 5 p.m. End of 4 th Week of Commencement	0%

Fees Structure:

- Detailed structure fees should be approved for online publishing by the Director of Finance every semester.

- The details should include the fees for the credits, Achievement Academy, Dorms and other applicable fees during the semester.

Below is an example from the Academic Year 2021-2022:

Undergraduate Tuition Applicable During the Academic Year 2021-2022	
Credit Hours	Per Semester (AED)
Less than 12 credits	4,180 per credit hour
12 to 16 credits	48,070
Over 16 credits	48,070 + 3,200 per credit hour exceeding 16 credit hours
Achievement Academy	31,220

Undergraduate Fees Applicable During the Academic Year 2021-2022			
Fee Type	Compulsory	Per Course AED	Per Semester AED
Lab/Technology Fee A	Applies for each registered course that has a fee “A” attached as per AUS catalog.	1,340	-
Lab/Technology Fee B	Applies for each registered course that has a fee “B” attached as per AUS catalog.	1,480	-
Activity Fee	Compulsory for all undergraduate and AA students	-	300 + 5% VAT
IXO Outings and Events Fees	All Incoming Exchange/ Visiting Students	-	700 + 5% VAT
Reinstatement Fee	If Applicable	-	1,500 + 5% VAT
Late Registration	If Applicable	-	500 + 5% VAT
Late Payment	If Applicable	-	500 + 5% VAT
Health Insurance: Plan I Plan II	AUS-Sponsored Students	-	600 + 5% VAT
	For all students who are not on Plan I	-	300
	For all Students - Medical Services at University Hospital Sharjah’s Primary Care Clinic & Emergency Room		112.50 + 5% VAT

Student Housing Fees Applicable During the Academic Year 2021-2022		
AUS has residence halls for men and women. Living on campus is optional. Students should contact the Office of Student Affairs for information regarding individual requirements.		
Room		Per Semester AED
	<i>Refundable Dorm Damage Deposit</i>	1,000
Private	Single occupancy with private bath and kitchenette	15,000
Semi-Private	Single occupancy with a shared bath and kitchenette	11,000
Sharing	Double occupancy with a shared bath and kitchenette	7,000
Utilities Service Fee	Compulsory for all students residing in dormitories – will be added to the respective room rate when charged to the student account	290 + 5% VAT

Calculation Sheet (Full-Time Students)

Name: _____ ID @: _____

Select relative fees and fill in the selection column.

Fee Type	Amount (AED)	Selection
Achievement Academy	31,220	
Tuition (12 to 16 credits)	48,070	
Extra Credits (per credit over 16)	3,200	
Medical Insurance—Plan I	600 + 5% VAT	
Medical Insurance— Plan II	300	
University Hospital Sharjah Charge	112.50+5% VAT	
Activity Fee	300 + 5% VAT	
Residential Hall—Private Room	15,000	
Residential Hall—Semi-private	11,000	
Residential Hall—Sharing	7,000	
Utility Fee (added to any type of residential hall room)	290 + 5% VAT	
Refundable Dorm Deposit (one-time fee for new residential hall registrations)	1,000	

Lab/Technology fee (per lab) Rate A as per AUS catalog	1,340	
Lab/Technology fee (per lab) Rate B as per AUS catalog	1,480	
Total Fees		
Less Grants (if applicable)		
Less Merit/Other Scholarships (if applicable)		
Less Payments Made		
Net Balance Payable to AUS (AED)		

Also an example for the Graduate students:

Graduate Tuition for Academic Year 2020-2021	
Graduate Courses	Per Credit Hour
College of Architecture, Art and Design	AED 4,750
College of Arts and Sciences	AED 3,790
College of Arts and Sciences Pd.D. programs	AED 4,750
College of Engineering (including Pd.D. programs)	AED 4,750
School of Business Administration (including Pd.D. programs)	AED 4,750

Optional		
Health Insurance (either/or)	Plan I AUS-sponsored students	AED 600 + 5% VAT (per semester)
	Plan II Available for all students	AED 300 (per semester)

Conditional		
Lab/Technology Fee A	Applies for each registered course that has a fee A attached as per AUS catalog	AED 1,340
Lab/Technology Fee B	Applies for each registered course that has a fee B attached as per AUS catalog	AED 1,480
Activity Fee	Applies to all graduate students	100 + 5% VAT
Thesis or Project Extension Fee	Applies to students who require this option	200
Thesis Processing Fee	Applies to students who require this service	1,000

Thesis Binding Fee	Applies to students who require this service	350
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Fines/Charges (if applicable)	
Late Payment Fee (initial charge if fees are not settled by the due date)	AED 500 + 5% VAT
Returned Check Penalty (per check if returned by bank) and /or Declined Credit Card Fee (per transaction for deferred payments if credit card is declined)	AED 500 + 5% VAT

Credit Card Authorization Form:

- To be filled by students applying for payment by installments
- Applied for both Graduate and Undergraduate students

Credit Card Authorization Form	
Credit Cards Payments (paid via written authorization)	Payments can be made through a credit card (debit cards not accepted) by filling out this Credit Card Authorization Form and email it to studentaccounts@aus.edu .
I authorize American University of Sharjah to charge the amounts given below in the schedule on the dates specified.	
Amount to be Debited on Each Installment	Date to Debit Credit Card
Please complete the credit card information below:	
Name of Card Holder _____	
Signature of Card Holder _____	
Credit Card type: ☐ Visa ☐ MasterCard ☐ Diner's ☐ American Express ☐ Other (please specify) _____	
Credit Card Expiry Date: Month _____ Year _____	
Credit Card Number _____ - _____ - _____ - _____	

UAE Tel (_____) _____ Other Tel (_____) _____ Fax (_____) _____ Date of Submitting This Document _____ <u>Please complete the student's information below:</u> Student Name _____ Student ID No. _____ Email Addresses (1) _____ (2) _____ _____ Remarks and Reason for Payment _____

4. Scope/applicability:

This policy applied to students, both Graduate and Undergraduate as relative, Student Accounts department specifically, and Finance Department in general.

5. Responsibilities:

- Student Accounts department shall always follow the guide in answering the students queries.
- Student Accounts department shall follow this policy in applying fines and penalties as applicable on students for late payments or returned credit cards payments.
- Student Accounts department follow up with students with no payments before the deadlines to ensure payments or installments plan in place
- Student Accounts department shall follow up with students before dropping them
- Payment guides should be built according to this policy and published online for easy access by students after being approved by the Director of Finance

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

E-Payment: Payment portal through Banner system.

Direct Deposit: Cash payment directly in the AUS account in one of Sharjah Islamic Bank branches or Al Ansari Exchange branches.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Accounts Receivable Policy

AUS POLICIES AND PROCEDURES MANUAL | AY24-25 | VERSION 5

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8. Policy history:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 11, 2018	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 27, 2023	Revised to reflect the current policies	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Students Accounts	Tel: +971 6 515 2039 or +971 6 515 2282	studentsaccounts@aus.edu

m. Student Discipline Policy/Student Code of Conduct Policy - Version 5

Policy Number:	0600SE13	Policy Title:	Student Discipline Policy/Student Code of Conduct Policy
Prepared By:	Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR)	Issue Date:	1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/ Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	Effective Date:	June 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 12, 2026

1. Policy:

The Student Code of Conduct Policy describes standards of general student conduct usually excluding academic responsibilities. All alleged violations are resolved per the code under the direct authority of the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of the Student Code of Conduct (“Code”) is to define standards of behavior expected from AUS students, and the procedures and sanctions that will apply in case the student behavior is inconsistent with the essential values of the University.

3. Introduction/background:

- i. This policy was applied from 1998 and modified every academic year since then.
- ii. The modified policy is effective August 2009.
- iii. Major modifications were effected in February 2012 based on the socio-economic impact on student life, challenging behavioral issues impacting the institution's safety, technological advances, and anticipated cyber offences specific to AUS students.
- iv. Student Code of Conduct Policy (SCCP) was reviewed in February 2014 and again in 2015 and modifications were effected according to structural changes.
- v. The Student Code of Conduct Policy was reviewed through March and April 2016 and substantial edits were made to clarify items. The appeal process was reformed.
- vi. The Student Code of Conduct Policy was reviewed in April and May 2018 and edits were made to the policy on abuse of information technology. Additionally, transcript notations on disciplinary suspensions and dismissal, and the confidentiality item, were clarified.
- vii. The Vice Provost for Student Life replaced the Dean of Students position in the Office of Student Affairs. Adhering to the recommendation of the Middle States Commission for Higher Education, in 2018, the process of Appellate Committee review of disciplinary dismissal case(s) was introduced. The temporary Appellate Committee for Reinstatement of Sanctioned Students was renamed Advisory Committee.
- viii. Revisions were made in the Code renaming Judicial Affairs as Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution from February 2020. A stand-alone smoking policy was added with a link to the Campus Free Smoking Policy. The code provides students with virtual and in-person options for conflict resolution. This code links students, faculty, and staff to report incidents on the Student Infraction Management System. Administrative and Educational Sanctions were clarified.
- ix. The definition of Appellate Committee was added. Section 3.1 on appealing was revised.

- x. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience reports to the Chancellor from November 2021. The code was updated with a section on preponderance of evidence. A policy is added on responsible use of institutional resources and facilities.
- xi. Rights and Responsibilities were revised in April 2024 so students are aware of their entitlements and accountabilities. Behavioral Penalties grid was added for students to be informed of the disciplinary outcomes. April 4, 2024 - As a significant advancement in our commitment to fostering a safe and respectful campus environment, the Chancellor, in collaboration with Departmental Heads, has approved a comprehensive Sexual Misconduct Policy. This newly approved policy supersedes all previous references to sexual harassment, including section 2.13 in the Student Code of Conduct. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience title in the leadership position was announced on 11 June 2024. The code is amended accordingly.

4. Policy Statement:

The student conduct system provides students with a fair adjudication process in instances where there are alleged violations of the Code. The purpose of student disciplinary proceedings is to determine whether the University's standards of conduct have been violated.

The University views the student conduct system as an educational opportunity that leads to a greater personal understanding of one's responsibilities and privileges in the University community. Acceptable standards of conduct have been established to protect the rights of others, ensure the safety of community members, and the orderly operation of the University. Students must ensure that their conduct does not violate applicable local laws of Sharjah, federal laws of the UAE, and all AUS rules, regulations, and policies, including the Code. At times, mediation or other non-disciplinary alternate dispute resolution options will be considered to resolve conduct cases.

Mediation is encouraged as an alternative means to resolve minor conduct cases. The Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Official will determine if mediation is appropriate and, at his/her discretion, may decline to process a complaint until the parties in a misconduct case make a reasonable attempt to achieve a mediated settlement. To be binding in a conduct case, any mediated settlement must be approved by the Senior Manager-Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution. If mediation fails, the case will be forwarded for adjudication.

Student Rights and Responsibilities:

Student Rights

Each enrolled student have the following rights:

- To utilize campus facilities reasonably and as deemed appropriate by the University.
- To be treated with dignity and respect at all times.
- To report a suspected violation of the code of conduct policy.
- To be heard without bias.
- To have the right to personal safety and security at all times while on campus.
- To receive a clear notice of charges and cause for disciplinary sanction, and the right to impartial hearing.
- To have the opportunity to appeal for a review of imposed sanctions.
- To privacy and confidentiality adhering to the university protocol and policies
- To receive support and guidance based on needs and circumstances.

Student Responsibilities

Each student is accountable for the following responsibilities:

- To treat students, staff and faculty with dignity and respect.

- To uphold AUS values both on campus and in public while representing the university.
- To refrain from using verbal, written or electronic methods to harass, threaten or intimidate another student.
- To avoid participating in any actions that jeopardize the health or safety of individuals at the university.
- To refrain from engaging in inappropriate physical contact between male and female students.
- To actively acknowledge and adhere to the Code, University Policies and the laws of Sharjah and UAE.

In cases of violations of the Code, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience, the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department, and the Conduct Council Hearing Board shall not consider ignorance of a policy, rule or regulation an acceptable defense.

1. Policies Concerning Prohibited Conduct

Specific examples of Prohibited Actions/ Conduct include, but are not limited to, the following:

1.1 Policy on Alcohol Abuse

- i. The possession, use, sale or distribution of alcohol in violation of the Code and the relevant laws of Sharjah and the UAE.
- ii. Entry upon University premises or involvement in any University activity in an intoxicated state or using or transporting alcoholic beverages into the residential halls or other locations on campus.

1.2 Policy on Controlled Substance/Drug Abuse

The possession, use, sale or distribution of controlled substances/drugs including, but not limited to, the use of any mind-altering substances in violation of the Code and the relevant laws of Sharjah and the UAE.

1.3 Policy on Disruptive Conduct

- i. Intentional obstruction or disruption of teaching, research, administration, disciplinary proceedings or other University-authorized activities, or functions on University premises, using derogatory, threatening or insulting verbal or written comments or gestures; and intimidating and individual or collective action that prevents any University community member from executing his/her legitimate activities.
- ii. Engaging in activities that result in excessive noise that, regardless of the means, disrupt or compromise University activities or functions.
- iii. Cursing in a public setting, using offensive or insulting language that includes, but is not limited to, name-calling, insults, profanity, inappropriate slang, vulgarity or speech that violates relevant laws of Sharjah and the UAE.
- iv. Persistent acts of disobedience that disrupt or compromise University activities or functions.

1.4 Policy on Dress Code

Inappropriate dress for both males and females is prohibited. This includes, but is not limited to, tank tops, clothing that is very tight or transparent and indecently exposes the waist or back or shoulders or cleavage, and clothing above the knees. Moreover, clothing must not display obscene or offensive pictures and slogans.

1.5 Policy on Endangering the Safety of Self or Others

- i. Conduct that threatens or endangers the health or safety of any person on University premises or at University-sponsored events or functions on or off campus.
- ii. Blocking a person and intentionally restricting his/her movement without consent.
- iii. Engaging in a gang-related activity including overt display of gang affiliation.
- iv. False activation of fire alarms, unjustified discharge of fire extinguishers, or purposefully tampering with the power supply equipment causing power failure; or misuse of any other firefighting or electric equipment in a manner that disrupts or compromises University activities or functions or results in potential harm to others.
- v. Engaging in blackmail or coercion.
- vi. Enticing or inciting a person to commit an act that is humiliating or demeaning that does not result in a physical injury but causes excessive mental stress to any member of the University community.
- vii. Misdemeanors that include, but are not limited to, malicious mischief and indecent or obscene communication with another University community member.
- viii. Imposing self-harm or inflicting self-injury.
- ix. Driving a vehicle on campus without a valid license or without permission of the vehicle owner.
- x. Failure to abide by traffic laws on campus or driving in a manner that may endanger the health and/or safety of oneself or others.

1.6 Policy on Refusal to Identify and Comply

- i. Entering or attempting to enter any dwelling, building or facility on University premises without permission from its lawful authority and refusing to leave the premise when instructed by the university official. Entering forcibly, trespassing or utilizing University academic buildings or facilities during or after official University working hours without necessary authorization.
- ii. Failure to comply with:
 - a. residential hall agreement;
 - b. entry and overnight stay procedures in the residential halls; or
 - c. responsible use of University residential assets and facilities.
- iii. Failure to comply with the direction of University officials and/or designated University security officials acting in performance of their duties and/or failure to identify oneself to these persons when requested to do so.

1.7 Policy on Falsification

Lying or knowingly furnishing false information to any University official or office. For matters related to falsification in academic work, please refer to the Student Academic Integrity Code in the undergraduate and graduate catalogs.

1.8 Policy on Attempts to Defraud

- i. Fraud, forgery, alteration or unauthorized use of documents, University records or instruments of identification with the intent to defraud or deceive, including, but not limited to, misusing or reproducing University-issued documents such as ID cards, commencement tickets, registration passes, temporary entrance permits or car stickers or false accounting (submitting false or exaggerated claims for reimbursement of expenses from university allocated budget for university- sponsored or university-approved activities).

- ii. Unauthorized use or distribution of course-related content, research of a second party, video or audio or exams, without the consent of the owner.
- iii. Tampering with or unauthorized or fraudulent use of campus telephones, or mobiles or access codes or bank credit or debit cards of any AUS community member.

1.9 Policy on Physical Assault

Physical abuse, including, but not limited to, assaults or physical injury to persons on University premises or at University-sponsored events or functions.

1.10 Policy on Harassment

- i. Conduct (physical, verbal, graphic, written or electronic) or intimidation that is sufficiently severe, pervasive or persistent so as to threaten an individual or limit the ability of a person to work, study or participate in an activity.
- ii. Stalking: Repeatedly engaging in a course of conduct directed at another person that makes a credible threat with the intent to place a person in reasonable fear for his/her safety or the safety of his/her family.
- iii. Defamation: Spreading rumors about a person and disclosing his/her personal information, or invading his or her privacy to cause embarrassment and distress to another person.
- iv. Use of profane, obscene, indecent and immoral or seriously offensive language and gestures or propositions.
- v. Inappropriate behavior demonstrating a lack of respect or harassment that is based on race, gender, color, national origin, sex, gender, sexual orientation, age, religion, gender identity, gender expression or disability.
- vi. Use of information and communication technologies including, but not limited to, email, mobile phones, instant messaging, text messages, personal websites, social networking sites and online personal polling websites to support harassing or hostile behavior by an individual or group, or that is intended or has the potential to harm or demonstrate disrespect for others (e.g., cyberbullying). <http://bit.ly/AUSDigitalContentGuidelines>
- vii. Bullying: Encouraging or being involved in any act individually or in conjunction with a group to cause physical or mental harm or humiliation or substantial risk to a student or other members of the AUS community. Such acts may include, but are not limited to, forcing someone to smoke or drink alcohol, creating excessive fatigue, or punching or kicking in any form.

1.11 Policy on Inappropriate Contact

Inappropriate contact between a male and female is strictly prohibited by the cultural norms of Sharjah and the UAE and is considered a violation of the Code.

1.12 Policy on Abuse of Information Technology

- i. Stalking, harassing, bullying or otherwise intimidating others using any information technology device, computers, social media or social networking websites.
- ii. Use of software or tools that constantly refresh or monitor for seat availability or those that automate filling fields or speed up registration in an unfair manner.
- iii. Misuse of social bots or similar tools for manipulating student voters' decisions during club/organization elections or events.
- iv. Hacking into the AUS network to access student records or other unauthorized information, cause a security hazard, or intimidate students, faculty or staff members.
- v. Intentionally interfering with the AUS network or IT systems to alter the intended use.

- vi. Intentionally using the AUS network or IT devices to spread malware or viruses to the AUS network.
- vii. Gaining unauthorized access to the computer or email, student information system, or course management system accounts of any member of the AUS community.
- viii. Unauthorized use or manipulation of University IT systems and/or University processes to alter or hinder University operations for personal, material or monetary gain. This includes, but is not limited to, reserving seats or buying, selling, trading or taking advantage of reserved seats in courses during registration, and the use of University resources to mine for any type of cryptocurrency.
- ix. Use of the AUS network or any IT device for any unauthorized purpose not otherwise listed in this Code.
- x. Tampering with, or unauthorized or fraudulent use of, University computers or other students' computers, network systems, personal USBs or other data storage devices or computer files as defined under IT policy. For more information, please see the IT Policies section at www.aus.edu/IT.
- xi. Institution's Facilities and electronic Resources
- xii. The appropriate and proper use of the institution's facilities and electronic resources, including Internet connections: The American University of Sharjah (AUS) has established the rules for the acceptable use of its IT facilities and network infrastructure. These rules, detailed in the Acceptable Use of IT policy, are necessary to preserve the integrity, availability and confidentiality of the university's network resources and services. The standards in this policy must be adhered to by all individuals granted access to any machine or network access at any time, whether physically present or via remote access. Failure to comply with the standards set forth in this policy will result in disciplinary action. <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/on-campus-services/it-services/it-policies>

1.13 Policy on Sexual Misconduct

For Sexual Misconduct Policy information, contact Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution at sccr@aus.edu, 06 515 2250/2740/2894 only. File your complaint at reachout@aus.edu

1.14 Policy on Theft, Property Damage and Vandalism

- i. Theft or unauthorized use of University property or property of an AUS student, faculty member, staff member, resident or visitor on University premises, including, but not limited to, possession and use of stolen property.
- ii. Vandalism, including, but not limited to, damaging or defacing objects or any University property willfully and/or recklessly.

1.15 Policy on Illegal and Unauthorized Possession or Use of Weapons

Using, possessing, selling or distributing any firearms, fireworks, explosives or weapons, or possessing any object produced as a weapon on University premises or at University-sponsored functions, or of any other materials or substances that are prohibited by law, with the sole exception of law enforcement officials duly authorized by law to possess firearms for the performance of their duties.

1.16 Policy on Involvement in Unauthorized and Illegal Activities

- i. Unauthorized use, distribution or posting of any printed material (including in electronic form) or use of the University's corporate name or logo in any communication or print by any student(s) or student organizations. This includes use of the University's logo or

corporate name in any off-campus functions, which may not be reserved in the name of the University.

- ii. Unauthorized soliciting or canvassing by any individual, group or organization on University premises or in University residential halls.
- iii. Gambling or other illegal or unauthorized games or contests of chance on University premises and in University residential halls or at University-sponsored functions.
- iv. Recording of images without knowledge – using electronic or other means to make a video or photographic record of any student in a location where there is a reasonable expectation of privacy without the person's prior knowledge, when such a recording is likely to cause injury, distress or damage to reputation. This includes, but is not limited to, taking video or photographic images in showers, locker rooms, residential hall rooms, classrooms and restrooms. The storing, sharing and/or distributing of such unauthorized recording by any means are also prohibited.
- v. Electronically or physically distributing, storing or posting of pornographic or offensive material that demonstrates a violation of the relevant UAE laws and federal laws of UAE.
- vi. Obtaining, reproducing, or distributing University-issued documents for personal, material, or monetary gain. This includes, but is not limited to, obtaining through unauthorized means and/or distributing course-related or University-issued material, and reproducing-issued material, and producing and/or buying, selling or trading University-issued documents such as registration passes or Commencement tickets.
- vii. Violations of traffic laws, including, but not limited to, reckless driving, forced parking, parking in a manner that blocks entrance or exit and parking in unauthorized spaces. This also includes failure to comply with instructions provided by persons responsible for enforcing parking and traffic rules on AUS campus. For more information, please refer to traffic policies at <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/on-campus-services/id-cards-and-car-stickers>

1.17 Policy on Smoking

- i. Violating the University [Smoke-Free Campus Policy](#) and UAE law including, but not limited to, smoking in the washrooms in all academic and administrative buildings, residential halls and parking areas.
- ii. Failure to comply with instructions or requests from persons responsible for enforcing smoking policies on the AUS campus.
- iii. Smoking or possession of shisha on campus, including in the residential halls.

1.18 Policy on Student Conduct System Abuse

Interference with the student conduct system, including, but not limited to:

- i. Failure to obey the directives of the Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB) or Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials.
- ii. Failure to appear at scheduled meetings or hearings with the Conduct Council Hearing Board.
- iii. Falsification, distortion or misinterpretation of information before the CCHB or Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials.
- iv. Disruption or interference with the orderly conduct of a conduct proceeding or hearing.

- v. Discouraging a student's or witnesses' proper participation in, or use of, the student conduct system.
- vi. Attempting to influence the impartiality of a CCHB member prior to and/or during the hearing.
- vii. Harassment (verbal or physical) and/or intimidation of a CCHB member or Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Official prior to, during and/or after a conduct proceeding or a hearing.
- viii. Influencing other students to commit abuse of the student conduct system.

1.19 Policy on Repeated Violations of the Code of Conduct

- i. Violating the terms of any disciplinary sanction imposed in accordance with the Code.
- ii. Violating the Code more than once.

1.20 Policy on Classroom Conduct

- i. Engaging in activities that are not related to the class; inappropriate use of electronic devices, cell phones or laptops; sleeping in class; chronically entering class late or leaving early; eating/drinking in class without permission; disputing authority and arguing with faculty and other students in class.
- ii. Threatening, verbal abuse including, but not limited to, using obscene language, demonstrating a lack of respect for the instructor, engaging in discussions in a manner that demonstrates a lack of respect for the instructor and/or others in the class, using admonitory or mocking gestures, defaming, harassment, physical altercations, destruction of property, and/or any behavior that puts the health or safety of the instructor or other students in the classroom in jeopardy

1.21 Policy on Conduct of Student Clubs/Organizations

- I. Tampering with the elections of any University-registered club or organization.
- II. Abuse of position and resources as an elected member of any registered organization including but, not limited to, misuse of resources allocated.

A. Procedures / Guidelines:

Complaints related to breach of the Code involving student(s) must be reported to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and/or Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution at sccr@aus.edu, or an incident report filed through the Student Infraction Management System at <https://sims.aus.edu>.

1. Student Conduct Process:

1.1 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will acknowledge the complaint, meet with the student(s) involved [the complainant(s) and the respondent(s)], discuss the charges, determine whether the violation has occurred, inform those responsible of the charges and issue the sanctions at a primary level. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials will issue undertakings, reprimands and warnings (verbal, first, second and final). In cases of infractions that warrant sanctions, the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will recommend sanctions to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience for consultation and approval. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will be responsible for questioning, listening to the complainant and respondent, writing reports, collecting supporting evidence, and reporting to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and the CCHB (when it is determined that a major misconduct warrants review by the CCHB). SCCR will be responsible for organizing hearings; implementing sanctions; documenting and storing case-related material; following up with students, witnesses and connected individuals; providing referrals to concerned University units; and archiving student files.

1.2 When a student is found responsible, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience is authorized to impose warnings with the following sanctions: conduct probation, community services, suspension for one or more semesters or dismissal from the residential halls, denial of use of University privileges, and levying fines. The EDSE can also recommend the following sanctions to the Chancellor: suspension for a stipulated period, or one- or two-semester suspension or dismissal from the University.

1.2 Students who have violated the Policy on Classroom Conduct must be referred to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will conduct an inquiry and take necessary action while the student continues his/her classes after signing the behavioral contract or no contact prohibiting him/her from continuing misconduct. If student behavior is found egregious and represents a threat to self or others, the concerned community member should provide Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution referral for crisis intervention and emergency action or Student of Concern Committee.

2. Proceedings

2.1. Any member of the University community may bring a complaint against a student or a student organization. A complaint or incident report must be filed with Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution on the discovery of the alleged infraction(s). SCCR will receive a complaint if extenuating circumstances prevented the complainant from reporting. The complaint or incident report should be a concise and complete statement of the allegations. A complainant may report anonymously; however, anonymous reports and delayed incident reporting may limit the outcome of investigations.

2.2. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will conduct inquiries with the complainant and respondent to determine whether a violation has taken place. If there is sufficient cause to believe that violation has occurred, the parties will be notified of the charges and evidence will be collected. Upon determination of policy violations, charges will be conveyed to the responsible student and sanctions will be discussed with the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience for implementation. If an incident warrants a hearing, the Senior Manager for Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will consult with the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and organize a hearing with the University's Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB).

2.3. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will contact the CCHB members to set a time and place for the hearing. Every effort shall be made to schedule this hearing within one week of the time a complaint is filed. The respondent shall receive a notification of the alleged violation and the time and place of the hearing.

2.4. If the respondent chooses not to appear for the hearing, the CCHB will consider the evidence supporting the allegations and a decision will be made in the absence of the respondent.

2.5. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials will notify the respondent in writing of the specific allegations filed, the hearing outcome and the sanctions.

2.6. Parents, family members, advisors or legal counsel are not permitted at any point during the conduct inquiry and adjudication process.

2.7. The University reserves the right to impose sanctions in cases in which a student has withdrawn from courses, withdrawn from the University, or been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case. The University may impose registration and/or housing holds to prohibit registration during the proceedings. If a sanction has been imposed on a student who has withdrawn from the University or been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case. The student's disciplinary record will be retained for five years from the date of the letter and then archived as legacy data in Student Infraction Management System.

2.8. In virtual/remote conduct inquiries with the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or the Conduct Hearing with the Conduct Council Hearing Board, where the student participates from his/her living room or other shared space and there is a potential for a person not participating in the hearing to be privy to confidential conversations whether intentionally or otherwise, the respondent will provide a confidentiality consent to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution prior to the hearing. The student must ensure that he/she is alone, and do not record or take any screenshots or audio/video of the hearing session.

2.9. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution reserves the right to continue the proceedings of an unclosed case after any semester break or university closure. Incidents will be kept open until the student is heard.

2.10. Evidence and Burden of Proof

In determining whether or not a violation of the Student Code of Conduct has occurred, accountability must be proven by a preponderance of the evidence. Preponderance of evidence in administrative hearings is, "is it more likely or not" that someone has violated a policy. This means that if there is sufficient cause to believe that a violation has occurred, the parties will be notified of the charges and evidence will be collected. Evidence can be any observation, admission, statement, or document which would either directly or circumstantially indicate that a violation has occurred.

Special Cases:

All AUS registered students are subject to rules and disciplinary procedures, including students with psychological, mental health or other medical conditions. The following will be treated as special cases as per the following procedures:

1. When there is sufficient cause to believe that a student accused of a violation of the Student Code of Conduct may pose a threat of violence directed against self, others or University property as a result of psychological, mental health or other medical conditions, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or designee may provide a referral to the University Counseling Services, the University Health Services, Student of Concern Committee or a qualified professional outside of the University for a comprehensive evaluation. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience may recommend to the Chancellor a suspension until a comprehensive evaluation verifies that the student does not pose a threat to self, others or University property.
2. If circumstances warrant a comprehensive evaluation by a qualified professional outside of the University, students will be responsible for all costs associated with the evaluation. The University reserves the right to verify that the evaluation has been completed.

Emergency Action:

If a student causes harm to self or poses an immediate threat to others, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or designee will contact Office of Protocol and Security for intervention and provide a referral to University Counseling Services, the University Health Services, or a qualified professional outside of the University for a comprehensive evaluation. If circumstances warrant a suspension or expulsion, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience will make a recommendation to the Chancellor.

In the instance of severely and willfully disruptive behavior, or when the ordinary rights of any member of the University community are threatened by the continued presence or activity of any student or students in the residential halls or elsewhere on campus, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience may suspend such student(s) from participating in residential life or other campus activities, or suspend an organization or club temporarily pending the outcomes of a hearing.

Confidentiality:

Incident discussions and conduct proceedings are treated confidentially for both the complainant and respondent. Only members of the AUS community with legitimate need-to-know will be consulted or informed of confidential information regarding a student. The University will weigh the request for confidentiality with the safety of the community in cases where there is evidence that the offender will cause harm.

If requested, efforts will be made to protect the complainants' and witnesses' identities, as a preventive measure for the safety of all parties involved. Parties will sign a No Contact Contract with Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution.

The right to confidentiality will be considered waived if an accused student discloses confidential information regarding the proceedings or decisions to a third party.

Parental Notification:

The Office of Student Affairs may notify parents or guardians of students' misconduct when:

1. A student violates the University's alcohol or drug policies or is involved in an act of serious misbehavior determined by the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience to be egregious to indicate that the student's health or safety may be at risk, or that the student may have placed others at risk.
2. A student's violations of the Code results in his/her removal from the residential halls or suspension or dismissal from the University.
3. A student is found responsible for a second violation of the Code.
4. A violation of the Code results in knowledge of a psychological, mental health or other medical condition that could result in the threat of violence directed against self, others or University property.

Non-Compliance with Policy:

Sanctions:

Standard sanctions such as conduct probation, social probation, fines or assessments for damages to University property may be appropriate for lesser offenses. Repeat offenders may receive harsher sanctions. For more serious matters, such as behavior that disrupts the orderly operation or compromises the safety or orderly operations of the residential halls or the University, suspension or dismissal from the residential hall or the University may be recommended. For student groups or organizations, probation, denial of use of University facilities, fines or withdrawal of official recognition or suspending the organization/group for up to two semesters may be recommended. The CCHB will recommend sanctions consistent with the severity of the offense. The CCHB may recommend sanctions reflecting the nature of particular offenses.

One or more of the following sanctions may be imposed for a violation of the Code. The CCHB is not limited to the list of sanctions provided below and may recommend new sanctions. However, all sanctions require review by and approval from the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and the Chancellor (refer to Student Conduct Process 1.2), and may be modified, deferred or suspended. A warning notice (oral or written) that continuation or repetition of prohibited conduct may be cause for additional conduct action will be conveyed to the student and may include any of the following sanctions:

Educational Sanctions: One or more educational sanctions may be considered, depending on the infraction, to promote student learning and understanding of the impact of their behavior on the community:

- Letter of apology addressed to the concerned student/faculty/staff routed through the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department.
- Presentation of an educational workshop on a topic related to the policy violated.

- Research paper or project. Student will be provided an outline to work on a research paper or a project that will impact learning and be shared with the University community.
- Reflection Paper. The topic and outline will be provided by SCCR.
- Community Services. The student will complete specified hours of voluntary service.

Administrative Sanctions: One or more conduct sanctions may be considered depending on the policy infraction and harm caused to the community.

- **Conduct Probation:** Sanction issued to a student containing specific terms and conditions. The Conduct Probation period may be extended if the student violates the Code again during the conduct probation term. Conduct probation may result in the loss of Financial Grant/Scholarships and other university privileges.
- **Fines:** A predetermined monetary fine for violation of policy.
- **Restitution:** Repayment of the direct cost for damages or services resulting from a violation of this Code.
- **Loss of privilege:** For example, denial of visiting privileges in University housing or denial of access to computer services or to the Sports Complex.
- **Housing Hold:** Residential Hall suspension will lead to a housing hold for a specified period.
- **Conduct Hold:** Temporary suspension, or University suspension will lead to a conduct hold.
- **Residential hall suspension** (up to two semesters) or dismissal (permanent) from the residential halls.
- **Suspension** (up to one academic year) from the University (permanently recorded on the student's academic transcript).
- **Dismissal from the University:** Permanent termination of student status and exclusion from University premises, privileges and activities, which will be permanently recorded on the student's academic transcript. In instances of dismissal from the University, when the student appeals the Appellate Board will review the case and make a recommendation to the Chancellor.

Sanctions for Student Organizations/Clubs/Sports Teams/Associations:

- **Loss of Status:** Individual student/s will have to step down from their existing position in that organization, or the group of students running the registered organization will be asked to discontinue and the organization disqualified and dissolved.
- **Social Probation:** The registered organization will not be allowed to conduct any student activity or event or host an event for a specified period.

Behavioral Penalties

Depending on the severity and frequency of violation, disciplinary actions may vary. AUS reserves the right to recommend additional sanctions beyond those explicitly stated in the code and the *Student Handbook*.

Possible Disciplinary Actions	Possible Sanction Time frame
Letter of apology, presentation of educational workshop, research paper or project, reflection paper	Immediate or during a semester
Community service	10 to 40 hours must be completed during the semester
Verbal or written warning	issued immediately

Possible Disciplinary Actions	Possible Sanction Time frame
Conduct probation	1 academic year from the date of the letter
Fines	issued immediately
Restitution	Must be cleared during the semester
Loss of privilege, housing hold, conduct hold, residential halls suspension	Up to 1 academic year
Suspension	Up to 1 academic year
Dismissal	Applied from the date of the letter

3. Appeal Process:

Conduct actions may be appealed in keeping with the following provisions:

3.1 Respondents may appeal any conduct determination arrived at through a hearing and resulted in a sanction of disciplinary probation, removal from University housing, suspension or dismissal.

- i. An appeal must be emailed to the University Appellate Committee at UACSC@aus.edu within seven working days after date of notice. In instances of dismissal from the University, Senior Manager–Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will forward the case to the Appellate Board and notify the student.
- ii. Appeals will be reviewed by an Appellate Board of the CCHB and will consist of five members who did not serve on the original hearing panel.
- iii. The Appellate Board will determine the appeal’s viability based on whether there is new information that significantly alters the face of facts stated earlier, evidence of improper procedure, findings that are against the weight of evidence or excessive sanctions.
- iv. The Appellate Board may deny the request for appeal and affirm the original findings of the CCHB or grant the request for an appeal and forward the decision made to the Chancellor. The Chancellor will issue the decision letter.
- v. The following standards will apply when appeals are considered by the Appellate Committee:
 - a) Sanctions may be increased or decreased if found to be substantially disproportionate to the offense.
 - b) Cases may be remanded for rehearing by the CCHB if specified procedural errors or errors in interpretation of university regulations were so substantial as to deny the respondent (*or complainant*) a fair hearing, or if new and significant evidence becomes available that could not have been discovered before or during the original hearing.
 - c) Cases may be dismissed if the finding is deemed to be unsupported by the evidence.

3.2 A student withdrawn or suspended temporarily due to misconduct or a psychological, mental health or other medical condition may appeal to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience for reinstatement in the residential halls. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience will ensure that there is no indication of continuation of the misconduct that resulted in withdrawal or temporary suspension. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience will form an advisory group to assess the appeal, review supporting documents (e.g., medical reports), and make a recommendation to the Chancellor. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or designee will inform the student of the final decision in writing.

5. Scope/applicability:

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This Code applies to:

- a) All conduct from the time of enrollment in an AUS undergraduate or graduate program or course and until the student completes the course, graduates from the program, or formally withdraws from the University. The University reserves the right to impose sanctions in cases in which a student has withdrawn from courses, withdrawn from the University, or been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case. If a sanction has been imposed on a student who has withdrawn from the University or has been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case, the files will be retained as a conduct record for at least five years from the date the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department issues a letter stating the sanctions.
- b) All conduct that occurs on the University premises.
- c) Off-campus conduct at a University-sanctioned event or when representing the University, including, but not limited to, tours, field trips, sports tournaments and events of student organizations, clubs and teams that are under the direct or indirect supervision of the University.
- d) Off-campus conduct that adversely affects the rights of other University community members, the University's reputation, or affects the health and safety of others.
- e) Any student who engages directly, indirectly or as an accomplice in violating the Code. A student who has been found to have violated the Code directly, indirectly or as an accomplice may be subject to conduct action.
- f) Any International Exchange Program incoming student.
- g) Any student who has been referred to the Sharjah Police or UAE federal authorities. A student who has been referred to the authorities will be subject to the adjudication process and, if found to be in violation, will be subject to conduct action under the Code. The Code does not preclude the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience (or designee) from referring an incident to the Office of Protocol and Security or the appropriate law enforcement agency prior to or during the adjudication process or after conduct action is taken by the University.

6. Responsibilities:

- Non-academic student conduct administration, conduct procedural compliance and approval of sanctions under the Code are under the remit of the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience (EDSE). The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience reviews modifications, endorses the Code and forwards it to the Chancellor for review and approval. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience ensures that the Code is publicized during the orientation sessions, through the Office of Student Affairs publications and the AUS website.
- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution implements the Code with the help of Campus Security, University City officials and the campus community.
- Members of the campus community should report breaches of the Code to the Office of Student Affairs/Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution.
- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will conduct a preliminary inquiry with the complainant and respondent, determine the policy violated, and take the necessary measures to prevent student(s) from further involvement as well as educate students on the conduct process that will be implemented to enforce this policy.
- The Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB) is responsible for deliberating and recommending sanctions on major infractions of the Code.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Adjudication: The process by which the University conducts meetings, hearings or other actions, bringing matters to resolution.

Administrative Sanctions: Sanctions imposed for serious violation of the code.

Appellate Committee: A committee appointed by the Chancellor and Vice Chancellor for Student Experience to review Student Appeal and make a final decision.

Behavioral Contract: A written agreement between the student and the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department. This is a restraining order with specified terms and conditions.

Complainant: Complainant is any individual, including any member of the University community, who has the reason to believe that a student has committed an offense and files a complaint to initiate a procedure under the code.

Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB): The American University of Sharjah's responsible authorities who ensure just, speedy and constructive resolution of problems arising from infractions of the Code. The CCHB comprises four (4) students, four (4) faculty members, two (2) University administrators, and a member from the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department.

Conduct Probation: Sanction issued to a student containing specific terms and conditions. The Conduct Probation period may be extended if the student violates the Code again during the conduct probation term.

Dismissal: Permanent separation from American University of Sharjah.

Educational Sanctions: Sanctions that allow students to reflect upon their own conduct, promote policy learning, and develop skills so they can make better choices in the future.

Fine: Payment in cash or kind for a breach of the code or causing damage to university assets.

Guest: Any person who is not a University staff member, student or faculty member.

Hold: Conduct or Residential Housing Hold on the Student Record for serious breach of the Code or suspension from residential halls after the sanction letter is issued.

Major Misconduct: A serious breach of the Student Code of Conduct that is also threatening, aggressive, harassing, violent or harmful to property or individuals. Repeated minor acts of misconduct may be treated as major misconduct.

May: May is used in the permissible sense.

Mediation: An alternative form of resolving conflicts with the assistance of a mediator to help the disputants reach an agreement.

Member of the University Community: A person who is a registered student, faculty member, staff member, administrator or any other person employed by the University.

Minor Misconduct: An act not deemed to be a serious breach of the Student Code of Conduct by a Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Official.

No Contact: A contract between the student and the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) Department or between two parties to conform to the conditions stipulated therein.

Organization: Any student club or student organization or sports team that is formally recognized by the University.

Policy: Any written regulation of the University as found in, but not limited to, the Code, regulations governing resident student conduct, the University website, IT policy and the graduate/undergraduate catalogs.

Preliminary inquiry: An inquiry conducted by the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Official that is intended to provide the student an opportunity to present evidence that explains the incident or disputes the allegation(s).

Prohibition: A sanction that prohibits a student from participating in extracurricular activities or from accessing University-offered privileges or facilities.

Reprimand: A notice before the warning letter.

Respondent: Any student accused of violating this Student Code.

Restitution: A sanction requiring a student to make compensation for damages.

Shall: Shall is used in the obligatory sense.

Student: All students enrolled and taking courses at the University, both full and part time, and international exchange students and Achievement Academy Bridge Program students. This policy applies to alumni while on AUS premises and using University facilities.

Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department: The University department responsible for responding to non-academic misconduct incidents reported, resolving conflicts, collecting evidence and supporting documents, and maintaining student conduct records.

Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Official: A University official authorized by the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience to further conduct inquiries, resolve allegations of misconduct, hear and/or present evidence, and sanction students found in violation of the Code.

Suspension: Temporary (for a specified period) exclusion of a student from the University premises or from the residential halls.

Undertaking: A formal acceptance to conform to the Code.

University: American University of Sharjah.

Verbal Warning: A warning issued verbally for disruption of University activities, including instructional activities.

Warning: An action stipulating that inappropriate behavior, if repeated, may lead to a more severe sanction.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Refer to the *Student Handbook*, available at www.aus.edu/student-handbook, and the Student Academic Integrity Code in the academic catalogs at: www.aus.edu/aus-catalogs.

Policy Dissemination:

- The campus community can access the Code in the *Student Handbook* on the AUS website (www.aus.edu/student-handbook).
- The Office of Student Affairs informs new undergraduate and graduate students about the Code during New Student Orientation each semester.
- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution organizes presentations on the Code for residential and non-residential students, the Student Council Board, International Exchange Students, Student Organizations, Resident Assistants, and Sports Teams.

- AUS Policies and Procedures website: www.aus.edu/policies.

9. Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of Changes	Requested By
1.0	1998	New Policy	-
2.0	March and April 2016	Appellate Committee to review Student Appeals	AU Washington Team recommendations Implementation
3.0	March 19, 2017	AACRAO issued a recommendation that transcript notations cite the reason for suspension or dismissal (e.g. academic or disciplinary), the department responsible for issuing the student separation from the institution, and the effective dates for the separation (as applicable). Furthermore, AACRAO recommends that a “Pending Conduct” statement be placed on transcripts while a process is underway and a hold be used to block the release of an official transcript until which time a final decision is made.	American Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admission Officer (AACRAO) recommendations in order to ensure that we adhere to best practice.
4.0	August 2023	The Executive Director of Student Experience reports to Chancellor from November 2021. The code was updated with a section on preponderance of evidence. A policy is added on responsible use of institutional resources and facilities.	Executive Director of Student Experience
5.0	June 2024	Rights and Responsibilities were revised in April 2024. Behavioral Penalties grid was added for students to be informed of the disciplinary outcomes. April 4, 2024 - As a significant advancement in our commitment to fostering a safe and respectful campus environment, the Chancellor, in collaboration with Departmental Heads, has approved a comprehensive Sexual Misconduct Policy. This newly approved policy supersedes all previous references to sexual harassment, including section 2.13 in the Student Code of Conduct. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience title in the leadership position was announced on 11 June 2024. The code is amended accordingly.	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Chancellor	06-5152217	chancellor@aus.edu
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	06-5152162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Senior Manager-Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	06-5152250	jcoutinho@aus.edu

n. Student Attendance Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600UI14	Policy Title:	Student Attendance Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	August 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Attendance Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines requirements for student attendance at AUS.

3. Introduction / background: Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Attendance, Withdrawal and Interruption of Studies Attendance and Lateness

Attendance and participation in all class, studio, recitation, workshop and laboratory sessions are essential to the process of education at AUS. Students benefit from the lectures and discussions with their instructors and fellow students. For this reason, students are expected to attend class regularly. Lateness or absence hinders progress for the individual and the class and affects the student's grade. University guidelines for lateness and attendance are as follows:

- Three occasions of lateness count as one absence. Lateness is defined by the individual instructor.
- In the event a student misses 15 percent of the total number of scheduled sessions in a class for any reason, the instructor may initiate withdrawal of the student from the course if a written warning or formal notification was issued when the number of absences reached 10 percent. Students are expected to manage course attendance to ensure that absences due to personal reasons or participation in extracurricular events do not exceed the 15 percent limit. Students who are absent as a result of participation in a university-sanctioned extracurricular event approved by the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost must notify the instructors at least two weeks in advance of the event- related absence and, if the requirements of the course allow, instructors are expected to make reasonable accommodations that may include make-up exams or the submission of assignments prior to an absence.
- Stricter attendance requirements may be approved by the relevant dean (or appointed designee) for courses that depend upon student contributions to complete collaborative team-based projects or to prepare for public performances.
- Instructors must specify attendance requirements in the course syllabus.
- If the syllabus states that missing 15 percent of class sessions will result in withdrawal, then attendance records must be maintained.
- If withdrawal occurs prior to the end of the 13th week of classes (end of the fourth week of classes for a six week summer term), a grade of W is assigned to the student for the specific course.

- Blended and online courses are no different from face to face courses and students are expected to attend classes regularly. Student attendance in online classes is defined as active participation in the course as described in the individual course syllabus. Online courses will have mechanisms for regular student participation, which can be documented by any or all of the following methods: student tracking records in the Learning Management System (LMS); submission/completion of assignments;
- The specific application of the attendance guidelines is at the instructor's discretion. Students are fully responsible for dropping or withdrawing from courses that they are not attending. Students who register for a course and do not attend may be administratively withdrawn, which will render them ineligible for a tuition refund or adjustment and result in the application of a no-show penalty fee.

Course Withdrawal

Students may withdraw from courses without grade penalty by submitting the Withdrawal Form (available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) to the Office of the Registrar. The student must submit the form in person.

Withdrawal from courses must occur no later than the end of the 13th week of classes (end of the fourth week of classes for a six-week summer term). A grade of W will be recorded on the transcript for the course from which the student has withdrawn. A W grade does not impact the student's GPA. The semester/term tuition is not recalculated following course withdrawal.

If a student with a documented medical condition (operation, hospital stay, serious illness, etc.) is withdrawn from a course after the established withdrawal deadline, the student may submit a Student Petition Form (available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) to the Office of the Registrar with the appropriate original medical documents.

The Office of the Registrar will verify the claims and approve the withdrawal with a grade of W recorded for the course.

Students are expected to maintain a minimum load of 12 credit hours per semester. Students on AUS financial grants/scholarships must maintain the minimum registration load specified by their grant/scholarship. For more information, refer to the Tuition, Grants and Scholarships/Grants and Scholarships section.

Students are fully responsible for dropping or withdrawing from courses that they are not attending. Students who register for a course and do not attend may be administratively withdrawn, which will render them ineligible for a tuition refund or adjustment and result in the application of a no-show penalty fee.

Instructors may withdraw a student from a course for excessive absence. For details, refer to the section on Attendance and Lateness.

A student may not withdraw from a course in which an academic integrity offense was committed until the case has been reviewed and the adjudication process is complete.

Withdrawal from the University

Students seeking to withdraw from the university must submit the Complete Withdrawal Form (available at www.aus.edu/regISTRATION/forms) to the Office of the Registrar. The student must submit the form in person.

If complete withdrawal occurs during the add and drop period, the courses are dropped and are not recorded in the student's transcript. If withdrawal occurs prior to the end of the 10th week of classes (end of the fourth week of classes for a six-week summer term), a grade of W is assigned to the student for the specific course. In addition, the refund schedule outlined in the table below will apply.

Withdrawal from the University*
Before the end of the first week of classes
100% refund excluding non-refundable deposits
During the second week of classes
50% refund of tuition, excluding the amount covered by AUS grants/scholarships
During the third week of classes
25% refund of tuition, excluding the amount covered by AUS grants/scholarships
After the third week of classes
0% refund

Students are fully responsible for dropping or withdrawing from courses that they are not attending prior to discontinuing their studies at the university. Students who do not drop or withdraw from courses may be administratively withdrawn, which will render them ineligible for a tuition refund or adjustment and result in the application of a no-show penalty fee.

Students in this category who seek to resume studies at the university following interruption of studies must pay all the upcoming semester/term tuition and fees, including charges that resulted from administrative withdrawal from courses.

For retrieval of official documents following complete withdrawal from the university, refer to Students Records earlier in this section of the catalog.

Interrupted Studies and Reactivation of Student Record

For the purpose of this policy, AUS students studying abroad for a regular semester at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement are considered to be in residence.

A summer term abroad at an institution with which AUS has a study abroad agreement is not considered as a term in residence.

Students Away for One Semester

- A student in good academic standing is allowed no more than one semester of leave. For the purpose of this policy, a semester of complete course withdrawal is considered as a semester of leave. To resume studies following a one-semester leave, the student must submit a Reactivation Request Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) to the Office of the Registrar, one month prior to registration. Returning students who received a financial grant and/or merit scholarship at the time of discontinuing their studies at AUS should consult the Grants and Scholarships section under Tuition, Grants and Scholarships later in this catalog.
- Students who are on probation and interrupt their studies by withdrawing from all courses during the semester are not eligible to resume studies at AUS.
- Students who are on probation and take a leave for one semester must petition to resume their studies by submitting the Reactivation Request Form (available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms) to the Office of the Registrar, one month prior to registration. Only with the approval of the student's associate dean and the Director of the Academic Support Center will a student be allowed to resume studies in his/her original major.

Students Away Longer than One Semester

- Students in good standing who leave AUS for two or more consecutive semesters, inclusive of a semester of complete course withdrawal, must submit a new application for admission to the Office of Enrollment Management/ Undergraduate Admissions. For details, refer to Returning Students under the Admission to Undergraduate Studies section earlier in this catalog.
- Students who are on probation and interrupt their studies for a period longer than one semester may not apply for readmission. For policies governing academic dismissal, please see the Academic Standing section under Grades and Academic Standing hereafter.

Transfer of Credit Hours

Courses taken at another institution while on leave from AUS will not be transferred.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate students

6. Responsibilities:

Individual course instructors are responsible for maintaining attendance records and implementing course withdrawal procedure. The Office of the Registrar is responsible for monitoring withdrawal from the university and timelines with respect to interruption of studies.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Learning Management System (LMS)

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Undergraduate Admissions Prospectus: www.aus.edu/admissions/forms-and-publications

Undergraduate catalog: www.aus.edu/catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	August 2021	General update.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised – online connection added	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB. The course withdrawal statement has been updated to align with the latest version of the catalog.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate	Tel: +971 (0)6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

Affairs and Instruction		
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o. Gender Segregation Policy

N.A.

p. Student Activities Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE15	Policy Title:	Student Activities Policy
Prepared By:	Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Issue Date:	March 26, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs /Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 13, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 13, 2026

1. Policy:

Opportunity for extracurricular activities for students

2. Purpose:

The Office of Student Affairs (OSA) provides, maintains and facilitates students with a safe and healthy environment, equipment, sports facilities, support systems and services, funding, scholarships as well as provides training and guidelines for activities participation for individual; group; sports teams; fitness, competitive and recreational sporting events; leadership enrichment activities; voluntary work; interest oriented events; service, skills and development activities; new students AUS integration activities; student clubs/organizations formation and initiated activities processing and execution; community awareness activities; cultural and creativity enrichment activities; conflict management activities; community living and learning activities; entertainment activities; multicultural learning organized events; seminars; conferences; workshops and other unspecified but invariably falling under non-academic extracurricular activities.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

All registered AUS students can engage in non-academic extracurricular activities that impacts their all-round personal development as well as allows them to participate, contribute and experience student life at AUS.

Procedure for Activity Engagement (Non-Academic Only)

Students who are part of student organizations and sports teams should log into Engage for regular updates and guidelines on activity participation and consult with appropriate OSA staff for clarification and assistance when needed. Advising, mentoring and supervision for student activities by OSA staff is aimed at achieving student personal and group activity success.

All student activities under the OSA can be found on the Engage platform. The Engage application empowers students to discover opportunities and take charge of their own extracurricular activities while enabling administrators to efficiently manage their office workflow.

The AUS Engage site can be accessed by logging in to engage.aus.edu.

Students taking part in activities and program on and off campus are expected to practice the highest behavioral standards set forth in the AUS Student Code of Conduct as well as abide by the UAE local and federal laws.

OSA activities are aligned with student learning outcomes therefore, any student requesting to organize, participate or contribute to an activity should follow the set guidelines and processes set through the activity-originating department. For example, for athletic participation, the student must approach the sports officials at Student Athletics and Recreation Department (SARD). On the other

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hand, for club and organizations, leadership enrichment and community service activities, the student must approach student activities officials at Student Engagement and Leadership Department (SELD). Group of students wishing to organize an activity through their student organization, or in collaboration with other organizations should comply with the guidelines set forth in the Student Clubs and Organizations Manual.

Students participating in off campus activities will sign the waiver of liability and will responsibly cooperate in completing the documentation formalities and comply with the supervisors instructions.

Students participating in extracurricular activities must cooperate in the assessment mechanisms conducted by OSA.

Activities conducted by trained members of student associations such as Student Mediation Association, Student Peer Leaders Association, Student Residential Life Association and others will communicate with the concerned departmental head for procedural compliance.

In the event of cancellation, delay or rejection of an activity, the Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience/designated OSA official will inform the concerned student/s, club, organization or team.

OSA will contact emergency services such as Campus Security, UHS, AUS units or other governmental emergency services when an emergency is determined to aid the student/group/activity venue.

Issues arising during any activity planning, processing or execution must be raised with the concerned OSA department head for resolution. Behavioral issues of individual and student groups arising during the activity must be addressed to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR).

The Active Vice Chancellor will oversee and ensure procedural compliance, processing and authorization of non-academic student activities.

5. Scope/applicability:

- This policy applies to all registered AUS students.
- Non-academic extracurricular activities participation is voluntary.
- Non-academic extracurricular activities participation includes on or off campus including but not limited to local, regional and international representation.

6. Responsibilities:

- SELD is responsible for engaging and facilitating students in student clubs and organizations, leadership programs and community service in extracurricular activities.
- SARD is responsible for coordinating with students regarding their sports activities.
- The Student Residential Life Department (SRLD) is responsible for coordinating with students regarding their activities in the residential halls.
- The Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience will oversee and ensure procedural compliance, processing and authorization of non-academic student activities.
- In the event of cancellation, delay or rejection of an activity, the Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or designated OSA official will inform the concerned student/s, club, organization or team.
- The role of Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials is resolving misconduct issues reported by an individual or student groups or OSA staff engaged in out of class/extracurricular activity.

7. Student Affairs will contact Emergency Services such as Campus Security, UHS, AUS units or other Governmental Emergency Services when an emergency is determined to aid the student/group/activity venue.

8. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AUS – American University of Sharjah
- OSA – Office of Student Affairs
- SELD – Student Engagement and Leadership Development
- SCCR – Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution
- SRLD – Student Residential Life Department
- UHS – University Health Services
- Non-Academic Activities – Extracurricular / Out of Class Activities organized by Office of Student Affairs
- Student Mediation Association – Association of students trained in Peer Mediation through Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution
- Peer Leaders/Team Leaders - Students trained as part of the Peer Leaders Program by Student Engagement and Leadership Department

9. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Refer to the Student Handbook, available at www.aus.edu/student-handbook
- Refer to the Student Clubs and Organizations Manual, available at <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/student-life/clubs-and-organizations/student-clubs-and-organizations-manual>

10. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	March 26, 2014	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 8, 2022	Edited Policy – updated position title and web links	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 12, 2024	Edited Policy – updated position title and some sections to include the Engage online platform	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu

q. Student Council Policy- Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE16	Policy Title:	Student Council Policy
Prepared By:	Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Issue Date:	June 16, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs /Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 13, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 13, 2026

1. Policy:

Policy governing the roles, responsibilities and selection of the Student Council (SC)

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to make known to all undergraduate students the procedures, guidelines, rules and regulations governing the selection, roles and responsibilities of the SC as outlined in the SC Constitution and Bylaws. The link to download the SC Constitution and Bylaws can be found in section 8 of this document.

3. Introduction / background:

The University is committed to enhancing student life and to promoting the welfare of students by working closely with the SC who shall convey student issues and concerns. The SC is the student-elected body mandated to articulate student views and interests and be the voice of students.

4. Policy Statement:

The SC is the official representative of the undergraduate student body to the University administration. It is mandated to articulate student views and interests and be the voice of students. The SC is selected through annual campus wide elections and consists of fifteen elected members and two appointed sub-committee members. The SC works directly with the Office of Student Affairs (OSA) who provide guidance, mentorship and administrative support for all their endeavors. The mission of the SC is to collaboratively work with university administrators to promote student welfare and enhance student life. Procedures, guidelines, rules and regulations as to the formation, roles and responsibilities of the SC are outlined in the SC Constitution and Bylaws.

5. Scope/applicability:

OSA encourages undergraduate students to take an active leadership role in extracurricular activities at the University. Eligible students should consider running for a post in the SC to serve and represent their peers and uphold the SC's mission of promoting student welfare and enhancing student life at the University.

6. Responsibilities:

- Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience – shall provide guidance and mentorship and extend support to the SC in addressing student concerns to the various AUS units.
- Student Engagement and Leadership Department – shall provide guidance, mentorship and administrative support for all SC initiatives, events, activities and funding requirements.
- SC Members – shall act and perform their duties and responsibilities in accordance with the SC Constitution and Bylaws.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- University – American University of Sharjah
- SC – Student Council
- OSA – Office of Student Affairs

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Refer to the Student Council Constitution and Bylaws available at <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/student-life/student-council>

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 16, 2021	New Policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
2.0	October 4, 2023	Edited Policy – updated position titles	Executive Director of Student Experience
3.0	June 13, 2024	Edited Policy – updated position titles and web link	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu

r. Student Publication and Media or Non-Academic Student Publications Policy-Version 4

Policy Number:	0600SE17	Policy Title:	Student Publication and Media or Non-Academic Student Publications Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Student Affairs	Issue Date:	2017
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs /Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 22, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 22, 2026

1. Policy:

This policy covers Student Publications, which are not part of an academic program.

2. Purpose:

Clubs and organizations may publish social media content, newsletters, magazines or other written promotional materials, provided that they are in accordance with the club's/organization's mission and goals and that they are in line with the policies and procedures of the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM). All promotional items need to be reviewed and approved by the Student Engagement and Leadership Department (SELD) before being published or disseminated.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

Student publications allow students to publish their literary work, articles, columns, poetry, stories, interviews, cartoons, jokes, opinions, comments, club advertisements, and other forms of written or artwork that is original, reflects university values, is respectful to the AUS and UAE culture and is in compliance with the university's social media guidelines.

Procedures for Publishing Student Work

Students wishing to publish their work must comply with the guidelines set forth by the Office of Student Affairs and SELD.

Students must:

- Fulfill procedural obligations set forth in the Student Clubs and Organization Manual.
- Submit contents in the specified format within the deadline.

SELD editorial team reserves the right to edit or reject articles before publishing to keep up with the quality of university specified publications as well as articles that are determined to be of poor quality, offensive, may hurt the community values, are provocative, are written with a malicious intent or may harm the reputation of the institution.

When necessary, SELD will confer with SCM for their final approval of content and design before printing.

All student work submitted and published remains the property of the university and becomes part of the SELD archive.

SELD does not interfere in the editorial content of any club's/organization's media or publication, unless there is a perceived violation of the rules of AUS, the laws of Sharjah and the UAE, and a hateful intent towards an individual, group or institution.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all student members of registered student clubs, organizations and associations.

6. Responsibilities:

- SELD is responsible for reviewing and approving materials before they are published or disseminated.
- The Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience oversees student publications and authorizes funding in compliance with the university procedures.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AUS – American University of Sharjah
- SELD – Student Engagement and Leadership Development
- SCM – Strategic Communications and Media Department
- UAE – United Arab Emirates

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Refer to the Social Media Guidelines section of the Student Clubs and Organizations Manual, available at <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/student-life/clubs-and-organizations/student-clubs-and-organizations-manual>
- Refer to the Policy on Harassment in the use of information and communication technologies of the Student Handbook, available at <https://www.aus.edu/life-at-aus/student-life/student-affairs/student-handbook>
- Refer to the Digital Content Guidelines, available at <http://bit.ly/AUSDigitalContentGuidelines>

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	2017	New Policy	
2.0	June 30, 2021	Substantial amendment. Edited sections 1 to 6 and 8.	Executive Director of Student Experience
3.0	May 13, 2024	Edited Policy – added the Policy on Harassment and its corresponding link.	Director of Student Engagement and Leadership
4.0	June 22, 2024	Edited Policy – updated position title.	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu

s. Students Rights and Responsibilities Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE18	Policy Title:	Student Rights and Responsibilities
Prepared By:	Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR)	Issue Date:	1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/ Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	Effective Date:	June 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 12, 2026

1. Policy:

This policy section is a part of the comprehensive Student Code of Conduct 2024-2025

2. Purpose:

The purpose of the student code of conduct (“code”) is to define standards of behavior expected from aus students, and the procedures and sanctions that will apply in case the student behavior is inconsistent with the essential values of the university.

3. Introduction/background: Not Applicable

4. Policy Statement:

Student Rights and Responsibilities

Each enrolled student have the following rights:

- To utilize campus facilities reasonably and as deemed appropriate by the University.
- To be treated with dignity and respect at all times.
- To report a suspected violation of the code of conduct policy
- To be heard without bias.
- To have the right to personal safety and security at all times while on campus.
- To receive a clear notice of charges and cause for disciplinary sanction, and the right to impartial hearing.
- To have the opportunity to appeal for a review of imposed sanctions.
- To privacy and confidentiality adhering to the university protocol and policies
- To receive support and guidance based on needs and circumstances.

Each student is accountable for the following responsibilities:

- To treat students, staff and faculty with dignity and respect.
- To uphold AUS values both on campus and in public while representing the university.
- To refrain from using verbal, written or electronic methods to harass, threaten or intimidate another student.
- To avoid participating in any actions that jeopardize the health or safety of individuals at the university.
- To refrain from engaging in inappropriate physical contact between male and female students.
- To actively acknowledge and adhere to the Code, University Policies and the laws of Sharjah and UAE.

In cases of violations of the Code, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience, the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Department, and the Conduct Council Hearing Board shall not consider ignorance of a policy, rule or regulation an acceptable defense.

Procedure /Guidelines

Complaints related to breach of the code involving student(s) must be reported to the vice chancellor for student experience and/or student conduct and conflict resolution in writing or emailed to sccr@aus.edu, or through an incident report filed through the student infraction management system at <https://sims.aus.edu>.

1. STUDENT CONDUCT PROCESS

2.1 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will acknowledge the complaint, meet with the student(s) involved [the complainant(s) and the respondent(s)], discuss the charges, determine whether the violation has occurred, inform those responsible of the charges and issue the sanctions at a primary level. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials will issue undertakings, reprimands and warnings (verbal, first, second and final). In cases of infractions that warrant sanctions, the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will recommend sanctions to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience for consultation and approval. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will be responsible for questioning, listening to the complainant and respondent, writing reports, collecting supporting evidence, and reporting to the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and the CCHB (when it is determined that a major misconduct warrants review by the CCHB). SCCR will be responsible for organizing hearings; implementing sanctions; documenting and storing case-related material; following up with students, witnesses and connected individuals; providing referrals to concerned University units; and archiving student files.

1.2 When a student is found responsible, the Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience is authorized to impose warnings with the following sanctions: conduct probation, community services, suspension for one or more semesters or dismissal from the residential halls, denial of use of University privileges, and levying fines. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience can also recommend the following sanctions to the Chancellor: suspension for a stipulated period, or one- or two-semester suspension or dismissal from the University.

1.2 Students who have violated the Policy on Classroom Conduct must be referred to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution. Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will conduct an inquiry and take necessary action while the student continues his/her classes after signing the behavioral contract or no contact prohibiting him/her from continuing misconduct. If student behavior is found egregious and represents a threat to self or others, the concerned community member should provide Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution referral for crisis intervention and emergency action or Student of Concern Committee.

2. PROCEEDINGS

2.1 Any member of the University community may bring a complaint against a student or a student organization. A complaint or incident report must be filed with Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution within 10 working days of the occurrence or the discovery of the alleged infraction(s). The complaint or incident report should be a concise and complete statement of the allegations. SCCR will receive a complaint if extenuating circumstances are affected and prevent the complainant from reporting for a significant period of time from the date of the incident. The complaint or incident report should be a concise and complete statement of the allegations. A complainant may report anonymously. Delayed incident reporting may cause difficulties in ascertaining facts and limit the outcome of investigations.

- 2.2 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will conduct inquiries with the complainant and respondent to determine whether a violation has taken place. If there is sufficient cause to believe that violation has occurred, the parties will be notified of the charges and evidence will be collected. Upon determination of policy violations, charges will be conveyed to the responsible student and sanctions will be discussed with the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience for implementation. If an incident warrants a hearing, the Senior Manager for Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will consult with the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience and organize a hearing with the University's Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB).
- 2.3 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Officials will contact the CCHB members to set a time and place for the hearing. Every effort shall be made to schedule this hearing within one week of the time a complaint is filed. The respondent shall receive a notification of the alleged violation and the time and place of the hearing.
- 2.4 If the respondent chooses not to appear for the hearing, the SCCR Official or CCHB will consider the evidence supporting the allegations and a decision will be made in the absence of the respondent.
- 2.5 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials will notify the respondent in writing of the specific allegations filed, the hearing outcome and the sanctions.
- 2.6 Parents, family members, advisors or legal counsel are not permitted at any point during the conduct inquiry and adjudication process.
- 2.7 The University reserves the right to impose sanctions in cases in which a student has withdrawn from courses, withdrawn from the University, or been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case. The University may impose registration and/or housing holds to prohibit registration during the proceedings. If a sanction has been imposed on a student who has withdrawn from the University or been awarded a degree prior to the resolution of a conduct case, the files will normally be retained as a disciplinary record. Student Disciplinary Record will be retained for five years from the date of the letter and then archived as legacy data in the Student Infraction Management System.
- 2.8 In virtual/remote conduct inquiries with the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution officials, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience or the Conduct Hearing with the Conduct Council Hearing Board, where the student participates from his/her living room or other shared space and there is a potential for a person not participating in the hearing to be privy to confidential conversations whether intentionally or otherwise, the respondent will provide a confidentiality consent to Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution prior to the hearing. The student must ensure that he/she is alone, and do not record or take any screenshots or audio/video of the hearing session.
- 2.9 Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution reserves the right to continue the proceedings of an unclosed case after any semester break or university closure. Incidents will be kept open until the student is heard.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all registered students of American University of Sharjah.

6. Responsibilities:

- Non-academic student conduct administration, conduct procedural compliance and approval of sanctions under the Code are under the remit of the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience reviews modifications, endorses the Code and forwards it to the Chancellor for review and approval. The Vice Chancellor for Student Experience ensures that the Code is publicized during the orientation sessions, through the Office of Student Affairs publications and the AUS website.

- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution implements the Code with the help of Campus Security, University City officials and the campus community.
- Members of the campus community should report breaches of the Code to the Office of Student Affairs/Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution.
- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will conduct a preliminary inquiry with the complainant and respondent, determine the policy violated, and take the necessary measures to prevent student(s) from further involvement as well as educate students on the conduct process that will be implemented to enforce this policy.
- The Conduct Council Hearing Board (CCHB) is responsible for deliberating and recommending sanctions on major infractions of the Code.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: Reference 6 M

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- To report a violation of the Student Code of Conduct, log into https://aus-advocate.symlicity.com/public_report/ to submit an incident form.

Refer to the *Student Handbook*, available at www.aus.edu/student-handbook

9. Policy History:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	1998	New Policy	-
2.0	2016-2017	Student Rights and Responsibilities was revised	Dean of Students
3.0	April 4, 2024	Student Rights and Responsibilities were revised in April 2024 so students are aware of their entitlements and accountabilities	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	06-5152162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Senior Manager-Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	06-5152250	jcourtinho@aus.edu

t. Student Counseling Policy - Version 5

Policy Number:	0600ES19	Policy Title:	Student Counseling Policy
Prepared By:	Counseling Services	Issue Date:	October 2, 2017
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Executive Director of Employee Services	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Student Counseling Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to support the psychological wellbeing of all students, faculty, staff and their dependents.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

University Counseling Services (UCS) is integral to the mission of the American University of Sharjah (AUS). The Center exists to support the university's mission by enhancing and promoting the psychological wellbeing of all students, faculty, staff and their dependents.

UCS is dedicated to providing evidence based best practices in prevention and intervention services and programs in a supportive, safe and welcoming environment for students, faculty, staff and their dependents.

4. Policy Statement:

The UCS is committed to promoting wellbeing and enhancing the quality of each community member's experience at AUS and provides psychological support to students, faculty, staff and their dependents as they pursue their academic and personal goals. The UCS believes that fostering self-understanding and mental health wellness is at the heart of a vibrant, health, creative and engaged campus.

The UCS aims to support the learning environment of the university by promoting positive mental health for the community through counselling, crisis intervention, consulting, assessments and referrals that are responsive to the individual, cultural and demographic diversity of the AUS community. It is UCS policy to provide:

- In-house counselling to students, faculty, staff and their dependents
- An environment of personal safety and respect
- Information regarding professional resources to assist community members in making self-referrals
- Workshops and promotion of mental health awareness through psycho-educational forums
- Collaboration with faculty and staff to promote student wellbeing through outreach, prevention and educational efforts
- Compliance of this policy is mandatory.

5. Scope/applicability:

The policy applies to all clients of the University Counseling Services including students, faculty, staff and dependents.

6. Responsibilities:

UCS Counselors - are responsible for managing the implementation of this policy and for ensuring that its provision are adhered to and applied consistently.

UCS Clients – are responsible for adhering to this policy.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

University Counseling Services Procedure

American Psychological Association's Code of Ethics <https://www.apa.org/ethics/code>

9. Policy history:

This policy will be reviewed every two years from the last review date by the University Counseling Services Counselors.

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	October 02, 2017	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	February 01, 2018	Edited Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
3.0	April 30, 2019	Edited Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
4.0	September 20, 2023	Revised	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
5.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Counselor, University Counseling Services	Tel +971 6 515 2685	ucs@aus.edu
Lubna Al Saraj, Director of University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2667	yousif@aus.edu

u. Health Services Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0600ES20	Policy Title:	Health Services Policy
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	May 6, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy:

Health Services Policy

2. Purpose:

AUS hold in great value the health and well-being of all students, thereby it requires its students to have health insurance coverage in order to minimize physical, mental and financial strain that would result from an illness or related conditions during the Academic year.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

University Counseling Services (UCS) is integral to the mission of the American University of Sharjah (AUS). The Center exists to support the university's mission by enhancing and promoting the psychological wellbeing of all students, faculty, staff and their dependents.

UCS is dedicated to providing evidence based best practices in prevention and intervention services and programs in a supportive, safe and welcoming environment for students, faculty, staff and their dependents.

4. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah Health Insurance Policy requires that registered students subject to this policy are required to participate in and pay fees associated with the student health insurance programs listed below.

- The fully insured student health insurance program offered by AUS.
- AUS University Health Services.
- University Hospital Sharjah insurance coverage.

All students will be automatically enrolled in the AUS University Health Services plan by default. However, they have the option to switch to the full insurance coverage plan during the registration period if they do not have existing insurance coverage. Students who opt out of the AUS University Health Services plan must provide proof of private insurance coverage and sign a waiver. The insurance fees will be published before the start of each academic year.

Abu Dhabi visa holders will have their insurance activated for 60 days starting from the enrollment date until October 31. They will continue to be covered by and billed for the fully insured student health insurance program until they submit proof of coverage under an alternative health insurance plan.

5. Scope/applicability:

All registered full time, matriculated undergraduate and graduate students, including International IXO students.

6. Responsibilities:

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: NA

9. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2018	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration
2.0	May 2018	Handled by HR department	Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration
3.0	July 2023	Edited Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration
4.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template/Policy statement	Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Lubna Al Saraj, Director of University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2667	yousif@aus.edu

v. Academic Advising Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0600UI21	Policy Title:	Academic Advising Policy
Prepared By:	Academic Support Center	Issue Date:	N/A
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Academic Advising Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the purpose and process of academic advising in general as well as specifically in the case of students who have been placed on probation.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Advising at AUS

Academic advising at AUS is an essential element of the educational process. All AUS undergraduate students are assigned an academic/major advisor within their department who helps them in selecting their courses of study and in planning their schedules. The academic/major advisor assists the student in obtaining a well-balanced education and in interpreting university policies and procedures. Students are responsible for selecting their courses, meeting course prerequisites and adhering to the most recent university policies and procedures.

AUS undergraduate students on academic probation are provided additional advising through the Academic Support Center (ASC). ASC advisors work with students experiencing academic difficulty on ways to improve their study skills, develop learning plans to support their academic success, and refer students to appropriate campus and external resources. ASC advisors can also serve as a point of contact between parents of students on probation and the university.

What is Academic Probation?

In order to be considered in good standing, an undergraduate student must maintain a cumulative, or overall, GPA (CGPA) of 2.0. A student must be in good standing to be eligible for graduation.

If the CGPA of an undergraduate student falls below 2.0 in any semester, then he/she is placed on academic probation.

The first semester a student is on academic probation is called Probation 1. A full-time undergraduate student on probation for the first time is allowed to carry a load of five courses with a maximum of 16 credits.

The second consecutive semester a student is on academic probation is called Probation 2. A full-

time undergraduate student on a second consecutive probation is only allowed to enroll in 4 courses with a maximum of 13 credits. Being on Probation 2 should be considered an extremely serious situation and should be viewed as a student's last chance to prove that he/she can succeed at AUS.

An undergraduate student who fails to remove his/her probation (by obtaining a CGPA of at least a 2.0) by the end of the second consecutive semester on probation is academically dismissed and will not be allowed to continue at AUS.

Obligations of a Student on Academic Probation

Students on **Probation 1:**

1. Must attain a cumulative GPA of 2.0 by the end of the current semester.
 - Failure to meet this condition will result in being placed on Probation 2 at the conclusion of this semester.
2. Must remain registered in **at least one course** for the entire semester.
 - Failure to meet this condition may result in denial of permission to resume studies at AUS.
3. Must pass the UPA 200 course if they have less than 30 earned institutional credit hours.
4. Must complete and submit the probation contract along with the parent/guardian's signature, passport or Emirates ID **by the end of the fourth week** of the current semester.
5. Must meet the ASC advisor as frequently as determined by the ASC advisor.
6. Students should have a **minimum of three advising sessions** before the start of early registration. Two advising sessions must be completed by week 10. Students can meet with their ASC advisor as frequently as needed but only one advising session per week can count towards the advising requirement.
 - Failure to meet these conditions will result in inability to register during early registration and a hold on registration until these conditions are met.

Students on **Probation 2:**

1. Must successfully attain a cumulative GPA of 2.0 by the end of this semester.
2. Must remain registered in **at least one course** for the entire semester.
 - Failure to meet these conditions will result in academic dismissal at the conclusion of this semester.
3. Must complete and submit this contract along with a copy of my parent/guardian's passport or Emirates ID **by the second day of classes**.
4. Must meet the ASC advisor as frequently as determined by the ASC Advisor. Three advising sessions must be completed by week 10. I should have a **minimum of five advising sessions** before the start of finals week. Students can meet with their ASC advisor as frequently as needed but only one advising session per week can count towards the advising requirement.
- Failure to meet these conditions will result in being ineligible to apply for reinstatement if academically dismissed from AUS.

Responsibilities of a Student on Academic Probation

Checklist	
	Fulfill all the obligations of academic probation as listed above
☐	Make their parents aware of academic standing and seek their help
☐	Schedule regular appointments with ASC advisor
☐	Come prepared for each advising session with questions or material for discussion
☐	Utilize AUS resources such as the Writing Center and the Math Learning Center
☐	Ask for help or clarification when needed
☐	Provide ASC advisor with accurate updates on academic performance
☐	Listen to and follow through on the recommendations made by ASC advisor
☐	Dedicate serious time and effort into improving grades
	Take responsibility for own learning and development
	Balance social obligations with academic responsibilities
	Incorporate new study skill strategies
	Become knowledgeable about AUS programs, policies and procedures

What to Expect from ASC Advising Sessions

ASC advisor will:

- recommend strategies to help students get on good standing
- encourage and guide students as they define and develop realistic academic goals
- calculate the GPA requirement to get on good standing
- advise students on major/minor requirements if needed
- refer students to AUS/community resources as needed
- encourage students to attend classes regularly and stay in touch with instructors
- request an update from faculty regarding academic progress
- interpret university policies and procedures as needed
- respond to student and parents'/guardians' inquiries

Benefits of ASC Advising Sessions

Students will:

- learn necessary study skills to improve academic performance
- gain a better understanding of graduation requirements
- find out the GPA required to get out of probation
- get recommendations regarding a manageable course load and get recommendations for course registration
- be informed of AUS policies and requirements
- learn the importance of making use of the add/drop period and the deadline to withdraw from courses without a grade penalty
- get feedback about class performance and attendance
- understand the importance of attending classes
- be able to discuss learning barriers and strategies to overcome them
- learn about AUS resources that can help attain good standing

Parental Involvement

ASC believes in partnership and collaboration with the parents/guardians of students on probation.

Parents/guardians are informed in writing if a student gets on academic probation by having them sign the probation contracts. This includes information regarding obligations of a student on probation. Parents of students on probation with a local phone number are also sent an SMS at the start of each semester to inform them of the student's academic standing and invite them to meet with an ASC advisor. The Office of the Registrar sends transcripts of students on academic probation with a letter from ASC explaining the academic standing to the address listed on Banner. It is the students' responsibility to ensure that the contact information listed on Banner is accurate.

Parents/guardians are welcome to contact ASC to get information about AUS academic policies and resources. Parents/guardians of students on academic probation are also welcome to schedule a meeting with an ASC advisor. It is strongly preferred that the student also be present for all parent meetings. These meetings can provide parents with a clear understanding about the student's academic progress at AUS and their areas of strength, growth, aptitude for major, and any learning barriers. From our experience we have found that it is advantageous for the students to get appropriate encouragement and assistance from parents and other family members. Parents/guardians are encouraged to motivate the students to utilize various resources available for student support and to check their progress frequently by having them log in to their iLearn account (online learning tool). Parents/guardians are advised to encourage the student to explore a different major that maybe better suited to their strengths before the student gets on Probation 2.

Academic Dismissal

Students who are academically dismissed from AUS may apply for reinstatement. Students should note that applying for reinstatement does not guarantee reinstatement, and only in very rare and exceptional circumstances will a student who has been academically dismissed from AUS be reinstated.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate students

6. Responsibilities:

Individual schools/colleges are responsible for academic progress advising and degree audits. The Academic Support Center is responsible for Probation advising and other advising support.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

ASC: Academic Support Center

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Undergraduate Catalog

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	May 2023	General Update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
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10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

w. Student Academic Integrity Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0600UI22	Policy Title:	Student Academic Integrity Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Academic Integrity Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines all of the acts that are defined as violations of the Student Academic Integrity Code as well as the adjudication process, the classes of penalties assigned and the appeals process.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Student Academic Integrity Code

Academic integrity lies at the heart of intellectual life. As an institution committed to the advancement of knowledge in a manner consistent with the highest ethical standards, AUS affirms the importance of respecting the integrity of academic work. The AUS Student Academic Integrity Code (referred to herein as Code) describes standards for academic conduct, students' rights and responsibilities as members of an academic community, and procedures for handling allegations of academic dishonesty.

In order to establish within the AUS student body a sense of ethical responsibility, honor and mutual respect, prior to registration, every student must sign the following Academic Integrity Pledge:

I [student's name] pledge my commitment to the following values:

- *I will hold myself accountable for all that I say and write;*
- *I will hold myself responsible for the academic integrity of my work;*
- *I will not misrepresent my work nor give or receive unauthorized aid;*
- *I will behave in a manner that demonstrates concern for the personal dignity, rights and freedoms of all members of the community;*
- *I will respect university property and the property of others; and*
- *I will not tolerate a lack of respect for these values.*

Students are responsible for becoming familiar with their rights and responsibilities as defined by the Code and for ensuring that they understand the requirements for their particular courses (e.g., regarding issues such as collaborative work, use of study aids or take-home examinations, etc.).

Attempts to violate or to assist others in violating the Code, including unsuccessful attempts, are prohibited and will be treated as actual violations.

Definition of Academic Violations

Members of the AUS academic community are expected to conduct themselves with integrity in their work and actions. Violations of the Code include, but are not limited to, the following categories.

Plagiarism

To plagiarize is to use the work, ideas, concepts, images or words of someone else without fully acknowledging the source in all academic work, including assignments, quizzes, examinations, papers and projects. Plagiarism may involve using someone else's wording—a distinctive name, a phrase, a sentence or an entire passage or essay—without using quotation marks and appropriately citing the source. Plagiarism may also involve misrepresenting the sources that were used or expressing the ideas of someone else in your own words without the appropriate citation.

Inappropriate Collaboration

Collaboration on academic work may be encouraged, but it is important to ensure that contributions are acknowledged. Inappropriate collaboration includes working with someone else in developing, organizing or revising a project (such as a paper, an oral presentation, a research or design project or a take-home examination) without acknowledging that person's help. The use of unauthorized assistance must be avoided in the production of all academic work.

Specific requirements related to collaborative work, peer review, the use of an external entity in the production of work, the use of tutors and editing may vary among courses and students must ensure that faculty members explicitly provide approval in advance of the collaboration.

Impersonation

Students must attend their own classes, be present and sit for all tests and examinations, and personally attend other events associated with a course. The individual impersonated and the impersonator may be subject to sanctions.

Dishonesty in Examinations and Submitted Work

All academic work and materials submitted for assessment must be the sole original work of the student, unless otherwise directed by the instructor. Students are prohibited from submitting any material prepared by or purchased from another person or company.

Communication is not allowed between or among students, nor are students allowed to consult books, papers, study aids or notes without explicit permission. Dishonesty includes, but is not limited to, communication with another student or an external party using electronic devices during an examination or in-class assignment, copying from another's paper, giving unauthorized assistance, obtaining unauthorized advance knowledge of examination questions, and the use of mechanical or marking devices or procedures for the purpose of achieving false scores on machine-graded examinations.

Specific policies regarding examinations may vary among individual professors.

Work Completed for One Course and Submitted to Another

Students may not present the same work for more than one course. Under exceptional circumstances, faculty members may permit a significant piece of research to satisfy requirements in two courses. However, both professors must agree in advance to this arrangement. If past research is incorporated into current projects, previous work must be appropriately referenced.

Deliberate Falsification of Data

Students may not deliberately falsify data or distort supporting documentation for course work or other academic activity.

Interference with Other Students' Work

Students may not intentionally interfere with the work of others, such as sabotaging laboratory experiments, creative work, research or digital files, or by giving misleading information or disrupting class work.

Copyright Violations

Copyright laws must be observed. These laws govern practices such as making use of printed materials, duplicating computer software, duplicating images, photoduplicating copyrighted materials and reproducing audio/visual works. The Code prohibits theft and the unauthorized use of documents and requires adherence to the laws of Sharjah and the federal laws of the UAE.

Complicity in Academic Dishonesty

Complicity in academic dishonesty consists of helping or attempting to help another person commit an act of academic dishonesty or willfully assisting another student in the violation of the Code. Complicity in academic dishonesty is pre-meditated and intentional. This can include, but is not limited to, the following:

- doing work for another student
- designing or producing a project for another student
- willfully providing answers during an exam, test or quiz
- communicating with another student or external party on a computer, mobile phone or other device while an exam is in progress
- providing a student with an advance copy of a test
- posting of notes or other materials from a class (whether the student is enrolled in the class or not) on the Internet, whether or not for a fee, without express permission from the faculty member
- leaving inappropriate materials behind at the site of an exam or test

Adjudication of Academic Offenses

Jurisdiction

Academic cases resulting from alleged violations of the Code are within the jurisdiction of the dean (or appointed designee) of the college/school in which the alleged Code violation occurred.

Faculty members who have knowledge of an alleged violation should report the incident to the dean (or appointed designee) of the college/school in which the alleged Code violation occurred.

A faculty member may exercise discretion in those cases involving a student's judgmental error rather than willful violation of the Code.

Students who wish to bring charges against other students must do so through the faculty member in whose course or academic activity the alleged Code violation occurred. The student who brings the charges must identify himself/herself to the faculty member.

Violations of the Code that involve admission and/or placement testing fall within the jurisdiction of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction and may result in the revocation of admission or dismissal from the university.

The Adjudication Process

An allegation of dishonesty must be reported to the dean (or appointed designee) and the head of the department or unit in which the offense occurred within five working days of the date of discovery of the alleged offense. The report must be supported by appropriate documentation.

Once the alleged violation has been reported, faculty members must not submit grades for the work in question or for the course until the case has been adjudicated. If the semester grades are due before the adjudication process is complete, a temporary grade of N will be assigned and a “Pending Conduct Investigation” statement will be recorded on the student’s academic transcript.

The student must remain enrolled in the course in which an infraction has been reported until the adjudication process is complete.

Legal counsel or involvement of any parties other than the student and relevant university personnel is not permitted at any point during the adjudication process.

After receiving complete information, the dean (or appointed designee) will follow the adjudication process outlined below:

- a. The dean (or appointed designee) will promptly notify the student of the charge and inform the student of the date and time of a formal meeting to discuss the charge. The dean (or appointed designee) will also notify the head of the department or unit in which the offense occurred and will consult with the student’s dean (or appointed designee) to inform them of the allegation if the student is pursuing a major in another college/school.
- b. The dean (or appointed designee) will meet with the student to explain the adjudication process and present the allegation and the evidence. If the student fails to attend the meeting, the dean (or appointed designee) will proceed with the process.
- c. The student will be given the opportunity to respond to the allegation in writing within two working days.
- d. After the deadline for the student to respond to the allegation has passed, the dean (or appointed designee) will consider all evidence and, depending on whether a preponderance of evidence supports the allegation of academic misconduct, take one of the following actions:
 - i. dismiss the case
 - ii. request that the student resubmit the work in question or retake an examination
 - iii. assign a penalty.
- e. If a student resubmits the work in question or retakes an examination, the results will be considered in determining whether a preponderance of evidence exists to support the allegation of academic misconduct and the assignment of a penalty.

Penalties

Violations of the Code will be treated seriously, with increasingly severe penalties considered for repeat offenders. A second violation may result in suspension or dismissal.

In assigning a penalty, the dean (or appointed designee) will take into account both the seriousness of the offense and any particular circumstances involved.

Penalties for an academic offense may include one or more of the following:

- a. a warning letter to be kept in the academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.
- b. a lowered grade or loss of credit for the work found to be in violation of the Code (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)
- c. a lowered overall grade for the course in which the offense occurred (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)
- d. a failing grade of XF for the course in which the offense occurred (to be specified at the time that the penalty is assigned)

- e. suspension for the semester/term in which the offense occurred with a possible addition of one or more academic semester(s)/term(s)
- f. dismissal from the university

Penalties (b)–(f) will result in non-academic sanctions that may include prohibition from extracurricular activities and the loss of athletic scholarships. See the *AUS Student Handbook* for details.

For penalties (e) and (f), the student is assigned a grade of N for all semester/term registered courses, with a provision for a grade penalty for the course where the academic offense was reported. No refund or cancellation of tuition fees will be permitted in such cases.

Students are solely responsible for any financial implications resulting from an academic integrity violation.

Students found guilty of an academic integrity violation will not be allowed to complete a course evaluation for the course in which the offense occurred.

Students with a record of sanctions resulting from violations of the Code (or Student Code of Conduct) will not be eligible for the Dean's List.

Suspension and Dismissal

The decision as to whether suspension or dismissal is appropriate in a given instance will necessarily depend on the circumstances of each case.

Suspension

(temporary separation from the university)

Suspension is effective for not less than the semester/term in which the penalty is levied or for not more than one calendar year. The length of a suspension must be specified in writing when the student is notified of the outcome of the adjudication process.

A student who is suspended is entitled to resume studies in the same college/school at the conclusion of the period of suspension if all academic requirements are met. The student must submit a Reactivation Request Form to the Office of the Registrar. The form is available at www.aus.edu/registration/forms.

Courses completed outside AUS while on suspension do not transfer.

Dismissal

(permanent separation from the university)

Dismissal is invoked in cases of serious infractions of rules and regulations and when circumstances indicate that a student's association with the university should be terminated in the interest of maintaining the standards of behavior and conduct normally expected in a university community. In instances where the dean (or appointed designee) hearing the case has recommended dismissal, the Academic Appeals Review Committee will review the case and make a recommendation to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Notification of Penalty

The dean (or appointed designee) hearing the case will notify the student in writing of the outcome of the adjudication process and, if applicable, the assigned penalty.

In addition to the faculty member bringing the charge, the following university officials have a legitimate need to know and will be informed of the outcome of the adjudication process at the time that the student is notified:

- The head of the department in which the offense occurred
- The dean of the college/school and the head of the department responsible for the major in which the student is enrolled (if applicable)
- The Dean of Students
- The Office of the Registrar
- The Academic Support Center
- The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction OR the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies (as appropriate)

For record keeping of documents pertaining to the infringement of the Code, please refer to the appropriate section under Student Records herein.

Appeal of Penalty

In cases concerning notation to the student's record [penalties (d)–(f)], students will be notified in writing of their right of appeal. Appeals must be submitted in writing to the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction within five working days of the date of notification of the outcome of the adjudication process by the dean (or appointed designee).

Appeals are limited to grounds of excessive sanction, improper procedure and unavailability of relevant evidence at the time of the meeting with the dean (or appointed designee) to discuss the charge with the student.

The Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction may affirm, modify, or remand the case to the dean (or appointed designee) with instructions for further action. The decision of the Vice Provost is final.

For penalty (f), the Academic Appeals Review Committee will review the case and make a recommendation to the Provost. The Provost may affirm, modify, or remand the case to the dean with instructions for further action. The decision of the Provost is final.

Notation of an Academic Integrity Code Violation Penalty

A student's standing that impacts his or her eligibility to continuously enroll at AUS affects academic progress and, for this reason, is deemed transcript-appropriate. The general type of infraction (academic or disciplinary) is noted on the student's transcript, as well as the office responsible for issuing the student's separation from the institution.

Penalties (d)–(f) will become a permanent part of the student's file maintained by the Office of the Registrar, with appropriate notation on the student's academic transcript indicating that there has been a violation of the Code.

For penalties (f) and (f), the student is assigned a grade of N for all semester/term registered courses, with a provision for a grade penalty for the course where the academic offense was reported.

The student may petition to replace an XF grade resulting from a category (d) penalty with an F grade at the time of graduation or following complete withdrawal from the university. For details, please refer to the Appeal of an XF Grade section under Student Petitions and Appeals.

For tracking purposes, all academic integrity violations will be recorded in the university's academic integrity database maintained by the Office of the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate students at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Individual colleges/schools are responsible for adjudication of cases. The Vice Provosts are responsible for appeal cases.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

AARC: Academic Appeals Review Committee

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Undergraduate Catalog

<https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	August 2021	General update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	March 2023	General Update	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

x. Student Appeal Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE23	Policy Title:	Student Appeal Policy
Prepared By:	Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR)	Issue Date:	1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/ Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	Effective Date:	May 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	May 12, 2026

1. Policy:

Student Appeal Policy is a part of the comprehensive Student Code of Conduct 2024-25

2. Purpose:

Student Appeal Policy provides a student an opportunity to appeal against a conduct action taken after going through the Conduct Proceedings for violating the Student Code of Conduct.

3. Introduction / background: Not Applicable

4. Policy Statement:

A student can appeal in the circumstances whereby he/she determines that there is a procedural error, the sanctions are excessive or new information was found after a conduct action was taken.

Appeal Process:

Conduct actions may be appealed in keeping with the following provisions:

4.1 Respondents may appeal any conduct determination arrived at through a hearing and resulted in a sanction of disciplinary probation, removal from University housing, suspension or dismissal.

4.2 An appeal must be emailed to the University Appellate Committee at UACSC@aus.edu within seven working days after the date of notice. In instances of dismissal from the University, Senior Manager–Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will forward the case to the Appellate Board and notify the student.

4.3 Appeals will be reviewed by an Appellate Board of the CCHB and will consist of five members who did not serve on the original hearing panel.

4.4 The Appellate Board will determine the appeal's viability based on whether there is new information that significantly alters the face of facts stated earlier, evidence of improper procedure, findings that are against the weight of evidence or excessive sanctions.

4.5 The Appellate Board may deny the request for appeal and affirm the original findings of the CCHB or grant the request for an appeal and forward its recommendations to the Chancellor.

4.6 The following standards will apply when appeals are considered by the Chancellor: a. Sanctions may be increased or decreased if found to be substantially disproportionate to the offense. b. Cases may be remanded for rehearing by the CCHB if specified procedural errors or errors in interpretation of university regulations were so substantial as to deny the respondent (or complainant) a fair hearing, or if new and significant evidence becomes available that could not have been discovered before or during the original hearing. c. Cases may be dismissed if the finding is deemed to be unsupported by the evidence.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to registered students of American University of Sharjah that go through the **conduct proceedings** and are sanctioned.

6. Responsibilities:

- The University's appellate committee of five faculty members are responsible for reviewing the appeal and providing recommendations.
- The decision of the Chancellor is final.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: Reference 6 m

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- To report a violation of the Student Code of Conduct, log into https://aus-advocate.symplicity.com/public_report to submit an incident form.
- Refer to the *Student Handbook* for the Student Code of Conduct.

9. Policy history:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	1998	New Policy	-
2.0	March and April 2016	Appellate Committee to review Student Appeals	AU Washington Team recommendations Implementation
3.0	May 12, 2024	Policy Template Update	Office of the Chancellor

This Policy is a section of the Student Code of Conduct updated annually.

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Chancellor	06-5152204	chancellor@aus.edu
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	06-5152162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Senior Manager-Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	06-5152250	jcourtinho@aus.edu

y. Student Grievances Policy

N.A.

z. Alumni Relations Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0600AA24	Policy Title:	Alumni Relations Policy
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	January 25, 2022
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy defines the scope of managing the relationship with alumni, especially in terms of streamlining the communication channels as one of the university's main constituents.

The Alumni Affairs unit within the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) is mandated to reach out to alumni to build loyalty and connection to their alma mater. Alumni Affairs' goal is to engage alumni and ensure that AUS plays a significant role in their futures, regardless of where they live or when they graduated. Alumni Affairs unit is doing this by regularly reaching out to its graduates and building pride in the institution through designing and implementing programs to engage alumni so that AUS continues to be relevant in their lives.

2. Purpose:

- b. This policy creates a process for communication with AUS alumni, who collectively form an important constituency for the University. All contact with alumni should be coordinated by OAAA so that communications are streamlined and consistent. In order to ensure that up-to-date contact details are used for communications with alumni, stakeholders are to collaborate with the unit responsible to ensure that a central comprehensive database is maintained by OAAA. This will involve the stakeholders sending their existing updated alumni information to OAAA and ensuring proper coordination prior to sending any communication to alumni.

In addition to that, the role of the Alumni Relations division is to maintain and update confidential records of AUS alumni (be it their contact details, professional and academic information); maintain relevant, and interesting communication with AUS alumni to promote alumni engagement; support AUS Alumni Association activities and events and acting as a liaison between the Association and the University; extend career services to the members of AUS alumni and assist them in all aspects of their career development process. This includes providing information on available employment opportunities, seminars, and conferences by major area of specialization; publish the monthly online Alumni newsletter to keep AUS alumni up-to-date; and creates events and initiatives that increase their engagement level with the university (that includes homecoming events, mentorship programs, and program/class-specific alumni receptions).

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

It is the policy of AUS that mutually beneficial relationships between the university and its alumni must be fostered, in particular by means of creating alumni awareness and promoting the various activities the university is undertaking to enhance its engagement with alumni.

As maintaining confidentiality of data is key to the university's processes, OAAA is mandated to maintain a central database that is kept under its purview, while coordinating efforts with other university stakeholders to ensure that communication with alumni is properly coordinated and streamlined.

Any dispute about this policy or its application must be referred to OAAA. This policy shall be reviewed and revised as needed.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy highlights the role of all university units with the operating principles as they communicate with alumni. This will help ensure efforts to engage alumni are efficient, are aligning with the overall advancement operation and the university's goals, and are providing a uniform positive experience for alumni.

This of course applies with the understanding that all leads and activities for AUS alumni are to be coordinated with OAAA.

6. Responsibilities:

Any office or department in the University seeking to communicate with the mass alumni is to send this communication through OAAA. Once approved, the message will be sent to the relevant alumni segment by OAAA.

All University departments and programs who currently maintain their own separate email lists for alumni of AUS, including for mailing of newsletters, bulletins and the like, are to provide electronic copies of their databases to OAAA, so that all addresses can be compared and updated in a central database held by OAAA. As per University policy, contact details for alumni lie within the purview of OAAA and may only be shared with the academic units' deans, when and where applicable.

For the purpose of accreditation surveys or invitations for accreditation visits, OAAA will coordinate with the academic units to provide them with the updated database. Access to the database will be limited to the dean and his/her designees. In addition, academic units can use any of the three options listed below to contact a particular segment of the alumni community directly:

Option 1 Mass email to alumni (regarding accreditation):

OAAA provides access to the database for a specific segment of alumni, based on the request of the academic unit. The academic unit responsible can then send a mass email to the alumni segment defined for this purpose.

Option 2 Personalized mass email to alumni (regarding accreditation):

OAAA receives the email communication with the title and signature of the requesting academic unit and sends personalized emails to the relevant segment of alumni using its iModules portal, making it appear as if it is the sender is the department itself. The final email will appear as follows:

*From: deancen@aus.edu To: Personalized email Dear Ahmed,
We at the College of Engineering*

Regards Dean XXX.

Reply-to: deancen@aus.edu

Option 3 Mass email to alumni (default option for all other purposes, if approved):

OAAA sends a 'forward' of the email communication with the title and signature of the requesting academic unit from OAAA@aus.edu, identifying the academic unit as the point of contact. The final email will appear as follows:

*From: OAAA@aus.edu To: CEN alumni
Cc: deancen@aus.edu*

The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs is pleased to bring to your kind attention the following message from the Dean of Engineering

All other communications including, but not limited to, invitations for events, solicitations of sponsorship, and career opportunities/internship requests, must be coordinated and channeled through OAAA.

Individual Communication with a specific alumnus/alumna will require receiving the consent of the individual in question to release their contact details before these are shared with the relevant academic unit.

Communications with “All Alumni” are managed and administered entirely by OAAA. OAAA is responsible for limiting communications with alumni to a maximum of one per day per specific segment of alumni. It is important to mention that a monthly newsletter is sent to all alumni (usually end of month) by OAAA. This could be a possible means of communication for both academic and non-academic units, through which they can send information to alumni. Aside from accreditation matters, all communications must be coordinated with OAAA.

Exceptions:

Any exception to the policy will need to be approved in writing by OAAA.

Non-Compliance:

Non-compliance with the policy will be reported to the Chancellor.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The policy on Community Engagement could be consulted for more details about how AUS is actively engaged in seeking ways to benefit our community and to enhance our presence as a force for good in our broader environment.

9. Policy history:

This policy has been introduced in January 2022. A review cycle has been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 25, 2022	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor
2.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

aa. Student Load Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0600UI25	Policy Title:	Student Load Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	May, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Registrar	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Load Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy covers the institutional rules regarding course loads for both undergraduate and graduate students.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Undergraduate

Semester/Term Course Load

A student admitted to and enrolled in a degree program normally registers for 15 to 18 credit hours each semester. All credit hours exceeding 16 credits will require a supplemental fee. A student can register for up to seven credit hours in a six-week summer term.

The degree programs have been designed to be completed normally in four years, except for the Bachelor of Architecture, which is a five-year program. However, some students may require additional time. The proposed sequence of study for every program is intended to assist students in planning their semester/term course load so that they complete their degree requirements within the normal time limit of their respective programs.

Full-Time Students

The required minimum load for a fulltime student is 12 credit hours per semester, and the maximum load is 18 credit hours per semester.

Part-Time Students

Part-time students are those students who register for less than 12 credit hours in a given semester.

Degree-seeking students are expected to maintain full-time status. Degree seeking students with academic difficulty could be moved to part-time status by their Academic Support Center advisor. Due to special medical conditions or other special considerations, a degree-seeking student could select to move to part-time status.

Part-time students are not evaluated for placement on the Dean's List and the Chancellor's List (see University Honors and Awards later in this section). Part-time students are normally not candidates for AUS disbursed financial grants or scholarships (for details, refer to the Tuition, Grants and

Scholarships section later in this catalog). Some other AUS privileges of full-time, degree-seeking students might not be available to part-time students.

Overload Students

A student who has attained senior standing and is in good academic standing may seek the permission of his/her dean (or designee) to register for up to 21 credit hours in the semester of graduation or nine credit hours in a summer graduation term. All credit hours exceeding 16 credits will require a supplemental fee.

First-Year Students Course Load

First-year students are normally restricted to five courses per semester to allow time for their adjustment to the learning environment of AUS. First-year students placed in two or more preparatory courses (e.g., MTH 001, WRI 001, etc.) in a semester should register for a maximum of 13 credit hours.

Probation Students Course Load

An undergraduate student on Academic Probation 1 is allowed to carry a maximum load of 16 credit hours. An undergraduate student who is on Academic Probation 2 may only register for a maximum load of 13 credit hours.

Summer Term Course Load

A maximum total of seven credit hours is allowed during a six-week summer term. The program coordinator/head of department may further restrict the maximum credit hours of a student on academic probation in a summer term.

Graduate

A graduate student's course load comprises the total number of credit hours of master's or PhD courses registered in a semester/term. Some master's degree students may be required to complete specific undergraduate-level courses; credit hours generated by these courses are not considered in the calculation of the student's semester/term course load.

Likewise, some PhD degree students may be required to complete specific master's or undergraduate-level courses; the credit hours generated by these courses are not considered in the calculation of the student's semester/term course load.

Full-Time Students

The required minimum load for a fulltime student is nine credit hours per semester, and the maximum load is 12 credit hours per semester.

Part-Time Students

Part-time students are those students who register for less than nine credit hours in a given semester.

Semester Course Load

Good Academic Standing Students

The maximum course load of a graduate student in good academic standing is nine credit hours per semester. The program coordinator/head of department may approve a student in good academic standing to register for up to 12 credit hours per semester.

Academic Probation Students

The maximum course load of a graduate student on academic probation is six credit hours per semester.

Summer Term Course Load

A maximum total of seven credit hours is allowed during a six-week summer term. The program coordinator/head of department may further restrict the maximum credit hours of a student on academic probation in a summer term.

A graduate student may not register for more than three credit hours of thesis/project/dissertation during a six-week summer term.

Conditional Admission Students

The maximum course load of a conditionally admitted graduate student is six credit hours per semester/term.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate degree courses at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

VPUAI to ensure policy is compliant with CAA regulations.

Registrar to ensure implementation.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Catalogs: <https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

9. Policy History:

This policy was initiated in May 2023.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 2023	New Policy derived from student catalogues and approved by the COD on June 5, 2023	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu
Registrar, Office of the Registrar	Tel +971 6 515 2003	ataya@aus.edu

ab. Sexual Misconduct Policy - Version 1

Policy Number:	0600SE26	Policy Title:	Sexual Misconduct Policy
Prepared By:	Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	Issue Date:	2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR)	Effective Date:	April 05, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	April 05, 2025

1. Policy:

The Sexual Misconduct Policy contained within this document applies to all students at American University of Sharjah (AUS). This policy is designed to promote a safe and equitable environment and to comply with applicable local laws of Sharjah, and federal laws of the UAE.

The information provided in this policy is not exhaustive and should not be construed as legal advice. While every effort has been made to ensure the accuracy and completeness of this policy, the possibility of errors or omissions cannot be ruled out. Additionally, legal standards and best practices surrounding sexual misconduct are subject to change. AUS reserves the right to update, amend, or revise the provisions of this policy at any time without prior notice in response to such changes or as deemed necessary by the university.

Modifications to this policy will be made with consideration to recommendations from internal stakeholders, legal advisors, and external expert consultation. All such changes will be communicated to the AUS community through official channels and updated in the policy documentation. This policy does not form a contract of any kind. AUS does not guarantee complete protection from sexual misconduct but strives to take appropriate and timely actions to prevent, correct, and discipline behavior that violates this policy.

Any discrepancies between this policy and current laws or regulations will be resolved in favor of compliance with the law. Readers are encouraged to seek guidance from the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution should they have concerns or questions regarding the interpretation or implementation of this policy.

This policy is a guiding document and should be utilized in conjunction with other official documents and resources provided by American University of Sharjah.

2. Purpose:

Sexual misconduct represents a spectrum of unwanted sexual behaviors, ranging from verbal harassment to physical assault, which infringe on an individual's autonomy and sense of safety. Recognizing that such actions disrupt the sanctity of our institution's values, AUS is resolute in addressing them with a robust and comprehensive policy. The policy not only encompasses a wide variety of misconduct – including harassment, assault, exploitation, and intimidation – but also acknowledges that these behaviors can transpire across all settings and mediums, impacting any community member, regardless of their identity. It can take place in various settings, including on campus, during university-sponsored events, or online interactions.

Sexual misconduct is a broad term encompassing a range of unwelcome sexual behaviors that violate an individual's dignity, bodily autonomy, or create a hostile environment. **It includes, but is not limited to:**

- **Sexual harassment:** Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature.
- **Sexual assault:** Any non-consensual sexual contact, including attempted or completed rape,

sexual battery, and sexual coercion.

- **Sexual exploitation:** Taking advantage of a person's vulnerability or power imbalance to engage in sexual activity.
- **Sexual intimidation:** Creating a hostile or offensive environment through unwelcome sexual conduct.
- We adhere to a policy of making decisions without regard to race, color, age, gender, religion, national origin, gender identity or disability.

3. Introduction/Background:

University Message

Central to AUS's ethos is the unwavering commitment to a safe and supportive environment, one which denounces all forms of sexual misconduct. This policy echoes our resolve to not just respond to incidents, but also to actively foster a culture of prevention, support, and accountability. We place significant emphasis on clear reporting mechanisms, confidential support services, thorough investigations, and disciplinary measures, when necessary, all of which reflect our promise for transparency and fairness. Through continuous reflection and policy enhancement, AUS dedicates itself to nurturing a campus life that every community member can relish with dignity and pride. We implore everyone within our community to familiarize themselves with the policy and join us in cultivating a campus climate of zero tolerance towards sexual misconduct.

American University of Sharjah unequivocally condemns all forms of sexual misconduct. We stand firmly committed to providing a safe and supportive environment for all members of our community. This policy serves as a clear expression of our values and outlines our comprehensive approach to preventing, responding to, and addressing sexual misconduct.

Key aspects of our commitment:

- **Prevention:** We prioritize proactive measures to prevent sexual misconduct through education, awareness campaigns, and bystander intervention training.
- **Reporting and Support:** We offer safe and accessible avenues for reporting incidents, ensuring confidentiality, and providing comprehensive support services to individuals impacted by sexual misconduct.
- **Investigation and Accountability:** We have a fair and transparent process for investigating all allegations of sexual misconduct, holding individuals accountable for their actions, and imposing appropriate disciplinary measures.
- **Continuous Improvement:** We are committed to continuous review and improvement of our policies and procedures, ensuring they remain effective and responsive to the needs of our community.

4. Policy Statement:

This policy serves as a foundation for achieving our goal of creating a campus environment where all students feel safe, respected, and able to fulfil their academic pursuits without a detriment to their health and safety. We encourage students to familiarize themselves with its contents and contribute to fostering a culture of zero tolerance for sexual misconduct at American University of Sharjah.

5. Scope /Applicability:

This policy applies to all registered students at American University of Sharjah.

6. Responsibilities:

This chapter outlines the responsibilities incumbent upon members of American University of Sharjah (AUS) community in enforcing the Sexual Misconduct Policy. These duties are distributed among general members of the community, university officials, and students, faculty, and staff, ensuring a collective commitment to maintaining a safe and respectful campus environment.

General Responsibilities

Every community member at AUS has an obligation to:

- Uphold the core values of integrity, respect, and dignity in all interactions.
- Familiarize themselves with the Sexual Misconduct Policy and related procedures.
- Report any instances or suspicions of sexual misconduct to the appropriate authorities in a timely manner.
- Participate in prevention, awareness, and education programs to foster a campus climate that is free from sexual misconduct.
- Respect the confidentiality and privacy of individuals involved in a sexual misconduct report or investigation.
- Cooperate fully with any investigations related to sexual misconduct.

General Responsibilities off campus

- The University will not be responsible for conducting investigations in sexual misconduct incidents that occur off campus.
- The University will extend any required accommodations or sanctions in case of the provision of solid evidence and if both parties are AUS students.
- The University will ensure that the complainant will be supported to file a complaint with lawful authorities in case it was requested by the complainant.

Responsibilities of university officials

University officials have additional specialized responsibilities, which include:

- Ensuring that all reports of sexual misconduct are addressed promptly, thoroughly, and impartially.
- Offering appropriate resources, support services, and interim measures to complainants and respondents.
- Maintaining up-to-date training to handle sexual misconduct cases sensitively and in accordance with university policies and legal requirements.
- Preserving the privacy and confidentiality of all parties involved in a report to the extent permitted by law and university policy.
- Remaining fair and unbiased throughout the investigation and resolution processes.
- Implementing and enforcing disciplinary measures and sanctions where warranted.

Specific officials have the following obligations:

- **The Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR)** office must oversee the investigative process and ensure adherence to procedural standards.
- **University Health Services (UHS)** is responsible for providing necessary medical care and support to affected individuals.
- **The Executive Director of Student Experience (EDSE)** must supervise the overall student-related aspects of sexual misconduct cases, including any necessary accommodations or adjustments.
- **The Sexual Misconduct Committee (SMC)** must conduct hearings, deliberate on findings, and recommend appropriate sanctions when a formal resolution is required.

Responsibilities of students, faculty, and staff

Students, faculty, and staff are expected to actively engage in creating a campus environment that is safe and respectful:

- **Students** must abide by all aspects of the Sexual Misconduct Policy and respect university
- **Faculty members** are expected to be familiar with the Sexual Misconduct Policy and Procedures and be responsible for incorporating discussions on consent, respect, and university norms into their curricula where appropriate.
- **Staff** should be vigilant and report and respond to concerns regarding sexual misconduct within their respective departments or professional domains.
- **Both faculty and staff** must ensure they actively participate in training programs, understand reporting obligations, and support students or colleagues who may be affected by sexual misconduct.

Collectively, these guidelines emphasize a proactive stance against sexual misconduct, aligning with AUS's commitment to safeguarding and fostering an educational and professional environment characterized by mutual respect and safety. By delineating clear responsibilities, AUS empowers its community to take meaningful action against sexual misconduct, support affected students and uphold the institution's reputation for excellence in all spheres.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronym:

Definition of Sexual Misconduct

Sexual misconduct is defined as engaging in any of the following acts including but not limited to:

- Insinuate, propose, or demand sexual favors of any kind.
- Invade another person's personal space (e.g., inappropriate touching.)
- Stalk, intimidate, coerce, or threaten another person to get him/her to engage in sexual acts.
- Send or display sexually explicit objects or messages.
- Comment on someone's looks, dress, sexuality, or gender in a derogatory or objectifying manner or a manner that makes them uncomfortable.
- Make obscene comments, jokes or gestures that humiliate or offend someone.
- Pursue or flirt with another person persistently without the other person's willing participation. Also, flirting with someone at an inappropriate time (e.g., in a team meeting) is considered sexual misconduct.
- Constant requests for name and phone number
- Forcing the complainant or tricking into filming self and sending the pictures to the respondent.
- Attempted rape, touching, or any other form of forced sexual act.

TERM	DEFINITION
AUS	American University of Sharjah – the institution upholding this policy.
Complainant	The individual who submits a report of sexual misconduct.
Confidentiality	The policy's guarantee that information regarding an incident will be handled discreetly.
Confidentiality Clause	A rule within the policy that maintains the privacy of all parties involved in a report of sexual misconduct.
Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration – May be engaged in overseeing and managing administrative aspects of this policy's enforcement.
COPS	Chief of Protocol & Safety – The official overseeing campus safety protocols and evidence collection related to incidents under this policy.
Disclosure	The release of any information related to the incident within the guidelines of this policy.
EDSE	Executive Director of Student Experience – The administrator responsible for the non-academic disciplinary scope of student life and policy implementation.

Investigation	The formal process of examining the details and evidence related to a report of sexual misconduct.
IXO	International Exchange Office – The office that aids international students in case the issue concerns them.
No-Contact Contract	An agreement that prohibits contact between the complainant and respondent, typically in place for a specified time frame.
Re-entry Process	The formal steps taken by the University Officials with the Complainant or Respondent to enable them to reintegrate into university life.
Respondent	The individual who has been reported to be the perpetrator of misconduct.
SCCR	Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution – The office responsible for overseeing the disciplinary process for student-involved cases.
Sexual Assault	Any non-consensual sexual act or attempted act, including rape, sexual battery, and sexual coercion.
Sexual Exploitation	Taking non-consensual or abusive sexual advantage of another for personal benefit or gratification.
Sexual Harassment	Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors, and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature.
Sexual Intimidation	Actions that aim to intimidate or coerce an individual into unwanted sexual activity or create a hostile environment.
SMC	Sexual Misconduct Committee – The body tasked with ensuring a fair and prompt resolution of sexual misconduct cases.

UHS	University Health Services – The entity that provides medical evaluations, maintains health records, and offers medical support in the context of policy enforcement.
Witness	An individual who has information relevant to the investigation of a reported incident.
Zero Tolerance	The policy of not tolerating any instances of sexual misconduct, with a commitment to promptly address all reports.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines and Other Resources:

Prompt reporting of sexual misconduct is crucial in enabling the university to respond effectively. All members of the community, including students, faculty, staff, and visitors, who have been subjected to, witnessed, or become aware of an incident that may constitute sexual misconduct should report the incident as per the guidelines set forth in this policy.

Reporting Channels

AUS offers multiple channels to ensure that reporting is accessible, secure, and respectful of the

confidentiality and dignity of all individuals involved:

- **Online Reporting Portal:** An anonymous report can be submitted via the AUS Advocate Report Center at https://aus-advocate.symplicity.com/public_report/.
- **Email:** The Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) Office can be reached via dedicated email at reachout@aus.edu.
- **Hotline Numbers:** For timely response and support, individuals may contact SCCR at 050 463 9091, or alternatively call 06 515 2250/2740/2785.
- **In-Person Reporting:** Individuals wishing to make a report in person may visit the SCCR Office. Locations and business hours can be found on the university website and in the *Student Handbook*.
- **Confidential Advisors:** Reporting parties may also seek confidential guidance from designated advisors who can assist with making a formal report while discussing available resources and options. The SCCR team will serve as designated advisors.
- Off-Campus sexual misconduct incidents can be reported at https://aus-advocate.symplicity.com/public_report/.
- The university will be limited in its investigation in such cases and will provide options for students to report to the lawful authorities. (Note: If the complainant or witnesses were under the influence of alcohol or controlled or non-prescribed substances during the sexual misconduct, no immunity will be offered for violating other conduct policies.)
- **Reporting Procedures**
- The effectiveness and integrity of the reporting process are paramount:
- **Initial Reporting:** Upon receipt of a report, Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) will conduct a preliminary assessment to determine the appropriate response. If immediate risks are identified, the priority shall be to address these risks swiftly.
- **Medical Evaluation and Safety Assessment:** In cases involving immediate harm or jeopardy to a student's health or safety, the university will facilitate urgent medical attention and address any ongoing risks to the complainant, respondent, or the wider university community.
- **Privacy and Confidentiality:** All reports will be handled discreetly, ensuring the privacy of the reporting party to the extent possible while balancing the need to investigate and address the report.
- **Timeliness:** Reports are encouraged to be filed within ten working days of the incident to ensure the effectiveness of the investigation. However, the University also acknowledges that extenuating circumstances may prevent timely reporting. In such cases, individuals are still urged to report incidents as soon as they are able to, preferably no later than 30 days, however this is outside the recommended timeframe.
- **Assessment and Next Steps:** Each report will be reviewed by the SCCR to determine the need for a formal investigation, interim protective measures, and/or any other necessary initial responses.
- **Formal Investigation:** If an investigation is warranted, the SCCR will inform the concerned parties and begin an investigative process that is thorough, impartial, and respects the rights of all involved.
- **Interim Measures:** To ensure the safety and well-being of all parties during an investigation, AUS may implement interim measures such as no-contact orders, academic accommodations, new housing arrangements, or course schedule adjustments.
- **Resource and Support:** At the time of reporting, the complainant and the respondent of sexual misconduct will be provided with information about available resources including health services, counseling, and support for academic concerns.
- **Retaliation Prohibited:** It is a violation of University policy to retaliate against anyone for making a report of sexual misconduct or cooperating with an investigation. Any retaliatory behavior should be reported immediately and will be subject to disciplinary action.
- **Rights of the Parties:** The complainant and the respondent will be informed of their rights under the policy, including the right to be accompanied by an advisor from the SCCR office of their choice present during interviews, choice during proceedings and meetings related to the report. Parents, family members, advisors or legal counsel are not permitted at any point during the conduct inquiry or adjudication process.
- AUS is committed to an environment where sexual misconduct is not tolerated and strives to ensure that all allegations are handled with the seriousness and attention they warrant. The

reporting procedures exist to empower individuals to step forward with confidence that their concerns will be addressed in a supportive and responsive manner. Violation(s) of any other Student Conduct Policies, other than Sexual Misconduct reported will be subject to disciplinary procedures.

Investigation Procedures

To uphold the integrity of American University of Sharjah's commitment to maintaining a campus environment free of sexual misconduct, meticulous investigation procedures are in place. These procedures ensure a thorough, unbiased examination of reports while providing necessary protections for all parties involved.

Upon the receipt of a sexual misconduct report, the following investigation steps are enacted:

- **Initiation of Investigation:** The Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution (SCCR) office will initiate an investigation, communicating transparently with both the complainant and the respondent about the process and their rights.
- **Selection of Investigator(s):** The SCCR will appoint trained and impartial investigator(s) to manage the fact-finding mission. This may include SCCR staff or external professionals from the institution, depending on the complexity and nature of the case.
- **Evidence Gathering:** Investigators will gather relevant information, including statements from the complainant, respondent, and witnesses. They will also review any physical, digital, or documentary evidence.
- **Interviews:** All parties involved will have the opportunity to be heard, to present witnesses and evidence, and to have an advisor from the SCCR office of their choice present during interviews. All interviews will be conducted with care and sensitivity to the welfare of the participants. Interviews will be recorded.
- **Review of Findings:** Once the investigation is complete, a detailed review of the findings will be undertaken in accordance with AUS's guidelines for adjudicating alleged sexual misconduct.
- **Decision Process:** Investigators will compile a comprehensive report summarizing the evidence and decide whether any sections of the sexual misconduct policy were violated.
- **Transparency and Updates:** Throughout the investigation, all parties will be kept informed of the progress and any developments linked to their case, adhering to confidentiality requirements.
- **Final Report:** At the conclusion of the investigation, a final report will be communicated to both the complainant and the respondent, outlining the findings and the rationale for the conclusion drawn.
- **Sanction and Appeal:** Should the investigation conclude that misconduct occurred, appropriate sanctions will be imposed. Both parties will be informed of the appeals process should they object to the findings or sanctions.

Student conduct and conflict resolution processing

- SCCR to ask for as many details and information as possible from the complainant or the witness.
- SCCR to consider the expectations of the complainant. SCCR will consider the circumstances, such as whether the student might want the matter to be resolved informally and discreetly or expects the matter to be referred to a hearing board and decide on appropriate action.
- SCCR to execute AUS punitive measures as per the matrix listed on this policy.
- In all the above stages, SCCR informs the Executive Director of Student Experience and the Chief of Protocol and Safety of the complaint and its progress.

Sexual Misconduct Committee

Sexual Misconduct Committee Representatives:

- Executive Director of Student Experience (Chair)
- Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution Senior Manager (Co Chair)
- Human Resources Representative (If a faculty/staff member is involved)
- Faculty Representative
- Office of Protocol Representative

- University Health Service Representative
- Student Residential Life Representative (If resident student)
- Administrative Staff (for minutes)

Sexual Misconduct Committee Representative Shall:

- Serve for the duration of one academic year.
- Represent their department on the committee.
- Be available for the scheduled hearing sessions.
- Be responsible for investigating, listening, evaluating, and acting on alleged reports of student misconduct when the respondents are both students.
- Recommend actions against the responsible student. Maintain strict confidentiality to protect the interests of those involved in the proceedings.
- Disclose any potential conflicts of interest that may arise in the course of their duties, particularly if they have personal relationships with any involved parties or if they have a vested interest in the outcome of a case. In the event of a conflict of interest, the representative shall recuse themselves from the proceedings to ensure impartiality and fairness.

Sexual Misconduct Committee (SMC) Procedure

- A sexual misconduct incident should be reported in writing within 10 working days of the incident.
- In case a sexual misconduct incident is reported to any other party other than SCCR, the receiver must report the incident to the SCCR and follow the regular outlined procedure.
- The complaint student will not reach the committee for hearing unless the Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution determines that there is a violation of the policy.
- An SCCR representative will organize a hearing session in coordination with SMC representatives.
- The Chair will proceed with the hearing upon the availability of at least five members of the committee.
- The committee will listen to both the parties during separate hearing sessions held at different times.
- All conversations during the hearing session will be recorded, and evidence submitted in any form (physical or electronic) will be archived.
- Witnesses and evidence will be examined and cross examined by the committee.
- At its discretion, the committee may seek additional information about the report from third parties.
- The committee will determine whether an act of sexual misconduct has occurred.
- After deliberating, the committee will determine the responsible party and recommend appropriate action.
- The recommendation of the committee would be based on a common consensus or upon agreement of a majority.
- The Chair will convey the committee recommendations to the Chancellor.
- The Chancellor may request further clarifications from the Chair.
- The final action will be conveyed in writing by the Sexual Misconduct Committee to the student found responsible.
- If either the compliant or respondent is not satisfied with the Committee's decision, either can appeal to the University Appellate Committee in writing within seven working days of receiving the final decision.
- The Co-Chair will share information with the Appellate Committee and respond to their queries. The Appellate Committee will forward their recommendations to the Chancellor to

make a final decision on the recommendation.

- All conversations during the hearing session will be recorded, and evidence submitted in any form (physical or electronic) will be archived.
- Witnesses and evidence will be examined and cross examined by the committee.
- At its discretion, the committee may seek additional information about the report from third parties.
- The committee will determine whether an act of sexual misconduct has occurred.
- After deliberating, the committee will determine the responsible party and recommend appropriate action.
- The recommendation of the committee would be based on a common consensus or upon agreement of a majority.
- The Chair will convey the committee recommendations to the Chancellor.
- The Chancellor may request further clarifications from the Chair.
- The final action will be conveyed in writing by the Sexual Misconduct Committee to the student found responsible.
- If either the compliant or respondent is not satisfied with the Committee's decision, either can appeal to the University Appellate Committee in writing within seven working days of receiving the final decision.

Appeal Process

- The Co-Chair will share information with the Appellate Committee and respond to their queries. The Appellate Committee will forward their recommendations to the Chancellor to make a final decision on the recommendation.
- In the outcome letter of Suspension, Dismissal or Final Warning that comes out of a sexual misconduct committee, the student is informed of the appeal process in person and in the letter.
- Conduct actions may be appealed in keeping with the following provisions:
- Respondents may appeal any conduct that resulted in a sanction of disciplinary/conduct probation, removal from university housing, suspension, or dismissal.
- An appeal must be emailed to the University Appellate Committee at UACSC@aus.edu within seven working days after date of notice. In instances of dismissal from the University, Senior Manager–Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution will forward the case to the Appellate Board and notify the student.
- Appeals will be reviewed by an Appellate Board of the CCHB and will consist of five members who did not serve on the original hearing panel.
- The Appellate Board will determine the appeal's viability based on whether there is new information that significantly alters the face of facts stated earlier, evidence of improper procedure, findings that are against the weight of evidence or excessive sanctions.
- The Appellate Board may deny the request for appeal and affirm the original findings of the CCHB or grant the request for an appeal and forward its recommendations to the Chancellor.
- The following standards will apply when appeals are considered by the Chancellor: a. Sanctions may be increased or decreased if found to be substantially disproportionate to the offense. b. Cases may be remanded for rehearing by the CCHB if specified procedural errors or errors in interpretation of university regulations were so substantial as to deny the respondent (or complainant) a fair hearing, or if new and significant evidence becomes available that could not have been discovered before or during the original hearing. c. Cases may be dismissed if the finding is deemed to be unsupported by the evidence.
- The minutes recorded and available evidence will be archived by Student Affairs for five consecutive years on the Student Infraction Management System.

- An annual Sexual Misconduct Committee report will be sent to the Chancellor by the Chair.

Obligations of the Sexual Misconduct Committee

- The committee shall not discuss or review matters under consideration outside of the hearing session. Failure of a committee member to uphold this provision renders such member subject to impeachment procedures by the Sexual Misconduct Committee. Impeachment shall be by majority verdict of that committee.
- No member of the committee shall attend the hearing if they know or have a relationship with the student. (Ethical Standards)

Recommendation After Going Through the Documentation and Evidence Presented.

The Committee may recommend many actions. These include, but are not limited to the following actions:

- Meeting the complainant and respondent
- In case of misunderstandings, referring the case for mediation or counseling
- Limiting future contact between the complainant (Or witness) and the respondent
- Recommending sanctions as listed in the *Student Handbook*, in the Non- Compliance with Policy Section.
- In case a student complainant provides false information, he/she will be referred to SCCR to conduct proceedings for misleading SMC.

Confidentiality of Reports

All reports of sexual misconduct will be handled confidentially. All the SMC hearing sessions will be recorded and stored in the Student Affairs archive under strictest confidentiality for five consecutive years.

Complainant Protection

Ensuring the protection and support of a complainant of sexual misconduct is a critical aspect of AUS's response:

- **Complaint Withdrawal:** The SCCR will provide the complainant with an explanation of the sexual assault procedure, and the complainant retains the right to withdraw their complaint at any point before the committee reaches a final decision. This measure aims to prevent the complainant from being influenced by the respondent or withdrawing their complaint out of compassion.
- **Safety Measures:** Immediate steps will be taken to protect the complainant, including but not limited to no-contact orders, alterations to housing or class schedules, or adjustments to work assignments.
- **Confidentiality:** To the greatest degree possible, the privacy of the complainant and the confidentiality of the case will be maintained throughout the investigation and subsequent proceedings.
- **Support Services:** Complainants have access to comprehensive support services, such as counseling, health care, and academic assistance, to ensure their well-being and to facilitate their continued participation in university life.
- **Avoiding Retaliation:** The university strongly prohibits any form of retaliation against individuals who report sexual misconduct or participate in investigations. Measures will be taken to monitor and protect against retaliatory acts.
- **Accommodations:** The university will work with the complainant to identify and provide reasonable accommodations to ensure their safety and comfort on campus.
- **Education and Training:** Ongoing education and training will be provided to all university members to ensure awareness of rights, resources, and responsibilities with regards to preventing and responding to sexual misconduct. Bystander Intervention, Awareness around Community Policies including Sexual Misconduct are provided for students and community

through Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution.

American University of Sharjah is committed to a proactive and compassionate approach to addressing all reports of sexual misconduct. The investigation procedures are crafted to safeguard the rights of all community members while promoting a culture of accountability and respect.

Disciplinary Measures

American University of Sharjah (AUS) upholds a zero-tolerance stance on sexual misconduct, and this is rigorously reflected in the disciplinary measures applied in cases where a policy violation is determined. This chapter outlines the disciplinary consequences imposed by the university, as well as potential legal ramifications in accordance with local laws.

Following a thorough investigation and upon the conclusion that a sexual misconduct violation has occurred, AUS will impose disciplinary measures that are commensurate with the severity of the offense and any previous violations. These measures are intended to enforce accountability, prevent recurrence, and ensure the safety of the AUS community.

Disciplinary measures may include but are not limited to:

Warning: A formal reprimand that the conduct was unacceptable and must not recur.

Probation: A period during which any further violation will result in more severe disciplinary action.

Counseling: Mandatory participation in counseling sessions to address behavior and prevent future misconduct.

No-Contact Orders: Restrictions on contacting the complainant or other relevant parties.

Suspension: Temporary removal from the university with conditions set for potential future re-enrollment.

Expulsion: Permanent dismissal from the university.

Loss of Privilege(s): A prohibition from university property and events.

Notation on Transcript: An entry made on the student's transcript indicating the nature of the violation.

As stated in the American Association of Collegiate Registrars and Admissions Officers (AACRAO) guidance for members, the academic transcript is an appropriate means to support communication about serious student misconduct. A student's standing that impacts his or her eligibility to continuously enroll at an institution affects academic progress and, for this reason, is deemed transcript appropriate.

In cases of suspension (temporary separation from the university) or dismissal (permanent separation from the university), transcript notations should include the following:

- the general type of infraction (academic or disciplinary).
- the department responsible for issuing the student's separation from the
- institution (the transcript legend will be amended accordingly).
- effective dates or date/term ranges of the student's separation from the
- university, if applicable.

While an investigation or hearing is planned or underway, a "Pending Conduct Investigation" statement will be recorded on the transcript. The standard suspension/dismissal notation will replace this statement if the student is found in violation of the code and that special statement will be removed if the student is found to not be in violation.

Transcript notation should be placed at the end of the semester/term in which the sanction occurs. Transcript legends (back side of transcript) will offer further explanation, as needed, and provide the reader with instructions on how/where to obtain additional information.

Every decision about disciplinary measures will be made based on the specifics of the case, considering

the context, and adhering to AUS procedures and standards.

AUS' S Punitive Measures

The university's punitive measures are not only corrective but also educative, aiming to reaffirm the values of respect and safety that define the AUS community. Any actions taken by the university will be in alignment with its dedication to upholding a safe, inclusive, and equitable learning environment for all.

Policy on Sexual Misconduct	Level of Offense	Process	Sanction (Sanctions will be based on the findings, and adhere to section 2.10 Evidence and Burden of Proof, <i>Student Handbook 2023-24</i>)	Parental Notification
Sexual Harassment:				
Unwelcome sexual advances, requests for sexual favors and other verbal or physical conduct of a sexual nature. Examples include but are not limited to: i. Insinuate, propose or demand sexual favors of any kind. ii. Invade another person's personal space (e.g., inappropriate touching.) iii. Stalk, intimidate, coerce, or threaten another person to get him/her to engage in sexual acts. iv. Comment on someone's looks, dress, sexuality or gender in a derogatory or objectifying manner or a manner that makes them uncomfortable. v. Make obscene comments, jokes or gestures that humiliate or offend someone. vi. Forcing the complainant and tricking into filming self and sending the pictures to the respondent.	First Offense	1. SCCR investigation, evidence collection, report alleged charge and make a recommendation of sanction(s) to EDSE. 2. Counseling referral 3. Sexual Misconduct Committee (SMC) hearing referral	No contact contract with terms and conditions for both complainant and respondent And Final Warning with Conduct Probation for one academic year	Parents will be notified of Final Warning/ Suspension and Dismissal
			Immediate Suspension (until the outcome of the SMC hearing if complainant is harmed or respondent is egregious)	
			Suspension for one academic year with Transcript Notation	
			Suspension for one academic year with Transcript Notation or Dismissal with transcript notation	
	Second Offense			
Sexual Assault:				
Any sexual contact, including but not limited to attempted or completed rape, sexual battery, and sexual coercion. (Examples include but are not limited to: i. intentionally touching any body part ii. forcing into oral sex)	First and Final Offense		No-contact contract with terms and conditions for both complainant and respondent. Interim Suspension until the finalization of sanctions. Suspension for one academic year with Transcript Notation or Permanent Dismissal with transcript notation	
Sexual Exploitation:				
Taking advantage of a person's vulnerability or power imbalance to engage in sexual activity.	First and Final Offense		Permanent Dismissal with transcript notation	
Sexual Intimidation:				

Creating a hostile or offensive environment through unwelcome sexual conduct. Examples include but are not limited to i. Sending or displaying sexually explicit objects or messages. ii. Pursuing or flirting with another person persistently without the other person's willing participation. Also, flirting with someone at an inappropriate time (e.g., in a team meeting) iii. Constant requests for name and phone number iv. Indecent exposure defined as the exposure of the private or intimate parts of the body in a lewd manner, in public or in private premises, when the accused may be readily observed.	First Offense		No-contact contract with terms and conditions for both complainant and respondent And/or 1. Final warning with conduct probation, community service, punitive fines, loss of privileges; or reflection paper and parental notification
			Immediate Suspension (until the outcome of the SMC hearing if complainant is harmed or respondent is egregious)
			Suspension for one academic year with Transcript Notation
	Second Offense		Dismissal with transcript notation
Off Campus Incident of Sexual Misconduct Acts falling under any of the above category reported at any given time.	SCCR will have limited access to information and evidence off campus.	University-designated officials will support the complainant to press charges with lawful authorities. Note: Medical charges and expenses for legal processes will be borne by the complainant.	No-contact contract for both Complainant and Respondent

Legal Consequences

In cases where sexual misconduct may constitute a criminal offense, complainants have the option to pursue legal avenues in addition to or instead of the university's internal process. The university recognizes its responsibility to comply with the law and will cooperate with law enforcement authorities as required.

Legal consequences for offending parties may include:

- **Criminal Charges:** Respondents may face charges under applicable criminal laws, leading to arrest, prosecution, and, if found guilty, penalties including fines and imprisonment.
- **Civil Actions:** Victims may seek damages through civil lawsuits against the perpetrator and, in certain cases, against the university if it is found negligent in preventing or responding to the misconduct.
- **Long-Term Repercussions:** Legal findings of sexual misconduct can have long-lasting impacts on future employment, education, personal relationships, and community standing.

AUS emphasizes that adherence to the law and respect for human dignity are cornerstones of the community's collective ethos. Affected parties are encouraged to utilize all the resources and support systems the university provides throughout the legal process, and the university undertakes to facilitate this engagement with external legal entities while respecting the autonomy and choices of the complainant.

Support Services

American University of Sharjah (AUS) recognizes that individuals affected by sexual misconduct require a network of comprehensive support services. AUS provides assistance that is readily accessible and sensitive to the needs of survivors and those impacted. These services aim to ensure that individuals have the support necessary to recover and continue their academic or professional pursuits.

Types of Support Services

AUS offers a variety of support services tailored to address the physical, emotional, academic, and legal needs of those who have experienced sexual misconduct.

- **Counseling Services:** Confidential psychological support and counseling sessions facilitated by licensed professionals who are trained to assist survivors of sexual misconduct.
- **Medical Services:** Access to medical care, which includes treatment and documentation of injuries, STI testing, pregnancy tests, and other related health services provided by University Health Services (UHS) or affiliated health facilities.
- **Academic Accommodations:** Adjustments to academic workload, extensions on assignments, or changes in class schedules, when appropriate, to lessen the educational impact on the survivor.
- **Housing Accommodations:** Temporary or permanent housing changes to ensure the survivor feels safe and secure in their living environment.
- **Legal Advocacy and Assistance:** Guidance in understanding legal options, support during legal proceedings, and liaison with law enforcement if a survivor chooses to pursue legal action.
- **Student Emergency Fund:** A fund dedicated to support students during unforeseen situations.

Accessing Support Services

Accessing the support services at AUS is designed to be straightforward and free of unnecessary obstacles.

- **Immediate Assistance:** In the event of an emergency or immediate need, individuals can contact the campus emergency number or visit the UHS for prompt attention.
- **Counseling and Health Appointments:** Students can set up appointments with counseling and health services directly. Information on how to make these appointments is available through the AUS website, in student and employee handbooks, and advertised around campus.
- **Coordination with SCCR:** The Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution office serves as a hub for information on all available support services and can help coordinate access to various resources.
- **Ongoing Support:** For longer-term needs, individuals are encouraged to maintain contact with support services. Counseling and UHS can provide or recommend continuous support options, including therapy or support groups.
- **Confidentiality:** All support services maintain the highest level of confidentiality permissible by law. Information will only be disclosed with the explicit consent of the individual, except in circumstances where there is an imminent threat to health or safety.
- **Advocacy Services:** Advocates from within or outside the university are accessible to assist individuals in navigating the various support services and administrative processes related to incident reporting and recovery.

It is a top priority for AUS that every member of the community has the necessary tools and resources to address and heal from the impact of sexual misconduct. The university is steadfast in its commitment to provide compassionate, comprehensive, and accessible support services to all those in need.

Prevention Measures

American University of Sharjah (AUS) proactively seeks to prevent incidents of sexual misconduct through a series of well-designed, preventive measures. Through awareness programs, staff training, and ethical policies, AUS aims to create a campus culture where sexual misconduct is recognized, deterred, and acted against decisively. This chapter outlines the prevention measures that are central to ensuring a safe environment for all.

Faculty and Staff Awareness on Reporting

Comprehensive and ongoing awareness for staff is key to upholding the values and safety protocols of AUS. This includes:

- email communication for all faculty and staff that cover identification, response, and reporting of sexual misconduct.
- specialized training for those directly involved in handling reports and investigations, such as members of the SCCR, UHS, and Campus Security.
- bystander intervention training for faculty, staff, and student leaders to provide them with tools to safely intervene in situations that could lead to sexual misconduct.

Ethical Policies and Rules

Establishing clear, ethical standards is critical to prevention efforts. This includes:

- a Code of Conduct embedded in the university's academic and employment guidelines that outlines acceptable behaviors and the consequences of misconduct.
- a clear statement articulating the zero-tolerance policy against sexual misconduct in handbooks, syllabi, and on the university website.
- safe channels for reporting and a no-retaliation policy that encourages individuals to come forward with concerns without fear of adverse consequences.
- regular reviews and updates to policies and rules to ensure they remain effective and reflect current legal and ethical standards.

AUS is dedicated to a comprehensive approach to prevention, with clear expectations, robust support, and regular evaluation to ensure the effectiveness of these measures. It is only through community engagement and commitment that a culture of prevention and safety can truly thrive.

Ensuring Confidentiality and Privacy

Ensuring confidentiality and privacy is paramount in creating an environment where individuals feel secure to report incidents of sexual misconduct. American University of Sharjah (AUS) is committed to preserving the dignity of all parties involved and fostering trust in its processes. This chapter details AUS's commitment and procedures to protect sensitive information and to support complainants.

AUS recognizes the sensitive nature of sexual misconduct cases and ensures the following:

- **Limited Disclosure:** Information about sexual misconduct reports and investigations will be accessible only to individuals who need to know for the purpose of investigation and resolution, as per university policy and applicable laws.
- **Training on Confidentiality:** All university officials involved in the handling of sexual misconduct cases receive specialized training on confidentiality protocols to safeguard the information entrusted to them.
- **Secure Record Keeping:** Documentation related to reports and investigations will be kept in secure systems with restricted access. Physical documents will be stored in locked cabinets in secure locations.
- **Communication Protocols:** When communicating about cases, minimal identifiers will be used. Communications will be conducted through secure means, and discretion will be observed in verbal discussions.
- **Anonymous Reporting:** Anonymous complaints delay investigations and make it difficult to establish legitimacy of the concerns. It also limits the outcome of the investigation.

Supports For Complainants

The university ensures that complainants are supported throughout the reporting and investigation process:

- **Confidential Resources:** Complainants have access to designated professionals who can provide confidential support and guidance without the information being disclosed to the investigative team or others against the complainant's wishes.
- **Respecting Wishes:** The decision to pursue formal action remains with the complainant, and the university respects his or her autonomy in the decision-making process, provided it does not conflict with the university's obligation to provide a safe environment for all.
- **Advisory Services:** Complainants are allowed to have an advisor of their choice present during meetings and proceedings related to their case to provide support and advice.
- **Protective Measures:** The university offers protective measures such as academic accommodations, housing modifications, and no-contact orders even if the complainant chooses not to pursue a formal complaint.
- **Retaliation Prevention:** Measures are in place to protect complainants, witnesses, and other parties from retaliation because of their reporting or participation in the process.

AUS is unwavering in its support for complainants, ensuring that all steps in the reporting, investigation, and resolution processes respect the privacy and choices of the individual, in accordance with the policy outlined within this document. Moreover, AUS is proactive in creating an environment where the privacy and confidentiality of all community members are of the utmost priority. These efforts collectively contribute to AUS's overarching goal of maintaining a campus where trust, safety, and respect are integral to the university's culture.

Policy Evaluation

To ensure the ongoing relevance, effectiveness, and responsiveness of the Sexual Misconduct Policy, American University of Sharjah (AUS) commits to a process of regular policy evaluation. This process is essential to maintaining the highest standards of protection for all community members.

The evaluation process includes the following key components:

- **Regular Review Cycle:** AUS will establish a schedule for periodic policy reviews every 2 years, ensuring that the Sexual Misconduct Policy remains current with evolving legal requirements, educational standards, and best practices.
- **Stakeholder Feedback:** Input from a broad range of community members, including students, faculty, staff, and external consultants, will be sought to assess the policy's clarity, accessibility, and effectiveness.
- **Effectiveness Metrics:** Data on reporting rates, outcomes of cases, and feedback from individuals involved in investigations will inform the policy's effectiveness in addressing sexual misconduct, supporting individuals, and deterring future incidents.
- **Transparency and Reporting:** The conclusions of the policy evaluations, and any forthcoming policy modifications, will be communicated transparently to the university community to maintain trust and accountability.

Through this ongoing evaluation framework, AUS demonstrates its dedication to creating and upholding a Sexual Misconduct Policy that not only reflects its values but also protects its community members with diligence and integrity.

Crisis Intervention

Recognizing the critical importance of swift and empathetic response in the aftermath of a sexual misconduct incident, American University of Sharjah (AUS) has meticulously developed its crisis intervention protocols. These protocols prioritize the immediate safety, medical, and emotional needs of the affected individuals.

Crisis intervention at AUS is designed to provide a comprehensive and immediate response to incidents of sexual misconduct:

- **Emergency Response:** AUS provides a 24-hour emergency contact number for immediate crisis assistance. Trained personnel handle calls with sensitivity and dispatch appropriate support quickly.
- **Counseling Support:** Immediate psychological support is available for complainant of sexual misconduct. The university offers access to confidential counselors who are specially trained in crisis intervention.

- **Advocate Support:** AUS ensures that specially trained advocates are available to support the complainant through the initial crisis period. The advocates guide individuals through their options, accompany them to necessary appointments, and serve as their liaison with university services and external organizations.
- **Safe Space:** The university will provide a secure and private location where individuals affected by sexual misconduct can receive services and discuss their situation in a confidential setting.
- **Coordination with Local Authorities:** Should the complainant choose to involve law enforcement; the university will facilitate this process and provide coordination with local authorities.
- **A dedicated Support Staff from SCCR or RHC** (in case the student is a resident at the halls) to aid the student with the process to file an incident report.

Medical Response

In the event of a sexual misconduct crisis, the medical needs of the complainant are of utmost priority:

- **Immediate Medical Care:** AUS's University Health Services (UHS) or partner healthcare facilities are prepared to provide immediate, comprehensive medical attention to those who have experienced sexual misconduct.
- **Evidence Collection:** In cases where the complainant consents, medical personnel are trained to conduct forensic examinations that preserve evidence, which can be critical in subsequent investigations or legal proceedings.
- **Follow-Up Care:** Beyond immediate medical attention, ongoing medical care and support will be made available to address any long-term health concerns related to the incident.
- **Confidentiality in Care:** All medical care will be provided with the highest regard for patient confidentiality, and information will only be disclosed with the consent of the individual, except where disclosure is required by law.

Through its crisis intervention and medical response protocols, AUS commits itself to prioritizing the well-being of its community members and providing the necessary support services swiftly and compassionately during times of need.

Crisis Intervention and Counseling

In the unfortunate event of a sexual misconduct incident, American University of Sharjah (AUS) recognizes the critical need to provide immediate, supportive, and confidential assistance to the

affected individuals. Crisis intervention and counseling services are key components of the university's comprehensive approach to dealing with sexual misconduct.

These efforts are centered around the physical safety, mental health, and overall well-being of survivors.

The university is committed to ensuring the health, safety, and well-being of its community members. AUS has a Medico-Legal Policy which outlines procedures for handling medico- legal cases on campus, integrating medical response, legal considerations, and support services.

The AUS crisis intervention and counseling framework is designed to address immediate and long-term needs:

- **Immediate Crisis Response:** Trained crisis responders are available around the clock to provide immediate assistance. This team is prepared to handle the emotional, psychological, and physical needs that arise in the aftermath of an incident.
- **Counseling Services:** AUS offers access to on-campus and off-campus professionals trained in trauma-informed care and counseling for survivors of sexual violence. Services include individual counseling, group therapy, and referrals to external mental health resources.
- **Confidentiality in Counseling:** Counseling services maintain the utmost respect for the privacy of the individual. Conversations with counselors are kept confidential, providing a safe space for survivors to express themselves and receive support without concern for the information being shared beyond the counseling session, unless there is an immediate risk to the individual or the community.
- **Immediate Protective Measures:** Complainant and respondent are provided with

information and assistance in accessing protective measures, such as changes in academic, living, transportation, and working situations if requested and reasonably available.

Advocacy and Support: Complainant and respondent have access to advocates who provide emotional support, assist with navigating university and legal systems, and empower complainant(s) to make informed decisions about their care and participation in university proceedings.

- **Ongoing Support:** Recognizing that recovery from trauma is a process that often requires continued support, AUS commits to offering long-term resources and referrals to help survivors manage the impact of sexual misconduct on their lives.

AUS endeavors to provide a holistic approach to intervention and counseling services, ensuring that members of the AUS community have ready access to the assistance they need in difficult times. By doing so, AUS affirms its commitment to a caring and responsive campus culture.

Documentation And Record-Keeping

Accurate and confidential documentation and record-keeping are essential aspects of American University of Sharjah's (AUS) response to sexual misconduct. These practices are critical for preserving the integrity of the investigative process, enforcing accountability, and maintaining a historical record for policy evaluation and legal compliance.

- **Incident Reports:** All reports of sexual misconduct will be documented in a secure and confidential manner immediately upon receipt of the report.
- **Investigation Records:** Detailed records of each step in the investigation process, including interviews, statements, and evidence, will be maintained.
- **Privacy Protection:** Documentation will contain only necessary personal information, and access to these documents will be strictly controlled.
- **Storage and Security:** All records will be stored in a secure manner, protected from unauthorized access, and maintained for a period as mandated by law and university policy.
- **Retention Schedule:** The university will adhere to a retention schedule that complies with AUS requirements and best practices in data storage and privacy.
- **Access and Disclosure:** Access to records will be granted only to authorized personnel, and the university will ensure compliance with applicable privacy laws and regulations regarding any disclosure of records.

The procedures and guidelines for documentation and record-keeping at AUS are designed to uphold the principles of respect, integrity, and confidentiality while ensuring that the university can meet its legal and administrative responsibilities.

Confidentiality

Maintaining confidentiality is a cornerstone of AUS's commitment to providing a supportive environment for individuals impacted by sexual misconduct.

- **Confidentiality Assurance:** AUS will assure all parties involved in a sexual misconduct report that their privacy will be protected to the greatest extent possible.
- **Information Sharing:** Limited sharing of information will be conducted on a need-to-know basis, seeking to balance the interests of confidentiality with those of justice and safety. The complainant and respondent will provide their consent to the university whether information can be shared with their parents.
- **Confidential Resources:** The university will clearly identify confidential resources on campus for those seeking advice and support without triggering formal university action.
- AUS is dedicated to maintaining the confidentiality and privacy of all individuals involved in incidents of sexual misconduct, creating trust in the procedures, and offering a protective environment to report and discuss such sensitive matters.

Legal Protocols

AUS operates within a framework of local, federal, and international laws, ensuring that its policies and procedures regarding sexual misconduct align with legal standards and obligations.

- **Compliance:** AUS ensures that its policies comply with the pertinent jurisdictional laws and

legislative requirements that govern conduct and response to sexual misconduct.

- **Cooperation with Law Enforcement:** When a report involves potential criminal conduct, AUS will cooperate with law enforcement in accordance with legal mandates and institutional policies.
- **Legal Support and Navigation:** The university will provide guidance and resources to help affected individuals understand their legal rights and the legal processes available to them, both within and outside the AUS community.
- **Due Process:** In all its actions and proceedings, AUS will strive to ensure fairness and due process for all parties involved in a report of sexual misconduct.
- **Regular Legal Review:** The Sexual Misconduct Policy, along with its procedures, will regularly be reviewed and revised as necessary to ensure compliance with evolving legal standards and best practices.

Through adherence to these legal protocols, AUS reaffirms its commitment to a just and lawful response to sexual misconduct, ensuring that its campus remains a secure and respectful environment for education and personal.

Communication Protocols

Effective communication is an integral part of American University of Sharjah's (AUS) approach to managing incidents of sexual misconduct. Clear, timely, and sensitive communication protocols are essential to maintain transparency, ensure confidentiality, and provide support. This chapter outlines the various stages of communication that are integral throughout the process of reporting, assessing, and responding to sexual misconduct incidents within the AUS community.

Reporting and Initial Assessment

- Notification of receipt of a report to be communicated swiftly to the complainant.
- Preliminary assessment outcome and next steps communicated to involved parties.

Medical Evaluation

- Clear instructions provided to survivors for accessing medical evaluations.
- Information about confidentiality and the option for forensic evidence collection conveyed.

Legal Review

- Parties informed about the option for legal review and rights to pursue criminal justice remedies.
- Explanation of the implications of parallel legal proceedings on university processes.

University Sexual Misconduct Committee

- Process and timeline for the university's Sexual Misconduct Committee's assessment communicated to all relevant parties.
- Opportunity provided for parties to submit questions or requests for clarification to the committee.

Return to University

- Formal communication regarding status or conditions for return to university responsibilities or activities after an imposed absence or suspension.

Ongoing Support

- Information about available ongoing support services communicated regularly to affected parties.
- Open lines of communication maintained for individuals to request additional support.

Regular Follow-Up

- Systematic follow-ups to ascertain the well-being of involved parties and to offer additional resources or adjustments to support measures.

Confidentiality

- Reminders of confidentiality protocols regularly communicated to involved parties and those in the know.
- Reinforcement of the consequences of breaching confidentiality

Compliance

- Regular dissemination of information on policy adherence and any changes in regulatory requirements communicated to the university community.

Documentation

- Protocols for the creation, access, retention, and destruction of documents outlined to involved parties.
- Assurance provided that all documentation will be handled per the highest standards of privacy.

Appeals Process

- Information regarding the right to appeal, including the process, deadlines, and basis for appeal, clearly communicated following outcomes. The University's Appellate Committee will review appeals on grounds of excessive sanction, improper procedure or new information if found after the decision is made.

Effective Date

- Communication of the effective date of the policy and any amendments to all university members, ensuring clear understanding of the current protocols and expectations.

The communication protocols as established by AUS are designed to facilitate a process that is respectful, transparent, and supportive from the moment a report is made, through the investigative and resolution processes, and beyond. They illustrate the university's commitment to upholding the values of integrity, respect, and fairness throughout all stages of managing sexual misconduct cases.

9. Policy History

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 5, 2024	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Chancellor	06-5152204	chancellor@aus.edu
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	06-5152162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Senior Manager-Student Conduct and Conflict Resolution	06-5152250	jcoutinho@aus.edu

ac. Student Emergency Fund - Version 1

Policy Number:	0600SE27	Policy Title:	Student Emergency Fund Policy
Prepared By:	One Stop - AUS Solution Center	Issue Date:	May 09, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/One Stop	Effective Date:	May 09, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	May 09, 2026

1. Policy:

AUS student can obtain an emergency assistantship from the University that does not cover tuition fees or dorm fees, it covers unanticipated expenses that may affect the student's during their academic journey due to non-expected emergency circumstances. Examples may include replacing lost items, covering emergency medical costs, meeting safety needs and addressing other individual urgent needs. This assistantship is following particular guidelines and rules (appendix 1).

2. Purpose:

The goal of the AUS Student Emergency Assistance Fund is to provide financial support for AUS students with unanticipated and insurmountable expenses related to emergency situations that may result in students facing financial hardship.

3. Introduction/Background (Optional)

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed):

AUS Student Emergency Assistance Funding, responsibilities, and reporting

- A- The university is to arrange for the budget for the first year. After the first year the Office of Student Affairs should provide a report for the first-year expenditure with recommendations in case of any increase in budget required for the coming year to work on a different path of funding.
- B- The Office of Student Affairs will be responsible to manage this emergency fund following a set of approved rules and regulations.
- C- The Office of Student Affairs will be responsible for reviewing and releasing assistantship fund under the fast-track application/ Tier 1 (appendix 1)
- D- A committee from different departments will review and approve Tier 2 & 3 applications.
- E- All assistantship applications should be documented and reported to the Finance Department. Applications without documentation cannot be approved.
- F- The student should submit a cash receipt to the Office of Student Affairs as a support and confirmation of the assistantship fund expenditures.
- G- The application will be considered closed only after receiving a vendor receipt of expenditure.
- H- A follow-up call or interview will be conducted with the student to ensure their needs have been met satisfactorily.

AUS Student Emergency Assistantship application

- A- An online application on the AUS website available online to be shared with applicants once requested to be filled out by the student (mandatory for all types of assistantship requests)
- B- One stop team members review the application and determine eligibility, application completion and Tier. level
- C- The Executive Director of Student affairs should approve the application online after confirming the availability of funds for all types of applications.
- D- The student should confirm receipt of the fund for all types of applications.

- E- The Finance Department has access to the application once it is initiated by the student until the receipt confirmation.
- F- Without the receipt confirmation and the receipt document, the application will remain in pending status open under the responsibility of the student and the Office of the Student Affairs.
- G- If the student failed to provide the required receipts, he/ she will be banned from getting any future emergency assistance.
- H- Due to the break between semesters, Student Emergency Fund applications are closed during official holidays. Student Emergency Fund awards cannot be distributed after the last day of the semester or session.

Tier 1 Fastrack <u>AED1 to AED 500</u> <u>Processing Time 24 Hours</u>	Tier II (AED 500 to AED 10,000) <u>Processing Time; One Week</u>	Tier III (AED 10,000 and above) <u>Processing Time; Up to Two Weeks</u>
Applying for Tier 1 involves several steps to ensure efficiency and accuracy in this process: 1- Receive Request: The request can be received through multiple channels: - Online form - Email - In-person request (either through the office of the Executive Director of Student Experience or through the One Stop center) - In all cases a standard form shared with the Finance Department should be filled out and submitted, this is to ensure following the audit and compliance regularities. 2- Verify Request Details: - Review and confirm the request to ensure it falls within the allocated funds for student emergencies Tier 1 which is limited to AED 500. - Ensure all necessary information is provided, including the nature of the emergency and any supporting documentation if available (not mandatory for Tier 1) - Determine the urgency of the request and whether immediate action is required. 3- Approval Process: - Depending on the institution policies, obtain approval from the appropriate authority, which is the Executive	Applying for Tier 1 involves several steps to ensure efficiency and accuracy in this process: 1- Receive Request: The request can be received through multiple channels: - Online form - Email - In-person request (either through the office of the Executive Director of Student Experience or through the One Stop center) - In all cases a standard form shared with the Finance Department should be filled out and submitted, this is to ensure following the audit and compliance regularities. 2- Verify Request Details: - Review and confirm the request to ensure it falls within the allocated funds for student emergencies Tier 2 which is capped to AED 10,000. 3- Approval Process: The committee convenes online to assess the application. Following their deliberation, a formal letter is sent to the student with the decision. If the decision is to award the student, the committee chair communicates with the Finance Department to release the amount to the student's bank account.	Applying for Tier 1 involves several steps to ensure efficiency and accuracy in this process: 1- Receive Request: The request can be received through multiple channels: - Online form - Email - In-person request (either through the office of the Executive Director of Student Experience or through the One Stop center) - In all cases a standard form shared with the Finance Department should be filled out and submitted, this is to ensure following the audit and compliance regularities. 2- Verify Request Details: - Review and confirm the request to ensure it falls within the allocated funds for student emergencies Tier 3, which is amount AED 10,000 3- Approval Process: The committee convenes online to assess the application. The committee submits their recommendation to the chancellor. The Chancellor makes the final decision. Chair notifies the student with the decision. If the decision is to award the student, the committee chair communicates with the Finance Department to release the

Director of Student Experience in case of Tier 1. 4- Allocate Resources: - Disbursing funds, coordinating services, or providing support directly. This should be handled directly by the office of student affairs.	A financial hold is imposed on Banner until the student furnishes a receipt. Students must provide a receipt within 5 working days of the emergency. 4- Allocate Resources: - Disbursing funds, coordinating services, or providing support directly. This should be handled directly by the office of student affairs.	amount to the student's bank account. A financial hold is imposed on Banner until the student furnishes a receipt. Student must provide a receipt within 5 working days of the emergency, 4- Allocate Resources: - Disbursing funds, coordinating services, or providing support directly. This should be handled directly by the office of student affairs.
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5. Scope/Applicability:

Student Emergency Fund Eligibility:

Students who are eligible to apply for emergency assistantship are:

- Graduate Students
- Undergraduate Students
- Full time registered students
- IXO students/ if not receiving any type of allowance.

Students who are ineligible to apply for emergency sponsored students, students who received assistantship within the same year. IXO students who are receiving an allowance.

Funding Sources: Allocated budget from the University. In the future, based on the periodical reviews funding sources may extend to include Faculty and Staff donation, AUS Alumni, Donors and Fundraising activities and events.

6. Responsibilities:

Control and compliance.

- A- The Finance Department will maintain a record for all applications through accessing the application forms.
- B- The Finance Department is eligible to ask the student for any additional documentation when required before closing the application.
- C- The Internal audit is eligible to view and review any application when required for the internal audit purposes.

Committee Members

- A- Committee members to be nominated by the related departments and approved by the Chancellor.
 - a. Executive Director of Student Experience (Chair)
 - b. Vice provost of undergraduate affairs (Co-Chair)
 - c. A representative from financial aid.
 - d. A representative from the office of student affairs.
 - e. A representative from UHC (In case of medical scenario)
 - f. A representative from another relevant department that is deemed based on the circumstances of the case.
- B- Any change with committee members should be officially approved and documented.
- C- The committee members are responsible for approving applications.

Custodian of the Fund and Liabilities

- A- The Office of Student affairs is the official custodian of the fund and all transactions upon which should be under their direct control and approval.
- B- The Executive Director of Student affairs can transfer the responsibility of handing the Emergency Assistance Fund to other members of the department upon an official memo shared with the Finance Department.
- C- To duly hand over the cash from the present custodian they go on vacation or is being terminated or has resigned. (Handing over means, tallying the physical cash balance with properly maintained book balance duly signed by the internal auditor approved by the departmental head)

The custodian of the fund has the right to:

- Approve applications under Tier 1 alone.
- Reject any type of application if it does not meet the conditions.
 - Reasons for a Declined Application
 - The situation did not meet the criteria for the current emergency causing financial hardship.
 - Documentation was not submitted,
 - The student is at cost of attendance and not currently eligible to receive Student Emergency Fund support.
- To check the accuracy of the application and the proof of severity needed.
- To ask for further documentation.

The custodian should:

- Have a cash of AED 5,000 under the custodian of the Executive Assistant of the Student Affairs to be used for the FastTrack applications.
- Follow up with the student after releasing the fund to ensure the student's needs have been met satisfactorily.
- Regularly check the availability of funds in case of any emergency application.
- Show the records of the fund maintained to the internal auditor, Financial Controller or to any authorized person(s) as the Controller may be assigned.
- To duly hand over the cash from the present custodian if he/she goes on vacation or is being terminated or has resigned. (Handing over means, tallying the physical cash balance with properly maintained book balance duly signed by the internal auditor approved by the departmental head countersigned by the successor)
- Under no circumstances can an individual use this fund for any other spending channels other than student's assistantship.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Student's Emergency Requests Limits:

A- Fastrack AED1 to AED 500

For applications for AED 500 or less, this will need the Executive Director of Student Affairs or approval only. The department should provide the assistantship immediately upon request no later than 24 hours of receiving the application.

B- AED 500 to AED 10,000

For applications with a limit between AED 500 to AED 10,000. Such requests should be reviewed by the fund committee, investigated if required with a set of documents to be provided by the student as a proof of the emergency severance.

C- AED 10,000 and above

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For applications with a limit of AED 10,000 and above. Such requests should be reviewed by the committee and approved by the Chancellor.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines and Others:

A- Assistantship Amount Criteria

The criteria used to determine the amount of financial assistance awarded to each student is to consider factors such as the:

- Severity of the emergency
- Financial need
- Available funds
- Application date
- Number of previous requests for the same student

B- Tiered Approval System and Limits:

Tiere Limit	Required Approval
1- Tier 1 - Fastrack (AED1 to AED 500)	Approval of the Executive Director of Student Experience
2- Tier 2 - (AED 501 to AED 9,999)	Approval of the committee
3- Tier 3 - (AED 10,000 and above)	Approval of the committee and the AUS Chancellor

C- Constitutions of Distribution for the Student Emergency Assistantship:

- Books or school related materials
- Eviction
- Replacement of belongings lost in a fire or natural disaster.
- Utility shut-off.
- Car repair that will prevent you from traveling to campus.
- Food insecurity
- Past-due medical bills
- Emergency Medical care/ hospital and surgeries
- Safety-related needs (e.g., lock change, emergency shelter, etc.),
- Other needs are considered on a case-by-case basis.

9. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description	Requested by
1.0	May 9, 2024	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Omaia Mahmoud - One Stop Manager	06-5152234	oalrawi@aus.edu
Mobeen Ihsan - Director of Finance	06-5154041	mihsan@aus.edu
Shaima Bin Taliah Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	06-5152162	sbintaliah@aus.edu

Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni Interim Provost & Chief Academic Officer	06-515-2127	mtarhuni@aus.edu
Dr. Tod Alan Laursen - Chancellor	06-515-3900	todlaursen@aus.edu

ad. Animal Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0600SE28	Policy Title:	Animal Policy
Prepared By:	Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Issue Date:	June 16, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs/Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 22, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 22, 2026

1. Policy:

This policy covers animals showcased on student events.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that animals showcased on student events are accorded their rights when they are brought to AUS for the purpose of promoting a student organization's goals and objectives. This policy sets the guidelines and procedures in handling animals and in maintaining the health and safety of event participants.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

Student Engagement and Leadership Department (SELD) engages students in extracurricular activities through student organizations and programs that focus on culture, academia and various interests. Student organizations serve as platform for out-of-class learning experiences that complement academic education and promote the holistic development of students.

SELD encourages students to be creative in their events and activities within the boundaries of health and safety and with respect for living beings that coexist with humans.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy covers all animals, vertebrates and invertebrates, wild and domesticated and all events and activities conducted by OSA-registered student organizations including the Student Council.

6. Responsibilities:

- SELD is responsible for reviewing and approving proposals from student clubs, organizations and associations pertaining to the exhibit of animals in events.
- Student organizations are responsible for submitting a detailed proposal regarding the exhibit of animals in their event three weeks in advance.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AUS – American University of Sharjah
- SELD – Student Engagement and Leadership Development
- UAE – United Arab Emirates

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Ethical Guidelines:

- Animal rights will be protected.
- High standards of animal welfare will be exercised.
- In support of wildlife conservation.
- Animals will be treated with dignity and respect.

Procedures and Guidelines:

- Prohibitions - the following must be considered before creating a proposal:
 - Huge animals such as horses, donkeys and camels cannot be exhibited on campus for safety reasons should the animal go wild.
 - Tamed animals that belong to a species of animals that is known to be wild and dangerous in nature cannot be exhibited. These include lions and tigers.
 - Venomous animals cannot be exhibited on campus including venomoid snakes and invertebrates such as spiders.
 - Animals cannot be used for fun activities and experiments.
 - Endangered species protected by UAE and international laws cannot be exhibited.
 - Animals cannot be exhibited on campus for the purpose of profit making.
 - Animals cannot be exhibited to attract attention or for entertainment because of their appearance.
- Proposal - student organizations wishing to exhibit animals in their events must submit a proposal to SELD three weeks before the event. The proposal must include a justification on how the animal exhibition supports the student organization's goals and objectives and the intended learning outcomes. Details and documents such as veterinary health certificates/animal records, trade license of the company along with passport and visa copies of handlers, method of animal transportation, on-site cage/habitat and special requirements, and budget and logistical requirements from SELD must be specified in the proposal.
- Review and Approval – SELD will review the proposal and documentations provided. Approval is limited to proposals that meet the requirements.
- Animal Exhibition – the following guidelines must be adhered to:
 - The SELD staff will supervise the event and has the final say on all matters related to the implementation of this policy.
 - Professional licensed handlers must be present at all times during the event to handle the animal.
 - Pets and domesticated animals leashed or unleashed cannot be brought to an event by event participants and attendees.

Non-compliance:

Non-compliance of the policy will be subject to disciplinary action including termination of the event. SELD reserves the right to delay or terminate the event in response to any act that is in breach of this policy.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 16, 2021	New Policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
2.0	June 22, 2024	Edited Policy – updated department title from SCOD to SELD	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu

ae. Policy on Sustainable Events - Version 2

Policy Number:	0600SE29	Policy Title:	Policy on Sustainable Events
Prepared By:	Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Issue Date:	June 16, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs /Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 22, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 22, 2026

1. Policy:

This policy covers the use of sustainable materials in student events.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all events and activities conducted by student organizations are in line with the university's sustainability efforts. Guidelines are established to protect resources to meet current needs without compromising the needs of future generations.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The Student Engagement and Leadership Department (SELD) encourages students to be creative in their events and activities with consideration to sustainability. Sustainable methods and processes are employed to promote sustainable events, augment students' perception about sustainability and optimize student-learning outcomes.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy covers all events and activities conducted by OSA-registered student organizations including the Student Council.

6. Responsibilities:

- SELD - ensure that event proposals are in line with the policy. Provide guidance to students on sustainable methods of conducting events. Oversee event preparations and execution to make sure that sustainability efforts are implemented.
- Student organizations - ensure that event proposals are in line with the policy. Plan and execute events in accordance with the policy.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AUS – American University of Sharjah
- SELD – Student Engagement and Leadership Development

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Ethical Guidelines:

- Use of resources will be aligned with the mission of AUS and its strategic priorities

- SELD supports resource conservation, preservation of the environment and reduction of energy needs.
- SELD believes that sustainability supports future generations
- SELD will continue to promote the use recyclable and reusable items
- SELD does not endorse any products or services of sustainability-related vendors or brands

Procedures and Guidelines:

- Proposal
 - Student organizations will go through the usual event application process. Students must ensure that the proposed event is in line with this policy and with the mission and goals of their organization.
 - Student organizations must submit a proposal including a budget. Students must ensure that expenditures are conservative and supports sustainability.
 - In planning for the event, students must consider a design that can be easily reused and made of locally produced materials.
- Event Materials
 - Single-use materials such as huge wooden structures are prohibited. This type of structure cannot be repurposed as it will require more resources and energy in the process neither can they be stored for future use due to lack of storage space in the university.
 - Students must use reusable or recyclable items only. The use of recycled materials is highly encouraged.
 - Students and food vendors can only use biodegradable disposable cutlery during events.
- Event Preparation
 - Work area will be designated by SELD for every event. Students must perform their tasks within the designated work area and not stray beyond the space provided.
 - Aerosols have a negative impact on the environment and adverse effects on health. Spray paints cannot be used to decorate. Only water-based paint is allowed.
 - Students should refrain from activities that cause damage to property. These include drilling, painting and cutting on top of permanent structures.
- Event Execution
 - Computers, electronics and electrical devices must be used according to their intended purposes only. Students must take special care when using such equipment to prolong their use.
 - Only energy efficient LED lighting can be used in events. Students must reduce the use of energy by reducing the number of equipment and providing food that does not require the use of energy for refrigeration or heating on site.
 - At the end of the event, every effort must be made to segregate waste for recycling. All equipment must be returned for safekeeping and made ready for the next user.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 16, 2021	New Policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
2.0	June 22, 2024	Edited Policy – updated department title from SCOD to SELD	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience	Tel: +971 6 515 2162	sbintaliah@aus.edu
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu

af. Student Travel Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600SE30	Policy Title:	Student Travel Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Student Affairs	Issue Date:	May, 2020
Responsible office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Student Travel Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy strives to ensure a uniform institutional approach to student travel that safeguards the interest of the institution and those of the student.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

● Travel Authorization

- Preliminary Student Travel Authorization must be approved by the applicable Senior Manager.

● Chaperone(s)

- A chaperone must accompany students.
- The chaperone(s) must be a AUS faculty or staff member
- Exceptions to having a chaperone must be approved by the Senior Manager.

● Student Travel Agreement

- Each student must submit a student travel agreement to travel organizer.
- When traveling overnight or internationally, student must have parental/guardian approval.
- For graduate student exceptions from parental/guardian approval must be approved by the senior manager.

● Student Conduct

- Students are required to abide by the student code of conduct in the Student Handbook and other university policies when travelling.

● Insurance

- Student travel insurance is mandatory for international travel. The travel organizer must purchase adequate travel insurance, either through the travel agent organizing the trip or a legitimate third party.
- Students must demonstrate health insurance policy coverage for international travel.

● **Forms**

- a) Travel authorization form, student travel agreement forms, and list of participants, shall be submitted to the applicable Senior Manager prior to travel. Other forms may be required by the travel organizer.

● **Records management**

- a) All records relevant to administering this procedure are to be maintained by the applicable Senior Manager.

5. Scope/applicability:

Undergraduate and graduate degree students at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Vice Chancellor of Student Experience to ensure policy is compliant with CAA regulations.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

AUS Catalogs: <https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/aus-catalogs>

New appendix-Student travel forms

9. Policy History

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 2020	New policy	Executive Director of Student Experience
2.0	November 15, 2023	To have the policy follow the latest template	Provost & CAO
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Student Affairs	Tel: +971 6 515 2166	studentaffairs@aus.edu

ag. Administration of Graduate Programs – Version 3

Policy Number:	0600PG31	Policy Title:	Administration of Graduate Programs
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Issue Date:	April 5, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

This policy is dealing with the administration of Graduate Programs.

2. Purpose:

To clarify the administration details for Graduate Programs.

3. Policy Statement:

The academic governance of all graduate programs at AUS is carried out through a Program Committee (PC) comprised of faculty members who actively participate in the program. The PC is chaired either by the Head of Department (HOD) or a faculty member appointed by the dean as the Coordinator of the Graduate Program (CGP). For graduate programs that are part of an academic department the HOD shall be responsible for all managerial and personnel duties consistent with established policies and practices at AUS.

A graduate program served by faculty members from more than one department or college is labeled as a *cross-departmental* program. A cross-departmental program may be housed inside a department or under the college/school as a “stand-alone” program, as determined by the responsible dean. The dean makes such determination in consultation with the PC and other deans if they have faculty members significantly involved in the program. A cross-departmental program may have a program coordinator who reports to the HOD or the dean depending on where the program is housed. In addition to the PC, a cross-departmental program will have a Steering Committee (SC) to assist the coordinator in managing the program. The following sections provide general guidelines pertaining to the CGP, PC, and SC.

I. Coordinator of the Graduate Program (CGP)

For cross-departmental programs, the appointment of the CGP is made by the responsible dean in consultation with the HOD, if applicable, and members of the PC. If a designation other than the CGP is deemed necessary, then approval from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost is required.

The dean may recommend to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost that the CGP be awarded **one** course release per academic year provided that the CGP is not receiving any other course releases due to academic administration duties.

The CGP assumes the role of the chair of the PC and SC and assigned managerial and personnel responsibilities for the program, including participation in faculty performance reviews, course scheduling, and resource management.

Recommended CGP Qualifications:

- Full-time academic position with a terminal degree in the field, preferably on a rolling contract.
- A demonstrated record of scholarly activities in areas related to the graduate program.
- Experience in major activities of graduate programs such as offered graduate courses, prior supervisory experience for theses, examined theses, involved in curriculum development, etc.

Recommended CGP Responsibilities:

The CGP, as Chair of the Program Committee, is responsible for developing and improving the program in consultation with the HOD, if applicable, and the program faculty. Major GPC duties include, but not limited to:

1. Assist with program marketing and preparation of program information.
2. Recruit students to the program.
3. Coordinate the admissions and review processes of applicants with the Office of Graduate Admissions.
4. Assist in new student orientation sessions.
5. Advise graduate students, monitor students' progress, and handle student petitions.
6. Create a supportive environment for graduate students.
7. Prepare course offerings and coordinate teaching assignments with department heads of program faculty.
8. Provide attention to the graduate program over the summer period.
9. Communicate with graduate students and program faculty about important deadlines, related policies, and changes to graduate programs.
10. Coordinate graduate assistants assignments, assessments, and training.
11. Oversee graduate program planning and curriculum development, program assessments, and accreditation.
12. Contribute to the annual faculty evaluation process by providing feedback to relevant department heads on the faculty contribution to the graduate program.

II. Program Committee (PC)

PC Role

The PC provides input on the following:

- Appointment of the CGP (input to the dean)
- SC membership (input to the CGP)
- Curriculum development and changes
- Major changes to the program, e.g. academic structure, concentrations, etc.
- Strategic plan and program policies
- Other matters as appropriate for the program

PC Membership

The PC is composed of faculty members who are qualified to teach and supervise students in the program. The PC is initially composed of the faculty who initiated the graduate program and listed in the Initial Accreditation self-study. New members are added to the PC once a qualified faculty member is recommended to teach and supervise students in the program. The PC is chaired by the CGP. The dean appoints the PC based on the recommendation from the CGP. The PC membership is for three years subject to reappointment for multiple terms.

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III. Steering Committee (SC)

SC Role

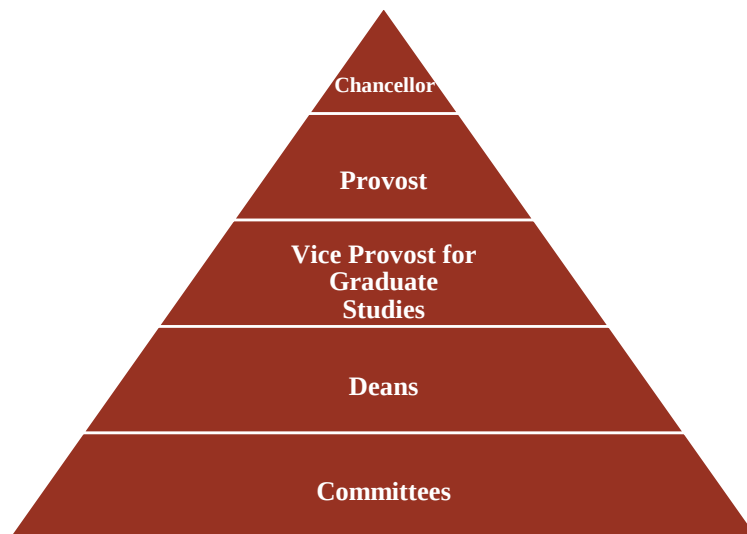
The SC assists the CGP in administering the graduate program and provide advice and recommendations on:

- Membership of the Program Committee
- Membership of other committees
- Admission and assistantship awarding criteria
- Curriculum changes
- Assessment and accreditation
- Other tasks as appropriate for the program

SC Membership

The SC members must reflect adequate representation of the major areas in the program. The SC is initially composed of the lead faculty members who developed the graduate program. The SC is chaired by the CGP. The dean appoints the SC based on the recommendations from the CGP, and HOD if applicable. The SC membership is for three years subject to reappointment for multiple terms.

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst administrators involved in this policy.



4. Scope/applicability:

To facilitate the administration of Graduate Programs.

5. Responsibilities:

As highlighted in the Policy Statement.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Program Committee (PC)

Head of Department (HOD)
Coordinator of the Graduate Program (CGP)
Steering Committee (SC)

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Policies and Procedures Manual.

8. Policy history:

This policy is part of the Policies and Procedures Manual. Any changes or updates to this policy are approved by the Council of Deans, and the Provost.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 5, 2021	Initial draft	Office of Research and Graduate Studies
2.0	October 2, 2023	A review – No Changes to the policy – Editorial changes into the new template for policies	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: 971-6-5154721	Email: ogs@aus.edu

7. Health, Safety and Environment

a. Health and Safety Policy- Version 3

Policy Number:	0700GS01	Policy Title:	Health and Safety Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Safety and Crisis Management	Issue Date:	January 9, 2016
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Safety and Crisis Management	Effective Date:	May 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chief of Protocol	Date of Next Revision:	May 31, 2025

1. Policy:

AUS is committed to providing a safe and healthy environment for the AUS community through active participation of staff, faculty, students and visitors to improve HSE (Health, Safety and Environment) performance. This policy establishes an HSE management system framework to:

- Comply with HSE related laws and regulations
- Ensure all hazards are adequately managed and mitigation measures are in place to control the identified hazards

2. Purpose:

The Purpose of this policy is to comply with the local and federal laws, regulation, and statutory requirements as applicable to the scope of the AUS institutional activities. The list of local and federal laws, regulation, and statutory requirements are managed, and addressed in line with the requirements of the internal SOP-004 (Legal and Other Requirements).

This policy provides a description of the overall framework that addresses the HSE framework implemented by the American University of Sharjah.

- The overall benefits for having this policy are to:
- Develop, implement, control, monitor and improve our tailor-made HSE management system that fulfils the needs and requirements of the American University of Sharjah (AUS). The main target of this policy is to control and eliminate exposure to hazards that may cause injury to people, damage to assets or the environment.
- Identify local and federal legal requirements and ensure AUS compliance to such requirements as applicable.
- Implement risk management and emergency preparedness protocols to maintain our readiness to respond as and when required.
- Provide a comprehensive framework to implement detailed internal audit and inspection sessions to manage and report risks, and to ensure efficient use of resources to foster the importance of the safety processes.
- Implement incident management and prevention processes and strategies to prevent and control unsafe acts and unsafe conditions.
- Promote a positive HSE culture across the institution.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

As a part of the UAE Higher Education System, and other local and federal legal, laws and statutory requirements, the American University of Sharjah has a range of HSE legislative, regulatory and contractual requirements with which it shall comply. These requirements also change over time, so it is important that we have processes to keep coping with these changes and regularly review, check and update policies and practice to maintain compliance. This policy guides those processes and assists us to demonstrate compliance when required.

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

4.1. Handling Accidents:

1. Remain calm and assess the situation.
2. Reassure the injured person.
3. Call ambulance if injury is severe.
4. Contact University Health Center for first aid +971 50 635 7651.
5. Contact AUS security personnel via mobile +971 50 626 7818.
6. In case of possibility of death or serious injury, contact the police.
7. Prepare a written report, by collecting all the facts and names of witnesses.

4.2. Campus OHS Evaluation:

1. The Office of Safety and crisis Management will maintain records of accidents and emergencies, safety violations and any complaints or suggestions regarding campus safety. The Security Division will cc the Office of Safety and Crisis Management with such reports.
2. The Office of Safety and crisis Management will compile data on distribution of safety materials, implementation of safety procedures and display of appropriate safety signage in classrooms and laboratories. The AUS Security will share campus security reports with the Office of Safety and Crisis Management as applicable.
3. The performance of the Office of Safety and Crisis Management is controlled, and evaluated by a set of internal KPIs (Key Performance Indicators) approved by the reporting line.
4. Planned OHS internal audit and inspection sessions will be conducted by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.
5. Documentation on the results of these planned audit and inspection sessions will be retained and made readily retrievable by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.
6. Physical and virtual periodic drills (e.g., fire drills) will be held to assess emergency response preparedness. Documentation on the results of these drills will be retained and made readily retrievable by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.
7. The Office of Safety and Crisis Management will prepare a report of all data collected relative to assessment of campus safety annually.
8. The Safety committee will review the data and propose changes in the campus safety plan and procedures accordingly.

4.3. OHS Risk Management:

The OHS risk management guidelines (as addressed in SP-005, Risk Assessment Procedure) should be used to identify, minimize and manage OHS hazards.

Systematically identify hazards, threats and their impact:

- Carry out audit and inspection sessions to consider what could reasonably be expected to cause accidents, injuries or hazards including fire hazards, traffic accidents, construction safety and precautions.
- Encourage employees to report any unsafe conditions or practices on premises safety@aus.edu
- Review accident or ill-health records.

Evaluate the hazards to see who or what might be at threat and decide on precautions:

- Possible hazards that may occur are fire, explosion, trips, falls, extreme weather conditions, swimming pool injuries, traffic or transportation hazards and construction hazards, etc.
- Consider activities to control identified hazards, such as protective clothing, goggles, safety boots, first aid, alerts, advisories, signage and barriers.
- Compile a risk register and determine the controls needed.
- Develop emergency response plans and recovery procedures.

Guidelines to manage emergencies effectively:

- Create awareness of emergency situations.
- Identify hazards that exist and expected consequences.
- Develop written procedures/checklists to determine response required.
- Develop written procedures/checklists for returning operations to normal.

4.4. OHS Audit & Inspection Sessions:

HSE audit and inspection sessions will be carried out periodically to check and evaluate compliance with applicable policies, procedures, local and federal legal and other requirements. Audit and inspection sessions are important to ensure system's continual improvement, identify areas for improvement, identify observation and plan for preventive measures, and identify non-conformities and plan for corrective measures. Audit reports will be made available for management review. This process is controlled by (SP-006, Internal Audit and Inspection Procedure)

4.5. Management Review:

The management (represented by the Health and Safety Committee) will periodically review documentation related to OHS audit and inspection sessions, OHS surveys, history of corrective and preventive actions to ensure the effectiveness of OHS system, Incidents reporting, compliance with legal and other requirements OHS KPIs, and other emerging issues as progress. This process is controlled by (SP-007, Health and Safety Committee Review Meeting Procedure) and (SP-010, Monitoring the Effectiveness of HSE Management System)

4.6. HSE Training:

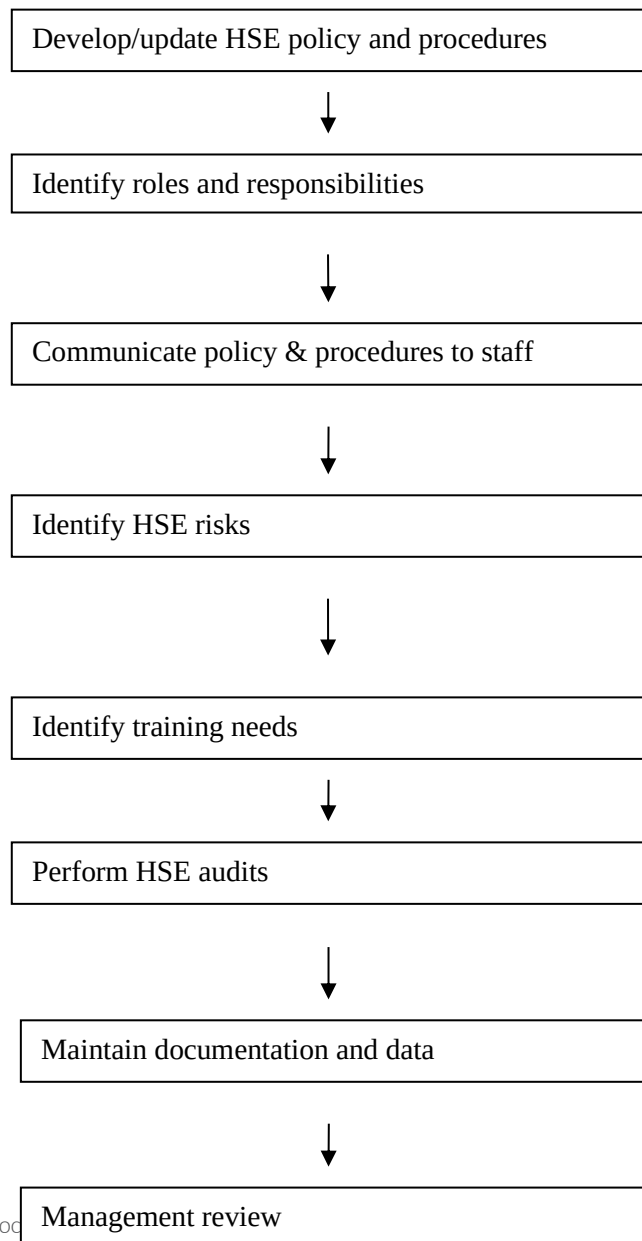
The Office of Safety and Crisis Management is responsible for implementing the OHS training sessions as per the OHS training matrix.

Adequate training will be provided to faculty, staff and students so that they are aware of risks and precautions relating to Health, Safety and Environment while carrying their routine and non-routine activities. Specialized trainings including those listed below should be provided to faculty, staff and student that have work responsibilities that may expose them to potential OHS hazards.

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management has two modes to deliver training sessions:

1. Virtual/online through the AUS ilearn® online system (ilearn.aus.edu). The trainee should use AUS the personal credentials (AUS username and password) to access such training sessions.
2. Face to Face training session conducted by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management or through an accredited third-party service provider. Such training sessions may include the following topics:
 - Fire Warden
 - Emergency response
 - First aid (Level 1)
 - Building safety and housekeeping
- Working at height and Fall protection
- Back/Spinal safety/Office Safety
- Lifting safety
- Spills, transportation, storage and waste management of hazardous materials
- Scaffold erecting/supervision/inspection

4.7. HSE Activities Flowchart:



4.8. HSE Guidelines:

HSE guidelines shall be followed to safeguard the health and safety of faculty, staff, students and interested parties once being present within the premises of AUS. Any reported/detected violation to AUS OHS requirement will result disciplinary action as per the governing procedures implemented by AUS (HR manual, student handbook, contractual requirements, applicable procedures and policies).

4.9. Respectful and Safe Workplace:

All employees are required to observe respectful behaviour in their interaction with others. Violation of respectful behaviour values by acts such as harassment, bullying, discrimination of any kind or violence should be reported to human resources, and/or the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.

Reports of such incidents can be shared with the Office of Safety and Crisis Management via:

E-mail (safety@aus.edu),

Or,

By calling the AUS Security Emergency: (050 626 7818)/(06 515 2100, then select/press 2)

4.10. First Aid:

First aid kits are distributed within the academic and administrative buildings in multiple locations within each floor. In case of any medical emergency, the university health service can be contacted (24/7) through emergency phone on (06 515 2699) or (050 635 7651).

4.11. Food Hygiene:

All food concessionaires/ contractors shall comply with municipality health and hygiene standards particularly those that apply to restaurants and kitchens. Quarterly inspections including monitoring adherence to the guidelines given below should be carried out in areas used for food preparation and food display.

- All food preparation and serving areas shall be maintained hygienic, and cleaned on a regular basis.
- Only chemicals that are considered food safe may be used on surfaces in contact with food.
- All staff involved in food handling shall observe good personal hygiene practices. They shall wear appropriate clothing for the area in which they are working, including where necessary, appropriate headgear.
- Food handlers who are unwell shall not be allowed to prepare and serve food.
- All food items shall be stored appropriately and in compliance with temperature control requirements.
- All equipment within food premises shall be kept well maintained and all faults shall correct and reported immediately
- Suitable arrangements shall be in place to dispose of food waste.

4.12. Pollution:

AUS has introduced a smoke free policy that doesn't permits smoking anywhere within the campus. The smoke free policy is aimed at protecting individuals from the ill-health effects of smoking and secondary smoke inhalation. Additionally; it is considered crucial to ensure fire safety across the campus. Any reported or detected violation to the requirements addressed in the smoking policy will subject the violator to safety disciplinary actions as per the approved internal processes addressed in HR manual and the student handbook.

4.13. Safety & Hygiene of Premises:

The Facilities Department should keep all areas clean, free of insects and pests, cleaning products and pesticides should be generally safe. Periodic inspections should be carried out to identify inadequate ventilation, mould, and lack of fresh air exchange, dampness or excess chemical contaminants.

Walking surfaces should be inspected periodically to identify obvious hazards such as raised surfaces or flooring levels that suddenly drop or sink which may cause tripping or losing balance.

A. Academic, Administrative, and Residential Buildings:

Every building within the campus shall be equipped as a minimum with a fire alarm system that contains audible fire alarm, smoke detectors, fire hose reels, fire sprinklers (as applicable), and adequate life-safety features that (for example) include emergency evacuation routes, fire zones, emergency exit lights, emergency call points, emergency exits, etc.

All work areas will be kept clean, tidy and safe by:

- Removing tripping hazards such as loose cords, loose floor coverings and objects in walkways and working areas.
- Cleaning up spills.
- Removing paper and obstacles from the floor

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management should develop a plan to carry out periodic audit and inspection sessions of the buildings to monitor or identify OHS risks including fire prevention in warehouses and general stability of the buildings.

B. Ergonomics:

AUS ensures to keep premises and work areas sufficiently lit, so that people are able to move about and perform work duties safely. Chairs and of office furniture provide adequate support for to ensure ergonomics safety. The Office of Safety and Crisis Management runs virtual/online training sessions to ensure office safety and ergonomics safety.

C. Swimming Pools:

A trained lifeguard will be on duty during weekdays/weekends, and any time that is considered necessary in case of special events. The lifeguard shall be trained in first aid and CPR. Any hazardous situations, incidents or accidents should be reported to the lifeguard to prevent injuries or any other harm.

General rules for use of swimming pool such as those given below should be posted near the pool area:

- Showers are required prior to entering the pool.
- Diving, flips, sitting on shoulders are not allowed in the swimming pool.
- Running is not allowed on the deck area.
- Pushing, throwing, dunking or similar acts are not allowed in the pool.
- Glass containers are not allowed near the pool.
- Appropriate swimming attire shall be worn in the pool.
- Swimming pools should be lit up at night.
- Children and inexperienced swimmers should not cross the shallow end.
- Children under five shall be supervised by parent/guardian at all times.
- Smoking is not allowed in the pool area.

D. Pool Emergency Response Guidelines:

- If lifeguard is present, he/she should blow whistle and proceed with lifeguard rescue procedures.
- Give appropriate first aid.
- If the injury is serious or life threatening, call ambulance 997.
- If only one person is present, they should stay with the injured person and direct another person to call university health services on (050 635 7651) or call the 997.
- Never leave an injured person unattended.
- Never move the victim unless absolutely necessary.
- Notify University Health Center to get medical records and public affairs to notify relatives of injured person.

E. Swimming Pool Contamination-Management Protocol:

Water quality in the swimming pool shall meet health and sanitary standards. Swimming pools are periodically tested by the Sharjah Municipality. In the event of contamination by foreign substances, pool shall be immediately cleared of swimmers, closed, and cleaned up.

The swimming pool shall remain closed until a new test for the quality is conducted, and confirm that the pool is safe for use.

F. Gym Facilities:

Precautionary steps should be taken to ensure that gym users are safe from potential hazards such as accidental injuries, infectious diseases and contamination.

Precautionary measures should include the following:

1. Routine inspection and maintenance of gym equipment in line with manufacturer's instructions.
2. Regularly sanitizing and disinfecting gym equipment, including exercise mats, upholstery, bars and rails.
3. Proper supervision over the gym activities.

G. Reporting Incidents at Gym and Swimming Pool Facilities:

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Minor accidents may include injuries like bloody noses or scraped knees and need not be reported formally.

Major accidents injuries such as broken bones, concussions or drowning shall be reported as per guidelines given below after attending to the injured person.

1. Prepare an incident notification report (SF-009-A) based on the observation, witness name and contact numbers, then submit it to the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.
2. If the accident or incident was due to unsafe act or unsafe condition, the Office of Safety and Crisis Management shall be notified immediately to take the immediate corrections and the future corrective actions to prevent further incidents.

H. Early Childhood Learning Center:

The Early Childhood Learning Center should maintain detailed procedures to ensure it complies with OHS requirements and regulations that are applicable to it. Regular inspections of the premises should be carried out by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management.

Such inspections should include monitoring compliance with the following health, safety and hygiene aspects:

1. The Day Care Center should be equipped with fire extinguishers and smoke detectors that are tested regularly.
2. Emergency exits are unblocked/unobstructed, clearly identified or clearly marked.
3. Doorways and exits aisles are free of debris and equipment to allow unobstructed passages.
4. Bathrooms are clean, in good repair and easily reached by children.
5. A well-supplied first aid kit is available to staff and out of reach of children
6. Medications are kept in original container, properly labelled, stored away from food and out of reach of children.
7. Strings and cords long enough to encircle a child's neck are not accessible to children.
8. The playground equipment is in good repair and safe condition (no sharp edges, splinters, cracks protruding parts etc.)
9. Outdoor areas are kept free of excessive dust, weeds, brush, high grass and standing water.
10. Surfaces underneath indoor and outdoor play equipment that children can climb on are covered with impact-absorbing materials.
11. A play structure should not have openings so small that may cause entrapment.
12. All play equipment should have a safe clearance from other structures.
13. The swing area should be safe, the front and rear of swing should not have equipment in case of a fall.
14. Adequate child-to-staff ratio so that children are supervised at all times.
15. Caregivers are appropriately trained and in good health.
16. Written procedures are maintained for care of ill children.
17. Limited or no TV viewing.
18. Perishable food shall be stored appropriately or refrigerated.
19. Cleaning supplies and other toxic materials should be locked in the cabinets in their original labelled containers inaccessible to children.
20. Stoves, microwaves, pipes and other hot surfaces should not be within reach of children.

21. Electrical outlets should be covered with protective caps.
22. Electrical cords should be in good condition and placed beyond children's reach.
23. Window guards on all windows except designated fire exits.
24. An emergency evacuation plan should be prepared and staff should be familiar with the plan.
25. Waste should be disposed of adequately.

4.14. Lab-Safety, Bio-hazard Safety and Waste Management Guidelines:

Biohazard refers to biological substances that may pose a threat to the health and safety of humans, animals or environment. Anything that comes in contact with a biohazard is normally deemed contaminated. Biohazard waste includes:

- Medical waste
- Animal carcasses (total body/organs)
- Laboratory human, animal, and plant bio-hazard waste (remaining tissues and body parts)
- Bio-contaminated sharp objects such as needles, cutters, biopsy tools, etc...
- Blood-soaked towels or gauze
- Bio-contaminated laboratory ware

A. Laboratories (Teaching and Research):

Faculty members who supervise laboratory projects are responsible for safety management of those laboratory projects. Such procedures should include taking reasonable precautions to protect safety and health of students, workers and environment as well as safe use and disposal of hazardous material labelled as waste item, expired items, or non-required/unused items.

The disposal of unused chemicals, chemical mixtures, chemical waste, biological waste, and contaminated lab-ware, other hazardous material shall be in line with specific disposal method to ensure safety and environment protection. Precautionary measures such as temperature, and labelling requirements shall also be adhered to for storage and handling of lab waste.

Detailed instructions to ensure laboratory safety, and for handling and disposing laboratory waste are well detailed in the Laboratory Health and Safety Handbook (SP-014).

In brief the following guidelines shall be adhered to:

- Chemical containers with screw type lids shall be sealed tightly.
- Sharp or glass waste shall be collected in heavy-duty cardboard boxes, sealing all seams with tape.
- Legible labels should be affixed on storage and waste containers, bags or boxes and wastage should only be placed in designated areas.
- Plastics that are contaminated with a residue from lab hazardous material shall be disposed of as per the guidelines addressed in the Laboratory Health and Safety Handbook (SP-014), and the specific disposal instructions addressed in the SDS of each item/component (chemical, biological, or others).
- Containers shall never be overfilled.
- Protective clothing and gloves should be worn and direct contact with contents should be avoided.

B. University Health Center:

The University Health Center shall maintain a written procedure for managing biohazards, medical waste, disease prevention, and infection control. Microbiological/biological laboratory waste includes

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laboratory cultures, gloves, paper towels, plastic products, non-penetrable waste (metal pans, blunt objects), liquid waste includes human blood and body fluid shall be managed, handled, and disposed using medical waste disposal methods.

The health care workers shall exercise precautions and their work practices should be in line with the government regulations. Safety measures comprise of wearing protective clothing, regular cleaning, disinfecting premises and use of biohazard labelled containers.

Handling, storage and transportation of waste shall comply with medical waste regulations.

4.15. Employee Wellness Programs:

Employee wellness programs are run by certified personnel. Examples of that include town-hall meeting with senior management for both faculty and staff, awareness sessions, sport and wellness programs, medical insurance, and university health services, social programs and gathering, and campus communications.

4.16. Third-party Service Providers, Suppliers and Contractors Management Guidelines:

Third-party service providers, suppliers and contractors who work on AUS campus and/ or support the AUS operations shall ensure the provision of reasonable OHS control measures. Such control measures shall be in line with AUS OHS control measures, and approved OHS practices.

Selection and evaluation criteria for the third-party service providers, suppliers and contractors should include a requirement for the bidders to provide an OHS submission that is in line with the approved guidelines. If any part of the contract is subcontracted to another party, then the main contractors shall ensure that such subcontractors comply with the approved OHS standards.

Workplace injuries or illnesses sustained by employees of the third-party service providers, suppliers and contractors or their subcontractor shall be immediately reported to the AUS Office of Safety and Crisis Management along with the accident/incident report within 24 hours.

4.17. Events on Campus:

Events on university premises may carry HSE risks, therefore safety and facilities personnel should be consulted at the time of planning an event.

4.18. Warehouse Activities, Transport and Traffic Safety Guidelines:

Safety of people is a crucial aspect during road traffic, transport and warehouse operations management. Only authorized commercial and private vehicles will be allowed in the campus. Documented safety guidelines should be kept for commercial vehicles offloading heavy equipment or materials. Vehicles owned and operated by AUS such as buses shall be maintained and inspected frequently. Drivers of vehicles violating speed limits or traffic rules will be fined as per the implemented policies with AUS.

a. Traffic Safety:

Traffic safety rules apply to vehicles, pedestrians and bicyclists.

Suggestions/comments for campus traffic safety will be invited by creating an email ID or drop box. Traffic/vehicle accidents on the university campus shall be reported and investigated in a timely

manner. Some traffic safety guidelines are given below. The Security Division should be contacted for further details.

- Parking permits issued by the security office shall be affixed on the windscreen of the car.
- Parking permits are renewed on a yearly basis and drivers shall ensure that they have a valid parking permit.
- Visitor parking shall only be used by visitors.
- Speed limits should be adhered to by vehicle drivers.
- Vehicles should not stop on the middle of the road to drop off passengers.
- Talking on the phone, texting and listening to music on earphones are distractions for vehicle drivers, bicyclists and pedestrians that either cause accidents or are unable to prevent incidents.
- Bicyclists should follow the same traffic rules as vehicle drivers, stopping at intersections.
- Extra caution should be exercised during rainy conditions.

b. Warehouse Safety:

Warehouse safety procedures (SOP-3000) should be documented and warehouse personnel trained to protect against transportation, housekeeping and materials handling hazards. Some safety guidelines are given below.

- Food, beverage, products should not be kept in chemical storage areas.
- Chemicals shall be stored and handled as per manufacturer's instructions.
- Chemical spills shall be properly cleaned up, inhalation of chemicals shall be avoided, and care should be taken to avoid accidental splashing or squirting of substances in to the eyes.
- Warehouse personnel should use proper personal protective equipment when handling chemicals.
- Storage areas are kept free from accumulation of materials that could lead to tripping, fire, and explosion or pest infestations.
- All hazardous materials containers are properly labelled, indicating the chemical's identity, the manufacturer's name and address, and appropriate hazard warnings.
- Fire equipment in the warehouse should be inspected regularly.
- Personnel using forklift equipment shall be adequately trained.
- Ladder safety rules such as not placing metal ladder near live electricity etc. shall be followed.

4.19. Incident Reporting:

Incidents involving injury, damage, loss to university personnel, asset/property, or damage to environment shall be reported and investigated by the Office of Safety and Crisis Management Manager who will assess the risk and the pre-incident control measures. Remedial actions shall be taken to prevent future recurrence of similar incidents.

For serious incidents, an investigation shall be initiated within 24 hours. (Incident investigation is performed with respect to SP-009, Incident Reporting and Investigation Procedure):

4.20. Emergency Preparedness:

Emergency preparedness procedures will allow the Crisis Management team to deal with various emergency scenarios that may impact student life, instruction, administration, campus and public safety.

Emergency preparedness guidelines given below have been developed to create awareness of and manage the following emergency situations:

- Medical emergencies, mental health emergency or suicide attempt
- Fire
- Threat of weapons/Possession of weapons
- Criminal activity
- Chemical spills
- Severe weather
- Utility failure
- Emergency evacuation

Procedures for situations such as death/injury, attempted suicide, riot, overdose, missing student, study abroad incident, hostage situation and explosion should be developed by the Crisis Management Team. (Adequate information are included in SP-011, Crisis Management Plan)

4.21. Crisis Management Team:

The Crisis Management team will be responsible for coordinating responses to emergency situations. The Crisis Management team should include members from the Operations Department as well as the Office of Safety and Crisis Management, and should immediately communicate the information regarding a major emergency or disaster to the Chancellor if there is an indication that a major emergency is probable or developing. (Adequate information are included in SP-011, Crisis Management Plan)

Medical Emergencies:

Medical emergencies should be reported immediately to the University Health Center at extension 2699 or 050 635 7651. University ambulance services can be contacted by calling extension 5676 or 050 666 6844. In case of serious injuries, the injured person should not be moved unless absolutely necessary. Following details shall be provided to medical emergency providers:

1. Nature of medical emergency
2. Location of the emergency (address, building, room number)
3. Caller's name and phone number from which the call is made

In case of suicide attempt or mental health emergency, the University Health Services should be contacted. Individuals who are aware of a person showing signs of mental health conditions such as severe depression, violent behaviour etc. should encourage such persons to seek professional medical help immediately.

Fire:

Every building on campus shall be equipped with a fire alarm system that contains as a minimum, audible fire alarm that sounds throughout the building, smoke detectors, fire extinguishers and fire sprinklers. Once the fire alarm is activated the audible alarm will sound, and the elevators will automatically go to the ground level. Water sprinkler will be activated only if the temperature in the immediate area is high enough or the fire is directly below.

Information regarding the location of fire alarm devices, emergency exits and assembly points shall be provided to faculty, staff and students.

Fire emergency drills should be carried out annually and HSE may seek volunteers to act as fire marshals for every floor who should be trained in handling fire emergencies.

5. Scope/applicability:

The document includes all activities that are within the HSE scope, including, but not limited to:

- Health, safety and hygiene
- HSE risk management
- Third-party/Contractor management (for compliance with HSE regulations)
- Bio safety and waste management (Health Clinic, Labs)
- Warehousing, transport and traffic safety
- Incident reporting (definitions, when, how and who to report)
- Disaster/emergency preparedness (incidents having impact on people, property and reputation)
- Business continuity management

6. Responsibilities:

- The Health and Safety Committee's chairperson is responsible to approve this Policy.
- The Health and Safety Committee's members are responsible to review this policy and recommend approval.
- The Head of Safety and Crisis Manager is responsible to develop, control and monitor, maintain and continually approve this policy.
- All (Deans (or as delegated), Executive Directors, Directors, Managers, Unit Heads, and Project Managers) shall properly support the implementation of this policy within their area of responsibility.

Note: The Office of Safety and Crisis Management is responsible for the dissemination of this policy:

- as part of the orientation process/checklist for new employees
- by posting it on the AUS website

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- AUS: American University of Sharjah
- HSE: Health, Safety and Environment
- OHS: Occupational Health and Safety
- Hazard: Source, situation or act with a potential to cause harm (injury/ill health) to people. The term (cause harm) is extended to include causing harm to the environment or to property

- Ill Health: Identifiable, adverse physical or mental condition arising from or made worse by a work-related situation
- Incident: Work-related event(s) in which a fatality, injury or ill health occurred (known as an accident) or could have occurred (known as a near-miss)
- Accident: A situation where an event (unplanned) causes a fatality, injury or ill health to people or a damage to environment or a damage to assets.
- Near Miss: A situation where an event (unplanned) has the potential to cause harm, but doesn't actually result in causing harm.
- Risk: a combination of the likelihood and severity of a hazardous event to cause harm.
- Risk Assessment: The process of identifying potential hazards, and their existing controls in order to quantify the risk value. The risk assessment process aims to provide insight regarding the coherence of the existing controls and the extent of the improvement required to achieve an acceptable risk level
- Acceptable Risk Level: the situation of a known risk that has been controlled and reduced to a level that can be accepted in terms of legal, social, ethical and moral obligations and liabilities. Acceptable risk is reduced to be ALARP "As Low As Reasonably Practicable Level"
- Workplace: Any physical location (office, classroom, laboratory, workshop, warehouse, or any indoor or outdoor vicinity) within AUS in which work-related activities are performed under the control of AUS.
- Interested Party: Persons or groups, inside or outside the workplace, concerned with or affected by the HSE/OHS performance of AUS.
- Interested parties may include parents, visitors, representatives of local and federal governmental, private and international entities, contractors, service providers, suppliers, etc.
- HVAC: Heating, ventilating and Air Conditioning.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

S/N	SOP (Code & Name)	SOP Description
1	SP-004, Legal and Other Requirement Procedure	Identify, monitor and ensure compliance with applicable local and federal laws and regulations.
2	SP-005, Risk Assessment Procedure	Identify and highlight risks in terms of routine and non-routine activities
3	SP-006, Internal Audit and Inspection Procedure	Framework to setup health and safety internal audit and inspection.
4	SP-007, Health and Safety Committee Review Meeting	A code of conduct to regulate the activities of Health and Safety Committee.
5	SP-008, Non-Conformity, Corrective & Preventive Action Procedure	Identifying health and safety areas of concerns, implement mitigation/control measures, and plan for closure actions.

6	SP-009, Incident Reporting & Investigation Procedure	Process to register, control and study incidents and implement preventive and corrective actions, and build a history database of information.
7	SP-010, Monitoring The Effectiveness of HSE Management System	Process to monitor the performance of the health and safety management system in order to ensure its effectiveness & readiness in order to plan for continual improvement.
8	SP-011, Crisis Management Plan	Management framework to manage crisis events in terms of planned response, effective communication and coordination, and identify approach to recover to normal operating conditions. It includes post-event analysis to identify root-cause and plan for corrective actions.
9	SP-014, Laboratory Health and Safety Handbook	Framework to manage, implement, control and monitor laboratory activities in order to ensure laboratory safe conditions and safe acts
10	Emergency Response Handbook	Compact awareness guideline to assist and guide AUS community members on proper response during emergencies
11	Emergency Response Posters	Compact awareness posters to assist and guide AUS community members on proper response during emergencies

9. Policy history:

The policy history started with the document prepared by to the AUS security in 2012. On 2016, the Office of Safety and Crisis Management was established, and continued to review and develop this policy on annual basis.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 9, 2016	New Policy	Chief Operation Officer
2.0	October 15, 2022	General Policy Update	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	May 31, 2024	General Update on the format	Office of the Chancellor

10.Reference:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Health, Safety and Environment	Tel: +971 6 515 4268	safety@aus.edu

b. IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0700IT02	Policy Title:	IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	May 13, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy prescribes a planning approach to IT equipment and software replacement based on defined useful life timeframes. These timeframes are determined by a combination of industry standard, vendor published values and risk assessment by the ICT & IT Security Department . The responsibility of this policy resides with the Director of Information Technology.

3. Introduction / background:

Information technology is integral to the functioning of the American University of Sharjah. The objective of this policy is to ensure timely replacement of IT equipment and software to ensure the ongoing sustainability of the information technology services delivered to the university community.

This policy prescribes a planning approach to IT equipment and software replacement based on industry standard useful life timeframes. These timeframes are determined by a combination of vendor published values and risk assessment by the Information Technology department. The responsibility of this policy resides with the Director of Information Technology.

4. Policy Statement:

AUS will ensure that all IT equipment and software budgeted and managed centrally and in the Information Technology Department is replaced based on the useful life of the asset. The university will ensure that a sufficient budget is planned for and allocated on an annual basis.

Procedure for Implementing Policy: The Information Technology Department will maintain multi-year Operating Expense and Operating Capital Renewal Plans to support the implementation of this policy. The Information Technology Department will review annually the useful life assigned to each IT asset class. Industry standards, vendor published values and risk assessments will be used to assign useful life times to each asset class.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all IT equipment and software budgeted and managed centrally and in the Information Technology Department.

6. Responsibilities:

- The responsibility of this policy resides with the Director of Information Technology.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N/A

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 13, 2014	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	April 5, 2017	Policy updates to reflect the new Scope, Sanctions and Frequently Asked Questions of the policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
4.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

c. Data Security Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0700IT03	Policy Title:	Data Security Policy
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	May 13, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

Data Security Policy

2. Purpose:

American University of Sharjah (AUS) has adopted a Data Security Policy to highlight the overall direction and vision for information security to further the university's goal of educating our future leaders.

3. Introduction / background: N/A

4. Policy Statement:

At a minimum AUS will strive to:

- Secure user authentication protocols.
- Secure access control measures.
- Protect all sensitive and private data that transits the AUS network.
- Provide responsible and reasonable monitoring of user activity.
- Provide reasonably up-to-date protection of university assets via (including but not limited to) firewalls, content filtering, anti-virus and anti-malware solutions.
- Ensure all AUS data is protected from destruction.
- Be a responsible "network neighbor" to the greater Internet community.
- Educate and train users on the proper use of computer security practices and the importance of data security.

5. Scope/applicability:

- All users of university information resources

6. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Firewall: A logical or physical discontinuity in a network to prevent unauthorized access to data or resources.
- Malware: A generic term for a number of different types of malicious code.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources: N/A

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 13, 2014	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	April 5, 2017	Policy updates to reflect the new Scope, Sanctions and Frequently Asked Questions of the policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Office of Institutional Research and Analysis
4.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

d. Appropriate Use of Technology Resources Policy.

This policy covers two policies:

1. IT Acceptable Use Policy - Version 3
2. Prohibited Acts and Proper Resource Utilization Policy - Version 4

1. IT Acceptable Use Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0700IT04	Policy Title:	IT Acceptable Use Policy
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	December 1, 2012
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date Of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

IT Acceptable Use Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to outline the acceptable use of computer equipment at AUS. These rules are in place to protect the students, faculty and staff and AUS. Inappropriate use exposes AUS to risks including virus attacks, compromise of network systems and services, and legal issues.

3. Introduction / background:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) IT Department's intentions for publishing an Acceptable Use Policy are not to impose restrictions that are contrary to AUS's established culture of openness, trust and integrity. The IT Department is committed to protecting AUS's students, faculty, staff, partners and the university from illegal or damaging actions by individuals, either knowingly or unknowingly.

Internet/Intranet/Extranet-related systems, including but not limited to computer equipment, software, operating systems, storage media, network accounts providing electronic mail, WWW browsing, and FTP, are the property of AUS. These systems are to be used for academic and business purposes in serving the interests of the university, and of our students, faculty and staff in the course of normal operations. Please review the Human Resources Policy Manual and the Student Code of Conduct for further details.

Effective security is a team effort involving the participation and support of every AUS student, faculty, staff and affiliate who deals with information and/or information systems. It is the responsibility of every computer user to know these rules and guidelines, and to conduct their activities accordingly.

4. Policy Statement:

The use of AUS resources outlined in the scope of this policy is subject to university policies and procedures, and local and federal laws and regulations. All users of these resources must comply with specific policies and guidelines governing their use. All users must only use these resources in a manner consistent with university policy and the law, including this policy and related procedure, and specialized policies created by specific departments, programs and offices of the university.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the use of information, electronic and computing devices, and network resources to conduct AUS business or interact with internal networks and business systems, whether owned or leased by AUS, the employee, or a third party.

This policy applies to students, faculty and staff, contractors, consultants, temporaries, and other workers at AUS, including all personnel affiliated with third parties. This policy applies to all equipment that is owned or leased by AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- File Transfer Protocol (FTP): A computer network protocol specifying the transfer of text or binary files across the network.
- Internet: A term to describe connecting multiple separate networks together.
- Intranet: A computer network, especially one based on Internet technology, that an organization uses for its own internal, and usually private, purposes and that is closed to outsiders.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- IT Acceptable Use Procedure

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 1, 2012	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

2. Prohibited Acts and Proper Resource Utilization Policy - Version 4

Policy Number:	0700IT05	Policy title:	Prohibited Acts and Proper Resource Utilization Policy
Prepared by:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue date:	May 31, 2012
Responsible office/ Functional area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective date:	August 31, 2024
Approved by:	Chancellor	Date of next revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

Prohibited Acts and Proper Resource Utilization Policy

2. Purpose:

Outline the prohibited acts and proper utilization of university resources.

3. Introduction / background:

The Information Technology Department (IT) is neither an investigative nor a disciplinary entity in its primary responsibilities. However, in cases where university resources and privileges are abused or otherwise threatened, the department may be asked to take appropriate steps. Immediate revocation of access and subsequent prosecution by the authorities, for example, might be directed. Such revocation may be appealed to the IT Steering Committee.

Another example would be to both discipline and hold accountable an individual who damages IT resources. Improper access or modification of AUS information in a computer system may also bring a stiff penalty.

4. Policy Statement:

Prohibited acts include but are not limited to the following:

- Intentional denial of computing service to other users.
- Exploitation of insecure accounts or resources.
- Attempting to guess, crack or otherwise determine another user's password.
- Interception of network transmissions with hardware or software "sniffers."
- Forging of electronic mail or electronic news or otherwise misrepresent themselves or other individuals in any electronic communication.
- System administrators are not to use their access to examine the private information of other users except in the course of resolving problems and where access to such information is necessary. In these cases, IT staff are required to seek permission and oversight.
- IT staff may not transfer resources (hardware, software, documentation, etc.) from designated locations without the explicit permission of their supervisor. The Supply Chain Department shall be notified of the movement and shall update the employee's inventory record accordingly.
- AUS employees or students may not load any software onto their workstations or servers that has not been purchased or is not free. Software identified as "shareware" should be examined carefully to ensure there is compliance with any licensing requirements. Under no

circumstances will software binaries from unknown or illegal sources be placed on workstations or servers.

- Under no circumstances will AUS employees or students share account passwords, key combinations, alarm codes, keys, access cards or any other access control mechanism for any university resource or facility with any individual in a manner inconsistent with the policies established by their supervisor. In the absence of such policies, employees must have the explicit permission of their supervisor to share any access mechanism to any department resource.
- AUS staff or faculty who bring vendors or personal guests into AUS IT facilities must make sure that these guests are escorted at ALL times with care given to protecting AUS equipment, facilities and information.
- IT management reserves the right to audit university-owned workstations and servers without warning for the purpose of verifying software-licensing compliance.
- All computer and network access is denied unless expressly granted. Access is generally granted by the IT Department in the form of computer and network accounts to registered students, faculty, staff and others as appropriate for such purposes as research, education (including self-study), or university administration. University accounts are protected by passwords.
- Accounts are assigned to individuals and are not to be shared unless specifically authorized. You, the user, are solely responsible for all functions performed from accounts assigned to you. Anything done through your account may be recorded. It is a violation of university policy to allow others to use your account. It is a violation to use another person's account, with or without that person's permission.
- Your password, used with your account, is the equivalent of your electronic signature. The use of user ID and password authenticates your identity and gives your online affirmation the force of a legal document. You should guard your password and account as you would your checkbook and written signature. It is a violation of this policy to divulge your password to anyone. It is a violation to attempt to learn the password to another person's account, whether the attempt is successful or not. Be sure that you check the Password Policy for further details on how to choose a strong password and keep it protected.
- You may not attempt to disguise your identity, the identity of your account or the machine that you are using. You may not attempt to impersonate another person or organization.
- You may not attempt to monitor other users' data communications; you may not infringe the privacy of others' computer files; you may not read, copy, change or delete another user's computer files or software without the prior express permission of the owner.
- You may not engage in actions that interfere with the use by others of any computers and networks. Such conduct includes, but is not limited to, the placing of unlawful information on the system; the transmitting of data or programs likely to result in the loss of the recipient's work or system downtime; the sending of "chain letters" or "broadcast" messages to lists or individuals; any other use that causes congestion of the networks or interferes with the work of others.
- You may not engage in actions that threaten or intentionally offend others, such as the use of abusive or obscene language in either public or private messages, or the conveying of threats to individuals or institutions by way of AUS computers and/or networks.
- You may not attempt to bypass computer or network security mechanisms without the prior express permission of the owner of that computer or network system. Possession of tools that bypass security or probe security, or of files that may be used as input or output for such tools, shall be considered as the equivalent to such an attempt.
- You may not alter, copy or translate software licensed to another party. You may not make available copyrighted materials without the express permission of the copyright holder.

Respect for intellectual labor is vital to the academic discourse. Violations of authorial integrity, plagiarism, invasion of privacy, unauthorized access, and trade secret and copyright violations may be grounds for university sanctions as well as legal prosecution.

To summarize, access to university computing and communications equipment and facilities may be revoked for reasons including, but not limited to:

- attacking the security of the system
- modifying or divulging private information such as file or mail contents of other users without their consent
- modifying or destroying university data, or
- using the networks in a manner contrary to the established guidelines.

Finally, users may not read sensitive information simply because it is accessible to them—because of accidental exposure and/or through the malice of others who have broken into a system or are misusing their access privileges. When sensitive information is recognized as such, it should not be examined further.

5. Scope/applicability:

- All University users

6. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N/A

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- IT Acceptable Use Policy and Procedure

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 31, 2012	New Policy	ICT and IT Security Department
2.0	December 31, 2018	Changed to new format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

4.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
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10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

e. Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy - Version 5

Policy Number:	0700IT06	Policy Title:	Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	May 31, 2012
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this document is to establish the responsibilities for equipment and software technical support in the academic areas of the University.

3. Introduction / background: N/A

4. Policy Statement:

4.1 Technical Support for University-Owned Hardware in Academic Areas: The Education Technology & Support unit of the Department of ICT and IT Security aims to support, educate and serve students, faculty and staff with innovative technologies for use in instructional teaching and learning spaces.

Responsibilities include:

- Install and support University-owned IT equipment and schedule periodic maintenance.
- Build and implement a standard configuration for university-owned computers.
- Convene a group of campus IT staff to collectively specify standard models of computers and devices for end-users to ensure compatibility with the University infrastructure.
- Secure laboratory equipment with the use of automated access control system.
- Keep an updated inventory of laboratory and classrooms equipment.

Education Technology & Support provides front-line support and services to faculty, staff and students during the University working hours from Mon-Thu (8AM-5PM).

For support and services, users can either:

- Visit the nearest IT Service Desk Center.
- Login into the online IT Service Desk portal at ITservicedesk.aus.edu.
- Send an email to ITservicedesk@aus.edu.
- Call the College/School specific hotline numbers.

4.1.1 Replacement cycle for faculty computers: Education Technology & Support maintains an equipment replacement cycle for faculty members to meet on-going demand for newer iterations

of hardware technology. Full-time faculty members receive a new computer every three years that best suits their teaching and research needs.

4.1.2 Replacement cycle for general computer labs and classrooms: General purpose computer equipment is replaced every three to four years, and high-end performance equipment is replaced every three years.

The instructional equipment is replaced when they reach the end of their operational life cycle. These include, but are not limited to:

- Computers and laptops
- Projectors and projector screens
- Printers
- Smart boards
- Lecterns
- Interactive Displays and TVs
- Handheld Devices
- Lecture capture cameras
- Audio and video systems

4.2 Technical Support for University-Owned Software: Education Technology & Support stores the authorized academic software, software documentation and licensing information in a secure centralized location.

The University established a software licensing agreement that provide students, faculty, and staff access to the latest versions of academic software required for instructional teaching and learning. The software is renewed annually to keep licenses up to date with the latest version.

Responsibilities include:

- Install academic software in all academic areas, including general and technical computer labs, studios and classrooms.
- Install and configure academic software on faculty computers and devices, and provide ongoing maintenance and support.
- Track and keep the academic software up-to-date with the latest upgrades and patches.
- Ensure the software licensing servers are functioning at high availability.
- Troubleshoot and resolve issues related to software.
- Manage software usage for better decision making and higher ROI.
- Monitor and track academic software to stay in compliance with license agreements.

4.3 Technical Support for student-Owned Hardware: Education Technology & Support provides hardware support to the University students.

Responsibilities include:

- Recommend hardware specifications and warranty bundles that meet technology requirements for the various majors and concentrations.
- Troubleshoot hardware issues on a priority basis.
- Setup, configure and troubleshoot network connectivity issues on student laptops and mobile devices.
- Provide Loaner laptops/devices to students in the laptop program while their laptops are in for repair at one of the University service desks.

4.4 Technical Support for student-Owned software: Education Technology & Support supports students' software related to their university courses.

Responsibilities include:

- Install and configure course-related licensed software on student laptops and mobile devices.
- Install, configure, and troubleshoot licensed Windows and Mac OSX Operating Systems.
- Install the latest software updates from Microsoft and Mac OSX.
- Install free Antivirus and removal of viruses and malware.
- Install network printers' drivers.
- Configure email clients.
- Install the University Course Management System mobile app.

5. Scope/applicability: This policy applies to software and hardware assets that are used for academic, non-personal purposes.

6. Responsibilities:

- Responsibilities are as outlined in section 4 of this policy document.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N/A

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Software Installation and Support Policy.
- IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 31, 2012	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

2.0	March 20, 2019	Changed to New Format	Office of Institutional Research and Analysis
3.0	November 05, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Office of Institutional Research and Analysis
4.0	May 20, 2024	Edited Policy: Updated the “Service Desk” office name and working hours.	ICT & IT Security
5.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

f. Security Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	0700GS07	Policy Title:	Security Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Protocol and Security	Issue Date:	September 1, 2016
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Protocol and Security	Effective Date:	May 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chief of Protocol	Date of Next Revision:	May 31, 2025

1. Policy

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) reflects the progressive spirit of the UAE. AUS students, faculty, and staff hail from several nationalities, cultures, and religions, with over 5,000 students and more than 850 faculty and staff members at the university. Security measures are, therefore, necessary to maintain a safe and secure environment for staff, students, and visitors. The university has developed and applied security controls and procedures. Security is not intended to be a hindrance to academic activity but an essential ingredient for the efficient operation of the university.

Our commitment to a safe and secure community can be seen in several ways. Our security officers come with some of the best, comprehensive training. We work hand-in-hand with local police, fire, and traffic departments as a team dedicated to providing a secure campus and community, and we continue to seek new and better ways to serve the AUS campus.

2. Purpose

It is recognized that the Office of Security and Protocol has an important role in supporting the university's key strategic aims. In line with the resources available, the key objectives of the Office of Protocol and Security are:

- Ensuring the safety and security of the students, faculty, staff, visitors, and contractors.
- Protecting the property and assets of the university.
- Reducing the incidence of reported crime.
- Maximize the efficiency and effectiveness of the department.

The security objectives can be achieved through:

- Providing security personnel 24/7.
- Patrolling the AUS campus.
- Provision and monitoring of CCTV cameras in a considerable number of academic buildings within a plan to cover all academic buildings.
- Developments in the installation and use of technology for areas such as building access and identification systems.
- Improved communication between the security team and the students, faculty, staff, visitors, and contractors.
- Providing information and advice on safety, security, and crime prevention.
- Ensuring buildings are locked in line with agreed schedules.
- Monitoring of service levels to amend where necessary.

3. Introduction

AUS POLICIES AND PROCEDURES MANUAL | AY24-25 | VERSION 5

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The American University of Sharjah (AUS) reflects the progressive spirit of the UAE. AUS students, faculty, and staff hail from several nationalities, cultures, and religions, with over 5000 students and more than 850 faculty and staff members at the university.

Despite AUS being a safe and secure place, theft of personal possessions such as wallets, purses, handbags, laptops, mobile phones, scooters, etc., is possible if these items are left unsecured or unattended. Security measures are, therefore, necessary to maintain a safe and secure environment for staff, students, and visitors.

The university has developed and applied security control and procedures. Security is not intended to be a hindrance to academic activity but an essential ingredient for the efficient operation of the university.

Responsibility for personal property remains with the owner of the property. The university takes no responsibility for such property left on the premises, including motor vehicles, laptops, wallets, mobile phones, Bicycles/e-scooters, etc., although the team and related personnel will aim to provide a security presence across the campus at key times.

AUS is a very safe university community. However, things do occur and no matter how infrequent or how minor a theft may be, when you are the victim, it is serious, frustrating, and at best inconvenient. So, the Office of Protocol and Security offers you the following advice:

- Never leave your valuables items (i.e. laptops, mobile phone, wallet, etc) unattended even for a moment.
- Remember credit card numbers or add them to your mobile phone wallet. This will help you in the event they are lost or stolen.
- Instead of carrying your credit card with you all the time, add them to your mobile wallet and use (apple pay, Samsung pay or google pay) services.
- Properly secure your bicycle or e-scooter to bike racks. Make sure you have registered your bike or e-scooter using the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.
- Nearly every theft in residential halls occurs as a result of an unlocked door. So, lock your door when the room is unoccupied or when you are sleeping.
- Any personal computers or laptops should have labels with your name on it.
- Share your security concerns or report security incidents through the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.

4. Policy Statement

AUS will endeavor to ensure and promote, as far as is reasonably practicable, the security of all its students, employees, contractors, and visitors at its campus.

The Office of Protocol and Security is responsible for effectively operating and enforcing the Security Policy and Procedures. While the responsibility for personal safety and security rests with all students, faculty, staff, visitors, and contractors, the Office of Protocol and Security seeks their assistance to ensure the successful implementation of this policy.

5. Scope/applicability

Our commitment to a safe and secure community can be seen in several ways. Our security officers come with some of the best, comprehensive training. We work hand-in-hand with local police, fire, and traffic departments as a team dedicated to providing a secure campus and community, and we continue to seek new and better ways to serve the AUS campus.

Security personnel are responsible for managing various tasks, including investigations, violations, traffic, parking, and issuing car stickers and IDs.

We always welcome the opportunity to answer questions or to simply get to know you better. We operate 24/7.

This Security Policy, therefore, seeks to formulate a cohesive and integrated approach to security services throughout the university.

6. Responsibilities

Responsibility for security rests with all students, faculty, staff, and visitors to the university. In particular, all suspicious activities should immediately be reported to the nearest security guard, or through the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.

Within this overall responsibility, some particular elements are defined as follows:

- a. Senior Management: should ensure that support and resources are available to staff to implement the Security Policy. Necessary measures to improve security in essential areas should receive priority consideration.
- b. Chief of Protocol and Security: Responsible for the overall development and planning of security strategy, policies, and procedures and overseeing the operations of the Office of Protocol and Security.
- c. Security Team Leader: Responsible for coordinating between AUS and University City police and external security service providers, supervising all security department works. Development and implementation of security strategies, policies, and procedures and the monitoring of their effectiveness and efficiency and updating of these policies and procedures. Investigation of crime, breaches in security, and student disciplinary matters. Day-to-day management and implementation of the parking policy and procedures. Issuance and getting back of car stickers.
- d. Security Field Officer: Management of security field-guards; delivery of an efficient and effective guarding service to the university and implementation of the security policy and procedures; performing security duties such as security patrolling, traffic and parking control.
- e. Security System Officer: Management of CCTV, and access control. Advice on implementing security hardware, access control, CCTV installations, etc., and issuing, renewing, and receiving AUS identity cards.
- f. Security Team (officers and guards): In addition to the above specific responsibilities of each member of the Office of Protocol and Security, the services offered by the Office of Protocol and Security include the following:
 - Ensuring the security of the university community and its property by providing protection 24/7.
 - Receiving and responding to complaints, concerns and emergency calls. These can be done either by calling AUS personnel via the AUS security number (+971 50 6267 818), through the ONLINE PLATFORM, or by visiting the security offices (rooms MM30 and MM33 on the west mezzanine floor of the Main Building).

- Issuing and renewing AUS car stickers for faculty, staff, and students. Note: to avoid fines, the AUS car sticker shall be returned to the Office of Protocol and Security if the car is sold, the sticker is damaged or is not in use, the owner of sticker is graduating or leaving AUS.
 - Issuing and renewing AUS ID card.
 - Issuing temporary permission and special permits for cars
 - Issuing bicycle & e-scooter stickers
 - Providing vehicle assistance including Re-charging car battery, help to open locked vehicles, or assist/Arrange a towing service.
 - Enforcing traffic safety regulations concerning:
 - Parking Policy
 - Campus paid parking system.
 - Car registration, and
 - Violation of traffic regulations
- a. Provost, deans, and heads of departments: These individuals have a key role in promoting security within their area. The actual responsibilities will vary according to the location and the activity's nature. While the provost, dean, and heads of department can delegate some of their security responsibilities to a nominated person in their department, the overall responsibility for security remains with them. Specific responsibilities can be identified as follows:
- Ensuring their staff have access to and are familiar with, the Security Policy, paying particular attention to issues directly relevant to their department.
 - Ensuring that all members of staff and students in their department understand and exercise their security responsibilities, including the displaying of university identity cards, and have due regard to university property (see sections below), in particular, the security of IT equipment.
 - Liaise with the Security Team on any security matter.
 - Controlling access to their departmental areas by approving the issuance of keys and authorizing staff to have out-of-hours access only as necessary.
 - Ensuring that, on the last day of work, their departmental staff return their own, and their dependents' AUS identity cards, car stickers, and any issued keys to the Office of Protocol and Security.
 - Notifying the security team of any security risk.
- b. Faculty and Staff: All faculty and staff must ensure they are familiar with and follow the procedures in the AUS Security Policy, paying particular attention to issues relevant to their activities. They must also cooperate with requests from the Security Division, especially in emergency or evacuation situations and in relation to security procedures. When on university property, staff are required at all times to carry their university ID cards.

All staff who reside on campus should ensure their dependents are aware of the security policy and procedures and comply with all laws and rules.

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management provides the Emergency Response Handbook to AUS community members. The emergency Response Handbook offers advice and information on emergency response procedures related to different scenarios. The [Emergency Response Handbook](#) is available on the AUS Website.

- c. Students: The students' responsibilities are to look after university facilities properly and to give the due consideration to security issues. They must follow security procedures designed to protect university property. Students must cooperate with requests from Security, especially in emergency or evacuation situations and in relation to security procedures.

All students are subject to UAE laws and AUS policies, regulations, and procedures affecting

students, which include security instructions and restrictions.

The students should be aware of all codes of conduct in the student handbook. Students are required to carry their AUS ID cards with them at all times when on university property and hand them over to security upon request.

The Office of Students Affairs provides a Student Handbook to all freshman students during their orientation day. The handbook offers advice and information on security issues such as the student code of conduct, Library code of conduct, etc., and on the AUS Website.

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management provides the Emergency Response Handbook to AUS community members. The emergency Response Handbook offers advice and information on emergency response procedures related to different scenarios. The Emergency Response Handbook is available on the AUS Website.

- d. Visitors: All visitors (including conference delegates and external event attendees) have a general responsibility to look after the university facilities whilst on campus and to give due consideration to security issues. In particular, they must follow security procedures designed to protect university property and, where issued, wear their visitor's badge at all times. Visitors must follow instructions from the Security Team, particularly in emergency situations.

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management provides the Emergency Response Handbook to AUS community members. The emergency Response Handbook offers advice and information on emergency response procedures related to different scenarios. The Emergency Response Handbook is available on the AUS Website.

- e. Contractors: All contractors have a general responsibility for looking after AUS facilities and should be present only in the location related to their tasks and follow the security instructions and show their identity and gate pass when asked.

The Office of Safety and Crisis Management provides the Emergency Response Handbook to AUS community members. The emergency Response Handbook offers advice and information on emergency response procedures related to different scenarios. The Emergency Response Handbook is available on the AUS Website.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms

1. Access Control: The process of granting or denying specific requests to obtain and use information and related information processing services.
2. Security online form: This refers to a digital document used to collect and process information related to security matters online. It could include reporting incidents, requesting access, or other security-related tasks conducted through a web-based interface.
3. Emergency Response handbook: This is a comprehensive guide that outlines procedures and protocols to be followed in the event of emergencies such as fires, natural disasters, medical emergencies, or security threats. It provides essential information on how individuals and organizations should respond to mitigate risks and ensure safety.
4. Student handbook: Also known as a student manual or guidebook, this document outlines the policies, rules, regulations, and procedures governing student conduct and academic life within AUS. It typically includes information on academics, student rights and responsibilities, campus resources, and community standards.

5. **Lost ID clearance form:** This is a form used to report the loss of an identification card (ID) and request clearance or replacement. It may require specific details about the lost ID and personal identification to verify the identity of the person requesting clearance or a replacement ID.
6. **Traffic fine appeal:** This refers to a formal process by which an individual challenges a traffic violation citation issued by authorities. The appeal usually involves submitting a written explanation or attending a hearing to present reasons why the fine should be reduced or dismissed. This can be done through the Security Online Form.
7. **AUS smoke-free campus policy:** This policy outlines regulations and guidelines prohibiting smoking and tobacco use on the campus of the American University of Sharjah (AUS). It typically includes penalties for violations, and support resources for those looking to quit smoking.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources

AUS is a very safe university community. However, things do occur and no matter how infrequent or how minor a theft may be, when you are the victim, it is serious, frustrating, and at best inconvenient. So, the Office of Protocol and Security offers you the following advice:

- Never leave your valuables items (i.e. laptops, mobile phone, wallet, etc) unattended even for a moment.
- Remember credit card numbers or add them to your mobile phone wallet. This will help you in the event they are lost or stolen.
- Instead of carrying your credit card with you all the time, add them to your mobile wallet and use (apple pay, Samsung pay or google pay) services.
- Properly secure your bicycle or e-scooter to bike racks. Make sure you have registered your bike or e-scooter using the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.
- Nearly every theft in residential halls occurs as a result of an unlocked door. So lock your door when the room is unoccupied or when you are sleeping.
- Any personal computers or laptops should have labels with your name on it.
- Share your security concerns or report security incidents through the ONLINE PLATFORM
- offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.

8.1 Lost and Found

- Lost and found can be reported to the security field office located on the ground floor of the Student Centre. You may also contact us by phone or email. Describe the item in detail and be sure to leave your name, ID number and phone number. The security officer will call you if your item is found.
- If you have found an item and wish to turn it, you may visit the security field office located on the ground floor of the Student Centre. The security field office is open 24/7.
- Lost and found items are logged in on a daily basis during the week and are stored at the security field office. If not claimed during a week, items will be sent to Student Affairs lost and found office which is located at Student Center reception desk where items unclaimed will be given to charitable organizations, sold or destroyed.
- In order to claim a lost item, you must bring your AUS ID card.

8.2 Motor Vehicle Assistance

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FOR A SMALL FEE OF AED 25, SECURITY PERSONNEL CAN OFFER ASSISTANCE IN THE FOLLOWING SITUATIONS:

1. Re-charging car battery
2. Helping to open locked vehicles; contacting the appropriate outlets in case of missing car keys
3. Arranging for towing services

8.3 AUS ID Cards

Students, faculty, staff, and eligible dependents will be issued an AUS identity card. This card should be carried at all times when being on a university property, and shall be handed over to security upon request. This ID should be returned to security office if:

- a student withdraws from courses, graduates or leaves AUS for any reason.
- the faculty or staff member (including their eligible dependents) leave AUS. AUS faculty and staff are responsible for returning the ID card issued to any one of their dependents when they leave AUS.
- the temporary ID card expires.

8.4 Students

a. New ID

- All registered students are eligible for an AUS ID card. New students should apply for the ID card before the deadline each semester; otherwise, a fine of AED 50 will be imposed.

b. To obtain an ID, Student must:

- settle all financial requirements with the AUS Finance Department.
- Email one passport-size photo (softcopy, white background) to idcards@aus.edu
- submit their blood group to the University Health Clinic
- register for their courses

c. Requirements for AUS ID Picture:

- Passport size picture
- Proper dress code
- Ladies should be wearing a proper office attire with blazer (shoulder should not be visible)
- Men should be wearing proper office attire.
- the background should be white.
- No sunglasses should be worn.
- No heavy accessories should be worn.

d. Lost ID

If a student loses his or her ID, he or she should complete the Lost ID Clearance Form, then submit it to the Office of Protocol and Security. The student must pay a fine of 100 AED. The fine will be placed on the student's account. Replacement cards will not be issued until this fine is paid. This charge is not required if the ID card is stolen (a police report is required in this case).

e. Renewing an ID

Registered students who did not renew their IDs before the deadline (usually the last day of first week of classes) will be fined AED 50. If they do not renew their ID card till the last day of the second week of classes, they will be fined AED 100. The fine will be deducted automatically from their accounts. The student reserves the right to appeal within ten working days of the fine being applied.

8.5 Faculty/Staff

To obtain an ID, faculty and staff members must send passport-size photo (soft copy) and their ID number to the Office of Protocol and Security through (idcards@aus.edu). They must also submit their blood group to University Health Clinic.

a. Requirements for AUS ID Picture:

- Passport size picture
- Proper dress code
 - Ladies should be wearing a proper office attire with blazer (shoulder should not be visible)
 - Men should be wearing proper office attire.
- the background should be white.
- No sunglasses should be worn.
- No heavy accessories should be worn.

a. Lost ID

If a faculty member, staff member or dependent loses his or her ID, he or she must complete the Lost ID Clearance Form, then submit it to the Office of Protocol and Security Office. The faculty/staff must pay a fine of 100 AED. The fine will be deducted from the monthly salary. This charge is not required if the ID has been stolen (a police report is required in this case).

8.6 Dependents

All faculty and staff dependents above 14 years of age are eligible for an ID card. To obtain an ID, one must submit a passport-size photo and his/her ID number to Security Division. He/she must also submit his/her blood group to University Health Clinic.

8.7 Alumni

Alumni are eligible for alumni ID cards, which allow them access to campus and use its services. The student ID and car sticker should be returned before an alumni card can be issued.

8.8 Access Control

8.9 For faculty/staff and students working in schools/colleges:

Access is granted by the school/college ACS-assigned operator. According to the instructions of the dean of the designated school, the schools ACS operators are to be identified by deans and director's secretary as shown:

- CAS
- SBA
- SEN
- CAAD

- RH

8.10 For Faculty/Staff Working in Non-Academic Departments

- Access is granted according to a request approved by the dean/director/manager of the department to the ACS administrator (Main Building) aus_security@aus.edu
- Any access control hardware and/or software installation or relocation request should get the approval of the Office of Protocol and Security.

8.11 Parking Services

AUS Parking Services is offered by the Office of Protocol and Security. The Office of Protocol and Security is responsible for the development and execution of the approved parking policies, administration of the parking system, collection of approved fees, and the enforcement of parking regulations, providing the highest quality customer-focused services that promote safe, efficient, reliable, and convenient parking.

Students who live on campus are not eligible to park in the academic area except during periods when parking restrictions are suspended. Visitors may use only the visitors' parking space as assigned in the gate pass issued to permit entry to the campus.

8.12 Parking Limitations/Prohibitions

- Officials posted signs shall govern the use of all areas.
- Failure to park so that the entire vehicle lies between the lines that designate the parking space is prohibited.
- Parking at any time on campus roads, lawns, loading docks, walkways, delivery entrances, disabled person dedicated parking spaces, or any other unauthorized parking area is prohibited.
- Securing or using parking privileges through misrepresentation or fraud is prohibited.
- Failure to display the AUS vehicle car sticker or gate pass is prohibited.
- Unauthorized or improper use of visitor parking is prohibited.
- Vehicle storage (parking over 48 hours) is prohibited without getting permission from the Office of Protocol and Security.

8.13 Enforcement

Campus parking and traffic regulations, as well as UAE and Sharjah traffic laws, are enforced by the AUS security team.

8.14 University Holidays and Weekends

- Parking lot restrictions are suspended on university holidays and weekends, except in designated disabled person dedicated parking spaces, and areas posted as reserved.
- Parking restrictions remain in effect for all campus roads, fire lanes, delivery entrances, walkways, lawns, and other unauthorized parking areas.

8.15 Wheel Locking

For the following violations, vehicles are subject to wheel locking without notice.

- Any vehicle obstructing a roadway, loading ramp, or that in any other way obstructs traffic.

- Any vehicle parked without authorization in a space reserved for disabled persons.
- A vehicle parked in other than a clearly marked parking space.
- Any individual who disregards a lawful order from a member of the Security Team.
- Any vehicle parked without displaying an AUS car sticker.

8.16 Appeals Process (Traffic Fine Appeals)

Individuals who feel that a notice of violation has been improperly issued may submit a Traffic Fine Appeal, within seven days of receipt of a parking fine. No appeal will be accepted after the deadline.

8.17 Limitation of Liability

Persons with parking privileges are entitled to the use of appropriate parking spaces. Acceptance of parking privileges car sticker constitutes an agreement between the holder and the university and that the university shall not be responsible for the loss or damage to the vehicle, its accessories, or contents, resulting from theft, fire, collision, or any other cause.

8.18 Fines issued by Police

For the following violations, the University City Police will be called to issue the fine according to UAETraffic Law in addition to the fine issued by AUS Security.

- Exceeding speed limit.
- Negligent driving.
- Violations committed by non-AUS members.
- Wheel spinning.
- Endangering self-driving or endangering others.
- Blocking obstructing parking entry, exit, or internal roads.
- Wrong parking.

8.19 Car Accident

If you get into a car accident, you should pull out of the driving lane and turn off the ignition. Immediately call the security emergency number (+97150 626 7818) to inform the security office of the accident and get medical assistance if needed.

The security officer will come to the accident scene and call the University City police to investigate and issue the accident report.

The police will conduct legal procedures before issuing a police accident report for fixing/repairing the car(s) if any damage has been caused.

If there is any damage to AUS property, a police letter will be sent to the Office of Protocol and Security. This letter should be handed over to office MM26 in the Main building, Mezzanine floor.

After receiving the police letter, the Facilities Department will estimate the damage. The driver responsible needs to pay the estimated amount before receiving a release letter from the Office of Protocol and Security.

8.20 Car Sticker

All faculty, staff, and students must register their vehicles and display a valid AUS car sticker.

8.20.1 Registration: entitles a person to drive on campus and to park in designated parking spaces in parking lots only. It does not guarantee the availability or location of a parking space.

8.20.2 Online Registration for Car Stickers:

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- All members of the AUS community who wish to own and drive their cars on campus must register their cars with the AUS Security office.
- All applications for getting /renewing car stickers will be made online using the banner at <https://banner.aus.edu/>
- All applicants will be asked to fill out a form and provide details, including personal details, car details, and the type of parking they wish and are eligible to get.
- After the online registration, students are required to bring their valid AUS ID card, driving license, and car registration to office number MM30, Mezzanine floor of the main building, within three working days to receive their stickers.
- The online registration for issuance/renewal will expire or be cancelled if the above documents are not supplied within three working days of registration.
- Students have to pay the due fees online.
- Paid parking stickers for students are limited and will be distributed on the first-come, first-served bases. After all the spaces are booked, interested students may choose to register themselves on an online waiting list for a chance to get a space in cases of cancellations or revocations.
- Students who live off campus have to register for free parking car stickers if they don't get paid parking stickers.
- All cars operated and parked at AUS MUST DISPLAY CAR STICKERS.

8.20.3 Issuing Car Parking Hang Tags

- Permanent car parking hang tags are issued to AUS students, faculty staff, and contractors.
- Temporary permits are issued for visitors, faculty, or staff on campus part-time or short-term, and for using rental cars.

8.20.4 Misuse of Car Sticker

If any student is found using an AUS car sticker that is not issued to him/her, the student will be charged with fraud, and his/her file will be transferred to the Office of Judicial Affairs. If the card is borrowed from another student, it will be confiscated, and the paid fees will not be refunded. A student can apply for a new card only after a minimum of one month and/or a maximum of four months from the date of confiscation, with a new payment.

8.21 Campus Paid-parking System

Parking areas on the central campus (not including residential halls parking) are divided into four categories:

- Reserved
- Paid
- Free
- Visitor

8.21.1 Reserved Parking

- Parking spaces in this category can be reserved for eligible faculty and staff members and will be numbered.
- Parking lots designated under this category are P12, P14, P15

8.21.2 Faculty and Staff Parking

- Parking spaces in this category are for eligible faculty and staff members. The availability of parking spaces within this category is not guaranteed. Spaces are accessible on a “first-come, first-served” basis.
- Parking lots designated under this category are P1, P3, P8, P9, P11, P13, P17, P19, and P20.

Note: Faculty and Staff are also permitted to use paid parking & free parking

8.21.3 Paid Parking

Paid parking lots are primarily available to students who live off campus. The students are required to pay a fee of AED 300 per academic year.

Paying the annual fees for paid parking does not guarantee the availability of parking spaces or grant a right to reserve a space within the paid parking space. Spaces are accessible on a “first-come, first-served” basis.

Parking lots designated under this category are P2, P4, P7, and P10.

8.21.4 Free Parking

Parking spaces in this category are available to off-campus (commuting) students, staff, faculty, and visitors.

Parking lots designated under this category are P5 & P6.

8.21.5 Visitor Parking

Parking spaces in this category are available for visitors who do not belong to the AUS community (i.e., who are not AUS faculty, staff, or students). The main parking lot designated for visitors under this category is P16 (mosque parking).

8.21.6 General Rules

- Students residing in residential halls are required to park their cars only in the spaces assigned to them within their residential halls parking areas. Students residing off-campus are not allowed to park their cars in residential halls parking areas. Fines will be imposed if vehicles are parked in unauthorized areas.
- Students residing with their parents on campus are not allowed to use their parent’s or spouse’s stickers to park in paid or reserved parking. They can only park in free parking areas or obtain their own paid parking student car sticker.
- In case the car carrying a paid sticker is not being used by its owner (due to an accident or the vehicle has gone for service, etc.), a temporary permit will be issued allowing the person to park in the Paid parking.
- As per service needs and requirements, university services vehicles can park anywhere on campus (during duty time only).
- The space owners do not have the right to lend or lease their space under any circumstance.
- The reserved spaces are to be used for short-term only.
- Parking spaces can be changed only after informing the Office of Protocol and Security.
- While on holiday or away from campus for a considerable duration of time, faculty and staff living on campus can only park their vehicles in the spaces provided at their residences.
- Any car not displaying a car sticker will be fined AED 50.
- Car stickers will be renewed annually.

- Any car sticker should be returned to the Office of Protocol and Security when the holder leaves AUS. Faculty and staff are responsible for returning the car sticker issued to any of their dependents.

8.22 Campus Bicycle and E-Scooter Policy

The purpose of this policy is to clearly define the rules and restrictions pertaining to the possession and use of a bicycle or e-scooter on campus. All Bicycles/e-scooters & e-scooters must be registered with the Campus Security Office. Failure to do so will incur a fine of AED 50. Bicycles/e-scooters and e-scooters are to be parked in designated locations outside buildings.

Bicycles/e-scooters and e-scooter may not be kept in hallways, under stairways, residence halls, or other places. AUS Security will remove Bicycles/e-scooters left in unauthorized places, and the owner must pay a fee of AED 50 to reclaim the bicycle.

- Skateboards, roller skates, and roller blades do not fall under this category and are hence not subject to this policy.

8.22.1 Bicycle/E-Scooter Registration

- Any member of the AUS community who wishes to own and ride a bicycle or e-scooter on campus must have them registered with AUS Security.
- The bicycle/e-scooter owner can complete the registration process through the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.
- Bicycle/E-Scooter owners below the age of 15 must have a no objection letter from their guardian to complete their registration.
- A one-time registration fee of AED 20 is charged per bicycle/e-scooter.
- Upon registration, the bicycle/e-scooter will have a bar-code sticker stuck on the front side of the steering handle. It is the responsibility of the bicycle/e-scooter owner to regularly check that the sticker is present, has not come off and is clearly legible. If the registration sticker has fallen off, is worn off or has become illegible, the bicycle/e-scooter owner must report immediately to AUS Security to get another sticker free of charge.
- Mopeds, quad-bikes and other motor-powered vehicles are strictly forbidden on campus.

8.22.2 Rules and Regulations

a. Riding Regulations

- Bicycle/e-scooter may only be ridden upon sidewalks and designated lanes. However, every person riding a bicycle/e-scooter shall yield the right of way to pedestrians at all times.
- The riders must be very cautious when riding on campus. Accidental collisions may seriously injure pedestrians or other riders. A bicyclist or e-scooterist who strikes anyone is liable for all medical expenses of that victim and any damage done to the victim's property.
- Obstacle riding or other acts or manoeuvres that may endanger the bicyclist or e-scooterist or others or damage property is prohibited.
- Bicycle/e-scooter racing is strictly prohibited.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters are not to be ridden at high, sprinting speeds at any time. Brisk riding is not permitted unless being coordinated with the Office of Protocol and Security.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters shall not be ridden upon any ramp, stairway, wall, bench, fountain, or other structure or facility or on or over shrubbery, grass or flower beds. Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters shall not be ridden within any building or parking structure except as part of a university-approved competition or function or within designated lanes.
- No person riding a bicycle/e-scooter shall attach the same in any manner to any moving vehicle.

- No bicycle/e-scooter shall be used to carry more than one person (the rider) at one time. Adult A bicyclist may carry a child securely attached to his/her person in a backpack or sling or in a child carrier securely attached to the bicycle.
- No person riding a bicycle/e-scooter shall carry any package, bundle, or other article which may prevent the operator from keeping at least one hand on the handlebars.
- Every bicycle/e-scooter shall be equipped with brakes, reflectors and other safety devices.

b. Parking Regulations

- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters may only be parked in the parking rails provided near each campus building.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters must never be parked directly in front of any entrance or driveway.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters must never be parked inside any building.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters must never be secured to any utility line, lamp post, gate, railing, divider, post or vehicle.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters not to be ridden on university property between the hours of 00:00 a.m. and 6:00 a.m. except as necessary for the transportation of university employees and students who have legitimate reasons for being on university property during these hours.

c. Abandoned Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters.

- If a bicycle/e-scooter has been identified as potentially abandoned, AUS Security will stick an identifying note onto the bicycle/e-scooter handlebar. This warns the owner that if the bicycle/e-scooter is not removed within seven days, it will be removed by Security and kept in storage for 30 days. If still unclaimed, it will be donated to charity or as scrap if it is not in usable condition.
- If the bicycle/e-scooter is claimed, the owner will be asked to provide proof of ownership and will have to pay a penalty of AED 50.

d. A bicycle/e-scooter is classified as abandoned if it meets one or more of the following criteria:

- It is secured in an inappropriate place.
- It is not in a roadworthy condition.
- It has been parked in the same spot for over two weeks without being moved.

8.22.3 Enforcement

- AUS Security staff and university-contracted security personnel are authorized to monitor and inspect Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters and bicyclist/e-scooterist on campus, and thus have the right to enforce penalties in violation of the rules in this policy.
- Bicyclist/e-scooterist that are found to be without the registration sticker will be impounded immediately and the owners will be fined AED 50 for not having said sticker.
- Bicyclist/e-scooterist found violating any riding regulations will be fined AED 50 for each violation. The fine shall be levied on the owner of the bicycle/e-scooter regardless if he/she was driving the bicycle/e-scooter.
- Bicyclist/e-scooterist that cause, as a result of riding a bicycle/e-scooter, any injuries to any individuals or damages to any property, whether of an individual or of the university, will have their bicycle/e-scooter impounded and be suspended from riding bicycle/e-scooter on campus indefinitely depending on the severity of the offense, as per the discretion of AUS Security.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters found to be violating any parking regulations will be fined AED 50 for each violation and the bicycle/e-scooter would be impounded. The fine shall be levied on the owner of the bicycle/e-scooter regardless if he/she was riding it.

- Impounded Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters that have registration stickers will be kept under the custody of AUS Security for 30 calendar days, after which the bicycle/e-scooter will be auctioned off by AUS Logistics Division. Notifications will be duly sent to the owners of the bicycle/e-scooter.
- Impounded Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters that do not have registration stickers will be kept under the custody of AUS Security for 30 calendar days, after which the bicycle/e-scooter will be auctioned off by AUS Logistics Division. No effort will be made to track down and notify the owners of the Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters. Owners may issue an official claim on the impounded Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters to the Office of Protocol and Security provided they present any proof of purchase or ownership.
- Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters that are handed over to AUS Logistics Division for the purpose of auctioning off are considered unredeemable. The earnings from the auction would be donated to AUS Community Services Division as charity.
- A bicycle/e-scooter operator who strikes a pedestrian or other bicyclist/e-scooterist and does not stop to inquire whether any harm or damage has been done, has committed the crime of “hit and run, and thus would be subject to punishment as per UAE laws.
- All fines and punishments will be levied on the owner of the bicycle/e-scooter that was being ridden when a violation or offense is committed. The bicyclist/e-scooterist will also be charged accordingly by AUS Security, depending on the nature of the violation or offense. The charge may range from an official warning, a fine or an indefinite suspension of on-campus bicycle/e-scooter driving privileges.

8.23 Residential Parking Policy

Any member of the AUS community (faculty or staff) residing on campus who owns any vehicle(s) must abide by the residential parking guidelines included in the Residential Parking Policy.

Residential Parking Rules and Regulations

- Residents can only park their vehicles in the residential parking area in front of their homes in the space designated for their vehicles.
- The entire vehicle must be positioned between the lines that designate the parking space.
- Residents can park any additional car free of charge in any of the available parking spaces next to their homes or in the visitor parking spaces usually available in each block.
- Residents do not have the right to lend or lease their parking space under any circumstances.
- While on holiday or away from campus for a considerable length of time, residents can only park their vehicles in the spaces provided in front of their homes or in the extra residential spaces available.
- All vehicles must display a valid parking permit (e.g., car sticker or temporary gate pass).
- Residents are responsible for ensuring that visitors park their cars in the designated areas for visitors.
- Unauthorized or improper use of visitor parking is prohibited.
- Vehicle storage (parking over 96 hours) is prohibited without permission of the Office of Protocol and Security. Permission can be requested through the ONLINE PLATFORM offered by the Office of Protocol and Security.
- In case of special events, residents/visitors have to park their cars in available parking areas and not on the roads, roundabouts or in empty parking space reserved for residents. The Office of Protocol and Security should be notified 24 hours before any major event that would cause significant parking issues in the residential areas.
- Driving without a driving license or with a license for a different vehicle type is punishable by imprisonment for a period not exceeding three months or payment of a fine not exceeding AED 6,000 (see Traffic Federal Law No. 21 of 1995, Article 51).
- Driving against the flow of traffic on any road or roundabout is illegal.
- Parking is not allowed on the side of a road, in a roundabout or in residents' empty parking spaces regardless of the reason {dropping off children, deliveries...etc.}

- Parking is prohibited, at all times, on campus roads, lawns, loading docks, walkways, sidewalks, delivery entrances, parking areas for the disabled (unless the driver has a permit), or any other unauthorized parking area.
- All drivers must drive at a safe speed and not exceed 40 kilometres per hour.
- Disturbances such as loud music, excessive honking of horns, etc. are not allowed on campus.
- It is not permitted to leave unused vehicles, boats or other items taking up a parking space. On campus. These should be moved off.
- Campus parking and traffic regulations and UAE (Sharjah) vehicle laws are enforced by AUS Parking Services Officers.
- All resident drivers must have a valid UAE driving license.
- All drivers on campus are subject to UAE laws as well as campus security regulations.
- For violations and penalties, residents should refer to the section 14 of this policy.
- Any resident's car parked on campus should be registered in the UAE or display any GCC valid plate number.
- Residents are not authorized to block any car, even if it parked in their designated parking area. In such cases, residents should call the security officer on the emergency number 050 626 7818.
- Upon permanently leaving AUS, a resident should directly remove his/her car(s) from the housing area.
- Upon moving to a new housing unit on campus, a resident should immediately move his/her car(s).
- Any breach of these rules can be reported to the Office of Protocol and Security.
- Residents will be responsible for any violation of this parking policy they commit, as well as those committed by any of their dependents. Such violations may result in a fine, which will be automatically deducted from the resident employee's payroll account.
- AUS reserves the right to close and/or restrict use of any parking area for maintenance.
- AUS security is authorized to restrict the use of spaces on a temporary basis to accommodate special meetings, AUS-sponsored activities, or any other reason.
- AUS security reserves the right to tow away vehicles that remain on university property in an inoperative or abandoned condition and/or vehicles that do not comply with AUS parking regulations. Reasonable effort will be made by AUS security to contact the owner prior to removal. The towing will be at the owner's expense. If you require assistance with long-time storage for your vehicle, please contact AUS security via (aus_security@aus.edu).
- For the following violations, the University City Police will be called to issue the fine according to UAE Traffic Law. This is in addition to any fine that may be issued by AUS Security:
 - exceeding the speed limit
 - negligent driving
 - wheel spinning
 - violation committed by non-AUS community members
 - any other violation

8.24 Smoke-Free Policy

In line with trends worldwide relating to smoking in public places, the university is implementing a new campus-wide policy to create a smoke-free environment on the academic campus. This policy developed to comply with state law and to protect the AUS community from exposure to passive or secondhand smoke. Prohibiting smoking will help to educate the campus community to the danger of smoking and will encourage members of AUS community to cease using tobacco altogether. The policy also aims to keep the campus clean. Hence, despite the effort to provide receptacles, some smokers continue to extinguish their cigarettes on buildings and drop the cigarette butts on the ground, leading to permanent disfiguration of buildings and trashy appearance to the campus. For the purpose of this policy, "Smoking" refers to inhaling or exhaling, burning, carrying, or processing any lighted Tabaco product, such as cigars, cigarettes, or electronic cigarettes that emit smoke.

The [AUS Smoke-Free Campus Policy](#) including responsibilities and sanction is posted at AUS website.

8.25 Violations and Penalties Table

SN	Fine Description	First Violation
1	Parking Zone violation	AED 50
2	Restricted Entry Violation	AED 50
3	Exceeding Speeding Limit	AED 50
4	Negligent Driving	AED 50
5	Roundabout Parking Violation	AED 50
6	Bus Parking Violation	AED 50
7	Loading Entrance Blockage	AED 50
8	Main Roads Parking Violation	AED 50
9	Invalid Car Sticker	AED 50
10	Not Displaying Car Sticker/ Hangtag	AED 50
11	Not stopping for pedestrians' crossings.	AED 50
12	Not stopping at (STOP) signs.	AED 50
13	Not stopping while buses are loading or unloading students.	AED 50
14	Illegal over taking.	AED 50
15	Sudden start-up (wheeling).	AED 50
16	Breaking the Gate Barrier.	AED 50
17	Improper U-Turn.	AED 50
18	Escaping from Security personnel at check point.	AED 50
19	Not responding or answering readily.	AED 50
20	Driving the wrong way.	AED 50
21	Stopping on pedestrian lanes.	AED 50
22	Blocking traffic movement.	AED 50
23	Driving on sidewalks or pedestrian ways.	AED 50
24	Leaving engine running in parking regardless if driver is inside or outside the car.	AED 50
25	Failure to park (entire vehicle lies between the lines which designate the parkingspace)	AED 50
26	Securing or using parking privileges through misrepresentation or fraud.	AED 50
27	Unauthorized or improper use of visitor parking.	AED 50
28	Lost car sticker	AED 50
29	Bicycles/e-scooters /e-scooters without registration, will be impounded, owner will be fined	AED 50
30	Bicyclists/e-scooterist /e-scooterist violating any driving regulations will be fined foreach violation	AED 50
31	Bicycles/e-scooters that cause any injuries to any individuals or damage to anyproperty	AED 50
32	Bicycles/e-scooters violating parking	AED 50
33	Bicycles/e-scooters parking directly in front of any entrance or driveway	AED 50
34	Bicycles/e-scooters parking inside any building	AED 50
35	Bicycles/e-scooters secured to any utility line, lamp post, gate, railing, divider,post or vehicle	AED 50
36	Bicycles/e-scooters ridden on university property between the hours of 00:00 a.m.and 6:00 a.m.	AED 50
37	Bicyclists/e-scooterist not being cautious when riding on campus	AED 50
38	Bicyclists/e-scooterist racing when riding on campus	AED 50
39	Bicyclists/e-scooterist driving upon any ramp, stairway, wall, bench, fountain, overshrubbery, grass, or flower beds	AED 50
40	Bicyclists/e-scooterist carrying any package, bundle, or other article	AED 50
41	Bicycles/e-scooters not equipped with safety devices	AED 50
42	Late ID	AED 50
43	Lost or damage of car sticker	AED 50

44	Late car sticker	AED 50
45	Vehicle storage (parking over 48 hours without permission). Car will be wheel-locked until 5:00 pm	AED 50+100
46	Registered students who didn't renew car sticker before the deadline of renewal(last day of withdrawal).	AED 100
47	Lost or damage to hangtag	AED 100
48	Lost or damage to ID	AED 100
49	Car locking	AED 100
50	Underage-driving penalties	AED 100
51	H/C Parking Violation	AED 300+100
52	Tampering with wheel-locks	AED 2000

8.26 In case of repeating the same traffic violation for cars, bicycles or e-scooters, the fine will be increased as follows:

8.26.1 Faculty and Staff

S N	Fine Description	First Violation
1	First Violation	AED 50
2	Second Violation	AED 100
3	Third Violation	AED 200
4	Fourth Violation (The car will be wheel-locked.)	AED 300 +100

8.26.2 Students

S N	Fine Description	First Violation
1	First Violation (Reprimand letter from the Judicial Affairs Officer)	AED 50
2	Second Violation (Warning letter will be sent to parents from JAO)	AED 100
3	Third Violation (Warning letter will be sent to parents from Dean of Students Affairs)	AED 200
4	Fourth Violation (Warning letter will be sent to parents from Dean of Students Affairs) car will be wheel-locked until 5:00 pm.	AED 300 +100

9. Policy History:

The policy history started with the document prepared by to the AUS security in 2012. On 2016, the Office of Safety and Crisis Management was established, and continued to review and develop this policy on annual basis.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 1, 2016	New Policy	Office of Protocol
2.0	August 10, 2023	General Policy Update	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	May 31, 2024	General Update on the Format	Office of the Chancellor

10.Reference:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Protocol & Security	Tel: +971 6 515 2222	aus_security@aus.edu

g. IT Clean Desk Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0700IT08	Policy Title:	IT Clean Desk Policy
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	May 1, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date Of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy:

IT Clean Desk Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to:

- Minimize the likelihood of unauthorized access, loss, or harm to information both within and beyond regular working hours.
- Guarantee that sensitive papers and documents are not accessible to unauthorized individuals after office hours.
- Preclude the opportunistic breach of confidentiality through unauthorized access to computer screen contents.
- The objective of this policy is to highlight the following:
- It is the responsibility of managers to implement the Clean Desk Policy within their departments and ensure that employees comply with it, in order to prevent unauthorized access to confidential and sensitive personal information.
- The Clean Desk Policy outlines the appropriate way for employees to leave their workspace when they are not present in the office.
- The main objective of the Clean Desk Policy is to limit the exposure of confidential data to unauthorized individuals, such as cleaning staff or external vendors, and prevent security breaches.

3. Introduction / background:

A clean desk policy can be an important tool to ensure that all sensitive/confidential materials are removed from an end user workspace and locked away when the items are not in use or an employee leaves his/her workstation. It is one of the top strategies to utilize when trying to reduce the risk of security breaches in the workplace. Such a policy can also increase employee's awareness about protecting sensitive information.

A clean desk policy is a workplace policy that promotes a clean and organized workspace by requiring employees to keep their desks free of clutter, confidential documents, and electronic devices when they are not present. The policy aims to enhance the security of confidential and sensitive information by reducing the risk of unauthorized access, theft, or loss of documents or electronic devices.

4. Policy Statement:

Employees are required to ensure that all sensitive/confidential information in hardcopy or electronic form is secure in their work area at the end of the day and when they are expected to be gone for an extended period.

- Computer workstations must be locked when workspace is unoccupied.
- Computer workstations must be shut completely down at the end of the workday.
- Any Restricted or Sensitive information must be removed from the desk and locked in a drawer when the desk is unoccupied and at the end of the workday.
- File cabinets containing Restricted or Sensitive information must be kept closed and locked when not in use or when not attended.
- Keys used for access to Restricted or Sensitive information must not be left at an unattended desk.
- Laptops must be either locked with a locking cable or locked away in a drawer.
- Passwords may not be left on sticky notes posted on or under a computer, nor may they be left written down in an accessible location.
- Printouts containing Restricted or Sensitive information should be immediately removed from the printer.
- Upon disposal Restricted and/or Sensitive documents should be shredded in the official shredder bins or placed in the lock confidential disposal bins.
- Whiteboards containing Restricted and/or Sensitive information should be erased.
- Lock away portable computing devices such as laptops and tablets.
- Treat mass storage devices such as CDROM, DVD or USB drives as sensitive and secure them in a locked drawer.
- All printers and fax machines should be cleared of papers as soon as they are printed; this helps ensure that sensitive documents are not left in printer trays for the wrong person to pick up.
- To ensure the security of sensitive or critical business information, whether on paper or electronic storage media, it must be stored in locked cabinets or other secure office enclosures, ideally in a fireproof and waterproof safe or cabinet, especially outside of working hours. Additionally, desks should be kept clear of all documents and papers whenever possible.
- The ICT & IT Security department of the American University of Sharjah (AUS) should implement appropriate technological controls to secure information systems by configuring parameters such as screen saver passwords, session timeout settings, and the automatic termination of inactive sessions.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the use of information, electronic and computing devices, and network resources to conduct AUS business or interact with internal networks and business systems, whether owned or leased by AUS, the employee, or a third party.

This policy applies to students, faculty and staff, contractors, consultants, temporaries, interns, trainees, and other workers at AUS, including all personnel affiliated with third parties. This policy applies to all equipment that is owned or leased by AUS, information, underlying information systems and IT infrastructure and associated premises.

6. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.

- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Confidentiality: The security objective that generates the requirement for protection from intentional or accidental attempts to perform unauthorized data reads. Confidentiality covers data in storage, during processing, and while in transit.
- Risk: The level of impact on organizational operations (including mission, functions, image, or reputation), organizational assets, or individuals resulting from the operation of an information system given the potential impact of a threat and the likelihood of that threat occurring.
- Threat: Any circumstance or event with the potential to adversely impact organizational operations (including mission, functions, image, or reputation), organizational assets, individuals, other organizations, or the Nation through an information system via unauthorized access, destruction, disclosure, modification of information, and/or denial of service.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- IT Acceptable Use Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 1, 2023	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

h. University Health Center - Standard Operating Services

This title covers a number of different UHS policies and procedure as below:

1. Patient Registration - Version 2
2. Medical Services Provided by UHS Staff – Version 2
3. Attending Emergencies During Working Hours – Version 2
4. General On-call Procedure After Working Hours – Version 2
5. Ambulance Transfer – Version 2
6. Medical Waste Management – Version 2
7. Medical Equipment Management – Version 2
8. Early Childhood Learning Center – Version 2
9. Student Medical Insurance – Version 2
10. Rules and Responsibilities of UHS Staff – Version 2

1. Patient Registration – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES09	Policy Title	Patient Registration
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Purpose:

Facilitate the efficient and accurate registration of walk-in patients entering the University Health Services.

2. Scope:

This SOP pertains to all nurses in the UHS.

3. Procedure:

1. Greeting:

- Warmly welcome patients as they approach the reception area.

2. Documentation Check:

- Verify patient details and insurance information.
- Ensure patients have the necessary documentation, including any relevant medical records.

3. Provide Registration Form:

- Hand over a Medical Record form to the patient.
- Offer assistance to those needing help, especially those facing difficulties completing the form independently.

4. Review and Clarify Information:

- Thoroughly review the completed registration form with the patient.
- Clarify any unclear information to ensure accuracy.

5. Registration in the Banner System:

- Open CYVISIT in the Banner system.
- Enter the patient's AUS ID number.
- For visitors/contractors, input the contractor's ID number, then enter the patient's details.
- Click save.
- Advise the patient to wait for their name to be called to be checked and triaged by the nurse. Following the triage, the patient will then proceed for consultation with the doctor.

NOTE: Priority will be given to patients based on the urgency of their need for treatment. This approach ensures that those requiring immediate medical attention receive prompt care, while also accommodating patients with less urgent medical needs in a timely manner.

6. Verification of Insurance:

- If applicable, verify the patient's insurance coverage.
- Inform the patient of any potential out-of-pocket costs or copayments for non-eligible dependents.

4. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

5. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

2. Medical Services Provided by UHS Staff– Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES10	Policy Title	Medical Services Provided by UHS Staff
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy: Medical Services Policy

2. Purpose

To ensure that University Health Services staff provides consistent, high quality primary health and educational services to the AUS community as mandated by Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP)

3. Scope

The University Health Services provides primary health care services from Monday until Thursday, 8:30 AM – 4:30 PM, as well as 24-hour accident and emergency care to AUS community after working hours and official AUS holidays.

Scope includes:

- i. Faculty / Staff and their eligible dependents
- ii. Students
- iii. Visitors - may access UHS for health care-related injuries and emergencies which occur on campus.
- iv. Charges apply for non-emergency services.

4. Introduction

University Health Services is a MOHAP licensed ambulatory, primary healthcare facility that provides free of charge (except for certain services and categories) healthcare services for AUS community with acute and chronic medical conditions. We also coordinate and promote educational sessions and activities on campus.

5. Policy Statement

This Policy and Procedure Manual is designed to regulate and coordinate the activities of the University Health Services. No policy or procedure shall be so construed as to violate in any way upon the University's policies and procedures, nor any policies be rendered to infringe in any way on the powers and authority of the governing body of the University.

6. Responsibilities:

1) Confidentiality

UHS clinical records are maintained in a locked room with limited access to authorized UHS personnel.

Confidential information will be disclosed only to individuals or agencies for which a patient has signed the consent form. A client's information will not be disclosed to any unauthorized persons, including family and friends unless the patient or the client's representative gives written permission for the disclosure. The identity of individuals who request information will be verified. Confidential information is not transmitted electronically (that is, by email). If necessary to communicate information to others, all clinical services reports are mailed to the client and/or to individuals or facilities designated by the client.

Hard copies of patients' medical records are archived for 7-10 years as per MOHAP policy and then sent for shredding with the strict supervision of our UHS staff.

At UHS, we aim to complement the academic mission of our university and are dedicated to providing primary healthcare as well as education and supportive services to AUS community. We provide a range of services:

- i. Outpatient services for both acute and chronic problems
- ii. Short-term emergency care
- iii. Referrals to specialists in all fields
- iv. Physical examinations for pre-admissions, pre-employment, overseas travel, sports teams, etc.
- v. Limited minor surgical procedures
- vi. Follow-up care (i.e., dressing changes, stitches removal, etc.)
- vii. Immunization advice, vaccines
- viii. Medical attendance at university events
- ix. Health education programs, first aid training, and pamphlet information on a wide variety of medical conditions
- x. Medical insurance for students
- xi. Ambulance services: emergency transfer to a local hospital
- xii. Laboratory services
- xiii. Pharmacy

2) Medical Services

1. Physical Examination

1.1 Preadmission check for students

A medical check will be undertaken to determine their health and fitness which can either be done at UHS, outside the clinic or hospitals, or through the EHS pre-university health check-up

- i. Complete the Medical record form.
 - o Personal information (i.e. school major, dorm/room number, emergency contact and telephone number)

- Physical examination to be done by the doctor.
- History of illness/pre-existing conditions and list of medications (if applicable)
- Laboratory tests
 - Complete Blood Count
 - Urinalysis
 - Blood group
 - Blood group will be entered in the banner to issue the AUS ID
- Vaccination Record
- IXO students
 - Submit the Completed Medical Record form.
 - Blood group
 - Submit International insurance.
- Graduate Students
 - Medical record form is required only for Plan 1 students.
 - Blood group only for others
- ii. Students are required to select their insurance plan in the banner and complete their information in the pulse form

1.2 Pre-employment Checks for Employees

- i. Send a welcome letter to the new employee with the JOT form link and medical record form attached.
- ii. Update the Google sheet.
- iii. Open a file for employees who have completed their medical record form.
- iv. Update the Google sheet with fit to work.
- v. For employees who will complete the pre-employment check at the UHS
 - Complete the Medical Record Form
 - Personal information (i.e. department, emergency contact and telephone number)
 - Physical examination to be done by the doctor.
 - History of illness/pre-existing conditions and list of medications (if applicable)
 - Laboratory tests
 - Complete Blood Count
 - Urinalysis
 - Blood group
 - Blood group will be entered in the banner to issue the AUS ID

2. Emergency

2.1 Medical Emergency Procedures

All the doctors and nurses share equal on call duties after working hours, weekends, and AUS official holidays. Compensatory off is given accordingly.

In cases of life-threatening emergencies as documented herein, individuals must call the emergency hotline at 4911, 050-6357651 or 998. The attending/on-call nurse will follow the procedures as follows:

- i. During working hours

- Ensure Emergency car is stationed next to UHS parking at all times.
 - Club car is available for shifting patients to UHS if needed.
 - Two nurses to attend the emergency call.
 - On-call mobile phones should be with the attending nurse at all times
 - The Attending Nurse will have a medical emergency bag with her at all times.
 - The nurse will inform the doctor of the emergency.
 - Call an ambulance to transfer the patient to the clinic or hospital if required.
 - Medical aid will be given immediately.
 - The nurse will stay with the patient until stabilized.
 - Register the emergency call in the banner, patient's file and JOT form for incident report if applicable
 - Date and time of call
 - Nature of call (Emergency)
 - Location
- ii. After working hours
- Calls from Dorms
 - All calls from the dorms should be through the resource officer (RO)/dorm coordinator.
 - The student will inform the dorm RO of their medical emergency and the dorm RO/Coordinator will call the emergency on-call accordingly.
 - If the patient is able and not severely ill, the patient will be seen and examined in the dorm's office (bedroom) and to be witnessed by the RO/coordinator on duty.
 - Attend to the call within 10 minutes (for non-life-threatening emergencies)
 - Assess patient.
 - On-call nurse will contact the on-call doctor if their professional advice or presence is required and call the ambulance for the hospital to transfer if needed. Follow the doctor's advice accordingly.
 - For the patients that requires to be seen by the on-call doctor, they are encouraged to come and be examined in the clinic except for life threatening emergencies.
 - Follow the steps on the on-call procedures for treatment based on patient's complaint
 - Calls from residential housing.
 - Determine the location and nature of call.
 - Call the ambulance.
 - Assess patient.
 - On-call nurse will contact the on-call doctor if their professional advice or presence is required and call the ambulance for the hospital to transfer if needed. Follow the doctor's advice accordingly.
 - For patient who requires to be seen by the on-call doctor, are encouraged to come and be examined in the clinic except for life-threatening emergencies.
 - Follow the steps on the on-call procedures for treatment based on the patient's complaint.
- iii. For employees and dependents' non-emergency calls, advise to visit hospitals/clinics under the insurance network. The patient should be made aware of the non-emergency call fee of AED 300 as per UHS invoice in case the patient prefers to consult with the on-call doctor.
- iv. If hospital transfer is required
- Call the ambulance (University City services or National Ambulance at 998)

- Shift patients by ambulance accompanied by the nurse and doctor if needed to the hospital under their insurance network.
 - The second on-call nurse will assume responsibility during the absence.
 - Inform the hospital before transfer if needed.
 - Fill in the incident report jot form.
 - Follow-up with the hospital with regards to the patient's condition
 - Report to the Director of Medical Services the following day (report will include all transfer information, and documentation confirming all medications and treatment given).
 - Complete the patient assessment form.
 - The patient's completed assessment form signed by the doctor on call to be photocopied and filed in the on-call folder while the original copy goes in the patient's medical file.
 - Enter the call in the banner system.
 - Refill the medicines and supplies used in the on-call bag.
 - Endorse the calls with the patient's assessment form to the next on call nurse.
 - Upon receiving the key and the on-call phone, the on-call nurse and the next on call should both check the crash cart, the controlled drugs and the on-call bag and sign the checklist provided
- v. RTA
- Call 998 and police 999
- vi. In the event of big emergencies, or catastrophes that the on-call nurse requires assistance, the second on call nurse, doctor and/or other nurses/doctors will be called to assist.
- vii. It should be remembered that due to the variety and complexity of emergency situations that can arise, it is the practice of the UHS to transport critical emergency patients to the nearest hospital facility to receive the appropriate emergency treatment.
- viii. Necessary information will be documented in the patient's medical record.

Emergencies outside AUS premises do not fall under AUS responsibility; thus, they can follow the emergency national protocol.

2.2 Non-Emergency

All patients will be treated at the clinic for acute and chronic disease and a prescription will be given as needed.

Major illnesses or complications will be referred to an outside specialist within the insurance network.

3) Infectious Disease

In case of infectious disease, the UHS will follow protocol to limit the spread of infection which includes:

- i. Treatment
- ii. Sick leave
- iii. Isolation
- iv. Notification to MOHAP Preventive Medicine

4) Medication

Medication is stored in the UHS in a secure storeroom and inventoried by the Charge Nurse.

- i. Doctors are responsible for prescribing of all medications prior to distribution using the electronically generated prescription through the banner system
- ii. On-call Nurses are responsible for dispensing medicines to patients attended during the call
- iii. The Charge Nurse is responsible for inventory count, adequate supply of medications and purchase of medication in coordination with Procurement department to maintain adequate stock for daily and emergency use.

4.1 Administration of Medications

Staff nurses will administer written medication and with clear orders from the doctors except in emergency and on-call situations where verbal order is accepted. The nurse administering the medication takes responsibility for the administration is performed in accordance with the doctor's orders. These details should be clearly documented as soon as possible:

- i. Medication Name
- ii. Dosage
- iii. Route (IV, Oral, IM, and SC)
Any sign of medication reaction will be immediately reported to the doctor and documented.

4.1.1 Chronic Prescription Refill

- i. All patients who are on chronic medications must provide a list of chronic medications that they are taking. This will be documented in their medical file at the initial evaluation or once the condition is diagnosed. A follow-up medical and laboratory test should be done or medical and laboratory reports should be submitted from their treating doctor or in case of medication or dose change.
 - Ordering a Refill
 - Prescription refills must be requested by email or in person prior to collection from the clinic. Refills requested after 4 PM, on weekends and holidays will be ready on the next working day.
- ii. Chronic prescriptions will be filled on a monthly basis. In the event of traveling, sabbatical leave etc., approval from the medical insurance provider must be obtained in advance.
- iii. Over-the-counter medications will not be prescribed and considered as chronic medications
- iv. Lost prescriptions and failure to collect medications in full is not the responsibility of the clinic. Duplication of prescriptions is not possible.

Note: For the safety of the patient and to ensure correct dosage and monitoring of patient's condition, written requests will only be accepted if the patient has been to the clinic for monitoring of their condition within the last 3-6 months or a follow-up medical and laboratory reports are submitted from their treating doctor.

4.1.2 Controlled Medication Dispensing (In accordance with the EHS mandates)

- i. Controlled Prescription
 - Controlled medication prescriptions are now requested online through the national platform for controlled medications e-prescription service. (NPCM)
 - A copy of the patient's passport and UAE National ID is required.
 - A copy of the e-prescription should be kept in the patient's file.
 - Controlled medication can only be prescribed by the GP for three days, according to MOHAP regulations

- ii. All controlled medication will be kept locked

4.1.3 Semi Controlled Medication

- All semi-controlled medication will be refilled for one month and one time only through NPCM E prescription.

4.1.4 Administration of injection (IM, IV, SC)

- i. Review Physician's order
- ii. Gather necessary supplies and check patient's file for allergies.
- iii. Wash hands and wear gloves
- iv. Prepare the medication and check the expiration.
- v. Mix the contents of the vial thoroughly until all visible particles have dissolved.
- vi. Assess the injection site for any evidence of damage or trauma.
- vii. Administer the injection.
- viii. After the injection, discard the used syringe and needle intact as soon as possible in the sharp box.
- ix. Observe the patient for any side effects or signs of reaction to the medication.
- x. Document all injections are given and any other relevant information and enter in the banner system.

5) Nebulization

- i. Check doctor's orders for the medication, and prepare thereafter.
- ii. Prepare equipment.
- iii. Position the patient appropriately, allowing optimal ventilation.
- iv. Assess and record breath sounds, respiratory status, pulse rate and other significant respiratory functions.
- v. Teach the patient the proper way of inhalation.
- vi. Turn the machine on (notice observe the mist produced by the nebulizer)
- vii. Place the nebulizer facemask to the patient, and offer assistance until he is able to perform proper inhalation (if unable to hold the nebulizer [pediatric/geriatric/special cases], replace the mouthpiece with mask)
- viii. Document the procedure, medication, date, and time given and enter in the banner system.

6) Suturing

- i. Gather all necessary equipment (Lidocaine, needle, surgical instruments, etc.)
- ii. Inform the patient of the treatment plan, which includes placing of one or more sutures.
- iii. Position the patient in a comfortable position that gives adequate access to the site.
- iv. The physician will perform suturing.
- v. Record the procedure and the outcome.

7) Vaccination

7.1 Patient Care Before Administering Vaccines

- Obtain complete immunization history at every healthcare visit.
- Accept only written, dated records (except influenza and PPSV23 self-report)

- Use recommended schedule to determine vaccines needed based on age, medical condition, and risk factors.
- Screen for contraindications and precautions prior to administering any vaccine(s)
- Discuss vaccine benefits and risks and vaccine-preventable disease risks using VISs and other reliable resources.
- Provide after-care instructions.

7.2 Patient Care During Vaccine Administration

- Encourage participation of parent/guardian and patient
- Use simple strategies to ease vaccination process.
 - a. positive attitude
 - b. soft, calm voice
 - c. eye contact
 - d. explain why the vaccine is needed.

7.3 Infection Control

- Hand washing/ wearing gloves.
- Equipment Disposal
- Place used syringes and needles (do not cut, recap, or detach from syringe) in a puncture-resistant biohazard container.
- Dispose of empty or expired vaccine vials as medical waste

7.4 Vaccine Preparation “Nevers”

- Never combine vaccines into a single syringe except when specifically approved by the FDA and packaged for that specific purpose.
- Never transfer vaccine from one syringe to another
- Never draw partial doses of vaccine from separate vials to obtain a full dose.
- Vaccine Adverse Events are to be reported to the MOHAP.

7.5 Procedures

- Verify the need for vaccination or check the immunization record for follow up vaccination.
- Screen patients for contraindications and precautions
- Explain to patients the risk/side effects associated with the vaccine.
- Inspect vaccine and diluent vial for damage or contamination.
- Check the expiration date.
- Administer the vaccine according to the route recommended by the manufacturer.

8) General Medication Dispensing

- i. Over-the-counter (OTC) medications (i.e., Painkillers) can be distributed by nurses and documented in the patient’s file and banner after ensuring there is no contra-indications.
- ii. Deductions from UHS store will be automatically shown in the Banner.
- iii. Prescriptions will not be altered in any way.
- iv. Medication will be dispensed from the UHS stock in all cases of emergency.
- v. Non-emergency medications can be distributed from the UHS stock if available with written order from the doctor.
- vi. All discrepancies, losses, expiry and/or breakages will be documented on an incident report.

- vii. Charge Nurse will ensure that all medication is within the validity date.
- viii. Expiry dates should be documented at time of purchase and all medication inventories will be distributed in accordance with expiry date.
- ix. Expired medications will be removed from stock and disposed of accordingly.
- x. Purchases to refill stocks will be initiated by the charge nurse and submitted to the UHS Director for approval.

9) First Aid

9.1 Training

- The UHS schedules the first aid training session in accordance with the HR training department.

9.2 First Aid box Refilling

- i. Employing units are responsible for assuring the availability of first-aid supplies appropriate to the work area are maintained and accessible to all employees.
- ii. The first aid kit should be checked regularly.
- iii. The number of kits required in a building or area is based on the number of staff and students working in the building and type of work carried out and will be determined in consultation with Safety team.
- iv. If any supplies have been used the department has to send an email to the University Health Services requesting for a refill mentioning the exact location and the supplies needed.
- v. UHS staff will be responsible for purchasing and refilling first aid supplies needed for the department once an email is received.
- vi. A separate budget is allocated for First aid supplies.

10) Sick Leave

10.1 Students

Purpose

- To ensure that students are given adequate rest and recovery time when they are ill and to ensure that they return to classes on time.
- Sick leaves will be issued by doctors as judged appropriately in accordance with EHS guidelines.
- Sick leave issued by outside doctors, needs to be approved by UHS doctors as detailed below:
 - Sick Leave must include diagnosis, duration of illness or hospitalization and include a legible Clinic/Hospital/Doctor stamp and signature.
 - All sick leave certificates (including those issued by private doctors) must be endorsed at the UHS within one week of the issuing date.
 - Medical report is required in case of hospital admission and sick leaves of more than 2 days.

10.2 Employees

- A Sick leave policy is provided to protect employees suffering from illness or injury. Employees are eligible to apply for sick leave from the date of their employment, provided they are full-time employees.
- Further information regarding the employee sick leave policy is available at **HR webpage Guidelines for Sick Leave Issuance**

10.3 Hospitalization or long Illnesses

- Notify the clinic or appropriate department as soon as possible.
- Present sick leave certificate to UHS with attached Medical Report and Discharge Summary
- Sick leave more than 2 days need to be entered by the employee in the Oracle Fusion System and with the reference number attached to it. They will be reviewed and approved by the UHS Director.

The UHS will not be responsible for the issuance of sick leaves for missed days that have been approved by the department head. At the request of a department head, if an employee has frequent absences from work due to illness a medical evaluation will be done to re-assess their fitness to work.

10.4 Sick leave during vacation

Employees cannot claim sick leave whilst on vacation apart from emergency admission to the hospital. A sick leave certificate must be presented to UHS with the attached Medical Report and Discharge Summary.

11) Chargeable Services

Non-eligible dependents and graduate students on N Plan will be charged fees as per the current price list, which is posted clearly on UHS reception. Charges will be deducted through either payroll or student accounts. UHS does not accept direct payment.

12) Community Service

- a) Supporting on-campus events by offering medical and ambulance assistance
- b) Periodic health awareness campaigns (Blood Donation, Breast cancer awareness, etc.) and monthly digital educational topics.
- c) Fitness certification (Sports, schools, etc.)
- d) Vaccination - Seasonal flu vaccines, travel vaccines, other vaccinations as per request, and other free vaccination campaigns by EHS. Charges apply for requested vaccines.

13) Grievance Procedure

- If a patient has a complaint with any aspect or service of the UHS, they should set up a meeting with the Director of UHS to file an incident report within 5 working days.
- For faculty and staff, if, after this meeting, the patient feels the response is inadequate, they may then raise the matter with the Executive Director of Employee Service.

7. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

8. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

3. Attending Emergencies during working hours – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES11	Policy Title:	Attending Emergencies During Working Hours
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Purpose:

This standard operating procedure addresses procedures for attending emergency calls from campus residents including students during working hours.

2. Scope:

This Standard Operating Procedure pertains to all nurses in the UHS

3. Procedure:

- Verify the call
- Take the exact location and the patient's complaint and condition
- If non-emergency, encourage the patient to come to the clinic.
 - Students in dorms– transportation to be arranged as per protocol.
- If life threatening emergency, inform the doctor and the ambulance
 - Students in dorms – medical and ambulance team will attend the call
- Take the emergency bag and attend to the call
- Assess the patient, take the vital signs, and provide first aid as needed
- Bring the patient to the clinic if needed
- Inform the doctor and follow the doctor's advice accordingly
- Document the call and treatment given in the patient's file and banner system

4. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

5. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

4. General On-call procedure after working hours – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES12	Policy Title:	General On-call procedure after working hours
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Purpose:

This standard operating procedure addresses attending calls from campus residents including students after working hours.

2. Scope:

UHS Nurses and Doctors

3. Procedure:

- Attend to the call within 10 minutes (for non- life-threatening emergencies).
- Follow the steps on the on-call procedures for treatment based on patient's complaint.
- Complete the patient assessment form.
- Photocopy the form and attach to the patient's file.
- Document the call by entering the patient assessment, diagnosis and treatment in the computer banner system.
- Ensure that the on call medical bag is filled with the required medicine and supplies
- Ensure hand over of cases to nurse on next on call shift.
- Upon receiving the on-call car key and the on-call phone, the next on call nurse should check the crash cart and the controlled drugs and sign on the checklist provided.

4. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

5. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

5. Ambulance Transfer – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES13	Policy Title:	Ambulance Transfer
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy:

The policy is designed to incorporate essential elements, guaranteeing that members of the AUS community receive optimal ambulance transfer services overseen by qualified medical professionals, ensuring they are transported to suitable medical facilities for necessary treatment.

2. Purpose:

This policy outlines the procedures and guidelines for the safe and efficient transfer of patients via ambulance. It aims to ensure that patients receive appropriate care during transportation and that all staff adhere to established protocols.

3. Scope:

This policy applies to University Health Services doctors and nurses, University City ambulance services personnel, and individuals involved in the transfer of patients.

4. Procedure:

- The ambulance stationed at the University City Bay operates 24/7 and is reserved strictly for serious emergencies requiring immediate hospitalization.
- Ambulance services can be reached out at 0506776844 through authorized channels, primarily via the medical team members. AUS community members should utilize this service only for life-threatening conditions to expedite emergency response.
- For emergencies unrelated to immediate hospitalization, such as road traffic accidents (RTAs) and police cases, contact the National Ambulance at 998.
- Upon arrival, the nurse promptly assesses the patient's condition and communicates with the UHS doctor to discuss the patient's status and evaluate the necessity for hospital transfer.
- Patients are transferred to a hospital within the network whenever feasible. However, in cases of life-threatening emergencies, they are promptly taken to the nearest hospital.
- Contact the receiving hospital before transfer, providing essential case details to the Emergency Room (ER) Nurse or Doctor.
- Ensure the patient is comfortably positioned on the ambulance stretcher and securely strapped in place. Attach necessary monitoring devices such as blood pressure (BP) monitors or oxygen when indicated.
- A nurse accompanies the patient during ambulance transport to the hospital. In cases of life-threatening emergencies, a doctor must accompany the nurse.
- Ensure a thorough handover process is conducted upon arrival at the receiving hospital.
- Provide detailed information about the patient's condition, vital signs, and any administered treatments to the hospital staff to facilitate seamless continuation of care.

- The accompanying nurse remains with the patient until the hospital doctor examines them and prescribes necessary treatment or procedures.
- The patient's information will be recorded and registered for subsequent follow-up procedures including regular calls to either the patient or the hospital to inquire about the patient's condition and progress.
- Communicate the treatment plan to the UHS doctor and thoroughly document it in the patient's file and the banner system for comprehensive record-keeping.
- Notify the Dorms Coordinator in the event of patient admission and maintain regular follow-up on the patient's progress.
- If the patient is a student, notify Student Affairs. For Faculty and Staff notify the Executive Director of Employee Services
- The same procedures apply to staff, faculty, and dependents in need of emergency medical assistance.
- Procedure-related documents:
 - Referral letter
 - Medical report
 - Transfer/Incident Report

Incident & Accident Report

University Health Services

Date *

DD-MM-YYYY



07:49

AM ▾

Date

Hour Minutes

Location of Incident *

AUS ID number *

@000

Patient's Name *

Emirates ID Number *

ex: 784-****_*****_*



Category *

Lives ON CAMPUS *

Please Select ▾

Please Select ▾

Mobile Phone Number *

05#-###-####

Please enter a valid phone number.

Incident Category *

College/ Department *

Please Select ▾

Please Select ▾

Incident Details *

5. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

6. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

6. Medical Waste Management – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES14	Policy Title:	Medical Waste Management
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy:

- It is the policy of University Health Services to follow the UAE Federal Law and local environmental and health regulations when planning and implementing the treatment and disposal of waste they generate.
- The UHS is responsible for ensuring good waste management practices in their premises.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide clear direction and guidance on the appropriate management of medical waste in accordance with the regulations set forth by the United Arab Emirates (UAE) Federal law, the Ministry of Health (MOH), and Municipality rules and regulations. The primary goal is to minimize health risks for healthcare staff, patients, visitors, and medical waste handlers while ensuring compliance with established protocols and signing on the checklist provided.

3. Scope:

- It is the responsibility of the UHS's management to ensure proper implementation of this policy.
- It is the responsibility of all staff working in a UHS to abide by these waste management policies and procedures.

4. Procedure:

General Considerations:

- The UHS shall assign staff for waste management.
- Ensure that all Healthcare staff are aware of the waste management practices.
- Ensure there is clinical waste signage (posters) on all waste segregation bins available in all areas
- Ensure all plastic waste sacks must be fully enclosed within bins to minimize the risk of injury.
- Ensure all waste bins must be visibly clean – externally and internally
- Ensure all waste bins must be foot-operated, lidded, and in good working order.
- Waste bags must be removed from clinical areas daily and there is no emptying of clinical waste from one bag to another
- Ensure there are no overfilled bags.
- The UHS has a contract with a licensed company (Wekaya) to handle and dispose of the waste it generates. (collection is done twice a week). The contract is renewed annually as required for the clinic's license renewal.

Waste Disposal and segregation:

GROUP	COLOR CODE	TYPE OF WASTE
Group A Medical Waste	Red Color bags	Anatomical or pathological waste, waste contaminated with human blood or other body fluids, excreta, vomit, human tissue, wastes from contagious diseases, dirty bandages, bed sheets, animal remains, and all other materials on which animal lay or cloth or used by animal whether contaminated or not
Group B Medical Waste	Yellow Plastic boxes (Sharp Object Boxes)	Sharps, syringes and needles, surgical tools, different medicine, medical equipment, vessels, broken glass, and all other sharp equipment, tools, and materials.
Group C and E-Waste	Yellow Polyethylene bags.	All waste that came in contact with human blood or fluid is considered, Pathological waste Anatomical waste Human tissue Used gloves, aprons, masks, shoes and head covers, dressing, bandages, diapers, cotton swabs, etc.
Group D	Blue color bags	Batteries, Broken thermometer, blood pressure gauges Expired medicines
General waste	Black color bags	Aerosols Domestic waste Food waste Paper towels, paper packaging materials, etc.

Waste Storage:

- General waste/hazardous healthcare waste should be stored in a separate location (LAN-023) on an impermeable surface (no cracks or floor drains) pending collection by the municipality or contractor.
- There must be enough space around stored waste containers/ bags to allow regular inspection for leakage or label deterioration.
- Waste bags and containers should be sealed (such as with adhesive tape) , labeled with the address of the producer and the waste category, and marked with a biohazard sign for medical waste.
- Waste should not be stored close to patients or where food is prepared. All clinical waste containers are kept secured and inaccessible to the public.

5. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

6. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

7. Medical Equipment Management – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES15	Policy Title:	Medical Equipment Management
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy Statement:

- The University Health Services is committed to establishing a comprehensive framework for the management of medical devices and equipment, ensuring adherence to the highest standards of safety, risk management, and financial efficiency. The policy is designed to mitigate potential hazards associated with these devices, emphasizing the importance of proper training and competence among employees in their usage. Additionally, it mandates that devices are maintained in a safe and reliable condition, undergo rigorous quality assurance measures, and are subject to comprehensive asset management inclusive of device history and tracking.
- The policy advocates for a standards-based approach to enhance the safety, efficiency, and quality of managing all medical devices and equipment within the UHS.

2. Policy Objective: Appropriate daily, periodic and corrective maintenance of medical equipment is key to achieving safe and cost-effective management of medical equipment.

- 4..1 Improve the accuracy of patient identification
- 4..2 Improve the effectiveness of communication among caregivers and care recipients
- 4..3 Improve the safety of using medications and medical devices
- 4..4 Reducing the Risk of healthcare-associated Infections
- 4..5 Ensuring correct site, correct procedure, correct patient for all procedures
- 4..6 Accurately and completely reconcile medications across the continuum of care
- 4..7 Encourage patients' active involvement in their care as a patient safety strategy
- 4..8 Improve recognition and response to changes in a patient's condition
- 4..9 Reducing the risk of patient harm resulting from falls
- 4..10 Reduce the risk of clinic

3. Scope:

All UHS medical personnel.

4. Definition of Medical Device:

- This refers to any instrument, apparatus, appliance, software, material or other article, whether used alone or in combination, together with any accessories for:
 - 4.1 Diagnosis, prevention, monitoring, treatment or alleviation of disease,
 - 4.2 Diagnosis, monitoring, treatment, alleviation of or compensation for an injury
- This definition also includes devices intended to administer a medicinal product

5. Roles and Responsibilities:

- Medical Director

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4..1 Provide assurance to the Health and Safety Department in relation to the system for medical device/equipment management. This assurance will be provided through an audit of compliance with this policy and standard and any relevant legislation and regulation.

- All Employees

4..1 It is the responsibility of each individual employee to ensure that they are conversant with the content of this policy and are appropriately trained and competent to use the medical devices that they are required to use as part of their duties.

4..2 All employees have a responsibility with regard to incident reporting and should follow the Incident Reporting Policy and Procedure in respect of incidents involving medical devices.

4..3 Under Health and Safety regulations employees must also take reasonable care for their own health and safety and also of other people who may be affected by their acts or omissions.

4..4 They should report any problem relating to use, maintenance, servicing, or decontamination as contained in this policy to their line manager.

6. Policy Implementation

The Medical Director is responsible for the effective communication and implementation of this policy as it relates to his/her directorate.

7. Evaluation and Audit

Services will be required to agree, implement and monitor relevant performance indicators at an operational and MOHAP standard and these will be subject to monitoring by the relevant Directorate.

8. Record Keeping

All records should be maintained up to date for the safe management of all Medical Devices/Equipment. A standardized system should be in place at the clinic for all records/data/history with relevant details and status updates.

9. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

7. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

8. Early Childhood Learning Center (ECLC) Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES16	Policy Title:	Early Childhood Learning Center Policy
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	January 2, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy Statement:

The University Health Services (UHS) collaborates closely with the Early Childhood Learning Center (ECLC) to ensure the implementation of health guidelines and procedures aligned with the standards set forth by the Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP) and the Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA). The UHS plays a pivotal role in facilitating preventive and treatment measures aimed at enhancing the health and wellness of both children and staff members at the ECLC.

2. Policy Objective:

To uphold a secure and healthy environment, regular health check-ups and preventive health measures are implemented. The University Health Services (UHS) is tasked with delivering timely and appropriate responses to any health-related issues that may arise, ensuring the well-being of the community under its care

3. Scope:

This policy applies to all the ECLC staff, children and their parents.

4. Process/Procedure:

- Perform fitness assessments for all Early Childhood Learning Center (ECLC) staff members.
- Conduct daily health check-ups for all children attending the ECLC.
- Guide on maintaining a healthy and sanitary environment within the ECLC premises.
- Diagnose and promptly report any contagious illnesses to the relevant authorities, such as the Ministry of Health and Prevention (MOHAP).
- Monitor and keep up-to-date vaccination records for all children enrolled at the ECLC.
- Administer sick leaves and facilitate the return to ECLC for staff if necessary.
- Respond promptly to any injuries or accidents that occur within the ECLC.
- Regularly inspect and replenish first aid kits per requirements set by the Sharjah Private Education Authority (SPEA) and municipal regulations.

5. Compliance:

Adherence to this policy is obligatory for all staff, children, and parents affiliated with the Early Childhood Learning Center (ECLC).

Failure to comply may lead to temporary exclusion from the ECLC until confirmation of adherence to health and safety standards by the University Health Services is obtained.

6. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2, 2024	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

7. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

9. Student Medical Insurance – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES17	Policy Title:	Student Medical Insurance
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	October 17, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Policy Statement

The American University of Sharjah Health Insurance Policy requires that all full time, matriculated undergraduate, including International IXO students and AUS-sponsored graduate student maintain health coverage that meets the standards of AUS and applicable laws, either through AUS Insurance Policy or self-provided one. Insurance Plan registration must be completed during the semester registration period.

- Plan 1 - Al Buhaira National Insurance Student Health Plan is mandatory for AUS sponsored students and those who does not hold any private medical insurance policy.
- Plan 2 - AUS University Health Services Student Health Plan is only for students who have an external medical insurance coverage and for UAE Nationals
- N Plan – No Plan is for graduate students not on AUS sponsorship
- Plan 0 – is for dependents of staff/faculty who has insurance under HR
- University Hospital Sharjah Supplemental Student Health Plan (UHS) is for all students except for those who are on AUS Health Services Student Health Plan (Plan II) and their own private health insurance covers University Hospital Sharjah (UHS). The students on this health plan can avail limited emergency health services from University Hospital Sharjah as per MOU between AUS and University Health Services

The medical insurance fees are as per the University's published tuition and fees schedule.

2. Purpose

AUS holds in great value the health and well-being of all students, thereby it requires its students to have health insurance coverage to minimize physical, mental, and financial strain that would result from an illness or related conditions during the Academic year.

3. Scope

AUS registered students, unregistered students on AUS sponsorship and /graduated students on AUS visa extension

4. Responsibility:

1) Undergraduate Students

All registered students must visit the UHS to complete their medical record form and select the Insurance Plan suitable for them in the <https://banner.aus.edu/index2.htm> and update their information in the <https://pulse.aus.edu/insurance-application>

2) Default Rules

If a student does not make a selection by **the deadline, the below default rules will apply.**

- Continuing students will remain on the health plan they were last registered on if they do not make any changes to their selection.
- New undergraduate or graduate students whose residence visa is sponsored by AUS will be enrolled in the Al Buhaira National Student Health Plan (Plan I) and University Hospital Sharjah Supplemental Student Health Plan (UHS).
- New undergraduate students whose residence visa is not sponsored by AUS will be enrolled in AUS Health Services Student Health Plan (Plan II) and University Hospital Sharjah Supplemental Student Health Plan (UHS).
- Students who selected Al Buhaira National Student Health Plan (Plan 1) but failed to submit the required documents by the deadline will be placed on AUS Health Services Student Health Plan (Plan II)

3) Abu Dhabi Visa Holders

A Certificate of Continuity is required if a student holds an Abu Dhabi visa and wish to apply for Al Buhaira Insurance – Plan 1. To be eligible for Al Buhaira insurance the student will need to cancel his/her current insurance. AUH visa holders cannot hold two insurances at the same time. Fines imposed by the Healthy Authorities due to gaps in the medical coverage will be charged to the student.

4) Waiving UHS Charges

UHS charges can be waived off only for students who are on AUS Health Services Student Health Plan (Plan II) and their own private health insurance covers University Hospital Sharjah (UHS). Students shall submit the proof of coverage for UHS within their private health insurance network for review through <https://pulse.aus.edu/insurance-application> Failure to submit the supporting documentation within the deadline for review will result in the student being charged for the UHS supplemental plan.

5) Obtaining AUS Student Visa in the Middle of the Semester

If an AUS student obtains visa in the middle of the semester, he/she will automatically be registered under Al Buhaira Insurance – Plan 1. Charges are applicable.

6) Duration of Health Insurance Coverage for Graduating Students

Students who are sponsored by AUS will have the insurance activated as long as their visas are valid with AUS. The charges are applicable in full if the visa is still active at the start of the semester following graduation.

Students who are not sponsored by AUS will have the insurance canceled after their graduation date. If the student is on Abu Dhabi or Dubai residence visa sponsorship, s/he needs to submit a signed NOL to studentmedicalinsurance@aus.edu to complete the cancellation process. Without the signed NOL, the student's account will continue to be billed for the health insurance premium plus any health claims incurred. This will result in a hold on the student's account and will not be able to receive his/her diploma or transcript until the hold is released.

During the registration period, banner using SYARUPD system will be made accessible to all students until the end of **Add and Drop** period for Plan selection.

By the end of the Registration, after the Add and Drop period, list of Plan 1 registered students is being generated through the Banner using SYSTDH System and the pulse form to finalize the details. Final List is sent to ABNIC to process and activate the student's insurance policy.

Registered students that are UAE Nationals will be automatically enlisted under Plan 2 unless otherwise requested to be on Plan 1.

Once the policy is activated, an email is sent to all Plan 1 registered students-with their insurance policy number that is linked to their emirates ID. To access the network, student must download

	Fall	Spring	Summer	Total - AED
Plan 1 Al Buhaira National Insurance Student Health Plan	600	600	300	1,500
Plan 2 AUS University Health Services Student Health Plan	300	300	150	750
University Hospital Sharjah Supplemental Student Health Plan	112.5	112.5	45	225

the ABNIC health vault app.

All undergraduate registered students can access the UHS regardless of whatever Insurance plan they have.

7) Graduate Students

All registered Graduate students non-sponsored by AUS will be enlisted under N-Plan by default.

AUS-sponsored graduate student will be enlisted under Plan 1 and University Hospital Sharjah Supplemental Plan by default.

8) Changes to Insurance Plans

Changing of Insurance Plans can be done through <https://banner.aus.edu/index2.htm> and update their information in the <https://pulse.aus.edu/insurance-application> during the Registration period of every semester until the Add and Drop period.

9) IXO Students

Incoming IXO students will be under Plan 2 by default. However, Plan 1 can be applied if the student does not hold an International Insurance coverage and the process should be done during add and drop period of the semester. UHS charges will be applied and can be waived if the student declares with official communication with the IXO management.

Outgoing IXO students who are under Plan 2 will be changed to NPlan and waived for UHS charges for the period they are on study abroad program. Plan 1 students will remain on the same insurance plan (Plan 1) for insurance continuity. Once student is back from study abroad, she/he will be placed back to their previous health plan.

10) Summer Charges

Unless student is graduating after spring, summer charges shall be applied to all Plan 1 registered students whether or not they are officially registered for summer classes in order to ensure the continuity of their membership over the summer

Note:

*Medical insurance is valid from AY September 1 to August 31, however charges are per semester

5. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
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AUS POLICIES AND PROCEDURES MANUAL | AY24-25 | VERSION 5

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1.0	October 17, 2023	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

6. References:

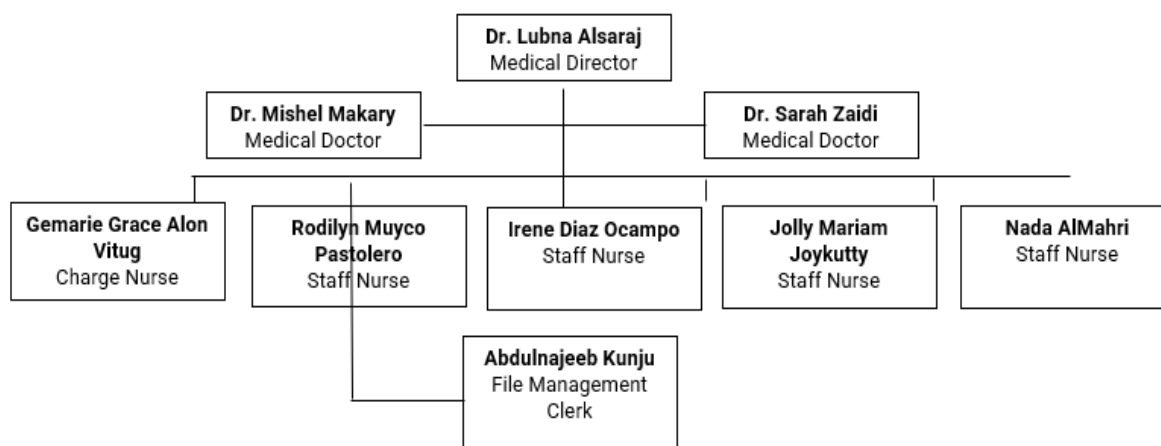
Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

10. Rules and Responsibilities of UHS Staff – Version 2

Policy Number:	0700ES18	Policy Title:	Rules and Responsibilities of UHS Staff
Prepared By:	University Health Services	Issue Date:	October 17, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	September 12, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 1, 2025

1. Roles and Responsibilities

UHS Organizational Chart



2. Director of Medical Services

- Provide leadership and management to UHS according to policy guidelines,
- Direct the work and activities of the medical care staff; ensure that university health services are provided efficiently and on a timely basis.
- Coordinate and manage relationships with outside vendors (laboratory and pharmacy) and other medical facilities (Emirates Health Services)
- Plan annual goals, objectives, activities, and budget
- Perform the roles and responsibilities of the Medical Doctor

3. Medical Doctors

- Provide health services on a daily basis, full examinations, prescribe medicines as necessary, and follow-up treatments if required.
- On-call rotation. Provide full presence at the scene whenever needed on campus premises (housing complexes, dormitories, or main campus). Provide assistance to the on call nurses if needed.
- Organize health education through lectures, seminars, or workshops, given by self or invited speakers.
- Ensure that strict confidentiality is maintained at all times.
- Refer cases to hospitals and specialists under insurance coverage.
- Exercise functional control over nurses and other staff for proper running and maintenance of the clinic

- vii. Attend activities hosted by other departments as requested to supply on-site medical care if needed.
- viii. Maintain 40 CMEs as required by the Emirates Health Services for the annual renewal of professional license.

4. Nurses

- i. Assist with the examination of patients and carrying out physician's orders.
- ii. Respond round the clock to emergency calls on campus.
- iii. Prepare and administer medications and perform nursing procedures to patients as prescribed.
- iv. Check and replenish first aid boxes at all locations on campus.
- v. Input data entry into the Banner System and generate daily and monthly statistical reports using Argos.
- vi. Operate and maintain various pieces of medical equipment.
- vii. Attend activities hosted by other departments as requested.
- viii. Daily check on children's temperature and reports on sanitary & hygienic conditions of all areas of the Early

Childhood Learning Center (ECLC)

5. Reception

- i. On rotation basis, covers the reception area of the clinic and perform the following duties:
 - o Greet and direct patients.
 - o Register every patient that visits the clinic in the banner system.
 - o Process forms and assist patients in obtaining health care services.
 - o Answer telephone calls, take messages and reply to queries sent thru emails.
 - o Prepare chronic prescriptions as per request.
- ii. Generate through the banner system all students who are registered under AUS insurance program every semester and send the list to Al Buhaira National Insurance Company (ABNIC) to process the application and activate their membership.
- iii. Determine that students are in the right plan according to their status and their need to have insurance policy (AUS Sponsored, Graduate students, IXO, Incoming and outgoing students, Dropped and graduated)
- iv. Communicate with the Finance Department (student accounts) and other related departments (Registrar/ IT Department) regarding insurance charges and anything that applies.
- v. Update student's medical insurance plan for any changes by running a report in a daily basis through the banner system.
- vi. Maintain 20 CMEs as required by the MOHAP for the renewal of professional license.
- vii. Process order of medications and disposables and keep adequate supply for clinic and emergency use.
- viii. Handle the maintenance, calibration and upgrade of medical equipment as needed.

6. Medical Records Clerk

- i. Arrange and prepare files of patients visiting UHS.
- ii. Maintain and develop file management system.

- iii. Daily indexing of scanned documents
- iv. Keeps record of stocks and supplies of store items.

7. UHS Medical Licensing

- i. Medical Staff and Establishment's License
 - a. Renewed annually.
 - b. Requirements for renewal:
 - Establishment Plan (Croak Plan)
 - Malpractice Insurance
 - Wekaya – Medical Waste Disposal
 - Establishment Request letter
 - Letter to Whom it may concern.
 - Establishment Contract
 - Name and license copies of medical employees
 - Amiri Decree
- ii. Professional License Evaluation (Doctors/ Nurses)
 - a. Medical Doctors – every 3 years
 - 40 CME every year as required by the MOH
 - b. Nurses - every 4 years
 - 20 CME every year as required by the MOH
- iii. Advance Cardiac Life Support (ACLS) Certification
 - Renewed every 2 years

Please refer to http://www.mohap.gov.ae/Files/MOH_Service/225/eTransform-Licensing_User_Manual_Ver_1.1_English_2019.pdf

8. Definitions

- **Life life-threatening emergency** is defined as an illness or accident that is so severe and sudden that it requires immediate medical or surgical attention.
- **Infectious diseases** are illnesses that can be transmitted either directly or indirectly.
- **Chronic medications** are medication taken on a regular, ongoing basis **Controlled medications** are drugs whose prescription and dispensing, is regulated by the government, represented by the EHS.
- **AUS Community** refers to faculty, staff, dependents & students.
- **Visitors** – people not included in AUS community who are present on campus such as contractors, maids, personal visitors and official AUS visitors.
- **MOHAP** – Ministry of Health and Prevention
- **CME** – Continuing Medical Education
- **GP** – General Practitioner

- **ACLS** – Advanced Cardiac Life Support
- **RO** – Resource officer
- **ABNIC** – Al Buhaira National Insurance Company

9. Related Documentation

<https://www.aus.edu/health-center>

<https://bannernav.aus.edu/applicationNavigator/seamlessjotform>

national platform for controlled medicine <https://npcm.ae/>
http://www.mohap.gov.ae/Files/MOH_Service/225/eTransform-Licensing_User_Manual_Ver_1.1_English_2019.pdf

<https://www.cdc.gov/>

<https://www.dha.gov.ae/Documents/Regulations/Guidelines/Medical%20Guidelines%20of%20Sick%20Leaves%20Duration.pdf>

https://cpr.heart.org/AHA/ECC/CPRAndECC/Training/HealthcareProfessional/AdvancedCardiovascularLifeSupportACLS/UCM_473186_Advanced-Cardiovascular-Life-Support-ACLS.jsp

10. Contacts

- UHS Reception: 06 515 2760
- Nurses Station: 06 515 2675
- Emergency hotline at ext. 4911, 050-6357651
- Ambulance 050 6776844
- Sharjah National Ambulance – 998
- Email: healthservices@aus.edu

11. Policy history:

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	October 17, 2023	New Policy	Employee Services
2.0	September 12, 2024	General Update	Employee Services

12. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Health Services	Tel +971 6 515 2760	healthservice@aus.edu

i. IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements – Version 3

Policy Number:	0700IT19	Policy Title:	IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements
Prepared By:	ICT & IT Security Department	Issue Date:	April 10, 2016
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT & IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 29, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 01, 2026

1. Policy: IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements

2. Purpose: This document details the minimum service requirements and useful life of information technology equipment at the American University of Sharjah (AUS).

3. Introduction / background (optional): N/A

4. Policy Statement:

- Requirements and useful life durations per equipment or service types are defined as follows:

End User Devices			
Category	Device Type	Useful Life (Years)	Comments/Notes
Portable Devices	Windows Laptops	4	
	Mac Laptops		
	Mobile Phones		
	Tablets		
Workstations and Multimedia Equipment	Mac and Windows Desktops	5	
	Television and Projectors		
	Audio-Video Equipment (cameras, mixers, speakers, microphones, control systems, amplifiers, digital podium)		
	Interactive Displays		
Monitors and Printers	Monitors	7	
	Printers, plotters, & photocopiers		
	Scanners		
Infrastructure Equipment			
Category	Device Type	Useful Life (Years)	Comments/Notes
Network and Infrastructure Hardware	Firewalls	6	
	Switches (Core)		
	Switches (Aggregations/Distribution)		
	Switches (Access)		
	Wireless Controllers		
	Wireless Access Points		
	Compute Servers		
	Telecom Equipment (Gateways and Servers)		

	UPS (Batteries and components)		
Network Infrastructure & Storage	Routers	8	
	Load Balancers		
	Storage		
Infrastructure Components	Passive Cabling (Copper)	16	
	Passive Cabling (Fiber)		
	UPS (Chassis)		
Services			
Category	Service	Requirement	Comments/Notes
NA	Internet Speed (Download)	10 Mbps	Average targeted speed per user.
NA	Internet Speed (Upload)	5 Mbps	Average targeted speed per user.

- Early replacements for devices and equipment may be considered on a case-by-case basis based on performance.
- The latest hardware models should be selected when procuring new devices and equipment to ensure long-term usefulness without compromising cost-effectiveness.
- It is important to note that an asset might continue to be in service even after the end of its estimated useful life, as the useful life may not necessarily reflect the actual service period of the asset. This will be evaluated on a case-by-case basis and must consider the availability of vendor support for the equipment.

5. Scope/applicability: This policy applies to all IT equipment owned by the university.

6. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- Useful Life: Useful life or equipment lifecycle is the time that any IT equipment can be expected to be serviceable or supported by its manufacturer.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy

9. Exceptions to the Policy: Should extenuating circumstances arise, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and/or the Chancellor have the authority to approve exceptions to this policy.

10. Policy Review and Update:

- This Policy shall be reviewed every two years.

- Any amendments to the policy must be endorsed by the Executive Director of ICT & IT Security, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and approved by the Chancellor.

11. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 10, 2016	New Policy	ICT and IT Security
2.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy – Entirely changed the Policy format following the new template shared by the OIRA	Office of Institutional Research and Analysis
3.0	August 22, 2024	- Title: renamed the policy from "IT Equipment Lifecycle" to "IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements". - Section 1. Purpose: expanded the purpose to include requirements as well as lifecycle. - Section 2. Policy Statement: updated to modify the table structure and include additional device types and new categories (infrastructure equipment and services).	ICT and IT Security

12. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

8. Learning Resources Center

a. LRC/Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations – Version 6

Policy Number:	0800UL01	Policy Title:	LRC/Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations
Prepared By:	University Librarian	Issue Date:	November 4, 2019
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Library	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations

Library policy, procedures and regulations are implemented at the AUS Library to ensure the efficient, effective and equitable use of space and resources. Multiple statements are developed to serve this purpose and are included in this document.

2. Purpose:

The AUS Library policy defines the use and access to library resources and space. By articulating and implementing these statements, the University provides learning resources that support, inspire and empower students, staff and faculty to achieve success in their learning and research endeavors.

3. Introduction / background:

Libraries in Higher Education Institutions around the world set policies to govern the use of the collections, services and space to best support their patrons and communities. The individual sections in the policy statement below have been implemented since to 2013 and are continuously updated as necessary. They are available on the Library website for visibility.

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The following policy statements provide detailed rules, guidelines and regulations for the running and use of the Library resources and services.

These are initiated by the Library and approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. The Library is the responsible unit. The latest revision date for these sub-policies is 25 March 2024. The date of next review is 15 June 2025.

Policy compliance is the responsibility of the University Librarian, and implementation is devolved to appropriate members of Library staff. Users who do not comply and who disrespect the rights of others will be asked for their university ID, escorted from the building and referred to university authorities.

Reporting on policy compliance is to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, to the Finance Department for budget issues, or to the Internal Audit department upon inspection as demonstrated below.

The policy statements providing detailed rules, guidelines and regulations are as follows:

4.1 Library User Rights and Responsibilities

4.2 Library Loan Rules

4.3 Inter-Library Loan

- 4.4 Policies for Selection, Storage and Access of Special Collections Materials
- 4.5 Collection Development Policy
- 4.6 Visitor Policy
- 4.7 Course Reserves – Streaming Video Reserves
- 4.8 Information Literacy, Instruction and Reference Policy

4.1 Library User Rights and Responsibilities

4.1.1 Introduction

The Library is committed to providing students and faculty with an inspiring and engaging learning environment that meets a wide variety of needs. To support this mission, the Library has adopted the following statement of Library User Rights and Responsibilities. Adherence to this statement is necessary to create an equitable and comfortable service and space for all.

The AUS Library provides:

- Courteous, knowledgeable, and helpful assistance
- Technology tools to facilitate research, inquiry and knowledge creation
- Facilities that support and enrich individual and collaborative learning
- Information resources in a variety of formats

Library users are expected to:

- Honor the library as a place for study, research and collaboration
- Behave in a manner that does not disturb others or cause damage to the library
- Interact courteously and respectfully with other library users and library staff
- Maintain a clean, pest-free environment by not bringing food or drink into the library (except as described below).

Library users, as members of a community of learners, play an important role in creating an environment that is conducive to research, reflection and collaborative learning. As such, all library users are expected to act appropriately in the library and conduct themselves in accordance with these rights and responsibilities. Users who do not comply and who disrespect the rights of others will be asked for their university ID, escorted from the building and referred to university authorities.

4.1.2 Food & Drink

AUS Library's Food & Drink Policy is intended to preserve our library materials, computer equipment, and furnishings, and to maintain a pleasant and comfortable environment for our readers and staff. We also recognize the University's commitment to move toward sustainable waste reduction initiatives.

Food - Food is not allowed in the library.

Drink - Unless otherwise posted, drinks may be consumed in the library. We encourage reusable cups or recycle your disposable cups/bottles.

Non-Compliance

- Users not complying with these policies will be asked to take the food outside of the library.

4.1.3 Mobile Phones

Library users are urged to set their mobile phones to silent or vibrate out of respect for the other users of the library.

4.1.4 Library Rooms

The following rules apply to all Group Study rooms on the 1st floor of the library:

1. The rooms are limited to 2 or more people.
2. Unattended items will be moved to the floor (in the corner of the room).
3. Individuals who prefer to study quietly may use the silent study area on the 1st or 2nd floor. There are 2 seminar rooms (Seminar Rooms 1 and 2) that can be reserved for faculty or staff for their tutorials or meetings. These can be booked in advance for the entire semester. Reservations for the rooms can be made through email to circulation@aus.edu or in person at the Library Services desk. The rooms can be checked out for 2 hours only.

4.1.5 Donations

Donations will only be accepted as described in the Library Donations Policy, (Section 4.8 below).

4.1.6 Photographing and Videotaping

Photography or videography is generally permitted if it is for general Public Library promotion by the media, student projects, and/or strictly for personal use.

In order to protect the rights of individual Library patrons and to reduce distractions, photographing and videotaping on Library property are restricted as follows:

- Under no circumstances may the public, members of the media, or Library staff take photographs or videotape without the express permission of any Library patrons who would be prominently included within the composition.
- Requests to photograph or videotape for commercial purposes are not permitted without approval by the University Librarian. Requests for permission to photograph or videotape for commercial purposes must be submitted in writing for review by the University Librarian.

4.1.7 Copyright & Fair Use

The AUS Library adheres to copyright regulations outlined in UAE Federal Law No.38 of 2021 On Copyrights and Neighboring Rights.

As an institution accredited in the United States, the library also adheres to the spirit of copyright legislation existing in the United States as it pertains to distribution of scholarly material. For more information about copyright please see our Copyright and Permissions Service.

Notices regarding reprographic reproduction legislation are placed clearly with copying equipment such as photocopiers, printers, and scanners.

4.2 Library Loan Rules

4.2.1 Borrowing privileges

Borrowing privileges are determined by patron type as follows. Unless specified, these apply to General Collection items.

Patron Type	Items Limit	Loan Period	No. of Renewals	Reference Books	Special Collections
Faculty	75	1 Semester	Semester Automatic renewals unless recalled	1 Day	1 Week
Graduate	75				
Staff	75				
Student	30	28 Days	Unlimited Automatic renewals unless recalled	-	-
UoSharjah Faculty	30			-	-

Alumni	30			-	-
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For all patron types, the following rules apply:

- Loaned Items will be automatically renewed provided that:
 - No other patron has requested the item
 - Your patron account is not due to expire within the next loan period
- Items may be recalled by another user after two weeks. In this case, you will be notified and given a reasonable amount of time to return the item to the library.
- Fines may apply to any late returns or lost items.
- You are responsible for all materials checked out to your account. The library strongly advises against loaning items you have borrowed to another person. In the event of loss or a late return, you will be liable for the applicable fines.

For specific patron types, the following rules apply:

For Undergraduate Students

- Undergraduate students (with Professor Approval) can use our Interlibrary Loan (ILL) Portal to request articles and books not found in the library collection.
- Presentation, group study and seminar rooms may be reserved in advance. Reservation times are 30 minutes to two hours. 4 bookings per week per type of room (Group Study rooms, Presentation rooms, etc.) are permitted. Excessive bookings per day may be cancelled.
- Students may utilize Pick-Up and Delivery Options.
- Students can request copies of book chapters or articles owned by the library (subject to copyright limits) via Scan and Send.

For Graduate Students and Faculty

- Graduate Students, Faculty and Staff may use our Interlibrary Loan Portal to request articles and books not found in the library collection.
- Presentation, group study and seminar rooms may be reserved in advance. Reservation times are 30 minutes to two hours. 4 bookings per week per type of room (Group Study rooms, Presentation rooms, etc.) are permitted. Excessive bookings per day may be cancelled.
- Graduate students, faculty and staff may utilize Pick-Up and Delivery Options.
- Graduate students, faculty and staff can request copies of book chapters or articles owned by the library (subject to copyright limits) via Scan and Send.
- Faculty may assign a proxy to check-out material(s) on their behalf. To assign a proxy, please login with your AUS credentials and complete the online Proxy Authorization Form.

For Alumni and Family

- Users may utilize Pick-Up and Delivery Options.
- Alumni and Family can request copies of book chapters or articles owned by the library (subject to copyright limits) via Scan and Send
- Licensing agreements restrict electronic databases to currently enrolled students and faculty/staff only, or onsite access.
- To review open access resources that are freely available, visit The Research Guide to Open Access Resources.

- *For University of Sharjah Faculty*
- The existing University of Sharjah ID card will be used as the library ID card.
- Fines may apply to any late returns or lost items.
- Hold requests are not available.
- Repeated overdue or loss/damage of materials may result in loss of borrowing privileges for individual users.
- University of Sharjah Staff, Students and other borrowers may request printed items via the UoS Library InterLibrary Loan Service.

4.2.2 Library Cards

Your AUS ID card serves as your borrower's card. Family members of AUS faculty over the age of 16 have the same borrowing privileges as Alumni (above) and can use their AUS ID cards. Borrowing privileges are extended only to AUS students, faculty, staff and family members in residence, but others may use the library's resources on the premises.

4.2.3 Renewals

If you are finished with an item, we encourage you to return it to the library. The library will automatically renew items on loan provided that:

- No other patron has requested the item
- The patron account is not due to expire soon

Patrons should not renew items themselves, as this interferes with the auto-renewal process.

4.2.4 Overdue Items, Fines and Replacement Charges

All Library borrowers are responsible for the safe and timely return of library materials. It is a courtesy and sign of respect to your fellow scholars to return items on time. When items are seriously overdue, courtesy notices are sent. However, failure to receive a notice does not excuse a user from overdue fines.

You are responsible for all materials checked out to your account. The library strongly advises against loaning items you have borrowed to another person. In the event of loss or a late return, you will be liable for the applicable fines.

- Borrowing privileges will be suspended when fines and/or replacement charges reach 100 Dhs or if you have one or more unpaid replacement fee.
- Students who have unpaid fines at the end of a semester will not receive their grades and will not be allowed to register for classes the following semester. Students who have graduated or transferred will not be able to receive transcripts until any outstanding library fines have been paid.
- Items that are long overdue will be considered lost and a replacement fee will be charged. If the item is returned after this time, the patron must still pay the applicable overdue fines plus a processing fee of 75 Dhs per item.

Item Type	Fines
General collection, leisure, media, music and periodicals (journals)	Items that have been requested by another patron (i.e. recalled or placed on hold) and not returned on time: 1 Dh. per day for 30 days. Items that are overdue for less than 1 month: No overdue fines will be issued. Items that are overdue for more than 1 month: Will be declared missing and a replacement fee will be charged.
Laptops	Fines begin accumulating from the time the item is due:

	20 Dhs. per hour up to 10 hours. After 10 hours the item will be declared missing and a replacement fee will be charged. Laptops must be returned with the included charger. Loan period is 5 hours. Loan periods will be shortened to 1 hour before library closing.
Room keys	Fines begin accumulating from the time the item is due. 10 Dhs. Per hour up to 10 hours. After 10 hours the item will be declared lost and a replacement fee will be charged.
Laptop peripherals	Fines begin accumulating from the time the item is due: 1 Dhs. per hour up to 10 hours
Hourly Reserve items	Includes reserves with 1 hour, 2 hour, 3 hour, and 1 day loan periods: 1 Dh. per hour up to 10 hours. After that time the item will be declared missing and a replacement fee will be charged.
Multi-day Reserve items	Includes reserves with 3, 7, and 28 day loan periods: 1 Dh. per day up to 30 days. After that time the item will be declared missing and a replacement fee will be charged.
Replacement fees	Borrowers will be charged a replacement fee for items that are missing, lost or damaged beyond repair. This fee will include the current cost of the item, PLUS 75 Dhs (more for sets and rare materials) for processing and shipping.

4.2.5 Fine Payment

Library fines can be paid online.

- Registered students and staff can pay online by credit card through the AUS website. For instructions, visit the AUS Finance Department's Online Payment Guide

4.3 InterLibrary Loans Policy

- Articles and books not found in the library collection may be obtained through interlibrary loan (ILL). This service is currently restricted to faculty, staff, graduate students and undergraduates with Professor approval.
- Requestors should first check to make sure that the materials are not available in the AUS Library. Please search WorldCat for books, articles and journals in the library collection.
- Requests may be submitted via the InterLibrary Loan portal on the Library website. Faculty, staff and graduate students can log on using their AUS email id and password.
- We will continue to process requests for materials that are emailed to the ILL Department, ill@aus.edu. Please be sure to include full bibliographic details when submitting requests.
- Due to the cost of providing this service, faculty are asked to exercise restraint when submitting requests. The library will endeavor to fulfill all reasonable requests but may on occasion need to restrict the number of orders submitted per faculty member. Graduate students may request up to 15 items per semester.
- Dissertations are difficult if not impossible to borrow through interlibrary loan and are expensive to purchase outright. If faculty or graduate students wish to borrow or purchase a dissertation, the library will contribute \$35.00 USD towards the purchase/borrowing price; the remaining cost will be the responsibility of the faculty member or graduate student.
- Undergraduate students with permission from their professor may request an interlibrary loan. Senior Design students should contact the interlibrary loan department for assistance, ill@aus.edu.

4.4 Policies for Selection, Storage and Access of Special Collections Materials

4.4.1 Special Collections room

Items are housed in the Special Collections room, based on one or more of the following criteria:

- The item has significant value and/or is rare, and could not be easily replaced should it be lost or damaged.
- The item's contents might be offensive to members of the University community because of:
 - nudity
 - extreme violence
 - extreme depictions of religious subjects
 - interpretations of Islam which are offensive to the Muslim community
 - written descriptions of actions or events which are objectionable.
- The item is fragile or bound in such a manner that it could be damaged by normal handling.

4.4.2 Selection and access to Special Collections materials

- The library does not intentionally select materials that require housing in the Special Collections room. Rather, items selected by normal means under the Collection Development Policy are transferred to the Special Collections room on finding them to meet one or more of the above criteria.
- Material housed in the Special Collections room is organized and stored in a manner appropriate to the items, and shall meet normal standards for access and preservation
- Any student or faculty member may access the Special Collections room during the library's normal operating hours. Staff, family members and others may use the Special Collections room only with the permission of the University Librarian.
- Everyone using the Special Collections room will be required to sign a special waiver form, and deposit their ID card with the library circulation desk while using the room. All materials stored in the Special Collections room may be used only within that room.
- Special Collections items may circulate to faculty for one week. Faculty members assume full responsibility for items loaned and their use outside the restricted area of the Special Collections. Under no circumstances are Special Collections materials circulated to students, staff, family members or other users.
- Material may be temporarily removed from the room for purposes of scanning or photocopying, but only with the permission of, and under the direction of a qualified library staff member.

4.5 Collection Development Policy

4.5.1 Purpose of the Collection Development policy

The library builds and maintains a comprehensive collection of resources to serve the needs of the University. Part of the library's mission is to connect students and faculty to the world of information and ideas. To fulfill this mission the library will review, evaluate, select and maintain materials in appropriate formats that primarily support the needs of the curriculum.

4.5.2 Principles of Selection

Faculty, staff and students are invited and encouraged to recommend purchases for the library collection. Each faculty department has an assigned liaison librarian. The librarian works in collaboration with faculty to develop a high-quality collection.

General evaluation:

When evaluating items for acquisition, priority will be given (in the following order) to selections that support:

- The curriculum of an existing undergraduate course, graduate course or degree program
- The general information needs of undergraduate and graduate students
- Undergraduate teaching, graduate teaching and course development
- Faculty research and their professional information needs
- The cultural, intellectual and professional needs of the University community
- Other needs, including recreational, of the extended University community

Evaluating books and media:

The following factors will be considered when evaluating books and media items for acquisition:

- Relationship of the title to the existing collection and collection goals
- Significance and timeliness of the material
- Scope and authority of the author or publisher
- Reviews and recommendations
- Format
- Cost

Evaluating periodicals:

The following factors will be considered when evaluating periodicals for acquisition:

- Relationship of the title to the existing collection and collection goals
- Significance and timeliness of the material
- Availability of indexing and finding tools
- Scope, authority and duration of the publication
- Reviews and recommendations
- Format
- Cost including annual inflation rates
- The form to 'Request a journal or database' is available from the Library website.

Evaluating electronic databases:

The following factors will be considered when evaluating electronic resources for acquisition:

- Relationship of the title to the existing collection and collection goals
- Significance and timeliness of the material
- Availability of indexing and finding tools
- Availability of full text and/or images
- Scope, authority and duration of the publication
- Reviews and recommendations
- Ease of access
- Format
- Cost including annual inflation rates

4.5.3 Electronic books (E-books)

The format of library materials is integral to its use by patrons, usefulness to the collection as a whole and support in the present and future. As academic and institutional needs change and technology advances, the library will adapt to reflect those changes.

The library acquires materials on an e-preferred basis. It acquires resources in electronic format where possible. Print will continue to be purchased when requested by faculty and where print is preferred for quality, usability or content reasons. Duplication of the print and electronic versions of a resource is generally avoided but will be considered on a case-by-case basis.

In addition to the criteria used for evaluating print books, the following additional factors will be considered when evaluating individual e-books for acquisition:

- e-book provides greater accessibility to information over print (multiple simultaneous users, off campus availability, link from iLearn)
- e-book can be downloaded to portable e-readers
- book is needed quickly
- availability via the Library's licensed vendors
- availability of remote access via IP authentication
- value-added features including flexibility and ease in searching, and frequent updates
- cost compared to print edition
- presence or absence of Digital Rights Management controls

Occasionally the library purchases or subscribes to e-books as pre-packaged collections. E-books are cataloged and access is provided from links in the online library catalog. The library also provides links to freely available e-books on the Web. The library will provide users with training and materials to aid them in searching for and using e-books.

All resource purchases are procured and authorized by relevant AUS channels, such as the Finance and Procurement departments, and have been assessed by Internal Audit procedures as satisfactory. Single source justifications are provided when necessary, and direct orders are only used when other procurement options are not available.

4.5.4 Exclusions

In general, the library does not collect the following: publications in languages other than English and Arabic (except as required by the curriculum); material for children; incomplete sets or incomplete runs of periodicals; items with bindings unsuitable for library use; materials in formats for which specialized equipment is required and is unavailable.

4.5.5 Controversial Materials

Occasionally faculty request materials that are culturally sensitive and require special handling. The Special Collections Room has been established to store these items. Special Collections is open to all AUS students and faculty; other staff may use the collection with approval of the University Librarian. Students using the Special Collections Room must sign in and agree to the policies governing access prior to using the collections. Special Collections is available at all times when the library is open.

Policies related to Special Collections can be found in the document, Policies for Selection, Storage and Circulation of Special Collections Materials, available from the University Librarian.

All Library resources are for educational use. Large databases or streaming media bundles may sometimes contain sensitive material. Library patrons should contact the University Librarian with queries on the appropriateness of specific resources, or follow the Objections process below.

4.5.6 Objections

One of the express objectives of the library is to gather materials representing diverse points of view. Therefore, cases may arise where a library user objects to a particular item in the collection. Objection forms may be obtained at the library administration office. On receipt of a signed and completed objection form, the library undertakes a review of the item. These reviews are conducted by the senior library staff and the University Librarian. When appropriate, the University Librarian may request input from faculty and senior academic officers. Findings of the review are reported to the library user originating the objection.

4.5.7 Cooperation with other Libraries

The library will cooperate as fully as possible in resource sharing activities. These activities may include interlibrary loan, reciprocal use/borrowing agreements, and cooperative collection development. Further, the library may participate in cooperative purchasing programs and other activities with other libraries and library consortia.

4.5.8 Replacements

The library does not automatically replace missing or damaged materials. The following factors are considered: existence of adequate coverage in the collection; cost of replacement (whether in-print or out-of-print); demand for the specific title or subject; and availability of newer or better materials on the subject.

4.5.9 Duplication

Duplicate and multiple copies of resources are not purchased unless there is a demonstrable need for additional copies. The library may retain duplicate copies that are received by various means.

4.5.10 Preservation

Damaged items may be repaired, replaced or withdrawn in accordance with the replacement policies of the library.

4.5.11 Weeding and Storage

Collection maintenance is undertaken to ensure ongoing relevancy and ease of use of the collection. Superseded and outdated materials may be discarded, placed in storage or donated to charity with the approval of the University Librarian. Retention policies are established for periodicals. Newspapers are retained for two months in their original printed form. The library retains records of withdrawn items for a reasonable period. An annual list is also made available for purposes of financial audit.

4.5.12 Standards

The library shall develop its collection according to the collection standards established in the latest available edition of "Standards for Libraries in Higher Education" as produced by Association of College and Research Libraries Board and the American Library Association Standards Committee.

4.5.13 Bibliographic standards

AUS Library uses Resource Description and Access (RDA) for bibliographic records. Authority records are sourced from Library of Congress authorities. OCLC WorldShare Management Services (WMS) is used for creating and maintaining records, which are in Machine-Readable Cataloging (MARC21) format. Additionally, AUS Library maintains an institutional repository (<https://dspace.aus.edu>) which uses the Dublin Core metadata standard.

4.5.14 Remote Access to E-resources

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Due to strict licensing arrangements, off-campus access to resources is available only to registered students, faculty and staff. Access is facilitated through the use of EzyProzy and Shibboleth authentication and identification technology. Walk-in access to e-resources is available on-site, with guest wifi available.

4.6 Visitors Policy

4.6.1 Process for Visitor Applications

The American University of Sharjah Library welcomes visitors for research and learning purposes.

Library privileges for visitors are outlined in the Terms of Use below. To register, visitors are required to complete the Visitor Access Request Form and send required documents to auslibrary@aus.edu. If approved, the Library will request a Gate Pass for visitor access onto campus for the duration of the visit (maximum one month per request).

4.6.2 Library Terms of Use for Visitors

Library privileges for visitors include in-house use of library print resources including journals, magazines and reference materials; access to reference service; and access to databases and electronic resources via the Guest Wireless network in the library building. Visitors must bring their own laptop or mobile device.

Library privileges for visitors exclude borrowing privileges for any materials; access to library computers and use of study rooms, presentation rooms, media rooms or seminar rooms. Visitors are expected to observe all library rules and regulations.

4.7 Course Reserves and Streaming Video Reserves

4.7.1 Library Reserve Systems

Faculty can use the library's Reserves systems to make materials available to their students. The Reserves systems are easy to use for students and faculty and ensure that all access is provided in accordance with copyright restrictions.

4.7.2 Course Reserves

Library or personal material can be placed on reserve. Normally, reserve items can be used for up to two hours and only within the library. Faculty may specify other reserve conditions if necessary. Library books and recordings can be placed on reserve by completing a Course Reserves Form, or by providing complete details to the library staff. Reservations for more than 10 items per class will be kept on the regular shelves and the library circulation system will be set not to allow borrowing of the specified items. Reservations for 10 or fewer items will be kept at the Circulation/Reserve desk, and handed to students on request.

NOTE:

- Items which are the personal property of a faculty member can also be placed on reserve. The library will take all reasonable measures to safeguard personal reserve items.
- Articles and personal property reserves will be returned to you at the end of each semester.
- Items placed on reserve must abide by UAE and US copyright laws.
- For additional information or questions on reserves, please email reserves@aus.edu

4.7.3 Streaming Video Reserves

The Streaming Video Reserves service provides digitization of video intended for educational use through iLearn to students currently enrolled in the class.

Faculty may request streaming video for use in current semester courses. Requests must be submitted using the Streaming Videos Reserves Form. The form and material to be digitized can be

submitted to library staff at the Circulation & Reserves Desk. The following formats can be digitized: DVD and video from some external devices.

Material to be digitized must be owned either by the library or by the person requesting the digitization. Third-party copies, recordings, or transfers, including rentals or personal recordings of television broadcasts cannot be digitized. Converting from VHS to streaming video is possible only when a DVD copy is not available for the same material. If a DVD copy is available this version must be purchased and then used for streaming purposes.

In order to digitize original footage created by students, written permission from the creator is required.

Video is digitized and placed on the Panopto portal. Content can then be accessed via iLearn for the duration of the semester. Copies of digitized material will not be provided.

For commercially produced video or film, the library follows applicable guidelines for fair use within the context of copyright law. Acknowledging the source of the copyrighted material does not substitute for obtaining permission.

The Library will adhere to the following definition of fair use when determining an appropriate amount of material to digitize – “reproduction by a teacher of a small part of a work to illustrate a lesson.”

In general, we are able to digitize the amount that would fall within a regular 50 minute classroom session. Some instances must be evaluated on a case-by-case basis. The library is more than happy to discuss the guidelines and how they apply to materials that faculty wish to use. Please contact Copyright (copyright@aus.edu)

4.8 Library Donations Policy

4.8.1 Donations to the AUS Library

The AUS Library welcomes inquiries about donations but has strict limits on what is accepted. For each donation we accept, there are both immediate and long-term expenses to cover processing of the items and making the items accessible. Generally, only items that would make a unique and important contribution to the library collection will be considered.

The AUS Library does not accept:

- Textbooks
- Mass-market paperbacks
- Books, journals, magazines, DVDs and CDs that duplicate our holdings
- Individual issues or small runs of scholarly journals
- Popular magazines (e.g. National Geographic, Smithsonian, Reader’s Digest, etc.)
- Materials in poor condition or exhibiting signs of mold or mildew
- Materials that contain highlighting, underlining, or annotations (unless annotations are of significant scholarly value)
- Materials in outmoded formats (e.g. cassette tapes, video tapes, etc.)
- Materials that might cause the library to be liable for copyright infringement (e.g., copied audio and video recordings)

Prospective donors should NOT send unsolicited items. They should, instead, first contact the appropriate Faculty Liaison Librarian to speak about the usefulness of the proposed donation. To help evaluate proposed donations, the Library may request that donors provide a list of materials.

No monetary value will be placed on materials given to the library. No special conditions will be agreed for housing, retention, display or any other variation from normal library practice. The library's selection and weeding principles apply to donated items in the same manner as they apply to purchased items.

4.9 Information Literacy, Instruction and Reference Policy

Librarians, in curricular partnership with the faculty, provide instruction, resources and services that strengthen student research skills, promote critical reflection and foster academic excellence.

At AUS, information literacy (IL) – the ability to locate, evaluate, and use information – is recognized as a set of critical research skills enabling students to navigate the complex information landscape to improve their academic, professional, and lifelong education. Information literacy is also recognized as an essential requirement of the General Education program of the university. In helping students develop these skills, the AUS Library provides a range of programs designed both to introduce library services and to promote information literacy at the curriculum level.

The library is responsible for delivery of course-integrated information literacy skills instruction sessions within three required General Education courses which all students must complete before graduating: WRI 102, and ENG 203 or ENG 204.

Library instruction is also provided by liaison librarians, at an undergraduate and graduate level across all disciplines upon faculty request. These sessions are often developed and supplemented by online librarian-designed subject guides (LibGuides) linked to iLearn courses.

Reference librarians assist students with research strategies, reinforce information skills gained in the information literacy classes, and provide reference service as needed by the community. Reference assistance is available at the Research Help Desk, by individual appointment and through the online "Ask-a-Librarian" service.

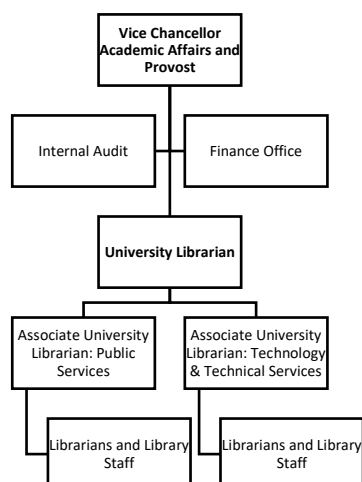
5. Scope/applicability:

The rules, procedures and services outlined in this document apply to AUS students, faculty, staff, alumni, visitors and patrons from the wider community where specified.

6. Responsibilities:

Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Responsible for approval budgets, staff appointments and policies relating to the library
University Librarian	Assumes overall responsibility for implementing the policies governing the functions and resource commitment/use of the AUS Library.
Internal Audit	Responsible for reporting on compliance of the Library with applicable requirements.
Finance Department	Responsible for the processing of invoices and other payment mechanisms.
Library Public Services team	Responsible for the day to day operations of the circulation and loans functions as articulated in the policies; the support and training of Library patrons, and the general appearance of the collections and facilities.
Technology & Technical Services team	Responsible for the acquisitions, cataloguing and organization of resources, both print and online. The Library Technology team deals

with IT issues within the Library, and the online Library presence (ie. Website).



7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **Automatic renewal:** When the Library Management System automatically renews loaned items for the following loan period. Patrons do not need to individually renew their loans, but may return them if they are finished with the item.
- **Digital Rights Management:** Access control technologies used to control or restrict the use of copyrighted materials, such as e-books.
- **DVD:** Digital Video Disk is a media format.
- **Fair Use:** the right to legally use a portion of copyrighted material for comment, criticism and further educational purposes without seeking permission from the copyright holder, such as including reproduction by a teacher of a small part of a work to illustrate a lesson.
- **General Education courses:** required courses which all students must complete before graduating such as *Academic Writing II* (WRI 102), and *Writing About Literature* or *Advanced Academic Writing* (ENG 203 or ENG 204).
- **iLearn:** the virtual learning management system used at AUS, based on Blackboard software.
- **InterLibrary Loan:** This is a library-to-library request on behalf of a patron for material not held at the requesting library. Usually, libraries seek supplying libraries from a subscribed network, or via organizations such as the British Library.
- **LibGuide:** usually a webpage on the LibGuide Content Management System platform, often used to explain a library resource or function.
- **Panopto:** Panopto is a system for recording and sharing lectures and educational content to a restricted audience.
- **Patron:** An individual using library resources or services.
- **Reserves:** A collection of resources (print or electronic) kept in a restricted area and only available for short term loan, to enable access to a wider group of patrons.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The AUS Library adheres to copyright regulations outlined in UAE Federal Law No.38 of 2021 On Copyrights and Neighboring Rights.

As an institution accredited in the United States, the library also adheres to the spirit of copyright legislation existing in the United States as it pertains to distribution of scholarly material.

Relevant forms and further procedural information can be found on the Library website: <https://library.aus.edu>.

Appendix 1: Visitor form - <https://library.aus.edu/sites/default/files/Documents/PDFs/visitor-access-request-form.pdf>

Appendix 2: Course Reserves webform - <https://library.aus.edu/forms/coursereserve>

Appendix 3: Streaming Video Reserve Request webform: <https://library.aus.edu/forms/videostreaming>

9. Policy history:

The policy statements in section 4 were each developed as separate policies for the administration of the library resources and services. Most articles were developed prior to 2013 and revised in 2018. This revision in 2024 has updated the statements where appropriate and reformatted the policies into the Ministry mandated template.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	November 4, 2019	Update of policies including contact details, change to loan policies.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	15.06.2021	Reformat of policies into Ministry mandated template	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	05.06.2022	Update dates, small content changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	15.03.2023	Update of policies including visitor information	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	25.04.2024	Update of policies including remote access, bibliographic standards	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
6.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

For policy, rules and guideline clarification, contact:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
University Librarian	+971 6 515 2255	auslibrary@aus.edu

9. Fiscal Resources, Financial Management and Budgeting

a. Internal Audit Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0900AR01	Policy Title:	Internal Audit
Prepared By:	Internal Audit	Issue Date:	September, 2019
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Internal Audit	Effective Date:	June 1, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	October, 2025

1. Policy:

AUS has established an Internal Audit department to provide an independent and objective assurance service that will add value and improve operations through improved controls and efficiencies.

2. Purpose:

AUS Internal Audit provides a service to the AUS Board of Trustees, and its sub-committee - the Audit and Compliance Committee, and to all levels of AUS management. AUS Internal Audit achieves this by reviewing and providing independent assurance on the internal control environment throughout AUS. AUS bylaws were established under Emiri Decree 9 (2011). Article 8 of the AUS bylaws give the AUS Board of Trustees power to establish Standing Committees and the Audit and Compliance Committee has been established under this provision.

With regards to Internal Audit, the Audit and Compliance Committee is required to;

- Appoint or dismiss the Internal Auditor; and to
- Approve the annual internal audit plan and receive and act on the reports of the Internal Auditor.

The AUS Director of Internal Audit fulfills the Bylaw's requirements by reviewing risks, internal controls, quality, efficiency and effectiveness of AUS processes and systems. The results of all reviews are reported to the Audit and Compliance Committee and the Board of Trustees at designated intervals throughout the year.

3. Introduction / background

This policy outlines the roles, authority and responsibilities of the Office of Internal Audit and those of the management whose schools, departments and divisions are audited. Internal Audit is defined by the Institute of Internal Auditors as;

“an independent, objective assurance and consulting activity designed to add value and improve an organization's operations. It helps an organization accomplish its objectives by bringing a systematic, disciplined approach to evaluate and improve the effectiveness of risk management, control, and governance processes.”

This policy applies to all full-time, part-time, permanent, temporary and uncompensated employees, faculty, staff, officers, volunteers, and student employees.

4. Policy Statement:

AUS has established an Internal Audit department to provide an independent and objective assurance

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service that will add value and improve operations through improved controls and efficiencies. Internal audit reviews are intended to assist the University in determining the adequacy and effectiveness of risk management internal controls, adherence with applicable laws and regulations, and reliability of financial reporting. A well-designed internal audit function will help AUS accomplish its objectives by applying a systematic, disciplined approach to evaluate and assess the effectiveness of risk management, control and governance processes.

All AUS Internal Audit personnel must be independent in appearance as well as in fact. For this reason, they report directly to the Chair of the Audit and Compliance Committee of the Board of Trustees and on a day-to-day basis to the Chancellor of the University. These reporting relationships ensure the independence of the Internal Audit function and the adequate consideration of Internal Audit findings and recommendations.

5. Scope/applicability:

AUS Internal Audit is responsible for utilizing a risk-based approach to evaluate and improve the effectiveness of internal controls in place at AUS and its affiliates. Activities include the following:

- Developing and implementing an annual Internal Audit Plan following approval by the Audit and Compliance Committee.
- Conducting operational and compliance audits of processes, procedures, practices and information systems, preparing timely reports, including recommendations for modifications of management practices, fiscal policies and accounting procedures as warranted by audit findings.
- Support departments and units with assessment of the effectiveness of policies, procedures and internal controls.
- Establishing and maintaining a quality assurance program to evaluate AUS Internal Audit operations, including an assessment of the uniformity of work paper preparation, audit sampling, work paper review, report preparation and review, report communication and issuance and record retention.

AUS Internal Audit remit covers all AUS activities and its affiliates that are determined by the Audit and Compliance Committee to be within the scope of Internal Audit. The scope of the Internal Audit activity is intended to determine whether AUS risk management, control, and governance, as represented by management, are adequate and functioning as designed.

6. Responsibilities:

AUS Internal Audit Responsibilities:

- Perform audits in accordance with the auditing standards of The Institute of Internal Auditors (IIA). The International Professional Practices Framework (IPPF) ® a global, recognized guidance-setting body, providing authoritative internal audit guidance. Conformance with the principles set forth in mandatory guidance is required and essential for the professional practice of internal auditing.
- Not to undertake responsibility for developing or implementing procedures, preparing records, or engaging in any activity which they would normally review and evaluate, since doing so could reasonably be construed as making them responsible for what they are auditing and thereby compromising their independence. In this regard, AUS Internal Audit personnel are not to be used as accounting, finance or information systems staff. AUS Internal Audit has neither direct responsibility for, nor authority over, the operations or activities that are

reviewed.

- Not to make operating decisions, and do not have the authority to direct activities, including implementation of corrective actions. These activities and tasks remain the responsibility of management.
- Are authorized to obtain the necessary assistance of AUS personnel unit where they perform audits, as well as specialized services from inside or outside of the organization.
- Exercise strict accountability for confidentiality and safeguarding records and information, AUS Internal Audit has full, free, and unrestricted access to any and all of AUS records, physical properties, and personnel pertinent to carrying out any engagement. While AUS Internal Audit have free and unrestricted access to senior management and the Board, they will attempt to resolve any issues related to a perceived limitation of scope through the Chancellor. All AUS employees are requested to assist the internal audit activity in fulfilling its roles and responsibilities.
- Exhibit the highest level of professional objectivity in gathering, evaluating, and communicating information about the activity or process being examined.
- Make balanced assessments of all the relevant circumstances and not be unduly influenced by their own interests or by others in forming judgments.

Management's Responsibilities:

- Notify Internal Audit when changes to applications and systems are being planned that may ultimately affect data that are used in AUS systems.
- Provide sufficient staffing and other resources as needed, including specialized technical staffing, to support Internal Audit during an engagement.
- Provide a timely response to the internal audit observations and recommendations, including an achievable management action plan, within ten business days from the receipt of the draft audit report.
- Promptly assign department responsibility for ensuring the management action plan is implemented and appropriate follow-up action is completed.
- Respond promptly to Internal Audit's requests for status reports and updates, and attend meetings of the Audit and Compliance Committee when the internal audit report is being considered.

The Internal Audit Organization Chart and reporting lines is shown at Appendix A. Appendix B shows a summary of the roles and responsibilities of the Audit and Compliance Committee, the Chancellor and the Director of Internal Audit.

7. Accountability

Under the direction of the Audit and Compliance Committee of the Board of Trustees, the Chancellor and Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration, the Director of Internal Audit shall ensure compliance with and implement this policy, which has been approved by the Audit and Compliance Committee.

8. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

ACC – Audit and Compliance Committee

IIA - Institute of Internal Auditors

9. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

This policy is related to;

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AUS Internal Audit Manual - This policy statement forms the basis of the AUS Internal Audit Manual which contains details on the AUS Internal Audit methodology and application.

External Audit Policy – - which sets out AUS’ approach to the appointment of its external auditor.

AUS Risk Management Policy - which sets out AUS’ approach to the management of risk.

10. Policy History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Jan 03, 2020	New Policy	Not Applicable
2.0	Feb 04, 2019	Edited Policy	Scope
3.0	May 17, 2018	Edited Policy	Scope, Sanctions and Frequently Asked Questions
4.0	June 1, 2024	General template update	Chancellor

11. References:

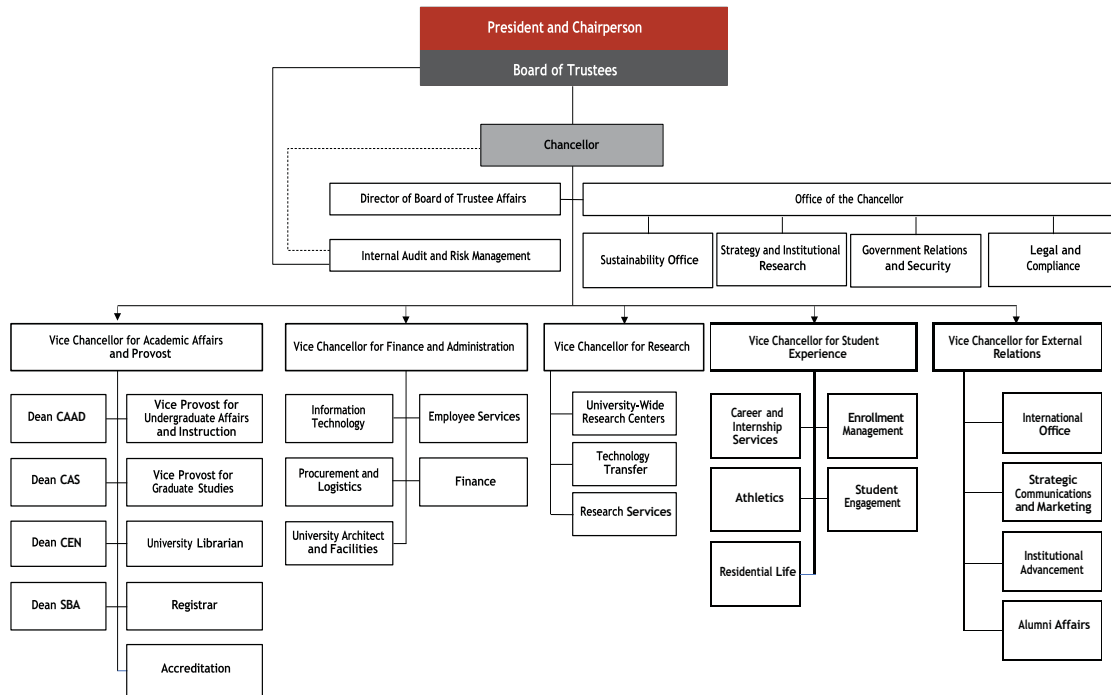
University faculty, staff and students may provide feedback about this document by emailing kfairbotham@aus.edu.

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director, Internal Audit, Office of the Chancellor.	Tel +971 6 515 4023	kfairbotham@aus.edu .

Appendices

Appendix A

Internal Audit Organization Chart and reporting lines



Appendix B

Roles and Responsibilities

Role	Responsibilities
AUS Audit and Compliance Committee	<i>“Audit and Compliance Committee - Role and Scope as per AUS Bylaws”</i> The Audit and Compliance Committee shall: • Review and audit accounts of the University and report on same to the Board; • Monitor compliance with internal policies and procedures; • Recommend approval of the engagement or dismissal of the External Audit firm; • Appoint or dismiss the Internal Auditor; • Approve the annual internal audit plan and receive and act on the reports of the Internal Auditor; • Review actions to be taken in the event of any reported budgetary impropriety; • Review the annual audit report made by the University's External Auditors at the end of each fiscal year and report on same to the Board for the approval of final accounts; • Adopt policies consistent with its responsibilities; and • Perform other duties requested by the Board or the Executive Committee;
The Chancellor	• Provide leadership to the AUS community to ensure AUS operates in a professional, ethical and well-controlled manner consistent with the expectations of its stakeholders. • Review and contribute to the annual Internal Audit Plan prior to its submission to the ACC. • Review and approve the annual Internal Audit budget • Receive regular reports from the Director of Internal Audit on internal audit activities and issues arising therefrom. • Report concerns to the Audit and Compliance Committee and Director of Internal Audit.
Director – Internal Audit	• Review, with the Chancellor, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and the Audit and Compliance Committee, the Internal Audit Policy, the Annual Audit Plan, other activities, staffing and organizational structure of the internal audit function. • Develop and deploy procedures and guidance to support the Internal Audit Policy. • Provide assessments entities under review on the adequacy and effectiveness of processes for controlling its activities and managing its risks to ensure controls are effective and functioning as intended. • Inform and advise the Audit and Compliance Committee and management of audit findings with recommendations for appropriate corrective measures.

	• Provide the Audit and Compliance Committee, Senior Management and auditees with an overall assessment of financial, operational, compliance and information technology controls necessary to minimize the risk of material loss and meet the University's functional objectives. • Conduct follow-up inquiries (informal) and reviews (formal) as appropriate to ensure satisfactory actions are taken by management to resolve significant audit findings. • Provide periodic updates to the Audit and Compliance Committee on the status of engagements contained in the Annual Audit Plan, including any findings warranting the attention of the Audit and Compliance Committee. • Coordinate Internal Audit activities with other AUS control and monitoring functions and external audit to best achieve the objectives of the internal audit function, as well as the objectives of the University. • Lead or assist in the investigation of significant suspected fraudulent activities and notify executive management and the Audit and Compliance Committee of the results • Maintain a professional audit staff with sufficient knowledge, skills, experience, training and professional certifications to meet the requirements of this charter. Periodically assess the overall effectiveness of department training program. • Keep the Audit and Compliance Committee and senior leaders informed of emerging trends and successful best practices in internal auditing. • Supervise any external advisors who are engaged to support internal audit activity. • Communicate periodically with the Chancellor and the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and the Audit and Compliance Committee on the internal audit activity's purpose, authority, responsibility, and performance relative to planned audit activities. Reporting will also include significant risk exposures and control issues, including fraud risks, governance issues, and other matters needed or requested by senior management and the board. The frequency and content of reporting are determined in discussion with the Chancellor, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and the Audit and Compliance Committee depend on the importance of the information to be communicated and the urgency of the related actions to be taken by senior management or the board.
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b External Audit Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0900FN02	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – External Audit Policy
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 30, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Audit and Compliance Committee	Date of Next Revision:	December 31, 2026

1. Introduction / background:

In compliance with the directives issued by the University's Board of Trustees, it is mandated that the University's financial accounts and records undergo an annual audit. This audit shall be executed by an independent public accounting firm, which will be selected and recommended by the Audit and Compliance Committee.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to adhere to the directives set forth by the AUS Board of Trustees, ensuring the maintenance and presentation of sound financial records to the Board. This policy also ensures compliance with governance standards and promotes the integrity of the University's financial reporting.

3. Policy Statement:

a. Frequency of Audit

The University's financial accounts and records are to be audited annually by an independent public accounting firm appointed by the Board of Trustees.

b. Duration and Rotation of External Auditor

The external audit firm appointed by the Board of Trustees is engaged for a maximum duration of six years, split across two consecutive three-year terms. After the initial three-year term, a mandatory rotation of the lead audit partner is required. However, AUS maintains the authority to terminate the contract at any point if deemed necessary.

c. Audit Scope and Approach

The audit is to be conducted in accordance with International Standards on Auditing (ISA) and the financial statements must be prepared in accordance with the International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS).

d. Audit Fees.

The initial audit fee agreed upon, as well as any subsequent modifications during the tenure of the External Auditor, must receive approval from the Audit and Compliance Committee.

4. Responsibilities

Auditor Selection

The Audit and Compliance Committee will recommend to the Board of Trustees to appoint an external audit firm. The selection process will involve a formal request for proposal (RFP) process, ensuring a competitive and transparent selection.

a. Review and Approval of the Audit Report

The ACC shall review the annual audit report made by the external auditors at the end of each fiscal year and report to the Board of Trustees prior to their consideration and approval of the audited Financial Statements.

5. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

International Standards on Auditing are professional standards for the auditing of financial information. These standards are issued by the International Federation of Accountants (IFAC) through the International Auditing and Assurance Standards Board (IAASB)

6. Policy Review and Updates:

This policy will be reviewed once every 3 years to ensure alignment with best practices and changes in international auditing standards and any amendments to the policy must be approved by the Board of Trustees.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Standing Committees Policy

8. Scope/applicability:

Finance department

End Users / Imprest custodians and approvers

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 30, 1998	Initial issuance of the policy	N/A
2.0	December 31, 2018	Changes to v1.0	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	December 8, 2023	Changes to v2.0	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
4.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

c. Budgeting Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	0900FN03	Policy Title:	Budgeting Policy
Prepared By:	Budget and Planning Office	Issue Date:	31 December, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	May 31, 2027

1. Introduction/background:

This Budget Policy Manual is designed to establish a comprehensive framework for the financial planning, allocation, management, approval, and oversight of resources at the American University of Sharjah (AUS).

2. Purpose:

It aims to ensure that the AUS's financial resources are utilized efficiently and effectively, supporting its mission to provide high-quality education and foster research, innovation, and community engagement. By adhering to the policies outlined in this manual, AUS seeks to maintain fiscal responsibility, transparency, and strategic alignment of its budgeting practices with its institutional goals and objectives.

3. Policy and Procedure:

Budget Planning And Preparation

Overview of the budget planning process

The budget planning process involves several key steps, including forecasting revenue and student numbers, determining expenditures, and submitting budget proposals. Departments across AUS are required to engage in this process annually to prepare for the upcoming fiscal year, ensuring that all financial planning aligns with AUS's objectives and financial policies.

Timelines for Budget Preparation

The timeline for budget preparation will be communicated by the Budget and Planning Office at the beginning of each budget cycle. Departments must adhere to these deadlines to ensure a smooth and efficient budget review and approval process.

Guidelines for Revenue Forecasting

Departments should work with Budget and Planning Office to project revenues based on historical data, enrollment trends, programs offered and any other relevant factors. Accurate revenue forecasting is crucial for informed budgeting decisions.

Expense Budgeting Guidelines

a) Principles of Expense Budgeting

- Budget allocations at AUS must align with the university's strategic goals and priorities, prioritizing expenditures that contribute directly to academic excellence, student success, research initiatives, and operational efficiency.
- All budgeted expenses must comply with applicable laws, regulations, AUS policies, and relevant Bylaws.
- Expenses should be categorized clearly into salaries & benefits, operating expenditures, and capital expenditures. Each category must adhere to predefined criteria based on university guidelines to ensure consistency and transparency across departments.

b) Budget Preparation and Justification

- Budget preparation begins with the determination of department level base budgets by BPO as agreed with the Senior Management.
 - Based on the base budgets shared, departments are required to prepare detailed budget proposals for each category of expenses, providing thorough justifications for the additionally requested amounts considering their anticipated needs.
 - Department heads / Individual budget owners are encouraged to discuss any budget related concerns with the Budget and Planning Office during the budget preparation stage.
 - Apart from annual budgets prepared in coordination with individual departments, Finance Department must also prepare a 5-year financial plan which will be presented only to the Senior Management and the Board of Trustees to provide an overview of the predicted financial position based on the strategic objectives and other financial initiatives of AUS.
- c) Cost-Efficiency and Savings:
- Departments should identify cost-saving measures and efficiencies as part of their budget preparation process, including exploring options for shared resources, bulk purchasing, and reducing unnecessary or duplicative expenses.
 - Innovative approaches to achieving more with less are encouraged and should be highlighted in budget proposals.
- d) Sustainability Considerations:
- Budget planning should incorporate sustainability considerations, prioritizing expenditures that promote environmental stewardship, energy efficiency, and resource conservation wherever possible.

Capital Budgeting Guidelines

- a) Principles of Capital Budgeting
- Ensure that all capital budget proposals are closely aligned with the university's strategic goals and priorities. Projects should support the mission and long-term vision of AUS.
 - Conduct thorough assessments to identify and prioritize the most critical needs across the university. Focus on projects that address essential infrastructure, technology, and facilities requirements.
 - Evaluate the potential benefits of each capital project against its costs. Consider factors such as return on investment, efficiency gains, and long-term value to the university.
 - Ensure that the proposed capital projects are financially viable. Verify the availability of funding sources and ensure that projects do not jeopardize the university's financial stability.
 - Maintain transparency throughout the capital budgeting process. Ensure clear documentation, open communication, and accountability for decision-making and resource allocation.
- b) Budget Preparation and Justification
- The Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration must initiate the capital budget preparation process by engaging with key stakeholders, including department heads, deans, and relevant administrative units. Stakeholders are required to submit detailed capital budget proposals for the upcoming year, outlining the scope, estimated costs, and anticipated benefits of each project.
 - Upon receipt of the proposals, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration, in collaboration with the relevant stakeholders, must evaluate each one based on predefined

criteria, considering alignment with AUS's strategic plans, project necessity and urgency, impact on academic and operational excellence, and availability of funding.

- Proposals must be then prioritized or revised to ensure the most critical and strategically significant projects are prioritized, often involving multiple rounds of review and feedback.
- For each prioritized project, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration in Coordination with Finance must identify internal funding sources, evaluating available funds, potential reallocations, and other financial resources. A comprehensive funding plan must be prepared detailing how these sources will cover project costs. This plan, along with the prioritized project list, must be presented to the Chancellor to present it to the FAC and the BoT for approval.

Instructions for Budget Submission

Budget submissions must be completed using the Budget Templates provided by the Budget and Planning Office. These templates facilitate the uniform preparation of budget requests, ensuring all necessary details are captured accurately.

Budget Review and Approval

The Budget Review and Approval process at the American University of Sharjah (AUS) ensures that all departmental budgets are thoroughly evaluated and aligned with institutional goals. This involves an initial review by senior leadership, feedback and adjustments by the Budget and Planning Office, and final approval by the Board of Trustees, ensuring compliance with budget guidelines and strategic priorities.

- **Initial Review:** Upon submission, the Finance Director, and Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration first review overall departmental budgets. Subsequently the initial budgets are discussed with Provost, Chancellor, and Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration for their respective areas. Each budget proposal is discussed against the base budget and additional budget requirements are ensured that it is in compliance with budget guidelines as well as they are related to the demonstrated needs.
- **Feedback and Adjustments:** The Budget and Planning Office provides feedback to departments after the initial review if any additional information or further justification is required on proposed expenditures, suggestions for reallocating funds within the department, or recommendations for aligning the budget more closely with their demonstrated needs.
- **Resubmission:** Departments may need to revise and resubmit their budgets incorporating the Budget Office's additional requirements (if any). This iterative process ensures that all concerns are addressed, and budgets are optimized for the university's needs. Any revised budgets must be approved by the Chancellor, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration, or the provost for their respective areas.
- **Submission to Board of Trustees:** After the final review and endorsement, the consolidated AUS budget must be submitted to the Board of Trustees (BoT) for approval. This submission includes a comprehensive budget narrative that outlines key investments, expected outcomes, and strategic alignments.
- **BoT Review:** The BoT must review the proposed budget, considering its alignment with the university's long-term vision, fiscal sustainability, and strategic priorities.
- **Approval:** All budgets shall be approved by the President pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board (FAC).

Communication of Approved Budget and System Upload

- Following approval by the Board of Trustees, Budget and Planning Office will upload the fiscal year budget to the ERP as per policy below. Subsequently, Budget and Planning Office will communicate the specific budget allocations for each department to respective budget owners and their department heads after the successful upload.

- **Preparation for Upload:** After final approval of the budget by the BoT, Budget and Planning Office will prepare the approved budget data for upload into the ERP System. This involves verifying the accuracy of all financial figures and ensuring they are formatted correctly for system compatibility and communication to the respective departments.
- **System Upload:**
 - **Data Integrity Checks:** Before uploading, Budget and Planning Office must conduct a thorough data integrity checks to prevent errors. This includes verifying account codes, cost centers, cost center wise allocations, and ensuring that the total budget aligns with the approved figures.
 - **Upload Process:** The approved budget must be uploaded into the ERP system using a standardized process that ensures data is accurately reflected across all relevant modules (e.g., general ledger, procurement, payroll). This process must be automated in the ERP system itself, to reduce the risk of manual errors.
 - **Confirmation and Backup:** Upon upload, Budget and Planning Office must review system uploaded budget to ensure accuracy. Budget and Planning Office must maintain a backup of the approved budget data for record-keeping and audit purposes.
- **Access and Permissions:**
 - Access to upload or to modify the uploaded budget within the ERP system is restricted to authorized personnel in Budget and Planning Office.
 - Department heads and budget managers must be granted view-only access to their respective budget allocations in the ERP system, enabling them to monitor their budgets and plan expenditures in alignment with the available budget amounts.

Budget Amendments and Adjustments

Criteria for Budget Amendments

- **Justifiable Need:** Amendments to the budget must be based on a clear and justifiable need that arises after the initial budget approval. This could include unforeseen expenses, changes in strategic priorities, or opportunities that align with the university's goals.
- **Strategic Alignment:** Any proposed amendment must support AUS's strategic objectives and not compromise the integrity or objectives of the original budget.
- **Fiscal Responsibility:** Amendments should demonstrate fiscal responsibility, ensuring that the overall budget remains balanced and sustainable. Requests must include a plan for sourcing additional funds or reallocating existing resources without negatively impacting essential services or objectives.
- **Compliance:** All amendments must comply with AUS policies, as well as relevant legal and regulatory requirements

Amendments of Budgets at an Overall University Level

The Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration shall support the Chancellor in presenting the proposed revisions to the Financial Affairs Committee of the BOT for their consideration.

- **Submission to Board of Trustees:** After the final review and endorsement, the consolidated AUS budget must be submitted to the Board of Trustees (BoT) for approval.
- **Approval of Budgets by Board of Trustees:** BOT approval must be obtained according to the approval process followed for the approval of annual budgets, discussed earlier in this document.
- **Upload and Notification:** Upon BoT approval, the budgets must be updated in the ERP system and all relevant stakeholders should be notified according to the "Communication of Approved Budget and System Upload policy" discussed earlier in this document.

Amendments Scenarios within a Department or a College

• **Transfers across Different Budget Categories**

Budget reallocations or transfers from one budget category to another are not permissible. To clarify, savings in Salaries and Benefits lines may not be used to cover budget overruns in either the Operating or Capital Expenditures budgets and vice versa.

• **Transfers within Operating Budget**

Transfers across categories within the Operating Budget section should not exceed 10% of the original allocated budget. Transfers within the same category are permitted without restrictions, subject to approval by the Department Head.

• **Capital Expenditure Transfers**

Budget reallocations or transfers from Capital Expenses to Operating Expenses (and vice versa) are not permissible.

Certain requests for capital expenditure transfers shall be approved on an exceptional basis, subject to DOAM approval.

• **Inter-Fund Transfers:**

Inter-fund transfers either between different cost centers or within the same cost center is not permissible.

However, in the event of a shortage of funds, Departments are allowed to incur such expenses from another fund account where budgets are available, with proper approval from the Department Head. Such expenses must subsequently be transferred to the correct fund account as and when identified within the same fiscal year by the GL team upon confirmation with the Budget and Planning Office.

Carry forward of Unutilized Budgets at Fiscal Year End

• **Operating Budgets:** Unused operating budgets are not permitted to be carried over to the next fiscal year. All departments must plan their expenditures accordingly.

• **Special Funds and Capital Projects Budgets:** Unutilized budget amounts in special funds are allowed to be carried forward to the next fiscal year, subject to the following conditions;

- Carried forward amounts are uploaded only into one expenditure line
- Accordingly, any transaction incurred under different expenditure lines within these budgets carried forward must be covered by the overall fund level.

Requesting and Approval of Additional Budgets

- Departments seeking additional budgets must submit a formal request to the Budget and Planning Office via budget@aus.edu, including a detailed explanation, the amount requested, and supporting documentation such as quotations, forecasts, or strategic plans.
- The request must be reviewed and approved by the department head before submission to the Budget and Planning Office to ensure alignment with departmental priorities.
- The Budget and Planning Office conducts a preliminary assessment and forwards the request the Finance Controller for a detailed review. Final approval must be granted by a designated authority per the AUS DOAM.
- The Chancellor can incur an over-expenditure of up to 10% of the budgeted amount for any specific line of an approved operating budget without further BOT approval, except in emergencies or critical needs (refer to AUS DOAM for details).
- The requesting department must be notified of the decision by the Budget and Planning Office, including any conditions attached to the approval, if any.

- All approved budget amendments must be documented, detailing the nature, justification, approval process, and conditions. The Budget and Planning Office must maintain a central record of all amendments for transparency and accountability.
- Approved amendments should be reflected in the ERP system for accurate tracking and reporting, with modification access restricted to authorized personnel.
- Significant amendments must be communicated to relevant stakeholders, including department heads, finance staff, and the AUS community, to ensure awareness and alignment.

4. Roles and Responsibilities

- **Department Heads:** Responsible for preparing and submitting their budget requests, following the guidelines provided.
- **Budget and Planning Office (BPO):** Provides templates, guidance, and support throughout the budget preparation process and reviews submitted budgets for compliance.
- **Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration (VCFA)** is responsible for the development of the operating budget, in consultation with the Chancellor and other Senior Management.
- **Chancellor** with the support of VCFA is responsible for presenting the annual operating budget, and any revisions thereto, to the Financial Affairs Committee of the BOT for their consideration. The Chancellor will have the authority to approve operating expenditures that fall within the approved operating budget. The Chancellor must also ensure that total operating expenses do not exceed actual revenues unless prior approval from the BOT is granted.
- **Financial Affairs Committee (FAC) of the BoT** is responsible to review the proposed budget considering the University's objectives, financial resources, available funds, and prospective income, and recommend a final draft of the budget for BOT consideration and approval.
- **Board of Trustees (BoT)** must consider, amend as necessary, and approve the University's operating budget for any given year at the appropriate BOT meeting.

5. Scope and Applicability

The policies and procedures detailed in this manual apply to all departments, units, and members of the AUS community, including faculty, staff, and administrators involved in budget planning, execution, and monitoring activities.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms

The following definitions and Abbreviations apply when used in this policy:

Budget	An itemized summary of expected income and expenses for a specified period, reflecting AUS's financial plans and priorities.
Capital Expenses	Expenses incurred to acquire or improve fixed assets, such as buildings and equipment, which have a useful life extending beyond the fiscal year.
Financial Year	The 12-month period used for budgeting and financial reporting purposes at AUS, running from September 1 to August 31.
Operational Expenses	Day-to-day expenses necessary for the university to function, including salaries, utilities, and supplies.
Variance	The difference between budgeted and actual financial figures, indicating overspending or underspending in specific categories

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- DOAM

8. Policy Review and Updates

- The Budget Policy shall be reviewed every three years to ensure it aligns with the latest financial reporting standards, alignment with the evolving needs of the university, etc.
- In addition to the scheduled reviews, ad-hoc reviews may be conducted in response to significant changes in the budgeting process at AUS, to incorporate any recommendations of external auditors / Auditors from Sharjah Financial Control Department, or changes in university operations.
- Any amendments to the policy must be approved by the Chancellor.

9. Policy History:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 31, 2021	New Policy issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2023	Revised to incorporate changes to the policy and procedures	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	May 27, 2024	Revised to incorporate changes to the policy and procedures	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
4.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Budget and Planning Office	+971 6 515 4153	Email: budget@aus.edu

d. Financial Policy

This policy covers a number of different financial policies:

1. Financial Planning at Program and Course Level - Version 2
2. Financial Policy - General Insurance – Version 3
3. Financial Policy - Petty Cash – Version 2
4. Financial Policy - Business Meals and Entertainment – Version 3
5. Financial Policy - Business Travel – Version 2
6. Financial Policy - Managing Grant Fund – Version 3
7. Financial Policy - Financial Reporting – Version 3
8. Financial Policy - Bank Reconciliation – Version 3
9. Financial Policy - Accounting Structure – Version 2
10. Financial Policy - Accounts Receivable – Version 2

1. Financial Planning at Program and Course Level - Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FA04	Policy Title:	Financial Planning at Program and Course Level
Prepared By:	Budget & Planning	Issue Date:	November 10, 2020
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Vice Chancellor for Finance & Administration	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Policy: Financial Planning at Program and Course Level

2. Purpose

This policy governs financial planning at program and course level for undergraduate and graduate courses, both on campus and in hybrid form. This also governs any courses that are temporary offered on-line during the COVID-19 pandemic.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement

The mission of the institute integrates liberal arts and professional programs, and is grounded in the context of UAE culture, aiming to prepare engaged and effective members of society who display mastery in their areas of specialization, communicate clearly, think critically and solve problems creatively. In order to meet this mission a wide variety of courses are on offer to all students, regardless of major. Tuition fees per credit hour are the intentionally the same across all programs and courses and are reviewed by the Board of Trustees annually. Expenditure per program and course will vary. The cost drivers for expenditures are enrolment, faculty salaries, and other overheads. Program and course enrolments are reviewed regularly by school/colleges, faculty salaries are set by the Office of the Provost and are approved by the Chancellor. The total costs of Faculty salaries, as well as other overheads, like hardware, software, infrastructure, utilities and support staff are forecasted and reviewed annually as part of the budgeting process of the university by the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and are approved by the Board of Trustees. This applies to programs and courses that are on campus, taught in hybrid, or exclusively online.

5. Scope/applicability

This Policy applies to all academic units of the university.

6. Responsibilities

The Dean regularly forecasts and reviews enrolment per course and program and ensures efficiency and effectiveness. The Provost recommends Faculty recruitment and salary levels, which are approved by the Chancellor. The Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration forecasts and reviews all the total costs of faculty salaries, as well as other overheads annually as part of the budgeting process. The forecasted budget is then approved by the Board of Trustees.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Overhead refers to the ongoing costs to operate a business but excludes the direct costs associated with creating a product or service.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Budgeting Policy

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	November 10, 2020	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Tel: +971 6 515 2344	ocoo@aus.edu

2. Financial Policy – General Insurance - Version 3

Policy Number:	0900FN05	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – General Insurance
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 30, 2016
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date Of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/background:

The American University of Sharjah recognizes the importance of maintaining a comprehensive program of general insurance to address a variety of exposures. The Finance Office is responsible for evaluating loss exposures and arranging appropriate insurance coverage to protect the University's financial assets.

2. Purpose:

The General insurance provides protection against unforeseeable contingencies and exposures like (but not limited to) damage and loss of the assets.

3. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah maintains a comprehensive program of general insurance to address a variety of exposures. The Finance Office is responsible for evaluating loss exposures and arranging appropriate insurance coverage to protect the University's financial assets.

Insurance is purchased to protect against losses that could have a catastrophic impact on the University's operations and financial condition.

Insurance Policies

The University has in place a comprehensive third party insurance scheme that includes the following general insurance policies:

A. Property All Risks:

This policy includes insurance for AUS buildings, infrastructure, furniture and fittings, machinery and equipment, laboratory equipment, library books, inventory and paintings. The policy covers property insured that is accidentally or physically lost, destroyed or damaged through any cause other than those specifically excluded.

The updated values of these assets are provided annually to the insurance provider.

The policy also includes a business continuity cover that will cover the University for the loss of revenues or the additional operating costs suffered by the university in case of business interruption.

B. Money:

This policy provides insurance for cash in transit, cash in locked vehicles and cash in cabinets / drawers (outside working hours) during non-registration weeks. During registration and

drop/add weeks, cash is collected at the end of every day by a security firm and deposited immediately into the bank. This is to avoid keeping large amounts of cash in the Cashier's safe overnight.

C. Fidelity Guarantee:

This policy covers Senior Management staff, all Finance department staff, all Procurement department staff and all Public Relations Officers. The Policy covers the loss that may be sustained by AUS for reason of any act of forgery and/or fraud and/or dishonesty of monies and/or goods on the part of any insured employee.

D. Workmen's Compensation:

Workers' compensation is a form of insurance providing wage replacement benefits to employees injured in the course of employment. The total estimated wages for AUS staff will be provided to the insurance provider on an annual basis.

E. Third Party Liability:

Third-party liability refers to the type of insurance that protects the insured from legal liability claims presented by third parties. As per the Third Party Liability/Public Liability insurance, the insurance company will indemnify AUS against all sums which AUS may become legally liable to pay for compensation in respect of:

1. Death, bodily injury or illness of any person;
2. Loss or damage to property arising during the course of business.
3. In addition, all costs and expenses of litigation by any claimant against AUS will be covered.

F. Travel Assistance:

The Travel assistance policy provides insurance for personal accident, personal baggage, delayed baggage, personal money and documents, cancellation and curtailment and personal liability. The policy applies to employees on Business Travel.

At the start of each academic year the Director of Finance shall send a copy of the updated policy to all Head of Departments and Directors.

G. Electronic equipment:

This policy includes insurance for various electronic equipment and external data media. This applies primarily to IT equipment, such as communication equipment, Electronic Data Processing (EDP) equipment, etc.

The policy and renewal terms shall also be reviewed by the Director of Information Technology.

H. Directors and Officers Liability:

This policy provides protection for University Directors and Officers against claims and lawsuits, including civil costs, defense costs, etc. Directors and officers liability Insurance is a liability insurance payable to the directors and officers of a company, or to the organization itself, as indemnification for losses or advancement of defense costs in the event an insured suffers such a loss as a result of a legal action brought for alleged wrongful acts in their capacity as directors and officers.

I. Medical Malpractice Liability:

Medical malpractice insurance is available to the University practitioners and nurses so that they will be protected in the event of a judgment against them for medical malfeasance.

The policy and renewal terms shall also be reviewed by the Director of the University Health Services.

J. Motor insurance:

Vehicles owned by American University of Sharjah are fully covered in this program. These vehicles include mini-buses, cars and pick-up vehicles. Its primary use is to provide financial protection against physical damage and/or bodily injury resulting from traffic collisions and against liability that could also arise therefrom.

Filing Insurance Claims

All insurance claims should be communicated to the Director of Finance as soon as possible following an incident. All claims will be filed with the insurance company by the Director of Finance.

Insurance Policies Renewal

All insurance policies are subject to renewal every three years. The financial limits identified in each policy should also be reviewed and modified, if needed, at each renewal. The renewal exercise and the review of the financial limits should be done in consultation with the insurance consultant retained by the University.

The renewal terms should be approved by the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration.

4. Scope/applicability:

Applicable for all items covered in the policy statement.

5. Responsibilities

The Finance Office serves as the University's primary liaison with brokers and underwriters to ensure that appropriate insurance coverages are obtained and renewed when required. The Finance Office also serves as an insurance resource for the campus community and provides advice on insurance matters and the management and resolution of insurance claims.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

This section is under review with Deloitte

- Insurance policy: the insurance policy is a contract defining the terms and conditions of the insurance between the insurer and the AUS, and determines the claims which the insurer is legally required to pay.
- Insurance claim: is a formal request to the insurance provider for reimbursement against losses covered under the insurance policy

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- DOAM
- Financial Policies
- Human Resources Policies

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 30, 2016	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 31, 2018	Amended to incorporate relevant updates	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department	Tel: +971 6 5152234	finance@aus.edu

3. Financial Policy – Petty Cash - Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FN06	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Petty Cash (Imprest)
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	December 31, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/background:

Petty Cash is usually the mechanism of last resort to access cash for payments, when other disbursement methods are impractical or cannot be used.

2. Purpose:

Petty cash funds provide a convenient way to pay for small expenses but keeping cash in any office entails risk of misuse or theft. This policy provides procedures designed to mitigate these risks. Understand appropriate uses of petty cash.

3. Policy Statement:

A Department or School can obtain a petty cash fund for a maximum of DH 1,000 from the Finance Department on the request of the Dean or Director. The request of the dean or director needs to include the following:

The petty cash fund can only be used to meet small financial needs of the department and/or school. It can only be used for one off purchase that are of individual value below AED 200.00, are not available in AUS stores and are few in quantity (not to exceed 2 per item).

The petty cash fund cannot be used to pay for;

1. Gifts/ Flowers
2. Awards
3. Meals (Lunches & Dinners)
4. Employee Allowances
5. Employee Overtime
6. Any remuneration for work done by individuals or students
7. Items that are of an asset nature

4. Procedure for Implementing Policy

Imprest Fund: Issuance and Replenishment

i. Introduction

Imprest Funds are used by various departments of the University whose activities require that some small-amount, cash payments be made. The following summarizes the University policies and outlines the procedures for petty cash issuance and replenishment.

ii. Imprest Fund Issuance Procedures

- Imprest fund requests are initiated by the Head of the requesting Department. Requests are approved by the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration.
- The fund is established by the issuance of an official University check, drawn for the amount of the approved fund, to the employee designated as the fund custodian.
- The initial check issued will be accompanied by the Petty Cash Policy (Section 4-1)
- An imprest fund account is established in the G/L and the account is debited for the fund amount.
- Any request to increase the imprest fund, whether temporarily or otherwise, will follow procedures A & B above.

iii. Imprest Fund Replenishment

- Imprest fund custodian will maintain a pre-numbered petty cash voucher (“PCV”) book for reimbursements of approved expenditures. Custodians will reimburse only invoices/ receipts approved by the Head of the concerned department. Receiver’s signature is obtained on the PCV and original invoice/receipt is attached to the PCV.
- PCV details include description of the expense, expense account to be debited, cost center and amount.
- At the time the fund is due for replenishment, the imprest fund custodian summarizes the PCV’s in a standard excel spreadsheet, showing the opening balance of the fund, reimbursed amounts supported by PCV’s, any received amounts (i.e. replenishments received), and the fund balance. The summary will also show the line item details (cost center, debit account etc.)
- PCV summary is signed by the custodian as preparer and approved by the Head of the department.
- The PCV summary received by the A/P Accountant is checked and agreed to supporting PCV’s for amount and authorization. Debit accounts and cost centers are reviewed by the Accountant for accuracy.
- The accountant enters a Direct Pay Invoice in the name of the petty cash custodian detailing the petty cash disbursement.
- This invoice is reported as part of the FARINVS (Invoices ready for payment list). This list is reviewed by the Finance Manager before the check-processing step.
- A check is then prepared for the replenishment amount during the regular check processing run.

iv. Accounting Control

The Finance Department will maintain a current listing of the individual outstanding imprest funds by department by custodian. This listing will constitute the basis for the Internal Auditor’s annual and semi-annual verification counts.

v. Transfer of Responsibility

In cases where a fund custodian leaves for vacation, his/her employment is to be terminated, or he/she is assigned new duties not requiring an imprest fund, the Head of the Department will send a memo to the Finance Department informing them on the new fund custodian, with an indication to the reason for the change.

A Petty Cash Handover of responsibilities to the new custodian shall then take place before the previous custodian’s leave or departure. Finance shall send an accountant to witness the petty cash (actual cash) handover. A Petty Cash Handover Form is filled and signed by both

the prior and the present custodian. The handover form is then submitted to Finance for the record.

Custodian-Rights & Liabilities

The custodian of the petty cash has certain obligations towards the University and some inherent rights attached in carrying out the duties.

5. Duties:

The custodian should:

- Only honor all bills that are duly approved / and authorized by the Departmental head whose cost center is being charged,
- Check the arithmetical accuracy of the bill,
- Put the correct account code for the expense in accordance with the budget
- Keep record of money disbursed & replenished
- Request replenishment well in advance: at most when cash depletes to approximately 30% of the Imprest held.
- Show the books of account maintained to the internal auditor, Comptroller or to any authorized person(s) as the Comptroller may deem fit.
- To duly hand over the fund to the successor in case the present custodian goes on vacation or is being terminated or has resigned. [Handing over means, tallying the physical cash balance with properly maintained book balance duly signed by the internal auditor approved by the departmental head countersigned by the successor].
- Under no circumstances can an individual use their own funds to purchase petty cash items. Reconcile the petty cash in custody weekly, and report any shortages or Overages to the controller in the form of a shortage/overage statement at the end of the replenishment report. If Overages/ Shortages is less than AED5 this would be sufficient action. If the shortage/overage is greater than AED5, a detailed report of the reason for the variance needs to be submitted by the custodian to the Controller after discussing the report with the department head and obtaining the department head's endorsement of the report. The report will be verified by the office of the controller.

6. Rights:

The custodian of the Imprest fund has the right to

- Reject payment of bill that is not duly approved for payment.
- To check the accuracy and authenticity of the bill presented for payment and also of the document that is being handed over by the predecessor.
- To ask for bills for which money has already been advanced
- Reserves the right to decide on the priority when there is a temporary crunch of money - Pending authorization by the departmental head

Petty Cash Replenishment Report

The Petty cash vouchers, the Bills, the summary replenishment report are the documents that form the petty cash replenishment report.

Confirmation that the reported cash on hand is accurate and has been reconciled and no overage/shortage exists. If overage/shortage of cash on hand exists, the appropriate statement/report should be attached as detailed in section 1.8 of the Custodian – Rights & Duties section of this policy.

The Petty Cash Voucher (PCV)

The PCV is the official and main document in disbursing petty cash. This is serially numbered, it requires the recipient's signature, the amount disbursed, a brief description of disbursement, date and approval apart from requiring details about cost center and account code. A petty cash voucher has to be filled out for every disbursement.

Original Bills (Invoices)

Bills are proof of expense. It is on this bill that an expense is recognized. There is generally no replenishment of expenses without original bills. Copies and duplicates are not accepted.

Summary Replenishment Report

It is a standard format as to how replenishment has to be requested. It contains the following details:

1. Imprest Fund (Department or School).
2. Summary of Petty Cash Disbursement.
3. Top-up amount.
4. Signature of person who prepared it and approval of authorized person i.e. Dean or the Director.

Reporting

Petty cash can be replenished at any level, if the following is followed.

The custodian reports the cash balance to Finance Dept. in the prescribed format. While reporting care should be taken regarding the following:

1. All bills that are to be reimbursed should have a PCV.
2. The departmental head should duly approve the summary report.
3. The PCV should bear the receivers signature (proof of money being disbursed)
4. The date of payment should be noted on the PCV.

The summary report should include the Cost Center and Account code per expense. While putting the account code care should be taken on whether the expense is budgeted for. If not, the custodian should inform the supervisor/departmental head of it and make sure that an account code is provided. On receipt of the completed, approved and fully supported summary report, finance department will issue a check in the amount expensed by the custodian within 4 working days

Transfer of Responsibilities

In cases where a fund custodian leaves for vacation, is assigned new duties, or leaves employment the Dean/Director should send a memo to the Finance Department for the transfer of funds to a new custodian.

A Petty Cash Handover of responsibilities to the new custodian shall then take place before the previous custodian's leave or departure. Finance shall send an accountant to witness the petty cash (actual cash) handover. A Petty Cash Handover Form is filled and signed by both the prior and the present custodian. The handover form is then submitted to Finance for the record.

Points to be noted

Money will not be replenished on invoice copies.

1. If any PCV is cancelled, it has to be submitted and mentioned in the report.
2. A PCV should not be overwritten. If at all its overwritten, it must be approved by the departmental head by countersigning just besides the correction.
3. Only actual money paid out should be noted on a PCV. For example, if there is a bill for AED 10.80, the actual amount paid should be only AED 10.75 as there isn't any 5 fils in UAE. So only AED 10.75 (actual amount paid) should be reported.

Account Code, Cost Center, Date, Recipient's signature and departmental head's approval/ authorization are necessary in a report

7. Scope/applicability:

Finance department

End Users / Imprest custodians and approvers

8. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **Custodian:** The employee responsible of the petty cash fund.

9. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policies

Supply Chain

Research

DOAM

10. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 31, 2018	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

11. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

4. Financial Policy – Business Meals and Entertainment Version - 3

Policy Number:	0900FN07	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Business Meals and Entertainment
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	July 01, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/Background:

It is important that the University utilize its resources to further the mission of the institution and be a thoughtful steward of its funds. This policy provides guidelines and limitations regarding expenditures of resources for the business purpose of entertainment, hospitality, and recognition. Expenditures are expected to be both reasonable and appropriate to the circumstances.

While such expenses are necessary and may benefit the University, funds expended for these purposes are resources that will be unavailable for other important expenditures that could further the mission of the University. Thoughtful utilization of university resources is an obligation of all faculty and staff.

2. Purpose:

This policy provides guidelines and limitations regarding expenditures of resources for the business purpose of entertainment, hospitality, and recognition. Expenditures are expected to be both reasonable and appropriate to the circumstances.

This policy has been prepared to promote discretion in spending and expenses related to business meals, entertainment and other social events.

3. Policy Statement:

Expenditures for a reasonable number of business meals and entertainment events are necessary in the normal course of business operations of the University. In each case, the business meal or event must be appropriate to the situation and the nature of the business conducted. Prudent business judgment and moderation, coupled with disciplined budgetary control, dictate whom these functions serve, the frequency of events, and the reasonableness of related costs.

The total amount and relative percentage of a school and/or department budget which is appropriate to spend on business meals, entertainment and social events should be planned as part of the preparation of the annual departmental operating budget, taking into consideration the limits and conditions set forth in this policy. The Dean, Department Head and / or Director is responsible for authorizing and monitoring events and the associated level of expenditure within the context of the approved budget.

Business Meals

Meals at which faculty, staff or students, and external parties are present for the purpose of conducting substantial and bona fide University business are allowable to the extent set forth in this policy. The reimbursement request with required supporting documentation should be submitted within 30 working days of incurring the expense.

For a business meal to be reimbursed, a business purpose with a list of attendees and their business relationship to the University is required. For annual departmental events involving more than 10

people, the individual names are not necessary but the name of the department sponsoring the event and the business purpose are required.

The University expects the cost of business meals to be reasonable in line with the business purpose. Except in the presence of a Senior Officer (as defined), or when specifically designated by a Senior Officer to host, or when specifically granted a waiver by a Senior Officer, the all-inclusive, VAT included maximum amount reimbursable per person is shown in Table 1. Costs in excess of the maximum will not be reimbursed. When a Senior Officer hosts the meal, either personally or through an appointed delegate, his/her judgment regarding what is necessary and reasonable for the event shall be recognized.

The business meal may be incurred in conjunction with travel or may be unrelated to travel. In all cases an itemized receipt is required.

Tipping is reimbursed up to 15% if service charge is not included and 10% if service is already included on the receipt.

A. Business Meals Involving External Parties

The University allows payment for reasonable and necessary meal expenses incurred during a business meeting involving external parties if the purpose of the meeting is to discuss University business, and it is necessary or beneficial to the University to provide a meal while the meeting is being held.

B. Business Meals among University Personnel

As a general rule, AUS faculty and staff should not claim reimbursement for business meals solely between or among employees except in unusual circumstances as described below. In those cases, the frequency and amount of such expenses must be moderate and appropriate to the purpose of the discussion and the nature of the business conducted. Such meetings include:

- Breakfast and dinner meetings which are necessary to conduct University business that could not otherwise be resolved during the normal course of business. A statement of justification is required as part of the reimbursement request.
- Formally organized luncheon meetings which are necessary to carry out the business of official committees appointed by the University;
- Meetings of an organized work group of employees that require the work of the group to progress through a normal mealtime.

C. Employees Working Overtime

Business meals may be reimbursed when department requirements necessitate overtime work of three hours or more after normal business hours. AUS expects these cases to be rare and the amounts to be reasonable.

D. Required Authorizations

The appropriate approval authority as outlined in the Delegation of Authority manual (DOAM) must approve expenses for business meals.

Entertainment and Social Events

Certain events sponsored in connection with student, faculty or staff-oriented social activities, fund raising, employee recognition, annual department gatherings and other similar functions may be allowable as business expenses if approved in advance. The following conditions must be met to qualify for payment of expenses incurred in connection with business entertainment and social events from University funds:

- the event must be approved in advance in accordance with the limits set forth in the DOAM;
- if the event involves external parties, the person(s) entertained must have an actual or potential business relationship with the University; and
- the event will provide a benefit to the University.

As a general rule, AUS does not pay for expenses related to alcohol and / or tobacco (including Shisha). However, there are situations where a Senior Officer, or his/her designee, may entertain board members or guests (not including candidates) of the University for development or representation and it would be awkward or counterproductive to enforce this rule. In these situations, modest alcohol and / or tobacco expenses may be reimbursed. All alcohol or tobacco expenses shall be approved by the VCFA prior to reimbursement. The purpose of the entertainment and the names of those in attendance must be clearly stated on the reimbursement request.

Student, Faculty or Staff-Oriented Functions

The University hosts a variety of student-oriented functions that are designed to enhance campus life and a sense of community. Additionally, the University sponsors various faculty social functions to foster collegiality and recognition among AUS faculty and visiting scholars. The frequency and related costs of these events must be appropriate to the situation(s) and the nature of business conducted.

Schools and departments may conduct a staff social event to promote teamwork and community building among employees who work together to achieve common business goals and objectives. These types of events would generally consist of a dinner or other appropriate event that results in a reasonable cost for the entire group.

Alumni and Fund Raising Events

A Senior Manager with development responsibilities must authorize social events that are held to entertain alumni, or current or prospective donors.

Employee Recognition

An annual group luncheon or modest reception may be held by a department to recognize the retirement or departure of a long-standing employee who has provided excellent service.

Annual Department Gatherings

Annual department gatherings can be sponsored from University funds provided that the event is reasonably modest in nature and is limited to one event per year. Schools and Colleges should make every effort to consolidate these activities among their various departments so that the total cost of such events is held to a reasonable amount.

Birthdays, Secretary's Day and Other Similar Occasions

University funds cannot be used to sponsor a social event for individuals in recognition of Secretary's Day, birthdays, or other similar occasions. Additionally, the AUS Gift Policy precludes the use of University funds to provide gifts to individuals in recognition of these events.

Substantiating the Business Purpose

To qualify for reimbursement, employees must substantiate the business purpose of the expense in compliance with the provisions set forth in this policy. All business meals and entertainment expenses must be properly documented or they will be returned unpaid.

Proper documentation includes an itemized receipt, the reason for the meal and/or entertainment, the benefit expected to be derived as well as the name, title, and affiliation of all individuals in attendance.

Location of Entertainment and Other Social Events

AUS should generally conduct entertainment and other social events in Sharjah to the extent practicable. In some instances, these events may be conducted in Dubai or elsewhere, but in all such cases, it must be demonstrated that the purposes of the department and the objective of the event are best served by the decision. In the limited number of authorized cases in which business entertainment events take place in a personal residence, reimbursement from University funds shall generally be limited to catering costs.

Expenses related to membership/dues in private clubs are considered personal expenses and are not reimbursable under any circumstances.

When the University hosts events within the academic environment on campus, service charges are included in the catering contract, thus additional tipping is not reimbursable.

University sponsored events may be held within the private residence of a Senior Manager or his/her designee. In these instances, the meals are typically catered and service is provided by the restaurant or catering company. The all-inclusive, maximum amount reimbursable per attendee is shown in Table 1. For outstanding service, reasonable tips may be given directly to the service staff, according to the limits established in Table 1.

Inclusion of Spouses and others

Meals and/or entertainment provided to an employee's spouse, family member or other person accompanying a University employee will be permitted only when there is a substantial and bona-fide business reason for that person's attendance.

Limitations on Charging Instructions

As a general rule, AUS does not permit entertainment to be charged to a grant or contract unless the contract specifically indicates that entertainment is allowed.

Entertainment expenses should not be charged to restricted gift and endowment income accounts. Deans and department heads are responsible for ensuring that restricted funds are used in a manner consistent with the stated intentions of the donor.

Special Situations/Exceptions

The maximum amount(s) stipulated in this policy shall be reviewed periodically and adjusted as necessary. Exceptions to this policy require written approval by the Chancellor.

Table 1.

All-inclusive, VAT included, maximum amount reimbursable per person (attendee) for Business Meals.	AED 300 *
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For sponsored events catering provided in a private residence, reasonable tips may be given directly to the service staff

AUS Recommends
AED 50 per staff helper
(No more than AED 70)

*As a guideline, the expected average per person is AED 150, benchmarked against CENTRO buffet in Sharjah.

4. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all individuals expending funds for the purposes of entertainment, hospitality, and recognition on behalf of the University.

5. Responsibilities:

The Claimant

1. Obtain approval for Business Meals/Entertainment in advance.
2. Ensure claim is accurate and properly documented.
3. Represent only those expenses directly related to a bona-fide business purpose.
4. Avoid extravagances or the appearance thereof.
5. Accurately and ethically report reimbursable expenses.
6. Do not report expenses that you have claimed or will claim from any other source.
7. Do not claim reimbursement for expenses that were not your own.
8. Exercise fiscal prudence and good judgment.

The Approver

1. Assess the purpose of the business meal/entertainment to ensure that it is reasonable, necessary, and appropriate.
2. Verify that the expenses claimed are directly related to a bona fide business purpose.
3. Ensure that business meals and entertainment are budgeted within the appropriate budget and that funds are available for use.
4. Ensure that the expense is not excessive or extravagant.
5. Approve, reject, or return the request promptly.

The Finance Office

1. Check all submitted forms for appropriate approvals.
2. Check expenses against receipts.
3. Review claims for accuracy and compliance with this and other relevant AUS policies.
4. Reject expenses that are not properly approved and/or documented, or are not allowable under this policy.
5. Ensure that proper internal controls are in place to mitigate the risk of improper activity. To do this, Finance reserves the right to:
 - a. Request additional documentation as necessary.
 - b. Question or challenge expense claims that are:
 - Not clearly reasonable, necessary and appropriate.
 - Not directly related to a bona-fide business purpose.
 - Deemed excessive or extravagant.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

A. Appropriate

Costs are appropriate if they are suitable or fitting for a particular business purpose. In order for a cost to be appropriate it is also presumed that there is a valid business purpose, which is normally the responsibility of the Head of Department (HOD) or Director to determine.

B. Business Entertainment and/or Social Events

Events involving faculty, staff or students, and guests of the University in which a substantial purpose of the event is social in nature.

C. Business Meals

Meals at which faculty, staff, candidates, students and/or other external parties are present for the purpose of conducting substantial and bona-fide University business.

D. Necessary

An expense is necessary if there is a valid business purpose required to fulfill the mission of the University. The primary benefit of a necessary business expense is to the University, not the individual. A necessary expense is a minimum purchase or service required to achieve a valid business objective.

E. Reasonable

Reasonable means the amount that normally would be spent in a specific situation. An expense is considered reasonable if it is not extreme or excessive and reflects a prudent decision and action to incur the expense.

F. Senior Officers

Senior Officers include the Chancellor, Provost, and Chief Officers.

G. Senior Management

As defined in the Delegation of Authority Manual (DOAM), this includes the Chancellor, Provost, Chief Officers, Deans, Executive Directors and other Senior Managers as determined by the Board of Trustees (BOT). Members of this group may also be referred to as Senior Managers.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Financial Policies
- Supply Chain Policies

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	July 01, 2018	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 31, 2018	Revised to incorporate changes to the policy and procedures	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

5. Financial Policy – Business Travel – Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FN08	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Business Travel
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 15, 2016
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date Of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/Background:

All official travel expenses shall be properly authorized, reported, and reimbursed. The policy of the university is that all reasonable, necessary, and appropriate expenses incurred by employees on authorized official business will be reimbursed subject to the limitations and requirements specified in this document.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that the travel expense of the University is controlled by establishing certain standards. Employees must control business travel expense by making the sound judgment with respect to use of university funds.

3. Policy Statement:

Pre-Travel, including Authorization and Approval

A. Approved Travel Authorization

All official University travel shall be authorized in advance, in writing, by the traveler's immediate supervisor along with their department head and / or appropriate Senior Manager. This is called an Approved Travel Authorization. Authority to approve travel mirrors the authority to approve financial commitments as outlined in the DOAM.

No one may approve his/her own travel or the travel of a relative. If an employee is in a position to approve the travel of a relative, s/he must pass it on to the next higher approval authority.

Documentation may be required by the approver to support the estimated budget and/or the business purpose of the travel.

B. Preferred Travel Agency

American University of Sharjah strongly encourages all University faculty, staff, and students to use the University Travel Office. The Travel Agent in the University Travel Office was chosen from among the leaders in the travel industry through a competitive sourcing process. Using the University Travel Office provides the traveler with several benefits:

- i. 24 X 7, 365 days a year travel services
- ii. Centralized reservations and billing
- iii. Knowledge of the whereabouts of all AUS travelers
- iv. Departmental reporting
- v. Lowest rate tickets

- vi. Consolidated travel expenditures
- vii. Volume negotiated discounts

C. Travel Advances

Travel advances are authorized upon the traveler's request based on a pre-approval from the traveler's direct supervisor. Travel Advances require an Approved Travel Authorization (see section 3.A above). However, in order to minimize administrative burden on the University, travelers are permitted to use their own credit cards for business travel expenses in lieu of, or in addition to, Travel Advances.

Travel Advances are available in AED only. There is an on-campus banking facility to exchange AED for USD or other currencies as needed.

An employee may only have one travel advance outstanding at a time. Travel advances shall not be authorized for any person who has not cleared a prior travel advance, unless authorized by a Senior Officer. If the traveler is a Senior Officer, the authorization must come from the Chancellor.

D. Reporting Travel Expenses

Travel Expense Report

A Travel Expense Report shall be used to account for all travel advances and expenses incurred in connection with official University travel. When properly completed and approved, this form is used to reimburse the traveler for any amounts due. If the amount advanced is less than the total amount of approved expenses, the traveler will be paid the difference. If the advance exceeds the amount of reimbursable expenses, the traveler shall reimburse the University through payroll deduction.

The traveler must submit a Travel Expense Report to clear his/ her advance within one month of the completion of the trip even if s/he is not owed any additional reimbursement.

Cancelled or Postponed Trips

The traveler must inform Finance immediately if a trip is cancelled after an advance has been paid. The advance can be repaid either by salary deduction or by payment to the cashiers.

Action to Recover Travel advances

If needed, travel advances may be requested by travelers. When returning from travel, those advances must be cleared by the traveler through the submission of an expense report within one month from the date of return. If the amount of the advance exceeds the amount of the business travel expense claimed, then the excess of the advance over the claim must be repaid to AUS within one month after submitting the expense report (two months after returning from travel).

Excess advances will be recovered by salary deduction over a period not to exceed two pay months. The Finance Department shall advise the traveler of such deductions, but specific authorization from the traveler is not required to initiate a payroll deduction.

If a travel advance has not been cleared after 60 days of the completion of the trip, the University is entitled to recoup the full amount of the advance through payroll deduction.

E. Documentation Required

Itinerary

An individual submitting a Travel Expense Report for the reimbursement of travel expenses must indicate the inclusive dates of each trip including the times of departure from and return to the traveler's residence.

A traveler may combine vacation time with business travel so long as annual leave days are properly reported and approved in advance. Any personal days shall be so indicated on the Travel Expense Report. The traveler may not claim any expenses for personal days.

The traveler's point of origin and destination(s) shall be shown on the Travel Expense Report along with the purpose of the trip and all other information required. The Report should also show the Cost Center and Account to be charged for the travel expenses. All expenditures for a trip should be reported on one Travel Expense Report.

Receipts

The following receipts must be submitted with the Travel Expense Report:

- i. Receipts for amount paid to the airline and/or travel agency that clearly state the travel destination(s) and date(s)
- ii. Receipts for each miscellaneous expense of USD 10 (AED 37) or more detailing the items purchased or services provided
- iii. Receipts for all lodging expenses showing itemized charges
- iv. Receipts and explanations for any unusual and/or extraordinary items
- v. If per diem is not claimed, meal receipts must be itemized and include all of the following information:
 - vi. The name and location of the restaurant
 - vii. The number of people served, along with their names and relationship to AUS
 - viii. The date and amount of expense
- ix. Valid business purpose

When receipts are required but cannot be obtained or have been lost, a statement describing the reason for the unavailability or loss shall be included as part of the documentation submitted with the Travel Expense Report and must be signed by the supervisor. In the absence of a satisfactory explanation, the amount in question shall not be reimbursed. Repeated loss of receipts may result in loss of reimbursement privileges.

Conference Program

If business travel is to attend a conference, the conference program, proof of conference registration and web link shall be attached to the Business Travel Expense Report.

Certification

Each traveler who submits a claim for Business Travel Expenses certifies, through the submission of the signed claim, that the amounts claimed are a true statement of the expenses incurred on official University business and that the expenses claimed have not or will not be paid by any other source at any other time. Submitting duplicate claims is considered fraudulent activity and will be dealt with according to the Human Resources Code of Business Ethics.

F. Reimbursable Expenses

i. Air Transportation

Air transportation tickets should be procured well in advance in order to obtain the best rates. The class of air travel (Business or Economy) shall be in accordance with the

traveler's contractual entitlement. Only the Chancellor may approve a class of travel that exceeds the traveler's eligibility, and adequate justification must be provided in all cases.

Traveling employees may retain frequent flyer program benefits. However, participation in these programs must not influence flight selection if it will result in incremental cost to the University.

Travelers are strongly encouraged to purchase flight tickets through the University travel agent. When doing so the ticket will be paid for directly by AUS. The traveler must ensure that the ticket cost is approved according to the approval authorities in the DOAM.

If the traveler chooses to purchase his own his / her ticket from another source, then the amount reimbursed shall be capped based on the quotation obtained from the AUS travel office. If the quotation is higher than the actual cost of the ticket, then the actual cost is reimbursed. If the actual ticket cost is higher than the quotation, then the amount of the quotation will be reimbursed.

Quotes are based on the most economical airfare, which is defined as the least expensive, refundable, most direct route on the required days of travel. Traveler preference for airlines, stop overs, indirect routes, departure times, etc. is not considered when determining the price of the most economical airfare.

Should an employee book a flight not using the AUS Travel Agent, the traveler is required to obtain a written quote from the AUS travel agent within 48 hours of their travel booking. The employee shall request the quote in writing (email traveldesks.aus@itltravel.com) for the required dates of travel to their business destination without preference for airline, stopover, route, or other matter of personal preference. They shall submit the written quote along with their expense claim. If the traveler does not submit a quote, AUS Finance will obtain one for them. However, this carries the risk that the quote will be less than the amount the traveler actually paid and thus the traveler will be reimbursed less than expected.

Should a traveler choose a ticket that is more expensive than the most economical airfare, the additional amount incurred over and above the most economical airfare will be paid by the traveler.

Baggage fees that are reasonable, necessary, and appropriate for the purpose and length of the trip are reimbursable. Fees for baggage that are personal in nature will not be reimbursed.

ii. Ground transportation

Where possible, the University's automobile fleet should be used for local business travel, with the prior consent of the Transportation Division.

Taxis may be used when they are a cost effective means of transportation. The AUS Finance office reserves the right to deny reimbursement for taxi use that they deem to be excessive or extravagant. Tips shall be clearly indicated and are reimbursable up to 20% of the taxi fare. Excessive or extravagant taxi use is not reimbursable.

Rental vehicles must be approved in advance by the appropriate approval authority. Local car rentals are organized through the transportation department. Rental cars should only be used when there are no other cost effective means of transportation available. Travelers should attempt to maximize savings by renting compact or economy cars. When more than one employee is traveling to the same business meeting or event, the party should rent only one car. The Traveler should purchase the LDW (Loss Damage Waiver; formerly called CDW or collision damage waiver) and LIS (Liability Insurance Supplement) insurance for car rentals. Optional accessories such as a satellite radio are not reimbursed.

Employees authorized to travel on business in their own automobile shall be reimbursed for actual mileage at the rates prescribed by the University per kilometer. Under no circumstances is mileage to be reimbursed to/from home and office.

iii. Per Diem

When Per Diem is claimed, it represents the maximum daily rate that will be reimbursed by AUS against the actual expenses incurred by the business traveler.

Per Diem rates vary by destination and are published on the AUS website. The AUS per diem rates are currently based on the US Government Rates.

Per Diem consists of two portions: (1) Lodging (2) Meals and Incidentals (M&I)

a) Lodging

Lodging expenses are reimbursed up to a maximum of the per diem lodging rate for the nights that are directly related to business. Itemized hotel receipts are required to claim lodging per diem.

Lodging per diem may not be claimed when reimbursable registration fees include lodging or where complimentary accommodation is provided by the organizer.

In case of stay at approved conference designated hotels, per diem rates for lodging may be exceeded. Please refer to the section below on *Conferences*.

Travelers who stay in a private residence at no cost to the traveler may be reimbursed for a reasonable token of appreciation (not to exceed \$35/night or \$100 per trip) to be paid to the host for the courtesy of staying there. Documentation (typically a receipt signed by the host) must be provided. Reimbursement is not permitted for travelers who stay in their own place of residence.

b) Meals and Incidentals (M&I)

Meals and Incidentals (M&I) include:

- i. Food and beverages
- ii. Incidental expenses, including:
 - o Tips
 - o Transportation between places of lodging or business and restaurants
 - o Cleaning and pressing of clothes (when away less than 5 nights)

When per diem is claimed for meals and incidental expenses, these charges may not be claimed separately. Receipts are not required for meals and incidentals when per diem is claimed. Receipts are required if meals and incidentals are claimed at actual amounts.

Any meals paid for by AUS cannot also be claimed through per diem. Meals provided are subtracted from per diem according to the following breakdown.

- Breakfast 15%
- Lunch 25%
- Dinner 40%
- Incidentals 20%

When an international flight greater than five hours (in the air) is involved, travelers may claim 50% of the M&I per diem on the first and last day of travel. When an international flight greater than twelve hours (in the air) is involved, travelers may claim 100% M&I per diem on the first and last day of travel.

Per diems are authorized for all business travelers. Senior Managers may opt out of M&I per diem and choose to be reimbursed their actual M&I expenses instead. Should they opt out of per diem, they must submit receipts for all expenses claimed. The choice of per diem vs. actual

must be made for the entire trip, meaning the traveler cannot choose per diem on one day and actual on the next.

Laundry and dry cleaning may be claimed in addition to per diem if the traveler stays five or more consecutive nights in one or more hotels in the continental USA. International Per Diem rates (those set by the State Department which apply outside of the 48 Continental United States) include laundry, thus the traveler cannot claim laundry and dry-cleaning expenses separately when the international (non-US) per diem rate is claimed.

iv. Business entertainment

Expenditures for a reasonable number of business meals and entertainment events are necessary in the normal course of business operations of the University. In each case, the business meal or event must be appropriate to the situation and the nature of the business conducted. Prudent business judgment and moderation, coupled with disciplined budgetary control, dictate whom these functions serve, the frequency of events, and the reasonableness of related costs.

For further details, please see the AUS Business Meals and Entertainment Policy.

v. Business Communication

Long distance business calls back to the University should be limited to calls where discussion is strictly necessary for a bona-fide business purpose. Use of prepaid cards and/or personal telephones is encouraged to avoid expensive hotel surcharges associated with direct dial. Travelers shall, to the extent possible, use services requiring no additional cost for their business communication.

For details on the use of AUS Mobile Phones while traveling, please see the AUS Mobile Phone Policy.

vi. Conferences

Conference Registration fees are reimbursable expenses. Expenses included in the conference registration fee may not be claimed separately. Optional conference entertainment expenses are not reimbursable.

In case of stay at approved conference designated hotels, the actual daily rate will be reimbursed irrespective of the maximum per diem rate. When actual lodging costs are reimbursed, the reimbursement shall include applicable taxes. Lodging costs are reimbursed at standard occupancy rates. Suites or deluxe accommodation are not reimbursable. Itemized hotel receipts are required.

If the traveler stays at a hotel that is not the designated conference hotel, then the traveler should claim per diem for the actual amount of lodging up to the maximum allowable within the per diem rate. In the event that lodging cannot be obtained at the conference hotel, nor can lodging be found within the allowable per diem limits, the traveler shall request a Senior Officer (defined in 1.G.) to authorize a higher per diem. The Senior Officer may approve the request if it is due to reasons beyond the control of the traveler, i.e. not due to poor planning on the part of the traveler.

Typically, lodging and/or M&I per diem are applicable for the number of the days of conference attendance, plus one day advance arrival if it would not be practical to arrive on the day the conference begins.

vii. Domestic Travel (within the UAE)

For travel assignments within the UAE, the reimbursement of daily subsistence expenses shall be based on the actual amounts incurred up to the limits specified by the applicable Lodging or M&I Per Diem. The expenses reimbursed must be reasonable, necessary and appropriate to

accomplish the official business purpose of the trip. All expenses must be supported by receipts, regardless of the amounts incurred. Amounts in excess of the allowable lodging or M&I Per Diem for the city visited are not reimbursable except in the case of stay at approved conference designated hotels, as described in the preceding Conferences section.

G. Non-reimbursable travel expenses

Expenses that may be associated with business travel but which are non-reimbursable include, but are not limited to:

- Expenditures deemed to be extravagant, excessive, or which provide significant personal benefit
- Alcoholic beverages and tobacco, including shisha (allowable exceptions are described in the *Business Meals and Entertainment* policy)
- Family member travel expenses
- Entertainment/Recreation: movies, headsets, athletic facilities, spas, social activities
- Expenses for vacation or personal days taken before, during, or after business travel
- Personal reading materials such as books, magazines, newspapers
- Personal items such as medications, toiletries, chewing gum, batteries, etc.
- Airline or other club memberships
- Upgrades, such as seat, hotel, car, etc.
- Expenses related to the personal negligence of the traveler. This may include parking tickets, traffic fines, towing charges, lost or stolen tickets, cash or personal property, etc.
- Costs incurred by traveler's failure to cancel reservations in a timely fashion
- Penalties or fees for cancellation or change of discounted tickets when the cancellation or change came about from personal rather than University choice
- Commuting expenses between home and the University
- Repairs and maintenance of personal vehicles used on University business
- Non-University related expenses
- Flowers and gifts (refer to Gifts and Prizes Policy for more details)
- Travel related insurance premiums and/or purchase of additional travel, life or accident insurance (other than those already provided by the University)
- Passport issuance or renewal fees
- Vaccinations and visas when not required as a specific condition of the assigned travel
- Personal grooming such as barbers, hairdressers, shoe shines
- Personal grooming items
- Clothing including evening or formal wear
- Child care, baby-sitting, house sitting, pet sitting
- Luggage, bags and bag wrapping

H. Insurance

The University maintains an Emergency Evacuation and Travel Assistance program that provides medical, personal safety and travel related assistance services if an emergency arises while traveling domestically or internationally.

Limited coverage for personal accident, personal baggage, delayed baggage, personal money and documents, cancellation and curtailment and personal liability is included in the University Business Travel Insurance policy.

I. Special Travel Situations

i. Professional Development Grant (PDG) Travel

PDGs are reimbursed a flat rate according to a specific, approved procedure outlined in the addendum entitled Faculty Professional Development Grants Travel Reimbursement.

ii. Enrollment Management / Student Recruitment

Student recruitment activities in the GCC administered through the Office of Enrollment Management are reimbursed a flat rate according to a specific, approved procedure outlined in the document entitled Admissions Office Travel Reimbursement.

iii. Student Travelers

A student may be approved for reimbursement of travel expenses when there is a direct connection between the expense and the business purpose of the University.

Travel will be considered to have a University business purpose if the travel:

1. Directly supports a faculty member's project or research program
2. Is required for attendance at student-oriented meetings
3. Involves student athletes representing the University at approved athletic events
4. Enables a student to attend a conference to present research findings for the University or to act in some other capacity on behalf of the University

iv. Non-University Travelers

Prior approval, in accordance with the approval limits set by the DOAM, is required for determining the entitlement in each of the special situations described below.

a) Invited guests of the University

Invited guests are reimbursed according to specific arrangements approved in advance.

b) Staff or faculty candidates

Staff or faculty candidates invited to interview with AUS may be reimbursed travel expenses if they are approved in advance. Class of travel and standard of accommodation shall be agreed in advance of the interview and shall be consistently applied according to established guidelines. Other allowable expenses, such as meals and ground transportation, may be reimbursed to candidates if approved in advance. Receipts are required.

For details refer to the Guidelines for Candidate Visits at the end of this document.

c) Visiting scholars / Guests in Residence

Visiting Scholars (VS) and Guests in Residence (GiR) are reimbursed according to the contractual arrangements stipulated in the Visiting Scholar/Guest in-Residence (VS/GiR) Approval Form.

d) Guest Lecturers

Guest Lecturers are reimbursed according to arrangements negotiated in advance.

e) Family members of employees

Incremental expenses incurred due to family members' travel, lodging, meals, etc. are not reimbursed unless the individual has a bona fide business purpose for engaging in the travel or attending the event. Such expenses must be approved by a Senior Manager in advance. The employee is responsible for identifying and separating personal costs from business costs.

f) Independent contractors and consultants

The travel expenses shall be in accordance with the contracts negotiated with the parties concerned.

4. Exceptions to policy

In the event of extenuating circumstances, the Chancellor may approve exceptions to this policy.

Rank of Candidate	Hotel	Air ticket	Lunch On interview days	Dinner On interview days	Presentation	Reception	Spouse	AUS Drivers	Visas
Dean	Single or Double Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Business Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Yes, if needed	Yes, after presentation	Yes (including Hotel and business class air ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse
Vice Provost	Single or Double Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Business Class – From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Yes, if needed	Yes, after presentation	Yes (including Hotel and business class air ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse

Rank of Candidate	Hotel	Air ticket	Lunch On interview days	Dinner On interview days	Presentation	Reception	Spouse	AUS Drivers	Visas
		candidate							
Director	Single or Double Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Economy Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/ Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Yes, if needed	Yes, after presentation	Yes (including Hotel and economy class air ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse
Chair	Single Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Economy Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/ Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Candidate's Hotel # of Persons: 7 including candidate	Yes, if needed	Yes, after presentation	No – for first visit Yes – for second visit (to include hotel and economy class ticket)	From and to Hotel only	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse (second visit only)
Department Head	Single Room only 4 Star (e.g. Centro Hotel – Sharjah) (if requested,	Economy Class From Point of Origin to	On campus Location: Open # of	Off campus Location: Candidate's Hotel # of Persons: 7	Yes, if needed	Yes, after presentation	No – for first visit Yes – for second	From and to Hotel only	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and

Rank of Candidate	Hotel	Air ticket	Lunch On interview days	Dinner On interview days	Presentation	Reception	Spouse	AUS Drivers	Visas
	Double Room difference to be paid for by the candidate)	Sharjah/ Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	Persons: Open	including candidate			d visit (to include hotel and economy class ticket)		spouse (second visit only)
Faculty	Guest House - If not available, Single Room Centro Hotel Only (if requested, Double Room difference to be paid for by the candidate)	Economy Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/ Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	No	No	No	No	From and to hotel only (if applicable)	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate only (if requested, spouse visa to be paid for by the candidate)

1. In all cases above, transportation in the candidate's home country (home to airport and back) is to be fully reimbursed by AUS
2. Exceptions to the above guidelines require the Provost's approval.

Rank of Candidate	Hotel	Air ticket	Lunch On interview days	Dinner On interview days	Spouse	AUS Drivers	Visas
Senior Manager	Single or Double Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Business Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Yes (including Hotel and business class air ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse
Unclassified Director	Single Room 5 star (e.g. Le Meridien Dubai Airport)	Business Class – From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Yes (including Hotel and business class air ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse
Director	Single Room only 4 Star (e.g. Centro Hotel – Sharjah) (if requested, Double Room difference to be paid for by the candidate)	Economy Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On or Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	No – for first visit Yes – for second visit (to include hotel and economy class ticket)	Full Day	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse
Other staff recruited internationally	Guest House - If not available, Single Room Centro Hotel Only (if requested, Double Room difference to be paid for by the candidate)	Economy Class From Point of Origin to Sharjah/Dubai Only – Any other routes and detours to be paid for by the candidate	On campus Location: Open # of Persons: Open	Off campus Location: Candidate's Hotel # of Persons: 7 including candidate	No	From and to hotel only (if applicable)	AUS to apply and pay for visa for candidate and spouse

1. In all cases above, transportation in the candidate's home country (home to airport and back) is to be fully reimbursed by AUS

2. Exceptions to the above guidelines require the VCFA's approval, except in the case of Senior Managers which require Chancellor's approval.

5. Scope/applicability:

Applied to all Business travelers

Supply Chain Department

Finance Department

6. Responsibilities:

A. The Business Traveler

- i. Complete Business Travel Authorization and submit to approver(s) on time.
- ii. Plan for travel well in advance to ensure the best price is obtained.
- iii. Ensure submitted forms are accurate, complete, and supported by invoices.
- iv. Represent only those expenses directly related to the business travel.
- v. Avoid extravagances or the appearance thereof.
- vi. Accurately and ethically report reimbursable travel expenses. Ethics violations will be dealt with in accordance with the Human Resources Code of Business Ethics.
- vii. Do not report expenses that you have claimed or will claim from any other source.
- viii. Do not claim reimbursement for expenses that were not your own.
- ix. When booking flight tickets, it is the traveler's responsibility to disclose personal travel and to reimburse the University for any costs incurred by AUS which are unrelated to the business travel plan.
- x. Submit annual leave request for any personal days that are included with the business travel.

B. The Business Travel Approver

- i. Assess proposed travel to ensure that it is reasonable, necessary, and appropriate.
- ii. Ensure that the travel is budgeted within the appropriate budget and that funds are available for use. Ensure that class of travel is according to the traveler's eligibility under his or her employment contract.
- iii. Approve, reject, or return the travel request promptly.
- iv. Only approve expense claims that are reasonable, necessary and appropriate.
- v. Ensure the traveler is aware that business travel reimbursement requests must be submitted within the timeline specified in this policy.
- vi. Verify that the expenses claimed are for appropriate business travel days.
- vii. Ensure that any personal time is clearly specified on the form and related expenses are not claimed for reimbursement.
- viii. Ensure that traveler has reported any personal time as annual leave.

C. Finance Office

- i. Check all submitted forms for appropriate approvals.
- ii. Check expenses against receipts.
- iii. Verify that the expenses claimed are for appropriate business travel days.
- iv. Review claims for accuracy and compliance with this and other relevant AUS policies.
- v. Reject expenses that are not properly approved and/or documented or are not allowable under AUS policy.

- vi. Process advances and reimbursements efficiently and accurately.
- vii. Ensure that proper internal controls are in place to mitigate the risk of improper activity. To do this, Finance reserves the right to:
 - request additional documentation as necessary.
 - question or challenge expense claims that are not clearly reasonable, necessary, and appropriate

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

A. Appropriate

Costs are appropriate if they are suitable or fitting for a particular business purpose. In order for a cost to be appropriate it is also presumed that there is a valid business purpose, which is normally the responsibility of the department to determine.

B. Necessary

An expense is necessary if there is a valid business purpose required to fulfill the mission of the University. The primary benefit of a necessary business expense is the University, not the individual. A necessary expense is a minimum purchase or service required to achieve a valid business objective.

C. Per Diem

When Per Diem is claimed, it represents the maximum daily rate that will be reimbursed by AUS against the actual expenses incurred by the business traveler.

D. Faculty Professional Development Grants

Faculty Professional Development Grants (PDGs) are subject to a unique “flat rate” which is detailed in the policy entitled Faculty Professional Development Grants Travel Reimbursement.

E. Reasonable

Reasonable means the amount that normally would be spent in a specific situation. An expense is considered reasonable if it is not extreme or excessive and reflects a prudent decision and action to incur the expense.

F. Travel Expenses

Only travel expenses which are reasonable and necessary to accomplish the official business purpose of a trip are eligible for reimbursement. Expenses should be incurred at economical rates and may include the following categories of charges:

- Transportation expenses, including airfare and ground transportation
- Per diem, including
 - Lodging
 - Meals and Incidentals (M&I)
- Required Business expenses such as communication costs
- Special fees for foreign travel, including visas and airport taxes
- Conference registration fees

G. Senior Officers

Senior Officers include the Chancellor, Provost, and Chief Officers.

H. Senior Management

As defined in the Delegation of Authority Manual (DOAM), Senior Management includes the Chancellor, Provost, Chief Officers, Deans, Executive Directors, and other Senior Managers as determined by the Board of Trustees (BOT). Members of this group may also be referred to as Senior Managers.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policies

Supply Chain Policies

Human Resources Policies

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 15, 2016	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

6. Financial Policy – Managing Grant Fund Version - 3

Policy Number:	0900FN09	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Managing grant fund
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 15, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/background:

The University recognizes the usefulness of grant funds support in maintaining the balance of teaching and scholarship of a faculty dedicated primarily to excellent teaching and dialogue with students, while remaining actively engaged in scholarly, scientific, and artistic creativity.

2. Purpose:

The grant policies and procedures outlined here have been developed to ensure that the University retains control of the administration of externally funded grants for research and instruction, and to satisfy the requirements of public and private granting agencies.

3. Policy Statement:

i. Administrative Approval of Proposals

The applicant needs to complete fully and accurately a Grant Application proposal. Every proposal submitted for external funding to any agency or organization—whether public, private, for profit or non-profit—must receive administrative approval by the University before it is submitted. This includes proposals which request faculty fellowship, sabbatical, or travel support. The Administrative Approval includes:

- First level: Approval by the School's Dean
- Approval by the Provost

Proposals should be submitted to the School's Dean at least two weeks before the proposal must be sent to the granting agency.

ii. Submitting a proposal to external parties

Once a proposal is approved and forwarded appropriately, the Dean's office is responsible for contacting the approved external parties. The proposal should include only the approved criteria of the project.

iii. Managing Grant funds

A grant agency accepts funding totally or partially an AUS project by sending to AUS a letter of intent. It is AUS's responsibility to draw up a Grant Arrangement Contract with the granting agency that should be signed by both parties. The contract will include:

- Name of Granting Agency
- Name of AUS
- Name of faculty member entrusted with the project
- Nature and time span of the project
- Details of expenses coverable by the grant, including:

- a. Percentage of salary & benefits covered by the grant of the faculty and staff involved.
- b. The administrative overhead charged against the grant.

The signed contract is distributed as follows:

- Original to Finance Department
- Copy to Provost's Office
- Copy to Dean's office
- Copy to faculty members

The Finance office on receipt of the contract will create a fund within its chart of accounts specifically related to the project.

The budget on the individual accounting lines within the fund will be set in line with the Grant Arrangement contract & after consultation with the Dean & faculty member. Access to ordering items and authorizing orders from the fund will be given to those persons determined by the Dean of the School receiving the grant.

Payment of the consultancy fees, as per the contract, to the faculty member is done via the monthly payroll. The AP accountant notifies the payroll office monthly of the consultancy payments to be made.

The budget of the grant fund will span the period of the project which could be less or more than one year. The period could commence or terminate any time within a fiscal year. Funds will be carried over from one fiscal year to another as required.

Finance will produce budget to actual reports of the grant fund on a monthly basis, and whenever it is requested.

- iv. AUS sharing in grant funds AUS may choose to contribute to a project's funds by adding to the funds granted by external parties. The budget contributed by AUS follows the same rules as those of external parties as noted in section iii above.

4. Scope/applicability:

Finance Department

Research Department

Budget and planning office

5. Responsibilities:

Currently under review

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

AP: AP in this policy means Accounts payable which is the unit in the Finance Department responsible for the processing of invoices and payments for the University.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policies

Budget and planning Policies

Research Policies

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 15, 1998	Initial Release of Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 31, 2018	Updated to include changes to policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

7. Financial Policy – Financial Reporting – Version 3

Policy Number:	0900FN10	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Petty Cash (Imprest)
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 30, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date Oof Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Introduction/Background:

Financial Statements shall be prepared annually according to International Financial Reporting Standards (IFRS).

Financial statements may also be prepared on a quarterly or monthly basis as needed.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to determine the the internal and external reporting performed on periodical basis.

3. Policy Statement:

Financial Reporting is the responsibility of the Finance Management Team, which includes the Executive Director of Finance, the Controller and the Finance Manager. The Financial Management Team shall be composed of qualified accountants, at least one of whom must hold professional certification from a recognized body.

They are to be supported in this duty by all staff in the Finance Office.

Annual Financial Reports shall be audited on an annual basis by a qualified external auditing firm. The external audit report shall be presented to the Board of Trustees for approval each year.

Financial Reports may be distributed to the Board of Trustees, the Chancellor, the VCFA, and others inside or outside of the organization as needed. Approval to distribute financial statements may be given by the Chancellor, the VCFA or the Director of Finance.

4. Scope/Applicability:

This policy applies to internal and external reporting performed on a quarterly and annual basis, as well as the ongoing accounting records used to generate this reporting.

5. Responsibilities:

Financial Reporting is the responsibility of the Finance Management Team, which includes the Executive Director of Finance, the Controller and the Finance Manager. The Financial Management Team shall be composed of qualified accountants, at least one of whom must hold professional certification from a recognized body.

They are to be supported in this duty by all staff in the Finance Office.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **IFRS:** are a set of accounting rules for the financial statements of an entity that are intended to make them consistent, transparent, and easily comparable around the world

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policies

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 31, 1998	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 31, 2018	Revised to include policy changes	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

8. Financial Policy – Bank Reconciliation – Version 3

Policy Number:	0900FN11	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Bank Reconciliation
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	December 31, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction / background:

Bank reconciliations are a very important tool in managing and controlling cash in banks.

2. Purpose:

Bank reconciliations are important to understand the time difference between the bank recognition, and the recognition of the transaction in the books.

3. Policy Statement:

All bank accounts must be reconciled monthly.

4. Scope/applicability:

Finance Department – All bank accounts

5. Responsibilities:

The responsibility to reconcile bank accounts and to resolve any differences is that of the General Accounts Supervisor. The bank reconciliations are reviewed by the Finance Manager and approved by the Controller or Director of Finance in a timely manner.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

A bank reconciliation is the process of matching the balances in an entity's accounting records for a cash account to the corresponding information on a bank statement.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policies

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 31, 1998	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 31, 2018	Revision of policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
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9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

9. Financial Policy – Accounting Structure – Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FN12	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Accounting Structure
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 30, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date Of Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Introduction / background:

The University recognizes the importance of having a well-organized and structure accounting and a systematic chart of accounts, cost centers, funds, and other parameters for the financial records of the University.

2. Purpose:

Having a properly structured accounting charts with different parameters will allow the University to have a better management and control over the accounting of such activities and will also enhance the ability of reporting to Senior Management the activities either by specific function or department or college, or the overall activities of the University.

3. Policy Statement:

The university's budget is defined, and its revenues recognized, and its expenses incurred against a specific accounting structure.

This structure consists of four (4) main components

A. Fund (Six digits).

Each fund is balanced independently. The funds are consolidated to represent AUS's financial position. Funds are differentiated by:

- The budget source
- Types of transactions that are processed through each fund.

The main funds utilized are:

i. **Current Unrestricted Fund**

All transactions related to regular operations of the University are recorded in the current unrestricted fund. A budget is defined for every expense and revenue category within the current fund prior to the commencement of every academic year. This budget is approved by the Board of Trustees.

Expenses incurred and revenues generated by the University are credited in favor of and charged against the "Cost Center" that generate or incur the revenue or expense.

ii. **Current Restricted Fund**

Special budgets that are approved for specific projects other than the regular annual budget are recorded in this fund. A fund is created for each project independently.

iii. **Endowment Fund**

Funds granted by external parties to the university with a stipulation that the principal is un-expendable. Only the revenue generated by the funds are expendable by the university. A fund is created per endowment.

iv. Research / Consultancy Fund

Funds granted by external parties to the university for the purpose of specific research or consultancy. The revenue generated and expenses are disbursed as per a contract signed between the university and the external party. A fund is created for each contract.

v. Conference / Workshop Fund

Conferences and workshops held at the university are recorded in a separate fund. A fund is created for each of the four schools. Each conference / workshop is assigned a separate cost center within the workshop / conference fund of the relevant school. Revenues generated by or donations made towards the conference / workshop are recorded in the cost center. Expenses incurred are recorded to the relevant expense account.

vi. Agency Fund

Funds collected by the university on behalf of other parties are recorded in this fund. The university acts as an agent in receiving and disbursing the funds to the appropriate parties. The main operation of this fund is the collection of the student activity fees revenue on behalf of the student council and disbursing the funds in accordance to the student council and clubs policies and procedures.

vii. Investment in Plant Fund

Assets purchased are capitalized in this fund.

viii. Bank Fund

The Debit side of the cash inflow transactions to Bank accounts and the credit side of the cash outflow transactions to the Bank account are recorded in this fund.

B. Cost Center (Organizations) (4 Digits)

The university's budget is created per cost center. The cost centers represent the departments within the academic and Non-Academic divisions of the university. Revenues are also recognized by the organization that generated the revenue. Lower-level enterable cost centers roll up to higher level cost centers in accordance to the divisions they report to.

C. Account (5 Digits)

Accounts represent the nature of the financial transaction. It includes Asset, Liability, income and expense categories.

D. Program (2 Digits)

Adding program to the accounting structure allows the roll up of expenses by program. This classification is required for financial reporting.

Chart of Programs

Code	Program Title
10	Instruction
20	Research

30	Public Service
40	Academic Support
50	Student Services
60	Institution Support
70	Operation & Maintenance of Facilities
80	Scholarships and Fellowships
90	Auxiliary Enterprises

4. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all financial records and bookkeeping activities in the University.

5. Responsibilities:

While the ultimate responsibility of usage of some the accounting structure component (Fund, Account, Cost Center, Program) remains under the end user of the combination of these components, Finance Department could review and recommend better presentation for some records, and correcting other if mistakenly presented by the user in a wrong manner.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **Cost Centre:** part or function or department of the university to which costs may be charged and/or allocated for accounting purposes.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policy

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 30, 1998	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

10. Financial Policy – Accounts Receivable - Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FN13	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Accounts Receivable
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	July 20, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction/background:

The wide variety of receivables generated by the various activities of the University results in various individual accounts receivable.

2. Purpose:

In order to effect early conversion of these receivables to cash and minimize credit losses, the Finance Department must maintain a policy for managing receivables. The management function consists of timely and accurate billing, effective collection procedures, analyzing outstanding accounts, and providing for bad debts.

3. Policy Statement:

Tuition and other revenue generated by AUS will be in accordance with the fee schedule approved by the Board of Trustees for the relevant academic year. Revenue will be recognized in the relevant fiscal period and the collection of the fees will be as per the published payment guide for the relevant semester.

Auxiliary Revenue will be determined by the relevant contract. Payment are due when the relevant invoice is issued as per the terms on the invoice and the signed agreement.

A. Granting of Credit

The granting of credit is not a primary function of the University; therefore, credit will be granted only as indicated below:

- Credit is granted to staff for salary (only new hires) and housing advances. However, payments made by the University on behalf of staff for expenses such as personal expenses, telephone bills, utilities etc., are recovered in the following month incurred unless otherwise stated in the policies established by the Human Resources department.
- Credit may be granted by the University to its students in a form of deferment as per section 5.2 below.
- Credit may be granted to vendors in accordance with the signed contract.
- Credit is extended to governmental units and other sponsoring agencies, during the time claims for reimbursement are outstanding. The Finance Department, "Finance" will ensure timely reporting and collection efforts are exercised to minimize the receivables arising from these claims.

B. Billing, Collection and Analysis

Prompt billing for reimbursement of expenses or fees arising from services provided under various agreements is essential for effective management of receivables. Information must be maintained on the status of all unbilled accounts to insure that all actions necessary for the preparation of the bill have been taken as required so that the bill may be issued as expeditiously as possible. Collection of receivables is primarily the responsibility of the Accounts Receivable unit of the Finance Department. Adequate information concerning the age of outstanding bills and claims is essential for proper overall control of accounts receivable and related reserves for bad debts; therefore:

- i. Ageing information must be maintained, reported, and acted upon in a standardized and consistent manner.
- ii. Levels of effort in record keeping and collection must commensurate with collection value.
- iii. In general, bills must be collected as expeditiously as possible or as otherwise agreed upon with the debtor.

4. Standards and Procedures:

A. Tuition and Fees

Revenue Recognition

- i. The Finance Manager completes the online fee assessment screen in accordance with the University Catalogue. This screen defines the formula that determines the fees and the tuition charged per term, per course registration, and per student level. The interface is tested with the Registrar's office prior to the commencement of the registration.
- ii. Registrar's office activates the on-line fee assessment flag when the registration process commences.
- iii. Students register online during the registration periods. This automatically updates the student's AR account.
- iv. Office of Student Affairs (OSA) defines the interface that calculates the dorm charges per assigned room type per semester in accordance with the University catalogue.
- v. Once OSA commences assigning rooms, the student AR account is automatically updated.
- vi. Library fines and other charges invoices are issued by the appropriate departments and the students or vendors AR accounts are automatically updated.

Applying Scholarships and Grants

- i. AUS grants are defined on the Student AR System by the Financial Grants & Scholarship Office.
- ii. SA apply the defined sponsorship to a student account by running the application process. This results in a payment type transaction to the student account reducing the balance.
- iii. SA defines external sponsorship contracts on the Student AR system as per terms of the sponsorship.
- iv. SA apply the defined external sponsorships to a student's account by running the application process. This results in a payment type transaction reducing the account balance.

B. Payments

The fees of any semester are to be settled as per the published payment guide of the semester. Students need to settle, in full, the fees of the prior semester before they are allowed to register in a future semester.

C. Exceptions

Extended Payment Plan

The Payment Guide states that the fees can be paid in installments as follows:

- 60% before the first day of class / payment deadline
- 20% one month after the payment deadline
- 20% two months after the payment deadline

Either postdated checks or credit card authorizations need to be given to the cashiers before the payment deadline with the 60% current payment. This needs to be done before the payment deadline to avoid being charged the late payment penalty.

Students may request an extended payment plan when they are unable to pay the fees as per the above for extenuating circumstances. All such requests must be made to the SA, Receivables and Collections Supervisor or the Finance Manager depending on the extent of the exception requested.

Requirements

- All previous dues are settled.
- Student has completed one year at AUS.
- Student is not in the Achievement Academy.

D. Approval Limits

SA / Receivables and Collections Supervisor are authorized to approve payment plans that are within the current term.

1. Payments using 50%, 25%, 25% with the same dates as the payment guide.
2. The ordering of the percentages is changed but the dates are the same as the payment guide.
3. Three equal payments on the same dates as the payment guide.
4. One month to be skipped due to, for example, the family rent being due on that month.
5. Two equal payments provided the first one is current and the second one is no later than the date of the third installment date on the payment guide.
6. There are two or more siblings at AUS at the same time and the parent requests to make one payment per month, provided that all the siblings' fees will be settled during the course of the semester.
7. Extend the payment dates to the end of the month if the payment dates per the payment guide are during the month.
8. Students receiving loans from banks in terms of sponsorships where the bank will settle the fees in full but within the first month of the first day of class.
9. Graduate students on graduate assistantships who will settle the balance tuition and dorms monthly from their assistantship salary that will be received by the student monthly.

Finance Manager

1. Monthly payments throughout the semester.

2. One or more payments but without a down payment for the first installment. This will include grandfathered cases where the payments have been made this way in prior years.
3. Checks / credit card authorizations cannot be provided as the student does not have them. This is mainly for students whose parents live outside the UAE and require to pay in installments. The payments will be made by direct transfers from the home country on the agreed dates. In this case the Fee Deferment Request will need to be completed by the student and approved by the Finance Manager.

Further Approval

Students requiring deferral beyond one semester or have outstanding fees from previous semesters and wish to register in a future semester need to present a written request to the Finance Manager. The following factors will be considered as part of the request approval process:

1. The student is in the last year prior to graduation.
2. The student has had a good payment history thus far.
3. There has been a change in circumstances by the family that renders them unable to settle the fees.

The approval of the case will as follows:

Amount due from previous semesters / Amount deferred beyond one semester	Approval limit
Less than or equal AED 20,000	Executive Director of Finance (Weekly report to the VCFA for sign off)
More than AED 20,000	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration in consultation with the Provost

Only when the request is approved by the relevant approver will the fees be deferred on Banner.

E. Penalties

The following penalties will be applied:

- Late payment to students who fail to pay the fees within the stated first payment deadline on the payment guide.
- Reinstatement charge for students who fail to pay their payment within the stated second payment deadline
- Late registration to students who register late according to the registration guide.
- Expired deposits for students who register courses and / or a room and withdraw the registration after the specified date on the registration guide.
- Check returned penalty if a check provided is returned for non-sufficient funds.
- Credit card authorization penalty if a credit card authorization provided is returned for non-sufficient funds.

All these penalties are subject to VAT in accordance with the UAE VAT regulations.

If a student wants to request the reversal of any of these penalties, he / she will need to do so in writing by completing a petition and submitting it to SA. The reason for the delay will need to be presented clearly with any relevant documentation if available.

Students are allowed one reversal of each penalty and this can be authorized by SA. If a student is requesting the reversal of more than one penalty then this will need to be approved by the Cashier Supervisor or the Finance Manager.

F. Refunds

Excess Balances

If a student overpays (i.e. he/she pays an extra amount), the excess will be automatically applied to the fees of the following semester. However, if the student wants to claim that excess, he/she would need to make a request at SA or by email.

Refunds are made through checks or wire transfers, which need five to eight working days to be issued.

Refunds more than AED 4,500 will need to be either to the parent's account or will require the approval of one of the student's parents if they are to be made to the student.

Students can request a refund only if the fees are settled in full. That is, a refund will be granted only when all the agreed upon installments are settled.

Students are entitled to one refund a term unless extenuating circumstances prevail.

Tuition Fee Refunds

Students are entitled to a refund of the tuition fees (in varying percentages) if they withdraw their registration on specific dates. These are stated every semester on the Registration Guide.

If there is a death in the first degree family of the student during the semester, and this renders the student incapable of completing the semester, the student may petition to have the fees refunded and the payments made carried forward to a future semester when the student will be able to resume his / her education. This will need to be approved by the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction.

If the student incurs a medical condition that renders him / her incapable of completing the semester, the relevant medical documents will need to be submitted to the University Health Center. If they are approved by the Medical Director and the Registrar the fees can be refunded and the payment made either refunded or carried forward to another semester, as stipulated by the Registrar.

If the student fully paid the semester fees and unexpected circumstances arose warranting the student's leaving AUS, and this is prior to the second payment deadline, then the student will need to present his / her case requesting a full refund, with any relevant documents, to the Registrar and the Executive Director of Finance who will consider the request and make a decision regarding the refund.

G. Auxiliary Revenue

Revenue Recognition

- A. The relevant end user department will notify Finance of the service rendered and the details of the amount to be invoiced.
- B. The notification of the end user department must be approved by the relevant approver in accordance with the Delegation of Authority Manual (DOAM).

- C. Finance prepares the invoice and it is signed by the Executive Director of Finance and issued to the vendor. VAT will apply in accordance with the VAT law in the UAE.
- D. For consulting contracts, revenue is only booked in the accounts when the payment is received. For lease agreements the revenue is recognized in the relevant fiscal period. For research grants the revenue is recognized when the funds are received.

Payments

- A. SA maintain all the vendor invoices for Auxiliary revenue and follow up on their payments.
- B. The relevant sheets are updated with new invoices issued and the payment status weekly.
- C. Penalties for late payments are charged in accordance with the penalty clauses stated on the contract, if any.
- D. Payment delays are reported to Finance and Operations Department to enable them to take the required action and follow up with the vendor.

H. Receiving Payments and Cash Controls

The Cashiers will collect cash or/and cash equivalent from students, employees and others. Cash collection may be defined as the receiving of payments and issuing receipts for monies (currencies, money orders, bank cards, checks, .etc.) offered as payment to the university. All monies received by cashiers are to be deposited daily into the university bank account. Such deposits must be accompanied by a bank deposit slip. A Daily Cash Receipt Report is prepared by each cashier detailing the receipt vouchers issued during the day, including amounts, type of collection. Furthermore a daily report showing the number of the bank notes and currencies collected and kept in the safe for the daily morning bank deposit is also prepared and approved by the end of every day.

I. Bad Debts

Write Offs

The accounts receivable ageing shall be reviewed annually before the fiscal year end. This will include balances due from students, sponsors, vendors, employees and others.

Balances that have been due for more than one year will be written off against the existing provision. The account where a write off was made will be placed on a “write off hold”. This will render the student incapable of further doing business with AUS until the hold is cleared. That way, if at any time in the future, the student approaches AUS for any service (mainly transcript), the request will be rejected until the amount due is settled in full and the write off hold removed.

Provisions

The yearend review of receivable ageing will also be used to provide a calculation of the required provision for bad debts for the following year. The provision calculation is based on the following:

Net Balances due in days	Provision %
361 days	100
241 to 360 days	75
121 to 240 days	50
120 days	0

The write off and provisions for bad debts are proposed, reviewed and endorsed by the Finance Department and approved as per the approval limit set by the DOAM.

5. Scope/applicability:

The policy applies to all kinds of revenues, and receivables.

The Finance department is responsible of applying this policy

6. Responsibilities:

Student Accounts

The Student Accounts (SA) division of the Finance Department has the following responsibilities:

1. Prompt and accurate invoicing of students, sponsors and vendors.
2. Answering student and parent queries regarding details fees, payment methods and options for installments.
3. Following up on payments dues from sponsors, vendors and others.
4. Maintaining records regarding the receivables of the University.

Cashiers

The University Cashiers are responsible for the collection of payments from the students in any of the accepted forms of payment as per the published Payment Guide.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Accounts Receivable (AR)	A current asset representing money due for services provided on credit.
Student Accounts (SA)	The office that is primarily responsible for dealing with the students' financial matters.
Cashiers	The staff responsible for collecting all payments for AUS. They are a division of the Finance Department.
Accounts Receivable Record	Each students, vendor or other balance showing amounts charged, payments made, exemptions applied and amounts due at any point in time.
Student AR System	A sub-section of the Banner Student module that deals with accounts receivable.
Semester / Term	The period of time representing a unit of academic provision. Both are used interchangeably.
Payment Guide	The document that is issued ever semester detailing the payment deadline and the installment dates.
Registration Guide	The document that is issued every semester by the Office of the Registrar detailing the registration dates and criteria of the relevant semester.
Installments	Payments in accordance with the payment guide or an agreed plan.
Deferment	The request to delay the payment of fees that are due.
Bad debt	An open account balance that has proven to be uncollectible and is written off.

Billing	The request for payment of a debt.
Delegation of Authority Manual (DOAM)	The document that dictates all approval limits in AUS.
Vendor	An individual, group, or corporation that provides a service for a fee in AUS.
Operations Department	The department responsible for preparing contracts with vendors for auxiliary revenue.
Auxiliary Revenue	Revenue earned by the University other than from education or education related activities. Examples include revenue from professional education, rentals from outlets on campus, research funding and others.
Invoice	An itemized bill detailing the cost of items provided by AUS requiring a payment by the recipient.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial Policy

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	July 20, 2018	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

e. Purchasing and Inventory - Version 3

Policy Number:	0900PL14	Policy title:	Purchasing and Inventory Control
Prepared by:	Supply Chain	Issue date:	April 30, 2017
Responsible office/ Functional area:	Supply Chain	Effective date:	January 03, 2024
Approved by:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next revision:	June 06, 2025

1. Purpose

The purpose of this policy is to provide an overview of the processes used to facilitate purchasing, delivery and management of various goods and services needed for university's operations from third party suppliers / vendors.

2. Introduction / Background:

The Supply Chain Policy & Procedures Manual was established in 2017. An exercise was carried out to consolidate various independent policies together in one policy. KMPG was appointed to carry out the gap analysis and draft the policy.

3. Policy Statement:

The AUS Purchasing and Inventory Control policy requires that:

1. All good and services required for teaching, research and operational needs are centrally procured out through the Supply Chain Department.
2. The purchasing and contracting activities are done with Pre-Qualified and Approved suppliers.
3. All contractual agreements relating to purchasing of goods and or services from third party suppliers/ contractors are reviewed and established through the Supply Chain Department.
4. All deliveries of goods are controlled and managed through the Central warehouse on the university campus.
5. Received deliveries of goods and services should be matched with purchase order and delivery note. End user should confirm receipt of deliveries to Warehouse.
6. Central Warehouse holds inventory of Store items and supplies them to the requestors when needed.
7. All AUS owned fixed assets are tagged and maintained in the fixed asset register (FAR), centrally managed by Supply Chain Department.
8. Supply Chain Department to carry out an inventory count of fixed assets annually and investigate any discrepancies with the fixed asset register.
9. All assets must be returned or declared for disposable upon replacement of the asset or reaching end of the life of the asset.
10. All fixed assets disposal requests must be evaluated by Asset Disposal Committee to decide on assessing the disposal options available and choosing the optimal option.

Any needed purchasing will be routed through one of the following routes:

- **Competitive Bidding** – Multiple bids from suppliers to choose the most suitable both technically and commercially. Sealed Bids are obtained for purchase valued over AED 100K and these follow a sequential evaluation format. Purchases below AED 100K, follow open bids and techno commercial evaluation process.
- **Single Source** – Competitive Bidding is eliminated for those purchases where only one known source of supply exists or only one supplier can meet the specific need. This route requires the requestor to fill out a Single Source Justification form and obtain necessary approvals through the DOA.

- **Framework Agreements** – These are open order / Blanket agreements established with various suppliers. Any purchases through these agreements do not require competitive bidding process. A purchase order can be placed directly upon receiving approved purchase requisition.
- **Emergency Purchases** – These are initiated for urgencies caused by unforeseen circumstances that result in endangerment to life, damage to property or the suspension of an essential service or operations and requires immediate response to mitigate the potential risks.

The purchase requisitions and purchase orders go through the approval as per the Delegation of Authority (DOA) matrix before making any commitments to the suppliers.

Upon the award of purchase, Supply Chain initiates a contractual agreement process where needed. Standard contract templates are maintained and used for drafting necessary agreements. All agreements are signed as per the DOA. Any individual or joint venture contracts are outside the scope of Supply Chain department.

Tendering and Evaluation Guidelines

This section discussed the overarching guidelines that are applicable to all stakeholders involved in the procurement activities at AUS.

Tendering Process

- **Communication with Bidders:** All communication with the prospective bidders shall be managed by the SCD's Tender Manager/Contract Administrator.
- **Pre-Issuance of Tender**
- **Proposed Bidder's List:** The bidder's list shall be prepared by the Tender Managers from the approved vendor's database.
- **The End-user Department** has the authority to recommend bidders to be included in the tender. The registration and prequalification of vendors will be conducted by the SCD.
- **Bid Submission Strategy:** The bid submission strategy shall be a one-stage submission applicable across all tenders managed by the SCD. Bidders shall be requested to submit technical and commercial bids simultaneously for evaluation.
- **For the bids for the purchases below AED 100,000** (i.e. the low value purchases and the Open bids purchases processes), the bids shall be submitted by the Vendor through emails.
- **For all the bids for purchases equal to or above AED 100,000** (i.e. the sealed bid purchases process), the technical and commercial bids shall be submitted in separate sealed envelopes. Failure by a Bidder to comply with the AUS's request for a sealed Bid will result in their disqualification from the tender.
- **The only exception to this is international bidders** where prices are already publicly published as part of their pricing catalogue which does not permit Sealed Bid receipt. Such an exception and any other exception to this requirement requires the Supply Chain Director's authorization and shall be fully documented.
- **Bid Award Strategy:** The award strategy must be agreed in coordination with the end user department and approved by the relevant DOA. SCD shall propose the relevant award strategy based on the scope of work pertaining to the tender.

- Approval of Tender Issuance: Issuance of tenders up to value AED 100,000 shall require only Procurement Manager's approval. All tenders with a value above AED 100,000 shall be approved by the Supply Chain Director for issuance.
- Issuance to Bidders: All instruction to the bidder must be included in the tender package that is issued by the tender manager.
- The tender manager must provide at minimum the following documents to the bidder as part of the tender package:
 - Agreement type and the legally approved standard Terms and Conditions (T&C) which include insurance, liability, and performance bond requirements.
 - Confidentiality agreement.
 - Scope of Work.
 - Contract Duration.
 - HSE Requirements.
 - Tender Issued
- Bid bulletin: In an event the bidder seeks clarifications regarding the tender prior to submission, AUS shall communicate the same information to all bidders without reference to the original bidder's identity.
- Further, any announcement of additional information regarding the submission (closing date extension, change to scope of work etc.) shall be communicated to the approved bidders list. All the bidders will have the right to resubmit their bid based on the revised information provided by AUS.
- Tender Cancellation: Regardless of the value of the Contract, there shall be a maximum of 3 rounds of clarifications. Exceeding this maximum number shall prompt the review of the Scope of Work and possibly the cancellation of an issued tender. The approval for the cancellation of an issued tender shall rest with the respective AUS DOA.
- Site Visit/Pre-bid Meetings: SCD shall coordinate the site visit and the pre-bid briefing meetings, where applicable, inviting all bidders.
- Bid Submission: Submission of unsolicited bids is strictly prohibited. All unsolicited bids submitted by the bidders will be disqualified and such vendors will be restricted from bidding in future AUS tenders.
- Bid Submission Timelines: No bids shall be accepted after the closing date/time unless a strong justification is provided and approved by the Supply Chain Director.
- Bid Bond/Performance Bank Guarantee: Bid Bond may be obtained from the Bidders depending on the nature of the Bid.
- The Bid Bond to be defined as part of the Bid Document. It should be valid for a minimum of 90 days in the form of bank guarantee. The same shall be returned to unsuccessful Bidders after the Award.
- The performance guarantee shall be defined in advance as part of the Bid documents and may be obtained from the successful bidder depending on the nature of the bid in the form of bank

guarantee, demand draft, cash deposit, manager's cheque or any other means of retention as mutually agreed.

- If the performance obligation or the amount is greater than AED 1,000,000, then a performance bond is required under the contract. The performance bond shall be equivalent to 10% of the estimated contract value and shall be provided following 7 days post signing the contract from both the parties. The performance bond shall be sent to the Finance Department for safekeeping.
- International Sourcing: AUS shall engage with the local UAE vendors and SMEs to promote local entrepreneurship over international vendors, unless the international vendors are sole vendors or sole authorized vendors in the region. If the local vendors provide the same quality products with a markup of up to 25% in the price as compared to the international vendors AUS shall engage with the local vendors.

4. Scope/ Applicability:

This policy applies to all staff and faculty members who require purchasing of goods and / or services from external suppliers as well as those who have / will have an asset registered under their name.

Purchases made through Faculty Research Grant (FRG) funds have an exemption to purchase consumables and chemicals within the limit of AED 7,500. These are not required to be routed through Supply Chain Policy. Purchases made via Petty Cash are also exempt from Supply Chain policy and will follow the Petty Cash Policy.

The following transactions are exempted from Competitive Bidding process:

- Single Source Purchases.
- Framework Agreements.
- Emergency Purchases.
- Transactional / Invoice-only purchases.
- Membership for certified organizations or sponsorship.
- Software licenses, other licenses, newspapers, magazines and journals.
- Local and international strategic partnerships as mandated by the relevant AUS DOA.
- Recruitment services.
- Hospitality & recreational activities and conferences managed by one organizer.
- Specialized trainings (specific institutes, subject matters experts & speakers), legal services and any other type of external services which are based on knowledge and intellectual property etc.
- Repairs to equipment of such nature that the scope of repairs can be ascertained only after dismantling. In such a case, order may be placed on the basis of labor and parts found necessary.
- Renewal contracts provided such contracts are placed within one year of the date of original purchase order / contract and is within the subsequent year subject to necessary approvals and policies as per contract management.

5. Responsibilities:

Requestor:

- a. Will be responsible to raise a requisition on AUS ERP system.
- b. Will ensure that necessary funds are available for the purchase.
- c. Will be responsible to provide clear and detailed Scope of Work
- d. Will be responsible to carry out necessary technical evaluations and provide feedback.
- e. Will make time available to receive the goods when ready for delivery.

- f. Will safeguard the assets in their custody till returned to the university.

Procurement:

- a. Will be responsible to evaluate the appropriate sourcing route for the received approved requisitions.
- b. Will be responsible to send the inquiry and obtain quotations from the suppliers.
- c. Will coordinate clarifications and seek approvals from requestor
- d. Will be responsible to process Purchase Orders.
- e. Will be responsible to administer the contracts and maintain contract repository.
- f. Will be responsible to resolve any conflicts or performance issues relating to the suppliers.
- g. Will be responsible to on-board and pre-qualify suppliers from time to time and maintain updated records.

Warehouse:

- a. Will take responsibility of identifying stock replenishment needs and place purchase requisitions.
- b. Will receive the deliveries from the suppliers against purchase orders and ensure the items are in good condition.
- c. Will coordinate with End User to deliver store and non-store items to them.
- d. Will carry out a monthly cycle count of physical inventory of store items

Asset Controller:

- a. Will take responsibility of asset registration in the Fixed Asset Register.
- b. Will tag the asset if it is taggable.
- c. Will verify and transfer an asset in the asset register after receiving a request for asset transfer from End user.
- d. Will maintain and update the information about asset warranty / guarantee in the FAR.
- e. Will carry out a physical inventory exercise annually and submit the finding report.
- f. Will coordinate the asset disposal request from end user with the Asset Disposal Committee.
- g. Will be responsible for asset inspection, valuation and disposal.

6. Definitions / Abbreviations / Acronyms

End User / Requestor - An internal AUS employee/department who have a need for goods/services to be procured.

Scope of Work - The technical specifications & drawings (if applicable) of the tender requirements that are to be performed / delivered by the successful bidder upon award of the contract.

Delegation of Authority (DOA) - Document approved by AUS detailing the delegation of powers to approve financial and non-financial transactions/ activities pertaining to the Supply Chain Department.

Pre-Qualified Supplier - A vendor that has been evaluated and approved by AUS as having the technical and financial capabilities to provide certain goods and services.

Store Items - The warehouse stores stationery items, housing requirement commodities (crocery, cutlery, and soft home furnishing items), maintenance spare parts and other consumables for Facilities Department.

Fixed Asset Register (FAR) - comprehensive document which shows the assets owned by AUS. These assets shall include land, buildings & improvements, plant and equipment such as office equipment, laboratory equipment, motor vehicles, machinery, computer software, infrastructure including power, intellectual property buildings, patents, trademarks, copyrights etc.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Supply Chain Policies and Procedures
- Manual Petty Cash Policy
- Supplier Code of Conduct
- Single Source Justification Form
- AUS Fixed Assets Policy Research Policy

8. Policy History:

- Version 1.0 - Policy issued on May 2, 2017 (Developed by KPMG)
- Version 2.0 – Revision made on Jan 5, 2019 (Changes made to Open Bids process)
- Version 3.0 – Revision made on July 3, 2024 (Tendering Process)

Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of Changes	Requested by:
1.0	May 2, 2017	New Policy	Procurement Dept.
2.0	Jan 5, 2019	Changes made to Open Bids process	Procurement Dept.
3.0	July 3, 2024	Tendering Process	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

For more information regarding this policy, you can contact:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Supply Chain Directorate	Tel: +971 6 515 2220	procurement@aus.edu

f. Cash Management – Version 3

Policy Number:	0900FN15	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Cash Management
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	September 10, 1998
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Introduction / background:

The University recognize that enough cash should be maintained to meet its operating requirements and recognize also the importance of efficient and robust control over cash in all of its forms, which could be current accounts or fixed deposits in banks, petty cash in custody with departments, or corporate credit cards.

2. Purpose:

The University recognizes the inherent risk in cash and the importance of having a robust control over the cash, and a string management tools for Cash in all its forms, hence the need of this policy to determine the actions needed to manage and control cash.

3. Policy Statement:

Cash Management is the responsibility of the Finance Management Team, which includes the Director of Finance, the Controller, and the Finance Manager. They are to be supported in this duty by staff in the Finance Office as needed.

Tools for Cash Management such as monthly cash flow, projections, and variance analysis should be maintained, to determine the excess amount in cash.

Surplus cash shall be invested according to Board of Trustees (BOT) directives or mandates, as applicable.

The Finance Management Team shall ensure that there is sufficient cash on hand at all times to adhere to this policy.

4. Scope/applicability:

Cash Management is the responsibility of the Finance Management Team, which includes the Director of Finance, the Controller and the Finance Manager. They are to be supported in this duty by staff in the Finance Office as needed.

5. Responsibilities:

Cash Management is the responsibility of the Finance Management Team, which includes the Director of Finance, the Controller and the Finance Manager. They are to be supported in this duty by staff in the Finance Office as needed.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **Cash flow:** the total amount of money being transferred into and out of a business, especially as affecting liquidity

- **Variance analysis:** is the study of deviations of actual behavior versus the forecasted cash flow. This is essentially concerned with how the difference of actual and forecasted behaviors indicates how cash flow is being impacted.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Standing Committees - The Financial Affairs Committee

8. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	September 10, 1998	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	December 15, 2018	Policy revision to include updates	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

9. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

g. Financial Risk Management Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	0900FN16	Policy Title:	Financial Risk Management Policy
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	June 30, 2023
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Policy:

Financial Risk Management Policy

2. Purpose:

The University recognizes that certain risks (in the context of this policy, risk refers to financial risk) are incidental to normal university operations. It is the general objective of the University to avoid unexpected losses and to minimize the potentially adverse impact that financial risk exposures may have on the University.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The University is committed to utilizing a systematic approach to the identification, assessment and mitigation of financial risk to improve both planning and decision-making across the institution. Financial risk management is the process of understanding and managing the financial risks that the University might be facing either now or in the future. These risks, include, but not limited to, interest rate risk, credit risk and liquidity risk.

The University is fully aware of potential financial pressure from shifting and declining student populations, economic downturns, employee compensation costs, and other challenging events.

5. Scope/applicability:

Finance department.

6. Responsibilities:

Under the overarching rolling 5-year financial sustainability plan of the University, the Administration is responsible for developing a budget considering all financial risks impacting the University's income and expenditure streams. These risks include but are not limited to interest rate risk, liquidity risk, credit risk, declining student population and other economic conditions affecting current and long term financial sustainability.

The Board of Trustees Financial Affairs Committee plays an oversight role on the financial sustainability of the University. This Committee reviews the University budget in light of the University's objectives, financial resources, available funds, prospective income, and recommend a final draft of the budget for consideration and adoption by the Board.

The Investment Committee of the Board of Trustees oversee the investment management process and monitor the performance of invested endowments. This entails recommending assets allocation, risk tolerance, and other investment policies to the Board and oversee the management of the Fund via a set of asset allocation targets and ranges for the portfolio.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Interest rate risk is the potential for investment losses that result from a change in interest rates from the University's fixed deposits.

Credit risk is the possibility of a cash loss resulting from a failure of students and sponsors to meet contractual obligations related to tuition and fees.

Liquidity risk is the risk that the University will have insufficient funds to meet its financial commitments in a timely manner. The two key elements of liquidity risk are short-term cash flow risk and long-term funding risk.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Investment policy

Budgeting policy

Cash Management policy

9. Policy history:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 30, 2023	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

h. Auxiliary Enterprises Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	0900FN17	Policy Title:	Auxiliary Enterprises
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	May 1, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	January 31, 2025

1. Policy: Auxiliary Enterprises

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide an overview of the process used to identify, award and monitor companies that provide our auxiliary services.

3. Introduction/Background (optional): N/A

4. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) will from time to time require essential and supplementary services to be offered by off campus providers. These are known as Auxiliary Enterprises.

An auxiliaries standing committee will be formed to overview and enforce this policy. This committee will consist of at least four people:

- Manager of University Support Services
- Director of Finance
- Director of Supply Chain Management
- Other people may be invited to join the committee as and when needed.

The responsibilities and process that should be followed in the award and monitoring of contracts is listed in the Responsibilities section of this document.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all staff members who are in contact with, or are involved with the awarding of contracts to, providers of auxiliary services.

6. Responsibilities:

Awarding The Contract

- Once the need for a service is identified, the Manager of University Operations department will put together a scope of work.
- The Supply Chain Department will put the service out to tender in the form of a Request for Proposal (RFP).
- When the responses from suppliers are received, the Auxiliaries Standing Committee will create a short list from the responses received.
- Suppliers will be invited to discuss their proposal with the committee.
- The auxiliaries standing committee will award the contract to the supplier who best meets the criteria laid out in the RFP.

- Any company awarded the contract to provide these services will, in some circumstances, have exclusivity.
- Where property is leased to the supplier, the Manager of University Operations will prepare the lease and include service level expectations.
- Where no property is leased, the Supply Chain Department will prepare the service contract including service level expectations.

Monitoring Service Levels

- Service levels and where applicable, hygiene levels are outlined in the contract.
- The Manager of University Support Services will be responsible for monitoring the agreed service levels.
- Where shortfalls in service levels are detected, the supplier will be given written notice of the shortfall and a deadline for rectifying the said shortfall.
- If necessary the contract may be terminated as per the terms of the contract.
- At the end of the contract, a decision will be made by the Auxiliaries Standing Committee as to whether to renew the contract or to put the service out to tender.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Auxiliary services include, but are not limited to, food and beverage, gowns and rings, laundry, textbooks, hairdressing, travel agency, pharmacy and branded gifts.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Financial policy – Accounts Receivable

Supply Chain policies and procedures

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 1, 2014	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	March 31, 2019	Forming Auxiliaries Committee	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
3.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department	Tel: +971 6 5152234	finance@aus.edu

i. Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits – Version 1

Policy Number:	0900FN18	Policy Title:	Financial Policy – Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	27 August 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	27 August 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	27 August 2027

1. Policy:

Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits Policy

The University is committed to ensuring transparency, accountability, and consistency in its financial transactions. This policy outlines the procedures for handling receipts, payments, guarantees, and deposits, ensuring that all financial activities are conducted with integrity and in accordance with established guidelines..

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish a clear and comprehensive framework for the management of receipts, payments, guarantees, and deposits at the American University of Sharjah (AUS). This policy aims to ensure the effective, efficient, and transparent handling of all financial transactions and the safeguarding of institutional funds.

This policy is intended to support AUS in maintaining financial integrity, enhancing operational efficiency, and ensuring compliance with all relevant laws and regulations. By establishing standardized procedures and controls for the management of receipts, payments, guarantees, and deposits, AUS aims to uphold the highest standards of financial stewardship and accountability.

3. Introduction / background

NA

4. Policy Statement:

Receipts

This section outlines the procedures and responsibilities associated with the collection and recording of all revenue at AUS. This ensures that all financial inflows are accurately documented, securely handled, and systematically processed to maintain the integrity of the university's financial records. Receipts policies of AUS are as follows:

- The Accounts Receivables team is responsible for ensuring all incoming funds are accurately recorded in the university's financial systems. This includes documenting each transaction in a timely manner, verifying the authenticity of the received amounts, and ensuring that all records are properly maintained for future reference and auditing purposes.
- AUS accepts a variety of payment methods to accommodate the diverse needs of its students, donors, and other stakeholders. These payment methods include online payments, direct bank transfers, checks, and transactions made through Al Ansari Exchange, as well as payments via credit and debit cards. This diversity in payment options aims to streamline AUS's collection processes across different platforms.
- To ensure that all received payments are accurately tracked and matched with the corresponding bank deposits, each receipt generated by AUS is assigned a unique identifier.

This unique receipt number is used to correlate the payment with the corresponding entry in the bank statement, facilitating easier reconciliation and reducing the likelihood of errors or discrepancies.

- To safeguard against theft, loss, or unauthorized access, all checks received by AUS must be handled with the utmost care. Upon receipt, checks must be placed in secure, lock-and-key cabinets managed by designated custodians. This security measure ensures that checks are physically protected until they are ready to be deposited at the bank. All checks must be deposited on their respective dates, minimizing the risk of checks becoming outdated or mishandled.
- When a payment is received without clear identification or it cannot be matched with a specific invoice or account, the AR team is responsible for investigating and resolving the issue. AR team must frequently review unidentified payments to determine their origin. If, after thorough investigation, the payment still cannot be identified, it must be recorded as a miscellaneous income.

Payments

This section outlines the procedures and responsibilities related to the disbursement of funds by AUS to its vendors, employees, and students. It ensures that all payments are processed efficiently, accurately, and in accordance with authorized protocols, thereby safeguarding the university's financial resources. The section provides clear guidelines on the methods of payment, authorization requirements, and the handling of checks, ensuring that all financial obligations are met in a timely and secure manner. Payment policies of AUS are as follows:

- The AP Team is tasked with managing and executing all payments for AUS, ensuring that each disbursement aligns with the university's financial commitments. AP Team shall utilize various payment methods, such as bank transfers, checks, and credit cards, to efficiently fulfill these obligations.
- Every payment processed by the AP Team must receive prior authorization from designated signatories, as outlined in the AUS Delegation of Authority Matrix (DOAM).
- Payments at AUS are managed through two distinct processing modes to ensure timely disbursements.
 - Batch Payments are regularly scheduled to cover all outstanding obligations within a set cycle, optimizing efficiency and workflow.
 - Off-cycle Payments are reserved for urgent, unforeseen needs, allowing for expedited processing upon receipt of necessary approvals.
- Payments shall be processed based on the beneficiary details updated in the Vendor Master File and the Employee Master List. AP team must coordinate with the respective teams (Procurement, HR, etc.) and clarify payment details in the event of any discrepancy between master details in the ERP system and the beneficiary details provided by the supplier/ end user.
- The AP Team must enter all checks into the university's ERP system to maintain a digital record of each transaction, ensuring traceability and accountability. Checks must be printed in a sequential order, to help in tracking and monitoring issued checks, preventing any discrepancies or potential misuse.
- Once a check has been signed, it must be securely stored by the AP Team until it is ready to be delivered to the intended recipient.
- When a vendor collects a check, the AP Team must obtain formal acknowledgment of receipt. This acknowledgement shall serve as proof that the payment has been successfully delivered and accepted by the intended recipient, providing a record for both the university and the recipient.

- To maintain accurate financial records and manage outstanding liabilities, any check that remains uncashed for six months must be voided, or "reversed," in the university's accounting system.

Bank Guarantees

This section outlines the procedures for managing the custody and execution of bank guarantees received by AUS. This policy ensures that bank guarantees, which serve as a financial safeguard in vendor agreements, are properly managed from receipt to release or liquidation.

- The AP Team is responsible for safekeeping and management of all bank guarantees received from vendors, which serve as security for advance payments and future contractual obligations. AP team must ensure all bank guarantees are securely stored, tracked, and easily accessible when needed for reference or execution.
- The Procurement Team is responsible for monitoring the fulfillment of contractual obligations and informing the AP Team when a bank guarantee should be released upon successful completion, or liquidated if the vendor fails to meet the agreed terms. This notification must be based on documented evidence such as Goods Received Notes, Service Receipt Notes, or milestone completion certificates, in order to ensure actions are taken based on verified fulfillment or non-fulfillment of goods or services.
- When a bank guarantee is liquidated or expired, the AP Team is responsible for promptly recording the transaction in the excel tracker, in order to ensure that the status of bank guarantees is accurately reflected providing a clear audit trail.

Deposits

This section provides guidelines for managing the placement, renewal, and liquidation of fixed deposits by AUS. This policy ensures that the university's funds are optimally invested with banks offering favorable rates while carefully managing exposure and cash flow needs. Deposits policies of AUS are as follows:

- The Finance Team must closely monitor the university's cash flow projections to determine the amount of funds that can be securely placed in fixed deposits without affecting liquidity, ensuring that excess funds are effectively utilized to generate additional income while maintaining sufficient cash for operational needs.
- To maximize returns on fixed deposits, the Finance Team must obtain interest rates from multiple banks and selects the institution offering the most competitive rate, securing the best possible terms for its investments, enhancing overall financial returns.
- When approving fixed deposits, Management should not consider only the interest rates but also should evaluate the total financial exposure AUS has with each bank in order to diversify financial risks and to ensure funds are not overly concentrated with any single financial institution.
- The Finance Director and the vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration (VCFA) are responsible for making decisions regarding the renewal or liquidation of fixed deposits by analyzing projected cash flow needs to ensure that funds are available when required.
- The GA Team must notify the Financial Controller at least two weeks prior to the maturity of a deposit, to provide sufficient time to evaluate whether to renew or liquidate the deposit.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all financial activities related to the receipt, payment, guarantee, and deposit of funds at AUS. It is applicable to all departments, units, and individuals involved in the financial management processes of the university, including but not limited to the Finance Department, Accounts Receivable (AR), Accounts Payable (AP), General Accounting (GA), etc. The policy governs the handling of all institutional funds, regardless of their source or intended use, and covers

the full range of financial transactions, from the collection of revenues and disbursement of payments to the management of financial guarantees and deposits.

6. Responsibilities

Compliance with this policy is mandatory for all relevant personnel to ensure the safeguarding of AUS's financial resources, the integrity of its financial operations, and adherence to applicable laws and regulations.

7. Exceptions to the policy

Should extenuating circumstances arise, the Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration and/or the Chancellor have the authority to approve exceptions to this policy.

8. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

9. Policy review and update:

- This Policy shall be reviewed every three years.
- In addition to the scheduled reviews, ad-hoc reviews may be conducted in response to significant changes in university's governance framework, to incorporate any recommendations of external auditors /Internal Auditor/ Auditors from Sharjah Financial Control Department, to incorporate any changes in the regulations issued by influencing authorities, or changes in university operations.
- Any amendments to the policy must be endorsed by the Director of Finance, VCFA and approved by the Chancellor

10.Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

This policy shall be read in conjunction with the other AUS policies that have been referenced in this policy document.

11.Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	27 August 2024	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Finance Department – Director of Finance	Tel: +971 6 515 4041	mihsan@aus.edu

10. Legal Compliance and Public Discourse

a. Conflict of Interest Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	1000ES01	Policy Title:	Conflict of Interest Policy
Prepared By:	Human Resources	Issue Date:	August, 2004
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Employee Services	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	September 1, 2025

1. Policy: Conflict of Interest Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all members of the University avoid conflicts of interest and abide by rules of confidentiality.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

- (a) The purpose of this Conflict of Interest and Code of Confidentiality Policy (“Policy”) is to ensure that employees to whom this Policy applies operate in accordance with all applicable UAE Laws and regulations in carrying out all of their job responsibilities, and in particular any responsibilities they have in connection with the American University of Sharjah (AUS). This policy should be read in conjunction with Conflict-of-Interest Procedure.
- (b) Because of the nature of AUS’s relationships with other entities and individuals and the active role that employees take in the community, potential conflicts of interest may occur.
- (c) Moreover, the University recognizes that the members of the University community participate actively in community, cultural activities and institutions, and other personal and economic endeavors.

4. Policy Statement:

- (a) It is the policy of the University that its employees and others acting on its behalf have the obligation and responsibility to avoid ethical, legal, financial and other conflicts of interest and to ensure that their activities and interests do not conflict with their obligations to the University and its welfare.
- (b) A conflict of interest occurs when a University employee or a member of his/her family has a personal stake in a transaction, including an employment decision, or happens to be the second party to a transaction, into which the University enters, such that it might reasonably and/or adversely affect the judgment the employee normally exercises on behalf of AUS. This includes any second offices or positions held by University employees.
- (c) Some questions on conflict of interest arise from outside professional activities of the faculty and staff. Others, in the more traditional meaning of conflict of interest, derive from the opportunities an individual may have because of his or her position at the University to influence the University’s relationship with an outside organization in ways that would lead

directly to the individual's personal financial gain. Conflict of interest concerns include nepotism, if such hiring could cause problems with favoritism, fraud, confidentiality or liability.

- (d) The University's commitment to non-discrimination is further supported by its policy on the employment of relatives. The employment of relatives is permitted so long as it does not create an environment that is discriminatory or harassing to other employees and so that it does not adversely affect the conditions of employment or working environment of non-relative employees. Employees may not report directly or indirectly to a relative.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to the following personnel:

- University employees: All University faculty and staff.
- Senior Management: For the purpose of this policy, senior management includes the Chancellor, Provost, Vice Chancellors and Deans.

6. Responsibilities:

University employees are required to comply with this policy at all times.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: N.A.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Bribery and Anti-corruption policy

Awards, Benefits, Gifts, Prizes and Honoraria Policy

9. Policy history: Revision History

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 2004	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
2.0	August 2006	Revision	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration
3.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting the template	Vice Chancellor for Finance Administration

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Amal Al Ghammai Executive Director of Employee Services	Tel +971 6 515 2182	aalghammai@aus.edu

b. Anti-Corruption and Bribery Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	1000FN02	Policy Title:	Anti-Corruption and Bribery
Prepared By:	Finance Department	Issue Date:	June 30, 2022
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Finance Department	Effective Date:	June 30, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Date of Next Revision:	June 30, 2025

1. Policy:

Anti-corruption and bribery

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that all members of the University conduct University business in an ethical manner.

3. Introduction / background (optional): N/A

4. Policy Statement:

The University is committed to conducting business in an ethical, fair, professional and honest manner. The University has zero-tolerance for bribery and corrupt activities of any kind for the purposes of gaining unfair advantage.

The University prohibits, directly or indirectly, the offering or giving of any bribes. AUS operates within the spirit of the US Foreign Corrupt Practices Act and the UK Bribery Act.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all employees and any other member of staff of the University, including any temporary or agency staff or unpaid members of staff and voluntary workers.

The policy applies to all activities of the University, whether related to its research, teaching, commercial or other activities, and exists for the protection of employees and the University.

6. Responsibilities:

University employees are required to always comply with this policy.

Employees are responsible for the prevention, detection, and reporting of bribery and other forms of corruption and are required to avoid any activities that could lead to, or imply, a breach of this policy.

Employees who believe or suspect that an instance of bribery or corruption has occurred or will occur in the future in breach of this policy, should notify their Line Manager or the VCFA and Director of Internal Audit as soon as possible.

Employees who are found to be in breach of this policy will be subject to disciplinary action and could face dismissal for gross misconduct in accordance with the University's Human Resources disciplinary code.

A deliberate failure to report suspicions of corruption or to conceal bribes by others will also be subject to disciplinary action.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Bribe: A gift, loan, payment, reward or advantage, either in cash or any other form of inducement, to any person or company in order to gain: (1) commercial, contractual or regulatory advantage for the University; or (2) personal advantage for an individual or anyone connected with that individual.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Conflict of Interest and Code of Confidentiality Policy

Awards, Benefits, Gifts, Prizes and Honoraria Policy

9. Policy History:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	June 30, 2022	New Policy Issued	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 30, 2024	Revised to update format	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Tel: +971 6 515 2344	occoo@aus.edu

c. Copyright and Intellectual Property Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	1000RE03	Policy Title:	Intellectual Property Policy
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Board of Trustees	Date of Next Revision:	June, 2027

1. Policy:

AUS will strive to enable and facilitate IP (Intellectual Property) creation, protection, management, and transfer such IP to the private sector and society within an environment that promotes the highest quality and integrity of academic activity, teaching, and research.

This Policy has been developed in line with UAE related IP laws.

2. Purpose:

Article (1) This IP policy is intended to promote collaborations with the private sector for the benefit of society, further discovery and innovation, encourage the participation of faculty, staff and students in research, and foster economic development in the United Arab Emirates and beyond. The Board of Trustees recognizes the importance of commercialization as being part of the mission of AUS, and acknowledges that collaborative research supported by industry requires timely and efficient processes to manage IP created at AUS.

3. Introduction / background:

Article (1) The American University of Sharjah (AUS) is a comprehensive, independent, non-profit, coeducational institution of higher education that promotes excellence in teaching, learning, research and creative work. Based on an American model of higher education, integrating liberal arts and professional programs, and grounded in the context of the United Arab Emirates culture, AUS prepares engaged and effective members of society who display mastery in their areas of specialization, communicate clearly, think critically and solve problems creatively.

AUS values the creation of knowledge through curiosity, academic adventure and rigorous research and contributes to the development of society by creating opportunities for collaboration and active engagement.

According to **Article (1)**, AUS is guided by the following principles related to intellectual property:

- The successful deployment of intellectual property developed through teaching, research, discovery, creative activity, and application of knowledge, irrespective of the funding sources, allows AUS to develop and disseminate knowledge, technology, and the results of creative activity for the benefit of the society, both locally and globally, and comports with the mission of AUS.
- The development and dissemination of knowledge, technology and the results of creative activity contributes to the vitality and competitiveness of AUS, Sharjah, and the United Arab Emirates. Therefore, AUS shall:

- i. Encourage partnerships with government entities, industry, and not-for-profit organizations; ii. Efficiently and expeditiously manage intellectual property created from these partnerships; and iii. Remain understanding, flexible, and open to the varied circumstances and needs of potential sponsors.
- c. Sponsored research or creative activity is frequently closely integrated with the educational mission of AUS. Therefore, conducting sponsored research or engaging in creative activity shall not abridge publication and research rights, impinge upon the dissemination of results, including student projects, theses and dissertations, nor diminish the environment of academic and research integrity at AUS.
- d. Sponsored research or creative activity requires the timely execution of critical agreements that clearly specify the responsibilities of all parties, financial obligations and outcomes, and ownership rights of, or appropriate access to, intellectual property resulting from the work.
- e. The primary duties of members of the faculty at AUS are to teach, study, investigate, discover, create, disseminate, develop professionally, and infuse new knowledge into their classes and student interactions.
- f. Commercialization of technology enhances the reputation of AUS and enables the transfer of knowledge and research results to the marketplace.
- g. Compliance with university policies and all applicable laws and regulations of the United Arab Emirates is essential for the successful commercialization of technology developed at AUS.

4. Policy Statement: AUS will strive to enable and facilitate IP (Intellectual Property) creation, protection, management, and transfer such IP to the private sector and society within an environment that promotes the highest quality and integrity of academic activity, teaching, and research.

ARTICLE 5 - OWNERSHIP OF IP AND RIGHTS OF USE

5.1. IP Created by Employees

5.1.1. AUS ownership. AUS owns all IP created by an Employee:

- a. in the course and scope of his/her employment; or
- b. making Substantial Use of AUS resources; or
- c. as set out in a written agreement.

5.1.2. Employee and Visitors ownership. AUS will not assert ownership of IP created by Employees or Visitors when such IP:

- a. is outside the course and scope of their employment and without Substantial Use³ of the AUS resources;
- b. is classified as Scholarly Work according to the definition given in Article 2, and such IP is created by the Employee or Visitor in the course and scope of his/her employment; or
- c. has been allotted by written agreement.

5.1.3. IP emanating from Research Contracts. In the absence of provisions to the contrary in any national law, the ownership of IP created by Employees in the course of a Research Project will be regulated by the terms of the associated Research Contract, as set out in Article 7.

³ Use will be deemed not Substantial if minimal overhead costs have been incurred by AUS (such as the use of office space, the library, facilities or traditional desktop computers); only a minimal amount of time has been spent using significant AUS facilities; or the IP has been written or developed in the personal (unpaid) time of the Creator.

5.1.4. **Appointment of Employees at another Institution**⁴. It is the responsibility of each Employee that holds an honorary or other academic or research appointment at another institution (Host Institution) to bring to the attention of the Host Institution, including its intellectual property management office, his/her obligations in terms of this Policy, prior to the tenure at the Host Institution. To the extent that the Host Institution's IP Policy makes a claim on IP created by the Employee pursuant to such appointment, the Employee shall ensure that the Host Institution negotiates a suitable IP arrangement with AUS.

5.2. IP Created by Students

5.2.1. **Student ownership.** Unless otherwise agreed to in writing, a student enrolled at AUS such as in an undergraduate or graduate degree program or a certificate program owns the intellectual property he or she creates

- (a) in courses or in required projects such as theses and dissertations,
- (b) during extracurricular activities, and
- (c) while using the resources and facilities of AUS commonly provided for a student's use and for which a student has paid tuition and fees.

5.2.2. **AUS ownership.** IP emanating from a Student's Research Project shall be owned by AUS in the following circumstances:

- a. If the IP is created by making Substantial Use of AUS's resources (excluding supervision) and there is no other agreement between AUS and the Student; or
- b. If the Research carried out by the student forms part of an AUS Research Project; or c. The student is an employee of AUS and the IP is developed within the course and scope of his or her employment, in which case the provisions of this IP Policy relating to employees shall apply; or
- c. The student works on a work-for-hire or institutional project which is regulated by a specific contractual agreement; or
- d. The student participates in an institutional Research Project where any IP created under that project is committed to, or encumbered by an agreement with a governmental, philanthropic, corporate or other sponsor.

5.2.3. **IP emanating from Research Contracts.**⁵ The terms of the Research Contract shall regulate the ownership of IP created by a Student in the course of such Research Contract, as set out in Article 8.

5.2.4. **AUS ownership responsibilities.**⁶ If AUS is the owner of IP created by a Student, in terms of Article 5.2.2, and hence created in terms of a Research Project or Research Contract, AUS shall:

- a. provide the Student with an explanation of the reasons for the assignment of IP rights to AUS;
- b. advise the Student to seek independent advice regarding the assignment; obtain a deed of assignment from the Student for all IPRs emanating from the Student's Research Contract or Research Project, where relevant, in return for revenue sharing as provided for in Article 10; and withdraw the Student from the Research Project or Research Contract if a Student elects not to assign the relevant IPRs to AUS.

⁴ This means that such Employees are a visitor at another institution.

⁵ That is, if the Student is participating in a Research Project under a Research Contract between the Institution and an external entity or research sponsor.

⁶ See also Article 3.4.2 of this Policy.

5.2.5. **Bursaries/scholarships.** An external party that grants a bursary or scholarship to a Student may elect to own the IP created by that Student in the course of his/her study at AUS provided the Student and AUS have consented to the assignment of IP ownership in writing and such consent is not contrary to any applicable local or national law.

5.3. IP Created by Visitors

5.3.1. **AUS ownership.** Unless otherwise agreed to in writing by AUS and the Visitor's home institution prior to the tenure at AUS, Visitors are required to assign to AUS any IP:

- a. created in the course and scope of their Appointment at AUS; or
- b. created by making Substantial Use of AUS's resources.

5.3.2. **AUS IP.** In the event that a Visitor created IP whilst at AUS, on departure from AUS the Visitor must submit signed IP disclosure(s) to OVCR.

5.4. Special Rules for Course Materials

5.4.1. **Ownership.** The Employee or Visitor will own the IP in Course Materials created by an Employee or a Visitor, with the exclusion of Course Material that is created from or for Open Educational Resources (OERs), in accordance with Article 5.7.1, unless otherwise agreed by contract.

5.4.2. **Licensed to AUS.** Employees and Visitors shall grant to AUS a non-exclusive, royalty free license to use their Course Materials for the AUS's Research and teaching purposes.

5.5. Special Rules for Scholarly Works

5.5.1. **Publication.** AUS recognizes and endorses the rights of Employees, Students and Visitors to publish their Scholarly Works, provided that any Scholarly Work which may disclose any possible Institutional IP shall be reviewed by AUS exclusively for the purpose to decide if AUS should protect said IP prior to publication.

5.5.2. **Licensed to AUS.** Employees, Students and Visitors shall grant to the Institution a non-exclusive, royalty free license to use their Scholarly Works for the Institution's administrative, promotional, Research and teaching purposes.

5.6. Moral Rights

5.6.1. **Recognition.** AUS undertakes to respect and protect the moral rights which copyright law of the United Arab Emirates confers on Authors of copyright.

5.6.2. **Rights granted.** AUS acknowledges the moral rights vest in Authors of copyright works and include:

- a. the right of divulgation;
- b. the right of attribution of authorship in respect of the copyright works and the right not to have authorship of the copyright works falsely attributed;
- c. the right of integrity of authorship in respect of the copyright works; and d. the right of retraction.

5.7. Public Domain

5.7.1. **Public Domain.** AUS IP will be incorporated into the Public Domain in the following circumstances:

- a. if a Research Contract provides that the Research results be placed into the Public Domain;
- or b. if Employees or Visitors made use of OERs or resources licensed through Open Source

or Creative Commons Licences⁷ and the licensing conditions require release of derivatives into the Public Domain.

5.7.2. **Release into the public domain.** AUS will release IP into the Public Domain in the following circumstances:

- a. where it is deemed to be in the public interest;
- b. if the IP has low commercial or other development potential and low prospects of fostering the development of new products or services; or
- c. if deemed necessary by AUS.

ARTICLE 6 – PUBLICATION, NON-DISCLOSURE AND TRADE SECRETS

6.1. **Right of publication.** AUS encourages and supports the right of Creators to decide if and when to publish their Research results, in accordance with Article 5.5 above.

6.2. **Non-disclosure for IP protection.** In conjunction with the right of publication, Creators should be aware that premature Public Disclosure may result in loss of IP protection rights.⁸ Therefore, they are strongly encouraged to make all reasonable efforts to identify any protectable IP as early as possible, according to Article 8, and shall consult the OVCR before making any Public Disclosure of potential AUS IP.

6.3. **Trade Secrets.** AUS may designate certain confidential information as a Trade Secret, owned by AUS. In that event, all Creators will be obligated to maintain secrecy of the Trade Secret and to follow the direction for management of the Trade Secret by AUS.

ARTICLE 7 – RESEARCH CONTRACTS

7.1. **Research Contract Policy.** All Research Contracts must be executed and performed in compliance with the AUS Research Administration Policy.

7.2. **Basic Principles.** The IP clauses in all Research Contracts shall be governed by the following basic principles:

7.2.1. **Concluded from the outset.** A Research Contract must be executed in writing and signed by authorized officers of AUS and the external party(ies)/sponsor(s) prior to the commencement of any Research Project and, as appropriate and without limitation, must contain terms relating to ownership, management and use of IP arising from the Research Project as well as any Background IP.

7.2.2. **Background IP.** All AUS Background IP must be properly recorded and declared prior to the commencement of a Research Contract and belongs to AUS. Similarly, Background IP of the external party/sponsor, belongs to such party or sponsor. Use of such Background IP requires express written permission.

7.2.3. **Foreground IP (IP arising from the Research Contract).** IP generated pursuant to a Research Contract by Employees, Students or Visitors shall be governed in terms of the above provisions relating to IP generated by these parties. Unless otherwise agreed in the Research Contract, such Foreground IP shall be owned by AUS.

⁷ Creative Commons is a non-profit corporation dedicated to making it easier for people to share and build upon the work of others within the framework of national copyright laws. The Creative Commons suite of free copyright licenses provides a simple.

⁸ Patents provide protection for technical inventions but there are strict procedures and rules which must be followed. A patent cannot be granted if the invention has already been disclosed and so care must be taken to avoid premature disclosure before the patent application has been filed.

7.2.4. Co-owned Foreground IP.

- a. **Terms for co-ownership.** Co-ownership of IP generated pursuant to a Research Contract shall be as mutually agreed contractually, in accordance with all relevant laws pertaining to the relevant jurisdictions.
- b. **Costs for protecting and maintaining co-owned IP.** The costs for protecting and maintaining any IPRs shall be shared between the Institution and the external party(ies)/sponsor(s) as mutually agreed contractually, in accordance with all relevant laws pertaining to the relevant jurisdictions.

7.2.5. **Serendipitous IP⁹.** Any IP created during the course of the Research Contract which falls outside the scope of the Research Contract shall be owned by AUS or by the external party(ies)/sponsor(s) that developed such IP, unless agreed contractually otherwise in the Research Contract.

7.2.6. **Right of first refusal to the IP.** The Research Contract may include provisions giving the external party(ies)/sponsors a right of first refusal to Commercialize the IP emanating from the Research Contract, through a license or joint venture arrangement or assignment.

7.2.7. **Publication delay.** It is the strict policy of AUS to allow Creators freedom to publish their work. However, AUS acknowledges that delays in publication for the purpose of initiating statutory protection of the IP is often necessary. In this regard, the Institution will agree, on a case-by-case basis, to a contractual delay in publication by Creators. Such delay will not exceed 90 calendar days from the date the OVCR is notified of the intent to publish, unless authorized by the Vice Chancellor for Research.

7.2.8. **Use of the IP for Research and teaching.** In instances where the AUS IP is licensed exclusively or assigned as part of the Research Contract, AUS shall retain a royalty-free license for non-commercial use of the IP for on- going Research and teaching purposes, unless an exception is authorized by the Vice Chancellor for Research.

7.3. **Exceptions to the Policy.** In certain cases, it may be necessary and/or beneficial to AUS to enter into a Research Contract that contains exceptions to the provisions of this Policy. Any such exceptions require prior written approval from the Vice Chancellor for Research.

ARTICLE 8 – DETERMINATIONS BY AUS

8.1. Responsibility to Disclose IP

8.1.1. **Recording.** Creators shall keep appropriate records of their Research in accordance with AUS's applicable policy procedures and make reasonable efforts to ensure that only those individuals within AUS who have a need to have access to such records for the performance of their duties are granted such access.

8.1.2. **IP Disclosure.** Where a Creator identifies potential IP resulting from his/her Research, or that of his/her team, he/she shall disclose such potential IP to the OVCR promptly by means of an IP Disclosure Form (IPDF).

8.1.3. **Complete disclosure.** Creators must provide to OVCR such full complete and accurate information, as the OVCR may reasonably require, to enable it to sufficiently assess the technical and related features and functions, ownership, commercial potential and IP protection

⁹ Results are serendipitous when research that was originally funded for one purpose turns out to be useful for another purpose. assess the technical and related features and functions, ownership, commercial potential and IP protection that might be applicable to such IP.

that might be applicable to such IP.

- 8.1.4. **Disclosure Clause for IP related to GRs and/or TK.** When potential IP has been developed using GRs and/or TK, the OVCR will require its Creators to disclose relevant information, in accordance with relevant national and international regulations.

8.2. Creatorship and Ownership

- 8.2.1. **Creatorship.** Creators shall, upon request, sign the appropriate legal documents provided by OVCR that attest to creatorship. Where there is more than one Creator, and there is a dispute as to the contribution to creatorship, OVCR shall in consultation with the Creators, assist in the determination of the percentage IP creatorship, failing which it shall be assumed that there was an equal undivided contribution.

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- 8.3.2 **Ownership.** Once creatorship has been determined, the Creators shall be required to formally assign any right, title or interest they may have in that IP to AUS in the form of a contract that specifies the rights that will accrue to the Creator(s) and to AUS and the obligations they will have to assist AUS with the Commercialization of that IP. Article 9.3 will apply.

8.4. Determination as to IP Protection and Commercialization

- 8.4.1. **Evaluation and recommendation.** OVCR will analyse the information disclosed in the IPDF within 90 days of formal receipt. The analysis will include: whether or not the subject matter is protectable as IP; an assessment of economic viability or marketability; and determination of any rights of external parties, such as a funder or collaborator. After evaluation, OVCR will prepare a preliminary report with findings that enable AUS to decide if it will proceed with IP protection and Commercialization. OVCR shall share the preliminary report with the Creator(s) and seek their input.

- 8.4.2. **Decision to protect/Commercialize.** AUS will decide, as soon as reasonably practicable, whether or not it wishes to protect and/or commercialize the IP. OVCR will use all reasonable efforts to notify the Creator(s) of AUS' decision within 90 days of formal receipt of the IP Disclosure. OVCR will also make a determination in relation to the validity of any claim made by an Employee, a Visitor or a Student that they are the true Creator(s) of that IP and in relation to their rights under this Policy.

- 8.4.3. **AUS' obligation to notify Creators of its decision.** Within no more than 90 days the OVCR will notify the Creator(s) of the decision of whether AUS will or will not pursue IP protection and Commercialization of their IP Disclosure.

8.5. Institution Elects not to Protect /Commercialize the IP

- 8.5.1. **IP abandoned or not Commercialized.** AUS reserves the right not to protect or Commercialize IP that it owns if after consultation with the Creators:

- a. There is no reasonable prospect of commercial success;
- b. It is not deemed to be in the best interest of aus; or
- c. It is not deemed to be in the public interest.

8.5.2 **Transfer of Ownership.** In the event AUS decides not to pursue IP protection and/or Commercialization, it will take steps to return said IPRs to the Creator(s), contingent on any other superseding contract rights of external party(ies)/sponsor(s).

8.5.3 **Written notification.** If AUS is unable to, or decides not to protect or Commercialize AUS IP, it should notify the relevant Creator(s) of its decision in writing and in a timely¹⁰ manner such that enables the relevant Creator(s) to take any formal steps to ensure the protection of IP, should they so desire.

8.5.4 **Assignment.** If the Creator elects to take assignment of the IP, AUS shall ensure that a deed of assignment is executed without delay.

8.5.5 **Terms and conditions.** If AUS assigns IPRs to the Creator in terms of this Article 8.4.4, the assignment may be subject to any the following terms and conditions:

- a. That upon Commercialization, AUS be compensated for any expenditure it may have incurred in connection with the protection and/or
- b. Commercialization of such IP; and/or
- c. That AUS be granted a non-exclusive, royalty-free license for the non commercial use the IP for Research and teaching purposes; and/or
- d. That upon Commercialization, AUS receives an agreed upon share of Commercialization revenues.

ARTICLE 9 - COMMERCIALIZATION OF IP

9.1. **Determination of the Commercialization Strategy.** Within three months of the decision to protect or commercialize the IP under Article 8.3.2, AUS will determine, with input from the Creators, the most appropriate Commercialization strategy.

9.2. **Assistance to OVCR.** Creators of IP which has been selected for IP protection and Commercialization by AUS must provide OVCR with all reasonable support in the assessment, protection (including preventing premature disclosure and execution of any documents including deeds of assignment and deeds attesting to creatorship), and Commercialization of the IP.

9.3. **Sovereignty and Cooperation.** AUS shall have the sole discretion regarding the Commercialization of IP fully owned by AUS. Notwithstanding, AUS will ensure that reasonable efforts are made to keep the Creators informed and, where appropriate, involved in the Commercialization of the IP to which they contributed. The Commercialization of AUS IP will be planned, executed, and monitored by OVCR.

9.4. **Commercialization Pathways.** Modes of IP Commercialization may include:

- a. license, either exclusive or non-exclusive, and variations thereof;
- b. assignment (sale);
- c. formation of a Commercialization Entity to which the IP is licensed or assigned in terms of this Policy;
- d. non-profit use or donation;
- e. joint ventures;

¹⁰ "Timely" means sufficient to not cause the loss of IP rights by failure to act.

- f. royalty free access on humanitarian or other grounds; or
- g. various combinations of the above.

9.5. **Guidelines.** Regardless of the mode of IP Commercialization, the transaction will be executed in a contract which:

- a. protects the interests of AUS, its Employees, Students and Visitors;
- b. retains rights for the Institution to use the IP for non-commercial educational and research purposes;
- c. assures that the IP will be utilized in a manner which will serve the public good; d. assures that the IP will be developed and brought to the marketplace as useful goods and services; and
- d. prohibits the “shelving” or “mothballing”¹¹ of the IP or its use in any illegal or unethical manner.

9.6. AUS will endeavour to Commercialize IP in a manner that enhances local, regional, and national economic development.

9.7. AUS will endeavour to Commercialize IP in a manner that encourages and fosters entrepreneurship by Employees and others, and which supports Commercialization Entities.

ARTICLE 10 - INCENTIVES AND DISTRIBUTION OF REVENUES

1.1. AUS's Incentive Structure

10.1.1. **Purpose and scope.** In the interest of promoting knowledge transfer, AUS will give due consideration to incentives to researchers to foster Research that has socio- economic impact; such incentives may be financial or non-financial. A Creator/Enabler may receive incentives from each IP they created/enabled which is Commercialized.

1.2. Sharing of Revenues

10.2.1. **General.** In line with standard practice of in academic institutions, AUS will include Creators/Enablers in the sharing of monetary benefits that may accrue to AUS from the Commercialization of AUS IP.

10.2.2. **Calculation of revenues for distribution.** Calculation of Gross IP Revenue, IP Expenses, and Net IP Revenue shall be in accordance with the following rules:

10.2.2.1. **Calculation of Gross IP Revenue.** “Gross IP Revenue” is defined in Article 2 as “*all revenue received by AUS for Commercialization of Institutional IP before any cost recovery or deductions for IP Expenses*” and includes, but is not limited to, outright sale of IP, option payments received, licence fees received, evaluation fees received, upfront and milestone payments received, royalty payments received, share of profits received, dividends received, commissions, income through disposal of equity, and direct sale of products or services.

10.2.2.2. **IP Expenses.** “IP Expenses” is defined in Article 2 as “*all expenses incurred by AUS in the management of IP for which Gross IP Revenue has been received*” and includes, but is not limited to, those expenses that relate to (i) AUS expenses incurred by payment to external entities for securing, maintaining, and enforcing IP protection, such as patenting and litigation expenses; (ii) costs incurred by AUS in the licensing/assignment of IP, including marketing costs, contract negotiation, and drafting costs; and (iii) costs in making, shipping or otherwise

¹¹ Shelving or mothballing of academic IP refers to IP and invention disclosure bundles that remain unexplored, unlicensed or unused.

distributing products, processes or services that embody the particular IP, but not including staff time or general administrative costs.

10.2.2.3. Calculation of Net IP Revenue. OVCR shall maintain accurate and transparent documentation of IP Expenses incurred for a particular IP and shall be entitled to cover all IP Expenses it has incurred, as set out in 10.2.2.2 above. The “Net IP Revenue” is calculated as the Gross IP Revenue less IP Expenses.

10.2.2.4. Co-owned IP. Where the IP is co-owned by AUS and an outside organization, the Gross IP Revenue received by AUS will be shared in accordance with a pre-determined formula as per a contractual arrangement. Thereafter, the Gross IP Revenue received by AUS and the Net IP Revenue will be determined, and revenues will be shared in accordance with section 10.2.3.1 and 10.2.3.2 below.

10.2.3. Sharing of revenues – Creators/Enablers

10.2.3.1. Standard Creator’s share. 50% of the Net IP Revenue will be allocated to the Creator. Where there is more than one Creator, the Creators are entitled to an equal or *pro rata* share, based on contribution, of 50% of the Net IP Revenue, except where there is a prior written agreement between all the Creators to the contrary.

10.2.3.2. Standard Enabler’s share. AUS may elect to set aside 10% of the Net IP Revenue for an Enabler. Where there is more than one Enabler, the Enablers are entitled to an equal or *pro rata* share, based on practical contribution, of 10% of the Gross or Net IP Revenue, except where there is a prior written agreement between all the Enablers to the contrary.

10.2.3.3. Disputes. In the event of a dispute or uncertainty regarding the Creators’/Enablers’ share of the Net IP Revenue from a specific IP, the issue shall be brought for resolution to the Office of the Vice Chancellor of Research.

10.2.3.4. Payment. Payment to the Creators/Enablers will be made by the Institution on a periodic basis as agreed in writing, but no later than 12 months after receipt of the Gross IP Revenue by AUS.

10.2.3.5. Entitlement. Creators/Enablers and their heirs will be entitled to IP revenue sharing for as long as AUS receives Gross IP Revenues from Commercialization of the AUS IP.

10.2.3.6. Banking details. The onus is upon each Creator/Enabler to ensure that AUS has their current banking details for the purpose of revenue sharing. AUS will keep the relevant IP revenue amounts in reserve for a maximum period of 3 (three) years after which all rights of Creators/Enablers to receive such payments will be forfeited. If AUS pays an amount into an incorrect account as a result of information supplied to it being outdated or incorrect, AUS will not have any further obligation or liability in respect of such payment, which will be deemed to have been duly and properly made.

10.2.4. Sharing of revenues – AUS. AUS’ share of Net IP Revenue will be allocated as institutional commercialization income to be used at the discretion of the Board of Trustees.

10.3.1. General. As a default position, AUS will refrain from accepting non-monetary benefits for the Commercialization of its IP or from offering incentives other than revenue sharing, unless they are in addition to the revenue sharing as per 10.2.3.1 and 10.2.3.2, as appropriate. AUS will thus give consideration, on a case-by-case basis, to the provision of other incentives, where monetary benefits (revenues) are not available or where the Creator/Enabler elects to choose other benefits *in lieu of* revenue sharing, which may only be realized in due course. Other incentives will include, but are not limited to, the incentives described in Article 10.3.2. – 10.3.4.

10.3.2. **Research funds.** The Institution will actively promote, source and/or facilitate collaborative arrangements with industry partners to secure funding for further Research for the Creators/Enablers.

10.3.3. **Creator/Enabler receiving shares in a Commercialization Entity or other licensee.**

10.3.3.1. In the case where a Creator/Enabler is granted equity in a Commercialization Entity that licences AUS IP which the Creator/Enabler has created, such Creator's/Enabler's portion in the standard revenue sharing formula of Article 10.2.3.1 or 10.2.3.2 will be adjusted accordingly, taking into account the shares held in the company by the Creator/ Enabler. All other Creators/Enablers will be rewarded in accordance with the formula in Article 10.2.3.1 or 10.2.3.2.

10.3.3.2. Where AUS receives shares in a licensee company, which company may be a Commercialization Entity, as consideration for an IP license, the Institution will hold all the shares until liquidation, at which time the income will be considered Gross IP Revenue and the Creators/Enablers will receive their share according to the revenue sharing formula in Article 10.2.3.1 or 10.2.3.2.

10.3.3.3. Notwithstanding the benefit sharing in respect of shares in terms of this Article 10.3.3, the Creators/Enablers will still be entitled to their share of any other revenues under the IP license.

10.3. Contact Details

10.4.1. **Contact details.** The onus is upon each Creator/Enabler to ensure that AUS is in receipt of their current address details for the purpose of revenue sharing. Unless contrary to law, should AUS be unable to locate the Creators/Enablers through reasonable efforts, in order to effect payment of the revenue share amount, and a period of 3 years has passed since an initial attempt, then the portion owed to that Creator/Enabler or his/her heirs will be paid to AUS central fund to be used at AUS's discretion.

ARTICLE 11 - IP PORTFOLIO MAINTENANCE

11.1. **Recording and monitoring.** OVCR shall maintain records of the AUS IP in an appropriate form and in sufficient detail. It shall monitor the deadlines for the payment obligations related to the maintenance or annuity fees of protected IP, and shall, within a reasonable time, inform the person or department designated to make such payments.

11.2. **Accounting.** The OVCR shall maintain income/expense accounting records on each IP so that revenue sharing allocations can be calculated.

ARTICLE 12 - TRADITIONAL KNOWLEDGE AND GENETIC RESOURCES

12.1. When Research is conducted at AUS using TK and/or GRs, provisions of national and international regulations must be observed,¹² which provisions may include prior informed consent, and access and benefit-sharing, and the need to obtain any relevant permits.

12.2. The Institution shall formulate procedures and mechanisms for access to GRs/TK in order to comply with national and international regulations.

¹² For instance, when a member of the Institution needs to access and use GRs for the purpose of the research, or when it is envisaged to share samples of GRs with partners from other countries, the Institution shall abide by the national laws in place and, to its best ability, apply international best practices.

ARTICLE 13 - CONFLICTS OF INTEREST AND CONFLICTS OF COMMITMENT

- 13.1. **Commitment to AUS.** Employees' and Visitors' primary commitment of time and intellectual contributions should be to the education, research and academic programs of AUS.
- 13.2. **Best Interests of AUS.** Employees and Visitors have a primary professional obligation to act in the best interests of AUS; they should avoid situations where external interests could significantly and negatively affect their work ethic and research integrity.
- 13.3. **Agreements with External Parties.** It is the responsibility of all Employees and Visitors to ensure that their agreements with external parties do not conflict with their duties and responsibilities in terms of this IP Policy. This provision shall apply in particular to private consultancy and other research service agreements concluded with external parties. Each individual should make his/her duties and responsibilities clear to those with whom such agreements may be made and should ensure that they are provided with a copy of this IP Policy.
- 13.4. **Disclosure of External Activities and Financial Interests.** Employees and Visitors shall promptly report all potential and existing Conflict of Interest (COI) or Conflict of Commitment (COC) to the appropriate AUS authority, in compliance with applicable COI/COC policies.
- 13.5. **COI and COC Policies.** AUS will develop separate and comprehensive policies on COI and COC in order to increase the awareness of Employees and Visitors about COI and COC; outline requirements for disclosure of COI and COC; and establish procedures to identify them, avoid or properly manage such conflicts.

ARTICLE 14 – DISPUTE

- 14.1. **Violation.** Breach of the provisions of this Policy shall be dealt with under the normal procedures of AUS, and in accordance with the relevant provisions of laws and regulations in force.
- 14.2. **Dispute Resolution.**
 - 14.2.1. Any internal disputes or questions of interpretation arising under this Policy must in the first instance be referred to OVCR for consideration and resolution.
 - 14.2.2. If the matter cannot be resolved by OVCR, then the dispute or question of interpretation must be referred to the Vice Chancellor for Research for adjudication.
- 14.3. **Appeal.** Individuals covered by this Policy shall have the right to appeal the application of any aspect of this Policy to the Chancellor. Decision by the Chancellor regarding appeals related to this IP Policy are final.

ARTICLE 15 – AMENDMENT

- 15.1. **Revision.** This Policy may be amended at any time by a decision of the Board of Trustees and in case of any substantial change in the governing UAE IP laws. In this case:
 - a. all IP disclosed on or *after* the effective date of such amendment shall be governed by the Policy as amended; and
 - b. all IP disclosed *prior* to the effective date of the amendment shall be governed by the Policy prior to such amendment, provided that the provisions of the Policy (as amended) shall apply when appropriate to all IP licensed or otherwise Commercialized on or after the effective date of any such amendment regardless of when the IP is disclosed.

5. Scope/applicability:

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Based on Article (3)

- 3.1. **IP.** This Policy applies to all IP generated at AUS, in particular by Employees, Students and Visitors.
- 3.2. **Background IP.** Upon commencing employment, enrolment or an Appointment, Employees, Students, and Visitors must declare any existing IP they wish to exclude from the application of this Policy due to creation prior to their employment, enrolment or Appointment at AUS.
- 3.3. **Applicability.** This Policy applies to all Employees, Students and Visitors who participate in a Research Project or produce Scholarly Works. Rights and obligations under this Policy shall survive any termination of employment, enrolment or Appointment at AUS.
- 3.4. **Binding effect of the Policy.** This Policy constitutes an understanding that is binding on AUS, Employees, Students and Visitors, once adopted by the Board of Trustees of AUS, on the following grounds:
- 3.4.1. **Employees.** AUS shall ensure that the employment contract or other agreement establishing any type of employment relationship between AUS and Employees includes a provision placing Employees under the scope of this Policy.
- 3.4.2. **Students participating in a Research Project.** AUS shall ensure that Students participating in a Research Project acknowledge, before commencing the project, that they have read and will comply with the provisions of this Policy, according to Article 5.2.
- 3.4.3. **Visitors.** AUS shall ensure that Visitors sign an Appointment agreement before commencing any activity at AUS. Such agreement shall place the
- Visitor under the scope of this Policy and shall make reference to this Policy, a copy of which will be made available to the Visitor.
- 5.4.4. **Informed consent.** A Summary of this Policy shall be included on AUS' website and referenced in AUS' Faculty Handbook. In addition, a reference to this Policy shall be made in both Graduate and Undergraduate Student catalogues or their equivalent. All of the above references shall be in sufficient detail to enable the full text of the Policy to be easily accessed.

6. Responsibilities:

Based on Article (4): Governance and Operation:

4.1. The IP Management Office: Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research

- 4.1.1. **Purpose.** AUS has established the OVCR Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR) to assist AUS in managing and commercializing its IP in a form that will most effectively promote its development and use for economic and social benefit.
- 4.1.2. **Responsibilities.** The responsibilities of the OVCR include, but are not limited to:
- a. Outreach/awareness to Creators;
 - b. Relationship management with Creators;
 - c. IP management;
 - d. Technology marketing and IP contract negotiation;
 - e. IP contract management; and
 - f. IP costs and revenue distribution.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: Article (2) Without prejudice to any applicable laws, in

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this Policy the definitions set out below shall apply:

Appointment. A formal agreement with AUS, which is a prerequisite to participate in or conduct Research, scholarship, creative work, or teaching at AUS.

Author. Any person to whom this Policy is applicable, who individually or jointly with others makes a design, a mark or copyrightable work and who meets the criteria for authorship under the IP laws of the United Arab Emirates.

Background IP. Any pre-existing IP created before the execution of any Research Project, or prior to a Creator becoming subject to this IP Policy, by virtue of Appointment in the case of a Visitor, employment contract in the case of an Employee, or registration in the case of a Student.

Commercialization. Any form of utilization of IP intended to generate value, which may be in the form of a marketable product, process or service, commercial returns, or other benefit to society. **Commercialize** is similarly defined.

Commercialization Entity. A company that has access to AUS IP through any one or more of the available Commercialization modes, to produce new products, processes or services. This can be a spin-off or start-up.

Conflict of Commitment (COC). Any situation in which an individual Employee's or Visitor's primary professional loyalty is not to AUS because the time devoted to outside activities adversely affects their capacity to meet their responsibilities as set out in their employment contract or Appointment, respectively.

Conflict of Interest (COI). Any situation in which real or perceived interests of an individual Employee, Visitor or Student may run counter to the interests of AUS or negatively affect their employment or duties.

Course Materials. All materials used in, or in connection with, and for the purpose of, teaching an education course through the provision of lectures, tutorials, seminars, workshops, field or laboratory classes, assessments, practicum and other teaching activities conducted by AUS; and all IP in such materials.

Creator. Any person to whom this Policy is applicable, who creates, conceives, reduces to practice, authors, or otherwise makes a substantive intellectual contribution to the creation of IP and who meets the definition of 'inventor', 'author' or 'breeder' as generally implied in the IP laws of United Arab Emirates.

Employee. Any person who is under a contract of employment with AUS including academic, research, technical, administrative and adjunct staff, whether full-time or part-time, or on a temporary basis.

Enabler. Any assistants, technicians, and other individuals who have indirectly contributed to the creation of IP by Creators - and as such may not be listed themselves as an author or inventor in terms of statutory intellectual property rights - mainly through the execution of standard tasks or following through on specific instructions, but without whose practical contribution the Commercialization would not have been possible.

Genetic Resources (GRs). "Genetic material of actual or potential value."¹³ Genetic material is defined as "any material of plant, animal, microbial or other origin containing functional units of heredity".¹⁴ Some GRs are linked to traditional knowledge (TK) through their use and conservation by indigenous peoples and local communities, often over generations, and through their widespread use

¹³ Article 2 of the *Convention on Biological Diversity*.

¹⁴ Article 2 of the *Convention on Biological Diversity*.

in modern scientific Research. Examples include medicinal plants, agricultural crops and animal breeds.

Gross IP Revenue. All revenue received by AUS on Commercialization of AUS IP before any deductions for IP Expenses, as defined in Article 10.

AUS IP. IP owned or co-owned by AUS.

Intellectual Property (IP). All outputs of creative endeavour in any field at AUS for which legal rights may be obtained or enforced pursuant to the law. IP may include, but is not limited to:

- a. literary works, including publications in respect of Research results, and associated materials, including drafts, data sets and laboratory notebooks;
- b. teaching and learning materials;
- c. other original literary, dramatic, musical or artistic works, sound recordings, films, broadcasts, and typographical arrangements, multimedia works, photographs, drawings, and other works created with the aid of AUS resources or facilities;
- d. databases, tables or compilations, computer software, preparatory design material for a computer program, firmware, courseware, and related material;
- e. patentable and non-patentable technical information;
- f. designs including layout designs (topographies) of integrated circuits;
- g. plant varieties and related information;
- h. trade secrets;
- i. know-how, information and data associated with the above; and
- j. any other AUS-commissioned works not included above.

Intellectual Property Rights (IPRs). The proprietary rights that may be granted for an invention, mark, design, plant variety, or other type of IP, should the statutory requirements for protection be met to result in a patent, trade mark, registered design or plant breeders' right, respectively.

Invention. Any innovative idea relating to a product, a method of manufacture, or an application of a known method of manufacture leading to a practical solution to a technological problem. **Inventor.** Any person to whom this Policy is applicable, who individually or jointly with others makes an Invention and who meets the criteria for inventorship under the IP laws of the United Arab Emirates.

IP Disclosure Form. The form [provided in Annex A] to be completed by Creators and submitted to IPMO to document their creation.

IP Expenses. All expenses incurred by AUS in the management and Commercialization of IP for which Gross IP Revenue has been received.

IP management office: Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research (OVCR). The administrative unit established in terms of Article 4 responsible for day-to-day management of all IP-related activities of AUS.

Net IP Revenue. Gross IP Revenue less IP Expenses.

Open Educational Resources (OER). Teaching, learning and Research materials that reside in the Public Domain and that have been released under an open license that permits their free use or modification by others.

Plant Variety. A homogenous grouping of plants that can be protected by a form of plant breeder's right such as that defined in the International Convention for the Protection of New Varieties of

Plants.¹⁵

IP Policy. This Intellectual Property Policy of the American University of Sharjah.

Public Disclosure. The communication of information, relating to IP, to external parties. Public Disclosure includes, but is not limited to, disclosure in written or oral form; communication by email; posting on a web blog; disclosure in a news report, press release or interview; publication in a journal, abstract, poster, or report; presentation at a conference; examination of a thesis; demonstration of an Invention at a trade show; or the industrial application of an Invention.

Public Domain. The freely accessible public realm in which works that are not protected by IPRs, either because the rights have been forfeited or because the rights have been expired, are thereby held by the public at large and available for all to use without permission from the Creator or owner.

Research.¹⁶ Any creative work undertaken on a systematic basis in order to increase the stock of knowledge, including knowledge of man, culture and society, and the use of this stock of knowledge to devise new applications. It comprises three activities: basic research, applied research and experimental development.

Research Contract. Any type of agreement between AUS and an external party or research sponsor, concerning Research, which could result in IP being created at AUS. This shall include, but is not limited to, all sponsorships, donorships and collaborations with the external party or research sponsor.¹⁷

Research Project. Any project that forms the basis of Research undertaken at AUS and includes projects undertaken by a Student, under the supervision of an Employee or a Visitor, as part of a research degree program.

Scholarly Works. All copyright works which are the outputs of academic Employees, Students or Visitors, including Research, creative and other outputs in area(s) of his/her expertise. Scholarly Works includes traditional textbooks in print or digital format, journal articles, research bulletins, monographs and other scholarly publications, non-commissioned creative works of art, including music, lyrics, photographs, poetry, choreography, works of fiction, plays, architectural works, sculpture, pictorial and graphic works, motion pictures, and sound recordings. It does not include Course Materials.

Senior Responsible Officer. The person at AUS who has the ultimate decision-making authority regarding IP.

Student. Any student registered for an approved course at AUS.

Substantial Use. Extensive [unreimbursed] use of AUS' resources which include but are not limited to facilities, equipment, human resources or funds, and Background IP that is not publicly available. Not included is routine use of libraries and/or office space.

Trade Secret. Confidential information not publicly available that has commercial value because of its confidential nature, and which the owner has taken reasonable efforts to keep secret.

Traditional Knowledge (TK). A living body of knowledge resulting from intellectual activity in a traditional context, which includes know-how, practices, skills, and innovations. TK embodies the traditional lifestyles of indigenous peoples and local communities and is transmitted from generation

¹⁵ Generally referred to as “UPOV Convention.”

¹⁶ Definition from the [Frascati Manual](#).

¹⁷ For details as to the difference between sponsorships, donorships and collaborations, and how the IP ownership clauses may change, see Article 8.

to generation, often forming part of the cultural and spiritual identity of the community. TK is not limited to any specific technical field, and may include agricultural, environmental and medicinal knowledge. TK also often encompasses knowledge associated with Genetic Resources.

Visitor. Any person who is neither an Employee nor a Student of AUS who engages in work at AUS, including visiting professors, adjunct and conjoint professors, teachers, researchers, scholars and volunteers; and who concludes an Appointment agreement with AUS.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

This policy is working in accordance to the UAE federal policy on Patent protection (UAE Federal Law No.17 of 2002 as later amended by Federal Law No.31 of 2006 on Patent Protection).

Insert copies of IPDF and of policies on COI, COC and Research Administration IP Disclosure Form

(IPDF)

Conflict of Commitment (COC)

Conflict of Interest (COI)

9. Policy history:

Policy on Intellectual property is a new policy initiated to comply with UAE Federal Law No.17 of 2002 as later amended by Federal Law No.31 of 2006 on Patent Protection.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	Policy was initiated	Chancellor
2.0	June 24, 2024	Revised: - Addition of reference to UAE IP laws - Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The IP Management Office, Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research	Tel: +971 6 5154721	research@aus.edu

d. Teach-out Policy – Version 5

Policy Number:	1000UI04	Policy Title:	Teach-Out Policy
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Teach Out Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy governs an institution's responsibility for arranging for students to complete their academic programs in cases where institutions are closed or programs discontinued.

3. Introduction / background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

The discontinuation or suspension of an academic program requires a detailed plan of the procedure used to ensure that all students currently enrolled in the program will have support to continue the program through to degree completion.

If the BOT makes the decision to discontinue a degree program or a degree program is suspended, the university will notify the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation at the earliest possible moment. In cases of discontinuation, the department must submit to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost a clear risk analysis and plan for ensuring that student needs for degree completion will be considered and academic quality will be maintained if the program is phased out, inform students of the decision, and implement the phase-out plan once approved by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and once any concerns and conditions expressed by the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation have been met. The institution may suspend admission to the program during the review process. If a decision is made to discontinue a program, the department will provide a schedule demonstrating that required courses would be scheduled in a manner that allows students to complete the discontinued program as per the proposed plan of study published in the catalog. In support of this schedule the department will provide a plan to ensure that all necessary personnel, equipment, and classroom and laboratory space, will be provided to ensure timely completion. If students enrolled in a program scheduled for discontinuation seek to move to another degree program or transfer to another institution, AUS will provide support through academic advising.

Procedure for Implementing Policy

Program discontinuation or program suspension requests may originate from the academic unit, the dean of the school/college, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Chancellor, or the Board of Trustees (BOT). The originator must provide a clear detailed rationale for the request. Program discontinuation or program suspension requests must be submitted to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost. Reasons for discontinuation or suspension may include, but are not limited to, low enrollment, lack of job opportunities for graduates, or failure to earn accreditation. The

academic unit and/or college/school responsible for the program must develop a complete report. If the program discontinuation or program suspension request originated from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, the Chancellor, or the BOT, then the dean of the college/school responsible must be notified of the request by week 1 of the fall semester and reports must be submitted to the relevant vice Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's office by week 8 of the fall semester. Reports are then forwarded to the Chancellor and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost for preliminary review. If the decision is made to proceed, the University Undergraduate Curriculum Committee or the Graduate Program Committee will review reports as part of the formal review process during the spring semester. The committee makes a formal recommendation to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

If the BOT makes the decision to discontinue a degree program or a degree program is suspended, the university will notify the UAE Commission for Academic Accreditation at the earliest possible moment.

Once a program is discontinued, resources unique to that program (e.g., equipment, facilities and other material) will be repurposed as follows. The college that hosted the program will submit to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost a proposal for repurposing these resources. If not approved, or if any resources remain, then other colleges will be invited to submit to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost proposals for repurposing the remaining resources. Any equipment and other material remaining after this process will be disposed of in accordance with the university's policy on disposal of surplus materials.

5. Scope/applicability:

Not applicable.

6. Responsibilities:

Not applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

CAA: Commission of Academic Accreditation

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Not applicable.

9. Policy History

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
2.0	03.01.2022	General update	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	December 5, 2022	Added paragraph on distribution of resources	CAA
4.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
5.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and

		organization chart in the FHB.	Provost
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10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Dr. James Griffin, Vice Provost, Office of Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Tel: +971 6 515 2769	jgriffin@aus.edu

e. Publications Policy

N.A.

f. Institutional Relations Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	1000AA05	Policy Title:	Institutional Relations
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	Pre-2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	September 09, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

At American University of Sharjah (AUS), institutional advancement is a strategic and integrated approach to cultivating relationships that enhance understanding and secure support from our key constituents. These include VIP Friends of the University, alumni and their families, government representatives, private sector entities, philanthropic organizations, and the broader community. The AUS Board of Trustees has entrusted the oversight of institutional advancement activities to the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA).

2. Purpose:

While various units within the University may engage with external constituencies in pursuit of their respective missions, it is essential that they coordinate with OAAA in all communications where there is potential for financial contributions.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

To ensure consistent and effective collaboration, detailed information about OAAA's role and its interaction with other units is outlined in the Community Engagement Policy. This policy will be circulated to faculty and staff every semester to reinforce the importance of cohesive and strategic engagement with our external partners.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all academic and administrative departments.

6. Responsibilities:

Institutional Advancement Processes

1. Relationship Management and Communication:

Objective: Foster relationships with key constituents, including VIP Friends of the University, alumni and their families, government representatives, private sector entities, philanthropic organizations, and the broader community.

2. Coordination with the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA):

Objective: Ensure all university units coordinate with OAAA in their external engagements, particularly where financial contributions are involved.

3. Distribution and Enforcement of the Community Engagement Policy:

Objective: Ensure consistent understanding and implementation of institutional advancement policies across the university.

4. Documentation and Reporting:

Objective: Maintain thorough records of all institutional advancement activities and ensure transparency and accountability.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

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Community Engagement Policy.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2021	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor
2.0	September 09, 2024	Update on the overall policy	Office of the Chancellor

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

g. Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships Policy – Memorandums of Understanding – Version 4

Policy Number:	1000AP06	Policy Title:	Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships Policy – Memorandums of Understanding
Prepared By:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	Pre-2013
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	April 2027

1. Policy:

Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships - Memorandum of Understanding

2. Purpose:

This document sets out the University's position on when, why, and how Memoranda of Understanding (MOU) are developed.

3. Introduction / background:

MOU's should be entered into with national, international and local partners (recommend after discussion with the Senior Management Team and approved by the Chancellor).

MOU's will be entered into by the University with institutions, organization, clusters, and centers to reflect the development of mutually advantageous strategic areas of interest as well as to consolidate teaching and research networks.

Consequences:

If the MOU formally enters into partnerships, the advice of the University legal firm will be sought prior to any commitment being made by the University.

Policy Dissemination:

International Exchange Office, Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs, Deans, Vice Provosts, Provost, and Chancellor.

4. Policy Statement:

All Memoranda of Understanding (MOUs) representing formal agreements between AUS and external entities must be signed by the Chancellor.

Agreements that are intended solely to build relationships with external entities without binding AUS to specific financial commitments, resource allocations, or other significant obligations may be signed

by the Provost, Vice Chancellors, Deans or Executive Directors of the respective colleges/school or offices within AUS. These agreements include, but are not limited to, letters of intent, cooperative agreements, and partnership frameworks that do not require executive or board-level approval.

Any agreement that may potentially involve significant commitments or liabilities must be escalated to the Chancellor for review and signature.

Procedures:

1. The **AUS Initiating Party** prepares the MOU as per the AUS or external party MOU template.
2. **AUS Initiating Party** corresponds with the external party for review of the draft MOU document.
3. **AUS Initiating Party** sends the MOU draft to the relevant AUS Administrators Involved in the MOU for initial review.
4. **AUS Initiating party** sends the final draft to the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost for review. **The P Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** sends the MOU draft to the Council of Deans members and relevant direct reports, including the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs, for information and feedback. Once the MOU is approved by **the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost**, the final draft is sent to the Office of the Chancellor for final approval.
5. Upon the approval of **the Chancellor**, the MOU is sent by the **Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's Office** to the AUS initiating Party for possible confirmation from the external party and to interested internal parties, including the Director of Strategic Communications and Marketing and the Office of the International Exchange.
6. If the MOU will impact programs of study at AUS then **the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** sends the final draft of the MOU to the Commission of Academic Accreditation (CAA) for approval.
7. If no signing ceremony is planned, the Chancellor signs the MOU and **the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's office** sends it to the external party for their signature. Once the original is received back from the External Party, **the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** records the MOU in the central log and sends the original to the AUS Archives.
8. If a signing ceremony is required, the **AUS Initiating Party (AIP)** coordinates with the external party for possible dates and times. Once possible dates are received, the **AIP** coordinates the dates with the Provost's Office. The Chancellor signs all MOU's so he must be available if signing is to occur at the ceremony. Alternatively, the Chancellor could sign in advance with the signed MOU presented to the external party for signing, as part of the ceremony. The exceptions to this procedure apply to K-12 schools where MOU's are signed by the Executive Director of Enrolment Management.
9. Once the date and time of the signing ceremony has been coordinated between the external party and the AUS Chancellor, the **Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** sends out a communication for possible attendance or action with the dates and times and with a copy of the MOU, for information, to:
 - Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
 - Vice Chancellor for Research
 - Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
 - All Deans
 - Executive Director of Enrolment Management
 - Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs
 - All Vice Provosts
 - Director of Strategic Communications and Marketing
 - AUS Initiating Party
1. If catering is required for the MOU signing ceremony, **the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** will arrange.

2. At the signing ceremony venue, the following will be prepared:
 - 2 copies of the MOU – in leather AUS folders – (by **the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's Office**)
 - AUS banner - (by **Events Management**)
 - Photography (by **Events Management**)
 - Media coverage, if required, (by **Communications and Marketing**)
3. Once the ceremony is complete and both copies of the MOU are signed, the **Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost** records the MOU in the central log and sends the original to the AUS Archives.

* The AUS Initiating Party could be an administrator, staff or faculty member.

Evaluation of Academic Agreements and MOUs:

The following process is used to regularly evaluate the effectiveness of MOUs signed by the university:

1. Establish clear objectives and expected outcomes of the agreement.
2. Assign a team or individual responsible for monitoring and documenting the progress of the MOU.
3. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will review the performance of the MOU against the established objectives and outcomes. This review will be conducted at the end of the second year of the agreement.
4. Assess if the MOU is meeting its objectives and discuss with key stakeholders and the external party to identify areas of improvement, if necessary.
5. Conduct a comprehensive evaluation of the MOU's effectiveness at the end of its term or at points of renewal.
6. Document the findings from the review process and share the report with relevant stakeholders

Template of a standard MOU:
MEMORANDUM OF UNDERSTANDING

This Memorandum of Understanding (hereinafter “MOU”) is entered into by **xxxxxx** and the American University of Sharjah in the United Arab Emirates hereinafter collectively referred to as the “parties”.

Whereas xxxxxx is a (xx);

Whereas American University of Sharjah aims to achieve and maintain pre-eminence as a coeducational institution based upon American models and grounded in the history and culture of the Arab Gulf region.

Now, therefore, the parties hereto agree to cooperate as follows:

I. Purpose

1.1 The purpose of this MOU is to provide a framework of cooperation and facilitate collaboration between the parties, on a non-exclusive basis, in areas of mutual interest in the United Arab Emirates.

II. Areas of Cooperation

2.1 The parties agree to cooperate in the following areas:

- xxxx;
- xxxx;
- xxxx.

III. Communication and Exchange of Information

3.1 The parties shall, on a regular basis, keep each other informed of and consult on matters of common interest, which in their opinion are likely to lead to mutual collaboration.

IV. Implementation Arrangements

When the parties wish to enter into a further specific co-operation (projects, special events etc.) within the framework of the MOU, the parties will sign a separate project- specific agreement, which will stipulate the obligations of the parties with respect to such co-operation. Any project-specific agreement will be concluded and carried out in accordance with this MOU, and will include a provision referring to the MOU, which is applicable to such agreements and the programs / projects resulting there-from.

4.2 In itself, this MOU will not carry any financial obligations for either party.

V. Branding and Communications

5.1 Neither Party shall use the name, logo or trademarks of the other party or any abbreviation thereof, in connection with its business or otherwise without the express prior written approval of the other Party in each case.

5.2 Each party acknowledges that it is familiar with ideals and objectives of the other party and recognizes that its name and logo may not be used in a manner inconsistent with the brand guidelines.

5.3 The Parties agree to recognize and acknowledge this partnership as appropriate. The parties should inform and share all the publications and marketing materials prior to use and/or public display and

take the written approval/signoffs of the each party prior to printing / publication or public distribution.

5.4 Any external communication with the media regarding the partnership from either party should be agreed upon in writing.

5.5 Neither organization shall speak nor make public statements on behalf of the other, nor claim to represent the other, except in specific cases where express agreement is given in writing.

VI. Statutory Compliance

6.1 Each party will cooperate in the activities envisaged under this MOU in accordance with their own internal regulations, rules, and directives. Specific activities envisioned under this MOU that require financial commitments or liabilities of either party will be subject to separate written agreements.

VII. Duration of the Agreement, Termination and Modification

VII.1 This agreement will enter into force for an initial period of xxxxxxxx years, on the date of its signature by the duly authorized representatives of the parties.

VII.2 Either party may terminate the arrangements described in this MOU upon one month's notice in writing to the other party. In the event of termination, the parties will take steps to bring the activities under the MOU to a prompt and orderly conclusion. Activities commenced under separate arrangements concluded under the MOU may also be terminated as agreed between the parties. In the event of breach of any terms of the MOU, it may be terminated without notice.

7.3 This agreement may be amended by mutual consent, provided that one of the parties notifies the other in writing of the proposed amendment.

VIII. Privileges

8.1 Nothing in or relating to this MOU shall be deemed a waiver, expressed, or implied of any of the privileges.

IN WITNESS WHEREOF the representatives of xxxxxxx and AUS do affix their signatures:

American University of Sharjah Name: _____ Designation: Chancellor _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____	xxxxxx Name: _____ Designation: _____ Signature: _____ Date: _____
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Communications in regards to any changes / renewal of this MOU should be done through:

American University of Sharjah Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost _____ Telephone: 9716 5152020 _____ Email: provost@aus.edu _____	XXXXXXXXXX _____ Telephone: _____ Email: _____
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5. Scope/applicability:

This policy applies to all University employees.

6. Responsibilities:

Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

MOU means a written document, signed by the parties to it, confirming the relations being entered into by those parties.

MOU = Memorandum of Understanding AUS = American University of Sharjah

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Template of MOU's to be used at AUS.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	Pre-2013	New policy	Chancellor
2.0	2016	Edited Policy - Due to change in office of responsibility	Chancellor

3.0	April 25, 2024	Edited Policy - Evaluation of Academic Agreements and MOUs has been added - changes have been made to ensure compliance with the MOE standards	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6 5152020	provost@aus.edu

h. Website Policy

This policy covers two policies:

1. AUS Website Policy – Version 10
2. AUS Web Platforms Creation Policy – Version 2

1. AUS Website Policy – Version 10

Policy Number:	1000SM07	Policy Title:	AUS Website Policy
Prepared By:	Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM)	Issue Date:	August 2008
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	SCM - Digital	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	July 9, 2025

1. Policy:

The university is committed to present the best public-facing web platforms, including the AUS website and other digital platforms. This policy offers a guideline on how that goal can be achieved and maintained.

2. Purpose:

Website management is an ongoing task, especially with the rapid evolvments of technologies and digital marketing trends. Therefore, a well-defined policy will aid in deciding how and what to implement in order to fulfill the goals defined in the university's marketing strategy.

Furthermore, a web policy defines ownership of the website, acknowledging that there are many stakeholders. By creating a web policy, American University of Sharjah (AUS) can decentralize the website management, resulting in a more efficient, consistent workflow of website management.

The AUS Web Policy governs the public-facing web platform of AUS. As the AUS web platform continues to develop, this document will be revisited and revised frequently, adapting to the ever-changing experiences and requirements of the university's audiences.

- a. Advantages of the policy: As the university presents itself to the public through public-facing platforms, there is a need to have consistency in the way these web platforms are presented. This will ensure that the look and feel of the university through various channels is consistent.
- b. Disadvantages of not following the policy: Should there be any AUS related web platforms that do not follow the same guidelines, there will be a risk of varying and consistent representation of the university through the different public-facing AUS web platforms.

3. Introduction/background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) website is a primary source of information for many of the university's key stakeholders. For many—including prospective students and their parents—it may be their first introduction to AUS. As such, the university public web presence must provide accurate, clear and consistent information to stakeholders while providing the best user experience possible. As

a key communication tool, the university's public web platform must be developed and managed strategically in order to protect and maintain the reputation of the university.

As the brand guardian for AUS, the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) is charged with managing the university's public-facing web platform (henceforth referred to as the "platform") in order to support the university's mission and vision. This mandate aims to ensure that the platform adheres to high standards of professionalism, accuracy and user experience. It also seeks to ensure security and privacy of AUS internal and external stakeholders, and AUS compliance with international best standards of web management.

5. Scope/applicability:

The scope of this document is any website, application, service or page that is public-facing and accessible by a user through a web browser using http/s or ftp protocols. This includes, but is not limited to, SaaS and cloud-hosted services. It also includes public web platforms that are associated, affiliated, managed or maintained by an AUS staff member, faculty member or student, whether on a full-time or part-time basis, in any official capacity.

This includes but is not limited to:

- i. AUS' main website www.aus.edu, which hosts AUS' public information geared toward marketing (and other purposes).
- ii. HubSpot, AUS' Content Management System (CMS) (info.aus.edu), a marketing platform used for capturing lead and event registration.

This document does not govern social media platforms. For that, please refer to the AUS Social Media policy.

6. Responsibilities:

- i. Brand and Design

To ensure consistency across AUS public web platforms, all design must be consistent with the AUS brand guidelines.

Before going live, all AUS public web platforms should be approved from a brand perspective, in writing by SCM.

To assist in the approval process, please follow the listed guidelines:

AUS Brand

Logo

- a. Only the official AUS logo and its official variations are to be used. This is provided by SCM.
 - b. The logo must be visible across all pages of the platform.
- a. The design must reflect the AUS colors designated in the AUS brand guidelines. These pre-approved color hex codes are:

- Digital Cooperate: #a03021 White: #fff and black: #000
- Light grey color range [#f2f2f2, #5d5d5d, #777, #747070]

The design is limited to two font families from within the same option, as designated by the AUS brand guidelines:

- *Raleway* for header and navigation.
- *Montserrat* for content and body text.

□ The font family option for legacy design and support is:

- *Georgia* for header and navigation
- *Helvetica Neue, Helvetica* or *Verdana* for content and body text.

Design

Basic design principles that must be followed include:

- a. The design must be simple, light and not include conflicting elements.
- b. The layout should be consistent across content types.
- c. The design should be responsive, readable and accessible on hand-held devices.
- d. The design should not incorporate external plugins, such as Adobe Flash, Java or components that require external software to be installed.
- e. The design should be W3C compliant.

ii. Content

To maintain and enhance the university's brand image and institutional reputation, it is imperative that all written web content is of the highest standard and accurately reflects the AUS brand and ethos.

All content must follow the *AUS Editorial Style Guide* that is provided by SCM.

*General Web Platforms**

- a. Written content must not deal with issues of an offensive, confidential or sensitive nature.
- b. Written content must adhere to AUS privacy and security policies.
- c. Written content must comply with the laws of the Emirate of Sharjah and the United Arab Emirates.
- d. To facilitate an optimized user experience, written content must be:
 - current and correct
 - grammatically and technically sound
 - derived from primary, authoritative and credible sources
 - appropriate and tailored for specific audiences (for example, students, parents, researchers or staff)
 - clear, unambiguous and avoiding unnecessary complexity or confusion

** Web platforms that are not under SCM management*

Web Policy

- brief and unduplicated
- in line with SEO best practice
- e. The platform owner is responsible for ensuring that all content, including any hosted digital media, is not in any legal violation of copyright and is credible and truthful.
- f. In sharing content that is not owned by AUS, a visible source must be cited and presented on the same page where the original content is published.
- g. Linking to external sites must adhere to the External Linking.
- h. Content on these platforms must not replicate content on the AUS official public web platform.
- i. The platform owner is responsible for enforcing these guidelines.
- j. SCM reserves the right to issue a takedown order in case of any content violations.

*AUS Official Public Web**

** Web platforms managed by SCM*

- a. The content must follow the content guidelines for General Web Platforms.
- b. All written content will be consistently monitored and maintained by SCM to ensure
- c. Site contributors are responsible for ensuring the accuracy of their content adheres to university standards.
- d. SCM has the authority to remove or change any content that does not meet the necessary standards.
- e. Content owners and contributors are required to notify SCM in advance in case of a mass content creation/migration to the official website or any structural changes to the content.
- f. All content on the platform is subject to SCM approval.
- g. Content linking to external sites is subject to SCM approval and must adhere to the External Linking.
- h. The content should reflect the platform marketing objectives and not to be of a technical or a self-promoting nature. There are other platforms for these types of content.

Content External Linking

External links are any hyperlinks that point to a target/page that is not hosted on the same website/platform. Usage must follow these guidelines:

- a. The link must be direct and cannot be a short link or through a redirection hub, unless it is provided and managed by AUS IT or SCM. This is to avoid dead links.

- b. The target link should be publicly accessible and not behind a registration portal or a pay wall. Registration forms that are approved by SCM are exempted.
- c. The link target site/platform must satisfy AUS privacy and security policies.
- d. The target should not be a replica of the original/source content.
- e. The link target site/platform content cannot be of a competitive nature toward the hosted content of AUS or any AUS organizations or affiliated organizations.
- f. The target platform must be managed by a well-known organization or a global entity.
- g. Linking to sites that are not part of the aus.edu domain and that do not meet the standards in point 7. It requires a written exception from SCM, on a case-by-case basis.
- h. The content author is responsible for ensuring that the content is not linking to a malicious site that violates any section of the Web Policy.
- i. Hyperlinks must be in the following formats:
 - For an aus.edu domain: `<a href="" target="_blank"></a>`
 - For a non-aus.edu domain: `<a href="" target="_blank" rel="nofollow"></a>`
- j. Non-aus.edu external links to a faculty member's own profile site or external organizations are permitted with the following conditions:
 - The link only exists within the faculty profile page.
 - The faculty member is responsible for maintaining the links and for verifying that these links are valid and adhere to the policies and guidelines mentioned in this document.
 - AUS and none of its organizations are accountable for any harm caused by linking to non-aus.edu external sites. The faculty member is solely responsible for the links listed under his/her profile.

Content Copying and Reusability Guideline

Users of the platform can copy content from any page on AUS' platform that does not require authentication/authorization citing the source with a direct link to it on the copied content.

If a department needs to copy/screenshot an internal page (i.e., a page that requires login), SCM approval must be granted.

7. Definition of Stakeholders and End Users

Stakeholders and end users are defined as entities interacting with public web platforms. They can be internal (from within the American University of Sharjah) or external.

Visitors

- a. Visitors interact anonymously to consume the provided information or submit an online form.
- b. The visitor segments being targeted are:
 - prospective students

- current students
- faculty and staff
- parents and guardians
- AUS alumni
- other entities with interest in AUS

Content Contributors

- Content contributors are employed by the university to create digital content.
- Credentials are required for authentication to be able to add content.
- Their assigned username should reflect their AUS username.
- Their content access is limited to the scope of their department, school or college content.
- They must follow the content and copyright guidelines as established in the *AUS Editorial Style Guide*.
- Content provided is subject to approval by SCM and can be changed at any time at the discretion of SCM. Stakeholders will be informed of any significant changes.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The following are guidelines issued by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) to help implement this policy:

- AUS Editorial Style Guide
- AUS Communication Policy

8. Policy history:

As the need for the creation of new web platforms is on the rise, a need also arose to regulate the way these AUS-related web platforms are created. This is the first version of the policy guiding the creation of these platforms. The policy will be revised accordingly when needed.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2009	New Policy	New Website Committee
2.0	March 2013	Edited policy adopting to new development and changes in the website management	Chancellor
3.0	July 2014	Edited policy to include further changes in how the website development was evolving	Chancellor
4.0	July 2017	Updated policy as the website was being revamped into a new Drupal platform	Chancellor

5.0	January 2018	Edited policy to delegate development authority to college web contributors	Chancellor
6.0	March 2020	Updated policy incorporating new development features of the website.	Chancellor
7.0	March 2020	Updated policy incorporating new development features of the website.	Chancellor
8.0	September 2020	Updated policy to adopt to accommodate operational changes during pandemic remote working.	Chancellor
9.0	May 2021	Edited policy to adopt to new changes.	Chancellor
10.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting only	Chancellor

10. References:

This policy was created and is managed and maintained by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing

(SCM). The policies herein are subject to changes and updates at any time.

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Gureni Lukwaro (Digital Marketing Manager)	06 515 2147	glukwaro@aus.edu
Majed Al Chatti (Web Developer)	06 515 2157	malchatti@aus.edu

2. AUS Web Platforms Creation Policy – Version 2

Policy Number:	1000SM08	Policy Title:	Web Platforms Creation Policy
Prepared By:	Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM)	Issue Date:	May 2, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	SCM - Digital	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	July 9, 2025

1. Policy:

The university is committed to showcase its brand through different web platforms for the university and its business units. This policy will guide in the creation and management of the various university web platforms.

2. Purpose:

Web platform management is an ongoing task, especially with the rapid evolvments of technologies and digital marketing trends. Therefore, a well-defined policy will aid in deciding how and what to implement in order to fulfill the goals defined in the university's marketing strategy.

Furthermore, a web policy defines ownership of the platform, acknowledging that there are many stakeholders. By creating a web policy, American University of Sharjah (AUS) can decentralize the website management, resulting in a more efficient, consistent workflow of website management.

The AUS Web Platform Creation Policy governs the public-facing web platforms of AUS. As the AUS web platform continues to develop, this document will be revisited and revised frequently, adapting to the ever-changing experiences and requirements of the university's audiences.

3. Introduction/background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement:

The American University of Sharjah (AUS) website is a primary source of information for many of the university's key stakeholders. For many—including prospective students and their parents—it may be their first introduction to AUS. As such, the university public web presence must provide accurate, clear and consistent information to stakeholders while providing the best user experience possible. As a key communication tool, the university's public web platform must be developed and managed strategically in order to protect and maintain the reputation of the university.

As the brand guardian for AUS, the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) is charged with managing the university's public-facing web platform (henceforth referred to as the "platform") in order to support the university's mission and vision. This mandate aims to ensure that the platform adheres to high standards of professionalism, accuracy and user experience. It also seeks to ensure security and privacy of AUS internal and external stakeholders, and AUS compliance with international best standards of web management.

5. Scope/applicability:

The scope of this document is any website, application, service or page that is public-facing and accessible by a user through a web browser using http/s or ftp protocols. This includes, but is not limited to, SaaS and cloud-hosted services. It also includes public web platforms that are associated, affiliated, managed or maintained by an AUS staff member, faculty member or student, whether on a full-time or part-time basis, in any official capacity.

This document does not govern social media platforms. For that, please refer to the AUS Social Media policy.

6. Responsibilities:

i. Web Platform Creation

Web platform is defined as any website, application, service or page that is accessible by a user through a web browser using http/s and ftp protocols. This includes SaaS and cloud-hosted services.

- a. A clear case and justification for creating the platform is required.
- b. The platform content and services cannot compete with content and services that AUS already provides.
- c. Creation of a new website/platform requires approval from SCM and the IT Department.
- d. Creation of a new section or microsite to be hosted on the AUS official public platform requires SCM approval.
- e. Platform ownership should be identified as a department or organization that is officially part of AUS.
- f. Any web platform that is associated, affiliated, managed or maintained by an AUS staff, faculty or student in any official capacity requires the aus.edu domain and an SSL certificate provided by the AUS IT Department.
- g. Created platforms should follow all the policies and guidelines in AUS Web Policy.
- h. The platform owner is responsible for and accountable for enforcing these guidelines.
- i. SCM reserves the right to issue a takedown order of the platform in case of any misconduct or violations. Content Guidelines.

ii. Privacy and Copyright

a. Privacy

For legal purposes, a privacy policy must be presented on all pages of the website, and it must (at least) cover the following aspects.

- Information collection: The platform might ask the user's information, such as name and email.
- Data logging: The platform might automatically log the user's IP address, time spent on a page and pages visited.
- Cookies: Cookies are files saved on the user's computer that the platform will access in order to gain information.

b. Copying and Reusability

Users of the platform can copy content from any page on AUS' platform that does not require a login with the source material of the content cited and links directly to the copied content. Hosted content cannot be an exact replication.

If a department needs to copy/screenshot an internal page (i.e., a page that requires login), SCM approval must be granted.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Stakeholders and end users are defined as entities interacting with public web platforms. They can be internal (from within American University of Sharjah) or external.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The following are guidelines issued by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) to help in implement this policy:

- a. AUS Web Policy
- b. AUS Editorial Style Guide
- c. AUS Communication Policy

9. Policy history:

As the need for the creation of new web platforms is on the rise, a need also arose to regulate the way these AUS-related web platforms are created. This is the first version of the policy guiding the creation of these platforms. The policy will be revised accordingly when needed.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 2, 2021	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor
2.0	July 9, 2024	Formatting only	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

This policy was created by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) – Events Unit.

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Strategic Communications and Marketing – Gureni Lukwaro (Digital Marketing Manager)	06 515 2147	glukwaro@aus.edu

i. Event Support and Support Services Policy – Version 1

Policy Number:	1000SM09	Policy Title:	Event Support and Support Services Policy
Prepared By:	Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM)	Issue Date:	July 9, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	SCM - Events	Effective Date:	July 9, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date Of Next Revision:	July 9, 2025

1. Policy: Event Support and Support Services Policy is set to make sure AUS Events are delivered according to AUS standards.

2. Purpose: The purpose of this policy is to establish guidelines and procedures for the effective planning, execution, and evaluation of events hosted in AUS. This policy aims to ensure that all events are managed efficiently, safely, and in alignment with the organization's goals and values.

3. Introduction/background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement: The policy suggests guidelines to clients on the best practices for planning and organizing events at AUS. All events need to be registered via an event form, to ensure collecting sufficient data that will make organizing events meet AUS standards.

Event form link: <https://go.aus.edu/forms/event-form>

5. Scope/applicability: This policy applies to all events organized inside and outside AUS, including but not limited to conferences, seminars, workshops, meetings, social gatherings, and virtual events. It encompasses all phases of event management, from initial planning to post-event evaluation.

6. Responsibilities: Event organizer is defined as the client that is responsible for initiating, defining the scope and objectives of the planned event. The client is responsible to inform related units by filling the Event Form and stating details and requirements for their event.

Events Team receives Event Form from Clients, analyse details, requirements and meet with the client for additional details or clarifications. Events Team informs AUS service units defined as Stakeholders of the event requirements and follow up on the execution.

AUS Service units such as Facilities, IT, Security, Safety, Health Centre, Transportation are defined and stakeholders and responsible for providing event services as requested by the Events Team.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Client - Defined as the event organizer / event initiator.

Events Team - Defined as an Event Planner and the intermediary that facilitates interaction between Clients and stakeholders.

Stakeholders - Defined as AUS service provider departments across AUS, such as Facilities, Security, IT, health services communications and media.

Small Scale Events - Requires very little involvement from the events team, held in one location not highly attended, with a duration of one to two hours.

Medium Scale Events - Requires a significant amount of planning and involvement of several stakeholders.

Large Scale Events - Complex event support requirements with a significant number of attendees that take place in multiple locations and days.

Special Events - Characterized as being unique where it's a one-time or infrequently occurring event, not a regular or recurring activity.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Pre-Approval

Clients need to obtain necessary approvals from the Head of the unit / Dean / Director on planned events prior to filling the Event Form. By selecting the YES option, event approval is assumed.

Event Information

Event title, date, time and location need to be actual. Otherwise, an event form should not be filled until Event Information is set.

Event title needs to be specific. For instance, general titles such as "AUS Event" are not accepted.

Venue Reservation

Event Form is not linked with the Room Reservation System (RRS). Clients filling this form are required to log in to RRS and book their rooms separately.

Anticipated number of Audience

The anticipated audience should be close to accurate. It will give the events team and stakeholders an indication of the expected turnout for the event, to take necessary measures accordingly.

AUS President attendance

Confirming the attendance of the AUS President must be done through proper channels, not through anticipations or trends of previous years.

Event sponsored by a third-party organization

This must be pre-coordinated with the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs, as applicable.

Event Description and Website Listing

For listing your event on the AUS website, Click YES only if you want to drive attendance to your event. Private or closed invitation events will not be included in the event listings.

Required text for listing an Event on the AUS Website

Event listings are meant to drive attendance to your event. Please provide engaging text that will help promote the event to your target audience. This should give an overview of the event (short paragraph) and tell readers why they should attend.

Speaker details must include name, title, institutional affiliation and a short biography.

Images added to the event web listing must adhere to the dimensions mentioned in the Event Form. In the case an image is not available when filling the form, Clients may email it separately to content@aus.edu

For events that are not required to be listed on the AUS website

Provide an event description that will help the events team understand the nature and scope of the event, in order to provide better guidance and event support.

Support for your event

Event forms are expected to be received in a timely manner allowing the Events Team and relevant stakeholders sufficient time to execute requested items.

Timelines are as follows:

- Small Scale events: 7 working days
- Medium Scale Events: 14 working days
- Large Scale Events: 30 working days

Note: Events Team reserves the right to reject requested items as per notice time given, availability, delivery location, type of use, potential damages, or for other reasons evaluated by the events team.

Setup:

Requirements added in the Setup section shall be executed by Facilities - Custodial Services. Kindly note the following:

Quantities:

All furniture and non-furniture items requested must be number specific, specifically for tables, chairs, wheel boards, pin boards etc.

Catering and Food displays:

All sorts of tables, tablecloths and chairs are only dedicated for exhibiting and exchange of information.

Setups

Tables and chairs are not meant for food displays nor for any sort of catering service. All catering-related setup must be arranged by the client via the catering provider.

Street Signage:

Due to the high volume of events increasing year after year, moving towards digital and sustainability initiatives, street signage requests will be selective according to its need and events team evaluation.

Street signage will be provided to events that are open to the public (non-AUS guests). This excludes defined number of external guests that the client is in direct contact with.

Street signage will not be provided to closed invitation events where the client is in direct contact with attendees. In this case, client needs to send the google coordinates of the designated parking.

Shifting boundaries:

Approved items can only be shifted by custodial services to buildings surrounding the main plaza and library plaza. For all other buildings, client needs to request for a truck from AUS Transportation.

Events Team will not provide furniture that has a potential of getting damaged or scratched due to shifting and handling.

Portable Stages:

Clients requesting to install a portable stage, are required to share exact dimensions of the desired stage. Length x Width x Height in meters.

Communications and Marketing

The Strategic Communications and Marketing consists of Content, Digital, Creative and Social Media units. They provide event services ranging from media coverage, posters, banners, photography, videography, social media coverage, etc.

Facilities

There are several units under Facilities that provide services to events.

- 1) Civil Services: provides carpentry and installation services, such as hanging banners, stage installation, and other related services.
- 2) Electrical Services: provide electrical connection services, such as power outlets, lighting and electrical connections.
- 3) Audio & Video (AV) Services: provide AV support such as projectors, podiums, wireless and clip on microphones and portable sound systems.

Security and Safety

Responsibilities include providing entry clearance for external guests, parking, gate passes, site inspections, etc.

For issuing gate passes for external guests, clients need to apply for them separately via the Security and Safety online portal.

University Health Services (UHC)

University Health centre is committed to ensure safety of event attendees by providing ambulance service, first aid and on call nurses

Services provided are subject to availability as advised by UHC and according to the event's nature.

IT Support

Once the event form is submitted, requirements will automatically be sent to IT as a Service Desk ticket. Clients will be added to the service desk ticket to communicate directly with IT.

Uploading Documents

Clients may upload additional documents and images that will help the Events Team setting up for the event. Documents can range from floor plans, sketches, agenda, etc.

After submitting the Event Form

Clients will receive a copy of the form displaying all entered data.

Events Team will review details received in the form and respond as follows:

Approve:

All event details submitted are complete as well as sufficient time to perform the requested tasks and item availability.

Request for more information

For all incomplete event details and requirements, the form will be sent back to the Client requesting for more information.

Reject

Events forms can be rejected by the Events Team depending on notice time given, availability of requested items or other reasons that will be stated by the events team upon rejection.

After approval of the Event Form

Events team will start working on sourcing the requested items by communicating with the relevant stakeholders.

Evaluation Feedback

After the completion of the event, post evaluation feedback will be sent to Clients to rate the event form experience and event support provided.

Additional Notes

External Orders of products (such as gift items, flowers, etc.) or services (such as catering or hotel rooms) must be placed through Banner requisitions. If you have any questions, contact the Supply Chain Department at procurement@aus.edu

Sustainability is a priority at AUS. To find out how to make your event comply with the university's sustainability initiatives, please contact sustainability@aus.edu

Room Reservation: Make sure that you have reserved a venue for your event on reserve.aus.edu

It is important to note that all requested items in "Support for your Event" section are subject to availability and confirmation from the relevant stakeholder / service provider.

9. Policy history: This is the first version of the Event Support and Support Services Policy

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	July 9, 2024	New Policy	Chancellor

10. References:

This policy was created by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing (SCM) -Events Unit.

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Strategic Communications and Marketing - Achraf Eldarbi (Events Manager)	06 515 2105	adarbi@aus.edu

j. Visa & Equalization Policy - Version 1

Policy Number:	1000GS10	Policy Title:	Visa & Equalization Services Policies and Procedures
Prepared By:	Office of Protocol & Security Visa & Equalization Services (VES)	Issue Date:	May 21, 2024
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Protocol & Security Visa & Equalization Services (VES)	Effective Date:	May 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chief of Protocol	Date Of Next Revision:	May 31, 2025

1. Policy:

American University of Sharjah's Visa & Equalization Services Department maintains exceptional professional standards in managing visa applications for both Employees and Students. Additionally, VES provide support to faculty and staff in attesting and equalizing their academic credentials whether they completed their study inside or outside UAE. Our commitment is to ensure the delivery of our efficient services, ensuring smooth and transparent processes.

With a focus on integrity and efficiency, VES make sure to provide a welcoming environment for international students, UAE residents, GCC & UAE nationals, who may be employees or students. This enables them to pursue their academic goals—whether studying, teaching, or working—legally and confidently

2. Purpose:

The Visa & Equalization Services (VES) policy at the American University of Sharjah is designed to comply with the regulations of the (ICP) United Arab Emirates Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs & Port Security, along with the Ministry of Education's (MOE) rules and regulations. This policy ensures that all visa applications, as well as academic credential attestations and equalizations, are conducted in accordance with UAE legal requirements. Specifically, this policy addresses:

- Changes in relevant UAE rules & regulations.
- Modifications in the status of AUS departments, such as separations, new hires, replacements, or the creation of new divisions, especially when renewing or changing the signatory representatives in the establishment card
- Any other legal entitlements or responsibilities as mandated by UAE law.

By adhering to these legal standards, the policy ensures that all processes are transparent, efficient, and legally compliant, providing a secure environment for students, faculty, and staff within the American University of Sharjah.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

The Visa & Equalization Services (VES) policy at the American University of Sharjah has been developed through a comprehensive process to ensure compliance with the United Arab Emirates' legal and regulatory framework. This policy reflects the university's commitment to maintaining high

professional standards and providing transparent, efficient services for visa applications and academic credential attestations and equalizations.

Historically, the need for a structured VES policy emerged from the increasing complexity of immigration and education regulations within the UAE. The policy was designed to streamline processes and ensure all university operations adhere to the UAE Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs & Port Security, as well as the Ministry of Education's rules and regulations.

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

4.1 Visa Application Processing:

- Employees must follow all established procedures and protocols when processing visa applications to ensure accuracy, fairness, and compliance with legal requirements.
- The use of discriminatory practices in the evaluation of visa applications is strictly prohibited.
- Employee should not disclose any data or information related to AUS including employees & students to any person (natural or legal), whether inside or outside the university, explicitly or implicitly, regardless of the reasons.
- The use of AUS and governmental electronic systems by employees, whether for issuing visas and residencies or accessing employee files, must be strictly within the scope of their assigned tasks.

4.2 Equalization/Recognition Services:

- Employees must provide equalization/recognition services, guidelines and assistant in a fair and unbiased manner, ensuring all clients receive the same level of service & communications regardless of their educational background or personal characteristics.
- Any form of discrimination in providing services is prohibited.
- Accessing employee files, must be strictly within the scope of their assigned tasks.

4.3 Confidentiality and Data Protection:

- Employees must protect sensitive and confidential client information in accordance with data protection laws and department policies.
- Unauthorized access to or disclosure of confidential information is strictly prohibited.

4.4 Use of Department Resources:

- Department resources, including technology, tools, and facilities, must be used responsibly and for official purposes only.
- Misuse of department resources is prohibited.

4.5 Compliance and Conduct:

- All employees must adhere to the ethical standards.
- Employees are responsible for reporting any violations the supervisors or through the established reporting channels.

5. Scope/applicability: this section should clearly state the target group/ audience and the units/departments or offices affected or entitled to this policy.

This policy applies to:

- **Target Group/Audience:** All employees, dependents, students, visitors & speakers involved in the processing of Government Approvals, visa applications and equalization services.

- **Units/Departments Affected:**

1. **Employee Services (HR):** The HR department is significantly impacted by visa regulations and equalization in various ways, including employees onboarding and off-boarding process. Also, in maintaining records of educational and Equalization/Recognition certificates for future audits.
2. **Office of Enrollment Management (Admissions):** The Office of Enrollment Management can be significantly influenced by the visa department, particularly concerning international students who may require AUS visa sponsorship. Several key areas where the visa department can impact admissions include visa processing time, communication with applicants, and recruitment strategies.
3. **IT Department:** The IT Department can be significantly impacted by the visa and equalization department in various ways. For instance, they might collaborate closely to develop monitoring and reporting tools aimed at tracking visa application processes, equalization of qualifications, and ensuring compliance with data protection regulations. Such collaboration enables them to identify any potential issues or areas for improvement efficiently.
4. **Office of Registrar:** Office of the Registrar: The Office of the Registrar is significantly influenced by the visa department, particularly in institutions such as AUS with a substantial international student body. Here's how this collaboration impacts our operations:
 - **Enrollment Verification:** The Registrar's Office plays a crucial role in verifying the enrollment status of international students, essential for visa applications or renewals. This involves issuing official letters or documentation confirming enrollment status and academic progress.
 - **Graduation Documentation:** Students under AUS visa sponsorship are unable to access official transcripts, diplomas, or other documents until the visa hold is removed and visa is canceled.
 - **Policy Compliance and Updates:** Changes in visa policies or regulations may necessitate adjustments to enrollment or registration procedures to ensure compliance. The Registrar's Office communicates these changes to students and updates their internal processes accordingly.
 - **Inactive Student Status Due to Withdrawal:** Inactive Student Status Due to Withdrawal: Upon a student's withdrawal from enrollment, their status is designated as inactive. Effective communication between the Visa and Enrollment Services (VES) departments and the Registrar is crucial to identify these students and correspond with them regarding their plans and visa status.
5. **International Exchange Office (IXO):** The International Exchange Office can be significantly affected by changes in visa and equalization services, as these directly impact the ability of students, researchers, and faculty to participate in international exchanges:
 - **Visa Processing Time:** Delays or changes in visa processing times can affect the timing of exchanges. If visas take longer to process, students may miss the start of classes or research programs, causing logistical challenges for both the students and the host institutions.
 - **Visa Regulations:** Changes in visa regulations, such as new requirements or restrictions, can impact the eligibility of certain individuals to participate in exchange programs.

5. Responsibilities:

○ Visa Application and Processing:

- Overseeing the visa application process for employees, their families as well as students.
- Ensuring all necessary documents are prepared, submitted, and tracked.
- Liaising with immigration authorities & related governmental entities.

○ Compliance and Legal Requirements:

- Staying updated with immigration laws and regulations in various countries.
- Ensuring AUS policies comply with local immigration & Ministry of Education (MOE) laws.
- Providing legal support and guidance to employees regarding visa & equalization issues.

○ Advisory and Support Services:

- Advising employees on visa types, requirements, and processes.
- Assisting with new visa, visa renewals, visa cancellations, visa transfer, and any other visa services.
- Assist Employees & Students in accessing their electronic copies of Residency & Emirates ID via ICP UAE application, UAE PASS application.

○ Record Keeping and Documentation:

- Maintaining accurate records of all visa-related documents and statuses.
- Ensuring data integrity and confidentiality.

○ Equivalency/Recognition:

- ensures that faculty and staff obtain a certificate of equivalency by the MoE if their qualifications are issued by Higher Education institutions located outside the UAE.
- ensure that faculty and staff obtain a certificate of attestation by the MoE if their qualifications are issued by nationally accredited Higher Education institutions located inside the UAE.
- Maintaining accurate records of all educational & equalization/recognition related documents and statuses.

6. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **(VES):** Visa and Equalization Service
- **(MoE):** Ministry of Education
- **(ICP):** Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs & Port Security
- **Equalization/Recognition:** Degree equalization responsibilities typically involve the processes and procedures for recognizing and validating academic qualifications obtained from foreign institutions. This is essential for individuals seeking employment in the United Arab Emirates.
- **(Attestation):** Degree attestation is the process of verifying the authenticity of educational documents issued by institutions. This ensures that degrees or certificates are genuine and recognized by relevant authorities. In the UAE, degree attestation is crucial for expatriates and citizens who need their educational qualifications for employment, higher education, or other official purposes.
- **(ICPUAE):** The ICP UAE application, often referred to in contexts such as immigration and visa services in the United Arab Emirates (UAE), is an online platform developed by the Federal Authority for Identity, Citizenship, Customs, and Port Security. This application facilitates various services for residents, citizens, and visitors of the UAE.

- **(UAEPASS):** The UAE Pass application is a secure national digital identity platform developed by the United Arab Emirates (UAE) to streamline and enhance the interaction between residents, citizens, and the government.

7. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Student Visa: [Student Visa | American University of Sharjah \(aus.edu\)](https://aus.edu/student-visa)
- Employee Visa & Equalization: [Visa Services | American University of Sharjah \(aus.edu\)](https://aus.edu/visa-services)
- Speaker Approval Form: <https://forms.aus.edu/233531231155849>
- Student Visa Request Form: <https://forms.aus.edu/233101045294849>
- Employee Residency Cancellation Form: <https://forms.aus.edu/241351376497867>
- New Candidate Data Form: <https://forms.aus.edu/223051239752856>
- Visa & Equalization Services Documents: <https://forms.aus.edu/230043205869049>

8. Policy history:

In response to the absence of a policy for VES (Visa and Equalization Services) in the AUS policy manual regarding visa procedures, this new policy has been developed to fill these gaps. It will provide a comprehensive framework for processing residence visas and other related matters. Additionally, this policy will introduce clearer guidelines to ensure consistency and compliance across all relevant processes.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	May 21, 2024	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor

9. Reference:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of Protocol & Security: Visa & Equalization Services (VES)	Tel: +971 6 515 2117	ves@aus.edu

11. Community Engagement

a. Community Engagement Policy

This policy is presented by a number of policies:

1. Community Engagement Policy - Version 2
2. Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy – Version 3
3. On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion Policy – Version 3
4. Policy on accepting Donations – Version 3
5. Sponsorship Policy Requests Emanating from Academic Units – Version 3

1. Community Engagement Policy - Version 2

Policy Number:	1100AA01	Policy Title:	Community Engagement Policy
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	April 07, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

This policy is presented by a number of policies:

1. Community Engagement Policy.
2. Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy.
3. On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion Policy.
4. Policy on accepting Donations.
5. Sponsorship Policy Requests Emanating from Academic Units.

The University is committed to serving its broader community through mutually productive relationships with partners and stakeholders within the external community.

2. Purpose:

- c. AUS recognizes that community outreach has always been an essential element of its mission. This policy is intended to clarify how AUS is actively engaged in seeking ways to benefit our community and to enhance our presence as a force for good in our broader environment. This is done through myriad volunteer projects, training programs and workshops, student leadership development and athletic programs, and the cultivation of partnerships with friends and donors.

3. Introduction / background (optional): NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The purpose of this policy is to outline the University's commitment to serving its broader community through mutually productive relationships with partners and stakeholders within the external community. The University acknowledges its responsibility as a corporate citizen to contribute to the common good within the Emirate of Sharjah, the UAE, and the region as a whole. AUS also acknowledges the manifold benefits of outreach activities for the sustained vitality of the University

itself. For the external community, outreach activities must provide access for AUS's many stakeholders to the human and material resources of the University. For the AUS community, outreach activities must provide experiential, educational, professional, and scholarly benefits through productive relationships within the external community and through material support for the operation of the University in the form of scholarships, sponsorships, gifts, and endowments.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy highlights the role each unit of the University, both academic and administrative, plays to identify external partners and outreach opportunities that are consistent with and supportive of that unit's purpose within the institution.

This of course applies with the understanding that all leads and activities of sponsorships are to be coordinated with the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs.

6. Responsibilities:

The Chancellor, Provost, and AUS Senior management, the Colleges and School, academic Departments, and major administrative units are understood to have many external constituencies, both public and private, which are replete with opportunities for fruitful engagement. As the University matures, such relationships will inevitably grow in number and complexity.

It is likewise understood that academic and administrative units may and, as occasion warrants, inaugurate relationships with external bodies in the normal pursuit of their respective missions. It is also normal that external parties will in the course of events approach individual University units as opportunities for collaboration arise over time.

Where such relationships have potential for resulting in a financial contribution or sponsorship, internal units have the duty to communicate such relationships to OAAA in a timely manner where OAAA will take the responsibility of cultivating such external partners.

It is also the responsibility of OAAA to facilitate and expedite such communications to ensure that these relationships are optimized and productive, that any potential competing interests between University units and external parties are accommodated and mediated, and that any misunderstandings and confusions are avoided. OAAA is explicitly responsible for facilitating communications between internal units and external parties, and particularly with encouraging and sustaining contacts between internal units and members of the alumni body, advisory groups, and our widespread donor communities.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms: NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The policy of the On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion could be consulted for more details about coordinating efforts on how requests, from non-University entities, carry out marketing promotions activities on-campus.

9. Policy history:

This policy has been introduced in April 2014. A review cycle have been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 7, 2014	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor

2.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Office of the Chancellor
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10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

2. Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy - Version 3

Policy Number:	1100SE02	Policy Title:	Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy
Prepared By:	Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Issue Date:	April 2020
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Office of Student Affairs /Student Engagement and Leadership Department	Effective Date:	June 13, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	June 13, 2026

1. Policy:

Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to ensure that fundraising activities conducted by or through Community Service and Outreach (CSO) are in line with the mission and goals of AUS and are consistent with the laws and legal requirements of the United Arab Emirates (UAE). The policy further aims to set guidelines for accepting, documenting and presenting donations generated from fundraising activities.

3. Introduction / background: z

This policy has been developed to ensure that fundraising activities conducted by or through CSO are in accordance with the laws and legal requirements of the UAE. CSO partners with UAE accredited charitable organizations for its fundraising activities.

4. Policy Statement:

CSO strives to promote mutually beneficial partnerships that respond to community needs and expand student understanding of voluntary work and their roles in the society. Through fundraising, CSO aims to support charities and link students with the various needs of the society.

CSO aims to ensure that high standards of integrity are maintained in its fundraising activities and with those that are conducted through CSO by student organizations officially recognized by the university. Every effort is made to ensure that all donations are documented, well accounted for and presented to the intended beneficiaries in a timely manner.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy covers all fundraising activities conducted by or through the CSO, fundraising activities by OSA-registered student organizations including the Student Council and other student organizations recognized by an AUS school/college.

6. Responsibilities:

- CSO – review and approve proposals for fundraisers, monitor fundraising activities, control and safekeeping of coupons, tickets and cash donations, liaise between AUS and UAE charitable organizations and oversee the counting and documentation of cash donations.
- SELD – deposit cash donations to the AUS Charity Account through the AUS branch of Sharjah Islamic Bank and request the Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience (AVCSE) for the disbursement of funds to the appointed beneficiary.

- AVCSE - approve disbursement of funds and request Finance Department to release the funds to the appointed beneficiary.
- Student Organizations and Student Council – submit fundraising proposals to CSO, remittance and accounting of cash donations with CSO and request disbursement of funds to beneficiary.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- UAE – United Arab Emirates
- AUS – American University of Sharjah
- AVCSE – Acting Vice Chancellor for Student Experience
- SELD – Student Engagement and Leadership Department
- CSO – Community Service and Outreach
- OAAA – Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs
- OSCM - Office of Safety and Crisis Management
- Fundraising - for the purpose of this policy, fundraising is defined as any activity that is aimed at generating funds and obtaining in-kind support for charitable purposes locally or internationally. Fundraising includes the following activities:
 - Appeal for cash donations, goods, services and discounts from the AUS community, commercial entities and individuals.
 - Sale of goods
 - Ticket sales for food fests, musicals and concerts
 - Space rental or charging participation fees
 - Appeal for sponsorship

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Ethical Guidelines:

CSO does not endorse any product or services of donors or sponsors.
 CSO does not engage in game of chance such as raffle draws and lotteries to raise funds.
 Fundraising will be truthful and indicate the intended use of donated funds.
 Donations shall be used for their intended purpose.
 CSO shall respect the privacy and dignity of fundraising beneficiaries.
 CSO shall honor donor's request for anonymity.
 AUS staff, student volunteers and any third party involved in fundraising shall act with fairness and integrity.
 Donations will be acknowledged through charity tickets and official receipts for major donations.

Beneficiaries:

Fundraising activities are intended to benefit and support AUS charity initiatives.
 Other than AUS, only UAE recognized charitable organizations can be appointed as beneficiaries.
 Charitable organizations outside the UAE are subject to the approval of Emirates Red Crescent.
 There must be a branch of Emirates Red Crescent in the country where the charitable organization is located.

Procedures and Guidelines:

- Proposal - student organizations wishing to conduct fundraising activities must submit a proposal to CSO. The proposal must include the purpose of the fundraising, details of activities, target amount, method of fundraising and the name of the beneficiary. Fund raising to support

other countries for calamities and natural disasters can only be proposed once Emirates Red Crescent initiates a similar campaign.

- Review and Approval - CSO will review the proposal and approve those that comply with the policy. Approvals are limited to proposals whose purpose is to raise funds for legitimate charitable purposes, those that promote and enrich community and voluntary work amongst students and those that aim to provide funding for AUS charity initiatives and projects.
- Marketing Materials - posters, announcements and other marketing materials are subject to the review and approval of CSO before they can be posted or published.
- Venue - fundraising must be conducted in the designated area only. Door-to-door appeals for cash donations across the campus is not allowed.
- Sale of Goods and Merchandise – goods that are being sold must not violate trademarks or copyrights. For merchandise with a value of more than AED 1,000, SCO will provide the initial funds to procure the merchandise through the AUS Procurement Department. This process will take at least 3 weeks. Any merchandise with printed artwork is subject to the approval of CSO or by the Strategic Communications and Marketing Department if AUS appears in the artwork. The initial funds provided with CSO must be returned after the fundraising activity. Any leftover goods or merchandise must be turned over to CSO for safekeeping.
- Sponsorships – for commercial entities sponsoring fundraising activities or charitable events and are participating on campus, necessary approvals are required before they can take part in the event. Approval is needed from OAAA if they are conducting activations or with the Office of Safety and Crisis Management OSCM if they are food-related and serving their food products to the AUS community.
- Space rental or participation fees – commercial entities who are not event sponsors but are participating in a charitable event must pay space rental fees or participations fees. Prior approval is required from OAAA or from the OSCM before they can settle the fees and participate.
- Ticket Sales – ticket sales for charity musicals and concerts are controlled by pre- numbered tickets in booklets. Performers, bands, singers, poets, artists etc. must obtain approval from the Office of Protocol before they can perform at AUS.
- Cash - for cash donation appeals, the coupon method must be used for tracking and control. CSO will issue pre-numbered coupons that can be used for the fundraising. The student organization must keep accurate financial records and remit all cash donations to CSO at the end of the day.
- Revenues – all revenues must be remitted to CSO at the end of the day. The cash and coupons will be counted in the presence of a representative from the student organization, a CSO staff and a student volunteer. Once the cash and coupons tally, the cash will be deposited to the AUS Charity Account through the AUS branch of Sharjah Islamic Bank on the same day or the next working day and a receipt provided with the exact amount. For class-related/educational fundraising activities approved by the concerned college/department, CSO can receive the cash donations and SELD will deposit the cash to the AUS Charity Account and a receipt will be provided with the exact amount. SELD will request the AVCSE for the disbursement funds to the appointed beneficiary. Once approved by the AVCSE, the request will be forwarded to Finance Department for payment processing. This process takes 8 working days.

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 2020	New Policy	CSO/SELD
2.0	May 2023	Edited Policy – updated position titles	Executive Director of Student Experience

3.0	June 13, 2024	Edited Policy – updated position titles, department titles and acronyms	Office of the Chancellor
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10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Director of Student Engagement and Leadership	Tel: +971 6 515 4771	hismail@aus.edu
Community Service and Outreach Manager	Tel: +971 6 515 2794	aisha@aus.edu

3. On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion Policy– Version 3

Policy Number:	1100AA03	Policy Title:	On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion Policy
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	April 07, 2014
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1.Policy:

Third Party On-Campus Brand Activation and Promotion policy refers to all such activities and communications that have the intent of promoting or marketing a non-University product, service, event, and/or organization in accordance with AUS Policies and Procedures.

2.Purpose:

- a. The purpose of this policy is to coordinate the activities pertaining to Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion on campus and ensure it is well coordinated and managed across the University. The responsible department is also in charge of assessing the brand association of those companies to avoid any reputational risk for the University.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

As part of the University's strategic direction to build mutually beneficial external relationships, the American University of Sharjah (AUS) recognizes the potential sources of revenue, or other non-monetary benefits, by way of allowing entities operating within both the public, and private sectors to carry out appropriate promotion campaigns for the purpose of promoting their brands, products and/or services on campus. AUS had adopted the following policy applicable to the offering of promotion campaigns to non-University entities. It must be emphasized that the University's reputation, image and strategic objectives must be always protected at all times.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy defines how requests, from non-University entities, carry out marketing promotions activities on-campus. Brand association accepted by the University and the evaluation criteria of handling those requests are defined in the procedures document related to this policy.

6.Responsibilities:

The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) will be responsible for implementing the policy in collaboration with other units including the Office of Strategic Communication and Marketing, Office of Student Affairs, Finance & Administration, and the Events Management Department. Any dispute about this policy or its application must be referred to OAAA.

7.Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8.Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The policy of Community Engagement could be consulted as it is the policy pertaining to organizing outreach efforts within the University.

9. Policy history:

This policy has been introduced in April 2014. A review cycle have been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 07, 2014	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor
2.0	December 15, 2017	Revised	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10.References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

4. policy on accepting Donations – Version 3

Policy Number:	1100AA04	Policy Title:	Policy on accepting Donations
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	February 22, 2009
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

The University is committed to ensure that fundraising with individuals, corporations, foundations and occasionally governments, do not compromise its educational purpose. The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs is responsible for fundraising activities of the University.

2. Purpose:

- d. The purpose of this policy applies to the framework for the acceptance and management of donations whether cash, in kind, bequests, and some grants where there is an intention to give and the transfer of all right, title and interest in the property is to the American University of Sharjah (AUS).

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

AUS depends upon the generosity of alumni and friends to support its mission, programs, and purposes. Contributions, donations, or gifts from benefactors to further the purpose of AUS must be solicited, accepted, processed, recorded, and acknowledged in a manner that protects its benefactors and the institution. AUS has created the position of Executive Director for Advancement and Alumni Affairs, to coordinate solicitations of funds and outright gifts to the University. The Executive Director for Advancement and Alumni Affairs is responsible for carrying out AUS's resource development priorities, as specified by the Board of Trustees in consultation with the Chancellor.

5. Scope/applicability:

This policy defines how the American University of Sharjah strives to ensure that donations and developmental funds do not compromise its educational purpose; donor requirements and restrictions are acceptable to the University; all funds received must be credited to the correct account and deposited; donations will be accepted and administered in a manner appropriate for a tax-exempt educational institution; and that gifts and other transfers of money or property will be acknowledged promptly.

6. Responsibilities:

The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) is responsible for implementing the policy and responsible for the University's ethical framework and ensuring the policy is embedded in the life and work of the University through the procedures and guidelines, which govern and inform the conduct of donations. Any dispute about this policy or its application must be referred to OAAA.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The Sponsorship Policy could be consulted as it is the policy pertaining to both seeking and providing sponsorship activities within the University.

9. Policy history:

The 'Policy on Accepting Donations,' which was approved by the Board of Trustees in its plenary session on February 22, 2009 (Board Policy Number: 2009 BOT – 231) has been updated to reflect

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the new name of the Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) and the new title of the Head of the Advancement and Alumni Affairs, namely, the Executive Director of Advancement and Alumni Affairs. It also makes explicit the possibility that buildings may be named after donors who pay the entire cost of construction.

A review cycle have been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	February 22, 2009	Revised	Board of Trustees and Chancellor
2.0	December 29, 2017	New Policy	Board of Trustees and Chancellor
3.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Board of Trustees and Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

5. Sponsorship Policy for Requests Emanating from Academic Units – Version 3

Policy Number:	1100AA05	Policy Title:	Sponsorship Policy for Requests Emanating from Academic Units
Prepared By:	OAAA	Issue Date:	April 04, 2018
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	OAAA	Effective Date:	June 25, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	January 30, 2025

1. Policy:

The University is committed to the development of its external environment by building mutually productive and sustainable strategic relations with key partners and stakeholders, as it recognizes the mutual benefits of sponsorship of AUS events and initiatives by a non- University entity.

2. Purpose:

- e. The purpose of this policy is to coordinate the sponsorship solicitation efforts across the University. The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) is the custodian of the policy to ensure that all matters pertaining to sponsorship is well coordinated and managed across campus.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

NA

4. Policy Statement: (Detailed)

The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA) has been delegated the authority to coordinate solicitations of funds and outright gifts to the University under the AUS Policy on Accepting Donations as approved by the University's Board of Trustees.

Certain decision-making and administrative functions related to this policy may be delegated by OAAA to other University offices or entities upon appropriate application to, and approval by, OAAA or its designee.

OAAA must be notified of any potential or actual sponsorship opportunities and sponsorships must be coordinated with the Office.

This policy shall be implemented in line with all relevant University approved policies and procedures.

Any dispute about this policy or its application shall be referred to OAAA. This policy shall be reviewed and revised as needed.

5. Scope/applicability:

As part of the University's strategic direction to build mutually beneficial external relationships, the American University of Sharjah (AUS) recognizes the mutual benefits of sponsorship of AUS events and initiatives by a non-University entity.

To ensure effective and efficient implementation of this policy, the University expects all employees to adhere to the sponsorship course of action outlined in this policy.

AUS is an academic institution that strives for academic excellence and prominent positioning among top peer academic institutions, as well as within the community; therefore, the University's reputation, image and strategic objectives must be considered.

This policy covers sponsorship funding provided by non-University entities.

6. Responsibilities:

Academic Units:

- Shall draft sponsorship requests and proposals
- Responsible for establishing sponsorship priorities in accordance with college/school/University objectives
- Shall attend meetings with prospect sponsors as arranged by OAAA
- Shall deliver on sponsorship commitments
- Responsible for preparing post-event reports demonstrating the fulfillment of AUS commitments towards the sponsorship. This shall include, but not limited to, event photographs, samples of collaterals produced for the event, and any announcements made on the media showcasing the association with the sponsor, and demonstrating the success of the event.

Office of the Provost:

- Responsible for reviewing and approving sponsorship agreements
- Shall evaluate school/college sponsorship requests
- Responsible for establishing sponsorship priorities in accordance with the University's academic mission
- Shall collaborate with OAAA to agree upon the sponsorship allocation committed by OAAA for a specific fiscal year
- Shall disburse funds to academic units.

Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs:

- Responsible for evaluating sponsorship viability of every request and confirming if the amount required by the academic units can be secured
- Shall review and update sponsorship requests as required
- Shall commit to the Office of the Provost an annual lump sum budget to support academic initiatives
- Shall develop list of prospects for each sponsorship request
- Shall send out, assign resources to handle, and follow up on sponsorship requests
- Shall attend meetings with prospect sponsors as arranged by academic units
- Responsible for updating academic units on sponsorship solicitation status
- Responsible for drafting sponsorship agreements forms
- Shall request Finance to issue invoices
- Shall follow up with sponsors on payment.

Finance:

- Shall issue invoices as requested by OAAA
- Shall provide monthly update to OAAA on the status of the pending invoices.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

NA

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

The Policy on Accepting Donations is the overarching policy that governs the solicitation and fundraising efforts across campus.

9. Policy history:

This policy has been introduced in April 2018. A review cycle have been implemented for the policy to be reviewed every 3 years.

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	April 04, 2018	New Policy	Office of the Chancellor

2.0	June 03, 2018	Revised	Office of the Chancellor
3.0	June 25, 2024	General Update on the Format of the Policy	Office of the Chancellor

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
The Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs (OAAA)	Tel: +9716 515 2022	oaaa@aus.edu

b. Advisory Boards Policy – Version 3

Policy Number:	1100UI06	Policy Title:	Advisory Boards
Prepared By:	Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction	Issue Date:	January, 2022
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	• Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction • Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

Advisory Boards Policy

2. Purpose:

This policy ensures that degree programs at AUS incorporate feedback from a program specific advisory board as part of their continuous program assessment.

3. Introduction / background (optional):

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

Each degree program at AUS has an advisory board that:

- Consists of external members who are considered stakeholders in the program
- Meets at least once a year
- Provides feedback to the program on areas such as curriculum and employment Advisory board members are appointed by the dean and require approval from the Provost. Minutes from the advisory board meetings must be maintained in the relevant department.
- Feedback from advisory boards must be considered by the program in its continuous assessment cycle.

5. Scope/applicability:

All undergraduate and graduate degree programs at AUS.

6. Responsibilities:

Department heads / program coordinators are responsible for arranging regular meetings with the program advisory board and considering the feedback provided by the board as part of the assessment cycle.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Not applicable.

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Not applicable

9. Policy history

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	January 2022	New Policy Created	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs	Tel: +971 6 5152281	vpus@aus.edu
Vice Provost for Graduate Studies	Tel: +971 6 5154721	ogs@aus.edu

c. Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning Policy – Version 4

Policy Number:	1100AP07	Policy Title:	Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning
Prepared By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Issue Date:	June 21, 2021
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Effective Date:	June 24, 2024
Approved By:	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Date Of Next Revision:	May 2026

1. Policy:

The University aims to provide educational opportunities to lifelong learners who want to enhance their skills and knowledge, display mastery in the core competencies of their areas of specialization, stay ahead of the competition, and who want to communicate clearly, think critically and solve problems creatively.

2. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to provide a framework for utilizing and/or reporting institutional resources in a manner that is aligned with the guiding principles of the AUS Strategic Plan, and to demonstrate to executive education's many audiences the quality and productivity achieved in its programs.

3. Introduction/Background:

Not applicable.

4. Policy Statement:

The function of Executive Education is carried out by all four colleges through the appointment of Executive Education main contact. The role of the Executive Education main contact is to:

- Serve as the focal point of contact, across each AUS College/school, for all executive and professional education requests by clients for custom programs
- Develop new open enrollment courses that are aligned with the University's academic and faculty expertise and interests, and be consistent with the mission of AUS
- Establish new courses/programs as per the requirements and demands of the market (i.e. blended-learning and distance-learning deliveries)
- Be responsible for the design, development and delivery stages of all executive and professional education courses/programs on a sustainable framework of operations, without placing undue burden on faculty members or detracting from the ability of the University to deliver on its primary mission of undergraduate and graduate education.
- Create a revenue stream for AUS and the academic Colleges/School, with courses/programs offered on a cost recovery basis

- f. Minimize liability and financial and reputational risk of AUS from such activities, by taking into consideration the mission of AUS, the long-term interests of its key stakeholders, and the interests of the broader community and region.
- g. Forward the AUS brand as a leader in executive education in the wider regional and, in the long run, in the international market, by creating courses/programs that utilize all specialties and expertise across each of the AUS Colleges/School.

Executive Education (Exec Ed)

Executive Education refers to high-level stand-alone courses and programs (defined as bundles of courses) for executives, leaders and managers that are non-credit and non-degree-granting, including Professional Certificates and Diplomas. They offer a fine balance between academic rigor and practical application in the real world, in order to develop new knowledge, functional, technical and managerial skills, competence and attitudes.

Contracts outlining coaching and education activities provided to four (4) or more individuals which encompass a significant instructional component are considered teaching and should be conducted as Executive Education Programs.

Custom Programs

Education programs that are designed (tailor-made) and carried out on behalf of, and at the request of, a client organization. Participants in custom programs are employees of the client organizations. Custom clients contract directly with the respective college Executive Education contact and are financially responsible for the cost of the program. Their delivery can take place either at the client's premises or at the AUS.

Blended/Distance Learning Programs

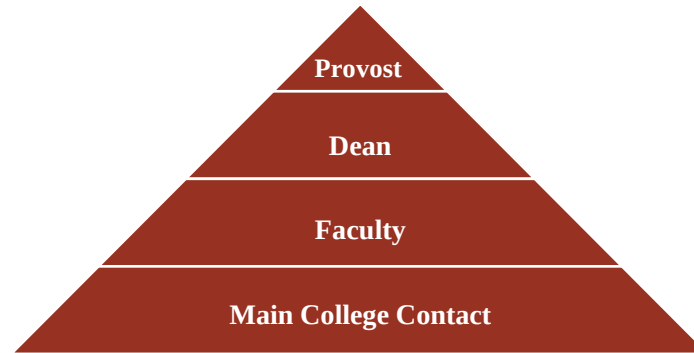
Education programs that provide the participant with the option to partially (blended-learning) or fully (distance-learning) study remotely in front of a computer with the use of an e-Learning Management System. They offer the convenience to professionals with an active work schedule that may also involve frequent travels to study at their own pace and from their own location.

Executive Education General Operations

The following are some of the main responsibilities that should be covered by each college/school when executing an executive education program:

1. Communicate and work with all relevant AUS non-academic units for the successful delivery of the courses/programs:
 - Office of Strategic Communications & Marketing (SC&M) – promote all programs in order to create awareness
 - Office of Academic Computing – to provide technical support for online program delivery
 - Other AUS units as deemed necessary
2. Oversee all course/program logistics and administrative duties from design to delivery, including:
 - Logistics: schedule classrooms, arrange catering (if needed), campus parking for participants, name tags, pre-course communication with participants and client(s), printing of course materials, computers, internet resources, and others as required
 - Administrative: maintain all Executive E-related documentation (including forms, proposals, contracts, financials, operating budget, internal reports, marketing material, and contract database, and others as required)

The hierarchical chart below reflects the flow of authority amongst faculty administrators involved in Executive Education.



5. Scope/applicability:

To ensure that the University is able to carry out its instructional responsibilities to students and to conduct scholarly activities and perform services to society and the University community, the Office of the Provost expects the adherence to this policy by all affected constituents (faculty, staff, students, as appropriate).

6. Responsibilities:

Executive Education responsibility is shared between faculty and administrators as applicable.

7. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

Exec Ed: Executive Education

8. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

Executive Education Custom Contract Template (Appendix VIII)

9. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	20.06.2021	Creation of a new policy	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
2.0	May 2023	Revised – No Changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
3.0	June 4, 2024	Appendix VIII has been updated – No changes	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost
4.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

10. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Tel: +971 6-5152020	provost@aus.edu

Appendices

Appendix I. Bylaws of the Governing Body

<i>Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasimi</i> <i>Supreme Council Member</i> <i>Ruler Of Sharjah</i>	بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ سُلْطَانُ بْنُ مُحَمَّدٍ الْقَاسِمِي عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد حاكم الشارقة
Decree of Law Number (3) of 2023	مرسوم بقانون رقم (٣) لسنة ٢٠٢٣ م
Concerning The Reorganization of the American University of Sharjah	بشأن إعادة تنظيم الجامعة الأميركية في إمارة الشارقة
We, Sultan bin Mohammed Al Qasimi, Ruler of the Emirate of Sharjah,	نحن سلطان بن محمد القاسمي حاكم إمارة الشارقة،
having reviewed Law Number (2) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Executive Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof;	بعد الاطلاع على القانون رقم (٢) لسنة ١٩٩٩ م بشأن إنشاء المجلس التنفيذي لإمارة الشارقة ولائحته الداخلية وتعديلاته،
Law Number (3) of 1999 concerning the establishment of the Consultative Council of the Emirate of Sharjah, its bylaw, and its amendments thereof;	والقانون رقم (٣) لسنة ١٩٩٩ م بشأن إنشاء المجلس الاستشاري لإمارة الشارقة ولائحته الداخلية وتعديلاتهما،
Law Number (3) of 1998 concerning the establishment and organization of the American University of Sharjah, its executive regulations, and amendments thereof;	والقانون رقم (٣) لسنة ١٩٩٨ م بشأن إنشاء وتنظيم الجامعة الأميركية في إمارة الشارقة ولائحته التنفيذية وتعديلاتها،
Amiri decree (53) of 2023 Regarding the Formation of the Board of Trustees of American University of Sharjah;	والمرسوم الأميري رقم (٥٣) لسنة ٢٠٢٣ م بشأن تشكيل مجلس أمناء الجامعة الأميركية في إمارة الشارقة،
based on the proposal of the President of the American University of Sharjah and the approval of the Executive Council; and	وبناءً على عرض رئيس الجامعة الأميركية بالشارقة وموافقة المجلس التنفيذي،
Upon public interest,	ولما تقتضيه المصلحة العامة،
have decreed the following Law:	رسمنا بالقانون الآتي:



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasimi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

سُلطان بن محمد القاسمي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

Article (1)

Definitions

In applying the provisions of this Decree of Law, the following terms shall have the meanings ascribed to each respectively, unless the context requires otherwise:

State	: The United Arab Emirates.
Emirate	: The Emirate of Sharjah.
Ruler	: The Ruler of the Emirate.
University	: American University in the emirate of Sharjah.
Board	: University's Board of Trustees.
President	: President of the University and the chairperson of the Board.
Chancellor	: Chancellor of the University.

المادة (١)

التعريفات

في تطبيق أحكام هذا المرسوم بقانون يُقصد بالكلمات والعبارات التالية المعاني المبينة قرين كل منها ما لم يقتض سياق النص خلاف ذلك:

الدولة:	دولة الإمارات العربية المتحدة.
الإمارة:	إمارة الشارقة.
الحاكم:	حاكم الإمارة.
الجامعة:	الجامعة الأميركية في الإمارة.
المجلس:	مجلس أمناء الجامعة.
الرئيس:	رئيس الجامعة والمجلس.
المدير:	مدير الجامعة.

Article (2)

Legal Personality

The University is a non-profit, academic, and scientific institution conferred the legal personality and legal capacity to fulfill its objectives and carry out its competences, shall be financially and administratively independent and shall be fully owned by the Emirate's Government.

المادة (٢)

الشخصية الاعتبارية

الجامعة مؤسسة علمية أكاديمية غير ربحية، تتمتع بالشخصية الاعتبارية والأهلية القانونية اللازمة لتحقيق أهدافها وممارسة اختصاصاتها، ويكون لها الاستقلال المالي والإداري وتعود ملكيتها بالكامل لحكومة الإمارة.



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Article (3)

The Campus

The University's main campus shall be located in the city of Sharjah and may, by a resolution of the President, establish branches inside or outside the Emirate.

المادة (٣)

المقر

يكون المقر الرئيس للجامعة في مدينة الشارقة ويجوز بقرار من الرئيس إنشاء فروع لها داخل الإمارة أو خارجها.

Article (4)

Values

The University is based on the principles and values of equality, justice, fellowship, tolerance, happiness, and sustainable development, all being part of the values of the State and the society, and the University shall promote such values in all its programs, bylaws, policies, and activities in accordance with the State law.

المادة (٤)

القيم

ترتكز الجامعة على مبادئ وقيم المساواة والعدالة والإخاء والتسامح، والسعادة والتنمية المستدامة باعتبارها جزءاً من قيم المجتمع والدولة، كما تعمل الجامعة على تعزيز هذه القيم في جميع برامجها ولوائحها وسياساتها ونشاطاتها على ضوء التشريعات السارية في الدولة.

Article (5)

Objectives

The University aims to achieve the following objectives:

1. balanced development of the University students' personality, knowledge and abilities, and to prepare human competencies trained in theory and practice to meet the requirements of the State's comprehensive development plans.
2. sponsor and encourage scientific researches to achieve scientific development and to service the community and to grow and develop it for the better.
3. Launch and develop higher education programs according to the University's policies and plans that are based on the needs of the community, to achieve scientific excellence.

المادة (٥)

الأهداف

تهدف الجامعة إلى تحقيق ما يأتي:

١. تحقيق النمو المتوازن في شخصية الطلبة الدارسين في الجامعة ومعارفهم وقدراتهم، وإعداد الكفاءات البشرية المدربة نظرياً وتطبيقياً لتلبية متطلبات خطط التنمية الشاملة في الدولة.
٢. رعاية البحوث العلمية وتشجيعها بهدف تحقيق التطور العلمي وخدمة المجتمع وتنميته وتطويره نحو الأفضل.
٣. طرح برامج للتعليم العالي وتطويرها بما يحقق التميز الأكاديمي، وفقاً لسياسة الجامعة وخططها المبنية على احتياجات المجتمع.



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4. strengthen cultural and scientific ties with other universities, institutes of higher education, and Arab and foreign academic organizations.
5. provide the necessary care and create a suitable environment for the University students, faculty members and administrative staff of different nationalities and to encourage them to excel, create and innovate.
6. contribute to the community service and to respond to and interact with its needs by forming partnerships with government and private agencies.

٤. توثيق الروابط الثقافية والعلمية مع الجامعات الأخرى ومعاهد التعليم العليا والهيئات العلمية العربية والأجنبية.
٥. توفير الرعاية اللازمة للطلبة الدارسين وأعضاء الهيئتين التدريسية والإدارية في الجامعة من مختلف الجنسيات، وإيجاد البيئة المناسبة لهم وتشجيعهم على التميز والإبداع والابتكار.
٦. الإسهام في خدمة المجتمع من خلال تكوين الشراكات مع الجهات الحكومية والخاصة، والاستجابة لاحتياجات المجتمع والتفاعل معها.

Article (6)

University Presidency

The presidency of the University shall be assumed by a President, appointed by an Emiri Decree, who shall be the chairperson of the Board and may delegate all or some of his/her powers in the Board to other Board members.

المادة (٦)

رئاسة الجامعة

يتولى رئاسة الجامعة رئيس يصدر بتعيينه مرسوم أميري ويكون رئيساً للمجلس، وله أن يخول غيره من أعضاء المجلس في كل أو بعض صلاحياته في المجلس.

Article (7)

Management of the University

1. The University shall be managed by, each in his/her field of competence and in accordance with the provisions of this Decree of Law and its executive regulations:
 - a. The President.
 - b. The Board.
 - c. The Chancellor.
 - d. The Board of Deans.

المادة (٧)

إدارة الجامعة

١. يتولى إدارة الجامعة كلٌّ في مجال اختصاصه وفقاً لأحكام هذا المرسوم بقانون ولائحته التنفيذية:

- أ. الرئيس.
- ب. مجلس الأمناء.
- ج. مدير الجامعة.
- د. مجلس العمداء.



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasbi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

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عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

2. The executive regulations of this Decree of Law shall prescribe the duties and competencies of the titles specified in clause (1) of this Article.

٢. تُنظّم اللائحة التنفيذية لهذا المرسوم بقانون مهام واختصاصات الجهات المحددة في البند (١) من هذه المادة.

Article (8)

Authorities of the President

The President shall, in particular, assume the following duties and authorities:

1. chairmanship of the Board.
2. nominating the Chancellor and submitting the same to the Board for approval.
3. approving the appointment of vice chancellors and deans.
4. issuing bylaws to organize the operation of the University and its academic, administrative and financial activities.
5. issuing organizational decisions.

المادة (٨)

اختصاصات الرئيس

يتولى الرئيس على وجه الخصوص المهام والصلاحيات الآتية:

١. رئاسة المجلس.
٢. ترشيح تعيين المدير ورفعته للمجلس للاعتماد.
٣. اعتماد تعيين نواب المدير والعمداء.
٤. إصدار اللوائح التي تنظم عمل الجامعة ونشاطاتها الأكاديمية والإدارية والمالية.
٥. إصدار القرارات التنظيمية.

Article (9)

Formation of the Board

The Board shall be formed by a resolution of the President and shall be constituted of not less than (9) members, and for the purpose of reorganization under this Decree of Law, the new Board of the University shall be formed by an Emiri Decree of the Ruler.

المادة (٩)

تشكيل مجلس الأمناء

يُشكّل المجلس بقرار من الرئيس وبعدد لا يقل عن (٩) أعضاء، ولأغراض إعادة التنظيم بموجب هذا المرسوم بقانون يُشكل المجلس الجديد للجامعة بمرسوم أميري من الحاكم.



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasbi
Supreme Council Member
Chancellor Of Sharjah

سُلطان بن محمد القاسبي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

Article (10)

Chancellor

1. The Chancellor shall be appointed by a resolution of the President after such appointment is approved by the Board. The Chancellor shall be responsible before the President in carrying out his/her duties. The Chancellor's salary and other financial and in-kind privileges shall be determined by the President.
2. If the position of the Chancellor becomes vacant, the President shall have the authority to appoint an acting Chancellor for a term that shall not exceed one year.

المادة (١٠)

المدير

١. يُعيّن المدير بقرار من الرئيس بعد اعتماد المجلس، ويكون مسؤولاً في ممارسة أعماله أمام الرئيس ويُحدد الرئيس راتبه وامتيازاته المالية والعينية الأخرى.
٢. إذا شغر منصب المدير يُخوّل الرئيس باختيار مدير بالإنابة وذلك لمدة لا تتجاوز عاماً واحداً.

Article (11)

Chancellor's Authority

The Chancellor shall, in particular, assume the following duties and authorities:

1. heading all the administrative and academic staff of the University.
2. implement the policies of the Board to ensure the advancement of the University and the appropriate conduct of its business and development of its activities.
3. undertake all tasks and activities that are required for the performance of his/her duties and responsibilities to achieve the continuous development of the University, however, taking into consideration the laws and regulations in force, and the resolutions and directives issued by the President and the Board.

المادة (١١)

صلاحيات المدير

يتولى المدير على وجه الخصوص المهام والصلاحيات الآتية:

١. يرأس كافة موظفي الجامعة الإداريين والأكاديميين.
٢. يتولى تنفيذ سياسة المجلس لتسيير أعمال الجامعة وتطوير أغراضها والارتقاء بها.
٣. يقوم بكافة الأعمال والنشاطات التي يراها فاعلة لأداء واجباته ومسؤولياته لتحقيق التنمية المستمرة للجامعة، وذلك بمراعاة القوانين واللوائح السارية والقرارات والتوجيهات التي يصدرها الرئيس والمجلس.



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasbi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

سُلطان بن محمد القاسبي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

4. preside over the public academic events and represent the University before all external parties and may delegate whomever he/she deems fit for this latter purpose.
5. report to the President and the Board on the activities, events and operation of the University.
6. delegate part of his/her duties and authorities to vice chancellors, assistant chancellors, directors of departments and competent employees of the University.
7. any other duties or authorities assigned to him/her by the President.

٤. يرأس المناسبات الأكاديمية العامة ويمثل الجامعة أمام كل الأطراف الخارجية ويجوز أن ينتدب من يراه لهذه الغاية الأخيرة.
٥. يرفع التقارير للرئيس والمجلس عن نشاطات وقضايا وأعمال الجامعة.
٦. تفويض غيره من نواب ومساعدتي المدير ومدراء الإدارات والموظفين المختصين بالجامعة ببعض صلاحياته واختصاصاته.
٧. أي مهام أو صلاحيات أخرى يكلفه بها الرئيس.

Article (12)

Colleges, Institutes, Centers, and Scientific Institutions of the University

1. The University includes colleges, institutes, and research, learning and training centers, and scientific institutions determined by resolutions issued by the President pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board.
2. All the affairs of the University, its colleges, institutes, and its academic, administrative, financial and community centers and departments, shall be subject to the laws and regulations in force in the State.

المادة (١٢)

كليات ومعاهد ومراكز الجامعة ومؤسساتها العلمية

١. تتكون الجامعة من كليات ومعاهد ومراكز أبحاث وتعليم وتدريب، ومؤسسات علمية تُحددها القرارات التي تصدر من الرئيس بناءً على اقتراح المدير وموافقة المجلس.
٢. تخضع الجامعة بجميع كلياتها ومعاهدها ومراكزها وأقسامها الأكاديمية والإدارية والمالية والمجتمعية في كافة شؤونها للأنظمة والتشريعات السارية في الدولة.



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasbi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

سُلطان بن محمد القاسبي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

Article (13)

Degrees

The University grants certificates of scientific, academic, professional and honorary degrees to those who are eligible according to the provisions of this Decree of Law and the regulations issued pursuant thereto.

المادة (١٣)

الشهادات

تمنح الجامعة شهادات بالدرجات العلمية والأكاديمية والمهنية والفخرية لمستحقها وفقاً لأحكام هذا المرسوم بقانون واللوائح الصادرة بموجبه.

Article (14)

Language of the University Teachings

- Teaching at the University shall be in both Arabic and English, depending on the nature of the approved study programs.
- The Board may approve other languages for teaching or training at the University if so required by the nature of the approved curriculums.

المادة (١٤)

لغة التدريس في الجامعة

- يكون التدريس في الجامعة باللغتين العربية والإنجليزية وذلك وفق طبيعة البرامج الدراسية المعتمدة.
- يجوز للمجلس اعتماد بعض اللغات الأخرى في التدريس أو التدريب في الجامعة إذا استلزم ذلك طبيعة بعض البرامج الدراسية المعتمدة فيها.

Article (15)

Financial Resources

The University's financial resources shall consist of the following:

- Government allocations.
- The revenues generated through the University's activity, for example:
 - tuition fees and the fees charged for services provided by the University.
 - proceeds of the investment of the University's immovable and movable assets.
 - proceeds of the sale or licensing of patents, copyrights, designs, trademarks and inventions owned by the University or

المادة (١٥)

الموارد المالية

تتكون الموارد المالية للجامعة مما يأتي:

- المخصصات الحكومية.
- الإيرادات الذاتية للجامعة نتيجة ممارسة اختصاصاتها، ومنها على سبيل المثال:
 - الرسوم الجامعية ومقابل الخدمات التي تؤديها الجامعة.
 - ربح استثمار أموال الجامعة الثابتة والمنقولة.
 - عائدات بيع أو ترخيص براءات الاختراع، وحقوق التأليف والنشر، والتصاميم، والعلامات التجارية



Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasbi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

سُلطان بن محمد القاسبي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

- which the University has the right to dispose of.
- d. gifts, bequests, donations, and endowment resources that are consistent with the University's activity and approved by the Board.
- e. any other resources approved by the Board.

- والاقتراعات التي تملكها الجامعة أو لها حق التصرف فيها.
- د. الهبات أو الوصايا والتبرعات والموارد الوقفية التي تتفق مع نشاط الجامعة ويوافق عليها المجلس.
- هـ. أي موارد أخرى يوافق عليها المجلس.

Article (16)

Budget and Fiscal Year

1. The University shall have a budget independent from the budget of the Government of the Emirate, which shall be approved by the President pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board.
2. The University's fiscal year shall begin on the first of September of each year and shall end on the thirty-first of August of the following year.
3. The Board shall determine the financial rules and accounting systems of the University and all its financial affairs in accordance with the internationally recognized accounting principles and standards.

Article (17)

Exemptions

The University's assets are public assets and, except the consumer fees, are exempted from all forms and types of local government taxes and fees. The University shall be exempted from customs duties on all its imports.

المادة (١٦)

الموازنة العامة والسنة المالية

١. تكون للجامعة موازنة مستقلة عن موازنة حكومة الإمارة يعتمدها الرئيس بناءً على اقتراح المدير وموافقة المجلس.
٢. تبدأ السنة المالية للجامعة في الأول من سبتمبر من كل عام وتنتهي في الحادي والثلاثين من أغسطس من السنة التي تليها.
٣. يُحدد المجلس القواعد المالية والنظم المحاسبية للجامعة وكافة أعمالها المالية وفقاً للأصول والمعايير المحاسبية المتعارف عليها دولياً.

المادة (١٧)

الإعفاءات

تُعتبر أموال الجامعة أموالاً عامة، وتُعفى من جميع الضرائب والرسوم الحكومية المحلية بكافة أشكالها وأنواعها باستثناء الرسوم الاستهلاكية، كما تُعفى من الرسوم الجمركية على جميع مستورداتها.



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Article (18)

Acquization of Real Estate and Assets

The University shall have the right, by a resolution of the President following an approval of the Board, to acquire real estate and movable assets of all kinds, to invest in all areas permitted under the laws and regulations in force, to establish commercial companies, hold shares, or manage businesses as well as the right to exercise all required legal actions.

المادة (١٨)

تملك العقارات والأصول

يحق للجامعة بقرار من الرئيس بعد موافقة المجلس تملك العقارات والأصول المنقولة بكافة أنواعها والاستثمار بكافة المجالات المسموح بها وفقاً للنظم والتشريعات السارية، ولها كذلك تأسيس الشركات التجارية أو المساهمة بها أو إدارتها، ولها ممارسة كافة التصرفات القانونية اللازمة لذلك.

Article (19)

Executive Orders

The President shall, in implementation of this Decree of Law, pursuant to a proposal by the Chancellor and the approval of the Board, issue the following resolutions:

المادة (١٩)

القرارات التنفيذية

تنفيذاً لأحكام هذا المرسوم بقانون يصدر الرئيس بناءً على عرض المدير وموافقة المجلس القرارات الآتية:

1. Executive Regulations of this Decree of Law.
2. Academic Regulation Bylaws.
3. Faculty Members Affairs Bylaws.
4. Non-Academic Employees Affairs Bylaws.
5. Granting Bachelor's Degree Bylaws.
6. Scientific Research Bylaws.
7. Higher Studies Bylaws.
8. Students' Disciplinary Bylaws.
9. Scholarship Bylaws.
10. Financial Bylaws.
11. Procurement Bylaws.
12. Any other bylaws or regulation orders.

١. اللائحة التنفيذية لهذا المرسوم بقانون.
٢. لائحة التنظيم الأكاديمي.
٣. لائحة شؤون أعضاء الهيئة الأكاديمية.
٤. لائحة شؤون الموظفين من غير أعضاء الهيئة الأكاديمية.
٥. لائحة منح درجة البكالوريوس.
٦. لائحة البحث العلمي.
٧. لائحة الدراسات العليا.
٨. لائحة ضبط سلوك الطلبة.
٩. لائحة الابتعاث.
١٠. اللائحة المالية.
١١. لائحة المشتريات.
١٢. أي لوائح أو قرارات تنظيمية أخرى.



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حاكم الشارقة

Article (20)

Accreditation and Auditing

1. The University shall be subject to the requirements and standards of institution licensing and program accreditation of the Ministry of Education and may expand its set of accreditations from other authorities.
2. The Board shall appoint an external auditor, and the President may seek the assistance of local government authorities to carry out auditing tasks.

المادة (٢٠)

الاعتماد المؤسسي والرقابة

١. تخضع الجامعة لمتطلبات ومعايير الترخيص المؤسسي والاعتماد البرامجي من قبل وزارة التربية والتعليم ولها توسيع مجموعة من الاعتمادات الخاصة بها من الهيئات الأخرى.
٢. يُعين مجلس الأمناء مدقق حسابات خارجي، ويجوز للرئيس أن يستعين بالجهات الحكومية المحلية للقيام بأعمال الرقابة.

Article (21)

Transitional Provisions

This Decree of Law supersedes, the afore-mentioned, Law No. (3) of 1998, provided that all executive regulations, bylaws and orders issued pursuant thereto shall, until they are amended or repealed, continue in effect to the extent they do not conflict with the provisions of this Decree of Law.

المادة (٢١)

الأحكام الانتقالية

يحل هذا المرسوم بقانون محل القانون رقم (٣) لسنة ١٩٩٨م المشار إليه، على أن يستمر العمل بكافة الأنظمة واللوائح والقرارات التنفيذية الصادرة بموجبه وبما لا يتعارض مع أحكام هذا المرسوم بقانون إلى أن تُعَدَّل أو تُلغى.

Article (22)

Notifying the Consultative Council

The Consultative Council of the Emirate shall, immediately when convenes, be notified of this Decree of Law.

المادة (٢٢)

تبلغ المجلس الاستشاري

يُبلغ المجلس الاستشاري للإمارة بهذا المرسوم بقانون فور انعقاده.

Sultan Bin Mohamed Al Qasimi
Supreme Council Member
Ruler Of Sharjah

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

سُلطان بن محمد القاسمي
عضو المجلس الأعلى للإتحاد
حاكم الشارقة

Article (23)

Effective Date and Promulgation

This Decree of Law shall come into effect on the date of its issuance, shall be enforced by the concerned authorities, each in their jurisdiction, and shall be published in the Official Gazette.

المادة (٢٣)

النفاذ والنشر

يُعمل بهذا المرسوم بقانون من تاريخ صدوره، وعلى الجهات المعنية تنفيذه كل فيما يخصه، ويُنشر في الجريدة الرسمية.

Issued by us on:

Thursday: 23 of Muharram, 1445 AH

Corresponding to: 10th of August, 2023

صدر عنا بتاريخ:

الخميس: ٢٣ محرم ١٤٤٥ هـ

الموافق: ١٠ أغسطس ٢٠٢٣ م



سلطان بن محمد القاسمي
حاكم إمارة الشارقة

Sultan bin Mohammed Al Qasimi
Ruler of the Emirate Sharjah

Appendix II. Policy Development, Document Control, Review and Dissemination

Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)

Responsibilities: Below are the main responsibilities of all parties involved in the process of reviewing and/or developing a policy/procedure.

The responsibilities of the owner /Chief of Area:

- Launching the regular review process and take the decision whether the policy/procedure needs to be review or it will continue as-is.
- In case of regular review, if the policy/procedure does not require any change, the owner has to submit the policy/procedure review request form informing the leadership with their decision regarding the review of the policy/procedure.
- When the unit/department initiate an ad-hoc policy/procedure review, the unit head is responsible for approving or rejecting the internal request of policy/procedure review or development related to their unit/department.
- After the initial internal approval (either ad-hoc or regular review), the owner or unit/department head call a Collaborative Working Group from all unit(s)/department(s) involved in reviewing, developing or implementing the policy/procedure to produce a consolidated policy draft with its procedure(s) and fill in the policy/procedure review request form.
- Making sure that the Collaborative Working Group has conducted a diligent and comprehensive research regarding changes to the policy/procedure or developing a new policy/procedure.
- Submitting the policy/procedure review request form, the policy draft, relevant procedures and other associated documents (such as related regulations, Frequently Asked Questions document, related forms or surveys) to the Review Committee/Policy Advisory committee or the governance unit (or equivalent to that at the AUS).
- The owner shall be the authority for policy/procedure document interpretation. If the policy/procedure has more than one owner, the policy/procedure should clearly identify the party who would be authorized for interpretation and resolving any potential conflict on the understanding of the policy.

The responsibilities of Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA) in the process of reviewing and developing a policy. OIRA is responsible for:

- a. Providing advice and guidance to the unit/department planning a review of a policy/procedure on regular scheduled reviews, on ad-hoc basis or developing a new policy/procedure.
- b. Reviewing the proposed policy/procedure in terms of its content and consistency with the AUS Template.
- c. Assessing the proposed amended policy/procedure within the overall context of AUS policies/procedures to prevent any duplication or contradiction of content.
- d. The OIRA should approve the proposed policy before submitting it to the Review Committee (PAC). Signature of the OIRA Director is mandatory.
- e. The OIRA director is participating in the committee meeting to review the policy proposal and all associated documents.
- f. The OIRA director or a representative will make sure that all feedback from involved parties have been incorporated within the draft submitted to the final review.

The Chancellor Responsibilities:

- a. The Chancellor may request a review of any policy/procedure when needed outside the normal schedule.
- b. Approving or rejecting the policy/procedure review or development based in the final proposal discussed by the review committee.
- c. The Chancellor (or designee) will send the final approved copy of the Policy/Procedure to OIRA.

The responsibilities of the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee:

It is the Policy Advisory Committee or the Governance Unit (or the equivalent available at the AUS). The composition of the review committee should include the owner of the policy, the initiator of the reviewed/new policy, representatives of the team responsible for the implementation of the policy, representatives from the relevant area Chief's office (Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, or Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration).

It is responsible for:

- a. Reviewing the policy/procedure proposal submitted by the owner. The committee ensures the discussion of the policy was conducted in a way that protects the rights of all stakeholders to be part of the process.
- b. Evaluating the objectives and goals of the policy to make it consistent with the strategic objectives and goals of the AUS
- c. Sending the proposal after review to the Collaborative Working Group for feedback and comments.
- d. Submitting the proposed policy/procedure to Chancellor for approval or to seek BOT approval.

Specific procedure: The specific steps for developing new policy/procedure or reviewing as existing one is basically started at the office of the policy owner, or it might start at the office of the Chancellor or Area Chief who can initiate a policy/procedure review request or new policy/procedure development request. There are main three pathways of reviewing a policy/procedure:

I. Regular review:

- a. The owner is responsible for reviewing the policy/procedure. Each policy/procedure has a reviewing date. It could be each two years or three years depends on the policy/procedure.
- b. The owner starts the reviewing process (6 months or a proper period to be agreed upon) before the reviewing date; so that at the time of reviewing deadline, the process should be completed and the policy/procedure is ready for recommended action).
- c. The owner should examine the policy and its associated documents such as procedures, manuals, appendices, and FAQs after considering comments that have been gathered as feedback from different stakeholders through different mechanisms such as meetings, helplines, comments, claims and so on.
- d. The owner will call for Collaborative Working Group from his unit and any other unit that is involved in the review, implementing or affected by the policy/procedure.
- e. If the Collaborative Working Group recommends to keep the policy/procedure as is, the owner(s) of the policy will fill in the policy/procedure review form and submit it to the OIRA for approval. At this stage the policy/procedure review form will stop at this level. It will not be submitted to the higher level.
- f. If the Collaborative Working Group recommends that the policy/procedure needs amendments, they all work collaboratively to develop a policy/procedure proposal to amend the existing document (policy/procedure).
- g. The owner would meet with the rest of their units/departments to finalize the policy/procedure review document that will be attached to the standardized policy/procedure review request form.
- h. The Standard Operating Procedure (SOP) developer should send a draft to the Collaborative Working Group for review. They can make sure that the language is clear, can be easily followed, and can be completed successfully. The team should test the document to ensure that it would achieve the desired outcome after incorporating relevant edits and suggestions to improve the document.
- i. The owner will submit the proposal to the OIRA for final review before present it at the Review Committee meeting (Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit or what is equivalent).
- j. After OIRA's approval, a finalized form and the associated documents will be sent to the Review

Committee for review.

- k. The Review Committee will discuss the policy/procedure review document, if approved, the proposal will be disseminated and officially published in the university website.
- l. If the Review Committee rejected the policy/procedure final document, the owner must wait for 6 months before making another request. The owner has the chance to address the comments of the committee and change the policy/procedure proposal accordingly.

II. Ad-hoc review of policy/procedure:

- a. Any unit/office/department may initiate a policy/procedure ad hoc reviewing by sending an internal request to the relevant Area Chief (Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration or the Chancellor).
- b. If the internal request is submitted to an Area Chief, the latter should have preliminary discussion with the Chancellor about the proposed policy/procedure. The Area of Chief is expected to provide a brief conceptual framework of the policy/procedure to the Chancellor to have tentative approval/permission to proceed with the ad hoc review process.
- c. The preliminary discussion with the Chancellor is crucial and essential for introducing significant edits/amendments of an existing policy/procedure.
- d. Significant edits/amendments of policy/procedure may vary, including, but not limited to, requiring new financial resources to any department/unit; reassigning of other units' resources; alteration of any responsibilities or tasks; or restructuring of any units/departments.
- e. If the internal request is rejected by the relevant Area Chief or rejected as a result of the subsequent discussion with the Chancellor, the unit must wait for 6 months before making another request.
- f. Suggestions by the Area Chief or the Chancellor will not be considered a rejection and will allow the owner to proceed with reviews once the edited request is approved.
- g. After the relevant Area Chief and the Chancellor approve the policy/procedure proposal in principle, they may authorize the initiating department/unit to complete a policy/procedure draft for internal discussion (within the department/unit/area).
- h. Once a draft is finalized, the document owner or the Area Chief will call for a meeting inviting units and departments involved in the policy/procedure review, development or implementation for discussion and comments.
- i. The policy owner is encouraged to contact OIRA at any point during the process for guidance. Should the owner have any question or enquiry regarding the policy review process or content, they should communicate with OIRA for early guidance. Earlier assistance of OIRA would enable a more effectiveness review process.
- j. Once a draft is developed and discussed within the Collaborative Working Group, a revised-if-needed policy/procedure draft, policy review request form and associated documents should be submitted to OIRA for review and approval.
- k. For academic policy/procedure, the owner or/and the Provost may share the draft policy with the Council of Deans for comments and feedback. This step must come prior to the submission of the document to the Review Committee.
- l. After the policy/procedure proposal is reviewed and approved OIRA, the policy/procedure owner must submit the proposal to the Review Committee (Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) and pursue a meeting with the Review Committee/PAC or equivalent.
- m. The policy owner shall submit the policy draft proposal along with the policy review request form, and all associated documents within a period of one month to the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS).
- n. The Review Committee will discuss the policy/procedure proposal in the next scheduled meeting. The discussion outcome must evaluate whether the proposal is properly developed (if new) or whether it properly addressed any policy/procedure issues (for reviews).
- o. If the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) approves the policy/procedure proposal, they will send the proposal to the Collaborative Working Group for final feedback and comments. Feedback and/or comments

must be sent to the Review Committee/PAC within 20 working days (four weeks).

- p. At the end of the four weeks period, all comments will be reviewed by the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS). Once there is no further drafting needed, the proposed policy/procedure and any supporting documents will be submitted to the Chancellor for approval.
- q. If the Review Committee disapprove the policy/procedure review document, the owner must wait for 6 months before making another request. The owner has the chance to address the comments of the committee and change the policy/procedure proposal accordingly.
- r. For reviews of policies/procedures that require the approval of the Board of Trustees, the proposal, an approved review request form and all associated documents should be submitted to the next BOT meeting.
- s. The policies/procedures require the approval from the Board of Trustees (BOT), if they met any of the following criteria:
 - i. If the policy/procedure has significant fiscal implications on AUS.
 - ii. If the policy/procedure involves the BOT in any way.
 - iii. If the policy/procedure has significant legal or institutional risk.
 - iv. If the Chancellor deems the policy or procedure requiring BOT approval.
- t. Should the Review Committee/PAC, Area Chief or Chancellor find that the proposed document meets any of those conditions, the final draft document is submitted, along with any supporting documents, to the BOT Audit and Compliance Committee (ACC) for review and comment, a month prior to the Review Committee meeting.
- u. A representative from the BOT ACC will be invited to be part of the Review Committee to discuss the final draft and comment. The ACC representative should keep constant and sustained communication with the BOT regarding the policy. The ACC representative will act as a liaison between the Review Committee and the BOT.
- v. Once the Review Committee acknowledged the BOT comments, the final draft along with all supported documents will be submitted to the BOT at their next or future meeting for approval. The Area Chief of the relevant unit owning the proposed policy/procedure shall manage the paperwork to place this on the agenda.
- w. After a draft is approved by the Chief, Chancellor or BOT, it should be published in the Handbook of Policies and Operating Procedures (HPOP). If approved, the relevant Executive Assistant will send the final approved policy/procedure to OIRA to ensure publication in the HPOP.
- x. If the approval is made by the BOT, the Executive Assistant to the Chancellor distributes the approved policy/procedure to the Chancellor's Cabinet and OIRA. OIRA will retain the copy of this information and will add the Policy/Procedure to the HPOP and other relevant publications.
- y. The relevant Area Chief will either disseminate the policy/procedure to the AUS community or authorize the Owner to do so.

III. Retiring of a policy/procedure:

- a. Any unit/office/department may initiate a policy/procedure retiring process by sending an internal request to the relevant Area Chief (Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration or the Chancellor).
- b. If the internal request is submitted to an Area Chief, the latter should have preliminary discussion with the Chancellor about the request. The Area of Chief is expected to provide a brief conceptual framework justifies the retiring request to the Chancellor to have tentative approval/permission to proceed with the retiring process.
- c. The preliminary discussion with the Chancellor is crucial and essential for retiring an existing policy/procedure.
- d. If the internal request is rejected by the relevant Area Chief or rejected as a result of the subsequent discussion with the Chancellor, the unit must wait for 6 months before making another request.
- e. Suggestions by the Area Chief or the Chancellor will not be considered a rejection and will allow the owner to proceed with the process once the retirement request is approved.
- f. After the relevant Area Chief and the Chancellor approve discussing the retirement of a

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policy/procedure in principle, they may authorize the initiating department/unit to proceed with extensive internal discussion (within the department/unit/area) regarding the retirement of the policy/procedure.

- g. The policy owner is encouraged to contact OIRA at any point during the process for guidance. Should the owner have any question or enquiry regarding the policy/procedure retirement process, they should communicate with OIRA for early guidance. Earlier assistance of OIRA would enable a more effectiveness process.
- h. Once the Collaborative Working Group agreed on the proposal for retiring a policy/procedure, policy review request form and a comprehensive analysis substantiates the retirement process should be submitted to OIRA for review and approval.
- i. For academic policy/procedure, the owner or/and the Provost may share the request with the Council of Deans for comments and feedback. This step must come prior to the submission of the official request to the Review Committee.
- j. After the request is reviewed and approved OIRA, the policy/procedure owner must submit the proposal to the Review Committee (Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) and pursue a meeting with the Review Committee/PAC or equivalent.
- k. The policy owner shall submit the retirement proposal along with the policy review request form, and the comprehensive analysis within a period of one month to the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS).
- l. The Review Committee will discuss the request in the next scheduled meeting. The discussion outcome must evaluate whether the retirement request is powerfully rationalized.
- m. If the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) approves retirement request, they will send the request to the Collaborative Working Group for final feedback and comments. Feedback and/or comments must be sent to the Review Committee/PAC within 20 working days (four weeks).
- n. At the end of the four weeks period, all comments will be reviewed by the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS). Then the retirement request will be submitted to the Chancellor for approval.
- o. If the Review Committee disapprove the retirement request, the owner must wait for 6 months before making another request.
- p. For policies/procedures that require the approval of the Board of Trustees, the retirement request, an approved review request form and comprehensive analysis legitimizes the request should be submitted to the next BOT meeting.
- q. The policies/procedures require the approval from the Board of Trustees (BOT), if they met any of the following criteria:
 - i. If the policy/procedure has significant fiscal implications on AUS;
 - ii. If the policy/procedure involves the BOT in any way;
 - iii. If the policy/procedure has significant legal or institutional risk;
 - iv. If the Chancellor deems the policy or procedure requiring BOT approval.
- r. Should the Review Committee/PAC, Area Chief or Chancellor find that the proposed document meets any of those conditions, the retirement request is submitted, along with any supporting documents, to the BOT Audit and Compliance Committee (ACC) for review and comment, a month prior to the Review Committee meeting.
- s. A representative from the BOT ACC will be invited to be part of the Review Committee to discuss the request and comment. The ACC representative should keep constant and sustained communication with the BOT regarding the policy. The ACC representative will act as a liaison between the Review Committee and the BOT.
- t. Once the Review Committee acknowledged the BOT comments, the request along with all supported documents will be submitted to the BOT at their next or future meeting for approval. The Area Chief of the relevant unit owning the request shall manage the paperwork to place this on the agenda.
- u. After the retirement request is approved by the Chief, Chancellor or BOT, it should be notified in the Handbook of Policies and Operating Procedures (HPOP). If approved, the relevant Executive

Assistant will send the retirement request to OIRA to ensure the removal of the policy/procedure from the HPOP.

- v. If the approval is made by the BOT, the Executive Assistant to the Chancellor distributes the notification to the Chancellor's Cabinet and OIRA. OIRA will retain the copy of approved request and will remove the Policy/Procedure from the HPOP and other relevant publications.

IV. Developing a new policy/procedure:

- a. Any unit/office/department may initiate a new policy/procedure development by sending an internal request to the relevant Area Chief (Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration or the Chancellor).
- b. If the internal request is submitted to an Area Chief, the latter should have preliminary discussion with the Chancellor about the proposed policy/procedure. The Area of Chief is expected to provide a brief conceptual framework of the policy/procedure to the Chancellor to have tentative approval/permission to proceed with the review process.
- c. The preliminary discussion with the Chancellor is crucial and essential for developing a new policy/procedure.
- d. If the internal request is rejected by the relevant Area Chief or rejected as a result of the subsequent discussion with the Chancellor, the unit must wait for 6 months before making another request.
- e. Suggestions by the Area Chief or the Chancellor will not be considered a rejection and will allow the owner to proceed with reviews once the edited request is approved.
- f. After the relevant Area Chief and the Chancellor approve the policy/procedure in principle, they may authorize the initiating department/unit to complete a policy/procedure draft for internal discussion (within the department/unit/area).
- g. Once a draft is finalized, the document owner or the Area Chief will call for a meeting inviting units and departments involved in the policy/procedure, development or implementation for discussion and comments.
- h. The policy owner is encouraged to contact OIRA at any point during the process for guidance. Should the owner have any question or enquiry regarding the policy development process or content, they should communicate with OIRA for early guidance. Earlier assistance of OIRA would enable a more effectiveness development process.
- i. Once a draft is developed and discussed within the Collaborative Working Group, a revised-if-needed policy/procedure draft, policy review request form and associated documents should be submitted to OIRA for review and approval.
- j. For academic policy/procedure, the owner or/and the Provost may share the draft policy with the Council of Deans for comments and feedback. This step must come prior to the submission of the document to the Review Committee.
- k. After the new policy/procedure proposal is reviewed and approved OIRA, the policy/procedure owner must submit the proposal to the Review Committee (Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) and pursue a meeting with the Review Committee/PAC or equivalent.
- l. The policy owner shall submit the policy draft proposal along with the policy review request form, and all associated documents within a period of one month to the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS).
- m. The Review Committee will discuss the policy/procedure proposal in the next scheduled meeting. The discussion outcome must evaluate whether the proposal is properly developed.
- n. If the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS) approves the policy/procedure proposal, they will send the proposal to the Collaborative Working Group for final feedback and comments. Feedback and/or comments must be sent to the Review Committee/PAC within 20 working days (four weeks).
- o. At the end of the four weeks period, all comments will be reviewed by the Review Committee/Policy Advisory Committee or Governance Unit (or what is equivalent to that level at the AUS). Once there is no further drafting needed, the proposed policy/procedure and any supporting documents will be submitted to the Chancellor for approval.
- p. If the Review Committee disapprove the new policy/procedure document, the owner must wait for 6 months before making another request. The owner has the chance to address the comments

- of the committee and change the policy/procedure proposal accordingly.
- q. For policies/procedures that require the approval of the Board of Trustees, the proposal, an approved review request form and all associated documents should be submitted to the next BOT meeting.
 - r. The policies/procedures require the approval from the Board of Trustees (BOT), if they met any of the following criteria:
 - i. If the policy/procedure has significant fiscal implications on AUS;
 - ii. If the policy/procedure involves the BOT in any way;
 - iii. If the policy/procedure has significant legal or institutional risk;
 - iv. If the Chancellor deems the policy or procedure requiring BOT approval.
 - s. Should the Review Committee/PAC, Area Chief or Chancellor find that the proposed document meets any of those conditions, the final draft document is submitted, along with any supporting documents, to the BOT Audit and Compliance Committee (ACC) for review and comment, a month prior to the Review Committee meeting
 - t. A representative from the BOT ACC will be invited to be part of the Review Committee to discuss the final draft and comment. The ACC representative should keep constant and sustained communication with the BOT regarding the policy. The ACC representative will act as a liaison between the Review Committee and the BOT.
 - u. Once the Review Committee acknowledged the BOT comments, the final draft along with all supported documents will be submitted to the BOT at their next or future meeting for approval. The Area Chief of the relevant unit owning the proposed policy/procedure shall manage the paperwork to place this on the agenda.
 - v. After a draft is approved by the Chief, Chancellor or BOT, it should be published in the Handbook of Policies and Operating Procedures (HPOP). If approved, the relevant Executive Assistant will send the final approved policy/procedure to OIRA to ensure publication in the HPOP.
 - w. If the approval is made by the BOT, the Executive Assistant to the Chancellor distributes the approved policy/procedure to the Chancellor's Cabinet and OIRA. OIRA will retain the copy of this information and will add the Policy/Procedure to the HPOP and other relevant publications.
 - x. The relevant Area Chief will either disseminate the new policy/procedure to the AUS community or authorize the Owner to do so.

V. Expedient review of policy or developing a new policy:

In case of emergency or special circumstances, the Chancellor (after the consultation with the Board of Trustees) may authorize the respective unit to develop or review the policy in an expedited process which may not include all steps or may shorten the process time.

Appendix III. Proposal for a New Major

American University of Sharjah Proposal for a New Major

COVER SHEET

Name of the New Major _____ Date _____

AUS College(s) and Departments Involved: _____

Department Heads

Signature _____

Date _____

Signature _____

Date _____

Deans

Signature _____

Date _____

Signature _____

Date _____

Chair of the Appropriate University Curriculum Committee

Signature _____

Date _____

Vice Provost

Signature _____

Date _____

Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

Signature _____

Date _____

American University of Sharjah

Proposal for a New Major

Name of Major _____

CHECKLIST

☐	Cover Sheet
☐	Checklist
☐	Executive Summary
☐	Rationale for the Major and Environmental Scan
☐	Curricular Detail
☐	Business Plan
☐	Space and Equipment Needs
☐	Sunsetting and Exit Strategies

Appendix IV. E-Learning Policy Manual

This document provides guidelines and processes pertaining to offering courses and programs through online or blended learning modes. It provides information about the responsibilities of relevant offices and the role of faculty in the development of e-learning courses and programs. The e-learning manual addresses the requirements set by the Ministry of Education 2019 Standards for Institutional Licensure and Program Accreditation.

An institution which offers academic programs and courses through e-learning must develop and maintain an e-Learning Manual, which must include the following:

- a. an organization chart illustrating the responsibility for e-learning programs and courses, including materials development, program delivery, learner support and evaluation;*

The AUS e-learning strategy will rely on the following offices and committees to oversee the development, evaluation and implementation of the University's e-learning strategy including:

Oversight, Development and Support:

- a. The Office of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will be responsible for overseeing the e-learning strategy and assessing its effectiveness through the offices of the Vice Provost for Graduate Studies (VPGS) and the Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs and Instruction (VPUAI).
- b. A University Technology Supported Learning Committee (UTSLC) will be appointed by the Provost to oversee the review and implementation of the University e-Learning strategy. UTSLC members will include the VPRGS, the VPUAI, college/school Technology Supported Learning Committee (TSLC) chairs, Center for Innovation in Teaching and Learning (CITL) representative, ICT and IT Security representative and a Library representative. The UTSLC will:
 - i. be responsible for raising awareness of the latest e-learning developments within and outside the university,
 - ii. act as a liaison between the colleges/school and other stakeholders to ensure that required resources for the e-Learning programs are maintained,
 - iii. liaise with the ICT and IT Security to coordinate e-Learning training and educational technology support of faculty members and students, and
 - iv. coordinate with the CITL to support faculty development related to instructional design, pedagogy, integration and dissemination of blended learning courses within the curricula
- c. A college/school TSLC will be established to promote technology-supported learning activities within the college/school. The dean will appoint the TSLC chair and department heads will designate their TSLC department representative.
- d. Department heads will be responsible for facilitating the e-learning strategy through the identification of potential courses for the integration of blended learning, in coordination with the program coordinators and course instructors. Department heads will seek approval from the Dean of the choice of courses identified for blended learning to secure the required resources.
- e. The TSLC members will be responsible for promoting technology-supported learning activities within their departments and reporting on the dissemination of best practice to the college/school TSLC.

Evaluation:

Course instructors and departmental curriculum committees will assess e-learning/blended learning courses/programs following the same process for assessment of courses and programs offered face-to-face. Furthermore, curriculum changes will follow the same process currently used for face-to-face

courses involving course instructors, department curriculum committee, college/school curriculum committee, and university level curriculum committee.

Training sessions for faculty and staff are organized when needed by the colleges/school in accordance with their blended learning strategies in coordination with the CITL. CITL provides professional development and consultative services for faculty and teaching staff and leads the integration and support for the use of educational technologies online and on campus. CITL also provides iterative instructional design and development services including an aesthetic interface, appropriate online tools beyond the LMS, customized learning activities, cutting-edge multimedia resources, and refinement of the courses.

Training sessions for students take place at the beginning of each semester to prepare students and facilitate effective use of the available learning tools. Furthermore, the ICT and IT Security Department provides an updated webpage for frequently asked questions related to IT services including e-learning tools at <https://itfaq.aus.edu/>. The AUS Educational Technology and Support team consists of highly qualified technology specialists who are well-versed and equipped with a broad range of technical and educational technology knowledge, skills and training. The team provides IT support channels including hotlines, live chat, service portal, on-site, and remote IT support. Faculty, staff and students are provided with a formal induction and orientation, introducing them to the technical facilities available to them on campus. E-learning specialists conduct orientation about the Learning Management System (LMS) for new students at the beginning of each semester. Additionally, IT support is provided for all online services to faculty, staff and students.

An organization chart illustrating the responsibility for e-learning programs and courses is shown in Figure 1. Departmental, college/school, and university level curriculum committees are involved in the review process following the AUS guidelines for curriculum review.

b. a statement of faculty roles and responsibilities in the development and implementation of e-learning programs and courses;

Faculty roles are defined in the *AUS Faculty Handbook* regardless of the mode of program or course delivery. Faculty members are expected to teach, conduct scholarly activities, and engage in service. In particular, the roles of the faculty in programs and courses using e-learning include:

- Participate in the establishment and development of program mission, outcomes, degree requirements, curriculum, assessment, and budget preparation.
- Prepare and update course syllabi and course material.
- Teach courses and interact with students both face-to-face and/or through technology tools.
- Participate in course and program assessment and evaluation for continuous improvement and ensure that the curriculum is following latest trends in the field.
- Acquire needed skills to deliver courses through e-learning/blended learning mode through in-house training and/or participation in professional development activities.

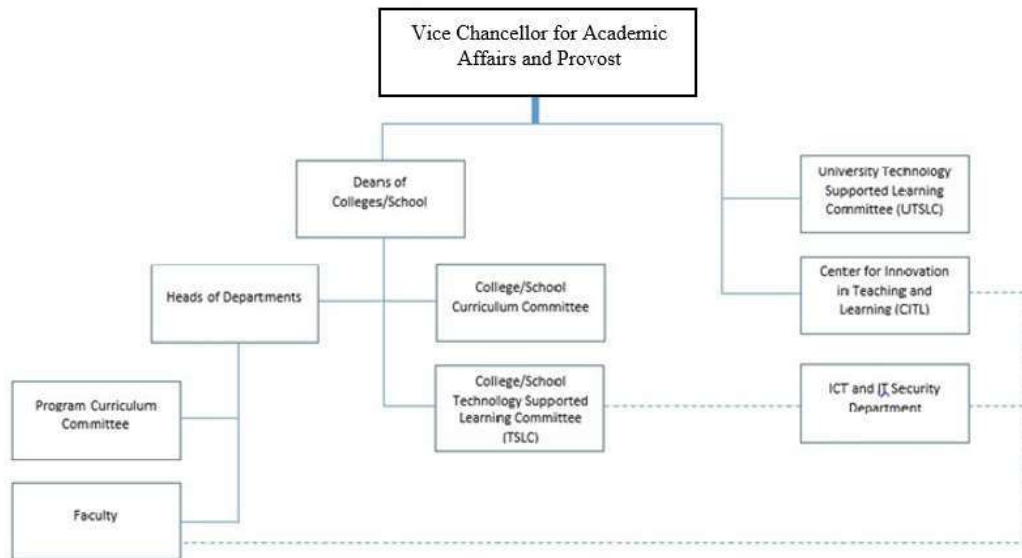


Figure 1: Organization chart for e-learning programs and courses

- c. information on the mode of delivery adopted by the institution for e-learning programs and courses (e.g., wholly online or blended mode; synchronous or asynchronous interaction among learners; media used for course delivery);*

AUS will use a blended mode of course delivery to enhance and support the face-to-face delivery and promote a more flexible mode of learning. Both synchronous and asynchronous modes of delivery will be utilized.

AUS is fully equipped with the IT infrastructure and educational technology tools for the use of synchronous modes of delivery including Blackboard Collaborate, a virtual learning environment within Blackboard, an official LMS at AUS, that is capable of delivering online lectures and seminars in real-time while engaging students who are dispersed in different geographical locations around the world. Blackboard Collaborate allows for students' interaction within the virtual learning environment through different mechanisms such as shared Power Point presentations, screen sharing, real-time voice interaction, instructor/user(s) management controls, and group-by-group interactions by using smaller virtual classrooms for each group, mimicking the traditional arrangements for group work. All instructors have access to their own virtual classroom, with a structured timetable for formal or informal sessions. Students can request meeting the instructor in person or schedule an on-line meeting.

In addition, AUS has many 'smart classrooms' equipped with interactive and smart TVs, as well as having integrated cameras, recording and archiving lectures using Panopto, and live streaming using Blackboard collaborate, Zoom, and Google Meet. These technologies enable instructors to use both synchronous and asynchronous modes of delivery, complemented by the strong IT and educational technology support services at the university.

- d. procedures and processes relating to the continuous development of e-learning materials for the institution, including overall project management, instructional design, content creation, design of assessments, etc.;*

The overall procedures and processes relating to the development of the Blended Learning courses will entail the following phases:

Analysis Phase

Program faculty will identify the potential courses to be delivered in a blended learning mode. The

criteria for identification of the potential blended learning courses include the nature of the courses, course level, profile of the learners, preparation of the instructors, and the desired outcomes such as enhancement of the teaching and learning experience, open and flexible delivery, support of different learning styles, etc. The course instructors will be responsible for compiling the course content and will provide a breakdown of the learning content delivered in the traditional mode and in blended learning mode in preparation for the design phase. The course instructors consult with the CITL staff in preparation for the design phase of the online component of the course. Approval of offering a course in a blended learning format will be through the regular curriculum review process involving department/program, college/school, university level curriculum committees, department head and dean.

Design phase

The course instructors in consultation with the TSLC department representative, CITL, and IT services will identify the learning components with potential for delivery in blended learning mode to match different learning styles and course objectives.

The design phase of the blended learning courses will identify the learning units of instruction that will be covered online. This includes the establishment of e-learning components such as online exercises, content, lesson planning, media selection, etc. IT requirements and educational technology support are also considered at the design phase.

Development and testing phase

The required e-learning components will be developed (e.g., video, animation, assessment, online lectures, etc.) by the instructional designer in liaison with the course instructor. The course instructor in collaboration with the instructional designer will continuously test, review and revise the instructional units.

Implementation phase

Training for the use of the LMS will be provided by the Education Technology and Support team to the course instructor and the students with clear instructions and guidance notes to assist with their engagement in the course. Where there are synchronous modes of delivery (real-time), technical support will be provided before and during the sessions. Similarly, instructions and technical support will be provided for asynchronous modes of delivery to ensure compatibility of the learning environment and smooth delivery of the course.

Evaluation phase

The evaluation phase includes gathering feedback from students and course instructors about the teaching and learning pedagogy, instructional design services, IT infrastructure services, IT infrastructure support, and other related services. Feedback is often obtained as part of the regular end of semester course evaluation process including student surveys and course assessment reports by the faculty. However, feedback may also be obtained through peer observation, self-reflection, and formal and informal discussion with colleagues. The feedback will be used by the concerned party (instructor, program, IT, CITL) to inform decisions about future changes and support to continuously enhance the e-learning course delivery experience.

e. assessment policies relating to e-learning, focused on maintaining the integrity of student work in the e-learning environment;

Mid-term and final exams will be conducted on campus (in-house), following the traditional controlled measures according to the university policy. Student work is also checked using the SafeAssign tool available on iLearn to detect any plagiarized submissions. Furthermore, assessment of submitted student papers/class projects involves class presentations and discussions and that will help in ensuring

authenticating the student work.

f. characteristics of the e-learning environment, including both its hardware and software components;

AUS e-learning environment has the following components:

1. Applications
2. Integrations
3. Infrastructure components

Educational Technology Tools

AUS offers an array of online tools that work together in harmony to support e-learning. The core of these applications is the Blackboard Learn. Other applications include lecture capture and video management system, virtual classroom and web-conferencing system, plagiarism detection tools, and productivity and file sharing/collaboration tools like Office365 and Google Drive. In particular, the following applications are available to students and faculty:

- i. Blackboard Learn has been used by AUS since 2005 as the official platform for learning management. Blackboard Learn offers the following:
 - Course content management tools
 - Group learning collaboration tools
 - Assignment management tools
 - Online testing and quizzing
 - Student grading and performance reporting
 - Course activity reporting
 - Asynchronous discussions
 - Synchronous online meetings through Blackboard Collaborate
 - Non-course based online communities
 - Social learning tools like Wikis and Blogs
 - Self and learning reflection tools like Journals
- ii. Lecture Capture and Video Management using the Panopto online system for capturing and archiving classroom lectures. Panopto is functioning as the campus wide video portal.
- iii. Blackboard Collaborate web conferencing system is used to provide a synchronous communication tool that works as a virtual classroom where instructors and students could hold learning sessions with a wide range of activities like application sharing, breakout sessions, quizzing, and polling.
- iv. SafeAssign works under Blackboard Learn as the plagiarism detection tool to enhance students' understanding of and conformity to academic honesty. SafeAssign detects text matching and generates originality reports that can be used as learning tools or to enforce course policies
- v. Office365, Google Suite, and Zoom are widely used by students and faculty members as online productivity tools and for content sharing and collaboration

1. Integrations

The multiple systems that make up the e-learning environment at the AUS integrate together via a series of data automation process that makes user's data available seamlessly and securely across applications. Registered courses, student enrollment, and teaching assignments are automatically imported from the Student Information System (Banner) into iLearn cancelling the need for any manual data updates. A single identity management system is used to facilitate account creation and

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authentication across multiple systems.

2. Infrastructure

AUS provides an adequate infrastructure that is comprised of state-of-the-art backend technology that includes server and networking hardware that supports and ensures industry standards of uptime are maintained. The Main Internet bandwidth capacity is 2Gbps with redundant links and Distributed Denial-of-service (DDoS) Protection (Etisalat). In addition, AUS secured multiple Digital Subscriber Lines (DSL) with capacity 500Mbps each. The recent introduction of an internet line from DU allows for better management of the bandwidth usage and having redundant links from two ISP provides independent multiple paths to current and future cloud services. The Traffic to Cloud SaaS providers from AUS network and on-campus end-users is prioritized using existing network technologies. The continuous fine-tuning of the networking technologies ensures the traffic to/from Cloud SaaS providers paths is optimized for better performance and availability.

To ensure that resources are adequately provided and effectively utilized, the ICT and IT Security allocate an annual budget to support learning environment including applications, infrastructure, and technical support.

g. the location of physical sites established to support delivery of e-learning programs and courses;

AUS will be the only physical site whereby programs using e-learning will be established. Should distance-learning programs be rolled out in the future, AUS will inform the Ministry of Education for approval of the establishment of those sites.

h. information on the systems and procedures for security of testing and authentication of examinees;

The identity of students conducting exams online will be authenticated by the course instructor by displaying official identity card/passport prior to the examination. Students are required to login to the course learning management system to using their secure credentials that are only known to the student.

i. copyright and intellectual property policies relating to e-learning materials developed by or for the institution.

AUS has an Intellectual Property Policy published in the *Faculty Handbook* (<https://www.aus.edu/academics/services-and-resources/faculty-development-center/faculty-handbook>). AUS treats course materials, including online content, as exempted scholarly works that are owned by the author(s).

Appendix V. Ethical Research - Version 4

Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation

I. Research misconduct proceedings - criteria, reports, and time limitations

The primary responsibility for maintaining high standards of conduct lies with the individual researcher. Nevertheless, because research misconduct is a very serious offense, AUS must also take appropriate steps to prevent its occurrence. To compliment this policy please see the procedures to be followed in all inquiries and investigations of potential misconduct in the Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation.

Enforcement of research standards will include some or all of the steps identified below:

A. Allegations

Any report of alleged misconduct must be presented to the university Research Integrity Officer (the Vice Chancellor for Research or his/her designee). Promptly after receiving an allegation of research misconduct, the Research Integrity Officer will review the allegations and determine whether they meet the definition of research misconduct and whether they are sufficiently credible and specific so that potential evidence of research misconduct may be identified. If these criteria are met, the Research Integrity Officer will determine whether the complaint should progress to the inquiry phase. If the misconduct allegation concerns students only and no external-sponsor funds were involved, and if the Research Integrity Officer determines that the alleged misconduct is academic, rather than research or scholarly, then the Research Integrity Officer will refer the matter to the degree program in which the student was enrolled, the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience, vice provost for undergraduate studies or vice provost for graduate studies. If, however, the Research Integrity Officer elects to view the matter as research misconduct, then the process described in this policy takes priority over any other academic or disciplinary process.

B. Inquiry

If the Research Integrity Officer determines that the allegations should progress under this policy, the Research Integrity Officer will initiate a discreet, confidential Inquiry (an initial review) of the evidence. This Inquiry will be completed within 60 calendar days after the Research Integrity Officer initiates the Inquiry, unless circumstances warrant a longer period and approval is obtained from the Vice Chancellor for Research. In concluding this Inquiry, the Research Integrity Officer will assess the validity of the allegations and prepare an Inquiry report outlining his/her findings and recommendations.

The Inquiry report will contain the following information:

- 1) The name and position of the Respondent(s);
- 2) A description of the allegations of research misconduct;
- 3) Sources of funding for the research involved, including, for example, grant numbers, grant applications, contracts, and publications listing;
- 4) The basis for recommending that the alleged actions warrant or do not warrant a more detailed Investigation; and
- 5) Any comments about the Inquiry by the Respondent.

The Respondent(s) will be given a reasonable amount of time within the 60-day period to review the draft report and provide comments. The final report will be submitted to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, who will review the report and make a written determination of whether or not an Investigation is warranted. If the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost determines that supporting information is not reasonably sufficient to substantiate the allegations, the matter will be closed. In such an event, all the material leading to the decision must be kept on file for

at least three years.

C. Investigation

If the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost determines that the allegations have sufficient substance, he or she will direct that a detailed Investigation be conducted according to AUS's current Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation.

The Investigation will begin within 30 calendar days of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's determination. On or before the date on which the Investigation begins, the Inquiry report and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's written determination will be sent to the appropriate office if sponsorship from other sources is involved.

AUS will use its best efforts to complete the Investigation within 120 calendar days of the date on which it began, including conducting the Investigation, preparing a draft report of findings, providing the draft report to the Respondent(s) for comment, submitting the final report to the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost for a final determination, and sending the final report to the appropriate sponsor office. If it becomes apparent that AUS cannot complete the Investigation within 120 calendar days, AUS will, in a timely manner, request an extension in writing from the appropriate sponsor office. These time periods apply to the Investigation and not to separate disciplinary hearings under other AUS processes.

The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will appoint an unbiased Panel consisting of members with the expertise to evaluate the potential research misconduct and who do not have an identifiable bias or conflict of interest regarding the matter. The Research Integrity Officer will, in most cases, provide staff support to the Investigation Panel. In doing its work, the Panel will:

- 1) Use diligent efforts to ensure that the Investigation is thorough and sufficiently documented and includes examination of all research records and evidence relevant to reaching a decision on the merits of the allegations;
- 2) Interview each Respondent, complainant, and any other available person who has been reasonably identified as having information regarding any relevant aspects of the Investigation, including witnesses identified by the Respondent;
- 3) Record or transcribe each interview, providing the recording or transcript to the interviewee for correction and including the recording or transcript in the record of Investigation;
- 4) Pursue diligently all significant issues and leads discovered that are determined relevant to the Investigation, including any evidence of additional instances of possible research misconduct, and continue the Investigation to completion;

The Panel will prepare the draft and final institutional Investigation reports in writing and provide the draft report to the Respondent(s) for comment. The final Investigation report will contain the following sections:

- 1) Allegations: Description of the nature of the allegations of research misconduct and the specific allegations of research misconduct considered in the Investigation and the institutional charge shall be included in the report.
- 2) Research Support: Description of and documentation of research support for the research in question, including, for example, the sponsor supporting the research, the grant numbers, grant applications, contracts and publications listing such support.
- 3) Policies and Procedures: Reference to and inclusion of the AUS policies and procedures under which the Investigation was conducted.
- 4) Research Records and Evidence: Identification and summary of the research records and evidence reviewed, as well as any evidence taken into custody by the Panel but not reviewed.
- 5) Statement of Findings: For each separate allegation of research misconduct identified during the Investigation, a finding whether research misconduct did or did not occur, and if such misconduct did occur: (i) whether the research misconduct was falsification, fabrication,

plagiarism, a practice that seriously deviated from those commonly accepted practices within the relevant research community for proposing, conducting, reviewing, or reporting research, a failure to comply with the requirements for protecting researchers, human and animal subjects and the public, or other violation of AUS policy, and whether any such misconduct was intentional, knowing or reckless, (ii) a summary of the facts and the analysis of the facts that support the conclusion, including a consideration of any reasonable explanation by the Respondent(s), (iii) the person or persons responsible for the misconduct, (iv) the seriousness of the misconduct, (v) the specific sponsored research support related to that allegation and finding, (vi) whether any publications need correction or retraction, and (vii) any current support or known applications or proposals for research support from governmental or private sources that the Respondents have pending.

- 6) Comments: Inclusion and consideration of any comments made on the draft report by the Respondents and complainants.
- 7) the Respondents and complainants.
- 8) Recommendations: If there is a finding that research misconduct has occurred, the Panel may recommend appropriate sanctions based on its understanding of the case. Even if the Panel concludes that research misconduct did not occur, it is nonetheless free to make recommendations as a result of the Investigation or a finding that other violations of AUS policies or procedures may have occurred. These recommendations are not binding on the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, even if he or she agrees with the findings of the report; determination and implementation of actual sanctions is discussed below.

After the Panel provides its final report, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost, at his/her discretion, may (i) ask any or all of the Respondents for their final written comments; (ii) seek clarification on various matters from the Panel; and/or (iii) refer the matter back to the Panel for additional investigation if he/she deems it necessary or appropriate. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will then conclude the Investigation by formally receiving the report. At this point, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will render his or her decision in a letter or memorandum that notes agreement or disagreement with the Panel's findings and recommendations and determines whether further administrative or disciplinary action on the part of AUS is appropriate; the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's decision is final. He or she will send a copy of the decision to the Research Integrity Officer, the Respondent(s), and the Panel members; he/she may also communicate the relevant results to any complainants. If the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost determines further administrative or disciplinary action is appropriate, he or she will send a copy of the final report and his/her decision to the Chancellor, and the relevant dean(s) so that further action may be initiated.

With regard to the appropriate sponsor, the Research Integrity Officer will (i) provide a copy of the Investigation report and attachments, (ii) inform the appropriate sponsor if the Investigation found research misconduct (and if so, who committed it), (iii) state whether AUS agrees with the Investigation's findings, and (iv) describe any pending or completed administrative actions taken against Respondent(s). AUS will maintain, and, upon request, provide to the appropriate sponsor all relevant research records and records of AUS's research misconduct proceeding. The Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will be provided copies of all reports and other communications submitted to the appropriate sponsor.

D. Disciplinary Action

At the conclusion of an Investigation in which it is determined that research misconduct occurred, AUS will take the following disciplinary actions:

- 1) Findings Against Administrative Personnel: If the research misconduct process concludes that research misconduct occurred, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost agrees with the findings of the Investigation report, and the Respondent is an academic administrator, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost and the Chancellor will cooperate in undertaking appropriate action.
- 2) Findings Against a Staff Member: If the research misconduct process concludes that the

allegations have substance, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost agrees with the findings of the Investigation report, and the Respondent is a staff member, the Research Integrity Officer will notify the Chancellor. The Research Integrity Officer and the Chancellor will cooperate in undertaking appropriate action.

- 3) **Findings Against a Student:** If the research misconduct process concludes that the allegations have substance, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost agrees with the findings of the Investigation report, and the Respondent is a student, the Research Integrity Officer will notify the Vice Chancellor for Student Experience, Vice Provost for Undergraduate Affairs, Vice Provost for Graduate Studies or the Dean of the most relevant School, as appropriate. The Research Integrity Officer and the appropriate Dean will cooperate in undertaking appropriate action under the applicable procedures within the Dean's purview. The Research Integrity Officer will also report the disciplinary actions taken as may be required by law.

II. Additional procedural considerations

A. Ensuring a fair research misconduct proceeding

AUS will take all reasonable steps to ensure an impartial and unbiased research misconduct proceeding to the maximum extent practicable. Those conducting Investigation shall be selected on the basis of expertise that is pertinent to the matter. Prior to selection, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost will screen individuals for any identifiable bias and unresolved personal, professional, or financial conflicts of interest with the Respondent, complainant, potential witnesses, or others involved in the matter. Any such bias or conflict that a reasonable person would consider to unfairly influence research misconduct proceeding will disqualify the individual from selection. If, pursuant to this paragraph, the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost is unable to serve, the Chancellor shall designate an appointee who is free of bias or conflict of interest to fulfill the roles ordinarily assumed by the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost in this process.

B. Confidentiality

AUS will strive to respect the confidentiality of Respondents and complainants and will not disclose any of these identities, except: (1) to those who need to know in order to carry out a thorough, competent, objective and fair research misconduct proceeding; (2) where applicable, the appropriate sponsor as it conducts its research misconduct proceeding; and (3) to those to whom disclosure is deemed necessary to remedy any findings of research misconduct or any other violations of law or AUS policy. Any information obtained during the research misconduct proceeding that might identify the subjects of research will be securely and confidentially maintained and will not be disclosed, except as noted above.

C. Interim protective actions

At any time during a research misconduct proceeding, AUS will take appropriate interim actions to protect public health, funds and equipment, and the integrity of the supported research process. The necessary actions will vary according to the circumstances of each case, but examples of actions that may be necessary include delaying the publication of research results, providing closer supervision of one or more researchers, requiring approvals for actions relating to the research that did not previously require approval, auditing pertinent records, or taking steps to contact other institutions that may be affected by an allegation of research misconduct.

D. Maintenance and custody of research records and evidence

AUS will take the following specific steps to obtain, secure, and maintain the research records and evidence pertinent to the research misconduct proceeding:

- 1) Either before or when AUS notifies the Respondent of the allegations, AUS will promptly take all reasonable and practical steps to obtain custody of all research records and evidence needed

to conduct the research misconduct proceeding, inventory those materials, and sequester them in a secure manner. In those cases where the research records or evidence encompass scientific instruments shared by a number of users, custody may be limited to copies of the data or evidence on such instruments, providing that those copies are substantially equivalent to the evidentiary value of the instruments. Where appropriate, give the Respondent copies of, or reasonable supervised access to, the research records.

- 2) Undertake all reasonable and practical efforts to take custody of additional research records and evidence discovered during the course of the research misconduct proceeding, including at the Inquiry and Investigation stages, or if new allegations arise, subject to the exception for scientific instruments in (1) above.
- 3) AUS will maintain all records of the research misconduct proceeding, as defined according to the AUS Records Retention Policy after completion of the proceeding.

E. Notices to respondent

During the research misconduct proceedings, AUS will provide the following notifications to all identified Respondents:

- 1) Initiation of Inquiry: AUS will sequester all research records and other evidence needed to conduct the research misconduct proceeding; AUS will typically provide the Respondent(s) written notification of the Inquiry before or at the time of sequestration of data. However, in some cases, the Research Integrity Officer may determine that data needs to be sequestered prior to the notification of the Respondent(s) in order to ensure the integrity of data, in which case the Respondent(s) will be notified as soon as the Research Integrity Officer has determined that the security of data is no longer at risk. If the Inquiry subsequently identifies additional Respondents, they shall be promptly notified in writing.
- 2) Comment on Draft Inquiry Report: AUS will provide the Respondent(s) an opportunity to respond to allegations at the Inquiry stage and to provide timely comments on the draft Inquiry report so that any comments can be attached to the report.
- 3) Results of the Inquiry: AUS will notify the Respondent(s) of the results of the Inquiry and include copies of the Inquiry report and institutional policies and procedures for the handling of research misconduct allegations.
- 4) Initiation of Investigation: Within a reasonable time after AUS's written determination that an Investigation is warranted, but not later than 30 calendar days after that determination, AUS shall notify the Respondent(s) in writing of the allegations to be investigated. AUS shall give Respondent(s) written notice of any new allegations within a reasonable time after deciding to pursue allegations not addressed in the inquiry or in the initial notice of the Investigation. The initial notice of the Investigation will identify the proposed members of the Investigation Panel. The Respondent has the right to request certain Panel members be replaced as outlined in the Procedures for Conducting a Research Misconduct Investigation.
- 5) Scheduling of Interview: AUS will notify the Respondent sufficiently in advance of the scheduling of his/her interview in the Investigation so that the Respondent may prepare for the interview and arrange for the attendance of legal counsel, if the Respondent wishes.
- 6) Comment on Draft Investigation Report: AUS will give the Respondent(s) a copy of the draft Investigation report, and concurrently, a copy of, or supervised access to, the evidence on which the report is based. The Panel will provide the Respondent no more than 30 calendar days from the date on which he/she received the draft report to provide comments. AUS will ensure that these comments are included and considered in the final Investigation report.
- 7) Results of the Investigation: AUS will provide a copy of the final Investigation report and notify the Respondent(s) of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost's decision regarding the report.

F. Restoring reputations

- 1) Respondents: AUS will undertake all reasonable, practical, and appropriate efforts to protect and restore the reputation of any person alleged to have engaged in research misconduct, but

against whom no finding of research misconduct was made, if the person requests that AUS do so.

- 2) Complainants, Witnesses, and Committee Members: AUS will undertake all reasonable and practical efforts to protect and restore the position and reputation of any complainant, witness, or committee member and to counter potential or actual retaliation against those persons as a result of participating in a research misconduct proceeding.

III. Interplay of AUS process with appropriate sponsor office

A. Notifying of the decision to open an investigation and of institutional findings and actions following an investigation

On or before the date on which the Investigation begins, the Research Integrity Officer will notify the appropriate sponsor (if applicable) with a copy of the Inquiry report and the provide the determination based on the report. Additionally, upon request from the appropriate sponsor, AUS will provide:

- 1) A copy of AUS's institutional policies and procedures under which the Inquiry was conducted;
- 2) The research records and evidence reviewed, transcripts or recordings of any interviews, and copies of all relevant documents; and
- 3) The charges that the Investigation Panel will consider.

Upon completion of the Investigation, AUS will promptly provide to the appropriate sponsor:

- 1) A copy of the Investigation report including all attachments and any appeals;
- 2) A statement of whether the institution found research misconduct and, if so, who committed it;
- 3) A statement from the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost of whether or not AUS accepts the findings in the Investigation report; and
- 4) A description of any pending or completed administrative actions against the Respondent.

B. Notifying of special circumstances

At any time during a research misconduct proceeding, AUS will immediately notify the appropriate sponsor if AUS has reason to believe that any of the following conditions exist:

- 1) Health or safety of the public is at risk, including an immediate need to protect human or animal subjects;
- 2) Sponsor resources or interests are threatened;
- 3) Research activities should be suspended;
- 4) There is a reasonable indication of violations of civil or criminal law;
- 5) Legal action is required to protect the interests of those involved in the research misconduct proceeding;
- 6) AUS believes the research misconduct proceeding may be made public prematurely so that the sponsoring office may take appropriate steps to safeguard evidence and protect the rights of those involved; and/or
- 7) AUS believes the research community or public should be informed.

C. Cooperation with the sponsoring agency

AUS will cooperate with and assist the appropriate sponsor, as needed, to carry out any administrative actions that the sponsoring agency may impose as a result of a final finding of research misconduct.

AUS will cooperate fully and on a continuing basis with the appropriate sponsor during its oversight reviews of AUS and its research misconduct proceedings and during the process under which the Respondent may contest findings of research misconduct and proposed University administrative actions. This includes providing, as necessary to develop a complete record of relevant evidence, access to all witnesses within AUS's authority, research records, and other evidence under AUS's

control or custody, or in the possession of, or accessible to, all persons that are subject to AUS's authority.

AUS will report to the appropriate sponsor any proposed settlements, admissions of research misconduct, or institutional findings of misconduct that arise at any stage of a misconduct proceeding, including the allegation.

Appendix VI. Professional Staff Development

This appendix includes two main related documents:

- Soft Skills Training Document.
- Technical Training.

1. Soft Skills Training

Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure sets out the procedure for arranging the Soft Skills training.

Audience

- HR

Soft Skills Training Procedure

- The training budget is agreed at the BOT in **June** every year. The Executive Director HR confirms the budget to the Training Manager for the next academic year.
- HR prepares a list of the soft skills training in **June** of every year, these courses are identified through different channels:
 - Performance Management system, a report named Training Report that lists all required courses is available under Reports Section in the Performance Management system, <https://intranet.aus.edu/appraisal/training>, this report gives a list of training requested as part of the appraisal process
 - Evaluation sheets from previous courses
 - Requests from staff
 - Reviewing staff's job descriptions. Specific courses are required for a group of job families. For example, administrative skills are required for all admin assistants
- HR sends the list of Soft Skills training available to all staff via email in **July** of every year, sample email is mentioned in Appendix A
- Maximum number of seats for soft skills course is 16 and the minimum number is 6
- Only full-time staff are entitled to attend training courses after they pass the probation period
- The maximum number of soft skills training courses allowed for staff is 3 courses per year
- Soft Skill courses are classified according to the staff levels, most of the courses are granted to all staff, subject to availability. However, some courses are only provided for supervisors/managers and above
- Staff should get approval from their line managers for the courses they want to attend and send these courses to their training coordinator. List of training coordinators is mentioned in Appendix B
- Training coordinator collects the approved training courses and sends them to the Training Manager
- Training Manager analyses the training requests and decides how many sessions will be conducted for each course based on the number of delegates in each course and budget availability
- Training Manager creates an instance for each session in the banner to enable participants to register in the sessions that are convenient for them

- Training Manager announces the dates for each course and notifies the concerned staff by email by **September** of every year, Sample email is mentioned in Appendix C
- Staff then needs to login to the Online Training Registration <https://intranet.aus.edu/Training/Login.aspx?ReturnUrl=%2fTraining> and register
- Training Manager confirms the staff registration if there are available seats in **October** of every year.
- The training takes place in M103 – the Steal Room that is located in the Main Building, First floor, is exclusive for the HR training courses
- The training courses are scheduled either from 8:30 until 4:30 or from 9:00 until 4:00 (depending on the content of the course) with three breaks in between. The first break is at 10:30 for 15 minutes, second one is from 12:30 till 1:30 and the third is from 3:00 till 3:15
- The Training Manager requests catering from Breakpoint and it costs 55 AED per delegate per day. The catering consists of light breakfast, lunch and afternoon tea break
- On the training day, if the trainer is not the Training Manager, then the Training Manager goes to the training room M103 and meets the external trainer, makes sure that he/she has the attendance sheet and the evaluation sheets and inspects the setup of the training, attendance and the catering.
- In case the training is conducted through an external training provider, then after the course delivery, the training provider sends the invoice to the Training Manager. Then he/she will forwards the invoice to the Finance department if there is a Banner Request, otherwise, the Training Manager gets the necessary approvals from HR Senior Manager and HR Executive Director if the amount is less than 15,000 AED then forwards the invoice to the Finance department. If the course fees is more than 15,000 AED, then the Training Manager should get the VCFA's approval too then forwards the invoice to the Finance department.
- If we apply for a Security Clearance for a trainer and it was approved, then there is no need to reapply for him/her again if he/she is going to deliver another training session, however, the Training Manager should notify the Office of Protocol via email every time the same trainer is coming to AUS.

Soft Skills Training Records

Soft Skills training records are stored in the Banner. To access these records, the Training Manager should use the Training Registration Report – PYPSTSR.



Select Report: Training Registration Report

Reference Number: Category: HR

Reference Date From: Reference Date To:

Training Location:

Training Code:

Department:

ID:

Status: Training Group:

Generate to File: No

Printing Method: Screen

Report Format: PDF

Evaluation of Training Course

The Training Manager uses the Evaluation Sheet, which is mentioned in Appendix D to evaluate the training courses

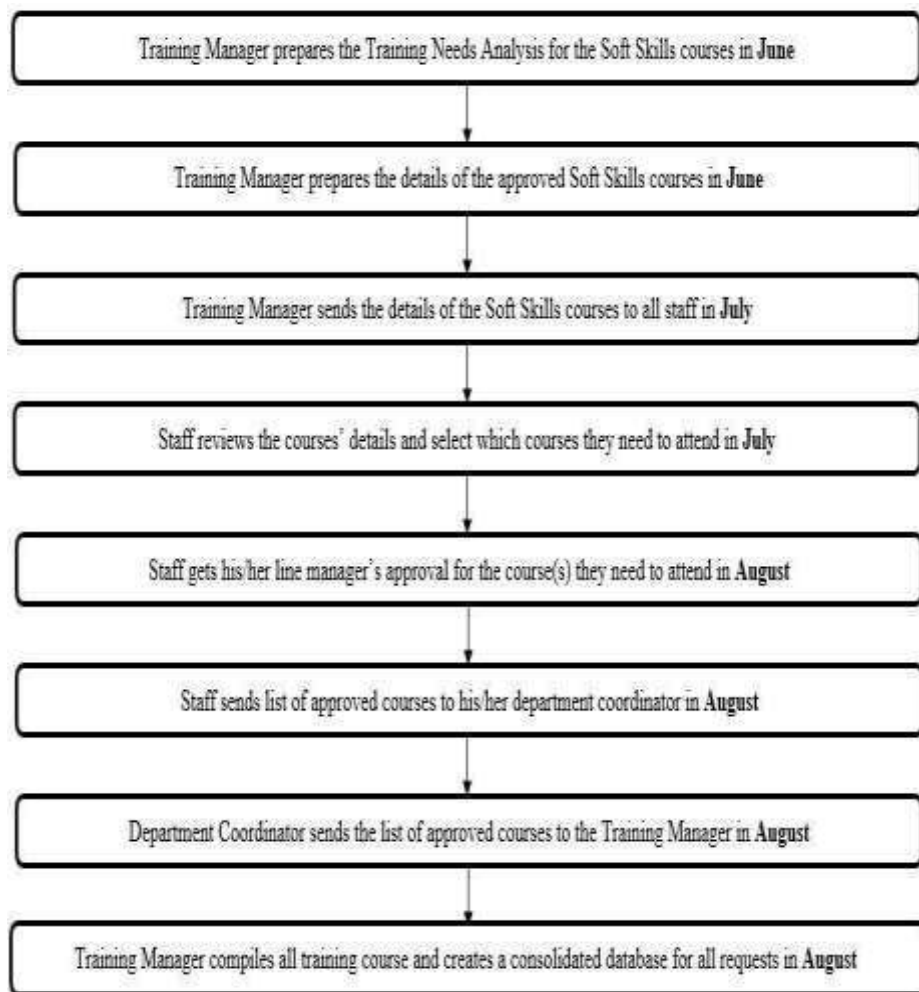
Curriculum				
1. Did the training meet your expectation?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
5. Was the course content organized and easy to follow?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
2. Were the training objectives identified and followed?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
3. Do you feel you will be able to apply what you have learnt to your work?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
4. How would you rate the overall course?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor

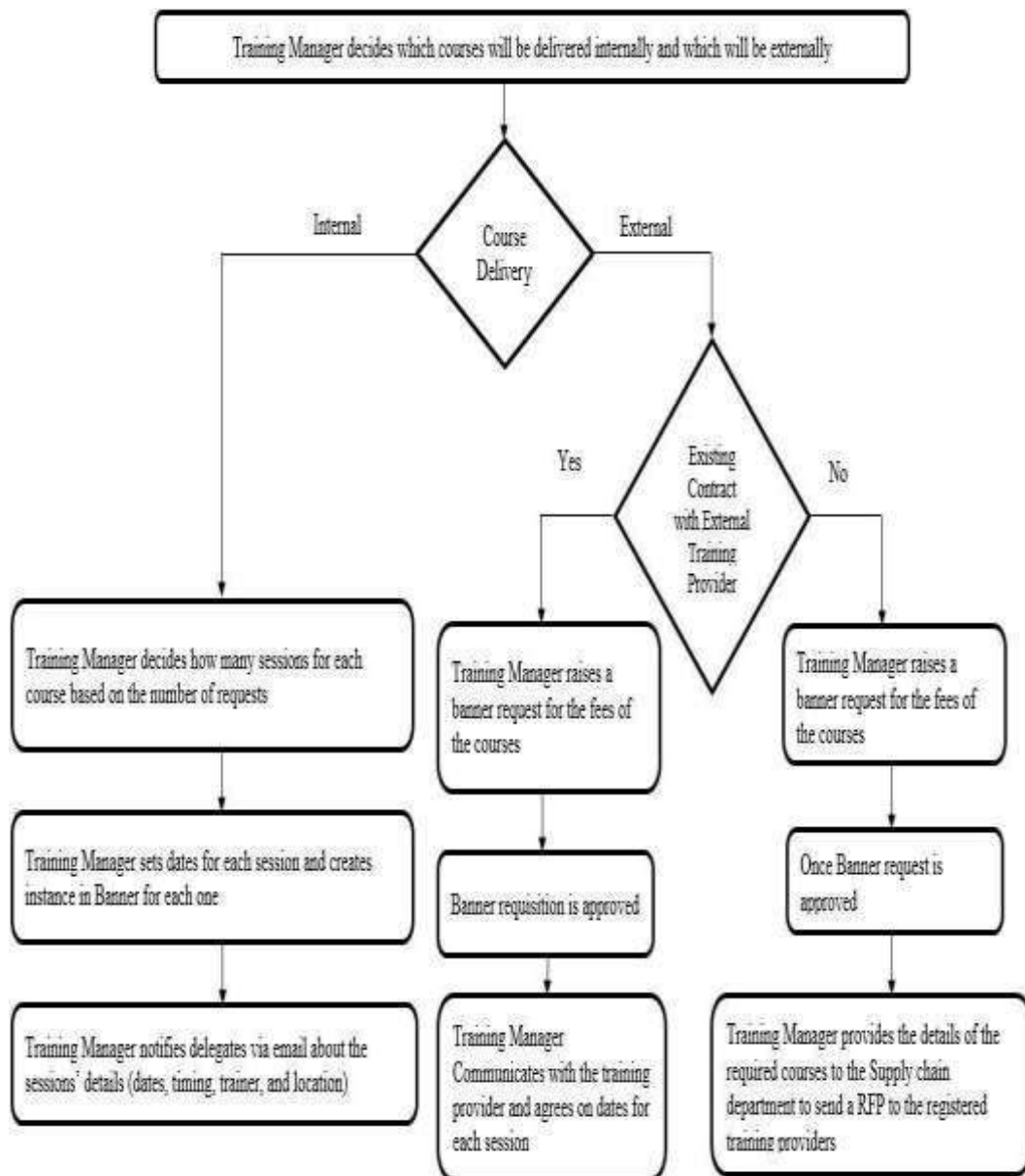
The Training Manager counts the total number of Excellent points, Good, Satisfactory and Poor for each question. He/she then multiplies the sum of Excellent by 4, the sum of Good by 3, the sum of Satisfactory by 2 and the sum of Poor by 1. Then he/she gets the sum of these multiplications and divide it by total number of the points. Then multiply this figure by 25 to get the percentage.

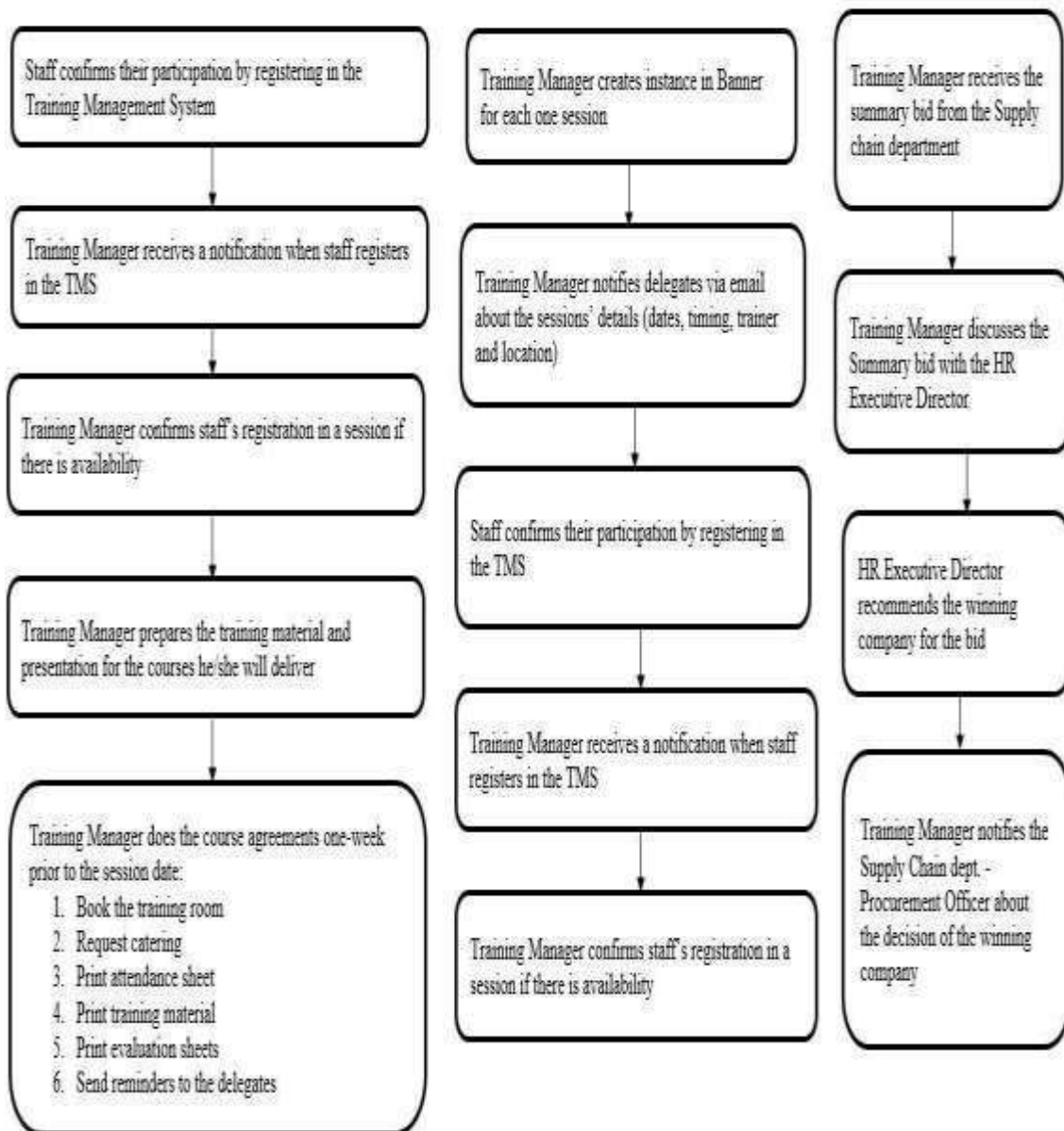
For example, the count of excellent points was 20 and the count for the Good points was 10 and the count for the Satisfactory points was 3, then $(20*4) + (10*3) + (3*1)$ therefore the total is 113. Divide 113 $(80+30+3)$ by 33 $(20 + 10+3) = 3.42$

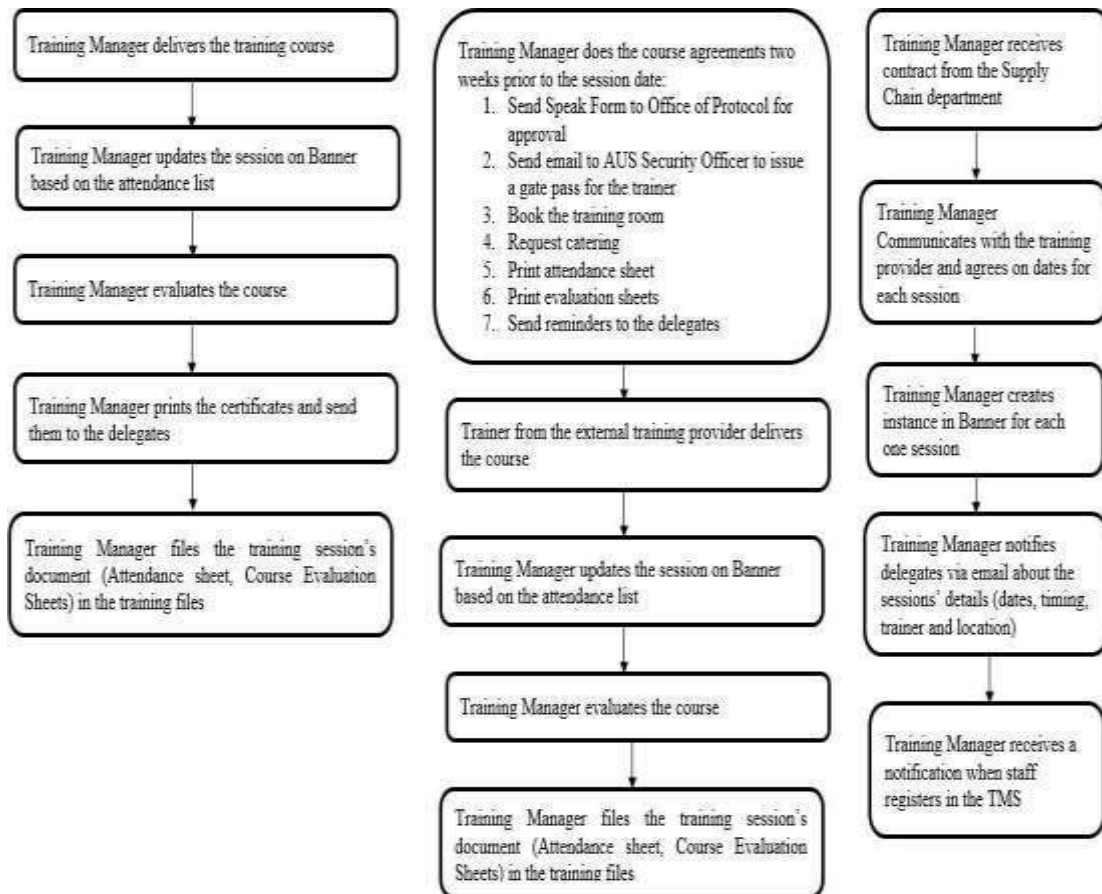
$3.42 * 25 = 85\%$

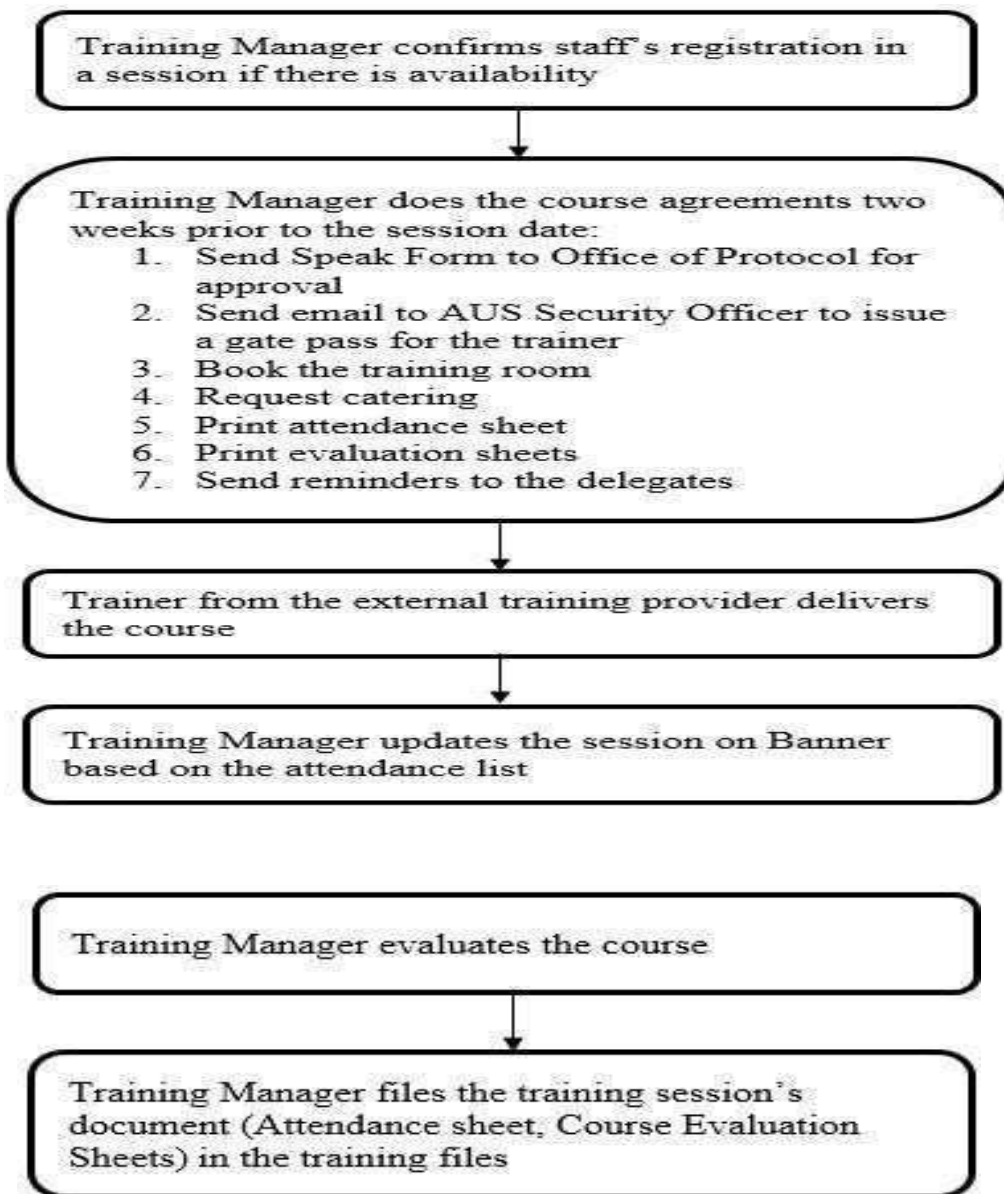
Flow Chart of the Training Process











Create a Session Instance

- Open the Banner
https://bancas01.aus.edu:8443/authenticationendpoint/login.do?Name=PreLoginRequ%20estProcessor&TARGET=https%3A%2F%2Fbannernav.aus.edu%3A443%2Fappliance%2Fspring_cas_security_check&commonAuthCallerPath=%252Fcas%252Flogin&forceAuth=false&passiveAuth=false&tenantDomain=carbon.super&sessionIdDataKey=3016ab44-c613-4555-9f20-2c8e92669c93&relyingParty=AppNav&type=cas&sp=AppNav&isSaaSApp=false&authenticationators=BasicAuthenticator:LOCAL
- Access the Training Registration Access Form [PYPSTSM] or from the main Banner screen, click on AUS Operations Menu, then Safety and Security Menu, then click on Training Registration Maintenance Form.
- Click on Ctrl + Page Down
- Enter the following mandatory fields:
 - Training Date
 - No of Days
 - Start Time
 - End Time
 - Training Location [Should use Training Location Validation Form PYVTRNL]
 - Training Code [Should use Training Type Validation Form PYVTRNT]
 - Trainer
 - Max No of Participants
- Save the form

The Training Manager can add delegates to a course session by entering the staff's ID in the area that is displayed below figure.

Training Manager confirms the staff registration in a course session by changing the Status Ind. from Waiting to Registered.

Training Manager may allow staff to register in a course session by editing the status of the Web Registration radio button should change from No to Yes and entering the following fields:

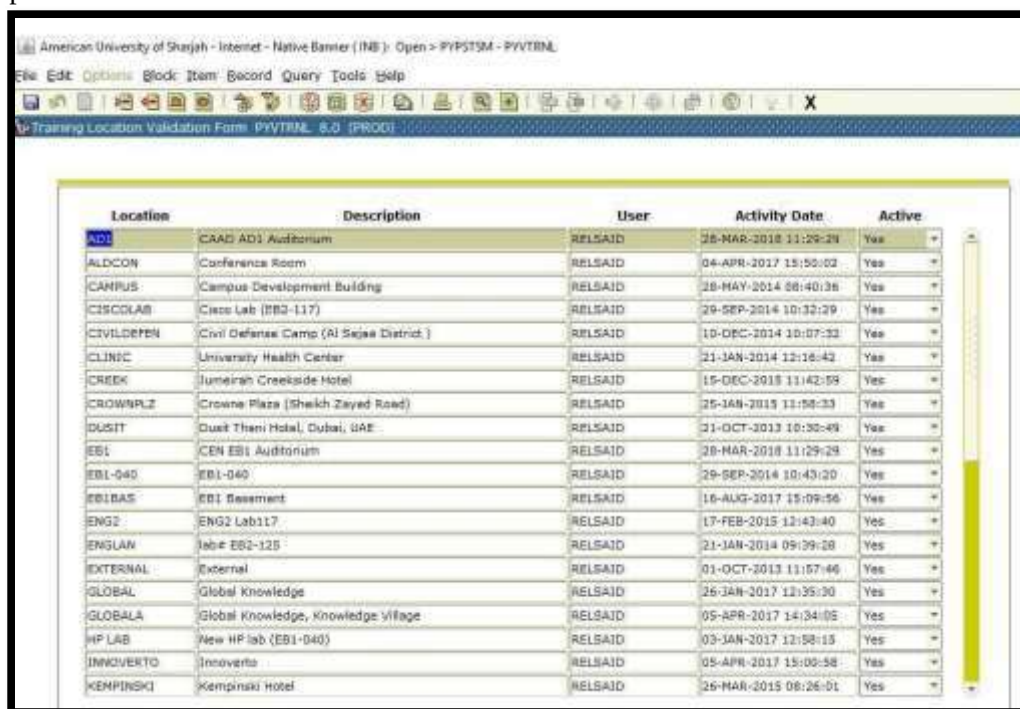
- Date From
- Date To

These fields represent the dates that the staff will be able to sign up for a session.

Create a Location Instance - Training Location Validation Form PYVTRNL

To create a new course location, the Training Manager enters the new training location code either by using the Training Location Validation Form PYVTRNL or by clicking on the Options Menu and selecting the Training Locations.

Scroll to the last record and press the down key to create a new record. Enter the location code and description and click on the Save button.



A screenshot of the 'Training Location Validation Form PYVTRNL' application window. The window title is 'American University of Sharjah - Internet - Native Barrier (INB) - Open > PYPSTSM - PYVTRNL'. The menu bar includes 'File', 'Edit', 'Options', 'Block', 'Item', 'Record', 'Query', 'Tools', and 'Help'. The toolbar contains various icons for file operations and data management. The main area displays a table with the following columns: Location, Description, User, Activity Date, and Active. The table lists various training locations such as ADU, ALDCON, CAMPUS, CISCOLAB, CIVILDEFEN, CLINIC, CREEK, CROWNPLZ, DUSIT, EBI, EBI-040, EBI040, EBI040, ENG2, ENGLAN, EXTERNAL, GLOBAL, GLOBALA, HP LAB, INNOVERTO, and KEMPINSKI. Each row shows the location code, a brief description, the user 'RELSAID', the activity date, and an 'Active' status with a dropdown arrow.

Location	Description	User	Activity Date	Active
ADU	CRAD AD1 Auditorium	RELSAID	28-MAR-2018 11:29:29	Yes
ALDCON	Conference Room	RELSAID	04-APR-2017 15:50:02	Yes
CAMPUS	Campus Development Building	RELSAID	28-MAY-2014 08:40:36	Yes
CISCOLAB	Cisco Lab (EB2-117)	RELSAID	29-SEP-2014 10:32:29	Yes
CIVILDEFEN	Civil Defense Camp (Al Sejah District)	RELSAID	10-DEC-2014 10:07:32	Yes
CLINIC	University Health Center	RELSAID	21-JAN-2014 12:16:42	Yes
CREEK	Jumeirah Creekside Hotel	RELSAID	15-DEC-2013 11:42:59	Yes
CROWNPLZ	Crowne Plaza (Sheikh Zayed Road)	RELSAID	25-JAN-2015 11:58:33	Yes
DUSIT	Dusit Thani Hotel, Dubai, UAE	RELSAID	21-OCT-2013 10:30:49	Yes
EBI	CEN EBI Auditorium	RELSAID	28-MAR-2018 11:29:29	Yes
EBI-040	EBI-040	RELSAID	29-SEP-2014 10:43:20	Yes
EBI040	EBI040	RELSAID	16-AUG-2017 15:09:56	Yes
ENG2	ENG2 Lab117	RELSAID	17-FEB-2015 12:43:40	Yes
ENGLAN	Lab# EB2-125	RELSAID	21-JAN-2014 09:39:28	Yes
EXTERNAL	External	RELSAID	01-OCT-2013 11:57:46	Yes
GLOBAL	Global Knowledge	RELSAID	26-JAN-2017 12:35:30	Yes
GLOBALA	Global Knowledge, Knowledge Village	RELSAID	05-APR-2017 14:34:05	Yes
HP LAB	New HP Lab (EB1-040)	RELSAID	03-JAN-2017 12:58:15	Yes
INNOVERTO	Innoverts	RELSAID	05-APR-2017 15:05:58	Yes
KEMPINSKI	Kempinski Hotel	RELSAID	26-MAR-2015 08:26:01	Yes

Create a course Code Instance [Training Type Validation Form PYVTRNT]

To create a new course code, the Training Manager enters the new training course code either by using the Training Type Validation Form **PYVTRNT** or by clicking on the Options Menu and selecting Training Codes.

Scroll to the last record and press the down key to create a new record. Enter the training code and description and click on the Save button.

Type	Description	User	Activity Date	Active
ADCS	Access	RELSAID	02-SEP-2014 15:14:58	Yes
ADDS	Adobe InDesign CC Course	RELSAID	16-DEC-2015 12:44:17	Yes
ADCCRM	Advanced Communication Skills	RELSAID	17-OCT-2017 14:33:48	Yes
ADHIN	Professional Secretarial Administration Skills	RELSAID	16-OCT-2015 14:19:19	Yes
AS SKILLS	Assertiveness Skills	RELSAID	21-JUL-2013 12:16:42	Yes
ATMS	Advanced Time Management Skills	RELSAID	03-SEP-2015 11:30:43	Yes
AVAYA	Avaya Aura Communication Manager and CM Messaging Train	RELSAID	09-FEB-2017 10:42:48	Yes
BLUEPRINT	The Blueprint for Constructing Your Project Management Office	RELSAID	06-FEB-2017 10:32:11	Yes
BODY LANG	Understanding Body Language	RELSAID	26-AUG-2013 13:10:40	Yes
BOSS	It's OK to be the Boss	RELSAID	24-MAR-2015 19:32:29	Yes
BUDGET	Fundamentals of Budgeting	RELSAID	26-AUG-2015 15:18:59	Yes
BUSLEV2	Business Writing Skills Level 2	RELSAID	06-OCT-2016 08:19:07	Yes
BW SKILLS	Business Writing Skills	RELSAID	21-JUL-2013 12:18:42	Yes
CAR	Basic Car Mechanics	RELSAID	26-FEB-2017 14:10:40	Yes
CCRA	CCRA	RELSAID	06-NOV-2013 11:45:56	Yes
CCRA AUD	CCRA Training - Enhancing Networking skills Part 2	RELSAID	28-MAR-2015 13:04:43	Yes
CCCP	CCCP	RELSAID	18-MAR-2016 22:21:28	Yes
CGEIT	CGEIT - Certified in the Governance of Enterprise IT training	RELSAID	12-MAR-2017 12:22:51	Yes
CH MGR	Change Management	RELSAID	01-AUG-2012 09:39:07	Yes
CHAUFFEUR	Chauffeur Etiquette	RELSAID	23-NOV-2015 14:58:41	Yes

Create a Database for Training Coordinators

Training Manager creates a Database for each department that contains the names of the staff in this department and the list of courses and sends it to the Training Coordinator.

The Database contains three tables:

- Required Courses
- Soft Skills Courses
- Staff

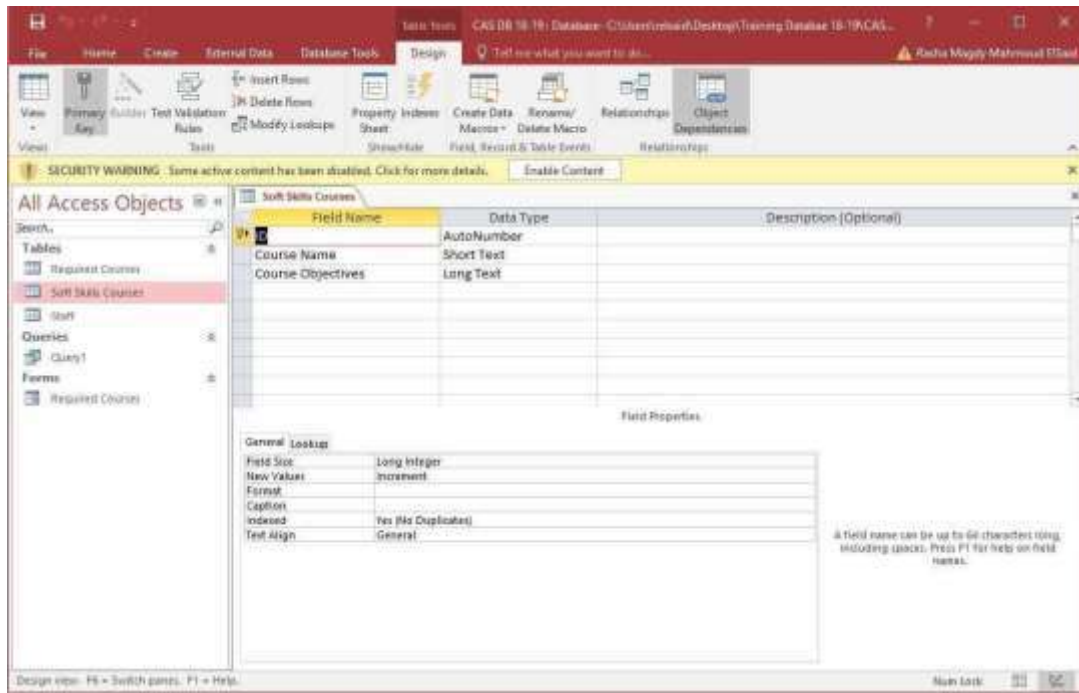
In addition to a form called: Required Courses.

Department coordinator uses the Required Courses Form to enter the approved courses for the staff in his/her department.

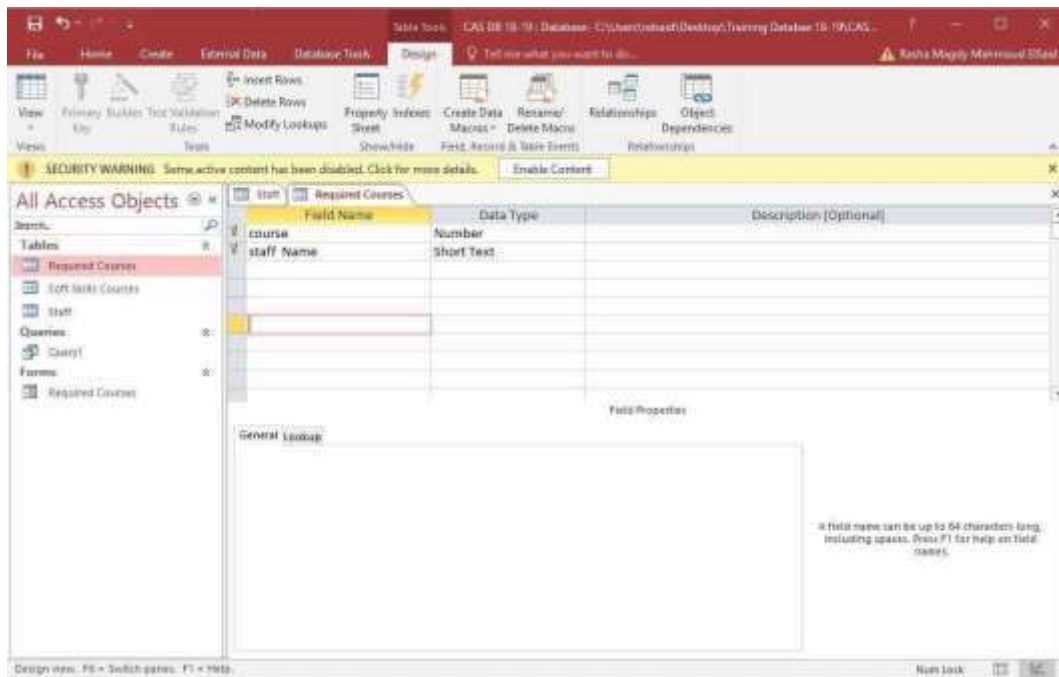
Staff Table

Field Name	Field Type	Description (optional)
ID	Short Text	
Full Name	Short Text	
Job Title	Short Text	
Department Description	Short Text	
AUS email	Short Text	

Soft Skills Courses Table



Required Courses



Required Courses Form

Training Coordinator uses the Required Courses form to enter the requested courses for his/her staff members. List of courses are available in the Courses drop list box and staff names are available in the Employee Name drop down list box.

The screenshot shows the Microsoft Access application window with the 'Required Courses' form open. The form contains two text boxes: 'Course' and 'Employee Name'. The 'All Access Objects' pane on the left shows the 'Required Courses' form selected under the 'Forms' section. The status bar at the bottom indicates 'Record 16 of 16' and 'Table: Required Courses'.

Appendix A

Email sent to all staff in July of every year

Dear Colleagues,

I am pleased to inform you that the list of **Soft Skills** training has been identified for this academic year.

You are kindly requested to discuss your training needs with your line manager in order to agree on the courses that you should take to enhance your skills and increase your productivity.

Please take into consideration the following points:

- The maximum number of training courses allowed for staff is 3 courses.
 - ▢ Courses are classified according to staff's levels, most of the courses are granted to all staff, however, there are some courses that are allowed only for supervisors or managers and above. Therefore, please make sure that your chosen courses match your current level.
 - ▢ Each department has a coordinator who collects the training requirements and sends them to me, therefore, I apologize for not being able to receive the training requirements from individuals.
 - ▢ All training requirements must be **approved** by the line manager and **sent** through the department coordinator.

If you have any further enquiries, please don't hesitate to contact me on Ext. 2285. **Best Regards,**
Rasha Magdy El Said

Human Resources Manager - Training and Development Human Resources Department Tel +971 6 515 2285

Fax +971 6 515 2139

American University of Sharjah PO Box 26666, Sharjah United Arab Emirates <http://www.aus.edu>
relsaid@aus.edu

Appendix B

List of Training Coordinators

Name	Department	Title
	Administrative Assistant	Information Technology
	Communications Coordinator	Office of Strategic Communication & Marketing
Aldrine Irene Creado	Manager Financial Grants & Scholarships	Office of Fin. Grants & Scholarships
Binu Kabeer Ibrahim	Administrative Assistant	Academic Support Center
Crisol Guintu	Administrative Assistant	Operations – Operations
Dana Yousef Ajjawi	AUS Call Center	Operations - Housing Division
Enas Said Subhi Tabakhah	Assistant to Dean	College of Arts and Sciences
Grace Morales	Director of Internal Exchange Office	International Exchange Office
Kristine Marcelo Castellort	Assistant to the Dean	School of Business Administration
Lamaan Darkan	Executive Assistant	Office of Student Affairs
Medelyn Marasigan	Administrative Assistant	Office of Protocol
Nabeel Issa Khalil Amireh	Director -Academic Computing	Office of Academic Computing
Nesrin Atabay	Administrative Assistant	Library Services
Rami Mahfouz	Director of Enrolment Service	Office of Enrolment Management
Rania Salah El Din Morsi	Director Development & Donor Relationship	Office of Advancement & Alumni Affairs
Reem Al-Alami	Finance	Finance Manager
Savio Creado	Assistant to the Dean	College of Architecture, Art and Design
Teresa Abesamis Oltiveros	Administrative Assistant	Achievement Academy
Vidya Malkani	Procurement Manager	Supply Chain

Appendix C

Dear Colleagues,

I would like to thank you for your interest in attending the Concentration Skills training. There are three sessions for this course. You should attend only **ONE** session.

The first session is scheduled on 12th December 18, the second is on 13th February 2019 and the third is on 14th March 2019. All sessions will be from 9:00 until 4:00 in M103.

Kindly login to the [Concentration Skills Training Link](#) and register taking into consideration that the seats are limited in each session.

The deadline for registration is 31st October 2018.

Best Regards,

Rasha Magdy El Said

Human Resources Manager - Training and
Development Human Resources Department



Tel +971 6 515 2285
Fax +971 6 515 2139
American University of Sharjah

PO Box 26666, Sharjah United Arab Emirates <http://www.aus.edu> relsaid@aus.edu

Appendix D - Evaluation Sheet

 American University of Sharjah Human Resources Department Training Evaluation Sheet

Course Name: _____ Date: _____
 Trainer: _____ Employee Name: (Optional) _____

Please read the questions carefully and select the criteria that best reflects your response.

Would you recommend this course to other colleagues? ☐ Yes ☐ No

On a scale of 1 to 10 (1 Strongly disagree and 10 Strongly agree), to what extent did you enjoy this course? ☐

Curriculum				
1. Did the training meet your expectation?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Were the training objectives identified and followed?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Do you feel you will be able to apply what you have learnt to your work?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. How would you rate the overall course?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. Was the course content organized and easy to follow?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Evaluating the Trainer				
1. How do you rate the trainer's presentation style?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Was the trainer interested and addressed trainees' questions/concerns?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Did the trainer allow enough time for discussions?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. How well did the trainer answer the questions that were asked?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Additional Comments
1. Which of the training presentations or topics were most useful to you?
2. Which of the training presentations or topics were least useful to you?
3. What presentations or topics were you expecting to hear, but were not presented?
4. What items or activities would you like to see added to this training?
5. What other courses are you interested in taking?

We would like to thank you for your feedback.

Appendix E

Courses for Academic Year 2018-2019

Course	Delivery	Duration	Level	Objectives
1. Advanced Communication Skills	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• Prevent misunderstandings by clarifying intentions and avoid common mistakes that escalate the situation rather than resolve it • Avoid blaming others and take responsibility • for your own contribution to any situation • Understand and manage your feelings so they don't clutter your understanding or affect your conversations with others.
2. Assertiveness Skills	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• Distinguish between assertive, aggressive and passive behavior • Express yourself assertively using specific verbal and non-verbal techniques and get maximum results • Request what you want assertively and get it.
3. Business Writing Skills	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	• To review the basic principles of business writing • To encourage thinking about the key messages writers, intend to convey to their readers • To recognize the impact that poor grammar, spelling, and punctuation has on a writer's credibility • To develop a range of useful phrases to be used in business correspondence
4. Coaching for Peak Performance	External Training Provider	2 Days	Manager and above	• Identify preferred leadership style • Examine the benefits of developing style flexibility • Evaluate skills and knowledge of different performance management approaches
5. Communication Skills	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• Understanding Effective Communication and how it works • Understand non-verbal communication • Impact of the toxic behavior in the workplace • Know how to communicate more assertively
6. Concentration Skills	External Training Provider	1 Day	All Staff	• Identifying attentional focus • Recognize the types of attentional focus • Understand strategies for focus and concentration • Develop concentration skills and abilities

7. Conducting Interviews	Training Manager	1 Day	Employees who interview potential candidates	- Follow a suitable strategy when interviewing based on your specific requirements - Take the necessary steps before conducting an interview - Choose the best interviewing strategy and questioning methodology to pick the best applicant
8. Creative Problem Solving and Decision Making	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	- To recognize the importance of dealing with the cause of the problem, rather than just dealing with the effect of a problem - To learn how to generate alternative solutions, using creative thinking and brainstorming - To learn the different stages of the decision making process and understand the importance of each stage in ensuring effective decisions are made
9. Customer Drive - Game Based Training	External Training Provider	1 Day	All Staff	- Within the challenging setting of this game, participants learn important lessons about customer needs and what it takes to meet them. - They also address other topics such as dealing with questions and handling complaints in the most effective way. - Facing customer demands, participants will also feel the pressure to do so efficiently in order to keep waiting times low whilst continuously balancing between service effectiveness and cost
10. Design Thinking and Innovation	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	- Apply innovation and innovative processes within organizations. - Identify the relationship between innovation, design thinking and entrepreneurship - Recognize the value of innovation to organizations
11. Emotional Intelligence	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	- To understand the elements of Emotional Intelligence - To increase your understanding of different aspects of human behavior - To understand how to manage your own emotional reactions to achieve desired results - To learn how to increase your ability to communicate and motivate others, based on understanding their emotions.
12. First Aid	Nurse from the Clinic	Half Day	All Staff	Topics that will be discussed during the training are:

				• First Aid basics • Medical Emergencies • Injury Emergencies • Environmental Emergencies
13. Giving Feedback	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• Understand the nature and purpose of giving feedback and how miscommunication takes place. • Know when you should give feedback to Others Deliver constructive feedback with a potential negative message • Take advantage of the incredible power of giving praise to others using established guidelines on showing gratitude
14. Goal Setting	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• To define your goals in way that will help you achieve them and increase the likelihood of success • To use the GROW model to self-coach or coach others • Create a mission statement and define your long-term goals using the 8-steps technique • To appreciate the incredible power of goal setting and its impact on your success
15. Influencing Skills	External Training Provider	1 Day	All Staff	• How to become a positive force using powerful influence skills • Build and leverage your influencing skills with Social Intelligence • Get results working with different & challenging personalities • Acquire flexibility to gain collaboration with others. • Apply personality styles to build influential communication.
16. Learning to Learn	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• Discover your learning style to better focus your efforts • Plan your learning, use learning tools to increase your learning and evaluate yourself based on your objectives • Unblock barriers to learning when feeling stuck
17. Money Smarts	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	• MoneySmarts is a workshop that revolves around learning the fundamentals of personal finance. • It includes the process of determining one's short-term and long-term financial goals in order to manage finances in an efficient manner. • Learn how to control over both income

				and expenses and avoiding the burden of debt. It also enables a person to make wise decisions about spending and saving.
18.Overcoming Procrastination	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	- What causes procrastination, how this can become a critical problem and what is an ideal approach to address it - Use self-tracking to monitor yourself and increase your self-awareness to avoid procrastination - Analyse your self-esteem by increasing your awareness of your mentality, what causes it, how to accept it and how to improve it
19.Personal Impact	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	- Define your brand and how you want others to see you - Increase your confidence and stop being shy when confronted with new situations - Learn how to make small talk and present yourself
20.Planning and Organizing Skills	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	- To understand the principles and importance of correct planning - To have a clear understanding of the essentials of planning - To learn to set objectives to aid in the achievement of the goals - To organize and adapt plans for successful implementation - To understand how to use planning tools such as Gantt Charts - To understand and practice the principles of prioritizing work effectively
21.Team Building	Training Manager	1 Day	Staff from the same department	- Identify how teams progress overtime and how does this impact team member and the leaders' leadership style - Evaluate a team's balance based on Team Roles and use systematic methods to enhance the efficiency of a team's intercommunications - Use empathic communication and increase your understanding of emotional skills - Discover what you know about yourself and how others think of you
22.The Art of Stress and	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	- Understand how thought structures relate to our emotions and affect our behaviour - Learn how to assess how well you handle

Anger Management				anger • Learn how we experience stress and how to transform it into useful emotions • Practice the use of the stress-reduction techniques and experience immediate results • Understand the importance of, and useful techniques for, setting and achieving goals
23.The Power of Positive Thinking	External Training Provider	2 Days	All Staff	• Establish the idea of positive thinking in a more realistic manner • Familiarity with tools of Humanistic Psychology for behavioural change • Understand and manage one's thinking processes for more vital living • Learn how to reframe life's events to get the best out of every situation
Time Management	Training Manager	1 Day	All Staff	• What is Time Management? • Benefits of managing your time well • Poor time management styles • Develop your goals & objectives • Identify time wasters

Appendix F

List of Training Providers

Training Provider	Company Website
1. HNI Training and Coaching	https://www.hni.ae/
2. Inform Middle East	https://www.informa-mea.com/
3. Meirc Training and Consulting	https://meirc.com/
4. Oakwood International	http://www.oakwooddubai.ae/
5. Pro-training	https://www.protraining.net/
6. Spearhead	https://www.spearhead-training.com/

Appendix G – Speaker Form



Speaker Approval Form

Name of Event:	Date of event:	Time of Event:
Email address of Requester:	Telephone number of Requester:	Department:
Location of event:	Any outside attendance: ☐ Yes ☐ No	Date received by Office of CPS

Purpose of the event Staff Training
Description of the event
Name, designation and short Bio of the presenter (further documents if the area below is not enough)
Title / description of the presentation (attach further document if the area below is not enough)

Requested by: _____ Employee's Name	Signature: _____	Date: _____
Approved by: _____ Dean/Department Head Name	Signature: _____	Date: _____
Approved by: _____ Office of Chief of Protocol & Security	Signature: _____	Date: _____

Please note:

- 1- The Office of Protocol & Security only accepts requests submitted minimum 2 weeks before the event date.
- 2- Speaker's passport copy, The passport must be valid for at least 6 months.
- 3- All requests are tentative until approved by the Chief of Protocol & Security.
- 4- In certain situations, further documents and information might be required.
- 5- In case the speech is part of a conference, conference agenda must be submitted along with the other requirements.

Form updated: October 10, 2016

Page 1 of 1

2. Technical Training

Purpose

This Standard Operating Procedure sets out the procedure for arranging the technical training for AUS staff.

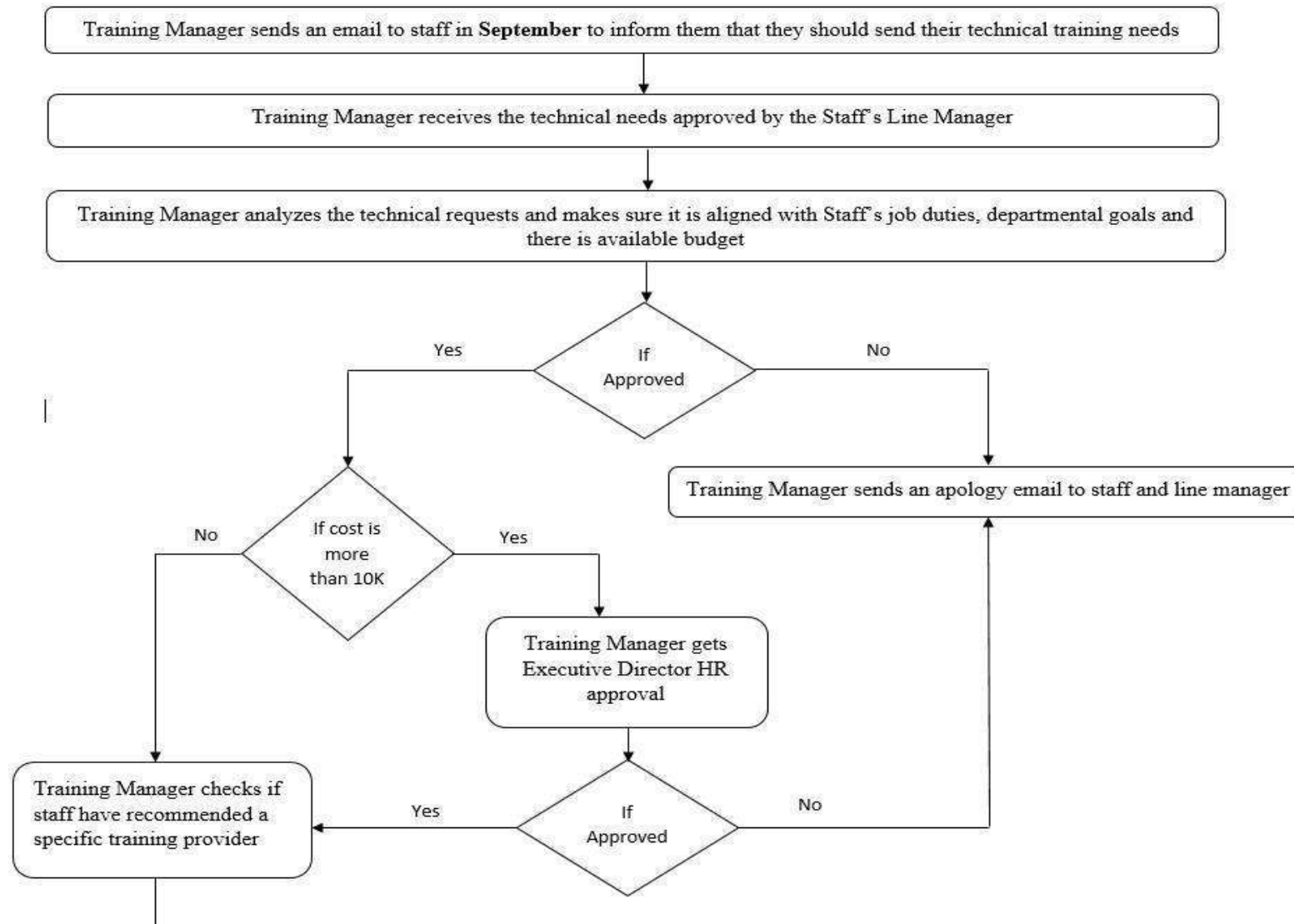
Audience

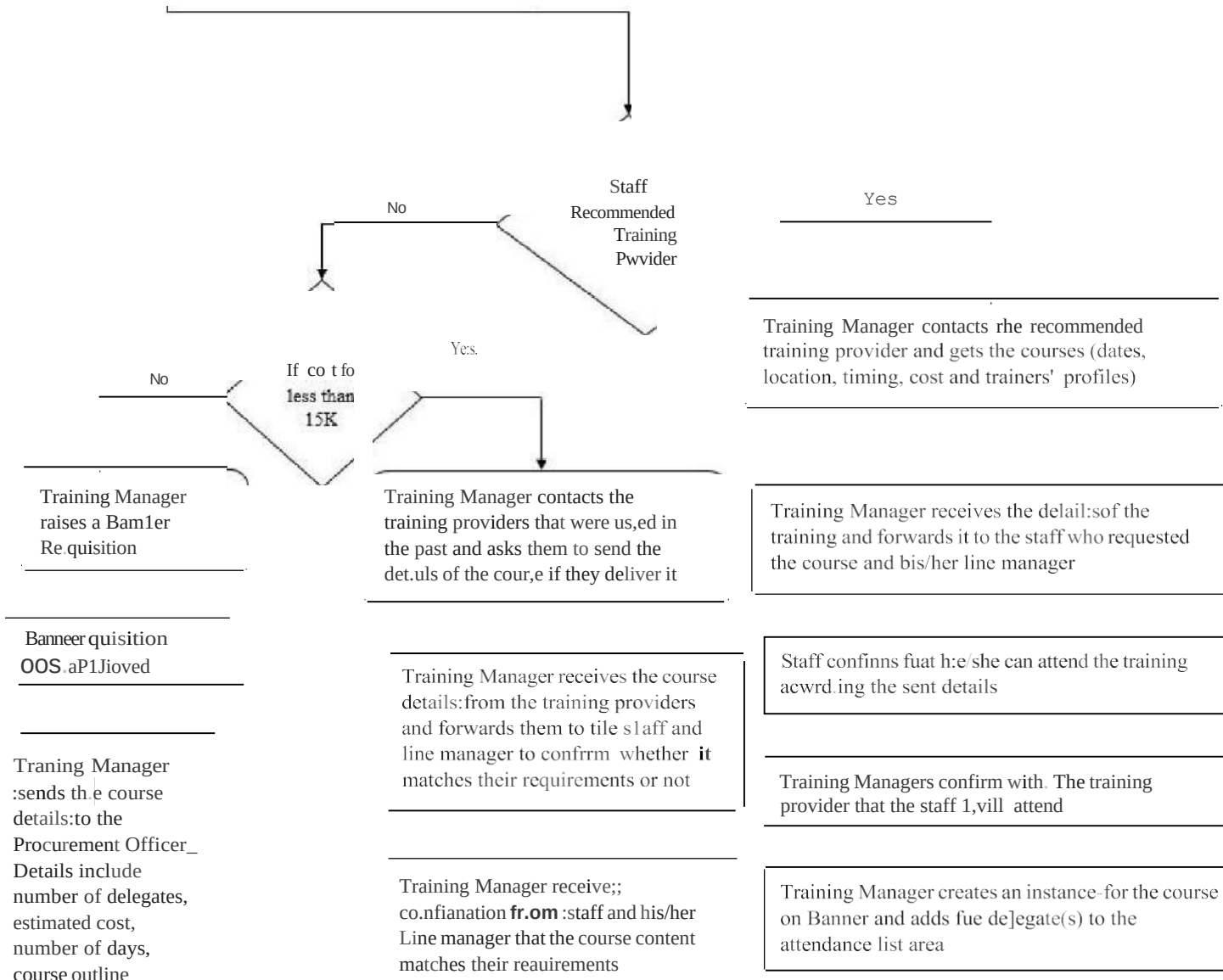
- HR

Technical Training Information

- The training budget for both soft skills and technical skills is agreed at the BOT in **June** every year. The Executive Director of HR confirms the budget to the Training Manager for the next academic year.
- Only full-time staff are entitled to attend technical training courses after they pass the probation period.
- Training Manager sends email to all staff in **September** of every year to inform them that they should send their approved technical training needs. See Appendix A for example email.
- Staff may send their approved technical training needs anytime during the academic year.
- Technical training should to be approved by staff's line manager.
- Training Manager analyses the technical training requests and makes sure they are aligned with staff's job duties and are subject to budget availability.
- If the cost of technical course is more than 10,000 AED, then the Training Manager should get the Executive Director of HR approval.
- The payment for the technical courses can be either by direct payment or by issuing PO through the Supply Chain Department.
- In case staff have recommended a specific training provider then the payment will be direct.
- If there is no recommended training provider, and the cost of the training is more than 15,000 AED then they payment should be made by issuing a PO, otherwise the payment will be direct.
- If the cost of the course is above 10, 000 AED and the payment is direct, then the VCFA should sign the invoice before sending it to the Finance Department.
- Line Managers/staff may recommend a specific training provider. Subject to procurement policy.
- List of frequently used technical training providers is mentioned in Appendix B.

Flow Chart of the Technical Training Process





Procurement Officer
sends RFP to
registered training
providers

Procurement Officer
receives the training
courses details from
training providers and
forwards it to the
Training Manager

Training Manager sends
the course details to the
staff and line manager to
confirm whether it
matches their
requirements or not

Training Manager
receives confirmation
from staff and his/her
line manager that the
course content matches
the requirements

Training Manager notifies
the Procurement Officer
which training provider
will be selected

Training Manager notifies the selected
training provider that staff will join
the training

Training Manager creates an instance
for the course on Banner and adds the
delegates

Training Manager sends a reminder to
the delegate(s) one week before the date.
Details include date, timing, and
location

Training Manager asks the training
provider to send the attendance sheet

Training Manager asks the staff to send
a copy of the training certificate

Training Manager sends the evaluation
sheet to the staff and asks him/her to fill
it out and send it back

Training Manager receives a copy of the
certificate and the evaluation sheet from
staff

Training Manager evaluates the course

Training Manager sends a reminder to
the delegate(s) one week before the
date. Details include date, timing, and
location

Training Manager asks the training
provider to send the attendance sheet
after the delivery of the course

Training Manager asks the staff to send
a copy of the training certificate

Training Manager sends the evaluation
sheet to the staff and asks him/her to fill
it out and send it back

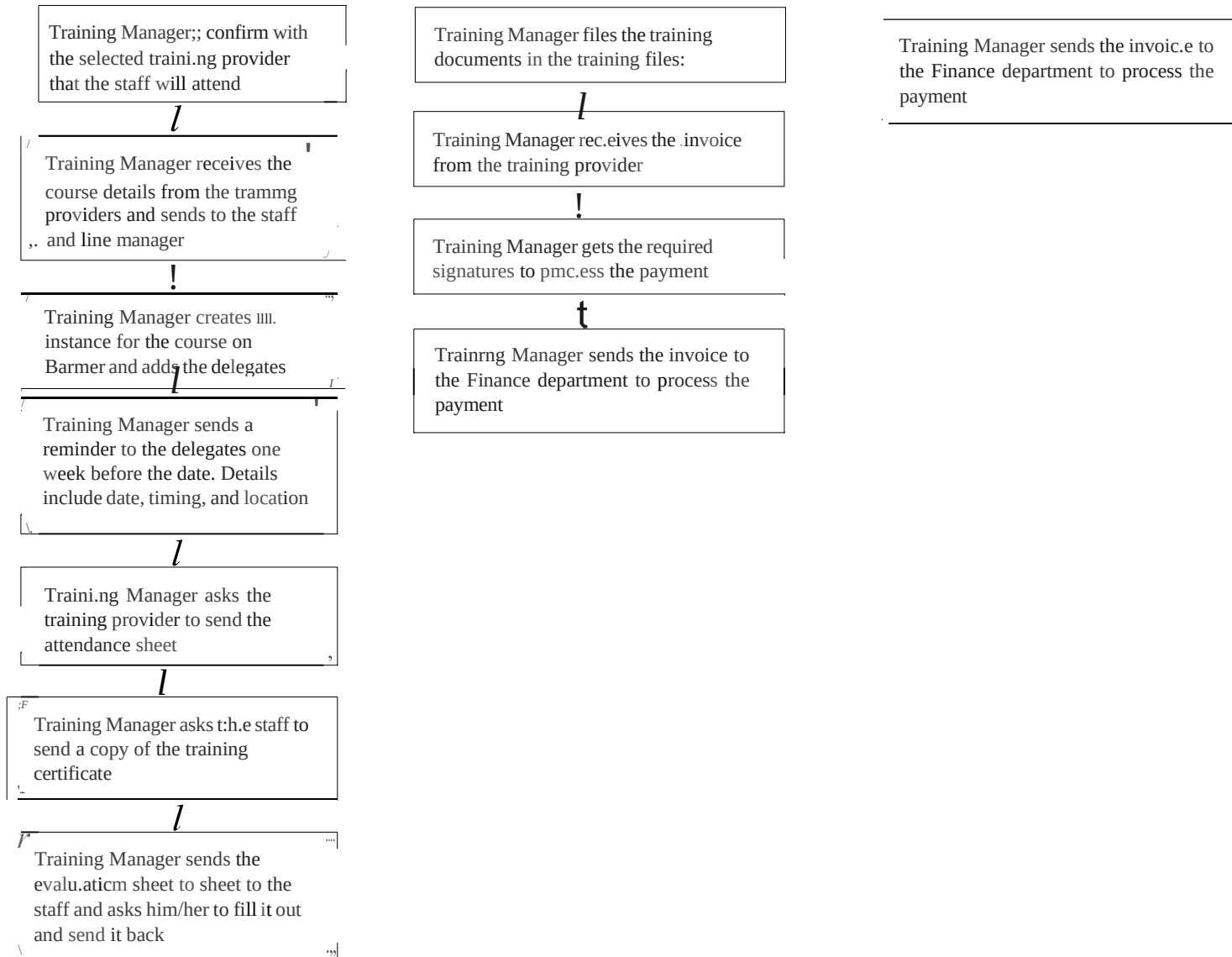
Training Manager receives a copy of the
certificate and the evaluation sheet from
staff

Training Manager evaluates the course

Training Manager files the training
documents in the training files

Training Manager receives the invoice
from the training provider

Training Manager gets the required
signatures to process the payment





Evaluation of Training Course

The Training Manager uses the Evaluation Sheet, which is mentioned in Appendix C to evaluate the training courses

Curriculum				
1. Did the training meet your expectation?	Excellent ☐	Good ☐	Satisfactory ☐	Poor ☐
2. Were the training objectives identified and followed?	Excellent ☐	Good ☐	Satisfactory ☐	Poor ☐
3. Do you feel you will be able to apply what you have learnt to your work?	Excellent ☐	Good ☐	Satisfactory ☐	Poor ☐
4. How would you rate the overall course?	Excellent ☐	Good ☐	Satisfactory ☐	Poor ☐
5. Was the course content organized and easy to follow?	Excellent ☐	Good ☐	Satisfactory ☐	Poor ☐

The Training Manager counts the total number of Excellent points, Good, Satisfactory and Poor for each question. He/she then multiplies the sum of Excellent by 4, the sum of Good by 3, the sum of Satisfactory by 2 and the sum of Poor by 1. Then he/she gets the sum of these multiplications and divide it by total number of the points. Then multiply this figure by 25 to get the percentage.

For example, the count of excellent points was 20 and the count for the Good points was 10 and the count for the Satisfactory points was 3, then $(20 \times 4) + (10 \times 3) + (3 \times 1)$ therefore the total is 113. Divide 113 by 33 $(20 + 10 + 3) = 3.42$

$$3.42 \times 25 = 85\%$$

Technical Skills Training Records

Technical Skills training records are stored in the Banner. To access these records, the Training Manager uses the Training Registration Report – PYPSTSR.

The screenshot shows a web-based form titled "Training Registration Report: PYPSTSM (A.U. PROD)". The form has a "Select Report:" dropdown menu set to "Training Registration Report". Below this, there are several input fields and dropdown menus arranged in two columns. The left column includes "Reference Number:", "Reference Date From:", "Training Location:", "Training Code:", "Department:", "ID:", "Status:", and "Generate to File:". The right column includes "Category:" (set to "HR"), "Reference Date To:", and "Training Group:". At the bottom, there are two dropdown menus for "Printing Method:" (set to "Screen") and "Report Format:" (set to "PDF").

Create a Session Instance

- Open the Banner

https://bancas01.aus.edu:8443/authenticationendpoint/login.do?Name=PreLoginRequestProcessor&TARGET=https%3A%2F%2Fbannernav.aus.edu%3A443%2FapplicationNavigator%2Fjspring_cas_security_check&commonAuthCallerPath=%252Fcas%252Flogin&forceAuth=false&passiveAuth=false&tenantDomain=carbon.super&sessionIdDataKey=3016ab44-c613-4555-9f20-2c8e92669c93&relyingParty=AppNav&type=cas&sp=AppNav&isSaaSApp=false&authenticators=BasicAuthenticator:LOCAL

- Access the Training Registration Access Form [PYPSTSM] or from the main Banner screen, click on AUS Operations Menu, then Safety and Security Menu, then click on Training Registration Maintenance Form.
- Click on Ctrl + Page Down
- Enter the following mandatory fields:
 - Training Date
 - No of Days
 - Start Time
 - End Time

- e. Training Location [Should use Training Location Validation Form PYVTRNL]
- f. Training Code [Should use Training Type Validation Form PYVTRNT]
- g. Trainer
- h. Max No of Participants
10. Save the form

American University of Sharjah - Internet - Native Banner (RIB) > Open > PYPSTSM

File Edit Options Block Item Record Query Tools Help

Training Registration Maintenance Form - PYPSTSM 8.0 (PROD)

Ref No:

Training Date:		No of Days:	
Start Time:		End Time:	
Training Location:			
Training Code:		Training Group:	
Trainer:		Training Cost:	
Max No of Participants:		Remaining:	
Department Code:		Provided Attendance Certificate:	
Contract Type:		Employee Type:	
Remarks:		UNCL:	
Web Registration:		Date From:	
User:		Date To:	
		Active Indicator:	
		Activity Date:	

ID	Name	Remarks	User	Activity Date	Status Ind.

Department:

*** Once Status is changed or Participant removed an e-mail will be sent to the employee.

Appendix A

Email sent to all staff Dear Colleagues,

Please send your approved technical training courses by 30 September 2018. Kindly note that processing your request depends on the following conditions:

- Your Manager's approval
- Whether the course is aligned with your job duties and departmental goals or not
- Subject to budget availability

If you have any queries, please do not hesitate to contact me. **Best Regards,**

Rasha Magdy El Said
Human Resources Manager - Training and Development Human Resources Department
Tel +971 6 515 2285
Fax +971 6 515 2139
American University of Sharjah

PO Box 26666,
Sharjah United Arab Emirates <http://www.aus.edu> relsaid@aus.edu

Appendix B

List of Technical Training Providers - Frequently Used

Training Provider	Company Website/Email	Type of Training
7. AUS CSE Academy Courses	faloul@aus.edu	IT courses
8. Belhasa Driving Centre (BDC)	http://www.bdc.ae/	Driving courses
9. Emirates Technical & Safety Development Centre.	www.etsdc.ae	Health and Safety courses
10. FIREBRAND	https://firebrand.training/ae	IT courses
11. Global Knowledge Training	https://www.globalknowledge.com/en-ae	IT courses
12. International Health, Safety and Environment Council	https://hsecouncil.org/	Health and Safety courses
13. Koenig Solutions Limited	www.koenig-solutions.com	IT courses
14. New Horizons Computer Learning Center	https://www.newhorizons.com/	IT courses
15. Oracle University	education_ae@oracle.com	IT courses
16. SitesPower	http://www.sitespower.com/	IT courses
17. SMME	www.smme.com	IT courses

Appendix C – Evaluation Sheet

 American University of Sharjah Human Resources Department Training Evaluation Sheet	
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Course Name: _____ Date: _____

Trainer: _____ Employee Name: (Optional) _____

Please read the questions carefully and select the criteria that best reflects your response.

Would you recommend this course to other colleagues? ☐ Yes ☐ No

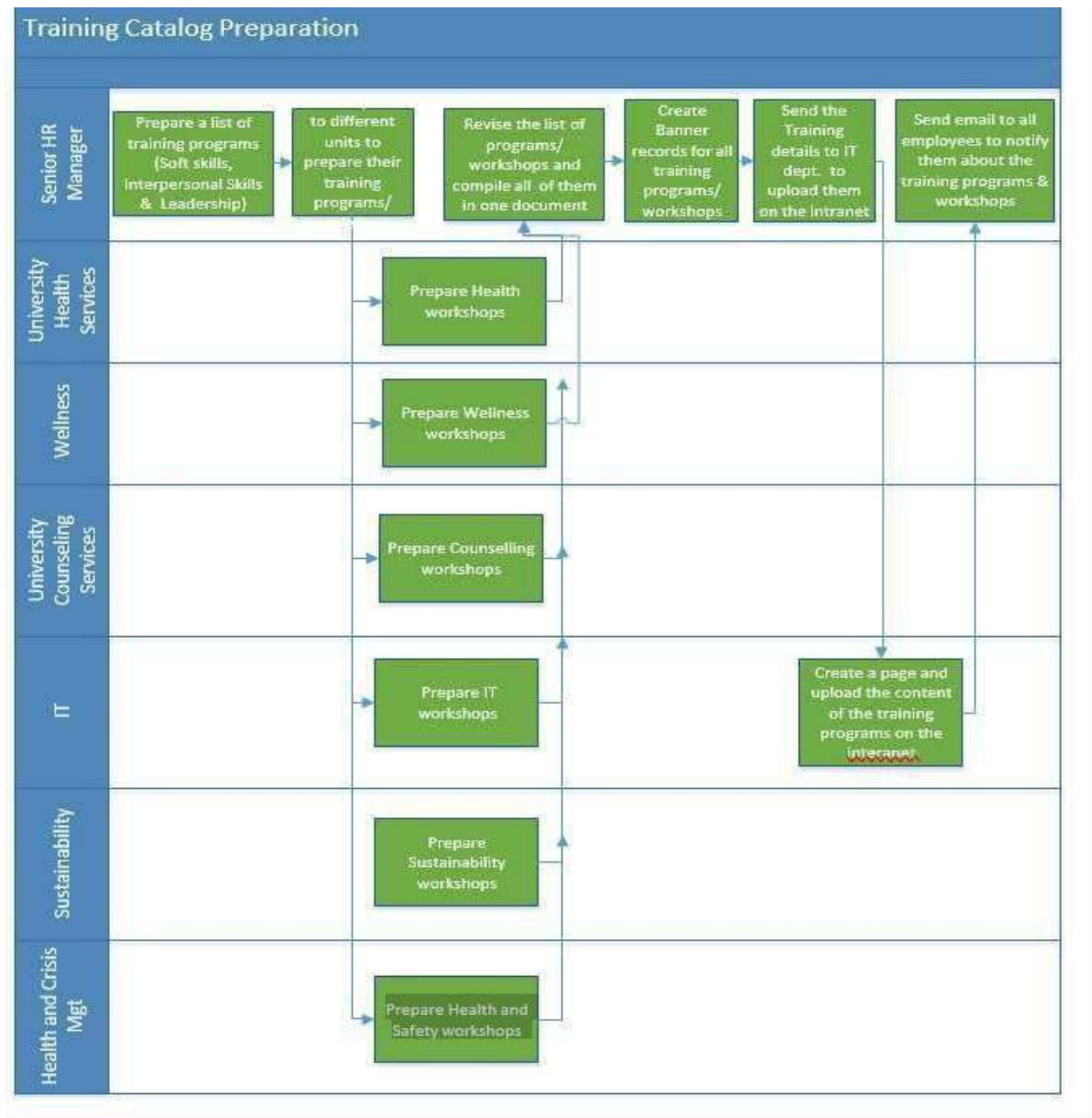
On a scale of 1 to 10 (1 Strongly disagree and 10 Strongly agree), to what extent did you enjoy this course? ☐

Curriculum				
1. Did the training meet your expectation?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Were the training objectives identified and followed?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Do you feel you will be able to apply what you have learnt to your work?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. How would you rate the overall course?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
5. Was the course content organized and easy to follow?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Evaluating the Trainer				
1. How do you rate the trainer's presentation style?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
2. Was the trainer interested and addressed trainees' questions/concerns?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
3. Did the trainer allow enough time for discussions?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐
4. How well did the trainer answer the questions that were asked?	Excellent	Good	Satisfactory	Poor
	☐	☐	☐	☐

Additional Comments
1. Which of the training presentations or topics were most useful to you?
2. Which of the training presentations or topics were least useful to you?
3. What presentations or topics were you expecting to hear, but were not presented?
4. What items or activities would you like to see added to this training?
5. What other courses are you interested in taking?

We would like to thank you for your feedback.



Appendix VII. Appropriate Use of Technology Resources Procedure

Appendix		Policy Title:	IT Acceptable Use Procedure
Prepared By:	ICT and IT Security Department	Issue Date:	December 1, 2012
Responsible Office/ Functional Area:	ICT and IT Security Department	Effective Date:	August 31, 2024
Approved By:	Chancellor	Date of Next Revision:	August 31, 2026

1. Policy: IT Acceptable Use Procedure

2. Purpose: Through a combination of technological controls and awareness campaigns, AUS implements our IT AUP. Each case is handled individually with input from the relevant organizational heads where appropriate.

3. Introduction / background: N/A

4. Procedure:

4.1 General Use and Ownership

4.1.1 While AUS's IT Department desires to provide a reasonable level of privacy, users should be aware that by utilizing university computing and networking resources they are consenting to relinquish their right to privacy for any personal information that is stored or transmitted on the university equipment. Because of the need to protect AUS's network and to comply with local laws, the university cannot guarantee the absolute confidentiality of information stored on any network device belonging to AUS. All data transiting the university network or stored on university computers is the property of the American University of Sharjah, which reserves the right to intercept, record, read or disclose it at the sole discretion of authorized personnel. Specifically, the university may disclose any information on or about these systems to law enforcement or other appropriate individuals. Users should not expect privacy of any data, whether business, medical or personal, even if encrypted or password-protected.

4.1.2 All students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at AUS have a responsibility to promptly report the theft, loss or unauthorized disclosure of AUS proprietary or confidential information.

4.1.3 All students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at AUS are responsible for exercising good judgment regarding appropriate use of information, electronic devices and network resources in accordance with AUS's policies and standards, and local laws and regulations.

4.1.4 Students, faculty and staff are responsible for exercising good judgment regarding the reasonableness of personal use. Individual departments are responsible for creating guidelines concerning personal use of Internet/Intranet/Extranet systems. In the absence of such policies, faculty and staff should be guided by departmental policies on personal use, and if there is any uncertainty, faculty and staff should consult their supervisor or manager.

4.1.5 The IT Department recommends that any information that users consider sensitive or vulnerable be encrypted. For guidelines on information classification, see the IT Department's Information

Sensitivity Policy. The IT Department also recommends that all files that users consider valuable or important be saved to the individual or department network folders provided by the IT department to avoid the loss of data. For guidelines on encrypting email and documents or using the individual and department network folders, go to the IT Department's Awareness Initiative.

4.1.6 For security and network maintenance purposes, authorized individuals within AUS may monitor equipment, systems and network traffic at any time, per the IT Department's Audit Policy.

4.1.7 AUS reserves the right to audit networks and systems on a periodic basis to ensure compliance with this policy.

4.2 Security and Proprietary Information

4.2.1 The user interface for information contained on Internet/Intranet/Extranet-related systems should be classified as either confidential or not confidential, as defined by confidentiality guidelines, details of which can be found in the Human Resources Policy Manual. Examples of confidential information include but are not limited to: private strategies, competitor sensitive, trade secrets, specifications, customer lists and research data. Faculty and staff should take all necessary steps to prevent unauthorized access to this information.

4.2.2 System level and user level passwords must comply with the Password Policy. Providing access to another individual, either deliberately or through failure to secure its access, is prohibited.

4.2.3 All computing devices must be secured with a password-protected screensaver or lock screen with the automatic activation feature set to 10 minutes or less. You must lock the screen or log off when the device is unattended.

4.2.4 Use encryption of information in compliance with the IT Department's Acceptable Encryption Use policy.

4.2.5 Because information contained on portable computers is especially vulnerable, special care should be exercised. Protect laptops in accordance with the Laptop Security Tips.

4.2.6 Postings by faculty and staff from an AUS email address to newsgroups should contain a disclaimer stating that the opinions expressed are strictly their own and not necessarily those of AUS, unless posting is in the course of business duties.

4.2.7 All hosts used by the students, faculty or staff that are connected to the AUS Internet/Intranet/Extranet, whether owned by the user or AUS, shall be continually executing approved virus-scanning software with a current virus database unless overridden by departmental or group policy.

4.2.8 Students, faculty and staff must use extreme caution when opening email attachments received from unknown senders, which may contain malware that may have bypassed the university scanning tools.

4.3 Unacceptable Use

The following activities are, in general, prohibited. Students, faculty and staff may be exempted from these restrictions during the course of their legitimate academic needs or job responsibilities (e.g., systems administration staff may have a need to disable the network access of a host if that host is disrupting production services).

Under no circumstances is a student, faculty or staff of AUS authorized to engage in any activity that is illegal under local, federal or international law while utilizing AUS-owned resources. Specifically, all students, faculty and staff must abide by articles of the UAE Federal Decree-Law no. 5 of 2012 on Combating Cybercrimes, which highlights a number of computer and online related activities and how they would be dealt with under the law. Reference to the law and additional commentary are documented in section 3.

The lists below are by no means exhaustive, but attempt to provide a framework for activities which fall into the category of unacceptable use.

4.3.1 Access to Inappropriate Material: In all administrative, academic and residential hall areas, AUS constituents will not use the university's system to access material that could be considered religiously offensive or hateful, that contains pornography, or that promotes or instructs on hacking or criminal activities.

Exceptions can be made if access to this material is required for valid and necessary academic or professional purposes.

4.3.2 System and Network Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited, with no exceptions:

1. Violating the rights of any person or company protected by copyright, trade secret, patent or other intellectual property, or similar laws or regulations, including, but not limited to, the installation or distribution of "pirated" or other software products that are not appropriately licensed for use by AUS.
2. Unauthorized copying of copyrighted material including, but not limited to, digitization and distribution of photographs from magazines, books or other copyrighted sources, copyrighted music, and the installation of any copyrighted software for which AUS or the end user does not have an active license is strictly prohibited.
3. Exporting software, technical information, encryption software or technology, in violation of international or regional export control laws, is illegal. The appropriate management should be consulted prior to export of any material that is in question.
4. Introducing malicious programs into the network or server (e.g., viruses, worms, Trojan horses, email bombs, etc.).
5. Revealing your account password to others or allowing use of your account by others. This includes family and other household members when work is being done at home.
6. Using an AUS computing asset to actively engage in procuring or transmitting material that is in violation of sexual harassment or hostile workplace laws in the local jurisdiction.
7. Making fraudulent offers of products, items or services originating from any AUS account.
8. Making statements about warranty, expressly or implied, unless it is a part of normal job duties.
9. Effecting security breaches or disruptions of network communication. Security breaches include, but are not limited to, accessing data of which the student, faculty or staff is not an intended recipient or logging into a server or account that the student, faculty or staff is not expressly authorized to access, unless these duties are within the scope of regular duties. For purposes of this section, "disruption" includes, but is not limited to, network sniffing, ping floods, packet spoofing, denial of service, and forged routing information for malicious purposes.

10. Port scanning or security scanning is expressly prohibited unless prior notification to the IT Department is made and approved.
11. Executing any form of network monitoring which will intercept data not intended for the student, faculty or staff's host, unless this activity is a part of the student's academic curriculum or faculty and staff's normal job/duty.
12. Circumventing user authentication or security of any host, network or account.
13. Introducing honeypots, honeynets or similar technology on the AUS network.
14. Interfering with or denying service to any user other than the student, faculty or staff's host (for example, denial of service attack).
15. Using any program/script/command, or sending messages of any kind, with the intent to interfere with, or disable, a user's terminal session, via any means, locally or via the Internet/Intranet/Extranet.
16. Providing information about, or lists of, AUS students, faculty or staff to parties outside AUS.

4.3.3 Email and Communications Activities

The following activities are strictly prohibited, with no exceptions:

1. Sending unsolicited email messages, including the sending of "junk mail" or other advertising material to individuals who did not specifically request such material (email spam).
2. Any form of harassment via email, telephone or paging, whether through language, frequency or size of messages.
3. Unauthorized use, or forging or spoofing, of email header information.
4. Solicitation of email for any other email address, other than that of the poster's account, with the intent to harass or to collect replies. This includes, but is not limited to, sending phishing email messages that attempt to trick users into providing private information such as usernames and passwords, whether for AUS or any other entities.
5. Creating or forwarding "chain letters", "Ponzi" or other "pyramid" schemes of any type.
6. Use of unsolicited email originating from within AUS's networks of other Internet/Intranet/Extranet service providers on behalf of, or to advertise, any service hosted by AUS or connected via AUS's network.
7. Posting the same or similar non-business-related messages to large numbers of Usenet newsgroups (newsgroup spam) or websites.

4.3.4 Blogging and Social Media

1. Blogging by faculty and staff, whether using AUS's property and systems or personal computer systems, is also subject to the terms and restrictions set forth in this Policy. Limited and occasional use of AUS's systems to engage in blogging is acceptable, provided that it is done in a professional and responsible manner, does not otherwise violate AUS's policy, is not detrimental to AUS's best interests, and does not interfere with a faculty or staff's regular work duties. Blogging from AUS's systems is also subject to monitoring.
2. AUS's Confidential Information policy also applies to blogging. As such, faculty and staff are prohibited from revealing any AUS confidential or proprietary information, trade secrets or any other material covered by AUS's Confidential Information policy when engaged in blogging.
3. Faculty and staff shall not engage in any blogging that may harm or tarnish the image, reputation and/or goodwill of AUS and/or any of its students, faculty or staff. Faculty and

staff are also prohibited from making any discriminatory, disparaging, defamatory or harassing comments when blogging or otherwise engaging in any conduct prohibited by AUS's Non-Discrimination and Anti-Harassment policy.

4. Faculty and staff may also not attribute personal statements, opinions or beliefs to AUS when engaged in blogging. If a faculty or staff member is expressing his or her beliefs and/or opinions in blogs, the faculty and staff member may not, expressly or implicitly, represent themselves as a faculty or staff or representative of AUS. Faculty and staff assume any and all risk associated with blogging.
5. Apart from following all laws pertaining to the handling and disclosure of copyrighted or export controlled materials, AUS's trademarks, logos and any other AUS intellectual property may also not be used in connection with any blogging activity. The use of AUS trademarks and logos should follow the AUS Communications Policy developed by the Office of Strategic Communications and Marketing.

5. Compliance, monitoring, and review

Compliance Measurement: The Information Security team in the IT Department will verify compliance to this policy through various methods, including but not limited to, business tool reports, internal and external audits, and feedback to the policy owner.

Exceptions: Any exception to the policy must be approved by the IT Department's Information Security team in advance.

Non-Compliance: Any faculty and staff found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including termination of employment. Any student found to have violated this policy may be subject to disciplinary action, up to and including dismissal.

6. Reporting

- No additional reporting is required.

7. Records Management: Staff must maintain all records relevant to administering this procedure in a recognized University recordkeeping system.

8. Responsibilities:

- All users of university information resources, including students, faculty, staff, contractors, consultants, temporary, and other workers at the university, are responsible for understanding and adherence to this policy/procedure.
- The Department of ICT and IT security is responsible for verifying compliance to this policy or procedure by all users of the university information resources.

9. Definitions/Abbreviations/Acronyms:

- **Blogging:** Writing a blog. A blog (short for weblog) is a personal online journal that is frequently updated and intended for general public consumption.
- **Honeypot:** Programs that simulate one or more network services that you designate on your computer's ports. An attacker assumes you're running vulnerable services that can be used to break into the machine. A honey pot can be used to log access attempts to those ports including the attacker's keystrokes. This could give you advanced warning of a more concerted attack.

- Port Scan: Using tools that probe and enumerate all listening network ports or running services on hosts in a network. Often used to detect vulnerabilities and map networks by administrators or attackers.
- Spam: Unauthorized and/or unsolicited electronic mass mailings.

10. Related Policies, Procedures, Forms, Guidelines, and Other Resources:

- Password Policy
- UAE Federal-Decree Law No. 5 of 2012 – <https://itfaq.aus.edu/article/1>
- HR Policy Manual
- Student Code of Conduct
- AUS Communications Policy

11. Policy history:

Revision History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 1, 2012	New Policy	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration
2.0	June 18, 2016	Updated based on InfoSec review, Internal Audit recommendations, and the SANS Institute policy project. Added policy header and converted document to new format.	ICT and IT Security Department
3.0	April 14, 2019	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Office of Institutional Research and Analysis
4.0	May 17, 2024	Edited Policy: format updates to reflect the new template shared by the OIRA	Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

12. References:

Department Name	Department Contact Number	Department Email ID
ICT and IT Security Department (IT Service Desk)	Tel: +971 6 515 2121	itservicedesk@aus.edu

Appendix VIII.The Executive education



Contract

First Party	Second Party
American University of Sharjah (AUS) PO Box 26666 Sharjah United Arab Emirates Represented by: Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Organization Name: Location: Represented by:

1. CONTACT PERSONS

Contact person appointed by First Party:

Name:

Title:

Email address:

Telephone:

Contact person appointed by Second Party: Name: Title:

Email address: Telephone:

2. RESPONSIBILITIES (options for Virtual delivery)

AUS is responsible for:

- Providing XX hours of a virtual executive education program.
- Providing a virtual learning platform to deliver the complete program online.
- Delivering the program by AUS instructors and external consultants as required.
- Providing training material, whose intellectual property and copyright is retained by AUS.
- Conveying AUS *Certificates of Completion* to attendees that complete a minimum of XX% of sessions (as agreed with the client). The client is responsible for:
 - Sending a maximum of XX participants to the program.
 - Ensure that the participants are able to attend the program during its duration.
- Designating a representative to liaise with AUS staff on course content. This representative will attend a kick-off meeting with AUS instructors and staff to review the project scope, clarify roles and

responsibilities and discuss initiatives and outcomes of the program.

3. RESPONSIBILITIES (options for On-Site delivery)

AUS is responsible for:

- Providing a XX days executive education program, broken down into XX modules. Each module includes XX contact hours, held into XX consecutive days.
- Delivering the program by AUS instructors and external consultants, as required.
- Providing training material, whose intellectual property and copyright is retained by AUS, including: course descriptions, teaching materials, handouts and assignments.
- After completion of each module, AUS will share the attendance sheets, participants' summary of performance and evaluation surveys from both participants and instructors.
- Presenting AUS Certificates of Completion signed by the chancellor of AUS, to all participants that successfully completed the program.

The client is responsible for:

- Sending a maximum of XX participants to the program
- Ensure that the participants are able to attend the program during its duration
- Designating a representative to liaise with AUS staff on course content. This representative will attend a kick-off meeting with AUS instructors and staff to review the project scope, clarify roles and responsibilities and discuss initiatives and outcomes of the program.

4. SCHEDULE AND STATEMENT OF WORK

Total program duration: XX days, XX modules of XX consecutive training days per module

Starting date:

Ending date:

Tentative schedule and statement of work (schedule may be adjusted to instructor's availability)

N o .	Module Title	Date
1	...	...

Dates for kick-off meeting and debriefing meeting, to be announced in due course.

5. LIST OF INSTRUCTORS AND TIME COMMITMENT

N o .	Instructor Name	Number of Days

1	...	...
---	-----	-----

6. LOCATION OF DELIVERY

(Note: Virtual, AUS campus or client premises to be clarified here)

7. PROGRAM COST

For the estimation of the program cost, the items below have been taken into consideration:

a. Instructors' Remuneration

For the development of the course and lecturing on the described program days above, based on the instructor's profile and course submitted in this proposal.

b. Program Administration and Logistics

That includes, but is not limited to, the administration of the course, management of i- Learn, program material printouts, certificates, stationery and support. (revise for virtual delivery)

c. Catering

(Note: whether the contract cost includes catering or not to be clarified here.)

After taking into consideration, the new course requirements and the partnership opportunity between our organizations, the cost for the proposed course for a cohort of up

to **XX** participants, is:

AED XX,XXX + 5% VAT

8. PAYMENT TERMS

Contract is payable to American University of Sharjah. Payment terms for the custom program development and delivery are as follows:

- (Terms of payment to be clarified here)

Failure of the client to meet these payment terms may lead to a cancellation of the course/program. In that case, new terms need to be agreed.

9. INDEMNITY STATEMENT

The second party agrees to hold harmless the American University of Sharjah from and against any claims, actions or demands, including without limitation, reasonable legal and accounting fees, resulting from this contract.

10. TERM AND TERMINATION

This contract shall be valid throughout the duration of the program and shall automatically be terminated at the end of the program.

11. SIGNATURES

First Party

Signatory name:

Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

Signature

Date

Second Party

Signatory name:

Title:

Signature

Date

Appendix IX. Internship Manual

Note: Kindly check the next page for the Internship Manual.

AUS CAREER SERVICES INTERNSHIP MANUAL

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1. Introduction

The American University of Sharjah is committed to providing a comprehensive educational experience, seamlessly blending knowledge development and professional skills enhancement throughout the students' academic journey. In conjunction with these foundational elements, the Internship Program stands as another cornerstone in the building blocks designed to enhance students' employability skills. This integrated approach prepares our students holistically for a better future, linking academic knowledge with industry experience. By bridging theory and practice, the program is meant to offer students valuable insights that not only enhance their skills but also provide a perspective for discovering their purpose and identifying a suitable career path. This commitment underscores our dedication to fostering well-rounded, career-ready individuals.

We encourage our students to embrace the transformative potential of the internship experience, where learning goes beyond the classroom, and each opportunity becomes a stepping stone toward your professional success.

2. Benefits of Internships

Internships present a multitude of invaluable advantages for students, encompassing a rich array of transformative experiences and opportunities. Through internships, students embark on a journey of self-discovery, where they not only explore potential career paths but also gain a profound understanding of the intricate nuances and diverse dimensions within their chosen industries and fields. The internship opens doors to multifaceted advantages, summarized across four key axes.

a) Career Exploration and Clarity:

- Explore career opportunities that align with students' interests and skills.
- Gain insights into the complexity and breadth of professional practice.

b) Skill Development

- Develop transferable skills, including interpersonal communication, teamwork, and leadership, which are applicable in future job roles.

c) Networking Opportunities

- Build relationships and professional contacts during internships that may lead to future employment opportunities.

d) Real-World Application of Academic Knowledge

- Apply academic knowledge in real-world scenarios, gaining practical experience that enhances understanding.

3. Getting Started

To fulfil graduation requirements, undergraduate students must complete either a credit-bearing or 0-credit internship, depending on their major and the degree catalog where all type of internships are outlined. For further clarification or queries, students are encouraged to consult their academic advisors or reach out to the career services office in their respective colleges or school.

To ensure diverse learning experiences, students are encouraged not to pursue internships with their family-owned businesses. While national and international opportunities are welcome, internships must be industry-specific, enabling students to gain specialized expertise relevant to their field of study.

4. Internship Management Offices

At AUS, we prioritize effective internship implementation by ensuring dedicated oversight at each school and college. At each college and school, there is a dedicated career services office to manage the internship process, working in conjunction with faculty members who serve as internship coordinators. The professional career services managers oversee the smooth execution of internship programs within their respective academic units, ensuring alignment with both academic requirements and professional development goals. They work closely with internship supervisors, and students to facilitate the internship process, from initial planning to successful completion. By having a designated point of contact at each school and college, we ensure that internship opportunities are efficiently coordinated and aligned with the academic and professional goals of our students.

COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE, ART & DESIGN			
Position	Name	Email	Phone
CAAD Internship Coordinator	Rachida Cherki	internship-caad-arc@aus.edu internship-caad-des@aus.edu	06 515 2891
Art and Design Internship Faculty Advisor	Prof. Mohamed Mamdouh	internship-caad-des@aus.edu	06 515 4363
Architecture Internship Faculty Advisor	Prof. Juan Roldan	internship-caad-arc@aus.edu	06 515 2821

COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCES			
Position	Name	Email	Phone
Senior Manager Career Services	Hiba Khayata	hkhayata@aus.edu cascareerservices@aus.edu	06 515 2744

COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING			
Position	Name	Email	Phone
Senior Manager Career Services	Dana Saleh	dgsaleh@aus.edu	06 515 2937

SCHOOL OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION			
Position	Name	Email	Phone
Career Design Lab Senior Manager	Eleni Papailia	epapailia@aus.edu	06 515 2368

5. Eligibility Criteria

To be able to enrol in the internship program, students must meet specific eligibility criteria, including the followings:

- Be a full-time student.
- Completion of a minimum number of credit hours and specific prerequisite courses where applicable.
- Receive the consent of their Internship Program Coordinator to participate in the program.

These prerequisites ensure that students possess the fundamental knowledge and skills necessary for success in their internship positions, demonstrating their readiness to engage in valuable real-world learning experiences and contribute significantly to their chosen fields of study.

6. Requirements per academic units

Internship requirements for College of Architecture, Art & Design

Prior to registering for an internship course, CAAD students must fulfil all the requirements as indicated in the table below.

COLLEGE	Undergraduate Degree	Course Code	Internship Period	Prerequisites		Credits
				Minimum Credit Hours	Courses	
COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE, ART & DESIGN	Bachelor of Architecture	ARC 397	5 Weeks 200 hours	75	ARC 302	0
	Bachelor of Interior Design	IDE 397		75	-	0
	Bachelor of Science in Design Management	DES 397		75	-	0
	Bachelor of Science in Visual Communication	VIS 397		75	VIS 302	0
	Bachelor of Science in Multimedia Design	MUM 397		75	MUM 302	0

Note: If the internship falls during the month of Ramadan, the requirements will be as follow. [6 Weeks - 200 hours]

College of Arts & Sciences

Prior to registering for internship course, CAS students must fulfil all the requirements as indicated in the table below.

COLLEGE	Undergraduate Degree	Course Code	Internship Period	Prerequisites		Credit
				Minimum Credit Hours	Courses	
COLLEGE OF ART & SCIENCES	Bachelor of Arts International Studies	INS 497	5 Weeks - 200 hours	75	-	0
	Bachelor of Science in Physics	PHY 397		75	-	0
	Bachelor of Science in Environmental Sciences & Sustainability	ENV 497		75	-	0
	Bachelor of Arts in English Language & Literature	ENG 497		75	-	0
	Bachelor of Arts in Mass Communication	MCM 497		75	MCM 323 & MCM 326 IMC	0
					MCM 371 & MCM 381 JOURNALISM	0
	Bachelor of Arts in Psychology	PSY 497		75	PSY 403	0

Note: If the internship falls during the month of Ramadan, the requirements will be as follow. [6 Weeks - 200 hours]

College of Engineering

Prior to registering for a credit-bearing internship course, CEN students must fulfil all the requirements as indicated in the table below.

COLLEGE	Undergraduate Degree	Course Code	Internship Period	Prerequisites		Credit
				Minimum Credit Hours	Courses	
COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING	Bachelor of Science in Industrial Engineering	INE 497	16 weeks	70	ENG 204	2
	Bachelor of Science in Civil Engineering	CVE 497		70	ENG 204	2
	Bachelor of Science in Chemical Engineering	CHE 497		70	ENG 204	2
	Bachelor of Science in Mechanical Engineering	MCE 497		70	-	2
	Bachelor of Science in Electrical Engineering	ELE 497		70	ENG 204	2
	Bachelor of Science in Computer Engineering	CMP 497		70	ENG 204	2
	Bachelor of Science in Computer Science	COE 497		70	ENG 204	2
	All Engineering Majors	XXX 397	5 weeks 200 Hours	70	-	0

CEN INTERNSHIP OPTIONS & REQUIREMENTS:

- Students admitted to CEN prior to Fall 2023 are required to complete a Professional Training in their respective Majors (INE 397, CVE 397, CHE 397, MCE 397, ELE 397 CMP 397 COE 397) a minimum duration of 5 weeks and covering a minimum of 200 working hours.
- Students admitted to CEN Fall 2024 onward and those transferred to CEN 2.0 from old catalogs are required to complete a Professional Training in their respective Majors (INE 497, CVE 497, CHE 497, MCE 497, ELE 497 CMP 497 COE 497) a minimum duration of 16 weeks.

School of Business Administration

Prior to registering for any internship course, SBA students must fulfil all the requirements as indicated in the table below.

SCHOOL	Undergraduate Degree	Course Code	Internship Period	Prerequisites		Credits
				Minimum Credit Hours	Courses	
SCHOOL OF BUSINESS ADMINISTRATION	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration [All Majors]	BUS 397	5 weeks 200 Hours	75	-	0
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration [All Majors]	BUS 497	12 weeks 480 Hours	75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Accounting	ACC 497	15 weeks Minimum 240 hours	75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Economics	ECO 497		75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Finance	FIN 497		75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Information Systems & Business Analytics	ISA 497		75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Management	MGT 497		75	-	3
	Bachelor of Science in Business Administration, Major in Marketing	MKT 497		75	-	3

SBA INTERNSHIP OPTIONS & REQUIREMENTS:

- Students admitted to SBA prior to Fall 2016 or on and after Fall 2020 are required to complete a Business Internship course BUS 397: Business Internship, a minimum duration of 5 weeks and covering a minimum of 200 working hours).
- Students admitted to the BSBA program in Fall 2016 or thereafter and before Fall 2020 are required to complete a twelve-week (480-hour) Business Practicum (BUS 497). Students with a requirement of BUS 497: Business Practicum are given the choice to opt for one of the two options to fulfil their requirement:
 - Complete the BUS 397: Business Internship + a 300+ level business course. The requirement is fulfilled by: Passing both the BUS 397: Business Internship and the selected 300+ level business course*).
 - Complete the BUS 497: Business Practicum. The requirement is fulfilled by passing the BUS 497: Business Practicum
- Students admitted in Fall 2022 and thereafter need to complete a major-specific internship (XXX497, 15 weeks and 240 hours). The major-specific internships are:
 - ACC 497: Business Internship in Accounting
 - ECO 497: Business Internship in Economics
 - FIN 497: Business Internship in Finance
 - ISA 497: Business Internship in Information Systems and Analytics
 - MGT 497: Business Internship in Management
 - MKT 497: Business Internship in Marketing

Note:

- Students who have changed major or catalog in a given year will follow the requirements of their new catalog
- Students who change their major or catalog must conduct a degree audit with their academic advisors and ensure that graduation requirements are met.

Technical details:

- BUS 497 is a business core course. Accordingly, when BUS 497 is substituted by BUS 397 and 300+ level business course, then the latter will be counted in the Business Core Area.

- If the 300+ level business course is a: Major course: then it must be taken in addition to the 8 major required and major elective courses. The 9th course will not be counted in the Major Area. As mentioned above, it will be in the Business Core Area.
- SBA Minor required or elective: The course will not count in the free elective area. It will be in the Business Core Area.
- The difference between the general internships and the major specific internships in the School of Business Administration:
 - BUS 397 and BUS 497 can be in any business field. While it is encouraged that students complete their internship in their major, BUS 397 and BUS 497 options give students the flexibility to explore other business functions.
 - Major specific internships must be relevant to the student's major:
 - ACC 497: Business Internship in Accounting must be completed by students majoring in accounting.
 - ECO 497: Business Internship in Economics must be completed by students majoring in Economics.
 - FIN 497: Business Internship in Finance must be completed by students majoring in Finance.
 - ISA 497: Business Internship in Information Systems and Analytics must be completed by students majoring in Info Systems and Analytics.
 - MGT 497: Business Internship in Management must be completed by students majoring in Management.
 - MKT 497: Business Internship in Marketing must be completed by students majoring in Marketing.

7. Internship Periods

Summer internships: Summer internships are scheduled between the end of May and the end of August. Internships bearing 0 credit hours can be pursued as follows:

- **Summer I:** typically spans from the end of May until mid-July.
- **Summer II:** generally, runs from mid-July to the end of August.

Restriction:

- Students cannot register for the summer internship course if they are simultaneously enrolled in another course during the summer semester¹.

Internships bearing 2 and 3 credit hours can be pursued as follows:

- Internship dates are typically from the end of May to the end of August, for any specific arrangements you need to get the consent of the internship coordinator, career services offices at school and colleges and the employer.

Winter internships

- Winter Internships are scheduled during the fall break, provided they meet the minimum duration requirements. For more information about the Winter Internship please consult with your respective career services office.

Fall and Spring Semester Internships: candidates should consult with Career Services Office and internship coordinators before considering this option.

Restrictions:

- CAS Students that are taking more than 7 credit hours during the Fall and Spring academic semesters are not allowed to take the internship course.
- CEN Students that are taking more than 10 credit hours during the Fall and Spring academic semesters are not allowed to take the internship course.
- SBA Students should abide by the following restrictions:
 - BUS 497:
 - BUS 497 cannot be taken in conjunction with other courses during the summer term.
 - During the Fall and Spring semesters, BUS 497 can be taken with 1 course, if needed.

¹ School of Business Administration allows 0 credit internships to run from summer I to summer II.

BUS 397:

- BUS 397 can be completed in Summer I or Summer II.
- You can take only courses in Summer I and do only BUS 397 in Summer II.
- During the Fall and Spring semesters, BUS 397 can be taken with no more than 2 courses.

Major-Specific Internships: ACC 497, ECO 497, FIN 497, ISA 497, MGMT 497, MKT 497

- They can be completed during a semester along with up to 4 courses.
- They can be completed during a Spring semester and the following summer term or a summer term and the following Fall semester.
- If a student is doing the internship, on a part-time basis in a regular semester, he/she will be advised to take four courses (12 credit hours) and make a work commitment of 16 hours per week (8 hours per day for 2 days/week).
- A student who takes no courses (zero credit hours) will be advised to work full-time, i.e. at least 32 hours per week.

Internships Dates and Duration

- Specific internship dates are mutually agreed upon by the employer, student, and internship coordinator for optimal schedule alignment.

Period	Internship Type	Starting Date	End Date	Restriction	Duration
Summer Internship	0 Credit	End of May	Mid of July	Restricted ²	5 Weeks minimum
Summer Internship	0 Credit	Mid of July	End of August	-	5 Weeks minimum
Summer Internship	2 & 3 Credits	End of May	End of August	Restricted	12 Weeks -16 Weeks
Winter Internships	0 Credit	End of December	End of January	Restricted ³	5 Weeks
Winter Internships	2 & 3 Credits	End of December	End of January	Restricted	4 - 5 Weeks
Fall Internships	2 & 3 Credits	September	Mid December	Restricted ⁴	12 to 16 Weeks
Spring Internships	2 & 3 Credits	February	Mid-May	Restricted	12 to 16 Weeks

Special Requirements

Major Specific Internship for SBA

Internship Code	ACC 497 ECO 497 FIN 497 ISA 497 MGT 497 MKT 497
Relevancy	Major Related Only
Tasks	You should carry tasks related to your major
Duration	The duration can't be below 15 weeks even if the working hours are beyond the minimum required (240 hours).
Credits	3 credit hours
Cost	Check with the student accounts for cost details

Double Major Internship

Students who are double majoring should consult with the internship coordinators from both departments or colleges to confirm their eligibility and obtain approval to apply one internship course towards both majors.

Excluded Internship Opportunities: Guidelines and Restrictions

- Internships at family business or under the supervision of a parent or direct relative are not allowed.
- Students cannot change employers or split the duration of the internship between two different employers unless otherwise approved by the internship coordinator and the career services manager.
- Working from home for some part of the internship duration that does not exceed 50% of the internship is acceptable only if this is the work culture or process adopted by the employer and in consultancy with your internship coordinator.⁵
- Full work from home or online internships will not be approved.

² You can't simultaneously enrol in another course during the summer semester.

³ This option might not be available every semester please check with your School or College

⁴ See restrictions for Fall & Spring Semester Internships

⁵ Applicable for CAAD Students.

Internships conclusion

- All internships must conclude before the first day of the next academic semester to facilitate a smooth transition except.
- SBA Major-Specific Internships can be completed during a Spring semester and the following summer term or a summer term and the following fall semester.

8. Internship Guidelines

Career Services in Academic Units and Office of Advancement and Alumni Affairs offer a comprehensive series of workshops aimed at equipping students with the necessary skills for a successful internship search. These workshops cover various aspects such as CV writing, Interview Skills, Internship search, Networking, and more. It is highly recommended for students to actively participate in these workshops, which are scheduled during the spring semester for summer internships and fall semester for winter internships. The dates for these workshops are communicated through the respective career offices at the academic units.

When to start looking for an internship

Whether you're aiming for a summer or winter internship, initiating your search early is crucial for securing the right opportunity. Starting early allows you to explore a wider range of options, conduct thorough research, and tailor your applications to each prospective internship.

Additionally, early preparation enables you to polish your resume, refine your cover letters, and gather any necessary supporting documents well in advance. By being proactive and organized, you increase your chances of standing out to potential employers and securing interviews. Furthermore, starting early gives you ample time to network, attend career fairs, and engage in informational interviews, all of which can enhance your chances of landing the ideal internship.

Preparatory Workshops

Attendance at these workshops and programs (Example: iLead by SBA), facilitated by Career Services at the school and colleges, is paramount as they are designed to equip you with essential skills and knowledge crucial for a successful internship pursuit. These sessions provide tailored guidance and resources, ensuring you are well-prepared and confident in navigating the internship search process effectively. The details of these sessions will be communicated to you via official internal communication [emails, posters, CDL App or social media] from the Career Services offices. It is imperative to adhere to the instructions provided, as participation in these workshops is mandatory to start your journey toward securing an internship.

a. Preparing a professional resume.

Crafting a polished professional resume is essential for effective career preparation, serving as a vital tool for showcasing skills, experiences, and qualifications to potential employers.

NB: CV Sample is in the appendix 8.

b. Cover Letter

The cover letter is indispensable for effective career preparation, especially in industries like consultancy, where it can be a deciding factor in the application process. It provides a unique chance to showcase tailored insights and alignment with the organization's goals, setting candidates apart and opening doors for successful career opportunities.

While not always mandatory, utilizing a cover letter offers a valuable opportunity to refine your writing skills and hone your professional pitch. Embracing this practice can significantly enhance your ability to effectively communicate your qualifications and enthusiasm for a position, potentially increasing your chances of standing out to employers.

NB: Cover Letter Sample is in the appendix 9.

c. Portfolio

Whether you are Architecture, Art & Design students, or any other background, compiling a portfolio serves as a vital tool for showcasing creativity, skills, and versatility. Whether presenting various projects or highlighting top works that align with employer requirements, the portfolio offers a comprehensive view of your capabilities and accomplishments. From architectural designs to multimedia productions, the portfolio demonstrates your ability to innovate and deliver results, making it an essential asset in securing opportunities within these dynamic industries.

d. Programme Learning Outcomes (PLOs)

Students should actively engage in consultation with their respective internship coordinators or career services offices to discern and articulate their learning objectives. This crucial step ensures that the internship experience aligns seamlessly with their educational goals. By discussing and clarifying these objectives with expert advisors, students gain invaluable insights into how their internship can contribute meaningfully to their academic and professional development. This process not only fosters a deeper understanding of their own aspirations but also enables them to tailor their internship experience to maximize its relevance and impact. Appendix 10.

- Schedule a consultation with your internship coordinator or career services office to discuss and clarify your learning objectives.
- Write your objectives based on the insights gained from discussions with your advisors.
- Submit the form outlining your objectives.
- Finalize and obtain approval for your objectives after discussing them with your career advisor.
- Take proactive steps to align your internship search journey with the approved objectives, ensuring that your experience seamlessly integrates with your educational goals.

e. Application Deadlines

Deadlines related to the internship process are communicated well in advance to students who meet the requirements and wish to pursue internship opportunities. It is imperative that students adhere to the directives provided by the career services offices at their respective school and colleges. These deadlines ensure that students have ample time to prepare and submit their applications, facilitating a smooth and organized internship application process.

f. Work Schedule

The internship schedule, subject to approval by the supervisor, will be chosen based on the position's required hours and the student's availability. The following regulations should be considered:

- Student interns must not work more than eight hours per day.
- During the Fall or Spring Internship, students are expected to meet minimum hour requirements as outlined in their catalogs and agreed upon by the internship coordinator of the career services management.
- A one-hour unpaid lunch break should be scheduled if the student is interning eight consecutive hours in a day.

9. Searching for Internships

Getting ready for your internships search

While the career services endeavours to provide internship opportunities aligned with our students' majors and career aspirations, it is imperative for students to proactively engage in securing their own placements. This proactive approach not only empowers students to navigate the internship search process effectively but also fosters valuable skills in decision-making and professional development.

To support our students throughout their search journey, the career services play an integral role in providing them with the essential knowledge and tools for securing internships. Through a variety of workshops, students

gain insights into the diverse range of resources accessible both within the university and externally. As students commence their internship search, they are actively encouraged to leverage these resources to their advantage.

University Career Services Resources

Career Advising Services:

- An invaluable resource, offering tailored guidance and support to students, equipping them with the skills and knowledge necessary to navigate and excel in their internship search. You may book an appointment to explore your options.

College /School	Staff	Email	Phone
College of Architecture, Art & Design	Rachida Cherki	rcherki@aus.edu	06 515 2891
College of Art & Sciences	Hiba Khayata	cascareservices@aus.edu	06 515 2744
College of Engineering	Dana Saleh	dgsaleh@aus.edu	06 515 2937
School of Business & Administration	Eleni Papailia	epapailia@aus.edu	06 515 2368
AUS Career Services	Kholoud Bassiouny	kbassiouny@aus.edu	06 515 2192
AUS Career Services	Yassine Otmani	careerservices@aus.edu	06 515 2063

Career Portal

- The [AUS Career Portal](#) stands as the pinnacle platform designed to cater to students in their quest for internships, featuring an extensive selection of exclusive opportunities presented by esteemed regional employers. Serves as a centralized hub where top UAE companies actively list internship positions, providing students with a diverse array of tailored opportunities to match their individual needs and career aspirations.

Online job portals and internship databases.

Companies' websites | Career Pages

- In addition to utilizing the AUS Career Portal, students are encouraged to explore internship opportunities through the career pages of various companies' websites. This approach not only allows for a comprehensive search but also provides insights into the culture, business lines, and values of potential employers.

LinkedIn

- Leveraging LinkedIn as a resource enables students to uncover suitable internship opportunities while honing essential networking skills, fostering connections with professionals in their field of interest for future career growth and development. Various workshop on how to use LinkedIn effectively are organized on regular basis.

Networking and informational Sessions.

- On Campus Information sessions by companies
- On campus professional networking events

Industry-specific organizations and events.

- Students should explore joining industry-specific organizations such as LinkedIn Groups and communities and prioritize attending industry seminars and workshops. Engaging with professionals in these settings offers valuable opportunities for students to enrich their knowledge, cultivate essential skills, and broaden their professional network, aligning closely with their career interests and aspirations.

Interview Preparation

- Workshops on Interview skills and professional etiquette.

The workshops on interview skills and professional etiquette, provided by the career services, offer students invaluable guidance in navigating the competitive job market. Attending these sessions is crucial for students as they provide essential tools and knowledge necessary to excel in interviews and professional settings. By participating in these workshops, students will be

equipped with the right skills to confidently present themselves and make a positive impression on potential employers, thus enhancing their prospects for success in their future careers.

- **Mock interview opportunities with companies**
The collaborative efforts between the career services and Human Resources professionals, whether in individual capacity or through Career Prep Days, encompass a dedicated component for mock interviews. These sessions provide an invaluable opportunity for students to practice their interviewing techniques, receive instant feedback, and refine their approaches, ultimately better preparing them for their job search endeavours. These opportunities will be advertised via the AUS Career Portal where you can book your seats.
- **Mock Interview practice via the career portal**
Students are encouraged to take advantage of the Mock Interview feature available on the career portal, providing a valuable opportunity to sharpen their interview skills. To access the 'Mock Interviews' section, students should follow the below steps.
 1. Login to the AUS Career Portal <https://aus-csm.symplicity.com>
 2. Click on Resources [Upper right menu]
 3. Select Mock Interviews
 4. Select from the two options: recommended interviews or creating their own interview.

Students will have the flexibility to choose their type of questions, the interviewer's character, and record their interview, students can tailor the experience to their preferences and needs. Sharing the recorded interview with their career counsellor allows students to receive personalized feedback, helping them to refine their interviewing techniques and build confidence for future job opportunities.

10. Internship Standards

A. Internship Posting Standards

Organizations recruiting students from the American University of Sharjah can do so free of charge using the AUS Career Portal Symplicity. All internships and employment opportunities submissions are reviewed and approved or rejected based upon the information contained in the postings. Positions posted on AUS Career Portal must adhere to the following criteria:

- All jobs and internships posted must be career related/professionally oriented and require candidates pursuing or already possessing university degree.
- All companies and organizations posting job or internship opportunities must be hiring candidates for their own human resource needs.
- Internship postings must meet the definition and criteria established for internships, and employment opportunities highlighted below.
- All companies and organizations must provide a job description detailing the below:
 - The internship position, including responsibilities, duties, and objectives. This should provide potential applicants with a clear understanding of what the internship entails.
 - Specify any required qualifications, such as academic background, skills, experience, or certifications.
 - Indicate the start and end dates of the internship, as well as the expected schedule (e.g., full-time, part-time, or flexible hours).
 - Specify the location of the internship, including whether it's onsite, remote, or a combination of both.
 - Provide clear instructions on how applicants should apply for the internship. This may include submitting a resume, cover letter, and any other required documents.

- Set a deadline for applications to be submitted.
- Include contact information for the person or department handling the internship application process.
- Specify whether the internship is paid or unpaid, as well as any additional benefits offered to interns.
- Career Page of the company to help us research your opportunity and direct the students for ample information.

B. Ineligible Job and internships

- Fee-based programs. Examples include fee-based training programs, fee-based placements or positions requiring the purchase of supplies or a training kit.
- Postings advertising events, services, or programs (e.g., career fairs, test prep, etc.).

C. Internship Acceptance and Approval

AUS Career Services welcomes career-related and professionally oriented internships from any industry or sector. When evaluating internships posted on AUS career portal, the following points are considered:

Meaningful Internship Experiences

Our students seek internship opportunities that offer significant, real-world experiences to complement their academic studies. Our goal is to facilitate connections between students and project-oriented, professional environments that contribute meaningfully to their professional development.

- Posted internships are evaluated on a case-by-case basis.
- We do not accept clerical or non-professional internships (i.e., receptionist, clerk, wait staff).
- Opportunities that are not compatible with the above guidelines will be examined and might be offered as paid part-time positions.

Location

Under UAE law, companies hosting onsite internships are obligated to maintain a safe and secure environment for our students during their internship placements. The Career Services Manager or Internship Coordinator may engage in spontaneous site visits with employers hosting AUS interns to ensure compliance.

- Home-office locations are not accepted for internship postings or as fulfilling internship placements.
- Virtual internship postings with professional outcomes might be accepted upon receiving the consent of the internship coordinator and the career services management. These internships must have strong professional, supervision and project components.

Compensation

Our preference is that all students be compensated for their hard work and dedication to the internship site; however, we welcome both unpaid and paid internship postings.

- We encourage you to consider compensating students for travel to and from the internship site.
- When engaging in an unpaid internship, we encourage you to consider the following guidelines:
 - Students should not be expected to provide their own resources, including computers, software, supplies, phone (including paid minutes), etc.
 - The employer should provide a professional space with all the resources the intern will need to perform their tasks successfully.
 - In addition, the employer should provide help with expenses that the student would not incur if not for the internship, including parking, mileage, travel expenses, etc.

Work Schedule

- A set internship schedule will be determined, pending approval by the internship supervisor at the company, and either by the internship coordinator, or the career services management at the University. This schedule will be determined based on the internship required hours and the availability of the student intern during the selected internship period.

The following regulations should be considered.

- Student interns must not work more than eight hours per day.
- During the Spring and Fall Semesters, students may work up to 16 hours a week.
- A one-hour unpaid lunch break should be scheduled if the student is interning six or more consecutive hours in a day.
- Student interns must be granted one 15-minute rest period for each intern service period of three continuous hours or more (not to exceed two rest periods per day).

Supervision

The intern should be supervised by a professional in the area in which the student is working. The professional should be available on a regular basis and should mentor the student throughout the program to help the student grow and succeed. The supervisor should meet with the student at the start of the internship to set the expectations and should meet with the student at the midpoint and end of the program to provide feedback and evaluations.

Reasonable Offer Deadlines.

- The Career Services urge the companies to keep the offers open for a minimum of 7 days in order to provide the student with the time needed to consider the offer.

Rescinding Offers

The Career Services strongly discourages rescinding internship job offers. If an employer must rescind an offer under exceptional circumstances, the employer should contact The Career Services Manager (University Contact Focal Point) so that we may facilitate the resulting conversation with the student. Likewise, students are strongly discouraged from reneging on an offer once accepted in writing. If a student renege⁶ on an offer, companies are urged to contact us so that we may resolve the issue.

Equal Employment Opportunity

In compliance with AUS's non-discrimination rules and policies which prohibit recruitment and selection for position openings on the basis of sex, marital or parental status, race, color, national origin, age, disability or religion. The Career Services is also in compliance with UAE laws that aim to prohibit discrimination and hatred on the basis of caste, race, religion or ethnic origin, and to protect the rights of people of determination (those with special needs) and ensure equal pay to women.

- The Career Services shall exclude from its activity's recruiters from any entity, which in employment matters has been determined to have a practice of unlawfully discriminating on any of the aforementioned bases.

Emirati Recruitment

- In the case of recruitment in the United Arab Emirates, employers are also expected to comply with the UAE goals for Emiratization where applicable. Employers looking to recruit UAE national students and alumni for internships, part-time and full-time opportunities can request CV books of candidates, post their positions to AUS Career Portal (stating that UAE nationals are preferred).

⁶ Reneging on offers is a violation of the terms of the internship agreement unless is approved by the career services management and the internship coordinator.

Third Party Recruiter

- The Career Services partners with employers seeking candidates for their organization's human resources needs. These employers may post jobs and internships on AUS Career Portal, to connect with our students seeking to intern or work at that company.
- The Career Services does not partner with third-party recruiters or service providers that aim to recruit students for other companies or organizations. Only in extraordinary circumstances as approved by the Career Services Management will third-party recruiters be allowed to post on the career portal.
- In these situations, the third party must comply with the following requirements:
 - Disclose the name of the company for which they are recruiting for.
 - The third party must include an official statement verifying that resumes and contact information will be collected solely for the particular opportunity and not retained for other opportunities for which the student did not directly apply.

Internship Termination Resignation

- Students may resign from their position by submitting their resignation, in writing, no less than two weeks prior to the indicated date of termination.
- Involuntary termination: It is required that companies give a two-week warning notice prior to involuntary termination.
- The written warning will give student interns an opportunity to be aware of and correct specific job deficiencies.
- A copy of the warning notice should also be sent to the Career Services Manager and the Internship Coordinator for student internship records.
- The student's failure to correct the deficiencies outlined in the warning notice will result in termination of internship service.
- Student interns may be involuntarily dismissed from an internship position if:
 - The student fails to perform in a satisfactory manner.
 - The student commits a major offense such as theft, misconduct, etc. (The two weeks' notice period will be waived for students who are dismissed under this category)

The organization will respect an internship termination request by the University for any student not complying with university student internship guidelines and procedures, as long as the organization has been notified seven days in advance.

11. Internship Approval & Registration Process

Students may opt to apply via the AUS Career Portal for internships posted, or they can take a proactive approach by identifying and applying to companies independently. Upon discovering a suitable opportunity, students must provide their respective internship coordinators or the career services management at their respective school and colleges with the organization's name, contact details, and pertinent information by a specified cut-off date. Subsequently, the internship coordinator meticulously evaluates each opportunity to ascertain its suitability and relevance, ensuring alignment with the student's academic and career objectives. Below are the specific processes for each academic unit.

College of Architecture, Art & Design

For an easy step-by-step registration process for your internships, ensuring clarity and accuracy in your application please refer to the detailed appendix accompanying this document. Appendix 1

Note: It is the responsibility of the student to register for summer Internship, available under summer II in AUS Banner during the pre-registration or registration period for summer. A fee of AED 200 will be paid by the student.

Students who do not register on time will not pass the internship.

Stage 1: Before Starting the Internship (During Spring)

Stage 2: Undertaking the Internship (During Summer)

Stage 3: Submitting Internship Documents (At the beginning of Fall)

Stage 4: Evaluation and Grade (Before the end of Fall)

College of Art & Sciences

For a detailed guide on registering for the internship, please refer to the step-by-step process outlined in the appendix 2. Alternatively, you can access the internship portal directly via the following link to begin your registration process immediately. <https://forms.aus.edu/app/232413698588975>

Note: Students are responsible to contact the admin assistant of their department requesting to be registered for the internship course on banner after they upload the Internship Agreement on the AUS Career Portal, and their internship gets approved by their internship coordinator.

College of Engineering

For a detailed guide on registering for the internship, please refer to the step-by-step process outlined in the appendix 3. Alternatively, you can access the internship portal directly via the following link to begin your registration process immediately. <https://auscse.com/apps/internship>

School of Business & Administration

SBA students are placed in a relevant course group by the Fall semester of their 3rd year of study. For a detailed guide on registering for the internship, please refer to the step-by-step process outlined in the appendix. Alternatively, you can access the SBA CDL Student App directly via the following link to begin your registration process immediately. <https://forms.aus.edu/232883265404862>

12.Attendance

The adherence to the attendance policy and meeting the required number of hours (see academic requirements) for your internship is a fundamental commitment to the learning opportunity it presents. By complying to these requirements, you showcase your commitment to maximizing the internship experience and highlight your preparedness to embrace the responsibilities expected of professionals. For detailed guidelines and procedures regarding the attendance, please refer to Appendix 5.

13.During the Internship

During their internship, students are expected to uphold certain requirements to establish a positive image, gain respect, and contribute effectively to their workplace environment.

Key Requirements for Students During the Internship

- Maintain professionalism in attire and attitude, adhering to the company's code of conduct.
- Demonstrate initiative, enthusiasm, and creativity in their work.
 - Interactions with clients or end-users⁷ if applicable.
 - Project management discussions⁸ if applicable.
- Communicate & cooperate effectively with supervisors and colleagues, contributing positively to the team dynamic.
 - Analysis & Research⁹ if applicable.
 - Design Ideation¹⁰ if applicable.
 - Proposal Representation or Production¹¹

⁷ This is a requirement for the CAAD students. This should carry a weight of 5 hours.

⁸ This is a requirement for the CAAD students. This should carry a weight of 5 hours.

⁹ This is a requirement for the CAAD students. This should carry a weight of 40 hours.

¹⁰ This is a requirement for the CAAD students. This should carry a weight of 40 hours.

¹¹ This is a requirement for the CAAD students. This should carry a weight of 40 hours.

- Adhere strictly to high ethical standards in all aspects of their work and interactions.
- Ensure punctuality for all duties and maintain confidentiality regarding sensitive company information.
- Keep thorough records of their work experience and activities.

Additional Expectations

Building professional relationships.

Building professional relationships during an internship is essential for both personal and professional growth. These relationships provide invaluable opportunities for networking, mentorship, and learning from experienced professionals in your field. By establishing connections with colleagues, supervisors, and industry professionals, interns can gain insights into the company culture, industry trends, and best practices. Additionally, strong professional relationships can lead to future career opportunities, such as job referrals, recommendations, and potential employment offers. Investing time and effort in nurturing these relationships during an internship can lay the foundation for a successful and fulfilling career in the future.

Effective communication.

Effective communication with supervisors and peers during an internship is essential for fostering a productive and positive work environment. Clear and open communication ensures that tasks are understood correctly, expectations are met, and feedback is exchanged constructively. By actively engaging with supervisors, interns can clarify objectives, seek guidance, and demonstrate their commitment to learning and growth. Similarly, maintaining strong communication with peers promotes teamwork, collaboration, and mutual support, leading to enhanced efficiency and effectiveness in completing tasks and projects. Additionally, effective communication skills are highly valued in the workplace and contribute to building professional relationships and establishing a reputation as a reliable and competent team member.

Learning from challenges.

Learning from challenges encountered during an internship is a crucial aspect of personal and professional development. While challenges may initially seem daunting, they provide invaluable opportunities for growth, learning, and skill enhancement. By overcoming obstacles, interns gain resilience, problem-solving abilities, and a deeper understanding of their field of work. Each challenge presents a chance to expand one's knowledge, refine existing skills, and acquire new ones. Moreover, navigating through challenges fosters adaptability and flexibility, essential qualities in today's dynamic work environments. Embracing challenges during an internship not only strengthens individual capabilities but also demonstrates initiative, determination, and a willingness to learn, qualities highly valued by employers.

14. Internship Termination & Resignation

Students may resign from their position by submitting their resignation, in writing, no less than two weeks prior to the indicated date of termination.

Involuntary termination

It is required that departments give a two-week warning notice prior to involuntary termination. The written warning will give student interns an opportunity to be aware of and correct specific job deficiencies. A copy of the warning notice should also be sent to the assigned career services office for student internship records. The student's failure to correct the deficiencies outlined in the warning notice will result in termination of internship service. Student interns may be involuntarily dismissed from an internship position if:

- The student fails to perform in a satisfactory manner.
- The student commits a major offense such as theft, misconduct, etc. (note: the two-week notice period will be waived for students who are dismissed under this category).

15. Performance Evaluation

College of Architecture, Art & Design

Evaluation of the work performed during internship will be based on all the required documents submitted. The student internship grade will be either a Pass or Fail.

Submitting Internship documentation:

To complete the Internship requirements, the student must submit the following documents on iLearn **in one pdf file**:

1. The weekly timesheets **signed** and **stamped** by the supervisor.
2. The Final Internship Report
3. Employer Evaluation of the Internship (submitted online by the internship supervisor). The link to the form is provided in the official letter sent to the supervisor from the CAAD Internship Coordinator. This evaluation is confidential and is not made available to the student. However, students must ensure that the internship supervisor submits this form.

Note: These submissions must be on iLearn and are all subject to a strict deadline.

Evaluation and Grade

The student internship grade will be either a Pass or Fail.

Evaluation of the work performed during internship will be based on all the following documents.

- Signed and Stamped timesheets
- Final Internship Report (not more than 2 A4 pages, single spaced, 12-point font). The report must include the following and demonstrate the ability to reflect critically on the experience:
 - a. A reflective essay on your experience and activities across the duration of the internship.
 - b. A summary of how course learning outcomes have been met.
- Student Evaluation of the Employer

A student who fails the internship will have to repeat it at a different organization. The F grade appears on your transcript. The requirement is not met until the internship is successfully completed and a Pass grade is assigned.

Grading Criteria

To receive a passing grade, a students must meet the following criteria:

- Satisfactory performance in the internship (as evidence by the employer evaluation)
- Satisfactory Final Internship Report
- Completing an approved internship (changing the internship employer without approval will result in a failing grade)

College of Art & Sciences

Students will pass their Internship if their performance as interns is found to be satisfactory upon the Internship Coordinator's review of the following:

- Site-Supervisor Evaluation
- Program Evaluation
- Internship report.
- Submission of weekly journal
- Submission of a copy of Thank you Letter to employer.
- Updated CV

Students will fail their internships if their performance is deemed unsatisfactory for any of the following reasons:

- Failure to comply with the Internship Guidelines.
- Failure to submit internship required documents by the stated deadline.
- An unsatisfactory Site- Supervisor Evaluation.

Weekly Journal

Students are required to maintain a journal or daily activity log documenting their internship experience, with weekly updates. Each entry should consist of a minimum of 100 words and a maximum of 350 words. An entry is expected for each week throughout the internship period.

- Record what is being done each day.
- Reflect on what you are doing and learning in your internship.
- Reflect on your reactions to the work and the people around you.
- List the positive and negative experiences that are inseparable from any working environment.
- Outline your expectations from the internship.
- Describe the goals you have set for yourself.
- Describe the obstacles that prevented you from achieving your goals.
- Record information you will need for your Final Report.
- Identify specific practices that will help you develop your work when you get a permanent job.

Internship Report

The report should summarize what students did during the internship, provide a brief description of the host organization and include samples of students' work. The report must be professional in content, style, accuracy, documentation, and presentation. Students must strive to organize their material to be relevant, concise, and properly tabulated with related references to support their statements. Students are strongly encouraged to meticulously review their written reports for layout, grammar, and spelling errors. It is essential that reports undergo thorough proofreading to address any discrepancies and ensure clarity and professionalism in presentation.

The internship report should range between **2000- 3000 words, 12-point font, 1.5 spaced**. Write a page about the host organization and one-page description of your activities and main duties. Follow the below outline, providing as much detail as possible and including specific examples:

- **Introduction:** introduce the company and include a brief description of its structure, values, and strategy.
- **Work Performed:** include a summary of activities, tasks, projects, and explain what worked well and didn't work, and suggest ways of improvement.
- **Internship Goals:** state the goals of your internship and which ones were achieved.
- **The connection between theory and real-life:** describe the connections found between the work performed as an intern and one's classroom experiences prior to and during the Internship.
- **Professional development:** highlight knowledge, skills, achievements, and challenges.
- **Conclusion:** summarize the overall internship experience and its impact on the future career choices
- **Work Sample:** Add a sample of your work including presentations, projects, articles written, research papers, and used datasheets.

Note: The internship report must be uploaded onto the portal.

Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance

This is completed by your supervisor or assigned HR contact at the company. You will have to update the contacts of your supervisor during your internship. We will send them the link to complete the evaluation.

Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience Performance

You will be prompted to complete the evaluation of the company at the end of your internship.

College of Engineering

Students will pass their Internship if their performance as interns is found to be satisfactory upon the Internship Coordinator's review of the following:

- Evaluation of the Internship Supervisor
- Program Evaluation

Students will fail their internships if their performance is deemed unsatisfactory for any of the following reasons:

- Failure to comply with the Internship Guidelines.

- Failure to submit internship required documents by the stated deadline.
- An unsatisfactory evaluation from your internship supervisor.

Weekly Journal (See Appendix 11)

- Record all activities in a weekly activity log.
- Have your logs verified weekly by the Internship Supervisor and submit them weekly to the AUS Internship Coordinator.

Internship Report

- Prepare a Summary Internship Report near completion of the internship assignment.
- Submit your feedback to both the internship company and the AUS internship coordinator to contribute to program enhancement.

Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance

This is completed by your supervisor or assigned HR contact at the company. You will have to update the contacts of your supervisor during your internship. We will send them the link to complete the evaluation.

Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience Performance

You will be prompted to complete the evaluation of the company at the end of your internship.

School of Business & Administration

See below for a summary and further information on the submissions required for each internship option. Carefully read the one applicable to your selected internship option, as the same submissions are applicable to any term/semester that the internship is completed.

BUS 397 (0-credit) Business Internship

All the below are expected to be submitted after the end of the internship.

- Weekly Journal
- Final Internship Report
- Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance
- Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience

BUS 497 (3-credit) Business Co-Op

The assignments are to be submitted during your internship, while the Journal, Report and Evaluations are to be submitted after the end of the internship.

BUS 497 Four Assignments to submit during the internship:

- Setting Internship Goals - Expected Completion: Week 2
- Reflective Essay 1 - Expected completion: Week 5
- Self-Assessment of Goals - Expected completion: Week 8
- Reflective Essay 2 - Expected completion: Week 11

BUS 497 Submissions after the end of the internship:

- Weekly Journal
- Final Internship Report
- Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance
- Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience

Major-Specific Internships (ACC 497, ECO 497, FIN 497, ISA 497, MGT 497, MKT 497) (3-credit)

The Weekly Journal and the Assignments are to be submitted during your internship, while the Final Report and Evaluations are to be submitted after the end of the internship.

Major Specific - 497 Submissions during the internship:

- Setting Internship Goals - Expected Completion: Week 2
- Weekly Journal Entry

Major-Specific 497 Submissions after the end of the internship:

- Final Internship Report
- Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance

- Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience (Optional)

Additional Information: Requirements and Submissions

Weekly Journal (See Appendix 11)

Applicable for all internship options.

- Throughout the duration of your BUS 397, BUS 497 and Major-Specific Internship you are required to maintain a weekly journal. This should be an entry of tasks, observations, challenges, and experiences for each week.
- Each entry should be at least 100 words.

The objective of the journal is to encourage reflection on your activities, learning experiences, and the connection between your internship, coursework, and career objectives. It is advised to dedicate a few minutes at the conclusion of each week to reflect on both challenges and achievements. The weekly journal aims to offer the course instructor insight into your internship routine and your responses to it. (See sample entry in the Appendix 11)

Employer Evaluation of the Intern's Performance: Applicable to all internship options

This is completed by your supervisor or assigned HR contact on the SBA CDL Employers' App. The questions of the Employer's Evaluation are shared with you on iLearn for your reference. You will have to update the contacts of your supervisor during your internship. We will send them the link to complete the evaluation.

You will receive a copy of the evaluation once it is completed. This needs to be completed during your last week of your internship and before your internship ends.

Student Evaluation of the Internship Experience Performance:

Applicable to BUS 397 & BUS 497 & Optional for Major-Specific Internships.

This is completed by you on the SBA CDL Students App. The App is available to download and accessible via your AUS credentials. The QR code and the link to the App are shared with you on iLearn. You must complete this up to a week after the end of your internship.

- Information and further explanation on the Final Reports and Assignments for each Internship Option is available on the syllabus of each internship course and on iLearn upon registration of the internship.

Deadline for Submissions and Graduating Seniors

Any submissions after the internship end are expected within a week of the end of the internship. The specific deadline is announced in each course on iLearn). Students who are expected to graduate at the end of their internship (Prospective Candidates for graduation) may have different deadlines and will be informed separately.

16. Post-Internship

Reflecting on the experience.

As an integral part of their internship experience, students are encouraged to engage in reflective practice, wherein they critically examine and analyse their learning, achievements, challenges, and growth during their time with the host organization. Through guided reflection, students gain deeper insights into the practical application of theoretical concepts, identify areas for personal and professional development, and integrate their internship experiences into their academic and career trajectories. The process of reflection enhances students' ability to articulate and demonstrate their skills, competencies, and understanding of industry practices, ultimately enriching their overall learning journey.

Professional Courtesy a thank you email.

Sending a thoughtful thank-you email to your internship supervisor and the company is not only a gesture of appreciation but also an opportunity to leave a positive and lasting impression. It demonstrates professionalism, gratitude, and reflects your genuine interest in maintaining connections with your

supervisor. Taking the time to express your appreciation for the learning opportunities and support received during your internship can foster goodwill, strengthen professional relationships, and potentially open doors for future collaborations or references. Consider sending a well-crafted thank-you email to convey your appreciation and leave a positive mark as you conclude your internship journey.

Updating resume and LinkedIn profile.

Adding your internship experience to LinkedIn is not just about updating your profile; it's a strategic move that can significantly enhance your professional brand and networking opportunities. By showcasing your internship on LinkedIn, you not only validate your skills and expertise to potential employers but also create a digital portfolio of your accomplishments and contributions. Embrace this opportunity to document and reflect on your experience while simultaneously expanding your professional network and visibility within your industry.

Requesting recommendation letters.

Requesting a recommendation letter from your supervisor or company management is a proactive step towards building your professional portfolio. A well-written recommendation can highlight your strengths, skills, and contributions during your internship, enhancing your credibility and prospects for future opportunities. Don't hesitate to reach out and request a recommendation letter, as it serves as a testament to your dedication and capabilities in the workplace.

17.Stakeholder Responsibilities

University's Responsibilities

Career Services Offices

- The University will be responsible for all local internships that are conducted during the regular academic year and summer months. The University and organization agree to schedule the internship to benefit all parties involved.
- Support students in finding internship opportunities and connecting them with employers.
- Update students through regular announcements about new internship opportunities.
- The University will provide the organization with non-objection letter or documents that might facilitate the onboarding of the student(s).
- Upon request, the University will identify a professional staff member to visit the internship site to assist in the development and coordination of learning experiences and share guidance on supervision and performance evaluation.
- Maintain appropriate contact with the interns throughout the internship to give direction and support.
- The University agrees to advise students of any known policies, procedures, and/or requirements of the project as specified in writing by the organization.

Internship Coordinator¹²

- Serve as student advisor to ensure that the internship meets the student's academic and professional goals.
- Evaluate the achievement of student interns towards meeting the goal determined in the work plan.
- Review internship assignments and ensure complete submission of forms, journals, reports and projects.
- Assess the performance of the student as per the rules and regulations of the University.

¹² Since there is no internship coordinator in SBA, most of the tasks are carried by the Career Design Lab Senior Manager except the evaluation of the internships.

- Communicate directly with the host company and supervisor for any issues related to the internship and the student's behaviors.

Organization's Responsibilities

- The organization will adhere to the Career Services recruiting policies and guidelines related to:
 - Fair treatment, Absenteeism, Learning Objectives, Supervision, Safe Environment, Discrimination and Harassment.
- The organization will publicize all internship opportunities to students through the AUS Career Portal system prior to interviewing or hiring any AUS students.
- The organization will provide training, clear guidance, and assistance for student internship programs, policies, and procedures.
 - If you require the student to sign a Non-Disclosure Agreement (NDA), you should communicate this requirement to the internship supervisor prior to proceeding for the signature of the document.
- The organization will seek AUS (Career Services Office or Internship Coordinator) approval prior to using AUS student on any marketing or publicity material.
 - Including postings in social media, catalogs, paid advertising, or any type of marketing material.
- During the internship period, the organization agrees to supervise each student for the mutually agreed number of hours and weeks.
- The organization agrees to determine the internship schedule in concert with the student's academic commitments/needs.
- The organization reserves the right to modify planned tasks and projects during the internship period, as may be required by changes in circumstances. However, any changes made should not affect the number of hours or the duration of the internship. The organization should make every reasonable effort to ensure that the student is placed in a like position and receives access to appropriate training and guidance.
- The organization will inform the student of her/his responsibility to address any transportation, meals, and/or lodging-related needs pertaining to the internship, if required.
- Employers are responsible for providing a safe and healthy working environment for interns, free from hazards and risks. They should implement appropriate health and safety measures and provide necessary resources to protect interns' well-being¹³.
- Employers should treat interns with respect and fairness, ensuring that they are not subjected to discrimination, harassment, or exploitation. Interns should be provided with clear expectations, duties, and responsibilities throughout their internship period¹⁴.
- Companies should provide interns with the necessary tools and equipment to perform their duties effectively. This includes access to all necessary tools required to perform their tasks. Students should not be asked to provide their own equipment for the accomplishment of their tasks.
- Should the organization become dissatisfied with the performance of the student, the organization will notify the University before performing necessary disciplinary procedures.
- The organization will respect an internship termination request by the University for any student not complying with university student internship guidelines and procedures, as long as the organization has been notified seven days in advance.

¹³ As per the Federal Decree Law No. (20) of 2023 Amending Certain Provisions of Federal Decree Law No. (33) of 2021 Regarding the Regulation of Employment Relationships

¹⁴ As per the Federal Decree Law No. (20) of 2023 | Refer to the non-discrimination policy appendix 6.

Site Supervisor Role | Internship Supervisor Role

- Assign meaningful work to students and provide them with hands on experience to fulfil the institution's expectations for learning outcomes. The supervisor should ensure that interns have access to necessary resources and guidance to fulfil their responsibilities.
- Meet virtually or in person with students regularly to evaluate performance and answer questions.
- Fill the site supervisor feedback form to evaluate interns' performance and behaviour.
- Prevent discrimination and harassment in the workplace, as mandated by labor laws. This includes providing a harassment-free environment, addressing any complaints promptly, and taking appropriate disciplinary action if necessary.

Student's Responsibilities

- The student will adhere to both the AUS student internship policies and procedures, and the organization's internship policies and procedures, for the duration of the internship.
- The student will maintain full-time enrolment necessary for internship service eligibility.
- The student will coordinate work hours with her/his internship supervisor according to the organization's needs and the student's academic coursework needs/demands when applicable.
- The student will arrive at the internship site prepared to accomplish assigned projects and tasks and refraining from conducting personal business while at the internship site.
- The student will dress appropriately, in accordance with organization dress code, and abide by the relevant policies and procedures of the organization.
- The student will be punctual, dependable, courteous, and considerate of the organization's employees and other staff.

APPENDIX 1

REGISTRATION PROCESS | COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE, ART & SCIENCES

Stage 1.1: Preparation

Students are expected to prepare their CVs, compile a portfolio of their work, and begin searching for an internship placement with companies whose major professional work is related to the student's major and future career goals. Students are allowed to seek internship at a professionally registered company of their choosing in the UAE, GCC and other parts of the world. Lists of companies that may be interested in accepting student interns will be shared via iLearn.

Stage 1.2: Submission of Placement Forms

Companies will normally ask for the applicant's CV, portfolio of work, as well as for an interview before any offer for placement is made. Once an offer for internship is made by a company and accepted by the student, the Internship Placement Form must be completed by the student through iLearn. Please visit iLearn to find this online form.

Please note that you must conduct your internship at a company that is directly related to your major. The deadline for submitting a placement form will be communicated through the internship guideline available on iLearn or via emails to the registered students.

Stage 1.3: Registration on Banner

It is the responsibility of the student to register for summer Internship, available under summer II in AUS Banner during the pre-registration or registration period for summer. A fee of AED 200 will be paid by the student. Students who do not register on time will not pass the internship.

APPENDIX 2

REGISTRATION PROCESS | COLLEGE OF ARTS & SCIENCES

1. Students are required to attend a mandatory Internship Orientation Session
2. Following the orientation, students will need to participate in mandatory Career Readiness Workshops, covering topics such as (Resume Writing, Internship Search Techniques, and Interview Preparation).
3. Complete the [online form](#) to initiate the process.
4. Once you will receive an initial confirmation/Acceptance from the companies that you applied for, kindly fill out the [internship Planning Form](#) to obtain an initial approval from your internship coordinator.
 - a. If you need a No Objection Certificate (NOC) or Official Letter, please email cascareerservices@aus.edu
 - b. Include in the following details in your communication:
 - i. Full name.
 - ii. ID Number.
 - iii. Major.
 - iv. Any other specific information that is required in the letter.

Step 1

Internship Documents

Internship Planning Form

Intern- Host Organization A...

Step 2

You will receive an email notifying you that the internship is initially approved and inviting you to complete step 2 (Internship Host Organization Agreement).

Click on "View Form" on the email to complete step 2.

5. You will receive an email notification from CAS Career Services that your internship is initially approved.
6. Click on View Form to upload the internship agreement form*.

Note: Before uploading the Internship Agreement Form, ensure that both the company supervisor and the student have signed it.

Compose

Inbox 1,744

Starred

Snoozed

Drafts 371

More

Labels +

Your internship has been initially approved.

Please fill out the form below and upload your internship agreement form to obtain the final approval from your internship coordinator.

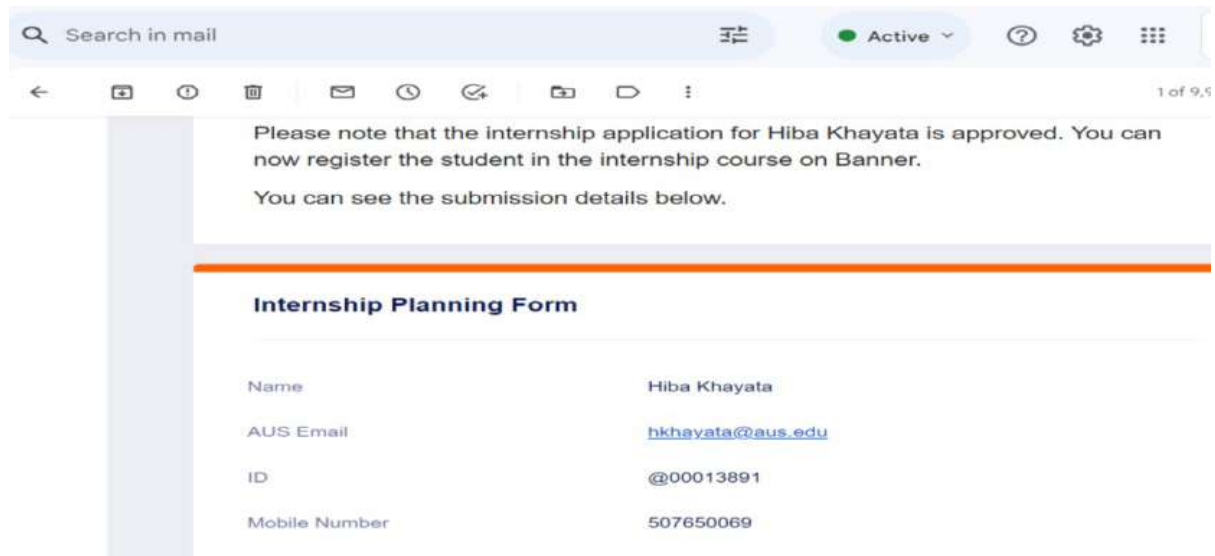
Remember: The Internship Agreement Form should be signed by you and the company.

Note: Make sure to star this email to return to it later.

Click the button below to fill out this form.

View Form

7. You will receive an email notification that your internship is finally approved, and the Admin Assistant can register you on banner.
8. Follow up with the admin assistant of your department to ensure you are registered on banner.



9. You will receive an email to verify the email address of your internship supervisor. This is a required step as we need to send out the internship evaluation to your supervisor.

Internship Supervisor's Email



10. Submit the internship report and other documents and complete the program evaluation. Click on View Form to Submit the Internship Report

APPENDIX 3

REGISTRATION PROCESS | COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING

Students can log in or create an account on the portal by visiting <https://auscse.com/apps/internship>

Once you create your profile follow the below steps:

1. Update your profile by adding a mobile number and signature.
2. Request an internship letter if required.
 - a. General letter (can be sent to many employers).
 - b. Specific letter (to be sent to one employer, details of the employer will be requested).
3. Once the request is approved by the internship Coordinator, student can download the internship letter and send it to the employer along with a resume requesting for an internship.
4. Once the student secures an internship then the student needs to request an internship agreement form, which will need to be digitally filled in and signed by all parties (student, employer, and internship coordinator). To submit the form, the student needs to provide the employer contact details.
5. The student will be able to download the internship agreement form once the internship coordinator and the employer approves the request.

Post-completion of the internship

6. Once the internship is completed the student will be requested to digitally fill in the internship evaluation form.
7. The employer will also receive a digital form to fill in their feedback.
8. Finally, the student should submit the internship report which will be checked and graded by the internship coordinator. The student can adjust and resubmit their report until the coordinator approves the report and locks it to prevent any further edits.

Follow the video for assistance: <https://drive.google.com/file/d/1JvSFP3islQf0Li6G54flgGB-aYoQItwF/view>

Important Note: Once the internship agreement is signed the students will not be authorised to change the designated company.

APPENDIX 4

REGISTRATION PROCESS | SCHOOL OF BUSINESS AND ADMINISTRATION

- Students MUST get approval for Internships from the Internship Manager prior to commencing the Internship experience. Internships completed without the Internship manager's approval WILL NOT be accepted and won't count towards the requirement.
- Internships cannot be considered or registered retroactively. A student cannot use an earlier work placement, not registered under the official internship program, as an internship to fulfill the degree requirements.
- The chosen company CANNOT be changed after the Internship Agreement has been signed by the student and submitted for Review to the SBA Internship Office.
- Students may reach out to the Internships and Placement Office for any concerns during their internship.
- You can register only one internship experience as an official internship for your degree requirement. A relevant internship letter will be given to you upon request, stating that this is an internship placement as part of your degree requirements. Independent internships are allowed for personal growth but cannot be registered officially. You'll receive a letter stating 'Independent Internship' if needed.
- Students with 0-credit internship requirement (BUS 397) may explore registering (BUS 497) 3-credits as a free elective. To consider this option, please complete a degree audit with your academic advisor.
- Check if you have any holds that will prevent your Registration on Banner.
- Select an internship that fits your preferences, considering location, work environment, commuting, and daily routines.
- Students are encouraged to utilize the internship agreement provided in Appendix 7 for their internship submissions.

STEP 2: Submit an Internship Opportunity for Review.

When to do this step: When you have found an internship opportunity, you met/interviewed with the recruiter and received an initial acceptance.

What you will need to know to complete Step 2:

- Company name, location, mode of work, start and end dates, workdays, and working hours.
- HR contact person name, email and mobile number
- Internship Supervisor name, email address and mobile number (if available at the time of signing)
- Internship Agreement or Contract including a brief job description/task list - ACTION: Fill out the Internship REVIEW Form <https://forms.aus.edu/232883265404862>

Once you submit the form, you will receive a submission confirmation-Keep it for your records as proof of submission. This is not proof of approval.

Step 3: Receive an update on the status of your submitted internship.

Typically, the submissions are reviewed within 48 hours. This might take a bit longer closer to the deadline given the increased workload.

Approved: You will receive an email Approving the internship (keep it for your records).

Rejected: You will receive an email stating why it is rejected and asking for more information or amendments

- If your internship is **approved**, you will be added to Banner and iLearn. (Unless you have a hold, so you won't be added, and further action will be required from you)
- If your internship is **rejected**, follow the instructions in the rejection email.
- You will have to RESUBMIT the Internship REVIEW Form <https://forms.aus.edu/232883265404862> within the advised deadline.

Step 4: After your internship is approved.

- Check Banner and iLearn to make sure that you are in the right internship course.
- Charges will apply so ensure that you are in the right course offering the credits you are expecting to receive. Follow the instructions and mark the deadlines on the syllabus for your internship submissions and evaluations.

APPENDIX 5

ATTENDANCE

Students are required to attend all days of the internships and follow the working hours set by the site-supervisor.

- All absences must be compensated by extending the Internship duration.
- Students who miss any day of the internship for legitimate reasons are required to notify their internship supervisors and their internship coordinators of the reason for being away from work.
- For medical leaves, students should submit medical reports on the portal, Ilearn or as indicated by the Career Services that can be viewed by the site supervisor and the internship coordinator.
- Students who are absent with no excuse and do not complete the minimum required hours as stipulated in their catalog will be awarded a grade of F.

Purpose: The attendance procedure for internships is designed to ensure that interns fulfil their commitments, gain valuable experience, and maximize their learning opportunities during their internship period. Consistent attendance as set by the hosting company is vital for professional development and successful completion of the internship program.

Attendance Expectations: Interns are expected to adhere to the following attendance guidelines:

- Interns must arrive on time for their scheduled work hours.
- Interns are expected to complete the designated number of hours as outlined in their internship agreement.
- Any deviation from the agreed-upon schedule must be communicated to both the internship supervisor and the internship coordinator in advance.
- Interns are responsible for notifying their supervisor promptly in case of illness or any other unforeseen circumstances that may prevent them from attending work.
- Students are required to submit medical reports through official channels, ensuring accessibility to both the site supervisor and the internship coordinator for review and documentation purposes.
- Any planned absences, such as doctor's appointments or personal commitments, should be communicated and approved in advance by the internship supervisor.
- Any absences must be compensated for by extending the internship duration, accordingly, ensuring that the compensation does not conflict with the beginning of the semester.

Reporting Absences: In case of absence, interns are required to:

- Inform their supervisor as soon as possible, preferably before the start of their scheduled work hours.
- Provide a valid reason for their absence.
- Discuss with their supervisor any arrangements for making up missed work hours, if applicable.

Consequences of Absenteeism: Repeated absenteeism or failure to adhere to the attendance procedure may result in the following consequences:

- Verbal warning: The intern will receive a verbal warning from their supervisor, highlighting the importance of punctuality and consistent attendance.
- Written warning: If absenteeism persists, the intern will receive a written warning outlining the consequences of continued non-compliance with the attendance policy. A copy of the warning should be shared with the internship coordinator.
- Termination of internship: In cases of severe or repeated absenteeism without valid reasons, the internship may be terminated, and the intern may not receive academic credit for the internship.
- Failing the internship: Students who are absent without excuse and do not complete the minimum required hours will be awarded a grade of F.

Documentation and Record-Keeping: The internship supervisor will maintain accurate records of interns' attendance, including any instances of tardiness or absenteeism. These records will be reviewed periodically to identify any patterns of non-compliance and address them accordingly.

APPENDIX 6

Reporting Incidents

The Career Services Office at AUS is committed to maintaining an environment that encourages and fosters appropriate conduct among all persons and respect for individual values.

Discrimination based on race, gender, color, creed, religion, age, national origin, ethnicity, disability, sex, pregnancy, genetic information, marital status, citizenship status, or on any other legally prohibited basis is unlawful¹⁵.

Such discriminations violate the University policy and will not be tolerated. In the case of a student complaint, the Career Services Office will require access to the employer's applicable policies, promptly investigate the incident, and act where appropriate.

REPORTING ISSUES

Any student who faces an act of discrimination should immediately report the circumstances in accordance with the procedure set forth below.

- A. Document the Incident: Keep detailed records of the misconduct incidents, including dates, times, locations, and descriptions of what happened. This act can provide important evidence if further action is necessary.
- B. Report to School, College Career Services Management representatives:
 - a. Many companies have internal policies and procedures for reporting incidents. The individual experiencing discrimination should report the incidents to the Human Resources (HR) department or to their immediate supervisor or manager in case they are not involved with the incident.
 - b. Contact the Career Services Manager at your school or college to report the incident.

College School	Full Name	Email	Phone Number
College of Architecture, Art & Design	Rachida Cherki	rcherki@aus.edu	06 515 2891
College of Arts & Sciences	Hiba Khayata	hkhayata@aus.edu	06 515 2744
College of Engineering	Dana Saleh	Dgsaleh@aus.edu	06 515 2937
School of Business & Administration	Eleni Papailia	epapailia@aus.edu	06 515 2368

- C. Provide Evidence: When reporting the incident please provide any documentation or evidence that supports the claims, such as witness statements, emails, text messages, or recordings, if available. This can help validate the complaint and facilitate the investigation process.
- D. Cooperate with the Investigation: This may involve providing additional information, participating in interviews, or identifying witnesses.
- E. The University may investigate any conduct and would contact the relevant parties and authorities, , and take remedial action where appropriate. The following actions may be taken:
 - a. The University reserves the right to terminate the internship opportunity.
 - b. The University may suspend consideration of new requests from the company for a period of one year, unless satisfactory corrective actions are implemented.
 - c. Students who experience discrimination will be provided with support and, if necessary, relocated to another institution.
 - d. Accumulated hours and days will be carried forward as applicable.

¹⁵ Article 14 | Federal Law Federal Decree-Law No. (33) of 2021

APPENDIX 7

Internship Agreement

INTERNSHIP AGREEMENT FORM

The internship agreement form formalizes the engagement between, employer, student, and the university, outlining expectations and responsibilities for a successful internship. This agreement will be binding as per the policies, rules, and regulations stipulated in the student's internship guide.

STUDENT DETAILS			
Full Name		ID Number	
Major		Phone Number	
Email		Signature	

HOSTING COMPANY DETAILS			
Company Name		Website	
HR Manager		Phone Number	
Email		Signature	
Compensation	AED	Other Benefits	

INTERNSHIP SUPERVISOR DETAILS			
Full Name		Job Title	
Email		Phone Number	

INTERNSHIP LEARNING OBJECTIVES	
1	
2	
3	
4	
5	
6	

INTERNSHIP COORDINATOR APPROVAL			
Full Name		Title	
Signature		Date	

APPENDIX 8

CV SAMPLE

Full Name

Mobile: (971) 50 111 1111 | LinkedIn:

E-mail: b000*****@aus.edu

PROFILE or OBJECTIVE

Specify the position you're applying for or the field you're interested in. Describe your strengths, skills, and relevant capabilities that make you suitable for the internship opportunity.

EDUCATION

Sep 2020 - Present

American University of Sharjah (AUS), United Arab Emirates

Bachelor of Science in ----- (always spell out your degree)

GPA

RELEVANT PROJECTS (these projects should support your objective)

highlight up to three projects that are pertinent to the internship role or the company you are aiming for.

- Research project in Structural | Water or Wastewater Management
- Project in Transportation

WORK EXPERIENCE (list in reverse chronological order if you have any)

Jan-May 2023

American University of Sharjah, Student Affairs Dept
Events Coordinator

Sharjah

- Compiled information for activity database
- Promoted special events, such as Global Day

SKILLS

- Oracle, Python, Java, etc. (List the software that are related to the field)
- Research Methodology, competent use of SPSS.
- Microsoft Office

Soft Skills

- Team player (List top 3 soft skills related to the internship opportunity)
- Details oriented
- Creative thinking

Languages

- English & Arabic Fluent
- French Fair

EXTRACURRICULAR ACTIVITIES (Should support your soft skills)

- Leadership Roles: Any positions held in student clubs, or organizations.
- Sports and Athletics: Participation in sports teams, competitions.
- Volunteering and Community Service: Involvement in community outreach programs, volunteering at local charities, or participating in service trips.
- Arts and Creativity: Activities such as music, dance, drama, painting, or any other artistic pursuits.
- Academic Clubs and Competitions: Participation in academic clubs, science fairs, math competitions, or debate clubs, MUN.

APPENDIX 9

COVER LETTER SAMPLE

Full Name

Your Address

Full Name of the person

Position: Human Resource Manager

Company Name

Location Dubai, UAE

Dear Full Name,

Introduction Paragraph

In this paragraph, introduce yourself and express your interest in the position. Mention where you found the job posting and briefly explain why you are interested in the company or organization. Include a brief overview of your background and qualifications that make you a strong candidate for the role.

Body:

This paragraph is where you delve into specific experiences, skills, and accomplishments that demonstrate your suitability for the position. Highlight relevant achievements from your education, work experience, or extracurricular activities that align with the job requirements. Use this section to connect your skills and experiences to the needs of the company or organization. You can also mention any research you've done about the company and how you see yourself contributing to their goals.

Conclusion:

Conclude your cover letter by expressing your enthusiasm for the opportunity and reiterating your interest in the position. Thank the employer for considering your application and express your readiness to further discuss how your qualifications align with the needs of the company. Also, include a polite closing statement and your contact information.

Note:

- Remember to keep your cover letter concise and focused, typically no more than one page in length.
- Customize each cover letter for the specific job and company you're applying to, highlighting the most relevant experiences and skills.

APPENDIX 10

Internship Objectives & Goals Planning

Technical Training	
Internship Goal #1	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Technical Training	
Internship Goal #2	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Skills Specific	
Internship Goal #1	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Skills Specific	
Internship Goal #2	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

System & Software Specific	
Internship Goal #1	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

System & Software Specific	
Internship Goal #2	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Leadership Development	
Internship Goal #1	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Leadership Development	
Internship Goal #2	
Goals Planning: How will you achieve these goals?	
What knowledge is required to achieve this goal?	
What Skills are required to achieve this goal?	
Assessment	
What I want to learn?	
How will I know I reached my goal?	
How will I do it in a way that is reasonably within my reach?	
How will I do it given my current responsibilities, needs, etc.?	
What is my deadline?	

Appendix 11

Journal Entry Sample

Week 2: June 14, 2022

Introduction: [\[Describe the objectives assigned during the week and key challenges\]](#)

This week was marked by significant progress and focused efforts towards achieving our project milestones. With a clear vision in mind, our team embarked on various tasks aimed at addressing key challenges and optimizing processes. Despite encountering some unforeseen obstacles, our determination remained unwavering, and we remained committed to delivering results of the highest quality.

Actions Taken and Outcomes: [\[Describe your actions and what outcomes yielded\]](#)

Throughout the week, I dedicated my efforts to tackling several critical action items outlined in our project roadmap. These actions included conducting thorough market research to gain deeper insights into consumer preferences and industry trends. Additionally, I initiated discussions with key stakeholders to gather feedback and align my work with the goals of the project. By proactively addressing potential roadblocks and leveraging innovative solutions, we anticipate streamlining operations and enhancing overall project efficiency.

Learning Outcomes and Personal Development: [\[Reflect on the Learning outcomes and how you are meeting those assigned objectives\]](#)

Reflecting on the experiences of this week, I am reminded of the invaluable lessons learned and the personal growth achieved. Engaging in strategic planning sessions and collaborative problem-solving exercises has not only honed my analytical skills but has also bolstered my ability to adapt to dynamic environments. Furthermore, navigating through challenges and embracing feedback has reinforced the importance of resilience and perseverance in achieving long-term objectives. As I continue on this journey, I am confident that the insights gained from this week's experiences will serve as guiding principles, steering me towards my desired learning outcomes and facilitating my professional development journey.

Note: The weekly report encapsulates the progress made, challenges overcome, and the invaluable insights gained, underscoring the significance of continuous learning and growth in achieving your goals.

Appendix 12

COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING | STUDENT INTERNSHIP FEEDBACK FORM SAMPLE

The information used below will **not** be used as part of your assessment. It will assist with the ongoing planning and improvement of future internships and the effectiveness of the host company.

Company Name			
Student Full Name		Student ID	
Major			
Internship Period			

Part A: Overall Perception of the Internship Experience. Please answer the following questions.

Questions	Yes	No
Was the staff helpful to you?		
Did you use the skills you have learned at AUS?		
Did the placement meet your expectations?		
Did the internship meet your objectives?		
Was there enough supervision?		
Was the internship helpful to you?		
Would you recommend the organization to other students?		
Were there any aspects of your internship you were not happy about?		
Did your internship confirm your career aspirations?		
Did the company involve you in different tasks?		
Did the internship enhance your soft skills?		
Did the internship enhance your technical skills?		

B: Contribution of the Internship Experience to the Program Outcomes: Please indicate your perception about how the internship experience has helped you in achieving the program outcomes. Use a scale from 1 to 5 where: **5** = Strongly agree; **4** = Agree; **3** = Neutral, **2** = Disagree, and **1** = Strongly disagree.

Questions	5	4	3	2	1
Your ability to identify, formulate, and solve complex engineering problems by applying principles of engineering, science, and mathematics.					
Your ability to apply engineering design to produce solutions that meet specified needs with consideration of public health, safety, welfare, cultural, social, environmental, and economic factors.					
Your ability to communicate effectively with a range of audiences.					
Your ability to recognize ethical and professional responsibilities in engineering situations and make informed judgments, which must consider the impact of engineering solutions in global, economic, environmental, and societal contexts.					
Your ability to function effectively on a team whose members together provide leadership, create a collaborative and inclusive environment, establish goals, plan tasks, and meet objectives.					
Your ability to develop and conduct appropriate experimentation, analyze and interpret data, and use engineering judgment to draw conclusions.					
Your ability to acquire and apply new knowledge as needed, using appropriate learning strategies.					

Please use the space below if you would like to make any comments on the above

Do you have any suggestions that you think might improve the internship program?

Student's Signature	Date

Appendix 13

COLLEGE OF ENGINEERING | EMPLOYER INTERNSHIP EVALUATION FORM SAMPLE

Student's name		AUS ID	
Company Name		Department	
Evaluator's Name		Evaluator's Title	
Internship Start Date		End date	

Part A: Overall Performance of the Student:

Please rate the student on the following aspect on a scale from 1 to 5 where: **5** = Excellent; **4** = Good; **3** = Satisfactory, **2** = Improvement required, and **1** = Poor. If unable to judge, please select N/A.

Questions	5	4	3	2	1	NA
A. Ability to understand, analyze, and solve engineering problems.						
B. Ability to work effectively as a member of a team.						
C. Ability to learn independently.						
D. Technical skills/ knowledge of field						
E. Adoption of professional ethics.						
F. Attendance.						
G. Punctuality.						
H. Proactivity with sense of initiative.						
I. Response to criticism.						
J. Response to supervision and instructions.						
K. Interpersonal skills and behavior.						
L. Communication skills (written English)						
M. Communication skills (spoken English)						
N. Adhere to organization code of ethics						

Part B: Attendance and Punctuality:

Attendance	
Number of days absent	Justification for absence
Punctuality	
Number of days late	Justification for lateness

Additional Comments

Evaluator's Name	Signature
Company Stamp	Date

Appendix 14

COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE, ART & DESIGN | STUDENT INTERNSHIP EVALUATION FORM

Prior to the grade for the internship course being assigned, students must complete an evaluation of the employer. The evaluation instrument includes the following components:

Company Name			
Student Full Name		Student ID	
Major			
Internship Period			

Question	None	A little	A lot
How much value did the internship add?			

Why do you feel that way?

Internship Duration	Too short	Just Right	Too long
How long was your internship?			

Why do you feel that way?

Question	Yes	No
Was the Internship Paid?		

List internship experiences	
Interaction with Clients	
High level Project Management	
Preconcept Research	
Design Ideation	
Design Development	
Presentation	
Project Management	

List internship experiences not on the above list?

Appendix 15

COLLEGE OF ARCHITECTURE, ART & DESIGN | EMPLOYER INTERNSHIP EVALUATION FORM

The employer's evaluation is considered as part of the entire set of documents submitted by the student and will be assessed qualitatively based on the patterns that emerge from the evaluation. The student will not have access to the employer evaluation.

Company Name		Department	
Evaluator's Name		Evaluator's Title	
Student's Name			
Internship Start Date		End date	

ATTITUDE	Does Not Meet Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceed Expectations
ENTHUSIASTIC AND WILLING TEAM MEMBER			
Is proactive in taking on tasks?			
ENTHUSIASTIC AND WILLING LEARNER			
Takes on Tasks that require new knowledge or skills?			

SKILLS	Does Not Meet Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceed Expectations
DESIGN SKILLS			
Demonstrated the ability to complete a design task?			
TECHNICAL SKILLS			
Demonstrated the ability to assess & work in unfamiliar situations?			
CRITICAL THINKING SKILLS			
Demonstrated the ability to assess & work in unfamiliar situations?			
DIGITAL TECHNOLOGY SKILLS			
Demonstrated the ability to use digital tools?			
COMMUNICATION SKILLS			
Demonstrated the ability to communicate orally & in writing?			

WORK HABITS	Does Not Meet Expectations	Meets Expectations	Exceed Expectations
TIME MANAGEMENT			
Manages competing demands on time and attention?			
RELIABILITY			
If assigned a task, completes it satisfactory?			
TEAMWORK			
Collaborates with other members on a team task?			

Appendix X. Administration of AUS Research Centers

Note: Kindly check the next page for Administration of AUS Research Centers.

**American University of Sharjah
Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research**

Administration of AUS Research Centers

January 18, 2024

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1. Introduction

The University fosters the development of innovative multi- and trans-disciplinary research and scholarly activities in specialized areas through the establishment of research centers.

This document provides guidance to all stakeholders regarding the governance, reporting and performance review obligations to the University.

Research Centers are entities approved by the Board of Trustees in alignment with the University's strategies and budget. They allow faculty members to pool their expertise to facilitate interdisciplinary research on pressing challenges to society, and to maximize institutional impact and output. They must have clearly defined missions that support the University's strategic research objectives and activities that enhance impactful research partnerships with industry partners. Their activities shall adhere to all current research policies and procedures.

New research centers are created in accordance with policies and procedures established by the Vice Chancellor for Research.

2. Governance and Roles

2.1. Functions

The Vice Chancellor for Research (VCR): The VCR is the Senior academic leader responsible for overall oversight of the Research Centers at American University of Sharjah. The VCR will each year deliver to the Chancellor and the Board of Trustees a summary report dealing with the activities of all Research Centers during the preceding year.

Dean: A Research Center is directly overseen by the Dean of the College/School in which it is housed. In the spirit of trans-disciplinarity, the Dean shall consult with the Deans of other participating colleges/school in strategic matters relating to the Center. The Dean shall oversee the Center's vision and strategy. Furthermore, the Dean shall review each center's activities annually including its financial management and compliance with university policies and shall report the results of that review to the VCR.

Director: A Research Center is led by a Director who is appointed for a three-year term by the Vice Chancellor for Research, upon recommendation from the Dean (in consultation with other participating Deans and the steering committee) and the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost (VCAA). The term is extendable contingent upon performance reviews, which shall be conducted annually. Normally, the *inaugural* Director of a Center is nominated by the Dean and shall be part of the initial proposal of the center. The Director, in consultation with the Dean and in coordination with the center's steering committee, is responsible for leading the center by providing a coherent vision and strategic direction for multidisciplinary research and postgraduate training. The director will report to the Dean. The director will lead and manage the research team, consisting of members listed in Section 2.3 below, that is appointed or hired in the Center.

Advisory Board: Each Research Centre has an Advisory Board whose members are appointed by the Dean and the Director. Members are external to the institution, including but not limited to industry partners, international collaborators, and academic researchers. Service on the Advisory Board is voluntary and pro bono. The Advisory Board is chaired by the Director. Members are appointed for three years subject to renewal for multiple terms. The Director needs to conduct an annual assessment on the effectiveness of the Advisory Board.

Advisory board members will:

- Provide advice to the Director on scientific and scholarly priorities and strategic guidance for the Research Center.
- Evaluate the research strengths and progress towards goals.
- Be consulted at the discretion of the Director, but not less than once a year. In the case of newly set up Centers, the Advisory Board will be convened every 6 months for the first two years.

The Research Center Director is responsible for preparing all materials/reports for the Advisory Board.

Steering Committee: The steering committee sets goals, oversees progress, and guides research priorities, ensuring the center's activities align with broader objectives and stakeholder needs. The steering committee shall include at least one representative from each participating college/school and one representative from each of its research clusters. Steering committee members are appointed by the Dean based on the recommendation from the Director. The steering committee membership is for three years subject to reappointment for multiple terms. The committee is chaired by the Director.

Steering committee members will:

- Assess the adequacy and appropriateness of resources and staff necessary for the successful operation of the research Center.
- Evaluate operational effectiveness, research effectiveness, visibility and impact on an annual basis.
- Advise on the allocation of the center's budget on an annual basis.

2.2. Research Center Director: Duties and Responsibilities

Strategic Vision and Leadership:

- Develop and articulate a vision and strategy that aligns with the AUS goals and national agendas.
- Provide leadership in steering the center towards achieving its mission and objectives, ensuring alignment with the long-term goals of the UAE in transitioning to a knowledge-based economy.

Operational Management:

- Oversee day-to-day operations of the center, including the planning, execution, and evaluation of research initiatives, programs, and events.
- Manage the annual budget effectively, ensuring that financial resources are allocated to support the achievement of the center's goals and objectives.

Research Direction:

- Identify and prioritize research areas within the multidisciplinary clusters, ensuring that they align with the strategic priorities of AUS, Sharjah, and the UAE.
- Foster a collaborative research environment that encourages faculty and students to engage in impactful research on innovation and sustainable development.

Publication and Impact:

- Drive efforts to publish research findings in leading and reputable journals, emphasizing the dissemination of knowledge in areas of particular relevance to the center.
- Monitor and enhance the research impact of the center, considering metrics such as journal quality, citation rates, and collaboration with international academics.

Engagement with AUS Community:

- Collaborate with faculty and students across AUS colleges and schools to involve them in the production and dissemination of research findings that address industry needs and community challenges.

Partnership Development:

- Establish and nurture strategic partnerships with external organizations.
- Explore opportunities for collaboration with international research centers.

Leadership and Governance Oversight:

- Work closely with the Advisory Board and Steering Committee, providing regular updates, seeking guidance, and incorporating strategic insights into the center's activities.
- Ensure that all faculty and staff working as a full-time employee under the center follow AUS established procedures related to working hours, absences and other HR related policies and procedures,
- Provide regular reports to the Dean, Advisory Board, and other stakeholders on the progress and impact of the center.

Long-Term Sustainability:

- Seek external institutional grants to build capacity and ensure the long-term sustainability of the center.
- Explore revenue-generation opportunities, such as consulting, joint research, continuing education, and certificate programs.

2.3. Types of Affiliations with the Research Center

A Research Center shall comprise a diverse pool of members, each with a set of entitlements and obligations:

- **Research Fellow:** Any member of the AUS faculty with a scholarly record aligned with the Center can be nominated or may self-nominate for appointment as a Faculty Fellow. These appointments are made to a three-year term by the Director in consultation with the Dean and the Steering Committee. Fellows are entitled to declare this association after their names, serve on the Steering Committee, schedule use of resources (labs, equipment and facilities), and be included in proposals sent out by the Center if appropriate. Fellows are obligated to contribute to the Center mission and, as AUS faculty, meet all requirements in the Faculty Handbook. The director, in coordination with the Center Steering Committee, may nullify or not renew the appointment if contributions are found to be insufficient.

- **Postdoctoral Fellow:** One or more ongoing research projects in the Center may hire postdoctoral fellows to work on project-related tasks. Such Postdoctoral Fellows are entitled to formally associate themselves with the Center if approved by the Director. The policies and procedures for all aspects of postdoctoral employment shall be as specified by the Office of Research and Graduate Studies.
- **Graduate Research Assistant:** Doctoral and Master students working on dissertations and theses aligned with the Center or hired to work on research projects in the Center, may formally associate themselves with the Center if approved by the Director. The policies and procedures for all aspects of graduate student employment shall be as specified by the Office of Research and Graduate Studies.
- **Visiting Scholar/Research Associate:** From time to time, individuals external to AUS may receive short-term appointments to collaborate in person or remotely on research projects hosted by the Center. Such Visiting Scholar/Research Associate appointments are made by the lead Dean in consultation with the Director. The policies and procedures for such appointments shall be as specified by the Office of Research and Graduate Studies.

3. Accountability and Research Center Evaluation Process

This section outlines a systematic evaluation process for research centers. The review process for the research center is comprehensively outlined, detailing the steps and criteria used to evaluate its performance. Following this, the Key Performance Indicators (KPIs) essential for assessing the center's success and impact are defined. These KPIs serve as measurable benchmarks, guiding the research center in achieving its strategic goals and objectives.

3.1. Review Process

The Vice Chancellor for Research (VCR) will establish the Research Centers Evaluation Committee (RCEC), which reviews the performance and continued viability of existing research centers every three years. The RCEC may include external reviewers; however, no members affiliated with the center or its advisory board can be included.

The director of the research center is required to submit an annual progress report to the dean. The dean will conduct an assessment of the center progress and submit a report to the VCR.

3.1.1. Annual Review

The research centers must submit an annual report of progress. This report is submitted by the Director to the Dean by Week 6 of the Fall semester. This annual review will provide a comprehensive assessment of the center's progress over the previous fiscal year, highlighting the following:

1. Accomplishments and key outcomes.
2. Overview of the financial health, including funding received, expenditures, and budget management.
3. Progress against goals: Evaluate progress made towards the year's predefined objectives and KPIs. Relate the achievements or progress in line with the goals.)

4. Challenges and Learnings: Discuss any challenges faced and how they were addressed. Include key learnings that can inform future activities.
5. Proposed plan for the upcoming year.

The Dean will evaluate the progress of the center and submit the evaluation report to the VCR by the end of Week 8 of the Fall semester.

3.1.2. Three-Year Review

The review cycle for the research centers is structured over a three-year period. Following the submission of annual reports, the centers undergo a comprehensive review at the end of Year 3.

The report for the three-year cycle is submitted by the Director to the Dean by Week 10 of the Fall semester following the submission of the Year 3 annual report. The report will include:

1. Consolidation of Annual Reports
2. Comprehensive Assessment of KPIs
3. Strategic Re-evaluation
4. Growth and Sustainability Analysis
5. Recommendations for the Future

The Dean will evaluate the three-year report and submit an evaluation report to the VCR by the end of Week 12 of the Fall semester.

The VCR will submit the report to the RCEC for evaluation. The RCEC report is submitted by Week 14 of the Fall semester.

3.2. KPIs and Evaluation Targets

KPIs are designed to capture a wide range of activities and outcomes, from research outputs and funding acquisition to public engagement and interdisciplinary collaboration. Other than the following general KPIs, additional KPIs can be developed to accommodate Center specifics.

The achievements of the Center will be measured as per the following 8 KPI categories:

1. Research productivity and impact
2. Funding acquisition
3. Innovation and technology transfer
4. Industry engagement, collaboration and partnerships
5. Community engagement and impact
6. Student engagement
7. Knowledge transfer
8. International collaborations

Each center establishes Evaluation Targets for each of the KPIs and reports on the achievement of these targets in the annual report and three-year report.

4. Termination and transition of research centers

Any major changes to the mission, scope, and name change of an existing center must have the support of all involved Deans, and approved by the VCR, the VCAA, the Chancellor, and the Board of Trustees.

In instances where the review of a research center concludes that the performance is below University expectations, or when previously available funding to support the Center may have ceased, a recommendation may be made to terminate the Center's activities. The recommendation to terminate or transition a research center is made as follows:

Recommendation from the Dean (in consultation with all involved Deans and Research Centers Evaluation Committee (RCEC)) is submitted to the VCR and VCAA by Week 14 of the Fall semester when the three-year cycle report is evaluated. The VCR and VCAA make a recommendation to the Chancellor by the end of the Fall semester. Final decision is made by the Board of Trustees in the January meeting.

5. Timeline

Annual Review

Deadline	Activity	Responsible Person
Week 6 Fall Semester	Submission of Annual research center report to Dean (except 3 rd year)	Director
Week 8 Fall Semester	Submission of Annual research center evaluation report to VCR (except 3 rd year)	Dean

Three-Year Cycle Review

Deadline	Activity	Responsible Person
Week 10 Fall Semester	Submission of 3-Year research center report to Dean	Director
Week 12 Fall Semester	Submission of 3-Year research center evaluation report to VCR	Dean
Week 14 Fall Semester	Submission of 3-Year evaluation report to VCR	RCEC

Document History:

Revision	Date	Description of changes	Requested By
1.0	December 10, 2023	Initial version	Committee Chair
2.0	January 18, 2024	Revisions to articulate the roles of the deans, director, and evaluation process/timeline	Provost and Chief Academic Officer
3.0	June 24, 2024	Updated the administrative titles and office names to align with the new organization chart in the FHB.	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

Appendix XI. Faculty Workload Procedures

This document states the procedures for implementation the Faculty Workload Policy.

Research and Creative Activities

Research and creative activities are recognized as part of the workload for faculty members who are required to maintain a research program. New faculty and faculty members who sustain a research program consistent with an evaluation of “as expected” (or better) by the HOD and by the Dean will be assigned the normal full-time teaching load of eighteen (18) credit hours per academic year (which is normally equivalent to six regularly scheduled three-credit course sections per academic year, usually split evenly between Fall and Spring semesters). If a faculty member fails to achieve an “as expected” (or better) performance in their research and creative activity over two consecutive academic years, the HOD and Dean may increase the teaching load assignment for the following AY by one regularly scheduled section. Once the faculty member achieves an “as expected” (or better) in their research and creative work evaluation then their teaching load is reduced back to the normal load of six regularly scheduled sections per AY.

For faculty members continuously demonstrating excellent research or creative activities, the HOD and Dean may award a teaching load reduction by no more than one regularly scheduled section per AY.

Supervision of Student Work

The faculty workload equivalent to the supervision of doctoral dissertations, master’s theses, independent study, or undergraduate senior design or graduation project is 0.25 Semester Credit Hour (SCH) for every three (3) registered credit hours per student, with a maximum of 1 SCH credited in any regular semester. For any given dissertation or dissertations, the equivalent workload is credited to the faculty member for up to a maximum of 6 consecutive long (Fall and Spring) semesters during which the PhD candidate(s) is(are) registered for credit in the program and working on dissertation topics. For any given master’s thesis or theses, the equivalent workload is credited to the faculty member for up to a maximum of 3 consecutive long (Fall and Spring) semesters during which the master’s student(s) is(are) registered for credit in the program and working on thesis topics. If in any given semester, a student is not regularly engaged with the supervisor(s) then the supervisor is responsible for informing the HOD to exclude the SCH credits from the teaching load reduction during that semester. If the supervision of a student is shared between two or more faculty members, the workload reduction will be equally distributed among them.

For every three (3) SCHs accumulated through student work supervision, the teaching load of the supervising faculty member will be reduced by one (1) regularly scheduled section.

The minimum teaching load per AY is four (4) regularly scheduled course sections. Exceptions to this minimum load maybe allowed with the approval of the Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost.

Appendix XII. Student Travel Forms

Student Travel Authorization Form

Preliminary Information

Travel Organizer Details	
Name	
Title	
Department/ College/School	
Email	
Work Phone #	
Mobile Phone #	

Travel Details	
Destination(s):	
Planned Departure Date:	
Planned Return:	
Approximate number of participants:	
Minimum number of participants for trip to run:	

Rationale for Travel	

ITL- AUS Travel Office estimated cost of travel (itemized breakdown in AED, include cost of travel insurance)	Comparative estimated cost of travel (itemized breakdown in AED, include cost of travel insurance)	Is part of the cost provided by AUS? If so, provide details.	Estimated cost per individual student.

Student Travel Authorization Form

Will there be a chaperone / chaperones(s)?	Yes	No
--	-----	----

If Yes, provide details. If No please provide a rationale:

Preliminary approval allows for the trip to be planned as per the travel details entered above. Final approval for travel is required for the trip to run.

Preliminary Approval

Senior Manager preliminary approval (Required for all travel)

Name	
Title	
Signature	
Date	

To be considered for final approval, Student Travel Agreements. List of participants along with this form must be submitted as per the AUS Student Travel Policy.

Final Approval

Senior Manager Approval (Required for all travel)

Name	
Title	
Signature	
Date	

Student Travel Agreement

AUS strives to ensure a uniform institutional approach to student travel that safeguards the interest of the institution and those of the student. The Student Travel Policy applies to University-sponsored travel initiated planned and/or arranged by AUS faculty or staff. This covers academic or non-academic curricular or extra-curricular activities outside of the cities of Dubai, Sharjah, and Ajman.

Description of Travel:

Travel Program:
Travel Dates:
Location(s):

Student Information		
Name	AUS ID	Date of Birth (dd/mm/yy)
Nationality	Year Standing	School/College
Address		Major
Email		Mobile

Parent/Guardian Emergency Contact Information		
Name of parent or guardian		Mobile Landline
Address		City
Next of kin (<i>second emergency contact</i>)	Relationship	Mobile Landline
Address		City

Medical and Insurance Information	
Health Insurance Provider (I have confirmed with my provider that I am covered while traveling)	Policy Number _____

Please read sections A, B, and C carefully, and sign below to indicate your understanding and acceptance.

Student Travel Agreement

The undersigned registrant represents and agrees to the following:

Section A: Cost of Travel

The following are the cost assignments associated with this travel:

Total Cost per Student	
AUS Contribution (per student)	

AUS will not pay any expenses that the participant has already incurred or may incur in the future as a result of participant withdrawal and negligence, decisions of event organizers or any unforeseen circumstances that may arise.

For more information, please contact the Travel Organizer:

Name	
Title	
Phone	
Email	

Section B: Student Conduct

1. I agree to represent AUS in the best possible manner and to abide by the rules, laws and norms of the hosting organization and country.
2. I agree to adhere to the AUS Student Code of Conduct outlined in the Student Handbook.
3. I agree to travel alone without being accompanied by any family member(s).
4. I agree unless there is an emergency, I am required to attend and to participate in all aspects of the program and be punctual.

Section C: Student and Parent/Guardian Waiver

If the student is travelling overnight and/or internationally, Parent/Guardian must also sign. For graduate students exceptions from parental/guardian approval must be approved by the senior manager.

1. _____ (student name) is a participant in program of which American University of Sharjah (University) is a sponsor.

_____/_____/_____

Date of Birth

AUS ID #

2. The student has voluntarily enrolled in a program which includes travel outside of Dubai, Sharjah and/or Ajman.

Student Travel Agreement

3. I am aware that the use of transportation, housing, safety and maintenance of buildings, equipment, public places, and conveyance; local medical delivery; weather conditions, dining services, and other goods and services in connection with participation in the program carries a risk of personal injury and property damage or loss that may result from the participation in the program and use of the goods and services described above. Further, I understand that participation in the Program involves risks not found in study at the University.
4. I hereby release and discharge the University, and their officers, directors, faculty, agents, employees, facilitators and legal representatives ("the Released Parties") from any liability, injury, damage, or loss arising out of the aforementioned risks or arising out of any other activity incident to the student's participation in the program, including any losses caused by negligence of the released parties. I do not release the university from liability for willful or intentional acts of punitive damages.
5. I understand that the University does not represent or act as an agent for, and cannot control the acts or omissions of any transportation carrier, hotel, or other provider of goods or services involved in the Program.
6. I understand that the University is not responsible for matters that are beyond its control. I hereby release the University from any injury, loss, damage, accident, delay or expense arising out of any such matters.
7. I understand that during free time (both within and following the period of the Program) elective independent travel occurs at the student's own expense. At such times, the student is acting as an independent agent and accepts sole responsibility for his/her own wellbeing. The University is not responsible for any injury or loss suffered when the student is traveling independently or when otherwise separated or absent from any University-sponsored activities.
8. I agree not to sue or make a claim against the released parties for injury, damage, or loss sustained as a result of participation in the Program and use of the goods or services described above. I hold harmless the Released Parties from all claims, judgments, and costs, including attorney's fees, incurred in connection with any action.
9. I further agree to abide by all applicable rules and regulations of the University, and the laws of the governmental jurisdiction at the place or places of Program offering. I agree to indemnify and hold harmless the Released Parties from all claims or losses resulting from my failure to abide by such rules and laws.

Student Travel Agreement

By executing and signing this agreement, I attest to the fact that I have read this Agreement carefully and understand the contents of this document. I have had the opportunity to ask questions as to the nature of the document I have signed. I sign this document of my own free will.

Student Name _____ Date _____ Signature _____

Student signatures are required for all travel

Student Travel Policy List of participants

ID #	Name of Student	Gender	Major	Date of Birth	Mobile Phone #	Nationality/Passport #

Chaperone(s)

Name	Email	Mobile Phone #

Senior Manager Approval

Name	
Signature	
Date	

Mapping of MOE Requirements to CAA Policies and Procedures

The table below attempts to map policies/procedures required by the Ministry of Education (MOE) Inspection and those required by the Commission for Academic Accreditation (CAA). The AUS Policies and Procedures Manual is organized based on CAA requirements.

MOE INSPECTION	CAA
2/A	1a-Mission Development, Approval and Review
2/B	1b-Organization of American University of Sharjah
2/C	1f-Policies Development, Document Control, Review and Dissemination
2/D	1g-Institutional Planning, and Specific Plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability, 2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy
2/E	3a-Program Planning and Development and Refer to other policies from section 3 of Policies and Procedure Manual
2/F	1i-Multiple Campus Coordination
2/G	1j-Campuses of UAE Institutions in Other Countries
2/H	1k-Branch Campuses of Foreign Institutions
2/I	6ab-Sexual Misconduct Policy
2/J	1h-Risk Management
3/A	2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy
3/B	2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy
3/C	1l-Board of Trustees Annual Self-Evaluation Policy, 2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy, Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Manual
3/D	1l-Board of Trustees Annual Self-Evaluation Policy, 2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy, Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Manual
3/E	2a-Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy, Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Manual
3/F	3f-Joint degree program policy, 10g-Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships Policy – Memorandums of Understanding
4/A	Refer to section 3 from the Policies and Procedure Manual
4/B	3e-Course Substitution Policy
4/C	3h-Additional Degree from the Same Institution Policy
4/D	3j-Academic Progress Policy
4/E	3o-Teaching and Learning Methodologies Policy
4/F	3r-Class Size Policy

4/G	11c-Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning Policy
4/H	3k-Grading and Assessment Policy
4/I	3l-Examinations Policy
4/J	3k-Grading and Assessment Policy
4/K	6i-Grade Approval and Change Policy
4/L	3c-Undergraduate Completion Requirements Policy, 3d-Graduate Completion Requirements Policy
5/A	1g-Institutional Planning, and Specific Plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability
5/B	4a-Research Administration and Support Policy
5/C	4b-Ethical Research Policy
5/D	Refer to section 4 from the Policies and Procedure Manual
5/E	4a-Research Administration and Support Policy
6/A	5j-Nepotism/Employment of Relative Policy
6/B	N.A.
6/C	5h-Professional Requirements for Teaching Policy
6/D	5g-Faculty Workload Policy
6/E	5g-Faculty Workload Policy
7/A	6a-Undergraduate Admissions Policy
7/B	6b-Graduate Admissions Policy
7/C	6c-Transfer Admissions Policy
7/D	6a-Undergraduate Admissions Policy
7/E	6a-Undergraduate Admissions Policy, 6b-Graduate Admissions Policy, 6f-Students Records Policy
7/F	Refer to section 6 from the Policies and Procedure Manual
7/G	6a-Undergraduate Admissions Policy, 6b-Graduate Admissions Policy
7/H	6e-Recognition of Prior Learning
7/I	6a-Undergraduate Admissions Policy, 6c-Transfer Admissions Policy
8/A	7f-Security Policy
8/B	7a-Health and Safety Policy
8/C	6t-Student Counseling Policy
8/D	6j-Career Services Policy

8/E	6n-Student Attendance Policy
8/F	6o-Gender Segregation Policy
8/G	6p-Student Activities Policy
8/H	6q-Student Council Policy
8/I	6r-Student Publication and Media or Non-Academic Student Publications Policy
8/J	6x-Student Appeal Policy, 6y-Student Grievances Policy
8/K	6f-Students Records Policy
9/A	3g-E-Learning Policy, 3r-Class Size Policy, 7a-Health and Safety Policy
9/B	3y-Testing Center Security Policy
9/C	3g2-Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy
9/D	8a-LRC/Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations
9/E	8a-LRC/Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations
9/F	Refer to section 7 from the Policies and Procedure Manual
9/G	7d-Appropriate Use of Technology Resources Policy
9/H	7e-Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy
9/I	5p-Employee Information and Privacy, 6f-Students Records Policy
9/J	7b-IT Equipment and Software Replacement Policy, 710-IT Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements Policy
9/K	7e-Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy, 3x-LMS Usage Policy
9/L	3s-Intensive Modes of Course Delivery Policy, 3w-Generative AI (GAI) Tools in Teaching and Learning Policy, 3x-LMS Usage Policy
9/M	Refer to section 7 from the Policies and Procedure Manual
10/A	9a-Internal Audit Policy, 9d-Financial Policy
10/B	Please refer to section 6 of the AUS Delegation of Authority Manual
10/C	9i-Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits
10/D	9i-Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits
10/E	9a-Internal Audit Policy, 9b-External Audit Policy
10/F	9c-Budgeting Policy
10/G	9e-Purchasing and Inventory
10/H	9f-Cash Management
10/I	9g-Financial Risk Management Policy

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10/J	9h-Auxiliary Enterprises Policy
10/K	9i-Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits
10/L	6l-Student Finance
11/A	6g-Information Release Policy
11/B	10c-Copyright and Intellectual Property Policy
11/C	10e-Publications Policy
11/D	10d-Teach-out Policy
11/E	10a-Conflict of Interest Policy
11/F	10b-Anti-Corruption and Bribery Policy
11/G	10g-Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships Policy – Memorandums of Understanding
12/A	11a5-Sponsorship Policy for Requests Emanating from Academic Units
12/B	11a-Community Engagement Policy, 1g-Institutional Planning, and Specific Plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability
12/C	11b-Advisory Boards Policy
12/D	6z-Alumni Relations Policy
13/A	7h-University Health Services - Standard Operating Services
13/B	7a-Health and Safety Policy
13/C	6k-Student Residential Life Policy

Individual Policy Approval Page

The tables below provide a list of policies and procedures from each area, with corresponding signatures (by the Chancellor or relevant Vice chancellor) provided as confirmation of approval.

Policy Approval: Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost

Section Number	Policy Number	Policy Title	Last Revision Date	Approver Title	Approver Name	Signature
3a	0300AP01	Program Planning and Development	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3b	03UIPG02	Program Specification Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3c	0300RG03	Undergraduate Completion Requirements Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3d	0300RG04	Graduate Completion Requirements	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3e	0300RG05	Course Substitution Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3f	0300PG06	Joint Degree Programs Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3g1	0300AP07	Design of E-Learning Programs and Courses Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3g2	0300AP08	Provision of Support to Course Instructors Teaching Online or Hybrid Course Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3g3	0300AP09	Online Assessment Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3h	0300RG10	Additional Degree from the Same Institution Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	

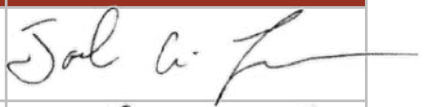
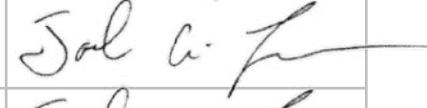
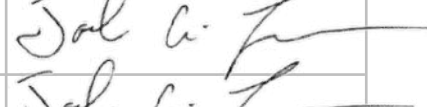
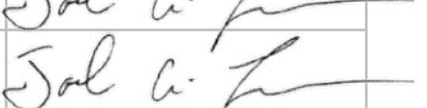
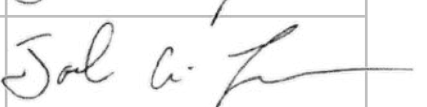
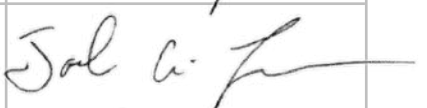
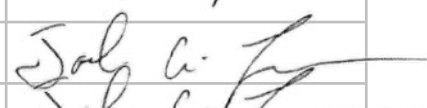
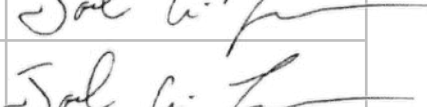
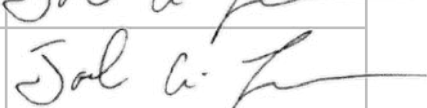
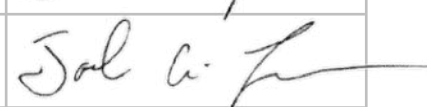
3i	0300RG11	Thesis/Dissertation Supervision and Examination Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3j	0300RG12	Academic Progress Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3k	0300RG13	Grading and Assessment Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3l	0300RG14	Examinations	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3m	03UIPG15	Curriculum Approval and Revision Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3n	0300RG16	Internship/Practicum Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3o	0300AP19	Teaching and Learning Methodologies Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3p	0300AP18	Course Syllabus Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3q	03UIPG19	Course File Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3r	0300UI20	Class Size Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3s	03UIPG21	Intensive Modes of Course Delivery Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3t	03SEUI22	Academic Misconduct Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3u	0300AP23	Conferral of Posthumous Degree	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	

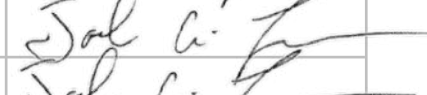
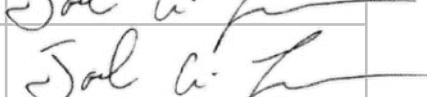
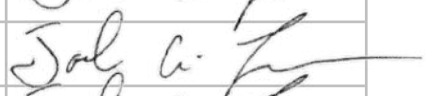
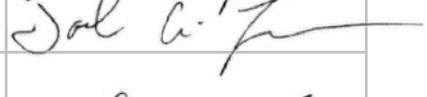
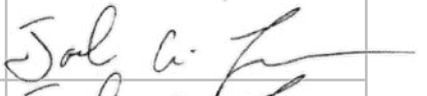
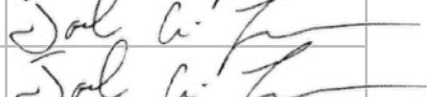
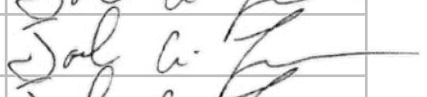
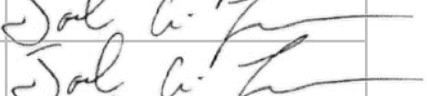
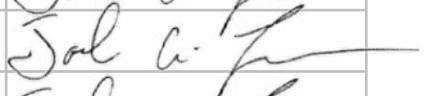
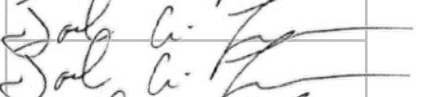
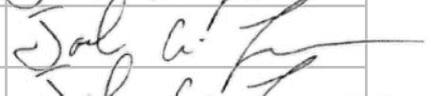
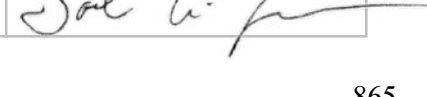
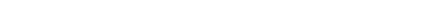
3v	03UIPG24	Creating New Majors Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3w	0300UI25	Generative AI (GAI) Tools in Teaching & Learning Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3x	0300UI26	Learning Management System Usage Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
3y	03UIEM27	Testing Center Security Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
4a	0400RS01	Research Administration and Support Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
4b1	0400RS02	Research and Scholarly Work Misconduct.	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
4b2	0400RS03	Protection of Human Subjects Participating in Research or Educational Activities	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
4c	0400PG04	Student Involvement in Research Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
4d	0400RS05	Commercialization of Research Output Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5a	0500AP01	Faculty and Professional Staff Role Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5b	0500AP02	Employment Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5d	0500AP04	Leave of Absence Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	

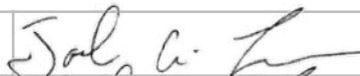
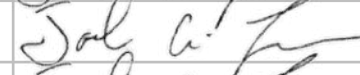
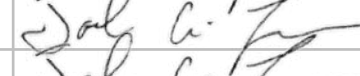
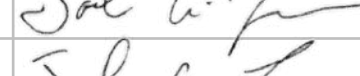
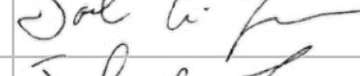
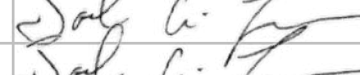
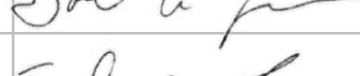
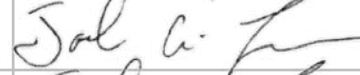
5f1	0500AP06	Professional Development for Faculty	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5g	0500AP08	Faculty Workload Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5h	0500AP09	Professional Requirements for Teaching Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5i1	0500AP10	Faculty Evaluation Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5m1	0500AP15	Faculty Grievance Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5n	0500AP17	Graduate Assistants Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
5o	0500AP18	New Faculty Orientation Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6a	0600EM01	Undergraduate Admission Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6b	0600EM02	Graduate Admissions Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6c	0600EM03	Transfer Admissions Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6d	0600EM04	Advanced Standing Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6e	0600AP05	Recognition of Prior Learning	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6f	0600SE06	Students Records Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	

6g	0600RG07	Information Release Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6h	0600UI08	Degree Audit Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6i	06URG09	Grade Approval and Change Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6n	0600UI14	Student Attendance Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6v	0600UI21	Academic Advising Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6w	0600UI22	Student Academic Integrity Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6aa	0600UI25	Student Load Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6af	0600SE30	Student Travel Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
8a	0800UL01	LRC/Library Policy, Procedures and Regulations	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
10d	1000UI04	Teach-out Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
10g	1000AP06	Cooperative Agreements and Contractual Relationships Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
11b	1100UI06	Advisory Board(s) Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
11c	1100AP07	Continuous Education and Lifelong Learning Policy	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	
6ag	0600PG31	Administration of Graduate Programs	June 24, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Academic Affairs and Provost	Dr. Mohamed El Tarhuni	

Policy Approval: Chancellor

Section Number	Policy Number	Policy Title	Last Revision Date	Approver Title	Approver Name	Signature
1a	0100IR01	Mission Development, Approval and Review Policy	August 20, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1b	0100BT02	Organization of American University of Sharjah	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1c	0100BT03	Terms of Reference of Standing Committees	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1d	0100BT04	By-Laws of the Governing Body	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1e	0100BT05	Board Appointments, Term of Office, and Replacement	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1f	0100IR06	Policies Development, Document Control, Review and Dissemination	August 20, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1g	0100IR07	Institutional Planning, and Specific Plans for Community Engagement, Research and Scholarly Activity and Sustainability	August 20, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1h1	0100AR08	Risk Management Policy	June 24, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1h2	0100AR09	Risk Management Procedure	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1i	0100BT10	Board of Trustees Annual Self-Evaluation Policy	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1m	0100BT11	Board of Trustees Statutory Records Policy	January 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
1n	0100BT12	Maintenance, Storage, and Access to Board of Trustees Materials Policy	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	

2a	0200IR01	Quality Assurance/Institutional Effectiveness Policy	August 20, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6j	0600AA10	Career Services Policy	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6k	0600SE11	Residential Life Policy	September 12, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6m	0600SE13	Student Discipline Policy/Student Code of Conduct Policy	June 12, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6p	0600SE15	Student Activities Policy	June 12, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6q	0600SE16	Student Council Policy	June 13, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6r	0600SE17	Student Publication and Media or Non-Academic Student Publications Policy	June 22, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6s	0600SE18	Student Rights and Responsibilities Policy	April 4, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6x	0600SE23	Student Appeals Policy	May 12, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6z	0600AA24	Alumni Relations Policy	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6ab	0600SE26	Sexual Misconduct Policy	April 5, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6ac	0600SE27	Student Emergency Fund Policy	May 9, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6ad	0600SE28	Animal Policy	June 22, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
6ae	0600SE29	Sustainable Events Policy	June 22, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
7a	0700GS01	Health and Safety Policy	May 31, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
7f	0700GS07	Security Policy	May 31, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
9a	0900AR01	Internal Audit Policy	June 1, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
9b	0900FN02	External Audit Policy	December 31, 2026	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	

10c	1000RE03	Copyright and Intellectual Property Policy	June 24, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
10f	1000AA05	Institutional Relations Policy	September 9, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
10h1	1000SM07	AUS Website Policy	July 9, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
10h2	1000SM08	Web Platform Creation Policy.	July 9, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
10i	1000SM09	Event Support and Support Services Policy	July 9, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
10j	1000GS10	Visa & Equalization Service Policy	May 21, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
11a1	1100AA01	Community Engagement Policy.	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
11a2	1100SE02	Community Service and Outreach Fundraising Policy	June 13, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
11a3	1100AA03	On-Campus Third-Party Brand Activation and Promotion Policy	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
11a4	1100AA04	Policy on accepting Donations	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	
11a5	1100AA05	Sponsorship Policy Requests Emanating from Academic Units	June 25, 2024	Chancellor	Dr. Tod A. Laursen	

Policy Approval: Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration

Section Number	Policy Number	Policy Title	Last Revision Date	Approver Title	Approver Name	Signature
5c	0500ES03	Compensation and Benefits Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5e	0500ES05	Faculty/Staff Personnel Records Policy	September 1, 2025	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5f2	0500ES07	Professional Development for Staff	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5i2	0500ES11	Staff Evaluation Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5j	0500ES12	Nepotism/Employment of Relatives Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5k	0500ES13	Faculty/Staff Discipline Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5l	0500ES14	Faculty and Professional Staff Appeals Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5m2	0500ES16	Staff Grievance Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
5p	0500ES19	Employee Information and Privacy	September 2, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
6l	0600FN12	Student Finance Policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
6t	0600ES19	Student Counseling Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
6u	0600ES20	Health Services Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)

7b	0700IT02	Equipment and Software Replacement Policy	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7c	0700IT03	Data Security Policy	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7d1	0700IT04	IT Acceptable Use Policy	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7d2	0700IT05	Prohibited Acts and Proper Resources Utilization.	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7e	0700IT06	Equipment and Software Technical Support Policy	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7g	0700IT08	IT Clean Desk Policy	May 17, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h1	0700ES09	Patient Registration	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h2	0700ES10	Medical Services Provided by UHS Staff	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h3	0700ES11	Attending Emergencies During Working Hours	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h4	0700ES12	General On-call Procedure After Working Hours	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h5	0700ES13	Ambulance Transfer	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h6	0700ES14	Medical Waste Management	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h7	0700ES15	Medical Equipment Management	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h8	0700ES16	Early Childhood Learning Center	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)

7h9	0700ES17	Student Medical Insurance	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7h10	0700ES18	Rules and Responsibilities of UHS Staff	September 12, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9c	0900FN03	Budgeting policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d1	0900FA04	Financial Planning at Program and Course Level.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d2	0900FN05	Financial Policy- General Insurance.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d3	0900FN06	Financial Policy- Petty Cash.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d4	0900FN07	Financial Policy- Business Meals and Entertainment.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d5	0900FN08	Financial Policy- Business Travel.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d6	0900FN09	Financial Policy- Managing Grant Fund.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d7	0900FN10	Financial Policy- Financial Reporting.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d8	0900FN11	Financial Policy- Bank Reconciliation.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d9	0900FN12	Financial Policy- Accounting Structure.	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9d10	0900FN13	Financial Policy- Accounts Receivable	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9e	0900PL14	Purchasing and Inventory Control Policy	July 3, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aalsuwaidi@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)

9f	0900FN15	Cash Management Policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9g	0900FN16	Financial Risk Management Policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9h	0900FN17	Auxiliary Enterprises Policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
9i	0900FN18	Receipts, Payments, Guarantees and Deposits	August 27, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
10a	1000ES01	Conflict of Interest Policy	July 9, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
10b	1000FN02	Anti-Corruption and Bribery Policy	June 30, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 aa lsu wai d@aus.edu aalsuwaidi@aus.edu (Sep 17, 2024 17:26 GMT+4)
7i	0700IT19	Equipment Lifecycle and Infrastructure Requirements	August 22, 2024	Acting Vice Chancellor for Finance and Administration	Mr. Ali Alsuwaidi	 26/08/2024

Policy Approval: Vice Chancellor for Research

Section Number	Policy Number	Policy Title	Last Revision Date	Approver Title	Approver Name	Signature
4e	0400RE06	Creating New Research Centers at AUS	August 12, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Research	Dr. Steven Griffiths	
4f	0400RE07	Organized Research Units	August 5, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Research	Dr. Steven Griffiths	
4g	0400RE08	Research and Scholarly Work Governance	July 16, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Research	Dr. Steven Griffiths	
4h	0400RE09	Care and Treatment of Animals	March 28, 2024	Vice Chancellor for Research	Dr. Steven Griffiths	

Approval Form for Office of Institutional Research and Analytics (OIRA) Documents

Documents required by the UAE Ministry of Education and maintained/produced by OIRA undergo approval by the Chancellor of the American University of Sharjah before their publication. Prior to the Chancellor's approval, the documents are endorsed by the Director of Institutional Research and Analytics.

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Endorsed by:

Dr. Felly Chiteng Kot

Director of Institutional Research and Analytics

Date



September 24, 2024

Approved by:

Dr. Tod A. Laursen

Chancellor and Professor

Date



September 24, 2024

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